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5001: human race, the

Human beings are the high point of God's creation. They alone are created in his image. As a result of sin they are alienated from God and from one another, and are unable by themselves to alter this situation. The salvation of humanity rests totally upon the atoning sacrifice of Jesus Christ, received by grace through faith.

5002: human race, and creation

Although the human race is the pinnacle of God's creative work, it shares the inherent limitations of the physical realm. Human beings are nevertheless given responsibility to manage and steward the world.

The human race is an integral part of the physical creation

The human race was created from the ground

GEN 2:7 The Hebrew word for man, "adam" sounds like the Hebrew word for ground "adamah". See also GEN 3:17-3:19; JOB 10:8-10:9; PSA 103:13-103:14

The human race was created on the same day as the animals

GEN 1:24-1:27

The human race was created from dust like the animals

GEN 2:7, GEN 2:19

The human race is set apart from the rest of creation

The human race is uniquely created in God's image

GEN 5:1-5:2 See also GEN 1:26-1:27, GEN 9:6; JAS 3:9

The human race is given authority to take care of creation

GEN 1:26-1:28 See also GEN 2:15, GEN 9:1-9:3; PSA 8:3-8:8; HEB 2:5-2:8

The human race is created with the power of choice

GEN 2:16-2:17 See also GEN 2:19

Human beings are created accountable to God for their actions

MAT 12:36 See also EZK 18:20; JHN 3:18-3:19; ROM 2:14-2:15; REV 2:23

The human race is created dependent upon God

MAT 4:4; 2CO 3:5 See also 2CH 20:12; JER 10:23; JAS 4:13-4:15

The human race comprises two complementary genders

GEN 2:18-2:24 See also GEN 1:26-1:27, GEN 5:1-5:2

The human race is one entity with a common ancestry in Adam

ACT 17:26 See also GEN 9:18-9:19, GEN 10:32-11:1

5003: human race, and God

Though vastly superior to the human race, God nevertheless loves, sustains and governs it, sending his Son as a human being to redeem humanity.

God is incomparably superior to the human race

ISA 40:15-40:22 See also JOB 25:1-25:6, JOB 38:1-38:7; PSA 8:3-8:4; ISA 31:1-31:3; ACT 17:24-17:25; 1CO 1:20-1:25

The human race is dependent upon God

JOB 34:14-34:15 See also JOB 12:10; PSA 36:5-36:6; ACT 17:24-17:28

The human race is valued and loved by God

The human race is the object of God's care and compassion

PSA 103:13 See also PSA 10:17-10:18; LAM 3:31-3:33; MAT 6:25-6:33 parallel LUK 12:22-12:31

God wants to bless the human race

GEN 12:1-12:3; ; ROM 10:12

God wants to save the human race

JHN 3:16-3:17 See also 1TI 2:1-2:4; 2PE 3:8-3:9

God highly values the human race and human life
GEN 9:6 See also EXO 20:13; MAT 16:26 parallels MRK 8:36–8:37, LUK 9:25; 1PE 1:18–1:19

God is sovereign and watches over the human race

PSA 33:10–33:15 See also PSA 9:7–9:8; PRO 5:21; DAN 5:18–5:21

God will judge and punish the wickedness of the human race

ISA 2:12–2:17 See also MAT 13:40–13:43; ACT 17:29–17:31; ROM 2:5–2:11

God is to be feared and worshipped by the entire human race

PSA 33:8; ROM 1:20–1:25 See also 1CH 16:28–16:31; PSA 96:7–96:10

5004: human race, and sin

As a result of the fall, human beings have become separated from God through sin, and are divided amongst themselves. All are in a condition of spiritual blindness, slavery and death, and are incapable of saving themselves from this situation.

All the human race is sinful

ROM 3:9–3:12 See also PSA 14:1–14:3, PSA 53:1–53:3; GEN 6:5–6:13; JOB 15:14–15:16; ECC 7:20; ROM 1:18–1:32; REV 18:1–18:5 Babylon symbolises human society which in its opposition to God has become thoroughly corrupt.

The human race is estranged from God

ISA 59:1–59:2 See also GEN 3:8–3:10, GEN 3:22–3:24; PSA 5:4–5:5; EPH 2:12, EPH 4:17–4:18; COL 1:21

The human race is spiritually callous, blind, enslaved and dead

EPH 2:1–2:3, EPH 4:17–4:19 See also ROM 1:21, ROM 5:12–5:14, ROM 6:16–6:20; 2CO 4:4; 1JN 5:19

The human race is divided

The human race is divided individual against individual
 GEN 4:3–4:9; ; ROM 1:28–1:29

The human race is divided man against woman
 GEN 3:8–3:12, GEN 3:16; ; PRO 21:9

The human race is divided nation against nation
 GEN 11:1–11:9; ; MAT 24:6–24:7

The human race is divided Jew against Gentile
 ACT 10:27–10:28; ; EPH 2:11–2:12

The human race is divided rich against poor
 AMO 8:4–8:6; ; JAS 2:1–2:7

The human race has been weakened by sin

The human race has become subject to death
GEN 2:16–2:17; ROM 6:23 See also ROM 5:12; 1CO 15:21; JAS 1:15

Human beings have become weak and frail

ISA 40:6–40:7 See also JOB 14:1–14:12; PSA 90:3–90:6, PSA 103:13–103:16; ECC 12:1–12:7; 1PE 1:24–1:25

5005: human race, and redemption

Through Jesus Christ's death on the cross and his redemption, human beings are offered a salvation that will give them spiritual life and freedom, reconcile them to God, and unite them to one another as part of a new humanity.

Salvation is offered to the human race through Jesus Christ

JHN 3:14–3:17 See also MAT 28:18–28:20; LUK 24:45–24:47; ACT 2:38–2:39, ACT 10:34–10:35, ACT 10:44–10:48; 1TI 2:1–2:7; TIT 2:11–2:14; REV 14:6–14:7

The Saviour was himself a human being

GAL 4:4; 1TI 2:5–2:6 See also MAT 1:1; ROM 1:3–1:4, ROM 8:3; PHP 2:8; HEB 2:17

The human race is reconciled to God through Jesus Christ's death on the cross

2CO 5:18–5:21 See also ROM 5:1–5:2; EPH 2:14–2:18; COL 1:19–1:22; HEB 2:17, HEB 10:19–10:22

The human race is united in Jesus Christ

GAL 3:26–3:28 See also JHN 10:14–10:16; 1CO 12:12–12:13; EPH 2:13–2:22; COL 3:9–3:11; REV 5:9–5:14

The human race is renewed in Jesus Christ

EPH 2:15 See also 1CO 15:47–15:49; 2CO 5:17

In Jesus Christ the human race is given spiritual life and freedom

EPH 2:4–2:5 See also ROM 5:17–5:18, ROM 8:1–8:2, ROM 8:9–8:11; 2CO 3:13–3:17

5006: human race, destiny of

All human beings must face judgment, when God will reward them according to their attitude towards him.

The human race will face final judgment

MAT 16:27; 1CO 4:5 See also DAN 12:1–12:2; MAL 3:16–3:18; MAT 13:40–13:43; JHN 5:24–5:29; ROM 2:5–2:11

Unbelievers will be separated from God

2TH 1:8–1:10 See also MAT 25:31–25:46; MRK 9:42–9:48; LUK 13:22–13:28; 2PE 3:7; REV 20:11–20:15

Those who have faith will live in God's presence

REV 21:1–21:3; JHN 14:1–14:3 See also ZEC 2:10–2:13; REV 7:13–7:17, REV 22:3–22:4

United in the praise of God

REV 7:9–7:10 See also ISA 2:2–2:4 parallel MIC 4:1–4:3; MAT 8:11 parallel LUK 13:29; REV 5:9–5:10, REV 21:22–21:27

Delivered from suffering, pain and death

REV 21:3–21:4 See also ISA 25:6–25:8, ISA 65:17–65:25; REV 7:16–7:17, REV 22:1–22:3

Sharing in the glory of Jesus Christ

COL 3:4; 1PE 5:4 See also 2TI 4:8

5008: conscience

An innate ability to discern the difference between right and wrong, which Scripture describes as having its origin in God himself.

5009: conscience, nature of

The faculty, given to every individual, that is capable of producing guilt, or reassurance in the case of innocence. Though never wholly reliable, the conscience is cleansed when the individual turns to God for forgiveness. It is possible for the conscience to become deadened through lack of use.

The natural conscience

ROM 2:14–2:15 Human beings have a built-in ability to know what is right and wrong.

Guilty consciences

GEN 42:21 See also EXO 9:27; 1SA 24:5; 2SA 24:10; EZR 9:6; PSA 40:12; JHN 8:7–8:11

Clear consciences**Before God**

ACT 24:16 See also JOB 27:6; ACT 23:1; ROM 9:1; 2TI 1:3

Before others

2CO 1:12 See also GEN 20:5–20:6; 2CO 4:2; 1TH 2:10; 1TI 1:5, 1TI 3:9; HEB 13:18; 1PE 3:16; 1CO 4:4 Conscience is not an infallible guide and a clear conscience does not necessarily imply innocence before God.

Consciences cleansed by the death of Jesus Christ

HEB 9:14 See also PSA 51:10; HEB 9:9, HEB 10:2, HEB 10:22; 1PE 3:21

Bad or corrupted consciences

TIT 1:15–1:16 See also GEN 6:5; EXO 7:14, EXO 8:15; JER 6:15, JER 17:9; ACT 5:2; ROM 2:5; EPH 4:19; 1TI 1:19, 1TI 4:2

5010: conscience, matters of

Scripture gives guidance on matters of conscience, particularly in cases where believers may reach different conclusions on certain matters of moral or spiritual choice.

Having a right attitude to Christians with different opinions**Consciences may differ**

ROM 14:2

Different conscientious decisions must not be condemned

ROM 14:1 The gospel dispenses believers from all prohibitions concerning food. Those who are strong in faith realise this, and joyfully accept this liberty. Yet others are hindered from accepting this, on account of scruples about food inherited from their past life. Paul asks those with a clearer grasp of the gospel to respect anyone whose “faith is weak”, so that, in their own time, they may come to share the fulness of the liberty of the children of God. See also ROM 14:10, ROM 14:13; 1CO 10:29–10:30

God accepts and supports people who reach different conscientious decisions

ROM 14:3–14:4

God alone must judge whether decisions of the conscience are right or wrong

ROM 14:12–14:13 See also COL 2:16

Decision-making**Decisions should honour Jesus Christ**

ROM 14:6 See also ROM 14:7–14:9, ROM 14:22; 1CO 10:31; COL 2:20–2:23

Decisions should arise from convictions

ROM 14:5 See also ROM 14:23

Decisions should be based on good doctrine

1CO 10:25–10:26

Consideration of others**Regard for another's position**

1CO 10:23–10:24 See also ROM 14:14

Restraint of freedom for the sake of another

1CO 8:9 “The weak” are Christians who have yet to grasp the full implications of the gospel. At this stage, they are likely to be scandalised by the full public exercise of Christian freedom on the part of those

who are more mature in their faith. Paul's advice is to respect the sensitivities of the weak, and wait for these fellow believers to become spiritually mature. Paul is not suggesting that Christians should cease to exercise the liberty of faith. Rather, he is asking for pastoral sensitivity. See also ROM 14:15, ROM 14:19–14:21, ROM 15:1–15:3; 1CO 8:10–8:13, 1CO 10:27–10:29

Appeals to conscience

1KI 12:1–12:15; ; ACT 10:9–10:16, ACT 15:6–15:11 Peter argues against circumcision for Gentile believers; ; 1CO 8:4–8:8; ; PHM 1:8–1:21; ; GAL 2:11–2:16 Consciences are not infallible.

5012: heart

A vital bodily organ. The term is used in Scripture of the inner life of God or a person. The entire inner person, though fallen, may be changed by the Holy Spirit, in which case it should show evidence of renewal.

5013: heart, divine

The inner thoughts, feelings, will and desires of God, as they are revealed in Scripture and in Jesus Christ.

Aspects of the heart of God

His joy

ZEP 3:17 See also DEU 30:9; PSA 147:11, PSA 149:4; ISA 42:1; JER 9:24; LUK 3:22

His compassion

HOS 11:8 See also GEN 8:21; EXO 33:19, EXO 34:6–34:7; PSA 78:38–78:39, PSA 103:8–103:11, PSA 106:44–106:45; ISA 54:10; MAT 5:44–5:45; JHN 3:16; ROM 9:15; 2CO 1:3; JAS 5:11

His affection

DEU 7:7–7:8 See also 1KI 9:3 parallel 2CH 7:16; PSA 148:14; ISA 40:11; JER 31:3, JER 32:41

His intentions

PSA 33:11 See also 1SA 2:35; JOB 10:13; ISA 63:4; JER 23:20, JER 29:11, JER 30:24; ACT 13:22

His inner pain

GEN 6:6 See also ISA 63:9–63:10; HOS 11:8; EPH 4:30

The heart of Jesus Christ

His joy

JHN 15:11 See also LUK 10:21; JHN 17:13

His compassion

MAT 9:36 See also MAT 14:14, MAT 15:32, MAT 20:34, MAT 23:37; LUK 7:13, LUK 19:41; JHN 11:35–11:36

His affection

JHN 13:1 See also MAT 11:28–11:29; MRK 10:21; JHN 21:20; PHP 1:8

His inner pain

MRK 3:5 See also LUK 22:44; JHN 11:35–11:36, JHN 11:38, JHN 12:27

God's people are to reflect God's heart

COL 3:10 See also 1SA 13:14; ACT 13:22; JER 3:15; LUK 6:27–6:36; ROM 8:29; 1CO 15:49; 2CO 3:18; EPH 4:24; 1JN 3:2, 1JN 3:17

5014: heart, human

A vital bodily organ. The word also refers to anything that is central or essential, such as the inner life of a person.

The heart as a vital bodily organ

2KI 9:24 See also EXO 28:29–28:30; 2SA 18:14; HAB 3:16

The heart as a central position

PSA 46:2 See also EXO 15:8; DEU 11:3; EZK 27:26; JON 2:3

The heart as the inner person

The intellect

LUK 2:19 See also GEN 6:5; 1KI 2:441KI 3:9, 1KI 3:12, 1KI 10:24 JOB 22:22; PRO 14:30, PRO 14:33PRO 16:1, PRO 16:9, PRO 19:21, PRO 20:5, PRO 24:2

The desires

MAT 6:21 GEN 34:3, GEN 34:8; ; DEU 17:17; ; JOB 31:9; ; MAT 5:28; NUM 15:39; 1CH 29:18; ; JOB 19:27; ; JHN 5:42; JOB 17:11; ; PSA 62:10 the love of riches; ; LUK 12:29

The emotions

Fear and anxiety: GEN 42:28; ; DEU 1:28, DEU 28:65; ; JOS 2:11; ; 1SA 4:13, 1SA 17:32, 1SA 25:37; ; PSA 18:45; ; PRO 12:25; ; ISA 13:7, ISA 19:3, ISA 21:4; LEV 26:36; ; DEU 28:67; ; JOS 7:5; ; 1SA 28:5; DEU 28:65; ; ECC 2:20; NEH 2:2; ; PSA 22:14, PSA 55:4; ; PRO 15:13; PSA 104:15; ; PRO 15:13, PRO 15:15, PRO 17:22, PRO 27:9, PRO 27:11; ; ECC 2:8, ECC 2:10, ECC 5:20; ; SNG 3:11; ; ACT 14:17; PRO 13:12; ; MAT 9:2, MAT 9:22; ; JHN 14:1, JHN 16:33

The will

2CH 29:31 See also EXO 25:2; DEU 29:18; 1SA 10:26; 2CH 36:22 parallel EZR 1:1; EZR 7:27; NEH 4:6; PSA 84:5

Affection

2SA 14:1 See also EXO 4:14; 1SA 14:7; SNG 3:1–3:4, SNG 4:9, SNG 5:4

5015: heart, and Holy Spirit

The Holy Spirit comes to dwell within believers, renewing them and directing their hearts towards a greater love for God.

The renewal of the heart by the Holy Spirit

PSA 51:10; EZK 36:26 See also PSA 51:12–51:17; ISA 57:15; JER 24:7; EZK 18:31

The heart as the residence of the Holy Spirit

ROM 8:9 See also JHN 7:37–7:39; ROM 5:5; 2CO 1:22; GAL 4:6; EPH 3:16–3:17; COL 1:27

The heart bears the fruit of the Spirit

GAL 5:22–5:23

Love for God

MRK 12:30 parallels MAT 22:37, LUK 10:27 See also EXO 25:2; DEU 6:5, DEU 11:13, DEU 30:6; 1KI 15:14

Faithfulness to God

PSA 44:18 See also 1KI 2:4; 1CH 29:18; NEH 9:8; ACT 11:23

Other results of the Holy Spirit's indwelling of the heart

Heartfelt worship of God

COL 3:16 See also 1SA 2:1; 2CH 11:16, 2CH 29:31; JOB 11:13; PSA 9:1, PSA 33:21, PSA 86:12, PSA 138:1; ROM 15:6; EPH 5:18–5:19; PHP 3:3

Heartfelt prayer to God

PSA 119:145 See also GEN 24:45; 1SA 1:13; 1CH 22:19; PSA 21:2, PSA 27:8, PSA 63:1, PSA 84:2; ROM 8:26–8:27

Wholehearted obedience to God

PSA 119:34 See also DEU 26:16, DEU 30:14–30:17, DEU 32:46; 1KI 14:8; 2KI 23:3, 2KI 23:25; NEH 2:12; PSA 40:8, PSA 119:2, PSA 119:69, PSA 119:112; ROM 6:17

Wholehearted trust in God

PRO 3:5–3:6 See also PSA 62:8; MRK 11:23; LUK 24:25; HEB 10:22

Wholehearted service for God

ROM 1:9 See also DEU 10:12; JOS 22:5; 1SA 12:20, 1SA 12:24

5016: heart, fallen and redeemed

The inner thoughts and feelings of an unregenerate person are opposed to God, making that person reject God and his love. At conversion the renewing work of the Holy Spirit transforms the human heart, enabling it to love and obey God.

The unregenerate heart

Hostile to God

PSA 14:1 parallel PSA 53:1 See also 1KI 15:3; 2CH 12:14; PRO 19:3; JHN 5:42; ACT 8:21–8:22; ROM 1:31, ROM 8:7; HEB 3:12

Hardened against God

JER 18:12 EXO 4:21, EXO 7:3, EXO 7:14, EXO 7:22–7:23, EXO 8:15, EXO 8:32, EXO 14:8; DEU 2:30; ; ISA 6:10, ISA 42:25; ; JER 16:12; ; DAN 5:20; ; MAT 13:15; ; ACT 28:27; ; ROM 2:5; ; REV 16:9, REV 16:11

Spiritually ignorant

EPH 4:18 See also 2SA 6:16 parallel 1CH 15:29; ROM 1:21; 2CO 3:15, 2CO 4:4

Proud

PSA 73:7 See also PRO 18:12, PRO 21:4; JER 48:29, JER 49:16; EZK 28:2, EZK 28:17; OBA 1:3; REV 18:7

Deceitful

JER 17:9 See also JOB 31:33–31:34; PSA 5:9, PSA 28:3, PSA 62:4; PRO 6:14, PRO 23:7, PRO 24:12, PRO 26:23–26:25; ISA 44:20; JER 22:17; 2TI 3:13

Sinful

GEN 6:5 See also JOB 36:13; PSA 10:3, PSA 41:6, PSA 55:21; PRO 6:18, PRO 20:9; ISA 1:5; MAT 9:4 parallels MRK 2:8, LUK 5:22; MAT 15:18–15:19 parallel MRK 7:20–7:23

Condemned

PRO 11:20 See also PSA 101:4–101:5; PRO 16:5, PRO 17:20; ECC 11:9; ISA 10:12; JER 17:10; EZK 25:6–25:7; ROM 1:24

Conversion: the changed heart

Convinced of need

JHN 16:8 See also JER 29:12–29:14; ACT 2:37, ACT 16:30; ROM 7:7; 1CO 14:25

Changed by the Holy Spirit

EZK 36:25–36:27 See also JER 4:14, JER 24:7; EZK 11:19, EZK 18:31; JHN 3:5–3:6; ROM 2:29; TIT 3:4–3:5

Given faith

2CO 4:6 See also ACT 5:31–5:32, ACT 15:9, ACT 16:14–16:15; ROM 10:8–10:10; EPH 2:8

Spurious conversion

A less-than-saving change

1SA 10:9 See also MAT 13:5–13:6 parallels MRK 4:5–4:6, LUK 8:6; MAT 13:20–13:21 parallels MRK 4:16–4:17, LUK 8:13; HEB 6:4–6:8, HEB 10:26–10:29

5017: heart, results of renewal in

An individual, if renewed and led by the Holy Spirit, will be aware of new spiritual experiences and desires, and also of the Holy Spirit's work of restoring charac-

ter. These things provide evidence of the grace of God at work in the life of a believer.

Inward experiences of the renewed heart

Assurance

1JN 3:19–3:21 See also PSA 112:7–112:8; ROM 8:14–8:16; EPH 1:18–1:19; 1JN 5:10

Love for God's word

ROM 7:22 See also DEU 4:9; PSA 37:31, PSA 119:11, PSA 119:30, PSA 119:111; PRO 6:21; JER 15:16, JER 31:33

Desire for holiness

MAT 5:8 See also 2CH 17:6; PSA 19:14, PSA 24:3–24:4, PSA 73:1; PRO 7:25; ECC 10:2; COL 3:1–3:2; 2TI 2:22; 1PE 3:15 DEU 10:16; JER 4:4

Desire to seek God

1KI 8:38–8:39 See also PSA 119:10, PSA 119:58, PSA 119:145

Encouragement

PSA 27:14 See also 2CH 16:9; PSA 73:26; JER 51:46 JHN 14:1, JHN 14:27; COL 3:15 2CO 4:1, 2CO 4:14; PHP 4:7; COL 2:2, COL 4:8; PHM 1:20; HEB 12:3, HEB 12:5, HEB 13:9

Joy

PSA 105:3 parallel 1CH 16:10 See also 1KI 8:66 parallel 2CH 7:10; PSA 4:7, PSA 16:9; ISA 65:14; ZEP 3:14; LUK 24:32; ACT 2:46–2:47

Desire for the salvation of others

ROM 9:1–9:3 See also ROM 10:1

Various kinds of distress

PSA 143:4 See also PSA 38:8, PSA 69:20; JER 4:19, JER 8:18–8:19, JER 23:9; LAM 1:20, LAM 2:11 ACT 21:13; 2CO 2:4; PHP 3:18

Love for the church

1PE 1:22 See also ZEC 7:10; JHN 13:14–13:15; ACT 4:32; 2CO 6:11–6:13, 2CO 7:2–7:3; PHP 1:7–1:9; 1TI 1:5; 1JN 3:11–3:18

The renewed heart and the restoration of character

Sincerity and integrity towards God and other people

PSA 86:11 See also 1KI 3:6, 1KI 9:4; JOB 33:3; PSA 15:2, PSA 78:72; MAT 18:35; 2CO 5:12; EPH 6:5–6:6; COL 3:22–3:23; JAS 4:8

Humility

PSA 131:1 See also DEU 8:14; 2KI 22:19; 2CH 32:25–32:26; MAT 5:3; PHP 2:3–2:5

Wisdom

PRO 2:10 See also JOB 38:36; PSA 90:12; PRO 2:2, PRO 3:1, PRO 3:3, PRO 23:15

The possibility of the renewed heart becoming faithless

The importance of self-examination before God

PSA 139:23–139:24 See also DEU 8:2, DEU 13:3; JDG 5:15–5:16; ISA 16:7; 1CH 28:9; 2CH 32:31; PSA 7:9, PSA 26:2; PRO 17:3; JER 20:12; ACT 1:24

Backsliding

HOS 5:4 See also 1KI 11:4, 1KI 11:9; PSA 78:8, PSA 78:37; ISA 29:13, ISA 57:11; JER 12:2; HOS 10:2; MAL 2:2; ACT 5:3

Restoration after backsliding

JOL 2:12–2:13 See also DEU 4:29, DEU 30:2–30:3; JOS 24:23; 1KI 8:46–8:51; PSA 51:10; ISA 57:15; JER 3:17

5019: human nature

Scripture declares that human nature was created by God in his image and likeness, and set above all other creatures.

5020: human nature

Human nature was created by God, is corrupted by sin and can only be renewed and recreated through the grace of God. Redemption was achieved by Jesus Christ taking upon himself sinful human nature on the cross, so delivering from the power and penalty of sin.

Human nature is created by God

God created humanity

EXO 4:11; ISA 45:12 See also GEN 1:26–1:27; PSA 95:6, PSA 100:3; PRO 22:2; JER 27:5

God created human beings as male and female

GEN 1:27, GEN 5:2 See also MRK 10:6 parallel MAT 19:4

God created human beings in his image and likeness

COL 3:9–3:10 See also GEN 1:26–1:27, GEN 5:1, GEN 9:6; JAS 3:9

Human nature is created inferior to God himself

PSA 8:3–8:5 See also NUM 23:19; PSA 144:3; HOS 11:9

Human nature is given life by the Spirit of God

GEN 2:7 See also JOB 12:10, JOB 27:3; ISA 42:5, ISA 57:16; JER 38:16

Human beings are dependent upon God

JER 10:23 See also 2CH 20:12; PSA 16:2; MAT 4:4; 2CO 3:5

Human beings have freedom to choose between good and evil

DEU 11:26–11:28 See also DEU 30:15–30:16, DEU 30:19; JOS 24:15; 1CH 28:9; JER 26:3; EZK 18:21–18:23

The components of human nature

The soul

PSA 116:7 The Hebrew and Greek words for “soul” are translated in various ways by the NIV, including “breath” and “life”. It refers chiefly to the principle of life. See also MRK 8:35–8:37; LUK 1:46; 1PE 1:9, 1PE 2:11

The spirit

JAS 2:26 The Hebrew and Greek words for “spirit” are translated in various ways by the NIV, including “breath”, “heart” and “mind”. It often refers to the identity-giving aspect of human nature. See also JOB 34:14; PSA 77:3; PSA 142:3; MAT 26:41; LUK 8:55; ACT 7:59; ROM 8:16; HEB 4:12

The flesh

JER 17:5 The Hebrew and Greek words for “flesh” are translated in various ways by the NIV, including “body”, “flesh” and “human nature”. The term can refer specifically to the frailty of human nature or to human nature in opposition to God. See also GEN 6:3; JOB 10:4; PSA 78:39; MAT 26:41; PHP 3:3–3:5

Human nature became corrupted by sin

Sin has its origins in the disobedience of Adam and Eve

GEN 2:16, GEN 3:1–3:6; ; ROM 5:12–5:19; ; 2CO 11:3; ; 1TI 2:14; ; JAS 1:13–1:15

Sin affects human nature universally

ISA 64:6 See also JOB 25:4; JER 17:9; JHN 3:19; ROM 3:23

Human nature is trapped in its sinful condition

ROM 7:24 See also GEN 6:5; JHN 8:34–8:36; ROM 6:16–6:17, ROM 7:5; EPH 2:3; 2PE 2:18–2:19

Sin hardens human nature

1SA 6:6 See also EXO 8:15, EXO 8:32; PSA 95:8; PRO 28:14; HEB 3:8, HEB 3:15, HEB 4:7

Human nature is mortal on account of sin

ROM 5:12, ROM 8:10 See also GEN 6:5–6:7; JOB 14:1–14:5; 1CO 15:22; 2CO 5:1; 2TI 1:10

Human nature can be redeemed through Jesus Christ

Jesus Christ took human nature upon himself

JHN 1:14

Jesus Christ mediated between God and humanity in his human nature

1TI 2:3–2:6 See also HEB 8:6, HEB 9:15; 1JN 2:1

Jesus Christ makes possible the reversal of Adam’s disobedience

ROM 5:19 See also ROM 5:12–5:17

Jesus Christ makes possible a sharing in God’s nature

2PE 1:4

5021: humanity, of Jesus Christ

See [2033: Jesus Christ, humanity of](#)

5023: image of God

Humanity is created in the image or likeness of God. This image of God, given in creation, was damaged in the fall, but may be restored through Jesus Christ.

Humanity created in God’s image

GEN 1:26–1:27 Image and likeness are probably synonymous terms in Hebrew parallelism. No physical likeness between God and humanity is intended. See also GEN 5:1–5:2

Paul implies that the divine image is associated in the first place with men

Although Paul at points seems to imply that the image of God is especially associated with males, he does not imply that this involves male supremacy: 1CO 11:7, 1CO 11:11–11:12

Respect for human life in God’s image

GEN 9:6; JAS 3:9

The divine image implies partnership with God in the stewardship of creation

GEN 1:26 See also PSA 8:3–8:8

The divine image includes imitating God’s love and justice

MAT 5:48 See also DEU 10:17–10:19

The image of God disfigured, though not totally destroyed, in the fall

ROM 3:23

Fallen humanity in contention with creation

See also GEN 3:17–3:19

Fallen humanity and the exploitation of nature

DEU 22:6–22:7; ; ISA 7:23–7:25

Jesus Christ the image of God

PHP 2:6; COL 1:15 See also 2CO 4:4

He is the exact representation of God

HEB 1:3

He reveals God

JHN 1:18

Jesus Christ is the perfect human being

JHN 1:4 See also JHN 1:9, JHN 1:14; PHP 2:7; HEB 2:17

Restoration of the divine image through Jesus Christ

The divine image is renewed in all who are united with him by faith

ROM 8:29 See also 2CO 3:18; EPH 1:13–1:14, EPH 4:22–4:24; COL 3:9–3:10

The promise of complete restoration in the future
1CO 15:49; 1JN 3:2 See also 1CO 15:42, 1CO 15:45–15:48; PHP 3:21

The Christian life as a process of transformation
2CO 3:18

5024: inner being

The deepest aspects of human nature, known completely by God, to be contrasted with the outward appearance or public image of a person.

The contrast of the inner being with the outward person

The desires of the inner being
ROM 7:14–7:25 See also PSA 51:3–51:6

The inner being is not subject to physical constraints
2CO 4:7–4:18

The inner being should take priority over the outward person

1PE 3:3–3:4 See also 1SA 16:7; EPH 3:16–3:19

5025: killing

Depriving another person or animal of life, usually by physical force. Scripture identifies various types of killing. While forbidding murder, killing of human beings is permitted in the form of execution and war. Animals may be killed for food or sacrifice, provided that the blood is ritually disposed of.

Murder

Murder prohibited by the sixth commandment
EXO 20:13 parallel DEU 5:17

Murder prohibited from the time of Noah
See also GEN 9:5–9:6; LEV 17:11

The life of the murderer is forfeit
GEN 9:6

Judicial killing

Judicial killing permitted for capital crimes
EXO 21:12 See also EXO 22:18–22:20; DEU 17:8–17:13, DEU 21:18–21:21, DEU 22:21–22:27

Executed criminals are under the curse of God
DEU 21:23

Unintentional killing (manslaughter)

The accidental killing of a fellow human being
EXO 21:13 See also DEU 4:41–4:42

The provision of cities of refuge to avoid blood revenge

DEU 19:2–19:13 Blood revenge, based on Ge 9:6, refers to the judicial revenge of a family or clan against a man who accidentally kills one of their members.

Killing in war

Killing in a holy war
JOS 6:17, JOS 6:21

Killing in other wars
DEU 20:10–20:15

The killing of animals

Regulations for disposal of blood
LEV 17:3–17:7, LEV 17:11

Animals may be killed at a distance from the sanctuary
DEU 12:15–12:16

Limitations on the killing of animals
DEU 22:6–22:7 This limitation appears to be an attempt to preserve the balance of nature.

5026: knowledge

A state of awareness and understanding, resulting from information which has been obtained or revealed concerning people or objects. Scripture stresses God's total knowledge of his creation and also the importance of his people knowing his will and purposes for them.

5027: knowledge, God's of humanity

God knows all people comprehensively, their nature, their deeds and their thoughts. He understands every aspect of their lives, past, present and future.

God knows all people

1KI 8:39 parallel 2CH 6:30 See also JOB 34:21; PSA 7:9; JER 17:10, JER 23:24, JER 32:19; ACT 1:24

God knows his own people

2TI 2:19 See also 1CO 8:3; GAL 4:9

He knows them by name

ISA 43:1 See also EXO 33:17; ISA 45:3–45:4

He knows them individually and intimately**JER 1:5** See also PSA 119:168, PSA 139:1–139:16; 1CO 13:12**He knows their needs and troubles****MAT 6:31–6:32** See also PSA 34:15, PSA 142:3; JER 18:23; MAT 6:7–6:8**He knows their sin****HEB 4:13** See also ISA 48:8; JER 29:23; HOS 5:3; AMO 5:12**The knowledge of Jesus Christ****He knows all people****JHN 2:25** See also MAT 12:25 parallel LUK 11:17; MRK 2:8 parallels MAT 9:4, LUK 5:22**He knows them by name****JHN 10:3** See also JHN 10:14**He knows their needs and troubles****REV 2:9** See also REV 2:13**He knows their sins****REV 3:15–3:16** See also REV 3:1–3:2**He knows their past and future****JHN 4:16–4:18** See also JHN 1:47, JHN 4:39 **MAT 26:33–26:34** parallels MRK 14:29–14:30, JHN 13:37–13:38**5028: knowledge, God as source of human**

All knowledge proceeds from God, although many do not acknowledge it. The pursuit of knowledge apart from God is futile and leads to pride.

God is the source of all knowledge**PRO 2:6** See also JOB 28:28; PRO 1:7, PRO 9:10**Pursuit of knowledge apart from God led to the fall****GEN 3:1–3:7** See also GEN 3:22–3:24**Pursuit of knowledge apart from God is futile****ECC 12:11–12:12** See also ECC 1:16–1:18; 1CO 8:1**Pursuit of the knowledge that proceeds from God merits divine approval****PRO 3:13–3:18** See also PRO 2:3–2:5, PRO 4:5, PRO 15:14; 2PE 1:5**God bestows knowledge on certain individuals****DAN 1:17** See also EXO 31:1–31:5, EXO 35:30–36:1; 1KI 3:10–3:12; 2CH 1:10–1:12; 1CO 12:8**5029: knowledge, of God**

Human knowledge of God may be a purely intellectual phenomenon, as when one knows about God through observing the results of his actions, but God's people

know him in a personal way because of their relationship with him.

Knowledge of God through his actions**God acts in creation****ROM 1:20** See also PSA 19:1–19:4; ACT 14:17**God acts in judgment****EZK 38:22–38:23** See also EXO 7:5, EXO 14:4; PSA 83:9–83:18; EZK 6:13, EZK 39:6, EZK 39:23**God acts in saving his people****ISA 52:9–52:10** See also ISA 17:46–17:47; ISA 37:20, ISA 49:26**God's people know him through his dealings with them****God delivers his people****EXO 6:6–6:7** See also EXO 10:2, EXO 16:6; DEU 4:32–4:35; JOS 3:10, JOS 4:23–4:24; 1KI 20:13, 1KI 20:28**God provides and cares for his people****EXO 16:8** See also 1KI 8:56–8:60; ISA 41:17–41:20, ISA 45:4–45:6; EZK 37:26–37:28**In giving them his law****EZK 20:19–20:20** See also EXO 31:13; EZK 20:11–20:12**God judges and restores his people****EZK 11:10–11:12** See also NUM 14:34; JER 24:5–24:7, JER 31:33–31:34; EZK 6:2–6:10, EZK 7:4, EZK 12:15–12:16, EZK 20:38, EZK 36:11, EZK 37:14**Knowledge of God leads to confidence in him****PSA 9:10** See also GEN 22:7–22:8; JOB 19:25; PSA 18:2, PSA 37:25, PSA 71:5–71:6; ISA 12:1–12:2; DAN 11:32**5030: knowledge, of Jesus Christ**

The believer's understanding and experience of Jesus Christ, which arises from a personal relationship established through faith.

Jesus Christ is the supreme revelation of God**JHN 14:6–14:10** See also MAT 11:27; JHN 1:1–1:2, JHN 8:19, JHN 17:26; COL 1:15–1:20; HEB 1:3**Knowledge of Jesus Christ acquired through a personal relationship with him****JHN 4:42** See also MAT 9:4–9:8 parallels MRK 2:8–2:12, LUK 5:22–5:26; JHN 10:38, JHN 14:11**Knowledge of Jesus Christ acquired through the work of the Holy Spirit****JHN 15:26** See also 1CO 12:3; 1JN 5:6–5:9

Knowledge of Jesus Christ is associated with knowing God

JHN 17:26 See also JHN 8:19, JHN 10:14–10:15, JHN 10:27–10:30, JHN 14:6–14:11, JHN 15:15

Knowledge of Jesus Christ should increase consistently

PHP 3:10; 2PE 3:18 See also 2PE 1:5–1:8

Consequences of knowing Jesus Christ

Reconciliation with God

2CO 5:19–5:20; ; EPH 2:16

Access to God

ROM 5:1–5:2; ; EPH 2:18

Becoming like Jesus Christ

PHP 3:10

Peace

See also JHN 14:1, JHN 16:33; ROM 5:1–5:2; EPH 2:14–2:18

Hope

EPH 1:17–1:18

Eternal life

JHN 17:3 See also JHN 10:27–10:28; 1JN 5:13, 1JN 5:20

Renewal

EPH 4:19–4:22

Unity among believers

JHN 17:21

Rejection by the world

JHN 15:18–15:21, JHN 16:2–16:3, JHN 17:14

Knowledge of Jesus Christ is to manifest itself in obedience

1JN 2:3–2:6 See also MAT 7:21–7:23, MAT 25:31–25:46; JHN 14:15, JHN 14:21, JHN 14:23, JHN 15:4–15:5

5031: knowledge, of sin

Originating with the fall, it is revealed by conscience, the law and the Holy Spirit.

Knowledge of sin as a result of the fall

GEN 3:1–3:13 See also GEN 2:16–2:17, GEN 3:22

Knowledge of sin through conscience

ROM 2:14–2:15 See also 1SA 24:5–24:6; 2SA 24:10; HEB 10:22

Knowledge of sin through the law

ROM 3:20 See also ROM 5:13, ROM 7:7

The law was taught to all in Israel

LEV 10:11 See also DEU 4:1, DEU 5:31, DEU 6:6–6:9

Knowledge of sin through the convicting power of the Holy Spirit

JHN 16:7–16:11 See also 1TH 1:5

5033: knowledge of good and evil

Every human being has some innate knowledge of good and evil. The full knowledge of good and evil derives from God and is revealed in Scripture. The human desire of Adam and Eve to know good and evil, and thus gain independence from God, brought about the fall.

The human quest for knowledge of good and evil

GEN 3:22 See also GEN 2:9, GEN 3:5–3:6; 2SA 14:17, 2SA 19:35; EZK 28:2–28:7

The consequences of the attempt to attain this knowledge

GEN 2:17 See also GEN 3:7–3:19; EZK 28:13–28:19; ROM 1:28–1:32

God as the source of full knowledge of good and evil

PSA 119:66 See also JOB 28:28; PSA 34:11–34:14, PSA 111:10; ROM 7:7

The natural knowledge of good and evil

Given in the human conscience

ROM 2:14–2:15 See also JOB 27:6; EZK 36:31; JHN 3:20; ACT 24:16; ROM 9:1; 2CO 1:12; 1TI 1:5, 1TI 1:18–1:19; 1PE 3:15–3:16

Conscience and moral decisions

1SA 25:30–25:34; ; 1CH 21:6–21:7; ; PSA 37:27; ; AMO 5:14–5:15; ; EPH 4:25–4:32

A natural knowledge of good and evil will not necessarily empower anyone to do good

ROM 7:15–7:25

5034: likeness

The similarity between objects or persons. Humanity is created in the likeness of God. Jesus Christ possesses a likeness to both God and humanity, which is expressed and safeguarded by the doctrine of the incarnation.

Human beings are created in the likeness of God

GEN 1:26–1:27 See also GEN 5:1, GEN 9:6; COL 3:9–3:10; JAS 3:9

Redemption includes being conformed to God's likeness

The likeness of God the Father

MAT 5:48 See also EPH 4:20–4:24

The likeness of God the Son

ROM 8:29 See also 1CO 2:16; 2CO 3:18; EPH 4:11–4:13

Jesus Christ was in the likeness of God and humanity

Jesus Christ is like God

COL 1:15 While stating that Jesus Christ is like God, Scripture also insists that this likeness is grounded in the fact that Jesus Christ is God. See also 2CO 4:4; PHP 2:6; HEB 1:3

Jesus Christ is like human beings

ROM 8:3 While stating that Jesus Christ is like humanity Scripture also insists that this likeness is grounded in the fact that Jesus Christ is human. Yet Christ did not share human sinfulness 2Co 5:21; Heb 4:15. See also PHP 2:6–2:7

5035: mind

The seat of human consciousness, thought and desires. Scripture stresses that the minds of believers must be shaped by the knowledge and love of God, as their ways of thinking and acting become more like the pattern set out in Jesus Christ.

5036: mind, of God

God's pattern of thought and attitude of heart is holy, righteous and good. It is expressed in his law and his word, and also in the outworking of his mercy, but it is, ultimately, beyond human understanding.

God's mind is expressed in his law and his word

EXO 20:1–20:17 See also DEU 4:1–4:2, DEU 6:1, DEU 6:24–6:25; PSA 119:4, PSA 119:34, PSA 119:66, PSA 119:89, PSA 119:105, PSA 119:130

The mind of God is holy, righteous and good

ROM 7:7 See also DEU 4:8; NUM 23:19; 1SA 15:29; 2SA 22:31 parallel PSA 18:30; PRO 30:5; PSA 19:7–19:10, PSA 119:68, PSA 119:75, PSA 119:137–119:138, PSA 119:142; JHN 17:17; ROM 7:12

The mind of God is also expressed in his merciful acts

EPH 2:4–2:5 See also NEH 9:31; PSA 123:2; ISA 55:7; DAN 9:18; HOS 11:8; MIC 7:18; LUK 1:78; ROM 9:18, ROM 11:32, ROM 12:1; 1PE 1:3, 1PE 2:10

The constancy of the mind of God

NUM 23:19 See also 1SA 15:29; PSA 110:4; EZK 24:14

God changes his mind

Drawing back from threatened actions

JER 26:13 The idea of God "relenting" does not mean a capricious change of mind, but the considered decision on God's part not to proceed with a threatened course of action in response to repentance on the part of individuals or the people. See also EXO 32:12–32:14; JER 18:5–18:10, JER 26:3, JER 26:19; JOL 2:13–2:14; AMO 7:3, AMO 7:6; JON 3:9–3:10, JON 4:2

Grieving over past actions

ISA 15:11 See also GEN 6:6–6:7; 1SA 15:35

The mind of God is, ultimately, beyond human understanding

Because of God's greatness

ISA 55:8–55:9 See also ISA 40:13–40:14, ISA 40:28, ISA 44:6–44:7; ROM 11:33–11:36; 1CO 2:16

Because of human lowliness

ECC 5:1–5:2 See also ECC 7:23–7:25

5037: mind, of Christ

The mind of Christ reveals the essence of God's nature. Jesus Christ desires that his followers adopt his attitudes; this comes about through the work of the Holy Spirit.

The mind of Christ discloses the mind of God

In relation to righteousness, holiness and the law

JHN 14:9–14:11 See also MAT 5:17; JHN 15:10; 1CO 1:30

In mercy

1TI 1:15–1:16 See also MAT 9:12–9:13 parallels MRK 2:17, LUK 5:31–5:32; HOS 6:6; MAT 23:23; JUD 1:21

The mind of Christ is made known to believers by the Holy Spirit

JHN 14:26 See also JHN 16:12–16:15; ROM 8:9; 1CO 2:11–2:13

The plans and purposes of Jesus Christ are made known to the first Christians by the Spirit

ACT 16:6–16:7 See also ACT 8:29, ACT 10:19, ACT 11:12, ACT 11:28, ACT 13:2, ACT 15:28

Knowledge of the mind of Christ leads to holiness

1CO 2:14–2:16 See also PHP 2:5–2:11; 1PE 4:1–4:2

5038: mind, the human

On account of its inner orientation the fallen human mind is in conflict with the mind of God. It is nevertheless capable of knowing God, and of being changed and renewed by him.

The human mind is the seat of reason and decision-making

JOB 12:1–12:3 See also 1CH 17:2; 2CH 7:11; NEH 5:7; PSA 19:14, PSA 49:3; PRO 15:28, PRO 19:21; ECC 2:3, ECC 8:16; DAN 4:16, DAN 5:12, DAN 7:1; ROM 10:10, ROM 14:5; 1CO 14:14–14:15; 1PE 1:13; REV 17:9

The fallen human mind

The human mind is fatally flawed by sin

JER 17:9 See also GEN 6:5, GEN 8:21; 2CH 12:14; PSA 5:9, PSA 64:6, PSA 73:7; ISA 32:6; JER 17:1; ROM 8:5–8:8; EPH 4:17–4:18

Even the fallen mind can know something of God through creation

ROM 1:19–1:20

The fallen mind tends to confuse the Creator with his creation

ISA 44:16–44:18 See also ROM 1:21–1:25

Consequences of the human mind's sinfulness

Sinful attitudes lead to sinful words and actions

MAT 15:19 parallel MRK 7:21–7:22 See also ROM 1:28–1:32; EPH 4:17–4:19; COL 2:18; 1TI 6:5; 2TI 3:8

Sinfulness leads to death

ROM 2:5 See also ROM 6:23; COL 1:21

Doubt and instability

JAS 1:6–1:8

God can change the attitudes of the sinful human mind

The mind can be convicted of sin

PSA 51:3 See also 1KI 2:44; JHN 16:8–16:11

The mind can be changed

1TH 1:9 See also 2CH 32:26; JOB 42:6; PSA 119:36; ACT 2:37, ACT 26:17–26:18

It is God who enlightens the mind

2CO 4:6 See also DEU 29:4 God may withhold understanding; 1SA 10:9; JOB 38:36; ISA 32:4; JER 24:7, JER 31:33, JER 32:39; EZK 11:19, EZK 18:31, EZK 36:26–36:27; ROM 2:4; 2CO 3:14

It is God who renews the human mind

PSA 51:10 See also TIT 3:3–3:7

The renewed mind of the believer

ROM 12:1–12:2

Renewal brings knowledge of God

COL 1:9–1:10

Renewal brings peace

PHP 4:7 See also ISA 26:3

Renewal leads to obedience

ROM 8:5 See also ROM 7:25, ROM 12:1–12:2; COL 1:10, COL 3:1–3:2; 1PE 1:13; HEB 8:10, HEB 10:16; JER 31:33

The believer's mind needs growth and renewal

2CO 11:3 See also ROM 7:22–7:23; EPH 1:17; COL 1:9

5040: murder

The unlawful killing of individual human beings, forbidden by God and carrying the threat of severe punishment.

Murder forbidden by the law

EXO 20:13 parallel DEU 5:17 See also MAT 5:21, MAT 19:18 parallels MRK 10:19, LUK 18:20; ROM 13:9; 1TI 1:9; JAS 2:11–2:12

Murder is to be punished

Punishment by death

EXO 21:12 See also GEN 9:6; LEV 24:17, LEV 24:21; NUM 35:16–35:21, NUM 35:31; DEU 19:11–19:13

Punishment by banishing

GEN 4:13–4:14 See also PRO 28:17

Punishment by exclusion from the kingdom

REV 21:8, REV 22:15

Unintentional murderers are protected from avengers

NUM 35:11 See also NUM 35:22–35:29, NUM 35:32; JOS 21:13, JOS 21:21, JOS 21:27, JOS 21:32, JOS 21:38

Witnesses are required before murder is proven

NUM 35:30 See also DEU 17:6, DEU 19:15; HEB 10:28

Unpremeditated murder

NUM 35:22–35:24 See also EXO 21:13; DEU 4:41–4:44, DEU 19:4; JOS 20:1–20:3

Premeditated motives of murder

Jealousy

GEN 4:8 See also 1JN 3:12

Lust

2SA 12:9–12:10 Many motives contributed to David's plan to remove Uriah. It began with lust. See also 2SA 11:1–11:17

Rebellion and power

2KI 12:20 See also JDG 3:21; 2KI 9:14, 2KI 9:24, 2KI 19:36–19:37

To remove opponents

1KI 2:25 See also JDG 9:1–9:6; 2SA 20:9–20:10; 2CH 21:4

To take revenge

2SA 13:28–13:29 See also EXO 2:11–2:13; 2SA 3:27, 2SA 4:1–4:8

Robbery

PRO 1:11–1:13 See also LUK 10:30

Persecution

MAT 24:9 parallel LUK 21:12–21:17 See also 2CH 21:13; JOB 24:14; PRO 29:10; MAT 14:6–14:11, MAT 23:30–23:37; MRK 3:6; ACT 2:23, ACT 7:54–7:60; 2TI 4:6

Murder as an attitude as well as an action

MAT 5:21–5:22 See also MAT 15:19; JHN 8:44; 1JN 3:15

Murderers can be pardoned**Unjustly**

LUK 23:25 parallels MAT 27:15–27:17, MRK 15:6–15:11, JHN 18:39–18:40 See also ACT 3:14

Justly–through God’s grace

2SA 12:9–12:13; ACT 26:10; 1TI 1:13–1:15 See also EXO 2:12–3:12; ACT 7:58, ACT 8:3, ACT 9:1, ACT 9:13, ACT 22:4; 1CO 15:9; EPH 3:8

5041: name

The title given to a person or object by one who is in a position of authority or ownership. Names often reflect the characteristics of a person or the aspirations or wishes for that person of the one bestowing the name.

5042: name of God, significance of

God’s name is synonymous with his person, his presence and his power, and is therefore held in the highest honour.

God is referred to as the Name

ACT 5:41 See also LEV 24:10–24:16; 2SA 6:2 parallel 1CH 13:6; 3JN 1:7

God’s person is revealed in his name

EXO 34:5–34:7 See also GEN 14:18–14:20, GEN 17:1, GEN 21:33, GEN 32:29–32:30; EXO 3:13–3:15, EXO 6:3, EXO 33:19; JDG 13:17–13:18; JER 16:21

God’s name is synonymous with his presence

NUM 6:22–6:27 See also DEU 12:5–12:7; 1KI 8:15–8:21 parallel 2CH 6:4–6:11; NEH 1:9; PSA 20:1, PSA 54:1, PSA 74:7, PSA 75:1; ISA 30:27; JHN 17:11–17:12

The name of God identifies his people

DEU 28:10 See also 2CH 7:14; ISA 43:6–43:7; MIC 4:5, MIC 5:4

Dishonouring God’s name is a serious offence

EXO 20:7 See also LEV 19:12, LEV 22:2, LEV 22:32; PSA 74:10, PSA 74:18, PSA 139:20; EZK 43:7–43:8; MAL 1:6

The righteous honour God’s name

PSA 29:2 See also NEH 1:11; PSA 86:11–86:12; ISA 26:13; MAL 2:5, MAL 3:16–4:2

The name of Jesus Christ**Supplication is to be made in the name of Jesus Christ**

JHN 14:13–14:14 See also MAT 18:19–18:20; JHN 15:16, JHN 16:23–16:24

Healing and other miracles performed in the name of Jesus Christ

ACT 3:6–3:8 See also ACT 3:16, ACT 4:30

Baptism is in Jesus Christ’s name

ACT 2:38 See also MAT 28:19; ACT 8:12, ACT 8:15–8:16, ACT 10:48, ACT 19:5

Salvation is in the name of Jesus Christ

ACT 4:12 See also JHN 14:6, JHN 20:31; ACT 2:21; JOL 2:32; 1CO 6:11; 1JN 2:12; PHP 2:9–2:11

5043: names, significance of

Labels that identify individuals. They may also denote aspects of character or reputation.

A name may reflect an individual’s nature

1SA 25:25 See also GEN 17:5 “Abraham” means “father of many”; GEN 32:27–32:29 “Israel” means “he struggles with God”; EXO 34:14; MRK 5:9 parallel LUK 8:30

Additional names or nicknames

MRK 3:17 In NT times an additional name or surname reflecting someone’s character was sometimes appended to the given name. See also LUK 6:15; JHN 1:42 “Cephas” and “Peter” mean “rock” in Aramaic and Greek respectively; ACT 4:36

A name may indicate an individual’s reputation and standing in the community**A good name indicates a good reputation**

PRO 22:1 See also PRO 3:4, PRO 10:7; ECC 7:1; SNG 1:3

A bad name indicates a bad reputation**NEH 6:13** See also DEU 22:13–22:19; PRO 25:9–25:10**Survival of one's name is important****RUT 4:9–4:10** See also GEN 48:15–48:16; NUM 27:1–27:4; DEU 25:7–25:9; 2SA 18:18; JOB 18:17–18:19**Preservation of a name indicates divine blessing****ISA 56:4–56:5** See also GEN 12:1–12:3; 2SA 7:9 parallel 1CH 17:8; 1KI 1:47; ISA 66:22**Obliteration of a name is associated with death****JER 11:19** See also DEU 7:24; DEU 9:14; 2SA 14:7; 2KI 14:27**Obliteration of a name is often linked with divine judgment****PSA 9:5–9:6** See also DEU 29:20; PSA 109:13; ISA 14:22–14:23; ISA 48:18–48:19; NAM 1:14**Bearing someone's name indicates ownership or identification****REV 22:3–22:4** See also EXO 23:21; 2CH 7:14; DEU 28:10; ISA 43:6–43:7; JER 14:9; DAN 9:18–9:19; REV 3:12; REV 14:1; REV 22:4**God knows his people by name****ISA 43:1** See also EXO 33:12; EXO 33:17; ISA 45:3; ISA 49:1; JHN 10:3**5044: names, giving of**

Scripture contains many examples of the naming of people and places. Personal names, usually given at birth by parents, were sometimes changed at a later date.

Names may reflect personal experiences**GEN 41:51–41:52** See also GEN 29:31–29:35; GEN 30:6–30:8; GEN 30:18–30:20; GEN 30:23–30:24; GEN 35:18; EXO 2:10; EXO 2:21–2:22; EXO 18:3–18:4; 1SA 1:20; 1CH 4:9**Names may reflect national experiences****1SA 4:21** See also GEN 10:25 parallel 1CH 1:19; ISA 8:3–8:4; HOS 1:2–1:11**Names may indicate future destiny****MAT 1:21** See also LUK 1:31–1:33**The giving of a name reflects the authority of the giver****GEN 1:5–1:10, GEN 2:19–2:20** See also GEN 2:23; GEN 35:18; 2KI 23:34 parallel 2CH 36:4; 2KI 24:17; LUK 1:62–1:63**The changing of names****On divine instruction****GEN 17:3–17:8** See also GEN 17:15–17:16; GEN 35:9–35:10; JHN 1:42**In relation to salvation****ISA 62:2** See also ISA 65:15; REV 2:17**In the light of past experience****JDG 6:32** See also RUT 1:20**In the future****ZEC 8:3** See also ISA 1:26; ISA 44:5; ISA 58:12; ISA 62:4; ISA 62:12; JER 7:32; JER 20:3–20:6; MAL 1:4**In a new culture****GEN 41:45** See also DAN 1:7**The instance of Paul**

ACT 13:9 The occasion of and reason for the change from “Saul” to “Paul” are not clear.

Place-names may reflect events or experiences

GEN 11:8–11:9; GEN 16:13–16:14; GEN 19:21–19:22; GEN 21:31; GEN 26:32–26:33; GEN 28:18–28:19; GEN 31:45–31:50; GEN 32:1–32:2; GEN 32:30; GEN 33:17; GEN 35:7–35:8

5046: opportunities

Events or moments at which actions of importance or significance can be achieved. God provides opportune moments both for his people to serve him and to proclaim the gospel and for those outside the church to respond to the gospel.

5047: opportunities, in life

Scripture views life as divinely ordained to include occasions when certain forms of behaviour are appropriate.

The need to discern opportune moments**ECC 3:1****Every possible opportunity should be taken to do good****GAL 6:10** See also LUK 10:33; JHN 9:4; EPH 5:16; COL 4:5; 2TI 4:2**Examples of individuals who seized opportunities to serve God**

Rahab saved the spies and her household: JOS 2:8–2:14; JOS 6:23; 2KI 5:1–5:3 Naaman's wife's maid helped Naaman by telling her mistress about Elisha; ; NEH 2:2–2:5 Nehemiah gained permission to rebuild the walls of Jerusalem.; EST 4:14; EST 7:3–7:6; DAN 2:14–2:16 Daniel

offered to interpret Nebuchadnezzar's dream; ; ACT 18:24-18:26 Priscilla and Aquila taught Apollos.

Some opportunities should be rejected

1SA 24:3-24:4, 1SA 24:10, 1SA 26:6-26:11

Opportunities to do evil may have appalling consequences

GEN 4:8 Cain made an opportunity to murder Abel; ; GEN 25:29-25:31 Jacob took the opportunity to "buy" Esau's birthright.; GEN 37:18-37:20, GEN 37:27; DAN 6:4-6:5 Daniel's enemies sought and found an opportunity to lay a charge against him.; MAT 26:16 parallels MRK 14:11, LUK 22:6

Giving others an opportunity to do wrong must be avoided

1TI 5:14

5048: opportunities, and salvation

God chooses the right moment in his work to save humanity. It is important to seize the opportunities he offers, both in receiving salvation and in working with him to offer it to others.

Israel had opportunities of salvation

At Sinai

EXO 19:4-19:8 God had saved Israel from slavery in Egypt. Now they accepted the opportunity to become his covenant people.

At Shechem

JOS 24:14-24:15 After Israel entered Canaan, Joshua challenged them to forsake idolatry and renew the covenant with the LORD.

The coming of Jesus Christ offers a new and urgent opportunity to respond to God

MAT 3:1-3:2; GAL 4:4 See also MAT 10:7; MRK 1:15; ROM 5:6

The message of opportunity continues after the resurrection of Jesus Christ

For Israel

ACT 3:24-3:26

For the Gentiles

ACT 17:30 See also ACT 17:23, ACT 17:31

God in his mercy gives opportunity to repent and believe

ROM 2:4; ; 2PE 3:8-3:9

The urgency of the need to respond to God's opportunity of salvation

2CO 6:2; HEB 4:7 See also PSA 95:7-95:8; ISA 49:8, ISA 55:6-55:7

God will judge evil at an opportune time

REV 14:18 See also REV 14:7

It is possible to refuse the opportunity of salvation, with sad consequences

The lesson of Israel

NUM 14:8-14:10; ; PSA 95:7-95:11; ; 2CO 6:1-6:2; ; HEB 4:3, HEB 4:7 Hebrews warns Christians not to miss their chance of blessing.

The seriousness of rejecting the good news

MAT 10:14 parallels MRK 6:11, LUK 9:5; ; LUK 19:41-19:42 Jesus Christ wept over Jerusalem because the city didn't recognise its opportunity; ; ACT 13:46-13:51, ACT 28:25-28:28

Christians should take every opportunity to tell others the good news

JHN 4:35 See also LUK 10:2; 1CO 16:9; COL 4:5; 1PE 3:15

5050: reason

The human capacity to think logically and intelligently, thereby discovering truth or persuading others. But human reason is limited and cannot arrive at a true and full knowledge of God without divine assistance and revelation.

The human power of reason

1CO 13:11

Human reason is limited

JOB 32:11-32:12 See also JOB 32:3

Human reason is far inferior to divine reason

1CO 1:18-1:31 See also JOB 12:20, JOB 12:24-12:25; ISA 29:14, ISA 55:8-55:9

Human reason may point people towards God

ROM 2:14-2:15 See also ISA 1:18-1:20; ACT 17:22-17:23, ACT 17:27-17:28; ROM 1:19-1:20; HEB 11:17-11:19

Paul reasons with unbelievers

ACT 17:2-17:4 See also ACT 17:17, ACT 18:4, ACT 18:19

Believers are to give reasons for their faith

1PE 3:15

God reasons with his rebellious people

ISA 1:18-1:19

5051: responsibility

An obligation, especially to give account of one's actions. Scripture stresses that the responsibilities which believers and the church have arise from their special and privileged relationship to God.

5052: responsibility, to God

Even though God is sovereign, all people everywhere are accountable to him for everything they do, say or think.

People are responsible for their own sins

God is not responsible for human sin

DEU 24:16; EZK 18:4 See also JOB 19:4; PSA 51:4–51:5; JER 31:30; EZK 18:20, EZK 33:1–33:20; ROM 6:23

Death is the result of sin

ROM 5:12, ROM 6:23 See also GEN 3:1–3:7; ISA 43:27; EZK 18:4; 1CO 15:21–15:22

The law heightens human responsibility for sin

It brings knowledge of sin

ROM 5:20 Because the law brings knowledge of sin, it prevents people from claiming ignorance of the nature and seriousness of that sin. See also ROM 7:7–7:9; GAL 3:19

It applies not only to actions but also to words and thoughts

MAT 5:22, MAT 5:28 See also JER 17:9–17:10; MAT 15:18–15:19

It brings judgment

ECC 12:14; MAT 12:36–12:37; 1CO 4:5 See also JOB 15:5–15:6; ROM 2:16, ROM 14:12; 2CO 5:10; 1PE 4:5; JUD 1:15

Ignorance does not remove responsibility

LEV 5:17 See also LUK 12:48; ACT 3:17–3:19; ROM 1:20

The responsibility of humanity to repent and believe

It is commanded by God

ACT 17:30 See also EZK 18:30; MAT 4:17; MRK 1:15, MRK 6:12; LUK 24:46–24:47

Jesus Christ's life and ministry heightens the responsibility to repent

JHN 3:18, JHN 15:22 See also MAT 11:20–11:24, MAT 12:41–12:42 parallel LUK 11:31–11:32; JHN 12:48

5053: responsibility, for God's world

All humanity has a moral obligation under God to one another, whether as national leaders, ministers, spouses, parents, children, believers or simply as

human beings. This moral obligation is shown in the Scriptures to also include the animal kingdom and the environment.

The responsibility of national leaders

To reward good and punish evil

ROM 13:3–13:4 See also PRO 16:12

To administer justice

PRO 31:4–31:5, PRO 31:8–31:9 See also DEU 27:19; PRO 14:31, PRO 17:5, PRO 29:4, PRO 29:14

The responsibility of Christian leaders

To care for believers

1PE 5:2 See also JHN 21:15–21:17; ACT 20:28

To preach, teach and handle the Scriptures properly

2TI 2:15, 2TI 4:2 See also EZK 33:6

The responsibility of those who are married

To love each other

EPH 5:25; TIT 2:4

To mutually honour each other

EPH 5:22; 1PE 3:7 See also 1PE 3:1

The responsibility of parents to their children

EPH 6:4 See also DEU 6:7; PRO 13:24, PRO 22:6; 1TI 3:4; TIT 2:4

The responsibility of children to honour their parents

EPH 6:1–6:3 See also DEU 5:16

The responsibility of every believer to represent Jesus Christ in the world

MAT 5:13, MAT 5:14, MAT 28:19–28:20 See also MRK 16:15; ACT 1:8

The responsibility of every human being to love God and others

LUK 10:27 parallels MAT 22:37–22:39, MRK 12:29–12:31 See also DEU 6:5; LEV 19:18; 1SA 20:17; PRO 14:31; MAT 5:43–5:45; LUK 10:28–10:37

The responsibility to exercise dominion over the animal kingdom and creation

GEN 1:26; PRO 12:10 See also GEN 9:2; EXO 23:5; DEU 22:4, DEU 22:6–22:7, DEU 25:4; PSA 8:6–8:8

5054: responsibility, examples of

Scripture provides examples of individuals and situations in which responsibility is accepted, delegated or denied.

Examples of responsibility accepted

Noah to build the ark

GEN 6:13–6:14, GEN 6:22 See also HEB 11:7

Joseph over Potiphar's household

GEN 39:4 See also GEN 39:1–39:6

Joseph over the other prisoners

GEN 39:22 See also GEN 39:20–39:23

Joseph over the whole of Egypt

GEN 41:39–41:41 See also GEN 41:55–41:57, GEN 45:8–45:9

Levites to be priests

NUM 3:5–3:7 See also NUM 8:5–8:26

Solomon, not David, to build the temple

1CH 22:2–22:10

Ezekiel to be a watchman

EZK 3:16–3:21

Jesus Christ in dying on the cross

PHP 2:8 See also MAT 26:39; JHN 10:18; ROM 5:19

Examples of delegation of responsibility

Moses chose leaders to judge

EXO 18:24–18:26 See also EXO 18:13–18:23

The apostles delegated responsibility to seven men

ACT 6:3 See also ACT 6:1–6:6

Responsibility delegated to elders

ACT 14:23

Examples of denial of responsibility

Adam and Eve in eating the fruit

GEN 3:11–3:13 God held them both responsible.

Aaron after making the golden calf

See also EXO 32:19–32:24

Saul after not destroying everything belonging to the Amalekites

1SA 15:3, 1SA 15:7–15:9, 1SA 15:15

Pilate after ordering Jesus Christ to be crucified

MAT 27:24

Judas after betraying Jesus Christ

See also MAT 27:3–27:5

5056: rest

Scripture recognises the need for physical and spiritual relief and stresses that the true resting-place of humanity lies in God, the Creator and Redeemer.

5057: rest, physical

The need for physical rest is recognised in Scripture, and provision is made for ensuring that people are allowed time for rest.

Jesus Christ needed physical rest

JHN 4:6 See also MRK 4:38, MRK 6:31; LUK 9:58

The provision of rest

The need for rest

MRK 6:31 See also PSA 23:2–23:3; PRO 17:1; ECC 4:6; MAT 11:28–11:30

Provision of sleep for rest

PSA 4:8 See also PSA 127:2; ECC 5:12

Provision of a Sabbath-rest

EXO 34:21; MRK 2:27 See also EXO 20:8–20:11 parallel DEU 5:12–5:15; EXO 31:15, EXO 35:2; LEV 23:3; NEH 13:15; ISA 58:13–58:14

The purpose of rest

To renew strength

LAM 5:5 See also ISA 40:29–40:31

To know peace

MAT 6:25–6:34 See also JOB 11:18–11:19; PSA 3:5, PSA 16:8; PRO 3:24; PHP 4:6–4:7

The character of rest

The absence of war

JOS 11:23 See also JOS 14:15; 1KI 5:4; 1CH 22:9; PSA 46:9–46:10; PRO 1:33; ISA 14:3

The absence of social strife

2CO 13:11 See also ECC 10:4; 1CO 1:10; 1TH 4:11; HEB 12:14; JAS 3:17–3:18; 1PE 3:8

The absence of fear

MRK 4:37–4:38 parallels MAT 8:24–8:25, LUK 8:23–8:24 See also GEN 32:11; PSA 127:2; MIC 4:4; MAT 6:31 parallel LUK 12:29

The absence of anxiety

1PE 5:7 See also MAT 6:25; PHP 4:6

The presence of God

EXO 33:14 See also DEU 33:27; MAT 11:28

The experience of security

DEU 33:12 See also PRO 19:23

The experience of peace in death

REV 14:13 See also DEU 31:16; JOB 3:13–3:17

The destruction of rest

By business

PSA 39:6 See also GEN 31:40; ECC 1:13, ECC 2:23, ECC 8:16; LUK 21:34

By conflict

2CO 7:5 See also LAM 5:5; 2CO 6:5, 2CO 11:27

By grief

JER 45:3 See also JOB 3:26; PSA 77:4; DAN 6:18

By unconfessed guilt

PSA 32:3–32:5 See also GEN 4:12; DEU 28:65–28:67; ISA 48:22, ISA 57:20–57:21; REV 14:11

By sickness

JOB 30:17 See also JOB 7:4–7:5

5058: rest, spiritual

To be at rest spiritually is to find peace with God through Jesus Christ. This rest is promised to all who put their trust in God and obey him.

The human desire for spiritual rest

LAM 5:19–5:22 See also PSA 55:4–55:8; LAM 3:25–3:26; 1TI 2:2

Spiritual rest is to be found in God alone

MAT 11:28–11:30 See also EXO 33:14; PSA 23:2, PSA 51:12, PSA 62:1–62:2, PSA 62:5–62:8, PSA 91:1–91:13; ISA 26:3–26:4; JHN 14:27; ROM 5:1; GAL 1:3, GAL 5:22; COL 1:20

God promises his people spiritual rest

HEB 4:9–4:11 See also PSA 1:3, PSA 37:7, PSA 116:7, PSA 119:165, PSA 125:1, PSA 131:1–131:3; PRO 29:25; ISA 30:15, ISA 32:17–32:18, ISA 58:11; JER 6:16, JER 17:7–17:8; JHN 14:1; ROM 8:6; 1PE 3:4

Spiritual rest is not for the wicked

PSA 1:4–1:5 See also PSA 112:10; ECC 2:23; ISA 48:22, ISA 57:20–57:21

God's offer of rest rejected by a faithless people

ISA 28:12; JER 6:16

5059: rest, eternal

Eternal rest consists of peace with God, an absence of toil and tribulation and a final deliverance from pain, sorrow and death. It is promised as the inheritance of the people of God.

Eternal rest foreshadowed in the OT

In God's rest after creation

HEB 4:3–4:4 See also GEN 2:2–2:3

In the rest promised to Joshua

HEB 4:8 See also DEU 31:7; JOS 22:4; PSA 95:7–95:11

The eternal state described as rest

HEB 4:9 See also JOB 3:11–3:19; REV 14:13

Aspects of eternal rest

Being in the presence of God

LUK 23:43 See also JHN 14:3; PHP 1:23; 1TH 4:17–4:18; REV 3:4, REV 7:15

Happiness

2CO 5:8 See also MAT 25:23; LUK 13:29

Refreshment and satisfaction

REV 7:17 See also PSA 16:11, PSA 17:15; EZK 47:1–47:12; REV 22:1–22:2

The absence of trouble

2TH 1:6–1:7 See also REV 6:10–6:11, REV 7:14

The absence of labour

REV 14:13 See also JOB 3:17; ISA 57:2, ISA 65:22–65:23; HEB 4:1–4:11

The absence of pain, sorrow and death

REV 21:4 See also ISA 25:8, ISA 65:19; LUK 20:36; ROM 8:23; 1CO 15:24; REV 7:16–7:17

The absence of conflict and harm

ISA 65:25 See also ISA 11:6–11:9; HOS 2:18

The absence of the curse

REV 22:3

Eternal rest is conditional upon faithful obedience

HEB 4:11, HEB 4:1–4:2

5061: sanctity of life

Scripture treats human life as a divine gift and something for which humans are responsible. It is thus to be valued and respected. No human being has the right to take the life of another.

The sanctity of all human life

It proceeds from God

GEN 2:7; ACT 17:25

It is precious to God

GEN 1:27 See also GEN 4:10–4:11; 2SA 18:12–18:13; MAT 6:25–6:26

It is protected by God

DEU 22:8 See also GEN 4:15; NUM 35:11–35:12; JER 22:3

Death is by God's appointment

HEB 9:27 See also JOB 14:5; PSA 90:3, PSA 90:5

God prohibits unlawful taking of life

EXO 20:13 parallel DEU 5:17 See also MAT 19:18; ROM 13:9 So precious is human life that some situations which required the death penalty in the OT are dealt with differently in the NT (e.g., Jn 8:5,11).

God punishes unlawful taking of life

GEN 9:6 See also EXO 21:14; 2SA 12:9; 2KI 21:16

The sanctity of children's lives**Children are planned by God**

GEN 18:10; ; JDG 13:3-13:4; ; 1KI 13:2; ; 2KI 4:16-4:17; ; JER 1:5; ; LUK 1:13-1:17, LUK 1:24-1:25, LUK 1:31-1:33, LUK 1:35

Children are precious and to be treasured

PSA 127:3-127:4 See also GEN 33:5, GEN 48:9; PSA 113:9, PSA 128:3

Child sacrifice is opposed

GEN 22:10-22:12; ; LEV 18:21; ; DEU 12:31; ; 2KI 3:27, 2KI 16:3 parallel 2CH 28:3; ; PSA 106:38; ; ISA 57:5; ; JER 7:30-7:31, JER 19:5; ; EZK 16:20-16:21

Warnings against murder of children

EXO 1:16-1:17; ; ACT 7:19

Antenatal life is fully human

JOB 31:15; ; PSA 22:9, PSA 119:73, PSA 139:13-139:16; ; ISA 46:3-46:4, ISA 49:1, ISA 49:5; ; JER 1:5; LUK 1:41, LUK 1:44

Injury to a pregnant woman is serious

EXO 21:22-21:25; ; AMO 1:13

The sanctity of old age**The old are to be respected**

PRO 23:22 See also LEV 19:32; JOB 32:6; PSA 71:18; 1TI 5:1-5:2

The old are to be cherished

1TI 5:4 See also GEN 47:12-47:13; 1SA 22:3; JHN 19:26-19:27

5062: spirit

In Scripture the innermost aspect of human nature. The three-fold division of spirit, soul and body is sometimes used to refer to this distinction between the physical and spiritual aspects of human existence.

5063: spirit, nature of

The life-giving principle of human nature, to be distinguished from the purely physical aspects of life.

The human spirit as distinct from the body

MAT 26:41 parallel MRK 14:38 **1TH 5:23** See also ROM 8:10; 1CO 5:3-5:5, 1CO 7:34; 2CO 7:1; COL 2:5; HEB 4:12 "spirit" and "soul" may be two names for the inner

being penetrated by the word of God, or they may distinguish the inner person in relation to God ("spirit") from their relation to the world ("soul"); JAS 2:26; REV 18:13

The human spirit vitalises the body

JAS 2:26 See also GEN 2:7; JOB 34:14; LUK 8:55; 1CO 15:45; REV 13:15 "breath" is the same word as "spirit" in Greek.

The human spirit as the seat of thought and feeling**The seat of perception**

EZK 13:3; ; MRK 2:8; ; ROM 8:16; ; 1CO 2:11

The seat of feeling

2SA 13:39; ; JOB 32:18; ; ISA 54:6, ISA 57:15, ISA 66:2; ; EZK 3:14; ; DAN 7:15; ; MAT 5:3; ; LUK 1:47; ; JHN 11:33, JHN 13:21

The seat of volition

MAT 26:41 parallel MRK 14:38; ; 2CO 12:18; ; PHP 1:27

The human spirit survives physical death

2CO 5:1-5:5 See also 1SA 28:13-28:14; MAT 10:28; ACT 7:59; ROM 8:23; HEB 12:23; 1PE 3:19, 1PE 4:6

Jesus Christ had a human spirit

JHN 13:21 See also MAT 27:50 parallels LUK 23:46, JHN 19:30; JHN 12:27

5064: spirit, emotional aspects of

A human being is made up of a variety of emotions and attitudes. Sometimes one trait is or becomes so dominant as to make it characteristic of the entire personality.

Examples of a bad spirit**Pride**

PRO 16:18

Jealousy

See also NUM 5:14

Fear

2KI 19:7 parallel ISA 37:7

Unfaithfulness

HOS 4:12, HOS 5:4

Despair

ISA 61:3

Spiritual dullness

ROM 11:8; ; DEU 29:4; ; ISA 29:10

Examples of a good spirit

Humility

PRO 29:23 See also NUM 12:3; ISA 57:15

Submission

NUM 14:24 See also NUM 14:6–14:9

Wisdom

DEU 34:9; ; 1KI 3:11–3:12; ; JOB 32:8; ; DAN 4:9

Steadfastness

PSA 51:10, PSA 51:12

Strength

LUK 1:17; ; MAL 4:5

Zeal

ROM 12:11; ; JHN 2:17

Gentleness

1CO 4:21; ; 1PE 3:4

Trust

2CO 4:13

God can effect a change of spirit

EZK 36:26 See also EZK 11:19, EZK 18:31; HAG 1:14; ZEC 12:10

5065: spirit, fallen and redeemed

Every aspect of the human personality, including the spirit, was affected by the fall. At regeneration the human personality is transformed by the Holy Spirit.

The human spirit is directly created by God

NUM 16:22 See also ISA 42:5; ZEC 12:1; HEB 12:9 “human fathers” is literally “fathers of our flesh (bodies)”, i.e., there is an antithesis between those who are the fathers of people’s bodies and God, who is the Father of their spirits. Thus bodies are derived from parents but souls from God.

The human spirit was affected by the fall

JER 17:9 See also GEN 6:5; PSA 64:6, PSA 78:37; MAT 15:19 parallel MRK 7:21; EZK 18:31

The human spirit is renewed by the Holy Spirit at regeneration

EZK 36:26–36:27 See also PSA 51:10; JER 31:33; EZK 11:19; JHN 3:6; ROM 8:10; GAL 5:22–5:23

The regenerated human spirit beyond death

It is perfected in heaven

HEB 12:22–12:23 See also 2CO 5:8

It is incomplete without a resurrection body

ROM 8:23 See also 2CO 5:1–5:4

5067: suicide

The deliberate taking of one’s own life, a rare occurrence in Scripture.

Psychological causes of suicide

A sense of guilt leads to suicide

MAT 27:5 See also ACT 1:18–1:19

Defeat leads to suicide

1SA 31:4 See also 1SA 31:5–31:6 parallel 1CH 10:4–10:5; 2SA 1:9, 2SA 17:23; 1KI 16:18

Defiance leads to suicide

JDG 16:26–16:30; ; 2SA 17:23

Failure leads to attempted suicide

ACT 16:27

Desire for death is more frequently expressed in the Bible than actual suicide

The desire for death in a prophet’s depression

1KI 19:3–19:4 See also JER 15:10, JER 20:14–20:18; JON 4:1–4:3 A desire for death does not lead to taking of one’s own life, but to entrusting the place and time of one’s death to the Lord.

The desire for death arising from grief and pain

JOB 10:1 See also JOB 3:1–3:4, JOB 7:15–7:16

The desire for death because of judgment

REV 9:6 See also HOS 10:8; REV 6:16

Life hated because of its apparent futility

ECC 2:17 See also PSA 90:8–90:10; ECC 4:1–4:3

Suicide usurps God’s sovereignty over life

God is Creator, and thus has authority over his creation

JOB 10:12 See also GEN 2:7, GEN 2:17; PSA 90:1–90:10, PSA 139:13–139:15

God controls life and death

JOB 1:21 See also EXO 23:25–23:26; DEU 32:39; JOB 30:23; ECC 8:8; LUK 12:22–12:25; HEB 9:27

Taking life, including one’s own, is sin

EXO 20:13

God’s command that believers love themselves is violated by suicide

See also LEV 19:18; MAT 22:39; EPH 5:29

God’s command that believers should love others is violated by suicide

MAT 7:12 Relatives and friends are hurt when a loved one commits suicide.

5070: Individuals in OT and NT

- 5071: Aaron
- 5075: Abraham
- 5080: Adam
- 5085: David
- 5091: Deborah
- 5092: Elijah
- 5093: Eve
- 5094: Jacob
- 5098: John the Baptist
- 5099: Mary, mother of Jesus Christ
- 5100: Melchizedek
- 5101: Moses
- 5106: Noah
- 5107: Paul
- 5112: Peter
- 5117: Ruth
- 5118: Solomon

5071: Aaron

The elder brother of Moses and Miriam. He served as a spokesman for his brother in the confrontation with Pharaoh, which eventually led to the exodus from Egypt. He was later consecrated as high priest.

5072: Aaron, spokesman for Moses

He was called by God to speak for his brother Moses in the confrontation with Pharaoh and to lead the Israelites out of Egypt. Negligence of the LORD's express command cost him the privilege of entering the promised land.

Aaron's genealogy and family

EXO 6:20; ; LEV 10:1-10:3; ; NUM 3:1-3:2; ; 1CH 6:3

Aaron was spokesman for Moses in Egypt

His call

EXO 4:14-4:16

The brothers meet and confront Pharaoh

EXO 5:1 See also EXO 4:27-4:28

The command to lead the Israelites out of Egypt

EXO 6:13

Aaron's staff

See also EXO 7:8-7:12, EXO 7:19-7:20, EXO 8:5-8:6, EXO 8:16-8:17

Pharaoh's hardness of heart

EXO 11:10

Subsequent events in Aaron's life

The LORD's instructions for the Passover

EXO 12:43 See also EXO 12:1-12:3

The Israelites grumble against Moses and Aaron

EXO 16:2-16:3, EXO 16:9

Aaron commemorates the LORD's provision of manna

EXO 16:33

The meeting of Aaron and Jethro

EXO 18:12

Aaron as census-taker

NUM 1:3, NUM 4:34, NUM 4:46

Aaron as prayer partner

EXO 17:10, EXO 17:12

Aaron's jealousy and subsequent repentance

NUM 12:1-12:2, NUM 12:5, NUM 12:11

Aaron makes the people a golden calf

EXO 32:4 See also EXO 32:1-32:3, EXO 32:5; ACT 7:40

Moses rebukes him

EXO 32:21-32:24, EXO 32:35; ; DEU 9:20

Rebellion against Moses and Aaron

NUM 14:2, NUM 16:3, NUM 16:11, NUM 16:20-16:22, NUM 16:39-16:48

Aaron's authority vindicated

NUM 17:8 See also NUM 17:10

The LORD prevents Aaron and Moses from entering the promised land

NUM 20:2, NUM 20:7-20:12

The death of Aaron

NUM 20:25-20:26, NUM 20:28-20:29, NUM 33:38-33:39

5073: Aaron, as model priest

Aaron was made high priest and charged with the responsibility of making offerings for the sins of the people and ensuring that the LORD was worshipped in the proper manner. His priesthood was to pass to his descendants, thus ensuring its continuity.

Aaron was high priest

His call to the priesthood

NUM 3:10 See also EXO 28:1; 1SA 12:6; PSA 99:6; HEB 5:4

His anointing, ordination and consecration

EXO 28:41, EXO 29:7-29:9; ; LEV 8:12, LEV 8:14, LEV 8:22, LEV 8:27, LEV 8:30

His priestly garments

EXO 28:2 See also EXO 28:4, EXO 28:36, EXO 28:42; LEV 8:7-8:9

The significance of the priestly garments

EXO 28:9–28:12, EXO 28:30, EXO 28:34–28:35, EXO 28:36–28:38

Skilled craftsmen were employed in the making of the priestly garments

EXO 31:6, EXO 31:10

Fellow Levites were to help Aaron in ministry

NUM 18:2

Aaron's priestly privileges**In sacrificial offerings**

EXO 29:27–29:28, EXO 29:32–29:33; ; LEV 2:3, LEV 7:35–7:36; ; NUM 18:8–18:9, NUM 18:11–18:13

In tithes

NUM 18:28; ; NEH 10:37

In cities allotted to his descendants

JOS 21:19

Aaron's priestly responsibilities**Respect for the holiness of the LORD and his sanctuary**

LEV 10:3 See also LEV 10:1–10:2, LEV 22:1–22:2; NUM 18:7

Keeping ritually clean

LEV 21:10–21:12

Tending the lamps in the Tent of Meeting

EXO 27:21, EXO 30:7

Obedying the LORD's commands about sacrificial ritual and offerings

LEV 6:8–6:9, LEV 6:14, LEV 6:24–6:25, LEV 7:1, LEV 7:11, LEV 7:37, LEV 9:22; ; NUM 18:8

Taking responsibility for the offences against the sanctuary and the priesthood

NUM 18:1

The future of Aaron's priesthood**The LORD's requirements are to stand for all time**

EXO 30:8; ; LEV 7:36, LEV 22:3

The priesthood continues through Aaron's descendants

NUM 20:28

Aaron's priesthood compared with Melchizedek's

See also HEB 7:11

5075: Abraham

The OT patriarch born in Ur and called by God to live in Canaan. God promised to make his descendants into a great nation, a promise fulfilled initially in Israel, and

subsequently in the Christian church. His trust in God is seen as exemplary by NT writers.

5076: Abraham, life of

God called Abraham to live as a nomad in Canaan and promised the land to his descendants, naming him “father of many”, although he had no heir until his old age.

Abraham's ancestors, marriage and descendants**The line of descent from Shem to Abraham**

1CH 1:24–1:27

Abraham's marriage to Sarah

GEN 11:29–11:30

Abraham's descendants

1CH 1:28–1:34

Abraham was called to live in Canaan**His migration from Ur to Canaan**

GEN 11:31–12:5 See also JOS 24:2–24:3; ACT 7:2–7:4; HEB 11:8–11:9

His nomadic way of life in Canaan

HEB 11:9 See also GEN 12:6–12:10, GEN 13:1–13:4

God gives Abraham his new name

GEN 17:5 The giving of a new name signifies a new relationship to God. “Abram” has the sense of “revered father”, whereas “Abraham” means “father of many people”. See also GEN 17:15

Abraham buys a burial site for Sarah

GEN 23:3–23:4 This is his only acquisition of land in Canaan. See also GEN 23:17–23:20, GEN 49:29–49:32

Abraham's dealings with his nephew, Lot

GEN 12:4–12:5 Abraham is accompanied to Canaan by Lot; ; GEN 13:5–13:12 Abraham and Lot separate; ; GEN 14:8–14:16 Abraham rescues Lot from five local kings; ; GEN 18:20–18:33, GEN 19:29

Significant encounters in Abraham's life

With Melchizedek: GEN 14:18–14:20; ; HEB 7:1–7:10; GEN 18:1–18:22 with three angels

God's covenant with Abraham**God makes a covenant with Abraham**

GEN 15:1–15:21 See also ACT 7:5–7:7

God gives Abram the name Abraham, as a sign of the covenant

GEN 17:1–17:8

God gives Abraham the gift of circumcision as a sign of the covenant

GEN 17:9–17:27 See also ACT 7:8; ROM 4:11

Abraham's family

Abraham and Sarah were childless

GEN 11:30 See also GEN 15:2–15:3, GEN 17:17, GEN 18:11–18:13

Abraham's pretence that Sarah is his sister

GEN 12:10–12:20, GEN 20:1–20:18

The birth of Ishmael

GEN 16:1–16:4, GEN 16:15–16:16

The birth of Isaac

GEN 21:1–21:7

Abraham dismisses Hagar and Ishmael

GEN 21:8–21:14

God tests Abraham over Isaac

GEN 22:1–22:19 See also HEB 11:17–11:19; JAS 2:21

Abraham's wife Sarah dies

GEN 23:1–23:2

Abraham makes arrangements for a wife for Isaac

GEN 24:1–24:9

Abraham marries Keturah and has children by her

GEN 25:1–25:2 parallel 1CH 1:32

The death of Abraham

GEN 25:7–25:11

The time span of Abraham's life

GEN 12:4 Abraham leaves Haran at the age of 75; GEN 16:3, GEN 16:16; GEN 17:1 Abraham renamed and circumcised at the age of 99; ; GEN 21:5 Isaac born when Abraham is 100; ; GEN 23:1 Sarah dies when Abraham is 137. Ge 17:17 indicates that Sarah was ten years younger than Abraham; ; GEN 25:7 Abraham dies at the age of 175.

5077: Abraham, character of

Despite some shortcomings as a husband and father, his obedience, faith, hospitality and effective intercession were exemplary. Such qualities led to his being called “friend of God”.

Abraham, the friend of God

He was blessed by God

GEN 14:18–14:19 See also GEN 21:22, GEN 24:1, GEN 24:35

He worshipped God

GEN 21:33 See also GEN 12:8, GEN 13:4, GEN 13:18

He had faith in God

GEN 15:6 See also ROM 4:18–4:22; HEB 6:15 Abraham's faith is seen in the length of time (25 years) that he waited for the realisation of the promise; HEB 11:8–11:12, HEB 11:17–11:19

He was obedient

GEN 22:1–22:19 See also GEN 12:4, GEN 26:5; JAS 2:20–2:22

He was a prophet and intercessor

GEN 20:7 See also GEN 18:16–18:33 As a prophet, God reveals his will to Abraham; as an intercessor, Abraham brings the revelation back to God and pleads for him to change his mind.

He was called the friend of God

JAS 2:23 See also GEN 15:6; 2CH 20:7; ISA 41:8

Abraham's weaknesses as head of his household

He was held responsible by God for his family

GEN 18:19 As the following references show, Abraham did not discharge this responsibility well.

He exploited his wife in a cowardly way

See also GEN 12:10–12:20, GEN 20:1–20:18

He fathered Ishmael as a result of wavering faith

GEN 16:1–16:4

He allowed Sarah to mistreat Hagar

GEN 16:4–16:6, GEN 21:9–21:14

Abraham's strengths as a member of society

He was well-respected outside his household

GEN 21:22, GEN 23:6

He sought to resolve disputes amicably

GEN 13:5–13:12, GEN 21:25–21:31

His wealth was a source of prestige

GEN 24:35 See also GEN 13:2, GEN 24:1

He was honoured for his military prowess

GEN 14:13–14:21

He was concerned to maintain his independence from the Canaanites

GEN 14:22–14:24 See also GEN 23:7–23:16, GEN 24:1–24:4

He showed hospitality to strangers

GEN 18:1–18:8

5078: Abraham, significance of

Whereas Jews see Abraham as the father of their nation on account of God's covenant with him, Christians see Abraham as the father of all who believe in Jesus Christ.

The significance of Abraham for nations other than Israel

Abraham was the father of many nations

GEN 17:3–17:6 See also GEN 17:20, GEN 25:1–25:4, GEN 25:12–25:18 Muslim Arabs trace their ancestry through Ishmael to Abraham.

Abraham was to be a means of blessing to many nations

GEN 12:3 See also GEN 18:18, GEN 22:17–22:18; ACT 3:25

The significance of Abraham for the people of Israel

Israel traces its origins back to God's call of Abraham

GEN 12:1–12:2 See also JOS 24:2–24:3; ACT 7:2–7:3; HEB 11:8–11:10

God promises the land of Canaan to Abraham's descendants

NEH 9:7–9:8 See also GEN 15:1–15:21, GEN 17:1–17:8; EXO 6:8; DEU 9:5; ACT 7:4–7:5

God is subsequently known in Israel as the God of Abraham

1KI 18:36 See also GEN 24:26–24:27, GEN 26:24, GEN 31:53; PSA 47:9; ACT 7:32; EXO 3:6

Abraham is seen as the father of the Jewish nation

JHN 8:39 See also PSA 105:5–105:6; ISA 41:8, ISA 51:1–51:2; LUK 1:54–1:55; JHN 8:33; ACT 13:26; ROM 11:1

God deals with Israel on the basis of his covenant with Abraham

1CH 16:14–16:18 parallel PSA 105:7–105:11 See also EXO 2:23–2:25; 2KI 13:22–13:23; PSA 105:42–105:45; LUK 1:68–1:75

Circumcision was the sign of participation in God's covenant with Abraham

GEN 17:9–17:14 See also LEV 12:3; JHN 7:22; ACT 15:1

The significance of Abraham for Christians

Abraham was an ancestor of Jesus Christ

MAT 1:1 parallel LUK 3:34

Jesus Christ attacks Jewish confidence in mere physical descent from Abraham

MAT 3:9–3:10 parallel LUK 3:8–3:9 See also JHN 8:33–8:41

Jesus Christ makes a point of identifying outcasts as children of Abraham

LUK 19:7–19:9 See also LUK 13:10–13:16

God's promise to Abraham is not inherited by those who obey the law

GAL 3:15–3:18 See also ROM 4:13–4:16; GAL 4:21–4:31

God's promise to Abraham is fulfilled in Jesus Christ, who is Abraham's seed

GAL 3:16 See also GEN 12:7, GEN 13:15, GEN 24:7; GAL 3:19, GAL 3:29

Abraham is the father of those who are justified by faith

GAL 3:6–3:9 See also GEN 15:6; ROM 4:1–4:25

Abraham's obedience to God shows that faith must lead to good works

JAS 2:20–2:24

Fellowship with Abraham is a symbol of salvation

MAT 8:11–8:12 See also LUK 13:28–13:29, LUK 16:19–16:26

5080: Adam

The Hebrew word “adam” is used both for “man” in general and also as the personal name of the first man that God created. It sounds like the word “adamah”, meaning “ground”.

5081: Adam, creation and life of

Adam is portrayed as the height of God's creation, made in the image and likeness of God, and entrusted with the stewardship of creation.

The creation of Adam

As a unique event

GEN 2:7

In the image of God

GEN 1:26–1:27 See also GEN 5:1; 1CO 11:7; JAS 3:9

His commission from God

GEN 1:28, GEN 2:15 See also GEN 1:26; PSA 8:4–8:8, PSA 115:14–115:16

His incompleteness without Eve

GEN 2:18–2:24 See also GEN 1:27, GEN 5:1–5:2; MAT 19:4–19:6 parallel MRK 10:6–10:9

His position and privileges

GEN 1:28–1:29, GEN 2:19–2:20

The limitations of his freedom

GEN 2:16–2:17 See also GEN 3:1–3:3

The fall of Adam

The nature of his sin

GEN 3:6 See also GEN 2:16–2:17, GEN 3:12, GEN 3:17; HOS 6:7

Immediate results of his sin

GEN 3:7–3:10

God's curse upon Adam and the earth

GEN 3:17–3:19 See also GEN 5:29; JOB 7:1, JOB 10:9; PSA 90:3; ECC 2:17–2:23, ECC 3:20; ROM 8:20

The life of Adam after the fall**His expulsion from the garden**

GEN 3:21–3:24

His children

GEN 4:1–4:2 See also GEN 4:25, GEN 5:3–5:4; 1CH 1:1

His lifespan and death

GEN 5:5

5082: Adam, significance of

Throughout the NT, Adam is seen as a real historical figure, from whom all humanity is descended and by whose sin all humanity is affected.

Adam as the original member of the human race

ACT 17:26; 1CO 15:45–15:49 See also GEN 2:7; LUK 3:23–3:38 The genealogy of Jesus Christ is traced back to Adam.

Adam's relationship with Eve**Adam as one flesh with Eve**

MAT 19:3–19:6 parallel MRK 10:2–10:9 See also GEN 2:24; 1CO 6:16; EPH 5:31

Adam as the head of Eve

1CO 11:3, 1CO 11:8–11:12; ; 1TI 2:12–2:15

The reality and results of Adam's sin**Sin spread to all the human race**

ROM 5:19 See also GEN 4:3–4:16; PSA 51:5; PRO 20:9; ROM 3:23

Death was introduced into the world

ROM 5:12 See also ROM 5:14–5:17, ROM 6:23; 1CO 15:21–15:22

Condemnation for the human race resulted

ROM 5:16, ROM 5:18

5083: Adam, and Jesus Christ

Paul presents Jesus Christ as both the last Adam, succeeding where the first Adam failed, and the second man, standing at the head of a new humanity.

The contrast between the first and second Adam

ROM 5:14 By his sin Adam brought universal misery on humanity. In this he is the foreshadower and prototype of Jesus Christ, who through his righteous act brings the universal hope of redemption.

The contrast in nature of the first Adam and the second Adam

Adam was a living being; Jesus Christ is a life-giving being

1CO 15:45

Adam was natural, Jesus Christ is spiritual

1CO 15:46

Adam was earthly, Jesus Christ is heavenly

1CO 15:47

The contrast in the consequences of the actions of the first Adam and the second Adam

Adam brought death, Jesus Christ brings life

ROM 5:15, ROM 5:17; 1CO 15:21–15:23

Adam brought judgment, Jesus Christ brings justification

ROM 5:16, ROM 5:18–5:19

The assurance this doctrine brings

1CO 15:48–15:49 See also PHP 3:20–3:21

5085: David

The youngest son of Jesse and great-grandson of Ruth and Boaz, who became Israel's greatest king. Born in the town of Bethlehem, he probably lived c. 1040–970 B.C.

5086: David, rise of

David rose from humble origins to become Israel's greatest king. His rise to power is seen by OT writers as evidence of God's guiding hand upon both David and Israel.

David was the great-grandson of Ruth and Boaz

RUT 4:13–4:22

David was anointed king by Samuel

1SA 16:1–16:13

David was a member of Saul's court

1SA 16:17–16:23 See also 1SA 18:2, 1SA 18:5

David's defeat of Goliath

1SA 17:50–17:51 See also 1SA 17:4–17:11, 1SA 17:17–17:26, 1SA 17:32–17:54

David's friendship with Jonathan

1SA 18:1 See also 1SA 19:1–19:7, 1SA 20:1–20:42, 1SA 23:16–23:18; 2SA 1:25–1:27

The relationship between David and Saul

Saul's jealousy of David

1SA 18:9–18:12 See also 1SA 18:15, 1SA 18:28–18:29, 1SA 19:1, 1SA 19:9–19:17; PSA 59:1–59:4

His flight from Saul

1SA 23:14 See also 1SA 21:10, 1SA 22:1–22:5, 1SA 27:1–27:6; PSA 52:1, PSA 54:1–54:7, PSA 56:1–56:2, PSA 57:1–57:6

His refusal to harm Saul

1SA 24:3–24:7 See also 1SA 26:7–26:25

His reaction to Saul's death

2SA 1:11–1:12 See also 2SA 1:17–1:27

5087: David, reign of

David reigned over Judah for seven and a half years and over all Israel for 33 years. He extended the kingdom to the boundaries promised by God to Joshua.

David reigned over Judah in Hebron

2SA 2:4 See also 2SA 2:8–2:11, 2SA 3:1, 2SA 3:12–3:21

David reigned over Israel in Jerusalem

2SA 5:3–5:10 parallel 1CH 11:1–11:9

David extended the boundaries of the kingdom

2SA 8:6 See also 2SA 5:17–5:25 parallel 1CH 14:8–14:17; 2SA 8:1–8:14 parallel 1CH 18:1–18:13; 2SA 10:1–10:19

David's kingship

He ruled justly

2SA 8:15 See also 2SA 9:1–9:11, 2SA 23:3–23:4

His problems with his children

2SA 13:1–13:21

Absalom's conspiracy

2SA 15:10 See also 2SA 15:13–15:18, 2SA 18:1–18:17, 2SA 18:28–18:33, 2SA 19:4–19:8; PSA 3:1–3:8

David's mightiest warriors were called ``the Thirty''

2SA 23:13–23:17 parallel 1CH 11:15–11:19 See also 2SA 23:24–23:39 parallel 1CH 11:26–11:47; 2SA 23:20–23:23 parallel 1CH 11:23–11:25; 1CH 12:4, 1CH 12:16–12:18, 1CH 27:5–27:6

The struggle against the northern supporters of Saul

2SA 3:1

The revolt led by Sheba

2SA 20:1–20:22

The census of Israel and Judah

See also 2SA 24:1–24:17

Solomon succeeds David despite the claims of Adonijah

1KI 1:5–1:53

The death of David

1KI 2:10–2:12 parallel 1CH 29:26–29:28 See also 2SA 23:1–23:7; 1KI 2:1–2:9

5088: David, character of

David, although not perfect, is portrayed as a man and a king after God's own heart.

David's appearance and attributes

1SA 16:18 See also 1SA 16:12

David's characteristics

His dependence upon God

1SA 13:14 See also 1SA 23:2, 1SA 23:4, 1SA 23:9–23:13; PSA 23:1–23:6, PSA 34:1–34:7, PSA 54:1–54:4, PSA 62:1–62:2, PSA 142:1–142:7

His trust in God

1SA 17:34–17:37 See also 1SA 17:40–17:51

His loyalty to others

1SA 20:41–20:42 See also 2SA 9:1, 2SA 9:6–9:7

His respect for those in authority

1SA 24:1–24:7 See also 1SA 26:1–26:25

His deep humanity is evident in his paternal grief

2SA 18:32–18:33 See also 2SA 13:38–13:39, 2SA 18:5, 2SA 19:1–19:7

David's abilities

He was a strategist and courageous commander

2SA 8:3–8:6 See also 1SA 17:34–17:47; 2SA 5:6–5:10, 2SA 5:17–5:25, 2SA 8:1, 2SA 8:13–8:14; 1SA 27:5–27:11

He was a musician and poet

2SA 23:1 1SA 16:18, 1SA 16:23, 1SA 18:10, 1SA 19:9–19:10; 2SA 22:1 parallel PSA 18:0 He sang; ; 1CH 16:7; ; PSA 3:0, PSA 34:0, PSA 51:0, PSA 52:0, PSA 54:0, PSA 63:0

He was a wise leader

2SA 8:15 See also 2SA 7:18–7:29, 2SA 15:14, 2SA 15:25–15:29, 2SA 15:32–15:36, 2SA 16:5–16:12, 2SA 19:18–19:29, 2SA 21:1–21:9

His military activities prevented him from building the temple

1KI 5:3; ; 1CH 22:7–22:8

David's sin and repentance

His adultery with Bathsheba and murder of Uriah

2SA 11:2–11:4, 2SA 12:7–12:10 See also 2SA 11:14–11:17, 2SA 11:26–11:27

His repentance

2SA 12:13–12:23; ; PSA 51:1–51:19

5089: David, significance of

David was instrumental in the establishment of Jerusalem as the centre of Israel's worship. Through David's personal rule, God exercised his own kingship over his people. David thus foreshadowed the Messiah, who would spring from his royal line.

The historical significance of David**The establishment of Jerusalem as the centre of worship**

2SA 6:1–6:11 parallel 1CH 13:1–13:14; ; 2SA 6:12–6:15 parallel 1CH 15:25–15:28

Preparations for building the temple

1CH 28:2–28:9 See also 2SA 7:1–7:7 parallel 1CH 17:1–17:6; 1KI 8:17–8:19 parallel 2CH 6:7–6:9; 1CH 22:1–22:19, 1CH 23:4–23:5, 1CH 25:1, 1CH 26:12, 1CH 29:1–29:5

The spiritual significance of David**The son of God and chosen king**

PSA 2:6–2:7

An eternal priest

See also PSA 110:4

A sign of God's final victory

PSA 2:8–2:11, PSA 110:1–110:3

God's covenant with David

2SA 7:11–7:16 parallel 1CH 17:10–17:14 See also 1KI 11:11–11:13; 2KI 8:19 parallel 2CH 21:7; PSA 89:1–89:37, PSA 132:12; ISA 55:3; JER 33:17; EZK 37:21–37:28; ACT 13:22–13:23, ACT 13:32–13:37

David as a type of Jesus Christ**Jesus Christ as the Son of David**

JER 23:5; EZK 34:23–34:24 See also ISA 16:5; MAT 1:1, MAT 12:23, MAT 15:22, MAT 21:9, MAT 20:30 parallels MRK 10:46–10:47, LUK 18:35–18:38; JHN 7:41–7:42; REV 22:16

Jesus Christ's kingship is linked with David's kingship

LUK 1:32–1:33 See also ISA 9:7, ISA 16:5; JER 23:5–23:6; MAT 22:41–22:46 parallels MRK 12:35–12:37, LUK 20:41–20:44; PSA 110:1

5091: Deborah

An outstanding leader in Israel when the nation faced a crisis of resurgent Canaanite power in the time of the judges. Her name means "bee".

Deborah's calling**As a judge**

JDG 4:4–4:5, JDG 5:7 She was probably called upon to settle intertribal disputes, "mother in Israel" meaning one who promotes the unity of God's family.

As a prophetess

JDG 4:4, JDG 4:7, JDG 4:9, JDG 4:14

Deborah's response to the Canaanite threat**She was petitioned by the people**

JDG 5:11–5:12

She appointed Barak commander-in-chief

JDG 4:6

She accompanied the army into battle

JDG 4:8–4:10

She led the people in victory celebration

JDG 5:1–5:3, JDG 5:28–5:31 In this respect she is like Moses and Miriam (Ex 15:1,20).

Deborah's character**She was wise, decisive, courageous, inspiring and bold**

JDG 4:5–4:9, JDG 4:14, JDG 5:9, JDG 5:15–5:17 Her confidence was in God's word and promise and she did not shrink from rebuking God's people.

She gave credit to others

JDG 5:14–5:15, JDG 5:18–5:19, JDG 5:24–5:27

She gave glory to God

JDG 5:20–5:23 These verses are a poetic acknowledgment that God has fought on Israel's behalf.

She was God's person for the hour

JDG 5:31 See also EST 4:14

5092: Elijah

Living in Israel, his ministry as a prophet was to oppose the worship of Baal in Israel, and the sin, injustices and idolatry of Ahab, Jezebel and Ahaziah. He came, probably, from Tishbe in Gilead, but his parentage is not certain. His name means "the LORD is God".

Elijah's special standing as a prophet**His prophecies and prayers were fulfilled and attested by miracles**

Drought prophesied and experienced: 1KI 17:1, 1KI 17:7, 1KI 18:1–18:6; ; JAS 5:17; 1KI 17:14 provision of flour and oil prophesied; 1KI 18:41, 1KI 18:44–18:45; 1KI 17:17–17:24 The widow's son is restored to life.; 1KI 18:36–18:38; ;

2KI 1:10, 2KI 1:12; 1KI 21:20–21:24, 1KI 22:37–22:38; ; 2KI 9:30–9:37

The word of the LORD came to him

1KI 19:9–19:18 See also 1KI 17:8, 1KI 18:1, 1KI 21:17, 1KI 21:23, 1KI 21:28, 1KI 22:38

Elijah's ministry to Israel

He confronts Ahab, king of Israel

1KI 18:16–18:18 See also 1KI 21:20–21:22

He challenges the people of Israel

1KI 18:21

He challenges Baal and his prophets

1KI 18:20–18:29, 1KI 18:36–18:38

The prophets of Baal are sentenced to death and executed

See also 1KI 18:40

Elijah calls down fire on Ahaziah's messengers

2KI 1:1–1:14

He predicts Ahaziah's death

2KI 1:16–1:17

He appoints successors to continue the fight against Baal worshippers

1KI 19:15–19:17 See also 1KI 19:19–19:21 Elisha is called; 2KI 8:13–8:15, 2KI 9:1–9:13 Jehu is anointed by one of Elisha's assistants.

He does not die, but is taken up to heaven

2KI 2:11–2:12

Elijah's lifestyle and character

It was one of simplicity

See also 1KI 17:2–17:6, 1KI 19:4–19:5; 2KI 1:8

He was a man of action and physical endurance

1KI 17:1, 1KI 17:3, 1KI 17:9

Parallels between Elijah and Moses

2KI 2:8 See also EXO 14:21–14:22; JOS 3:14–3:17; 2KI 2:14

Elijah's return is awaited by Israel

Some Jews believed John the Baptist was Elijah returned

LUK 1:17 See also MAL 4:5–4:6 MAT 11:14, MAT 17:9–17:13 parallel MRK 9:9–9:13 JHN 1:21 John the Baptist denies being Elijah. 2KI 1:8; MAT 3:4 parallel MRK 1:6

Elijah appears at the transfiguration of Jesus Christ

MAT 17:1–17:8 parallel MRK 9:2–9:8

5093: Eve

The wife of Adam and the first woman created. Her significance lies in being the first to be deceived and become disobedient to God. She is only given her name (which resembles the word for “living”) by Adam after the expulsion from Eden.

Eve was created in the image of God

GEN 1:27

Eve was a companion for Adam in Eden

GEN 2:18

Eve was deceived

GEN 3:1–3:7 See also GEN 3:13; 2CO 11:3; 1TI 2:13–2:14

Events in Eve's life

Her creation

GEN 1:26–1:27, GEN 2:21–2:23

Her shame

GEN 3:8–3:13

The curse upon her

GEN 3:16

Adam names her

GEN 3:20

The LORD clothes her

GEN 3:21

She becomes a mother

GEN 4:1–4:2

5094: Jacob

The grandson of Abraham, and one of the two twin sons of Isaac. As the firstborn son of Isaac, Esau was entitled to inherit all of Isaac's property. However, he sold this to his brother Jacob to satisfy his immediate physical hunger. Through subsequent deception, Jacob was able to gain Isaac's blessing, and inherit all that was rightly Esau's. Despite such major faults, Scripture regards Jacob as further confirmation of God's promises to Abraham, and a model of faith and obedience.

5095: Jacob, life and character of

The grandson of Abraham and son of Isaac, who was chosen by God, despite his personal faults and shortcomings, to be the recipient of the promises made to Abraham. His name means “he grasps the heel”, an allusion to the circumstances of his birth (Ge 25:25–26).

Jacob's birth**GEN 25:21–25:26****Jacob obtains the rights of the firstborn son****GEN 27:36** See also GEN 25:29–25:34, GEN 27:1–27:29; HEB 12:16–12:17**Jacob inherits the promises made to Abraham****GEN 28:10–28:15** See also GEN 12:1–12:3, GEN 15:5, GEN 27:29, GEN 28:3–28:4, GEN 35:11–35:13**Jacob flees to Haran****As the result of Esau's enmity****GEN 27:41–27:45** See also GEN 28:5**He encounters God at Bethel**

GEN 28:10–28:22 The encounter with God at Bethel confirms that Jacob has received the promise made to Abraham, and that Jacob has accepted his role of bearer of that promise to future generations.

He marries Leah and Rachel**GEN 28:1–28:2** See also GEN 29:16–29:30 Jacob is deceived by Laban into marrying Leah before Rachel.**He accumulates wealth****GEN 30:29–30:43** See also GEN 31:4–31:9, GEN 31:14–31:16, GEN 31:36–31:42**Jacob returns to Canaan****His flight from Haran****GEN 31:1–31:3** See also GEN 31:10–31:13, GEN 31:17–31:24, GEN 31:44–31:55**His encounter with God****GEN 32:24–32:30** The change of his name from “Jacob” (meaning “he grasps the heel”, figuratively, “he deceives”) to “Israel” (meaning “he struggles with God”) confirms Jacob as the recipient of the Abrahamic blessings. See also GEN 35:1–35:5, GEN 35:9–35:15**His reunion with Esau****GEN 33:1–33:17****Jacob's children****His twelve sons****GEN 35:22–35:26** See also GEN 29:32–29:35, GEN 30:3–30:13, GEN 35:16–35:18**The rape of his daughter****GEN 34:1–34:2** See also GEN 34:5, GEN 34:7, GEN 34:13–34:31**His favouritism towards Joseph and Benjamin****GEN 37:3–37:4** See also GEN 37:31–37:35, GEN 42:1–42:4, GEN 44:20, GEN 44:22, GEN 44:27–44:31**His reunion with Joseph****GEN 46:29–46:30** See also GEN 45:27–45:28, GEN 46:1–46:4, GEN 47:11**Jacob blesses his descendants****HEB 11:21** See also GEN 48:15–48:20, GEN 49:1–49:28**Jacob's death and burial****GEN 47:28–47:30** See also GEN 49:29–49:33, GEN 50:2–50:3, GEN 50:12–50:13**5096: Jacob, the patriarch**

God's covenant promises to Abraham were inherited by Jacob, through his father Isaac, and so it was through his line of descent that the promised Messiah was to come.

Jacob was one of the three patriarchs**EXO 3:6** See also NUM 32:11; DEU 1:8; MAT 8:11, MAT 22:32; ACT 3:13**Jacob received the Abrahamic promises****God's promise to Abraham****GEN 12:1–12:3****Jacob chosen in preference to Esau****ROM 9:11–9:13** See also GEN 25:23; MAL 1:2**The promises given to Jacob and his descendants****GEN 28:3–28:4** See also GEN 28:13–28:15, GEN 35:11–35:12; LEV 26:42; 1CH 16:17 parallel PSA 105:10; HEB 11:9**Jacob's descendants****He fathered the twelve tribes****EXO 1:1–1:5** See also 1KI 18:31; 1CH 2:1–2:2**He was the father of the nation****PSA 22:23** See also PSA 77:15; ISA 45:19**Jacob as a symbol for the nation****Jacob and Israel were linked together as equivalent terms for the nation****PSA 14:7** See also NUM 23:7, NUM 24:5; 1CH 16:13; PSA 78:5, PSA 114:1, PSA 135:4; ISA 9:8, ISA 43:28**The nation is described as the house of Jacob****EXO 19:3** See also ISA 2:6, ISA 8:17; JER 5:20; AMO 9:8; LUK 1:33**Other descriptions of the nation**

DEU 33:4; ; PSA 87:2; ; ISA 27:9, ISA 59:20, ISA 41:21; ; JER 30:18; ; LAM 2:2; ; MAL 2:12; ; ROM 11:26

National and patriarchal references merged**PSA 46:7** See also PSA 20:1, PSA 24:6, PSA 75:9, PSA 94:7, PSA 99:4; JER 10:16

5098: John the Baptist

The forerunner of Jesus Christ, born to elderly parents of the Aaronic line. His public ministry began in the Judean wilderness with a call to repentance and baptism. His ministry is seen as a fulfilment of OT prophecy, in preparation for the ministry of Jesus Christ. He was executed by Herod.

John's birth and early years

His birth and naming

LUK 1:57–1:60 See also LUK 1:5–1:13, LUK 1:61–1:66

Prophetic words over his life

LUK 1:14–1:17 See also LUK 1:76–1:79

He was related to Jesus Christ

LUK 1:36

His early years

LUK 1:80

John's ministry

His simple lifestyle

MAT 3:4 parallel MRK 1:6; ; MAT 11:18 parallel LUK 7:33; ; LUK 7:24–7:25

His call for repentance

LUK 3:3 parallels MAT 3:1, MRK 1:4

He fulfilled Isaiah's prophecy

MAT 3:3 parallels MRK 1:2–1:3, LUK 3:4–3:6 Just as roads were improved in the ancient world in preparation for the visit of a king, so John calls for people to prepare spiritually and morally for the imminent coming of the Messiah. See also ISA 40:3; JHN 1:23

His practice of baptism

MRK 1:4–1:5 parallel MAT 3:5–3:6 See also JHN 3:23, JHN 10:40

His challenge to established religion

MAT 3:7–3:10 parallel LUK 3:7–3:9 See also LUK 3:10–3:14

The contrast of his own baptism with that which the Messiah would bring

LUK 3:15–3:17 parallels MAT 3:11–3:12, MRK 1:7–1:8

His testimony to Jesus Christ

JHN 1:15 See also JHN 1:6–1:8, JHN 1:21–1:27, JHN 10:41

He recognises that his own ministry must decrease, while that of Jesus Christ will increase

JHN 3:27–3:30

John's baptising of Jesus Christ

See also MAT 3:13–3:15 parallels MRK 1:9, LUK 3:21 John's reluctance to baptise Jesus Christ lay in his

recognition of who Jesus was and the apparent inappropriateness of such a baptism; JHN 1:29–1:34

John and his disciples

John had disciples

JHN 1:35–1:37, JHN 3:25, JHN 4:1

He taught them to pray

LUK 11:1

His disciples become envious of Jesus Christ

JHN 3:25–3:26

He sends his disciples to question Jesus Christ

MAT 11:2–11:6 parallel LUK 7:18–7:23 Locked up in prison, John needed reassurance that his expectations about Jesus Christ had been well-founded.

John's disciples and the first Christians

ACT 18:24–19:7

John's imprisonment and death

His confrontation with Herod leads to his imprisonment

LUK 3:19–3:20 See also MAT 14:3–14:5 parallel MRK 6:17–6:20

His execution

MAT 14:6–14:12 parallel MRK 6:21–6:29

Some thought Jesus Christ to be John risen from the dead

MRK 8:27–8:28 parallel MAT 16:13–16:14 See also MAT 14:1–14:2 parallels MRK 6:14–6:16, LUK 9:7–9:9

Jesus Christ's estimation of John

Jesus Christ honours him

MAT 11:11 parallel LUK 7:28

Jesus Christ sees him as marking the end of the old covenant and the arrival of the kingdom

LUK 16:16 See also MAT 11:12–11:13

Jesus Christ sees him as the promised Elijah

MAT 11:14 On the basis of Malachi's prophecy (Mal 4:5), it was widely accepted that Elijah must come before the Messiah could appear. This identification would have been reinforced by John dressing like Elijah (see 2Ki 1:8). See also MAT 11:10; MAL 3:1; MAT 17:11–17:13 parallel MRK 9:11–9:13

5099: Mary, mother of Jesus Christ

Mary, the mother of Jesus Christ, provides Christians with an example of obedience to God and trust in Christ. She shared in the sufferings of her son, and took her place alongside the other disciples.

Mary's background

She was from Nazareth

LUK 1:26, LUK 2:39, LUK 2:51

She was related to Elizabeth, a descendant of Aaron

LUK 1:5, LUK 1:36

Possibly descended from David

LUK 1:32

She was betrothed to Joseph

LUK 1:27

She was a virgin

LUK 1:34 The Greek word translated “virgin” means “young”, “unmarried” and implies virginity. Betrothal might take place as early as 12 years old and lasted usually for a year, being as binding as a marriage contract, though without sexual relations. See also ISA 7:14; MAT 1:23

The events in Mary's life leading up to the birth of Jesus Christ

The annunciation

LUK 1:30–1:31

Mary's response of submission and obedience

LUK 1:38

The Magnificat expresses Mary's wonder and joy

See also LUK 1:46–1:55

Elizabeth's response to Mary

LUK 1:42–1:45

Mary, the mother

The birth of Jesus Christ

LUK 2:4–2:16

Her memories

LUK 2:51

Jesus Christ's circumcision and presentation

LUK 2:21–2:24 Joseph and Mary were poor and they could not afford to offer a lamb (see Lev 12:8).

The flight to Egypt

MAT 2:14

Her other children

MAT 13:55–13:56 parallel MRK 6:3

Her anxieties

LUK 2:48

Her doubts about Jesus Christ

MRK 3:20–3:21, MRK 3:31

She could not dominate Jesus Christ

MRK 3:34–3:35 parallels MAT 12:48–12:50, LUK 8:19–8:21; ; JHN 2:4

Mary, the disciple

Mary acknowledges Jesus Christ's authority

JHN 2:5 At the wedding at Cana.

Mary at the cross

JHN 19:25 Many Christians see this as the poignant fulfilment of Simeon's prophecy in Lk 2:35.

Mary in Jesus Christ's family

JHN 19:26–19:27

Mary praying with other disciples

ACT 1:14

5100: Melchizedek

“King of Righteousness”: king and priest of Salem, who blessed Abraham. David assumed Melchizedek's role as king and priest of Jerusalem for himself and his descendants. Jesus Christ succeeded to this role and became a high priest in the order of Melchizedek.

Melchizedek was both king and priest

As a king, Melchizedek entertained Abraham

GEN 14:18 See also HEB 7:1

As a priest, Melchizedek blessed Abraham

GEN 14:18–14:19

Abraham acknowledged Melchizedek as a priest of the LORD

GEN 14:20, GEN 14:22 Melchizedek here points ahead to Jesus Christ, who is also priest and king.

The status of Melchizedek

David appropriates Melchizedek's office and authority for himself and his descendants

PSA 110:1–110:2, PSA 110:4 The word “order” here means “in succession to”, meaning that Christ assumes the status and function of Melchizedek.

The Davidic Messiah (Christ) inherits the office of Melchizedek

MAT 22:41–22:44 parallels MRK 12:35–12:37, LUK 20:41–20:44 Jesus Christ was at that time being acclaimed as the “Son of David” and by implication here claims to be the Messiah. See also MAT 20:30 parallels MRK 10:47, LUK 18:35–18:39; MAT 21:9 parallel MRK 11:10; MAT 21:15; ACT 2:34

Jesus Christ as high priest after the order of Melchizedek

HEB 5:8–5:10, HEB 6:19–6:20 Only the high priest could sacrifice for the sins of the nation in the inner sanctuary behind the curtain.

The characteristics of the order of Melchizedek

HEB 7:2–7:3 Melchizedek's order of priesthood was one of kingship, peace and righteousness; it did not depend on genealogical descent (unlike the Levitical priesthood); it is eternal, without known beginning or end. See also PSA 110:4; HEB 5:6, HEB 6:20, HEB 7:21

The uniqueness of Jesus Christ's high priesthood in the order of Melchizedek

HEB 7:6–7:7 Melchizedek was superior to Abraham and therefore to the Levitical priesthood descended from Abraham; **PSA 110:4** The priesthood is secured by God's oath. See also HEB 6:17–6:20, HEB 7:16, HEB 7:20–7:22, HEB 7:26–7:27, HEB 8:1–8:2

Jesus Christ's high priesthood makes the Levitical priesthood obsolete

HEB 8:13 See also HEB 7:11, HEB 7:18–7:19, HEB 8:7–8:13

5101: Moses

One of the most important figures in the OT. Moses was called by God to lead Israel out of captivity in Egypt through the Sinai wilderness to the brink of the promised land. He was the mediator of the old covenant, and in several major respects anticipates the person of Jesus Christ.

5102: Moses, life of

The life of Moses sets the scene for the great events of the exodus from Egypt, and the showing forth of the power of the LORD, culminating in the giving of the covenant at Sinai and the preparations for entry into the promised land.

The meaning of the name Moses

EXO 2:10

Moses' birth and early life

See also EXO 2:1–2:3, EXO 2:5–2:6; ACT 7:20–7:22

Moses kills an Egyptian

EXO 2:11–2:15; ; ACT 7:23–7:29

The calling of Moses

God reveals himself to Moses at the burning bush

EXO 3:1–3:5

He is called to deliver his people

EXO 3:10 See also EXO 3:7–3:9

Moses learns the divine name

EXO 3:14

Moses protests his inadequacy

EXO 3:11 See also EXO 3:13, EXO 4:1, EXO 4:10–4:13, EXO 4:16 Moses is given Aaron as spokesman.

Moses' confrontation with Pharaoh

Moses and Aaron speak to Pharaoh

EXO 7:6–7:7

Pharaoh's disobedience leads to the plagues

See also EXO 7:1–7:5

The death of the firstborn in Egypt

EXO 11:4–11:9

The institution of the Passover

EXO 12:26–12:27

Moses leads Israel in the exodus from Egypt

The crossing of the Red Sea

EXO 14:29 See also EXO 14:26–14:28; JOS 2:10, JOS 4:23; HEB 11:29

Thanksgiving for deliverance from Egypt

EXO 15:1

The establishment of the covenant with Moses

Moses is given the Ten Commandments

EXO 31:18

He smashes the tablets because of the people's idolatry

See also EXO 32:19; DEU 9:16–9:17

He puts the new stone tablets in the ark

DEU 10:3–10:5

Moses leads Israel in the wilderness

He asks to see the glory of the LORD

EXO 33:18, EXO 33:22–33:23; ; LUK 9:30–9:32

The LORD promises his presence on the journey

EXO 33:14

The construction of the tabernacle

EXO 39:32; ; HEB 8:5

Moses inaugurates the Aaronic priesthood

LEV 8:30; ; NUM 6:22–6:27

Moses on the brink of the promised land

He takes a census before the entry into Canaan

NUM 1:2

He sends spies ahead

NUM 13:1–13:3

He is vindicated against the grumblers

NUM 16:28–16:32, NUM 21:4–21:9

He is prohibited from entering the promised land**NUM 20:12** See also DEU 3:23–3:26, DEU 34:4**Joshua succeeds Moses**

NUM 27:18, NUM 27:22

The death of Moses**DEU 34:4–34:5** See also DEU 34:6; JUD 1:9**5103: Moses, significance of**

Moses performed a number of major roles in the history of Israel. Many of these roles later found their perfection in Jesus Christ.

The roles of Moses**As teacher**

EXO 18:20; ; MAT 23:10; ; JHN 1:38

As intercessor

EXO 17:11, EXO 32:11; ; NUM 12:13, NUM 21:7; ; PSA 106:23; ; JHN 17:9; ; HEB 7:25

As servant of the LORD

JOS 1:1–1:2; ; 2CH 24:6; ; ACT 3:13; ; HEB 3:5; ; REV 15:3

As prophet

NUM 12:6–12:8; ; DEU 18:15, DEU 34:10; ; ACT 3:22

As deliverer

EXO 3:10; ; ACT 7:35; ; GAL 5:1

As judge

EXO 18:13

As writer

EXO 24:4; ; DEU 31:9; ; LUK 24:27; ; JHN 1:45, JHN 5:46

As shepherd

EXO 3:1; ; PSA 77:20; ; JHN 10:11

As the friend of God**EXO 33:11** See also EXO 33:17; MAT 17:5; JHN 5:20**As the mediator of the law and the covenant**

EXO 19:5–19:6; ; DEU 6:1–6:3, DEU 31:9; ; JOS 23:6; ; 2KI 18:12; ; GAL 3:19; ; HEB 9:15, HEB 12:24

Characteristics of Moses**He was a man of faith**

EXO 14:13–14:14; ; HEB 11:24–11:28

He was not eloquent

EXO 4:10

He understood that the law meant life**DEU 32:46–32:47** See also MAT 5:17–5:19, MAT 19:17; ACT 7:38**He was passionate in his defence of the Lord's holiness**

EXO 32:19; ; NUM 16:30; ; LUK 19:45–19:46

He worked miracles that brought glory to God

EXO 14:15–14:18; ; JHN 2:11

Institutions established by Moses**He fathers, and is identified with, the Judaic legal system**

JOS 1:7–1:8; ; 1KI 2:3; ; EZR 3:2; ; NEH 13:1; ; JHN 5:45, JHN 7:23; ; 1CO 9:9

He inaugurates the ritual slaughter of the Passover lamb**EXO 12:21** See also JHN 1:29**He sprinkles the people with the blood of the covenant**

EXO 24:8; ; LEV 17:11; ; MAT 26:28; ; HEB 9:13–9:14, HEB 11:28

He orders the atonement sacrifice

NUM 16:46; ; ROM 3:25

Moses enters the glory of the LORD

EXO 24:17–24:18, EXO 34:29; ; MAT 17:2; ; 2CO 3:7; ; REV 15:3–15:4

Moses present at the transfiguration**MRK 9:4** parallels MAT 17:3, LUK 9:30**Jesus Christ is superior to Moses**

See also HEB 3:3, HEB 3:5–3:6

5104: Moses, foreshadower of Jesus Christ

Moses foreshadows Jesus Christ in his role as a law-giver, as a mediator between God and his people and as a prophet who declared the will of God. In these matters, Jesus Christ brought to perfection the work begun through Moses.

Parallels between the infancies of Moses and Jesus Christ**Their births****ACT 7:20** See also LUK 2:11**Moses' mother hid him to escape the slaughter decreed by Pharaoh**

EXO 1:22, EXO 2:2

Herod's attempt to slaughter Jesus Christ

MAT 2:12, MAT 2:16

Moses, the Israelite exile in Egypt and Midian

EXO 2:11, EXO 2:15, EXO 2:22; ; DEU 34:4

Joseph takes Jesus Christ to Egypt for safety

MAT 2:13, MAT 8:20 Moses, like Jesus Christ, had no settled home in his own country.

Supernatural signs confirmed the callings both of Moses and Jesus Christ

EXO 4:5–4:9; ; MAT 3:17

Parallels between Moses and Jesus Christ**As mediators of covenants**

HEB 9:15 See also EXO 19:3–19:9; JHN 1:17; HEB 8:6–8:7

As those intimate with God

EXO 33:11; JHN 5:20 See also DEU 34:10; MAT 17:3–17:5; JHN 14:9–14:11

As prophets

DEU 34:10; ACT 3:22; JHN 6:14 See also DEU 18:15–18:18; LUK 24:19; JHN 4:19; ACT 7:37

As priests

HEB 9:11–9:12 See also HEB 10:11–10:12

As those who reveal the glory of God

EXO 34:33–34:35; 2CO 3:18 See also JHN 1:17

Moses as servant; Jesus Christ as Son

HEB 3:1–3:6

5106: Noah

A figure of major importance in the early chapters of Genesis, with whom God established a covenant, the sign of which was the rainbow. The life of Noah (whose name means “rest” or “comfort”) demonstrates God’s ability to save the righteous and destroy the ungodly.

Noah’s righteousness**Noah walked with God**

GEN 6:8–6:9 See also EZK 14:14, EZK 14:20

Noah enjoyed God’s protection

2PE 2:5

Noah illustrates God’s restoring grace after judgment

ISA 54:7–54:10

The history of Noah**Noah’s family**

See also GEN 5:22–5:29; 1CH 1:1–1:3

Noah built the ark at God’s command

HEB 11:7 See also GEN 6:11–6:21

Noah had three sons

GEN 5:32 See also GEN 9:18–9:19; 1CH 1:4GEN 10:1, GEN 10:32

Noah saved his family and animals from the flood

GEN 7:7–7:9 See also GEN 8:18–8:19; 1PE 3:20

Noah worshipped the LORD

GEN 8:20

God established a covenant with Noah, the sign of which is the rainbow

GEN 8:21–8:22 See also GEN 9:8–9:9, GEN 9:12–9:17

Noah lived to a great age

GEN 9:28–9:29

Noah’s character**Noah was obedient**

GEN 6:22 See also GEN 8:15–8:19

Noah was reverent

GEN 8:20

Noah was a man of the soil

GEN 9:20

Noah was subject to human frailty

GEN 9:21 Nakedness was seen as shameful by OT writers.

Noah blessed and cursed his sons in a prophetic way

See also GEN 9:24–9:27

Jesus Christ was a direct descendant of Noah

LUK 3:23, LUK 3:36

The last days are likened to the time of Noah

MAT 24:37–24:39 parallel LUK 17:26–17:27

5107: Paul

The “apostle to the Gentiles”. Converted from Judaism by an encounter with the risen Christ, Paul planted and corresponded with churches through much of the Mediterranean. In his letters, Paul stresses the universality of the gospel, which knows no distinction between Jew and Gentile, and the effects of Christian faith upon life and conduct.

5108: Paul, life of

Paul, previously known as Saul, had been a zealous persecutor of the church, but an encounter with the risen Christ (c. A.D. 35) led to his becoming the apostle to the Gentiles, with a mission to proclaim the gospel throughout the Gentile world. He was probably martyred during the persecutions of Nero, possibly in A.D. 67.

Paul’s early life**His Jewish heritage**

PHP 3:4–3:5

His citizenship**ACT 22:27–22:28****His place of birth and education****ACT 22:3** See also ACT 21:39**His trade as a tentmaker**

ACT 18:1–18:3

Paul's conversion**His persecution of the church****PHP 3:5–3:6** See also ACT 7:59–8:3, ACT 9:1–9:2, ACT 22:19–22:20; GAL 1:13**His conversion on the road to Damascus and his apostolic calling**

ACT 9:1–9:19 parallels ACT 22:3–22:16, ACT 26:9–26:18

Paul's early Christian activity**His journey to Arabia****GAL 1:15–1:17** Acts makes no mention of this trip, but it seems that Paul went to Arabia immediately after he met Ananias and then subsequently returned to preach in Damascus.**His return to Damascus****2CO 11:32–11:33** See also ACT 9:19–9:25**His visit to Jerusalem (c. A.D. 38)****GAL 1:18** See also ACT 9:26–9:28**His return to his home town of Tarsus****ACT 9:29–9:30** See also GAL 1:21 Tarsus was in Cilicia.**His stay in Antioch****ACT 11:25–11:26****Paul's first missionary journey and his partnership with Barnabas (c. A.D. 46–48)**

See also ACT 13:1–13:6, ACT 13:13–13:14, ACT 13:49–13:51, ACT 14:1, ACT 14:5–14:7, ACT 14:21–14:28

Paul and the Council of Jerusalem (c. A.D. 49)

The similarities between Paul and Luke here suggests that both writers are referring to the same events in these passages. Some, however, prefer to equate the meeting recorded in Gal 2:1–10 with the journey to Jerusalem mentioned in Ac 11:30: ACT 15:1–15:6, ACT 15:22–15:35; ; GAL 2:1–2:10

Paul's second missionary journey (c. A.D. 50–52)**His disagreement with Barnabas and his new partnership with Silas**

ACT 15:36–15:41

In Asia Minor

ACT 16:6–16:8

In Macedonia

ACT 16:9–16:12, ACT 17:1, ACT 17:10

In Greece

ACT 17:15, ACT 18:1 It was from Corinth that Paul wrote to the Thessalonians.

His return to Antioch

ACT 18:18–18:22

Paul's third missionary journey (c. A.D. 53–57)**His general purpose in making his journey**
ACT 18:23**At Ephesus**

See also ACT 19:1–19:12; 1CO 15:32, 1CO 16:8–16:9

His visit to Corinth

2CO 1:15–1:16, 2CO 1:23–2:4, 2CO 13:2 Most scholars believe that Paul wrote 1Corinthians from Ephesus, and that he also visited Corinth during this period. This visit, however, proved to be such a painful experience for him that he abandoned plans for a third visit, and instead wrote the Corinthians a “tearful” letter, calling them to repent of their sinful behaviour.

His journey to Greece

ACT 20:1–20:6; ; 2CO 2:12–2:13 Paul had hoped that Titus would bring him news from Corinth. They finally met in Macedonia, and Titus brought good news about the Corinthians' change of heart. Paul then wrote 2Corinthians before visiting Corinth for a third time.

His return to Jerusalem with the collection

ACT 20:6, ACT 20:13–20:16, ACT 21:1–21:8, ACT 21:15, ACT 21:17–21:19; ; ROM 15:25–15:26 Paul wrote Romans at this point in his travels. There is a considerable degree of uncertainty as to precisely when Galatians, Ephesians, Philippians, Colossians and Philemon were written.

Paul under arrest**His life threatened in Jerusalem**

ACT 21:27–21:34, ACT 23:12–23:21

In Caesarea (c. A.D. 57–59)

ACT 23:23–23:35, ACT 24:23–24:27

His appeal to Caesar

ACT 25:1–25:12

His shipwreck

ACT 27:1–28:10

His visit to Rome (c. A.D. 60)

ACT 28:11–28:16, ACT 28:30–28:31

The latter part of Paul's life

These verses from the Pastoral Epistles may indicate that Paul was ultimately released and undertook further journeys in the Eastern Mediterranean before his death: 1TI 1:3; ; 2TI 4:13, 2TI 4:20; ; TIT 1:5, TIT 3:12

5109: Paul, apostle to Gentiles

Paul saw his encounter with the risen Christ as a call to apostleship, with a special mission to proclaim the gospel to the Gentile world. Paul's complete dedication to Jesus Christ made his own personal weaknesses a vehicle for the power of God.

Paul's calling as an apostle: origins and implications

His calling began with his encounter with the risen Christ

GAL 1:15–1:16 See also ACT 9:3–9:19 parallels ACT 22:6–22:16, ACT 26:12–26:18; 1CO 9:1

His calling involved his being sent to the unevangelised Gentile world

GAL 2:9 See also ACT 22:21; ROM 15:18–15:21; 2CO 10:13–10:16; EPH 3:7–3:9

His calling put him under an obligation to preach the gospel

1CO 9:16 See also ROM 1:14–1:15; 2CO 5:11–5:14

Paul's commitment to his apostolic calling

He supported himself in order to present the gospel free of charge

1TH 2:6–2:9 See also 1CO 9:3–9:18; 2CO 12:13

He put the gospel before everything else

2CO 4:5 See also ROM 9:1–9:3; 1CO 9:19–9:23; PHP 1:12–1:26

He boasted in his weaknesses

2CO 12:7–12:10 See also 2CO 4:7–4:10, 2CO 6:3–6:10, 2CO 11:21–11:29

He experienced God's power at work through him

2CO 12:11–12:12 See also ACT 13:6–13:12, ACT 19:11–19:12; ROM 15:18–15:19; 1CO 2:4–2:5; 1TH 1:4–1:5

He had a confident attitude to death

PHP 3:10–3:11 See also 2CO 5:6–5:10; PHP 1:20–1:24; 2TI 4:6–4:8

Paul and the example of Jesus Christ

His appeal to Jesus Christ as an example to the churches

2CO 8:9 Paul here uses the example of Jesus Christ in order to encourage the Corinthians in their giving. See also ROM 15:1–15:3; PHP 2:5–2:11

His own exemplary imitation of Jesus Christ

1CO 11:1 See also 1CO 4:14–4:17; PHP 3:12–3:17, PHP 4:8–4:9; 2TH 3:6–3:9

His sharing of Jesus Christ's sufferings

COL 1:24 Paul is not suggesting here that there is any deficiency in Jesus Christ's atoning sacrifice. Rather, there are some aspects of suffering which Christ could not experience because they arose only as a result of people preaching the message of the cross and suffering because of it. See also 2CO 1:5–1:9, 2CO 4:7–4:12; GAL 6:17

Paul and the churches

His integrity in dealing with the churches

2CO 1:12 See also ACT 20:17–20:21; 2CO 2:17, 2CO 4:1–4:2; 1TH 2:10–2:12

His love for the churches

PHP 1:8 See also 2CO 11:7–11:11, 2CO 12:14–12:15; 1TH 3:12

His prayers for the churches

1TH 1:2 See also ROM 1:8–1:10; EPH 1:15–1:19; 2TH 1:11–1:12

His dependence on the prayers of the churches

1TH 5:25 See also ROM 15:30–15:32; EPH 6:19–6:20; PHM 1:22

Paul's imagery of apostleship

As Jesus Christ's ambassador

2CO 5:20; ; EPH 6:19–6:20

As a builder

ROM 15:20; ; 1CO 3:10

As a farmer

1CO 3:5–3:9

As a father

1CO 4:15; ; 1TH 2:11–2:12

As a mother

GAL 4:19; ; 1TH 2:6–2:7

As God's captive

1CO 4:9; ; 2CO 2:14–2:16 Paul portrays God as a victorious Roman general, with himself as a captive, bringing up the rear of the triumphal procession.

As Jesus Christ's slave

The word translated servant in these verses commonly means slave: ROM 1:1; ; 2CO 4:5; ; PHP 1:1; ; TIT 1:1

Paul's successors were to safeguard the truth of the gospel after his death

2TI 2:1–2:2 See also 2TI 1:13–1:14, 2TI 3:10–4:8

5110: Paul, teaching of

Paul's understanding of the Christian life was dominated by the importance of Jesus Christ's death and resurrection, by means of which he saw God as having acted decisively to redeem the world. Paul emphasised that Jews and Gentiles alike are justified by faith, and share together in the glorious new era of the Holy Spirit, which is to be consummated at Christ's return.

The redeeming work of Jesus Christ

God's work of redemption in Jesus Christ's death and resurrection

ROM 3:25 See also ROM 8:3–8:4; 2CO 5:18–5:19; COL 1:21–1:22

Jesus Christ as substitute, exchanges places with the sinner

2CO 5:21 See also GAL 3:13–3:14, GAL 4:4–4:5

Jesus Christ reverses the effects of Adam's sin

1CO 15:21–15:22 See also ROM 5:12–5:19

The death and resurrection of Jesus Christ mark the beginning of God's new order

New life comes through the death and resurrection of Jesus Christ

GAL 2:20 See also 2CO 5:16–5:17; EPH 2:4–2:7; COL 2:13

Jesus Christ's death and resurrection are the basis for a new moral life

ROM 6:11–6:13 See also ROM 6:1–6:7; 2CO 5:15; COL 2:20–3:11

Those who participate in God's new order are "in Christ"

1CO 1:30 See also ROM 8:1–8:2; EPH 1:3–1:14 Paul extends the scope of the phrase "in Christ" to include believers, their activity, and the salvation they have received.

Both Jews and Gentiles are justified by faith

Paul stresses that salvation is by grace through faith alone

EPH 2:8–2:9 See also ROM 3:21–3:26, ROM 4:16, ROM 5:1–5:2

Jewish works of the law have no role in salvation

GAL 2:15–2:16 See also ROM 4:13–4:15, ROM 9:30–10:4; GAL 3:6–3:14; PHP 3:8–3:9

Both Jews and Gentiles are united in the one body of Christ

1CO 12:13 See also GAL 3:26–3:28; EPH 2:14–2:18, EPH 3:6

The Holy Spirit

His indwelling is an integral part of Christian experience

ROM 8:9 See also ACT 19:1–19:7; GAL 3:2–3:5 Paul's questions suggest that he identifies receiving the Spirit with becoming a Christian.

He equips the church with gifts

1CO 12:1–12:11 See also 1CO 14:1–14:33

He enables believers to relate to God as Father

GAL 4:6–4:7 See also ROM 8:14–8:17; EPH 2:18

He guides believers into a right understanding of the law

ROM 7:6 See also ROM 2:29, ROM 8:3–8:4; 2CO 3:3, 2CO 3:6

He overcomes believers' sinful human nature

ROM 8:13 See also ROM 8:5–8:8; GAL 5:16–5:25, GAL 6:8

He is the guarantee of eternal life

ROM 8:11 See also ROM 8:23; 2CO 5:4–5:5; EPH 1:13–1:14

The return of Jesus Christ

Paul lived in the hope of the forthcoming personal return of the risen Christ

PHP 3:20–3:21 See also 1CO 15:22–15:28; 1TH 4:14–4:17; 2TH 1:6–1:10

Believers are to be raised with Christ upon his return

1TH 4:14 See also 1CO 15:12–15:23

The whole created order will be renewed at the return of Jesus Christ

ROM 8:19–8:21 See also EPH 1:9–1:10

5112: Peter

The foremost of the disciples of Jesus Christ during his lifetime and of the apostles after the resurrection.

5113: Peter, the disciple

The son of Jonas or John, he was called Simon until Jesus Christ gave him the name Peter meaning "rock".

Peter's background and family

He lived in Capernaum

MAT 8:14 parallels MRK 1:29, LUK 4:38; ; JHN 1:44 He originally came from Bethsaida.

He was a fisherman by trade

LUK 5:10

Peter as Jesus Christ's disciple

He was called by Jesus Christ

MAT 4:18–4:20 parallel MRK 1:16–1:20; ; LUK 5:10; ; JHN 1:40–1:42

He witnessed Jesus Christ perform many miracles

MAT 8:14–8:15 parallels MRK 1:30–1:31, LUK 4:38–4:39; ; MAT 17:24–17:27; ; LUK 5:4–5:8; ; JHN 21:2–21:6

He was chosen to be with Jesus Christ on certain occasions

MAT 17:1–17:2 parallels MRK 9:2, LUK 9:28–9:29 at the transfiguration of Jesus Christ; ; MAT 26:36–26:37 parallel MRK 14:32–14:33 in the Garden of Gethsemane; ; MRK 5:37 parallel LUK 8:51

He sometimes acted as spokesman for the other disciples

He asked Jesus Christ to teach them: MAT 15:15, MAT 18:21; MAT 16:15–16:16 parallels MRK 8:29, LUK 9:20; ; JHN 6:69; MAT 17:4 parallels MRK 9:5, LUK 9:33 He asked Jesus Christ to prolong the transfiguration experience; ; MAT 19:27 parallels MRK 10:28, LUK 18:28; ; MRK 1:36–1:37; ; LUK 5:4–5:5; ; JHN 6:68

His impetuous nature interacted with his devotion to Jesus Christ

MAT 14:28–14:29 He wanted to walk to Jesus Christ on the water; ; MAT 16:22 parallel MRK 8:32 He tried to prevent Jesus Christ from going to his death; ; MAT 26:35 parallels MRK 14:31, LUK 22:33, JHN 13:37 He vowed that he was willing to die for Jesus Christ; ; JHN 13:6–13:8, JHN 18:10

He was the subject of both special commendation and rebuke

MAT 16:17–16:19 He was commended for his confession of faith in Jesus Christ; ; MAT 16:23 parallel MRK 8:33 He was rebuked for his opposition to Jesus Christ's prediction of his suffering; ; MAT 26:34 parallels MRK 14:30, LUK 22:34, JHN 13:38 He was warned that he would disown Jesus Christ; ; MAT 26:40–26:41 parallel MRK 14:37–14:38 He was rebuked for falling asleep in the Garden of Gethsemane; ; JHN 18:10–18:11, JHN 21:20–21:22

Peter's denial of Jesus Christ and his reinstatement

He denied that he knew Jesus Christ

MAT 26:69–26:74 parallels MRK 14:66–14:71, LUK 22:54–22:60, JHN 18:15–18:18, JHN 18:25–18:27

He repented of his denial

MAT 26:75 parallels MRK 14:72, LUK 22:61–22:62

The risen Christ appeared to him on his own

LUK 24:33–24:34; ; 1CO 15:4–15:5

He was reinstated by Jesus Christ in front of other disciples

JHN 21:15–21:17

5114: Peter, the apostle

As a result of the coming of the Holy Spirit, Peter was transformed into a dynamic apostle and witness to Jesus Christ.

Peter's credentials as an apostle

MAT 10:2; ; ACT 2:37, ACT 5:29; ; 1PE 1:1; ; 2PE 1:1

Peter as an apostle to the Jews

GAL 2:8

Peter's leadership

See also ACT 1:21–1:22, ACT 2:14, ACT 3:12, ACT 4:8, ACT 5:29, ACT 8:20

Peter and the Gentiles

He was the first to baptise Gentiles who had not been circumcised

ACT 10:47–10:48

He defended this action against critics

ACT 11:17, ACT 15:7–15:11

He later wavered in his attitude to the Gentiles

GAL 2:11–2:14

The miraculous power of the Holy Spirit at work in Peter

ACT 3:2–3:7, ACT 5:9–5:10, ACT 5:15–5:16, ACT 9:34, ACT 9:40, ACT 12:1–12:11 Peter himself experienced a miracle when imprisoned by Herod Agrippa.

Peter's missionary travels

1CO 1:12 He visited Corinth; ; 1CO 9:5 He took his wife with him; ; 1PE 1:1 He visited northern Asia Minor; ; 1PE 5:13 One interpretation of this verse is that Peter was writing from Rome and was using the name "Babylon" symbolically to refer to Rome.

5115: Peter, preacher and teacher

Peter preached mainly to the Jews. He taught both through his preaching and his letters.

Peter's commission

JHN 21:17

Peter quoted from the OT in his teaching

Referring to the death of Judas: ACT 1:16, ACT 1:20; ACT 2:16–2:20, ACT 2:25–2:28, ACT 2:34–2:35; ACT 3:22–3:23, ACT 4:11; 1PE 1:15–1:16, 1PE 1:24–1:25, 1PE 2:6–2:8, 1PE 3:5–

3:6, 1PE 3:12, 1PE 3:14, 1PE 3:20, 1PE 4:18, 1PE 5:5; ; 2PE 2:5–2:9

Peter taught about Jesus Christ

About the life and miracles of Jesus Christ

ACT 2:22 See also ACT 10:36–10:39; 2PE 1:17–1:18

About Jesus Christ's suffering and death

ACT 2:23 See also ACT 3:13–3:15, ACT 4:10, ACT 5:30, ACT 10:39; 1PE 2:22–2:23, 1PE 3:18

About the resurrection of Jesus Christ

ACT 2:24 See also ACT 2:31–2:32, ACT 3:15, ACT 4:10, ACT 5:30, ACT 10:40–10:41; 1PE 1:3, 1PE 1:21, 1PE 3:18

About the ascension and exaltation of Jesus Christ

ACT 5:31 See also ACT 2:33, ACT 2:36, ACT 3:13; 1PE 1:21, 1PE 3:22

About the second coming of Jesus Christ

1PE 5:4 See also 1PE 1:7, 1PE 1:13, 1PE 4:13; 2PE 3:10–3:13

Peter taught about salvation through repentance and faith in Jesus Christ

ACT 4:12 See also ACT 2:38, ACT 3:19, ACT 10:43

Peter taught that God cared for all people

ACT 10:34, ACT 15:7–15:9

Peter wrote his first letter to encourage Christians

1PE 1:1, 1PE 5:12 See also 1PE 2:1 He exhorted them to live holy lives; 1PE 2:13–2:14 They must obey authority; 1PE 3:16; 1PE 4:12–4:16, 1PE 4:19 1PE 5:10 God will vindicate and save his people.

Peter wrote his second letter to strengthen Christians who were at risk from false teaching

2PE 1:12 See also 2PE 1:16 He reminded them of the truth of the gospel; 2PE 2:3 He warned them of the judgment awaiting false teachers; 2PE 3:13 They must keep alive their hope in the coming day of the Lord.

5117: Ruth

A young Moabite widow, who, because of her selfless devotion to her mother-in-law Naomi, and to Naomi's God, gained a husband and a child, a place in Jewish history and became the great-grandmother of David and an ancestor of Jesus Christ.

Ruth faces the problems of widowhood

RUT 1:3–1:5 See also RUT 1:6–1:13

Ruth commits herself to Naomi

RUT 1:16–1:17 See also RUT 1:18, RUT 1:22, RUT 2:11

Ruth and Boaz

Boaz allows Ruth to glean in his fields

RUT 2:8–2:9 See also RUT 2:14–2:23

Ruth asks Boaz to be her "kinsman-redeemer"

RUT 3:9 The kinsman-redeemer was the closest male relative who had responsibility to marry a widow within the family and thereby protect the interests of needy members of the extended family.

Boaz negotiates with a nearer relative of Ruth's

See also RUT 4:1–4:8

Boaz marries Ruth

RUT 4:9–4:10 See also RUT 4:11–4:13

She has a son who is presented to Naomi

RUT 4:13 See also RUT 4:17

Ruth is included in the genealogy of Jesus Christ

MAT 1:5–1:6

5118: Solomon

The son of David and Bathsheba, who succeeded David as king of Israel. Noted for his great wisdom, Solomon was responsible for the building of the temple of the LORD. In his latter years, influenced by his many foreign wives, he turned to idolatry.

5119: Solomon, life of

Solomon succeeded his father David as king and secured Israel's stability through treaties with foreign powers.

Solomon's birth

1CH 3:1–3:9 See also 2SA 12:24–12:25

Solomon's accession

Adonijah's rivalry

1KI 1:5 See also 1KI 1:11–1:14, 1KI 1:24–1:25, 1KI 2:13–2:25

David's approval

1KI 1:30 parallel 1CH 29:23 See also 1KI 1:32–1:35, 1KI 2:1–2:4

The coronation

1KI 1:38–1:40 parallel 1CH 29:21–29:22 See also 1KI 2:12

Solomon's administration of Israel

1KI 4:7 See also 1KI 4:20–4:25, 1KI 4:27, 1KI 10:25–10:27

Solomon's building projects

The temple

2CH 3:1 parallel 1KI 6:1 See also 1KI 5:5–5:6, 1KI 5:10–5:11, 1KI 6:14, 1KI 6:37–6:38, 1KI 8:63

The palace**1KI 7:1–7:3****Other building projects**

See also 1KI 9:15–9:19; 2CH 9:20; ECC 2:6 Solomon's Pools 1KI 7:7–7:8; JHN 10:23; ACT 3:11

Solomon's many wives**1KI 11:1–11:5** See also 1KI 3:1**Solomon's death****1KI 11:42–11:43** parallel 2CH 9:30–9:31**5120: Solomon, character of**

Solomon was a man of outstanding gifts and abilities. Initially he was approved by God, but the latter years of his reign were marred by idolatry and apostasy.

Solomon's abilities**Wisdom**

1KI 4:29 See also 1KI 3:7–3:12 parallel 2CH 1:8–1:12; 1KI 3:16–3:28, 1KI 10:6–10:7 parallel 2CH 9:5–9:6; MAT 12:42

Political shrewdness**1KI 3:1** See also 1KI 4:21, 1KI 10:13**Dealing with individuals****1KI 2:35** See also 1KI 2:24, 1KI 2:27**Poetry and writing**

1KI 4:32 See also PSA 72:0, PSA 127:0; PRO 1:1, PRO 10:1, PRO 25:1

Solomon's righteousness

1KI 8:62–8:63 parallel 2CH 7:4–7:5 See also 1KI 3:6–3:15, 1KI 8:54–8:61, 1KI 8:65–8:66

Solomon's sin

NEH 13:26 See also DEU 17:16–17:17; 1KI 10:26, 1KI 10:28, 1KI 11:1, 1KI 11:4, 1KI 11:9–11:13

Solomon's splendour was renowned**MAT 6:29** parallel LUK 12:27**5125: Parts of the body and clothing**

- 5126: arm
- 5127: back
- 5128: baldness
- 5129: bathing
- 5130: beard
- 5131: belt
- 5132: biting
- 5133: blindness
- 5136: body
- 5137: bones

- 5138: bowing
- 5139: bracelet
- 5140: breasts
- 5141: cheeks
- 5142: clapping
- 5143: climbing
- 5144: cloak
- 5145: clothing
- 5146: covering
- 5147: deafness
- 5148: ear
- 5149: eyes
- 5150: face
- 5151: feet
- 5152: fingers
- 5153: foot-washing
- 5154: forehead
- 5155: hair
- 5156: hand
- 5157: head
- 5158: head-covering
- 5159: hearing
- 5160: heel
- 5161: kneeling
- 5162: lameness
- 5163: legs
- 5164: lips
- 5165: listening
- 5166: liver and kidneys
- 5167: mouth
- 5168: muteness
- 5169: nakedness
- 5170: neck
- 5171: nose
- 5172: offal
- 5173: outward appearance
- 5174: prostration
- 5175: reading
- 5176: ring
- 5177: robes
- 5178: running
- 5179: sandal
- 5180: shaving
- 5181: sitting
- 5182: skin
- 5183: smell
- 5184: standing
- 5185: stomach
- 5186: stumbling
- 5187: taste
- 5188: tearing of clothes
- 5189: teeth
- 5190: thigh
- 5191: thought

- 5192: thumbs
- 5193: tongue
- 5194: touch
- 5195: veil
- 5196: voice
- 5197: walking
- 5198: weeping
- 5199: womb

5126: arm

Used as a symbol of strength and as a means of expressing affection and relationship. Some ornaments are worn on the arm.

Everyday uses of arms

See also NUM 11:12 carrying; NUM 20:11 hitting; 2SA 22:35 parallel PSA 18:34 archery 2KI 5:18, 2KI 7:2, 2KI 7:17 PSA 129:7; ISA 17:5 ISA 44:12 craftsmanship; HOS 11:3 teaching to walk

The arm as a symbol of human strength

Of physical strength in general

GEN 49:24; ; JDG 15:14, JDG 16:12; ; PRO 31:17; ; ISA 44:12

Of strength for battle

EZK 30:24–30:25 See also JOB 35:9

The arm as a symbol of human weakness

A broken arm expresses defeat

JER 48:25 See also JOB 38:15; PSA 10:15; EZK 30:21–30:22, EZK 30:24–30:25; ZEC 11:17

Restrained arms

JER 40:4; ; ACT 12:7

Feeble arms need to be strengthened

JOB 26:2 See also HEB 12:12

Human arms are weak compared with God's strength

JOB 40:9 See also 2CH 32:8

The arm of God as a symbol

Of the might of God

PSA 77:15 See also PSA 89:10, PSA 89:13; ISA 63:12; JER 27:5

Of the power of God to save

NUM 11:23 See also EXO 6:6; DEU 9:29, DEU 33:27; 2CH 6:32; ISA 53:1, ISA 59:1, ISA 59:16

Of the eternity of God

DEU 33:27

Of the holiness of God

PSA 98:1; ; ISA 52:10

Arms as an expression of affection and greeting

Used to embrace in greeting

GEN 45:14 See also GEN 29:13, GEN 33:4, GEN 46:29, GEN 48:10; LUK 15:20; ACT 20:37

Used to embrace a wife or lover

SNG 2:6 See also GEN 16:5; 2SA 12:8; PRO 5:20; SNG 8:3; MIC 7:5

Used to embrace the young

MRK 10:16 See also NUM 11:12; 2SA 12:3; 1KI 17:19, 1KI 17:23; 2KI 4:16; ISA 49:22; LAM 2:12; MRK 9:36; LUK 2:28; ACT 20:10

Open arms express generosity

PRO 31:20

Used in phrases expressing the adoption of false gods

See also 1KI 9:9 parallel 2CH 7:22

The beauty of the arm

SNG 5:14

Objects worn on the arm

Ornaments

See also GEN 24:30, GEN 24:47; NUM 31:50; 2SA 1:10; ISA 3:18–3:19; EZK 16:11, EZK 23:42

Identification marks

GEN 38:28, GEN 38:30

Magic charms

EZK 13:18, EZK 13:20

5127: back

As the part of the body used for bearing loads it is used both literally and metaphorically.

The human back used for carrying

Jesus Christ carried his cross on his back

JHN 19:17 See also MAT 27:32 parallels MRK 15:21, LUK 23:26 The shape of the cross necessitated it being carried across the shoulders and back. It appears that Jesus Christ started to carry his own cross but Simon of Cyrene took over as Christ weakened.

Weapons carried on the back

1SA 17:6

Animals carry people and goods on their backs

ISA 30:6 See also EXO 15:1, EXO 15:21; 2SA 13:29, 2SA 16:1–16:2, 2SA 18:9, 2SA 19:26; 2KI 18:23 parallel ISA 36:8; ISA 21:7, ISA 30:16; JER 6:23; HAG 2:22; REV 9:17

Riding on the backs of animals may indicate royalty or privilege

ZEC 9:9 See also 1KI 1:33, 1KI 1:38, 1KI 1:44JDG 5:10, JDG 10:4, JDG 12:14REV 6:1–6:8, REV 19:11–19:21

Jesus Christ mounted a donkey for his triumphal entry into Jerusalem

MAT 21:7–21:9 parallels MRK 11:7–11:11, LUK 19:35–19:38
See also JHN 12:13–12:15

Carrying a burden on the back represents bearing suffering and trials

PSA 66:11 See also PSA 38:4; ECC 1:13, ECC 3:10; MAT 11:28–11:30

Injury to the back

JDG 3:22; ; 2SA 2:23; ; JOB 20:24–20:25

Pain in the back causing anguish

PSA 38:7

The back endures punishment

Bending of the back indicates loss of physical strength

PSA 69:23 See also ROM 11:10

Beating on the back is a punishment

PRO 10:13, PRO 14:3, PRO 19:29, PRO 26:3

Beating on the back may be an unjust punishment for God's servants

ISA 50:6 See also ISA 53:4–53:5; MAT 21:35 parallels MRK 12:3, LUK 20:11 The servants in the parable represent the OT prophets.

Jesus Christ endured flogging

MAT 27:26 parallels MRK 15:15, JHN 19:1 Jesus Christ becomes the suffering servant of Isaiah's prophecies.

The apostles endured flogging

2CO 11:23–11:25 See also ACT 5:40, ACT 16:22–16:23, ACT 16:37, ACT 21:32; 2CO 6:5, 2CO 6:9

Jesus Christ's disciples should expect similar flogging

MAT 10:17 See also MAT 23:34; MRK 13:9

Whipping on the back used figuratively in a warning

JOS 23:12–23:13

Walking over the back used figuratively to indicate defeat

ISA 51:23

Turning one's back means desertion

God makes the enemies of his people flee

EXO 23:27 See also 2SA 22:41 parallel PSA 18:40; PSA 21:12

Israel flees from her enemies

JOS 7:12

God's people desert him

NEH 9:29 "To turn one's back", in these verses and the following verses, also implies a lack of respect and reverence for God and his ways. See also 2CH 29:6; ISA 1:4, ISA 59:12–59:13; JER 2:27, JER 32:33–32:34; EZK 8:16

God's people desert his instruction

ZEC 7:11; ; 2PE 2:21

Thrusting behind one's back means discarding

ISA 38:17 God forgives sins, putting them out of sight; **EZK 23:35** See also 1KI 14:9; NEH 9:26

God turns his back in his grace

EXO 33:22–33:23 To see God's face would bring death.

God turns his back against disobedient people

JER 18:17

5128: baldness

Loss of hair on the head as the result of natural causes or deliberate action. Baldness may be used to signify judgment, mourning or shame.

Instructions regarding baldness within Jewish law

Associated with idolatrous practice

See also LEV 21:5; DEU 14:1; JER 16:6 In pagan Canaan mourners shaved their foreheads.

Regarding sores on bald heads

LEV 13:40–13:42

Cleansing may involve shaving the head

LEV 14:8–14:9; ; NUM 6:9, NUM 6:18; ; DEU 21:12

Vows that involve shaving the head

JDG 13:5, JDG 16:17–16:19; ; ACT 18:18 based on the Nazarite rule recorded in Nu 6:1–21

Baldness may signify God's judgment

EZK 5:1 Ezekiel instructed to shave his head to symbolise this

Judgment on Jerusalem and Judah

ISA 3:17, ISA 3:24, ISA 7:20

Baldness as a symbol of mourning

JOB 1:20 Job here mourns the loss of his children, household and livestock. See also ISA 15:2, ISA 22:12; JER 48:37; EZK 27:31; AMO 8:10; MIC 1:16

Used figuratively to indicate the mourning of a nation

JER 47:5

Baldness as a symbol of shame

2KI 2:23; ; EZK 7:18; ; 1CO 11:5–11:6

Examples of baldness

EZK 29:18 baldness caused by the rubbing of leather helmets in warfare; ; JDG 16:19 Samson; ; 2KI 2:23 Elisha

5129: bathing**Bathing as an act of ritual cleansing**

LEV 14:8–14:9 See also LEV 15:4–15:11, LEV 16:26–16:28; NUM 19:7–19:8

Bathing as a means of cleansing or refreshing the body

EXO 2:5; ; 2SA 11:2; ; 1KI 22:38

Bathing referred to metaphorically

DEU 33:24; ; PSA 58:10; ; ISA 34:5–34:6; ; EZK 16:9, EZK 23:40

5130: beard**References to the beard**

EZK 5:1 See also JDG 16:17; 1SA 21:13; 2SA 20:9; PSA 133:2

Cutting or pulling the beard**In grief**

JER 48:37 Moab is in mourning. See also ISA 15:2; JER 41:5

In dismay

EZR 9:3

In the ceremony of cleansing

See also LEV 14:9

As an extreme insult

2SA 10:4–10:5 parallel 1CH 19:4–19:5; ; ISA 7:20, ISA 50:6

Cutting the edges of the beard was forbidden

LEV 19:27 This is a prohibition still adhered to by some Jews today; ; LEV 21:5

5131: belt

An item of clothing, worn round the waist, used for gathering clothes and holding weapons or money.

The belt as an item of clothing

1KI 18:46 See also 2SA 20:8; 1KI 2:5; 2KI 4:29, 2KI 9:1; PSA 109:19; ISA 5:27; JER 13:1–13:11; DAN 10:5; MAT 10:9 parallel MRK 6:8; ACT 21:11

Part of the battledress of a warrior

ISA 18:4 See also 2SA 18:11; EZK 23:15

A leather belt was a sign of rough living

2KI 1:8 See also MAT 3:4 parallel MRK 1:6

The belt symbolises truth and righteousness

ISA 11:5; EPH 6:14

5132: biting

The use of teeth to harm, threaten or express frustration. It is illustrative of the effect of slander, cold wind, excessive wine or of God's judgment.

Biting used literally**An effect of demon-possession**

See also MRK 9:18

Biting by reptiles and animals

NUM 21:6 See also ECC 10:8, ECC 10:11; DAN 6:24

Reptiles and animals prevented from biting

DAN 6:21–6:22 See also MRK 16:18; ACT 28:4–28:5; HEB 11:33

Biting used metaphorically**Of God's judgment on the wicked**

JER 8:17 See also JOL 1:6; AMO 5:19, AMO 9:3

Of the wicked against God's people

ACT 7:54 See also PSA 35:16, PSA 37:12; LAM 2:16; 1CO 15:32 A fulfilment of the prophecy of Isa 22:13, indicating that the devouring of God's people is a part of the greed of the wicked; 2TI 4:17

Of Satan and demons

1PE 5:8; ; REV 9:8

Of the frustration of the wicked

LUK 13:28 See also PSA 112:10; MAT 8:12, MAT 13:42, MAT 22:13, MAT 24:51, MAT 25:30; REV 16:10

Of quarrelling, slander and treachery

GAL 5:15 See also GEN 49:17; PSA 57:4, PSA 58:4, PSA 140:3; ROM 3:13–3:14; 2CO 12:20

Of a cold wind

JOB 37:9–37:10 See also ISA 28:2

Of penetrating sarcasm

MAT 23:27–23:28 See also PSA 115:3–115:7; ISA 46:5–46:7; 1CO 4:8; 2CO 12:11–12:13

Of the effect of excessive wine

PRO 23:31–23:32

5133: blindness

The inability on the part of someone to see properly. Blindness is often used in Scripture as a symbol of human sin.

5134: blindness, natural

The inability to see properly. The healing of such physical blindness was one of the many miracles performed by Jesus Christ, who restored sight to the blind at several points during his ministry. Scripture often treats blindness as a symbol of the human inability or refusal to realise the importance of God and the gospel. The restoration of sight can thus be treated as a symbol of coming to faith.

The causes of blindness

A natural affliction

EXO 4:11 See also GEN 27:1, GEN 29:17; ISA 3:2, ISA 4:15; JHN 9:1–9:3; ACT 22:11; GAL 4:15

A consequence of sin

GEN 19:11; ; DEU 28:28–28:29; ; 2KI 6:18; ; PSA 69:23; ; ACT 13:9–13:11

A result of human cruelty

NUM 16:14; ; JDG 16:21; ; 2KI 25:7 parallels JER 39:7, JER 52:11

Directions to care for the blind

LEV 19:14; ; DEU 27:18; ; JOB 29:15; ; JER 31:8

The healing of blindness

LUK 14:13

The LORD makes blind eyes see

2KI 6:17, 2KI 6:20; ; PSA 146:8; ; ISA 35:5, ISA 61:1

The healing of the blind by Jesus Christ

LUK 4:18 See also MAT 9:27–9:30, MAT 11:5 parallel LUK 7:21–7:22; MAT 12:22, MAT 15:30–15:31, MAT 20:29–20:34 parallels MRK 10:46–10:52, LUK 18:35–18:43; MRK 8:22–8:25; JHN 9:6–9:7; ACT 9:17–9:18 through Ananias

Blindness as a symbol

Of moral defect

LEV 20:4; ; DEU 16:19; ; ISA 12:3; ; PRO 28:27; ; MAT 5:29, MAT 6:23, MAT 18:9; ; LUK 6:39

Of grief

GEN 21:19; ; ISA 2:33; ; JOB 17:7; ; PSA 6:7, PSA 31:9, PSA 38:10, PSA 88:9; ; ISA 38:14

Of the powerlessness of idols

PSA 115:5 parallel PSA 135:16

5135: blindness, spiritual

An inability or unwillingness to perceive the truth of the gospel.

Unbelievers are spiritually blind

1CO 2:14 See also PSA 32:9, PSA 92:6–92:7; PRO 4:19ISA 44:9, ISA 44:18–44:19 EZK 12:2; MIC 4:12MAT 13:13–13:15; LUK 8:10; ISA 6:9–6:10 MAT 15:16; LUK 24:25; JHN 1:5, JHN 9:40–9:41 the spiritual blindness of the Pharisees; ROM 3:11; 1CO 14:23, 1CO 14:24

Spiritual blindness is a result of sin

LAM 4:14; ZEP 1:17; 2CO 4:4 See also MRK 9:32; LUK 18:34; JHN 3:19–3:20, JHN 12:39–12:40; EPH 4:17–4:19

The consequences of spiritual blindness

ROM 1:18–1:23 See also DEU 28:28–28:29 lack of success, oppression and robbery; PSA 82:5; ISA 42:25 the violence of war; ISA 59:10; LAM 4:14; MAT 6:23; ACT 28:26–28:27; ISA 6:9–6:10; 2CO 4:4; 1JN 1:61JN 2:9, 1JN 2:11

The removal of spiritual blindness

2CO 4:6 See also NUM 24:4; 2KI 6:17 Elisha asks the LORD to open his servant's eyes; PSA 119:18, PSA 119:130, PSA 146:8; ISA 32:3, ISA 35:5, ISA 42:16–42:18; LUK 4:18; ISA 61:1; LUK 24:31; JHN 3:3 No-one can see the kingdom of God without being born again; JHN 8:12 Jesus Christ is the light of the world; JHN 9:39; ACT 26:18; 2CO 3:16; EPH 1:18, EPH 5:8; 1PE 2:9

The spiritual blindness of Israel

ISA 1:3 See also DEU 29:4, DEU 32:28; ISA 29:10; JER 4:22, JER 5:21; MIC 4:12; ROM 11:7–11:8, ROM 11:25; 2CO 3:14–3:15

The spiritual blindness of leaders

MAT 15:14 See also ISA 29:9–29:12, ISA 56:10; MAT 23:16–23:19, MAT 23:24–23:26; LUK 6:39; JHN 3:10, JHN 8:27, JHN 9:40–9:41, JHN 10:6; ROM 2:19–2:21; 2PE 2:12

The spiritual blindness of believers

JHN 14:9 See also JOB 42:3; DAN 12:8; MAT 15:16 parallel MRK 7:18; MAT 16:9 parallel MRK 8:21; LUK 2:50, LUK 9:45, LUK 24:25; JHN 12:16; 2PE 1:9

The spiritual blindness of a church

REV 3:17–3:18

5136: body

Used in Scripture in both a physical and metaphorical sense, the body is susceptible to sin and suffering, but may be offered to God in worship and will finally be transformed by resurrection.

The body is formed by God

PSA 139:15–139:16 See also GEN 2:7, GEN 2:22; JOB 10:8–10:11; ECC 11:5

The body's appearance

The beauty and strength of the body

ISA 16:12 See also ISA 9:2; 2SA 11:2; SNG 5:10–5:16, SNG 7:1–7:9; DAN 10:6

Clothing for the body

EXO 22:27, EXO 28:42; ; LEV 16:4; ; 2KI 6:30; ; ISA 20:2

Diseases affecting the body

Bodily pain

JOB 2:7 See also GEN 3:16; 2CH 21:19; JOB 7:5, JOB 14:22, JOB 17:7, JOB 30:30; PSA 38:7; 2CO 12:7

Leprosy

LEV 13:2–13:17; ; NUM 12:10; ; 2SA 3:29; ; 2KI 5:1–5:2, 2KI 5:6–5:7; ; 2CH 26:19–26:21; ; MAT 8:2–8:3 parallels MRK 1:40–1:42, LUK 5:12–5:13; ; LUK 17:12–17:13

Boils

EXO 9:9–9:11; ; LEV 13:18–13:23; ; DEU 28:27, DEU 28:35; ; 2KI 20:7 parallel ISA 38:21

The marks of suffering

JHN 20:25, JHN 20:27; ; GAL 6:17

Healing of the body

MRK 5:25–5:29 parallels MAT 9:20–9:22, LUK 8:43–8:44 See also EXO 4:7; 2KI 5:10, 2KI 5:14; JOB 33:25; MAT 8:3–8:4 parallels MRK 1:41–1:42, LUK 5:13

Certain actions and attitudes affect the health of the body

The body's response to godliness

PRO 14:30 See also PRO 3:7–3:8, PRO 4:20–4:22

Godliness is no guarantee of bodily health

JOB 21:23–21:26; ; PSA 73:4

The body's response to sin

PSA 38:3 Suffering and death are the result of sin in general, but specific experiences of suffering cannot usually be traced to specific sin. See also PSA 32:2–32:3, PSA 38:4–38:11, PSA 109:18; PRO 5:11

The body's response to distress

PSA 31:9–31:10 See also PSA 44:25; NAM 2:10

The body's response to fear

JOB 4:14–4:15, JOB 21:6; ; ISA 21:3; ; DAN 10:15–10:17

Life here and now in the body

In the body“ meaningin this life“

2CO 5:6 See also 2CO 5:8–5:10; GAL 2:20; PHP 1:20, PHP 1:22, PHP 1:24; 2PE 1:13

Body“ meaningself“

PSA 63:1 See also GEN 47:18; NEH 9:37; 2CO 7:5

Bodily relationships

Parenthood

GEN 15:4 See also GEN 35:11; 2SA 7:12; MIC 6:7; ROM 4:19; HEB 7:10

Kinship

2SA 5:1 parallel 1CH 11:1 See also GEN 2:23, GEN 29:14; JDG 9:2; NEH 5:5; ISA 58:7

Marriage

1CO 7:4 See also MAT 19:5 parallel MRK 10:7–10:8; EPH 5:28–5:29, EPH 5:31; GEN 2:24

Rituals performed on the body

Circumcision: GEN 17:13–17:14; ; JER 9:25; ; EPH 2:11; LEV 15:16; ; NUM 8:7; LEV 19:28, LEV 21:5

The believer's body as a temple of the Holy Spirit

1CO 6:19–6:20 See also JHN 2:19–2:22 Jesus Christ also likens his body to a temple; ROM 8:10–8:11

Believers are to devote their bodies to God

2CO 7:1 See also ROM 6:13, ROM 8:13, ROM 12:1; 1CO 9:27; 1TH 4:4, 1TH 5:23; JAS 3:2

Sin at work in the body

The body is subject to sinful desires

MAT 26:41 parallel MRK 14:38 See also ROM 6:6, ROM 7:23–7:24

Bodily temptation is to be resisted

ROM 6:12 See also ROM 1:24, ROM 6:19; 1CO 6:13–6:16, 1CO 6:18; JUD 1:8

Undue concern for the body is to be avoided

1TI 4:8 See also MAT 6:25–6:32 parallel LUK 12:22–12:30; MAT 10:28 parallel LUK 12:4–12:5

The resurrection of the body

Dead bodies restored to this life

1KI 17:20–17:22; ; 2KI 4:32–4:36, 2KI 13:21; ; MAT 9:25 parallels MRK 5:41–5:42, LUK 8:54–8:55; ; LUK 7:14–7:15; ; JHN 11:43–11:44

The resurrection body of believers

PHP 3:21 See also PSA 16:9–16:10; ISA 26:19; ROM 8:11, ROM 8:23; 1CO 15:35–15:54

Bodies other than human

Idols of pagan gods

ISA 5:4; ; PSA 115:4–115:7, PSA 135:15–135:17

Angelic beings

ISA 6:2; ; EZK 1:11, EZK 1:23, EZK 10:12

Heavenly bodies

MAT 24:29 parallels MRK 13:25, LUK 21:26; ; ACT 7:42; ; 1CO 15:40–15:41

Body in a metaphorical sense

A body of people: EZR 8:20; ; 1TI 4:14; DEU 4:8; ; ROM 2:20

5137: bones

Associated in Hebrew thought with both death and life. A symbol of the whole person, and also the state of one's well-being.

Bones represent dead bodies**Human remains to be treated with respect**

1SA 31:13 parallel 1CH 10:12 See also 2SA 21:12–21:14; 1KI 13:31; 2KI 23:18; EZK 39:15

Non-burial as a sign of disrespect

AMO 2:1–2:2

Non-burial as a sign of God's judgment

PSA 53:5 See also 2KI 9:34–9:37; PSA 141:7; JER 8:1–8:2; EZK 24:4–24:5, EZK 24:10

Bones were considered to be unclean**Bones made anyone who touched them unclean**

NUM 19:16 See also NUM 19:18; MAT 23:27

Bones used to desecrate objects of pagan worship

2KI 23:14 See also 1KI 13:2; 2KI 23:16, 2KI 23:20; 2CH 34:5; EZK 6:5

Bones as a sign of hope**The hope of God's promise**

GEN 50:25 See also EXO 13:19; JOS 24:32; HEB 11:22
The presence of Joseph's bones among the Israelites was a constant reminder of God's promise to Joseph concerning the promised land.

The hope of life after death

EZK 37:1–37:14 See also 2KI 13:21

The hope of the Passover lamb

JHN 19:36 See also EXO 12:46; NUM 9:12; PSA 34:20
Jesus Christ fulfilled the symbolism of the unbroken bones of the Passover lamb.

Bones represent living individuals**Bones indicate a living body**

LUK 24:39

Bones represent a whole person

PSA 35:10 "My whole being" is literally "my bones".
See also JOB 2:4–2:5, JOB 10:11; PSA 6:2, PSA 51:7–51:8; ISA 66:14

Bones represent kinship

GEN 2:23 GEN 29:14; ; JDG 9:2; ; 2SA 5:1 parallel 1CH 11:1; ; 2SA 19:12–19:13

Bones represent physical health**Bones associated with good health**

PRO 15:30 See also PRO 3:7–3:8, PRO 16:24

Bones symbolise strength and vigour

JOB 21:23–21:24 See also JOB 20:11, JOB 40:18; PRO 25:15

Bones associated with God's protection

PSA 34:19–34:20 See also JHN 19:36

Mere skin and bone represents bad health

JOB 19:20 See also JOB 33:21; PSA 102:5; LAM 4:8

Broken bones symbolise defeat or oppression

NUM 24:8 See also ISA 38:13; JER 50:17; LAM 3:4; DAN 6:24; MIC 3:2–3:3

Health can be damaged by negative attitudes

PRO 14:30 See also JOB 4:14; PRO 12:4, PRO 17:22; HAB 3:16

Health can be damaged by sin

PSA 38:3 See also PSA 32:3, PSA 109:18; LAM 1:13

Repentance brings restoration

PSA 6:2 See also PSA 51:18

Health can be damaged through obedience to God's will

JER 23:9 See also JOB 30:17, JOB 33:19; PSA 22:14, PSA 22:17, PSA 31:10, PSA 42:10; JER 20:9

5138: bowing

An act of submission before something or someone deemed worthy of honour.

Bowing as an act of submission

GEN 42:6; 2SA 1:2; PSA 72:9 See also GEN 33:3, GEN 43:26–43:28, GEN 49:8; EXO 11:8, EXO 18:7; RUT 2:10; 1SA 2:36, 1SA 24:8, 1SA 25:23; 2SA 15:5, 2SA 18:28; 1KI 1:16; 1CH 21:21; ISA 49:23

Bowing before angels

GEN 18:2 See also GEN 19:1; NUM 22:31; LUK 24:5

Bowing before God

EXO 4:31; 2CH 20:18; PSA 95:6 See also GEN 17:3, GEN 24:26; EXO 12:27, EXO 34:8; DEU 26:10, DEU 33:3; 1KI 1:47; 2KI 17:36; 1CH 29:20; 2CH 29:28; NEH 8:6; PSA 22:27; ISA 66:23

Bowing before the temple

PSA 5:7 The temple represented God's presence. See also PSA 138:2

Bowing before idols

EXO 32:8; 2KI 17:16; ISA 2:8 See also NUM 25:2; DEU 29:26; 2KI 21:3; 2CH 25:14; ISA 44:17, ISA 44:19; EZK 8:16; MIC 5:13

Bowing before Jesus Christ

MAT 2:11; PHP 2:10 See also MAT 8:2, MAT 9:18, MAT 15:25, MAT 27:29; MRK 5:6, MRK 10:17; LUK 17:16

Bowing as an expression of sorrow

PSA 35:14, PSA 145:14 See also PSA 38:6, PSA 57:6, PSA 146:8; LAM 2:10

5139: bracelet

An expensive ornamental armlet usually worn by women.

5140: breasts

On a woman, the bosom; on a man the upper part of the chest. Female breasts are primarily referred to as a means of feeding young and as a figurative description of Israel and God as nursing mothers. Beating of the breast is a sign of remorse. The breast is protected in physical and spiritual warfare.

Breasts as a symbol of fertility

GEN 49:25

Breasts as the means of feeding young

See also 1SA 1:23 until they are weaned; 1KI 3:20; JOB 3:12; PSA 22:9; SNG 8:1; JOL 2:16; LUK 11:27 "Nursing" includes breast-feeding.

Nursing mothers and their children experience acute distress

LUK 23:29 See also JOB 24:9; MAT 24:19 parallels MRK 13:17, LUK 21:23 The implication is that children nursing at their mothers' breasts are completely vulnerable and defenceless.

Other creatures breast-feed their young

LAM 4:3

Female breasts are attractive

SNG 8:10 See also PRO 5:19; SNG 4:5, SNG 7:3, SNG 7:7-7:8

Breasts are a source of temptation

PRO 5:20

Undeveloped breasts are a sign of youth

SNG 8:8

The figurative breasts of Israel**Jerusalem as a breasted woman**

EZK 16:7

Jerusalem as a nursing mother

ISA 66:10-66:12

Jerusalem as a prostitute

EZK 23:3 The two sisters are Samaria and Jerusalem. See also EZK 23:8, EZK 23:21; HOS 2:2 Gomer's unfaithfulness is likened to that of Israel.

Dry breasts are a sign of God's punishment

HOS 9:14

God's care exceeds that of nursing mothers

ISA 49:15 See also ISA 49:23, ISA 60:16 The Gentiles will be used by God to provide nursing for Israel.

Beating of breasts**As a sign of grief**

NAM 2:7 See also ISA 32:12-32:13; EZK 21:12, EZK 23:34; LUK 23:48

As a sign of contrition

LUK 18:13 See also JER 31:19

Protection of the breast**The high priest's breastpiece**

EXO 25:7, EXO 28:15-28:30, EXO 29:5, EXO 35:9, EXO 35:27, EXO 39:8-39:21; ; LEV 8:8

Breastplates worn for protection in confrontations

REV 9:9, REV 9:17

Figurative breastplates as spiritual armour

EPH 6:14 See also ISA 59:17; 1TH 5:8

Animal breasts used in sacrificial offerings

EXO 29:26-29:27; ; LEV 7:30-7:31, LEV 8:29, LEV 9:20-9:21, LEV 10:14-10:15; ; NUM 6:20, NUM 18:18

5141: cheeks

Literally, the parts either side of the face. Striking the cheek is an extreme form of insult.

Cheeks as features of beauty

SNG 1:10 See also SNG 5:13

Cheeks can bear symbols of grief

LAM 1:2

Striking the cheek is a form of insult or challenge

JOB 16:10; MAT 5:39 See also LAM 3:30; MIC 5:1; MAT 26:67; JHN 18:22-18:23; LUK 6:29

Plucking the beard from the cheek is a form of insult

ISA 50:6 See also 2SA 10:4–10:5 parallel 1CH 19:4–19:5

5142: clapping

Applauding with one's hands, as an expression of delight. Scripture portrays even the creation sharing in this delight at the majesty of its Creator.

Clapping as an expression of delight

At a coronation

2KI 11:12

Expressing praise

PSA 47:1

Expressing the delight of the creation in its Creator

PSA 98:8 See also ISA 55:12

Clapping as an act of derision

LAM 2:15 See also JOB 27:21–27:23, JOB 34:37; EZK 25:6; NAM 3:19

5143: climbing

Physical climbing

DEU 32:49–32:50 See also NUM 27:12; 1SA 14:8–14:13; 1KI 18:42; 2KI 19:23; 2CH 20:16; ISA 40:9; JER 4:29; LUK 19:4

Climbing associated with worship

PSA 24:3 Because Jerusalem was built at a high elevation, going to worship there usually involved ascent. See also PSA 122:3–122:4; ISA 2:3, ISA 30:29; ZEC 14:17

Figurative climbing

PSA 139:8; JER 9:21 See also GEN 28:12, GEN 49:22; DEU 30:12; SNG 7:8; ISA 14:13–14:14, ISA 24:18; AMO 9:2; JHN 1:51

5144: cloak

A protective outer garment, often treated as a symbol of authority.

The cloak used as a garment

ACT 12:8 See also GEN 39:12, GEN 39:18; 1KI 19:13; SNG 5:7; MAT 5:40 parallel LUK 6:29; MAT 9:20–9:21 parallels MRK 5:27–5:28, LUK 8:44 A woman's bleeding is stopped; MAT 14:36 parallel MRK 6:56; MAT 24:18 parallel MRK 13:16; ACT 22:22–22:24; 2TI 4:13

The cloak used as a covering or blanket

EXO 22:26–22:27 See also DEU 24:13, DEU 24:17

Symbolic use of the cloak

Royal symbolism

2KI 9:13 This constituted an act of royal homage. See also MAT 21:7–21:8 parallels MRK 11:7–11:8, LUK 19:35–19:36

Prophetic symbolism

1KI 19:19 See also 1KI 11:30; 2KI 2:8, 2KI 2:13–2:14

The cloak torn as a symbol of mourning

EZR 9:3 See also EZR 9:5

Figurative use of cloaks

PSA 109:29 See also PSA 109:18–109:19; PRO 30:4; ISA 59:17

5145: clothing

Garments were originally provided by God for Adam and Eve. Kings and priests were given special garments. God's people should neither be unduly anxious about how they dress, nor judge others by what they wear. Inner clothing is more important than outer adornment.

The origin of clothing

GEN 3:21

Various regulations regarding clothing

See also LEV 15:1–15:27; DEU 22:5, DEU 22:11–22:12

Special clothing for priests

EXO 28:1–28:5, EXO 29:5–29:6, EXO 39:1; ; LEV 8:7–8:9; ; EZK 44:17–44:19

Rich clothing a sign of wealth or status

GEN 41:42; ; 2SA 13:18; ; EST 6:8–6:9, EST 8:15; ; PSA 45:13–45:14; ; DAN 5:7; ; LUK 16:19; ; ACT 12:21

The Israelites' clothing did not wear out in the desert wanderings

DEU 8:4, DEU 29:5; ; NEH 9:21

Clothing as a symbol of fragility and perishability

ISA 51:8 See also ISA 50:9

Symbolic actions involving clothing

The hem or corner of a garment

RUT 3:9 The corner of a garment spread over a person denotes protection and possession.; ZEC 8:23; ; MAT 9:20 parallel LUK 8:44; ; JHN 20:17; 1SA 15:27, 1SA 24:4–24:5; GEN 37:29, GEN 37:34, GEN 44:13; ; LEV 10:6**2SA 3:31**

Provision of rich clothing a picture of God's love

See also EZK 16:10–16:13; LUK 15:22

Examples of unusual clothing

Joseph's richly ornamented robe

GEN 37:3, GEN 37:23, GEN 37:32

The dress of Elijah and John the Baptist

2KI 1:8; ; MAT 3:4 parallel MRK 1:6

Isaiah's lack of clothing a prophetic sign

ISA 20:2–20:4

The mock robing of Jesus Christ

MAT 27:28 parallels MRK 15:17, JHN 19:2; ; LUK 23:11

Gambling at the cross for Jesus Christ's clothing

MAT 27:35 parallels MRK 15:24, LUK 23:34, JHN 19:23–19:24; ; PSA 22:18

Women and clothing

Women praised for making clothing

PRO 31:21, PRO 31:24; ; ACT 9:39

Women urged to dress modestly

1TI 2:9 See also 1PE 3:3

Believers not to be unduly anxious about clothing

MAT 6:28–6:30 parallel LUK 12:27–12:28

Believers not to discriminate because of clothing

JAS 2:1–2:4

Inner clothing more important than outer adornment

1PE 3:3–3:4 See also ISA 16:7; PRO 31:25; ISA 52:1, ISA 61:3; COL 3:12; 1TI 2:9–2:10; 1PE 5:5

The robe of righteousness

ISA 61:10 See also JOB 29:14; PSA 132:9, PSA 132:16; ZEC 3:3–3:5; MAT 22:1–22:14; 2CO 5:2–5:4; REV 3:17–3:18, REV 19:8

White clothing, the clothing of heaven

The transfiguration of Jesus Christ

MAT 17:2 parallels MRK 9:3, LUK 9:29

The angels at the tomb

See also MAT 28:3 parallels MRK 16:5, LUK 24:4; JHN 20:12

The vision of the redeemed

REV 3:4–3:5 See also REV 3:18, REV 4:4, REV 6:11, REV 7:9

The vision of the exalted Christ

REV 1:13, REV 19:13

5146: covering

That which literally or metaphorically hides from the human or divine eye what should not be seen.

Covering for the human body

GEN 3:7; EZK 16:8 See also GEN 9:23; EXO 22:26–22:27, EXO 28:42; ISA 47:3, ISA 57:8; EZK 16:10; HOS 2:9; JON 3:6; REV 3:18

Covering as a sign of submission or humility

ISA 6:2 See also GEN 24:65; 1CO 11:5–11:15 Some suggest that this passage refers either to a woman's modesty or to her dignity considering her new Christian status of equality with man.

The covering of human sin through atonement

PSA 32:1–32:2 See also GEN 20:16; LEV 4:20 The word translated “atonement” literally means “covering”; NEH 4:5; JOB 14:17; PSA 32:5, PSA 85:2; PRO 17:9; ROM 4:7–4:8; JAS 5:20; 1PE 4:8

Natural phenomena as God's covering

PSA 18:11 See also EXO 19:18; NUM 9:15–9:16; PSA 105:39

5147: deafness

The condition of being wholly, or partly, without hearing. It can be expressed in physical or spiritual terms and is often used to depict spiritual rebellion.

God's control of deafness

EXO 4:11 See also PSA 94:9; PRO 20:12; LUK 1:20, LUK 11:62

Physical aspects of deafness

Compassion for the deaf

LEV 19:14

Deafness sometimes caused by Satan

MRK 9:25

Healed by Jesus Christ

MAT 11:5 parallel LUK 7:22 See also MRK 7:32–7:37; LUK 22:49–22:51

Spiritual aspects of deafness

God deaf to a rebellious people

DEU 1:45 See also PSA 28:1, PSA 38:13, PSA 39:12

Rebellious humanity deaf to God

JER 6:10 See also PRO 28:9; ISA 6:10, ISA 42:19–42:20; EZK 33:32, EZK 37:4; MIC 7:16; ZEC 7:11; MAT 13:15; MRK 4:9–4:12; LUK 8:10; JHN 12:40; ACT 28:26–28:27; 2TI 4:4; REV 2:7 Sin brings spiritual deafness.

The deafness of idols

DEU 4:28 See also PSA 115:6, PSA 135:17; DAN 5:23; REV 9:20

Release from deafness

Through repentance

ISA 29:18 See also ISA 35:5, ISA 42:18

Through the coming of Jesus Christ

LUK 7:22 parallel MAT 11:5 See also MRK 7:32–7:37

5148: ear

The organ of hearing; the ear is referred to in various OT rites and is a symbol of attention, alertness or readiness to hear.

The ear in the OT rites

Piercing the ear: a symbol of servanthood

PSA 40:6 See also EXO 21:5–21:6; DEU 15:16–15:17

Blood applied to the ear: a symbol of cleansing and ordination

LEV 8:23 See also EXO 29:20; LEV 14:14

God's ear as a symbol of his alertness to humanity

PSA 116:1–116:2 See also 2KI 19:16; 2CH 7:15; NEH 1:6; JOB 34:28; JAS 5:4; PSA 5:1, PSA 31:2, PSA 34:15, PSA 88:2, PSA 130:1–130:2; DAN 9:18

God's ear may be turned away from humanity

PSA 28:1 The refusal to turn an ear towards someone was a symbol of refusing to listen. See also DEU 1:45; LAM 3:56; EZK 8:18 God's attending ear is partly dependent on human attitudes to him.

The human ear used symbolically

Human ears should be open to God

ISA 50:4–50:5, ISA 55:3 See also JOB 42:5; PSA 81:8; ISA 30:21, ISA 32:3; MAT 13:9 parallels MRK 4:9, LUK 8:8 “He who has ears” implies a potential willingness to listen; MAT 13:16; MRK 9:7; REV 2:7

Human ears may be closed against God

ZEC 7:11–7:13 See also PSA 58:4–58:5; ISA 6:10

The human ear should also be open to others

ISA 48:8; ; JER 6:10; ; EZK 12:2; ; ACT 7:51, ACT 7:57; ; 2TI 4:4 **PRO 21:13**

A discerning ear brings knowledge and understanding

See also JOB 12:11, JOB 13:1, JOB 34:3; PRO 18:15

5149: eyes

The part of the body designed for seeing. In Scripture eyes are often associated with light, watchfulness or spiritual understanding, whereas blindness may be a metaphor for darkness, ignorance of God or rebellion against him. The eyes of God watch over all his creation.

Eyes are part of the physical body

DEU 28:65; ; JOB 11:20, JOB 31:16; ; PSA 69:3

Eyes may represent the whole person

LUK 10:23; ; REV 1:7

Eyesight is a vital sense

MAT 6:22 See also PSA 54:7; PRO 20:12; LAM 4:17; MAT 11:5 parallel LUK 7:22; MAT 20:33 parallels MRK 10:51, LUK 18:41; ACT 28:27; 1CO 12:17

Eyes may have a powerful emotional effect

SNG 4:9

Eyes reflect character, feelings and emotions

Malice: PSA 35:19; ; PRO 6:13, PRO 10:10, PRO 16:30; PSA 101:5; ; PRO 21:4; MRK 3:5 anger; ; MRK 10:21 love; PSA 88:9; ; JHN 11:33–11:35; 2PE 2:14; ; 1JN 2:16

God's eyes are upon all his creation

God is aware of everything

JOB 34:21 See also ISA 16:7; PSA 94:9, PSA 139:16; PRO 15:3; AMO 9:8; HAB 1:13; ZEC 3:9, ZEC 4:10; HEB 4:13

God watches over his people with care

PSA 34:15 See also DEU 11:12; 1KI 8:29, 1KI 9:3; PSA 1:6, PSA 121:3–121:5; PRO 22:12; 1PE 3:12

God's eyes symbolise his assessment of human behaviour

GEN 6:8 See also EXO 15:26; JDG 2:11; 1KI 15:5; 2CO 8:21

Human eyes may symbolise spiritual vision

God opens eyes in a spiritual sense

PSA 119:18 The “opening of eyes” is an important biblical metaphor for revelation; **EPH 1:18** See also NUM 24:3–24:4; 2KI 6:17; EZR 9:8; ISA 35:5, ISA 61:1; MAT 6:22–6:23 parallel LUK 11:34–11:36; ACT 26:18; HEB 11:27

Human eyes should be directed towards God

PSA 34:5, PSA 123:1–123:2 Lifting one's eyes towards God is an important biblical image of prayer. See also 2CH 20:12; PSA 25:15, PSA 27:4; ISA 40:26; JHN 17:1; ACT 7:55; 2CO 3:16; HEB 12:2

Human eyes will ultimately see God

JOB 19:25–19:27 See also ISA 33:17; JHN 17:24; 1CO 13:12; 1JN 3:2; REV 22:4

Eyes are a channel of temptation

MAT 4:8–4:9 parallel LUK 4:5–4:7 See also GEN 3:6; NUM 15:39; JOS 7:21; 2SA 11:2; PSA 119:37; ECC 2:10, ECC 6:9; MAT 5:28–5:29; 1JN 2:16

Eyes should be guarded against evil

JOB 31:1; PRO 4:25 See also PSA 101:3; ISA 33:15–33:16 The direction of human eyes is a matter of choice.

Closing one's eyes may symbolise indifference to God and his will

MAT 13:15 See also ISA 6:10; PRO 28:27; EZK 22:26; MAT 23:16–23:17; JHN 9:41

5150: face

The main visual characteristic of a person. Facial features are recognisable as uniquely those of a particular person. The face also indicates mood and attitude. The showing or directing of the face towards someone or something may indicate regard, approval or determination, while hiding or turning away of the face indicates the opposite.

The face is the main recognisable feature of a person

Examples of facial recognition

MAT 26:71 parallels MRK 14:66–14:67, LUK 22:56 See also EST 5:2, EST 5:9; MAT 13:55 parallel MRK 6:3; MAT 14:35 parallel MRK 6:54; JHN 1:36, JHN 1:47–1:48

Examples of failure to recognise faces

GEN 42:8 See also GEN 38:15; LUK 24:16; JHN 20:14 There is no evidence to suggest that Jesus Christ's post-resurrection face was different.

The face may be used symbolically to represent the whole person

DEU 7:10

The physical appearance of faces

Attractive faces

SNG 1:15–1:16 See also ISA 16:12; ECC 8:1; DAN 1:4

Disfigured faces

ISA 52:14 See also JOB 2:12; MAT 27:29–27:30 parallels MRK 14:65, LUK 22:63; JHN 18:22

Facial expressions

The face expresses a person's mood

GEN 4:5 See also GEN 21:6; 1SA 1:18; JOB 29:24; DAN 5:6, DAN 5:9; LUK 24:17; JHN 20:15

Averting the face may express worship, respect, modesty or shame

EXO 3:6 See also GEN 24:65; RUT 2:10; 1SA 5:3–5:4; 1KI 18:42; 1CH 21:21; JOB 11:15; PSA 83:16; ISA 6:2; JER 13:26; LUK 5:12

Setting the face expresses determination

LUK 9:51 the literal translation is “set his face to go”

Other gestures involving the human face

Hiding the face from someone as a sign of loss of favour

DEU 31:17–31:18; ; JOB 13:24

Raising the face as a sign of lack of shame

JOB 11:15

Slapping someone's face as a challenge or insult

1KI 22:24; ; JHN 18:22

Spitting in someone's face as an insult

DEU 25:9; ; MAT 26:67

Seeing someone's face

An indicator of acceptance

GEN 33:10 See also GEN 43:3–43:4, GEN 44:23–44:26; DEU 34:10

Indicating confrontation

GAL 2:11 See also 2SA 14:24–14:32; 2KI 14:8

Not seeing someone's face may indicate rejection

EXO 10:28

Examples of supernatural facial appearance

MAT 17:2 parallels MRK 9:2–9:3, LUK 9:29 See also EXO 34:30; MAT 28:3 parallels MRK 16:5, LUK 24:4; ACT 6:15; 2CO 3:7–3:8, 2CO 3:18; REV 1:14, REV 1:16

The face of God

As a symbol of blessing

NUM 6:25–6:26 See also 2SA 21:1; 1CH 16:11; PSA 4:6, PSA 31:16, PSA 67:1, PSA 80:19, PSA 105:4, PSA 119:135; EZK 39:29

Seeking the LORD's face means seeking his will

2CH 7:14; ; PSA 27:8; ; HOS 5:15

God's face may be turned away, hidden or set against people as a sign of opposition or removal from favour

DEU 31:17 See also LEV 17:10; 2CH 30:9; PSA 44:24; ISA 1:15, ISA 59:2, ISA 64:7; EZK 14:8, EZK 39:23; MIC 3:4; 1PE 3:12; PSA 34:15–34:16

People cannot normally see God's face

EXO 33:20 See also GEN 32:30; DEU 34:10; JOB 13:15, JOB 19:26–19:27; 1CO 13:12; REV 22:4 In the end all human beings will see God face to face. **ISA 50:7**

“Face of the earth” indicates the earth's total area

See also GEN 6:7, GEN 7:4; DEU 6:15, DEU 14:2; PSA 104:30; ZEP 1:2–1:3; LUK 21:35

5151: feet

The part of the body associated with moving and with foundation, direction and chosen path. Feet may symbolise the response to God's direction. The feet of God and of Jesus Christ are mentioned symbolically to describe some divine characteristics.

Feet as part of the physical body**Human feet**

EXO 30:19–30:21; ; LEV 8:23; ; DEU 8:4; ; JOS 14:9; ; 2SA 4:4; ; 1KI 15:23; ; SNG 7:1; ; EZK 6:11, EZK 25:6; ; LUK 7:44; ; ACT 3:7

The feet of creatures and objects of worship

GEN 8:9; ; EXO 37:3; ; EZK 1:7; ; DAN 2:33

A whole person may be represented by the foot

JOB 28:4; ; PSA 36:11; ; PRO 6:18; ; ISA 59:7

Symbolic references to human feet**In relation to guidance, direction and following**

PSA 17:5 See also PSA 37:31, PSA 44:18, PSA 56:13, PSA 119:101, PSA 119:105; PRO 3:6, PRO 4:26–4:27; LUK 1:79

In relation to disobedience and waywardness

PSA 1:1 See also 2KI 21:22; JOB 31:5; PRO 1:15–1:16, PRO 4:14, PRO 6:18; ISA 59:7; MAT 18:8 parallel MRK 9:45

In relation to a secure standing with God

PSA 40:2 See also 1SA 2:9; 2SA 22:34 parallel PSA 18:33; PSA 31:8, PSA 66:9; PRO 4:26; HAB 3:19; 1CO 15:58; EPH 6:13

In relation to bringing the gospel

ISA 52:7 See also NAM 1:15; ROM 10:15; EPH 6:15

In relation to expressing attitudes and emotions

JOS 10:24 defeat and humiliation; ; RUT 3:4–3:8 requesting marriage and redemption; ; 1SA 25:24 supplication and homage; 1SA 25:41; ; LUK 7:44; ; JHN 13:5; 2SA 22:39–22:40 parallel PSA 18:38–18:39; ; EZK 24:17 mourning; ; MAT 10:14 parallels MRK 6:11, LUK 9:5 scorn and a warning to those who reject God's message; ACT 4:35, ACT 10:25; HEB 10:29 rejection

“Jesus' feet” symbolises the source and place of God's grace**Worshippers come to Jesus Christ's feet**

LUK 8:35 See also MAT 28:9

The sinful come to Jesus Christ's feet

LUK 7:37–7:38 See also JHN 12:3

The suffering come to Jesus Christ's feet

MAT 15:30 See also MRK 5:22–5:23 parallels MAT 9:18, LUK 8:41; MRK 7:25 parallel MAT 15:25; JHN 11:32

People sit at Jesus Christ's feet to learn

LUK 10:39 It was common practice for disciples to gather around their teacher in this way. See also JHN 8:2

Ultimately all will come to Jesus Christ's feet in worship

ROM 14:11; ; ISA 45:23; ; PHP 2:10

“Feet of God” symbolises his majestic presence

ZEC 14:4 See also EXO 24:10; ISA 66:1; NAM 1:3; MAT 5:35; ACT 7:49; REV 10:2

God's feet are referred to in relation to worship

PSA 99:5, PSA 110:1, PSA 132:7; ; REV 1:17

“Beneath/under the feet” to denote the defeat and subservience of enemies

JOS 10:24; ; 2SA 22:39; ; 1KI 5:3; ; PSA 8:6, PSA 45:5, PSA 47:3; ; ISA 49:23; ; LAM 3:34; ; MAL 4:3; ; MAT 22:42–22:45; ; PSA 110:1; ; ACT 2:34–2:36; ; ROM 16:20; ; 1CO 15:25–15:28; ; EPH 1:22–1:23; ; HEB 10:13; ; REV 3:9

5152: fingers

Parts of the hand used in various kinds of activity, both good and bad. They were prominent in the OT sacrificial ritual, and were also used as a symbol for authority, accusation and minimum effort.

Regular activities using the fingers

PSA 144:1; ; PRO 31:19; ; SNG 5:5

Fingers used in sacrificial ritual**In the consecration of priests**

EXO 29:12 See also LEV 8:15

In the ritual for the sin offering

LEV 4:6 See also LEV 4:17, LEV 4:25, LEV 4:30, LEV 4:34, LEV 9:9

In the ritual of the Day of Atonement

LEV 16:14, LEV 16:19

In cleansing rituals

LEV 14:16; ; NUM 19:4

The finger as a unit of measurement

JER 52:21

Deformed fingers

2SA 21:20 parallel 1CH 20:6

Jesus Christ's fingers

Jesus Christ heals with his fingers

MRK 7:32–7:35

Jesus Christ writes with his fingers

JHN 8:6 See also DAN 5:5

Proving Jesus Christ's resurrection

JHN 20:25 See also JHN 20:27

Evil done with the fingers

Idolatrous worship

ISA 2:8 See also ISA 17:8, ISA 59:3

Making accusations

ISA 58:9 See also PRO 6:12–6:13

Doing harm

JOB 1:12

Fingers used in symbolic actions

The finger ring as a sign of authority

GEN 41:42 See also EST 3:10, EST 8:2; LUK 15:22

The finger as a symbol of minimal effort

MAT 23:4 See also 1KI 12:10 parallel 2CH 10:10 Rehoboam refusing to lift the burdens placed on the people by his father Solomon; LUK 11:46

The finger as a visible reminder

PRO 7:2–7:3 See also DEU 6:8, DEU 11:18

5153: foot-washing

A practice of hospitality used by Jesus Christ to express his servanthood.

Foot-washing as a sign of courteous hospitality

GEN 18:4 See also GEN 19:2; JDG 19:21; 1SA 25:41; LUK 7:44

Jesus Christ washes his disciples' feet

JHN 13:3–13:5 The washing of feet was a lowly task normally performed by a servant.

As an example of servanthood for his followers

JHN 13:14 See also MAT 20:26–20:27 parallel MRK 10:44–10:45; LUK 22:26–22:27; 1TI 5:10

As a symbol of spiritual cleansing

JHN 13:6–13:10

5154: forehead

The front of the head between the eyes. Often used figuratively in phrases denoting a stubborn or persevering attitude. The forehead is the place where symbols of remembrance or allegiance can be placed. Such symbols may particularly represent allegiance to God or Satan.

Literal use of the forehead

See also LEV 13:41–13:43; 2CH 26:19–26:20 NUM 24:17; 1SA 17:49; JER 48:45; EZK 3:9

The forehead used figuratively to denote stubbornness

ISA 48:4

The forehead as a place for symbols which prompt remembrance

EXO 13:9 See also EXO 13:16 DEU 6:8, DEU 11:18

The forehead as a place for symbols of dedication and allegiance

To God and his purposes

EXO 28:36–28:38 See also EZK 9:4; REV 7:3, REV 9:4, REV 14:1, REV 22:4 The receipt of this symbol of allegiance provides protection in judgment and a reminder of the Passover where God's marked people escaped judgment.

To Satan and his ways

REV 13:16, REV 14:9, REV 17:5, REV 20:4

5155: hair

Various conditions, both physical and spiritual, are indicated in Scripture by human hair. Animal hair is used for a variety of purposes.

Physical qualities of human hair

A woman's hair is attractive

SNG 7:5 See also 2KI 9:30; SNG 4:1; 1CO 11:15

A man's hair shows vigour

JDG 16:17–16:22 See also 2SA 14:26; SNG 5:11

Grey hair shows the glory of old age

PRO 16:31 See also LEV 19:32 "aged" may be translated "grey-haired"; PRO 20:29

Greying hair as a sign of declining strength

HOS 7:9

White hair as a sign of age and wisdom

REV 1:14 See also DAN 7:9

Hair as indicating physical or spiritual conditions

Unharmed hair speaks of protection

MAT 10:30 parallel LUK 12:7 See also 1SA 14:45; 2SA 14:11; DAN 3:27; LUK 21:18; ACT 27:34

Hair standing on end indicates fear

JOB 4:15

Baldness may indicate God's judgment

ISA 3:24 See also ISA 3:17

Hair colour may indicate skin disease

LEV 13:3 See also LEV 13:10–13:11, LEV 13:26, LEV 13:30–13:37, LEV 13:40–13:45

Rituals and customs involving the hair

Rules concerning hair for those under a vow

NUM 6:5 See also NUM 6:9, NUM 6:18–6:19; JDG 13:5, JDG 16:17; 1SA 1:11; ACT 18:18, ACT 21:23–21:24

Rules concerning hair for those being cleansed

LEV 14:8–14:9

Mourning customs affecting hair

MIC 1:16 See also LEV 10:6; DEU 21:12–21:13; JOB 1:20; JER 16:6, JER 47:5, JER 48:37; AMO 8:10

Grief signified by tearing or cutting one's hair

EZR 9:3 See also ISA 22:12; JER 7:29

Humiliating others by shaving or pulling out the hair

2SA 10:4 parallel 1CH 19:4 See also NEH 13:25; ISA 7:20

Pagan customs to be avoided

LEV 19:27 See also DEU 14:1–14:2

Customs concerning hair and public worship

1CO 11:6, 1CO 11:13–11:15; ; 1TI 2:9; ; 1PE 3:3

Animal hair

Animal hair used in tabernacle furnishings

EXO 26:7 See also EXO 25:4, EXO 35:26, EXO 36:14

A prophet's clothing made from animal hair

2KI 1:8 See also ZEC 13:4; MAT 3:4 parallel MRK 1:6

Animal hair as a disguise

GEN 27:16 See also 1SA 19:13, 1SA 19:16

Hair used to wipe Jesus Christ's feet

JHN 12:3 See also LUK 7:38, LUK 7:44; JHN 11:2

Nazirite vows forbade the cutting of hair

The reason for taking a Nazirite vow, separation to the Lord

NUM 6:1–6:2 While attention is often focused on Nazirite prohibitions, it is important to note that the

primary reason was for separating oneself to God. Both men and women could make the vow; ; NUM 6:8

The requirements of the Nazirite vow

NUM 6:2–6:4 Nazirites must abstain from all produce of the vine; ; NUM 6:5 Nazirites must not cut their hair; ; NUM 6:6–6:7 Nazirites must not touch a dead body.

The rules for re-establishing a broken Nazirite vow

NUM 6:9–6:12

The regulations for completing the Nazirite vow

NUM 6:13–6:17 The Nazirite vow is completed, first, through prescribed sacrifices; ; NUM 6:18 The Nazirite vow is completed, second, through cutting off one's hair and burning it on the altar; ; NUM 6:19–6:20 The Nazirite vow is completed, third, through ritual acts performed by the priest.

Examples of people dedicated to being lifelong Nazirites

Samson was a lifelong Nazirite: JDG 13:2–13:7, JDG 16:1–16:22; 1SA 1:10–1:11 Samuel was a lifelong Nazirite; ; LUK 1:13–1:15 John the Baptist was possibly a Nazirite.

Examples of temporary Nazirite vows

ACT 18:18, ACT 21:20–21:26

Nazirites to be seen as gifts from God to his people

AMO 2:11–2:12

Expressions involving hair

JDG 20:16; ; REV 6:12

5156: hand

Associated in Scripture with various activities, the hand symbolises particularly power and strength. Jesus Christ's hands often bring healing and blessing.

The hand as part of the physical body

Hands used for physical work

1TH 4:11 See also GEN 31:42; EXO 35:25; DEU 2:7; JOB 1:10; PSA 90:17; ECC 2:11; ACT 20:34

Hands used for praying

EXO 9:29 See also 1KI 8:38 parallel 2CH 6:29; 2CH 6:12–6:13; EZR 9:5; PSA 77:2, PSA 88:9; 1TI 2:8

Hands used in clapping

2KI 11:12 PSA 47:1, PSA 98:8; ; ISA 55:12; JOB 27:23; ; LAM 2:15; ; EZK 25:6; ; NAM 3:19

Hands used for carrying weapons

JER 21:4 See also NUM 22:29, NUM 35:17; JOS 5:13; 1SA 18:10; 2KI 11:11 parallel 2CH 23:10; EZK 9:1–9:2

Hands used for writing

GAL 6:11 See also 1CH 28:19; DAN 5:5, DAN 5:24; ROM 16:22; COL 4:18; 2TH 3:17; PHM 1:19

Hands as a means of assistance

MAT 9:25 parallels MRK 5:41, LUK 8:54 See also PSA 109:31; ISA 63:12; LAM 4:6; MRK 9:27; ACT 3:7, ACT 9:41

Hands used in making idols

2CH 32:19 See also DEU 31:29; 2KI 19:18, 2KI 22:17; 2CH 34:25; ACT 7:41

Idle hands

ECC 10:18 See also PRO 6:10, PRO 10:4, PRO 21:25, PRO 24:33; ECC 4:5, ECC 11:6

Right and left hands**Right hand as the place of honour**

1KI 2:19 See also GEN 48:13–48:14; 1CH 6:39; PSA 45:9; JER 22:24; MAT 25:33–25:34

Significant uses of the left hand

JDG 20:16 See also GEN 48:13–48:14; JDG 3:15, JDG 3:21; 1CH 12:2; EZK 39:3; MAT 6:3

Symbolic uses of the hand**The hand as a symbol of power**

JOB 30:2 See also DEU 32:39–32:40; 1KI 11:12; ISA 47:6; DAN 9:15

The hand as a symbol of violence

PSA 58:2 See also JOB 16:17, JOB 31:21; PRO 6:17; ISA 1:15, ISA 59:3, ISA 59:6; EZK 23:45

Clean hands as a symbol of innocence

PSA 24:3–24:4 See also DEU 21:6–21:7; 2SA 22:21 parallel PSA 18:20; JOB 17:9, JOB 22:30; PSA 26:6, PSA 73:13; MAT 27:24; JAS 4:8

Limp hands as a symbol of paralysing fear

EZK 21:7 See also NEH 6:9; JOB 4:3; ISA 13:7, ISA 35:3; JER 47:3; EZK 7:17–7:18; ZEP 3:16

Hands as a symbol of temptation

MAT 18:8 See also GEN 3:22; EZK 18:8, EZK 18:17; MAT 5:30; MRK 9:43

Hands used in making agreements**Striking hands in pledge**

EZR 10:19; ; PRO 6:1, PRO 11:15, PRO 17:18, PRO 22:26

Symbolic actions in oath taking

GEN 14:22, GEN 24:2, GEN 24:9, GEN 47:29

Joining hands in partnership or fellowship

2KI 10:15; ; ISA 2:6; ; HOS 7:5; ; GAL 2:9

Figurative use of hands

1SA 19:5 See also JDG 12:3; 1SA 28:21; JOB 13:14; PSA 119:109; ISA 2:8

Hands of Jesus Christ**Jesus Christ's hands used in healing**

LUK 4:40 See also MAT 8:3 parallels MRK 1:41, LUK 5:13; MAT 9:18 parallel MRK 5:23; MRK 6:5, MRK 7:32–7:33; LUK 13:13

Jesus Christ's hands used in blessing

MRK 10:13–10:16 parallel MAT 19:13–19:15 See also LUK 24:50

Jesus Christ's hands were pierced

JHN 20:27 See also PSA 22:16; ISA 53:5; ZEC 12:10; JHN 19:37; LUK 24:40; JHN 20:25; ACT 2:23

Hands of angels

EZK 10:7–10:8 See also 1CH 21:15–21:16 parallel 2SA 24:16; ISA 6:6; EZK 1:8

Significant examples of hands

In Jacob's life: GEN 25:26, GEN 27:16, GEN 27:22–27:23; EXO 10:22, EXO 14:21, EXO 14:27; NEH 4:17 Nehemiah's defences; ; MAT 26:23 Judas' betrayal

5157: head

The position of the head often expresses an attitude or emotion. Figuratively head may mean "chief", "first" or "top".

The head as part of the body**Heads of people**

GEN 28:11, GEN 28:18, GEN 48:14, GEN 48:17; ; JDG 5:26; ; SNG 2:6; ; JON 2:5

Heads of animals

EXO 12:9; ; LEV 1:4; ; 2KI 6:25; EXO 22:1; ; 1KI 4:23; ; 2CH 15:11, 2CH 35:9

Heads of idols

1SA 5:4, 1SA 19:13, 1SA 19:16

The head as the uppermost part of the body

LEV 13:12; ; 2SA 14:25; ; JOB 2:7; ; ISA 1:6; ; HAB 3:13; ; JHN 13:9

A measure of height

1SA 9:2, 1SA 10:23

A crown worn on the head

2SA 1:10; ; EST 2:17; ; PSA 21:3; ; JER 13:18; ; LAM 5:16; ; ZEC 6:11

A turban worn on the head

LEV 8:9; ; EZK 23:15; ; ZEC 3:5

Death and decapitation

GEN 40:19; ; 1SA 17:46, 1SA 17:51; ; 2SA 4:7, 2SA 16:9; ;
MAT 14:8–14:11 parallel MRK 6:24–6:28

Head used figuratively in various expressions

“Be it on one’s own head”: personal responsibility that is inescapable

LEV 20:9, LEV 20:11–20:13, LEV 20:27; ; JOS 2:19; ; 1SA 25:39; ; 2SA 1:16; ; 1KI 2:33; ; EZK 9:10, EZK 33:4–33:5

“To come back on one’s own head”: a wrongdoer suffering the very wrong he or she has committed
1KI 8:32 parallel 2CH 6:23; ; NEH 4:4; ; EST 9:25; ; PSA 7:16, PSA 140:9; ; JOL 3:4, JOL 3:7; ; OBA 1:15

“To heap burning coals on his head”: generosity towards an enemy in the hope of causing a change of heart

PRO 25:22; ; ROM 12:20

“Not a hair on one’s head will be lost”: absolute safety

1SA 14:45; ; 1KI 1:52; ; DAN 3:27; ; LUK 12:7; ; ACT 27:34

“To keep one’s head”: staying calm

2TI 4:5

“Making it up out of one’s head”: imagining something

NEH 6:8

“Blessing resting on your head”

GEN 49:26; ; DEU 33:16; ; PRO 10:6; ; ISA 35:10, ISA 51:11

Rituals concerning the head

Cleansing after infectious skin diseases: LEV 14:9, LEV 14:18, LEV 14:29; NUM 6:9; ; JDG 13:5, JDG 16:17; ; 1SA 1:11; DEU 21:12

The anointing of the head

EXO 29:7; ; LEV 8:12; ; MAT 26:7 parallel MRK 14:3

Covering or uncovering the head in Christian worship

1CO 11:4–11:7, 1CO 11:10, 1CO 11:13–11:15

Expressions of grief involving the head**Bowing the head**

PSA 35:14; ; LAM 2:10

Shaving the head

DEU 14:1; ; ISA 15:2; ; JER 47:5, JER 48:37; ; EZK 7:18, EZK 27:30–27:31, EZK 44:20; ; AMO 8:10; ; MIC 1:16

Putting dust on the head

JOS 7:6; ; 1SA 4:12; ; 2SA 1:2, 2SA 15:32; ; NEH 9:1; ; JOB 2:12

Covering the head

2SA 15:30; ; EST 6:12; ; JER 14:3–14:4

Various attitudes expressed with the head**Lifting up the head in joy and expectation**

PSA 3:3, PSA 27:6, PSA 110:7; ; LUK 21:28

Bowing the head in humility

ISA 58:5; ; LUK 18:13

Hanging the head in shame and dejection

JDG 8:28; ; JOB 10:15

Shaking the head in scorn

2KI 19:21 parallel ISA 37:22; ; JOB 16:4; ; PSA 109:25; ; JER 18:16, JER 48:27; ; LAM 2:15; ; MAT 27:39 parallel MRK 15:29; ; PSA 22:7

Rearing the head in rebellion

PSA 83:2

Head meaning chief“ orfirst“**Jesus Christ as the head**

1CO 11:3; ; EPH 1:10, EPH 1:22, EPH 5:23; ; COL 1:18, COL 2:10, COL 2:19

The head of a family, tribe or kingdom

EXO 6:14, EXO 6:25; ; NUM 1:4, NUM 17:3; ; JDG 11:8–11:9; ; ISA 7:8–7:9, ISA 9:14–9:15

Man as the head

1CO 11:3; ; EPH 5:23

Head meaning “top“**Head of a street**

PRO 1:21; ; ISA 51:20; ; LAM 2:19, LAM 4:1; ; EZK 16:25; ; NAM 3:10

Head of a valley

ISA 28:1, ISA 28:4

Head of a table

1SA 9:22

Head of a stalk of grain

LEV 2:14; ; HOS 8:7

Head of an axe

DEU 19:5; ; 2KI 6:5

Head meaning “front“

2CH 20:21; ; JOL 2:11

5158: head-covering

A form of clothing worn on the head, often as a sign of status or rank.

Priestly head-coverings

EXO 29:6 See also EXO 28:4 parallel LEV 8:9; LEV 16:4; ZEC 3:5

Royal head-coverings

EZK 21:25–21:26 See also 2SA 1:10; 2KI 11:12 parallel 2CH 23:11; EST 1:10–1:11, EST 2:17; PSA 21:1–21:3; SNG 3:11; REV 14:14

Military head-coverings

1SA 17:5 See also 2CH 26:14; EZK 23:15, EZK 23:24, EZK 27:10, EZK 38:5

Head-coverings in mourning

2SA 15:30 See also EST 6:12; EZK 24:17

Head-coverings in worship

1CO 11:4–11:7 NIV footnote gives an alternative translation for these verses, taking hair as the head-covering.

Metaphorical use of head-coverings

JOB 29:14 See also EPH 6:17

5159: hearing

In Scripture, both physical hearing and spiritual apprehension. God hears the prayers of his people and the cry of the oppressed. People must hear and respond to God's word.

Divine hearing**God hears the prayers of his people**

2SA 22:7 See also PSA 3:4; ISA 65:24; JHN 11:41–11:42; 1PE 3:12; PSA 34:15

God hears the grumbling of his people

NUM 11:1 See also EXO 16:7–16:9, EXO 16:11–16:12; NUM 12:1–12:2, NUM 14:27

God hears the cry of the oppressed

JAS 5:4 See also EXO 3:7; PSA 94:9

God does not hear the unrighteous

ISA 59:1–59:2 See also PSA 66:18; ISA 1:15; JER 11:11, JER 11:14; EZK 8:18; AMO 5:23; JHN 9:31

Other gods cannot hear

1KI 18:26–18:27; ; PSA 115:6, PSA 135:17; ; ISA 46:7

Hearing the word of God**The importance of hearing God's word**

DEU 5:1; EPH 1:13 See also DEU 4:1; JER 2:4, JER 7:2; MIC 1:2; MAT 13:16–13:17 parallel LUK 10:23–10:24; JHN 5:24; ROM 10:17

Having ears to hear

MAT 11:15 See also MAT 13:9; MRK 4:9, MRK 4:23; LUK 8:8; REV 2:7, REV 2:11, REV 2:17, REV 2:29, REV 3:6, REV 3:13, REV 3:22

The gospel must not only be heard but accepted and acted on

HEB 4:2 See also MAT 7:24–7:27; MRK 4:14–4:20 parallels MAT 13:19–13:23, LUK 8:11–8:15; ROM 2:13; GAL 3:2, GAL 3:5; 1TH 2:13; JAS 1:22–1:24

It is God who grants effective hearing

ACT 16:14 See also PRO 20:12; ISA 50:5; 2TH 2:13–2:14

Some people refuse to hear God's word

JER 6:10 See also ISA 42:18–42:20; EZK 12:2; ACT 7:51; 2TI 4:4

God denies the effective hearing of his word to those who stubbornly resist him

MAT 13:10–13:15 parallels MRK 4:10–4:12, LUK 8:9–8:10 See also ISA 6:9–6:10; JHN 8:43; ACT 28:26–28:27; ROM 11:8; DEU 29:4; ISA 29:10

The first Christians witnessed to what they had heard

ACT 22:14–22:15 See also ACT 4:20; HEB 2:3; 1JN 1:1

Physical hearing was restored by Jesus Christ

MRK 7:35–7:37 See also MAT 11:5 parallel LUK 7:22

The dead will hear the voice of the Son of God

JHN 5:25 See also JHN 5:28–5:29, JHN 11:43–11:44

5160: heel**The heel as a vulnerable part of the body**

GEN 3:15; ; JOB 18:9

“Lifting up one's heel” as a metaphor of betrayal

PSA 41:9; ; JHN 13:18

Jacob grasps Esau by the heel at birth

GEN 25:26 Jacob's name means “he grasps the heel” which, figuratively, means “he deceives”; ; HOS 12:3

5161: kneeling

A bodily posture which expresses an attitude of humility, especially in worship, prayer or submission to the authority of another person.

Kneeling in worship

PSA 95:6 See also 2CH 7:3, 2CH 29:29

Kneeling in submission**To God**

ISA 45:23 See also ROM 14:11; PSA 22:29

To Jesus Christ

PHP 2:9–2:11 See also MAT 27:29 kneeling in mock submission; MRK 5:6, MRK 10:17; LUK 5:8

To other people

EST 3:2 See also 1KI 1:16; 2KI 1:13; MAT 18:26

Kneeling in prayer

DAN 6:10; MAT 9:18; EPH 3:14 See also 1KI 8:54; 2CH 6:13; EZR 9:5; MAT 8:2, MAT 15:25, MAT 17:14, MAT 20:20; LUK 22:41; ACT 7:60, ACT 9:40, ACT 20:36, ACT 21:5

5162: lameness

A physical condition impairing leg movement.

Causes of lameness**Congenital**

ACT 3:2, ACT 14:8

Accidental

2SA 4:4 See also 2SA 9:3, 2SA 9:13

Care for the lame**General care**

JOB 29:15 See also JER 31:8; LUK 14:13–14:14

Healing

MAT 11:5–11:6 parallel LUK 7:22 See also MAT 4:23–4:24, MAT 8:6–8:7, MAT 9:2–9:8 parallels MRK 2:1–2:12, LUK 5:17–5:26; MAT 15:30–15:31, MAT 21:14; ACT 3:6–3:10, ACT 8:7–8:8, ACT 9:33–9:34, ACT 14:8

The spiritual significance of lameness**Relative importance of lameness**

MRK 9:45

Parallel to weakness

See also 2SA 5:6–5:8; ISA 35:2–35:3; HEB 12:12–12:13

As a parallel to fools' words

PRO 26:7

Ultimate healing in heaven

ISA 35:6

Lameness in animals

See also DEU 15:21; MAL 1:7–1:8, MAL 1:13

5163: legs

The legs of an animal were among the choice parts offered in sacrifices. In a human being legs provide strength. Bowing the knee symbolises the submitting of one's human strength to God's control.

Choice parts of a sacrificial animal

EZK 24:4 See also EXO 12:9 EXO 29:17–29:18; LEV 1:9, LEV 1:13, LEV 8:21, LEV 9:13–9:14 LEV 4:11–4:12 burnt outside the camp in the sin offering

Legs of human beings are objects of beauty

SNG 5:15, SNG 7:1

Legs of human beings symbolise strength

REV 10:1 See also 1SA 17:6; PSA 147:10; DAN 2:33, DAN 2:40, DAN 10:6

God's judgment saps human strength

DAN 5:5–5:6 See also EZK 7:17, EZK 21:7; NAM 2:10; HAB 3:16

God's judgment brings pain and disgrace

DEU 28:35; ISA 7:20, ISA 47:2

God gives strength to the weak

HEB 12:12–12:13 See also JOB 4:4; ISA 35:3

The legs of Jesus Christ were not broken at his death

JHN 19:31–19:36

5164: lips**Lips as part of the human body****As a vehicle of speech**

1SA 1:13; ; JOB 15:6, JOB 33:3

As a means of eating and drinking

SNG 7:9; ; DAN 10:3; ; JOL 1:5; ; JHN 19:29

As an object of beauty

SNG 4:3, SNG 4:11, SNG 5:13

Lips attributed to God

JOB 11:5 See also JOB 23:12; PSA 17:4, PSA 89:34; ISA 30:27

Lips associated with various kinds of speech**Praising lips**

PSA 34:1 See also PSA 51:15, PSA 63:3, PSA 63:5, PSA 119:171; ISA 57:19; MAT 21:16; PSA 8:2; HEB 13:15

Praying lips

PSA 21:2 See also JOB 13:6; PSA 17:1

Lips that speak God's word

ACT 15:7 See also EXO 13:9; LUK 4:22

Lips that speak promises and vows

PSA 66:14 See also NUM 30:6, NUM 30:12; DEU 23:23

Lips that give testimony

PSA 40:9, PSA 119:13; ; LUK 22:71

Encouraging lips

JOB 16:5; ; PRO 10:21

Lips expressing different moods**Joyful lips**

JOB 8:21; ; PSA 71:23

Lips that express hesitancy

EXO 6:12, EXO 6:30

Apprehensive lips

HAB 3:16

Lips that speak rashly

PSA 106:33

Lips associated with wrong values**Perverse and sinful lips****JOB 6:30** See also PSA 59:12, PSA 140:9; PRO 4:24, PRO 16:30, PRO 19:1; ISA 6:5**Lips can tempt into sin****PRO 5:3** See also PRO 14:7, PRO 17:4, PRO 18:6–18:7**Deceitful lips****PRO 24:28** See also PSA 31:18, PSA 34:13, PSA 120:2; PRO 10:18; ISA 59:3**Flattering lips**

PSA 12:2–12:3

Hypocritical lips

PSA 50:16; ; PRO 26:23–26:24; ; JER 12:2; ; MAT 15:8 parallel MRK 7:6; ; ISA 29:13

Lips associated with positive values**Lips that speak truth****PRO 12:19** See also PRO 8:6–8:7, PRO 16:13, PRO 23:16; JER 17:16; MAL 2:6–2:7**Lips that speak wisdom****PRO 10:32** See also PSA 40:9; PRO 10:13, PRO 15:7, PRO 20:15, PRO 22:17–22:18**Wise lips are profitable****PRO 12:14** See also PRO 13:2, PRO 18:20**Foolish lips are disastrous****ECC 10:12** See also PRO 14:3, PRO 18:7**Lips must be watched over by God****People must guard their own lips****PSA 141:3** See also EXO 23:13; PRO 13:3; 1PE 3:10; PSA 34:12**Lips must be purified****ISA 6:7** See also HOS 2:17; ZEP 3:9; COL 3:8**Lips need God's touch**

PSA 45:2; ; DAN 10:16

5165: listening

People are called upon to listen attentively to God's word, to his Son and also to words of wisdom. Christians must not only listen to God's word but also put it into practice. Those who refuse to listen to God's word or to correction are condemned.

The importance of listening**To God's word and his spokesmen****1SA 3:10** See also 2CH 20:15; PSA 81:8; JER 26:3–26:6; MIC 1:2; ACT 2:14, ACT 13:16, ACT 28:28**To Jesus Christ****MAT 17:5** parallels MRK 9:7, LUK 9:35 **JHN 10:27** See also MAT 15:10 parallel MRK 7:14; LUK 10:16, LUK 10:39; JHN 10:8, JHN 10:16**To words of wisdom****PRO 19:20; JAS 1:19** See also PSA 34:11; PRO 5:7, PRO 7:24, PRO 8:32–8:34, PRO 12:15, PRO 13:1, PRO 15:31; LUK 2:46; JAS 2:5**Believers should not listen to false prophets or ungodly suggestions****JER 23:16** See also DEU 13:1–13:3, DEU 13:6–13:8; JER 27:9, JER 27:14–27:17, JER 29:8–29:9; EZK 13:19; 1JN 4:1, 1JN 4:5–4:6; 2JN 1:10**The wicked refuse to listen to God****EZK 3:7** See also EXO 7:13 Pharaoh's refusal to listen; 2KI 17:14, 2KI 17:40, 2KI 18:12; NEH 9:17; PSA 81:11; ISA 65:12 JER 7:13, JER 7:26–7:27, JER 12:17, JER 13:11, JER 17:23, JER 22:21, JER 25:3, JER 25:7, JER 29:19, JER 32:33, JER 34:14, JER 35:15, JER 35:17, JER 37:2, JER 38:15, JER 44:5, JER 44:16 EZK 20:8; ZEC 7:11–7:12; MAL 2:2; LUK 16:29–16:31**Those who refuse to listen to correction are condemned****MAT 18:15–18:17****God's people must not only listen to God's word but also put it into practice****LUK 11:28; JAS 1:22–1:24** In Hebrew and Greek the verb "listen" is related by the verb "to obey". See also EZK 33:32; MAT 7:24–7:27 parallel LUK 6:47–6:49; ROM 2:13**Examples of people listening**

GEN 18:10 Sarah at the tent entrance; ; GEN 27:5 Rebekah to Isaac; ; 1SA 3:9–3:10 Samuel to God; ; PRO 19:27 a son to instruction; ; LUK 2:46 Jesus Christ to the

teachers of the law; LUK 5:1, LUK 20:45; LUK 10:39 Mary to Jesus Christ; ACT 16:14, ACT 16:25, ACT 26:29

5166: liver and kidneys

The liver and kidneys as vital internal organs of the body

PRO 7:23 See also JOB 16:13, JOB 20:24–20:25

The liver and kidneys are symbolic of human emotions and the conscience

PSA 73:21 The Hebrew words for liver and kidneys are occasionally translated as “heart”, “spirit” or “inmost being”. See also JOB 19:27; PRO 23:16; JER 12:2; LAM 2:11, LAM 3:13

God examines the innermost being as symbolised by the kidneys

PSA 26:2 See also PSA 7:9; JER 11:20, JER 17:10, JER 20:12

God is concerned for the innermost being as symbolised by the kidneys

PSA 139:13 See also PSA 16:7

The liver and kidneys as offered in animal sacrifice

Liver and kidneys offered in various sacrifices

LEV 3:3–3:5 The liver and kidneys are associated with the fat as the choice parts of the animal. See also LEV 3:9–3:11, LEV 3:14–3:16, LEV 4:8–4:10, LEV 7:3–7:6

Liver and kidneys had a central role in the ordination services for priests

EXO 29:13, EXO 29:22–29:25; ; LEV 8:16–8:17, LEV 8:25–8:28, LEV 9:8–9:10, LEV 9:19–9:21

Divination by inspection of the liver

EZK 21:21 Divination by inspection of the liver (hepatoscopy) was a common practice. The future was predicted from the colour and configuration of the liver of a sacrificial animal, usually a sheep.

5167: mouth

In addition to its normal physical functions, it has great potential for good and evil. The words of God’s mouth are always effective. Mouth is also used in the sense of an entrance or opening.

The words of God’s mouth

They are always effective

LAM 3:38 See also ISA 55:11

They are creative and life-giving

DEU 8:3 See also PSA 33:6; MAT 4:4

They bring judgment

HOS 6:5 See also JOB 15:30; 2TH 2:8; REV 2:16

They are reliable

NUM 23:19 See also 1KI 8:15 parallel 2CH 6:4; 1KI 8:24 parallel 2CH 6:15; HEB 6:13–6:18

They are to be treasured

PSA 119:72 See also JOS 1:8; JOB 23:12; PSA 119:13–119:14, PSA 119:103

God puts his words into the mouths of his people

DEU 18:18 See also EXO 4:12, EXO 4:15; NUM 22:38; 1KI 17:24; ISA 49:2; JER 1:7, JER 1:9; EZK 3:1–3:4; ACT 4:25, ACT 4:31

The mouth used for eating and drinking

PRO 18:20 See also JDG 7:5–7:6; PSA 78:29–78:30; PRO 19:24, PRO 30:20; ECC 6:7; EZK 4:14; NAM 3:12; ACT 11:8

The mouths of animals

The danger they represent

1SA 17:35; ; JOB 41:14, JOB 41:19, JOB 41:21; ; AMO 3:12

Enemies described as dangerous animals

PSA 22:13 See also PSA 22:21; 2TI 4:17

God controls the mouths of dangerous animals

DAN 6:22 See also NUM 22:28–22:30; HEB 11:33; 2PE 2:16; REV 12:15–12:16, REV 16:13

The mouth used for speaking

To speak what is good

PRO 10:11 See also JOB 16:5; PSA 19:14; PRO 8:7

To praise

PSA 71:8 See also PSA 51:15, PSA 63:5, PSA 89:1; ROM 15:6

To testify about God

PSA 71:15 See also PSA 71:18; ROM 10:10

To teach God’s wisdom

PSA 49:3 See also PSA 37:30; PRO 10:31; MAL 2:6–2:7; MAT 13:35; PSA 78:2

To speak what is bad

PSA 10:7 See also 1SA 2:3; JOB 20:12; PSA 5:9, PSA 36:3, PSA 50:19; PRO 5:3, PRO 7:21, PRO 11:9, PRO 15:28, PRO 26:28; ISA 9:17, ISA 29:13; LUK 6:45; REV 13:5–13:6

Gestures involving the mouth

JOB 3:1 Opening the mouth signifies declaration; ; JOB 21:5 Clapping the hand over the mouth signifies keeping silent from fear or astonishment; ; ACT 23:2 Striking the mouth signifies rebuke.

God fills mouths

With good things
PSA 81:10

With joy

PSA 126:2 See also EZR 3:13; JOB 8:21, JOB 35:10; PSA 40:3, PSA 132:16, PSA 149:6; ISA 35:6; LUK 1:64

With food

PSA 145:15 See also NEH 9:20; PSA 78:27-78:30, PSA 81:16, PSA 104:27-104:28; LUK 1:53

Mouth meaning entrance or opening

The mouth of a well

GEN 29:2-29:3, GEN 29:8-29:10

The mouth of a sack

GEN 42:27, GEN 43:12, GEN 43:21, GEN 44:1-44:2, GEN 44:8

The mouth of the grave

PSA 141:7; ; ISA 5:14 “the grave” is literally “Sheol”, the shadowy abode of the departed.

The mouth of a cave

JOS 10:18, JOS 10:22, JOS 10:27; ; 1KI 19:13; ; JER 48:28

The mouth of a river

JOS 15:5, JOS 18:19; ; ISA 19:7

The mouth of the earth

GEN 4:11; ; NUM 16:30, NUM 16:32, NUM 26:10; ; DEU 11:6

Mouth likened to a sword

JOB 5:15; ; ISA 49:2

5168: muteness

The inability to speak or to make sounds comprehensible as speech.

Physical muteness

A disability, sometimes associated with demon-possession, healed by Jesus Christ

MAT 9:32-9:33 See also MAT 12:22 parallel LUK 11:14; MAT 15:30-15:31; MRK 7:31-7:37, MRK 9:14-9:29

Healing as a Messianic sign

MAT 12:22-12:23 See also ISA 32:4, ISA 35:6; MAT 4:23, MAT 9:33

God and muteness

God gives and withholds speech

EXO 4:11-4:12 See also EXO 4:10

God may impose muteness in judgment

LUK 1:20 See also LUK 1:64

God may silence his prophets

EZK 3:26 See also EZK 24:27, EZK 33:22

The muteness of idols

1CO 12:2 See also 1KI 18:26; PSA 115:5 parallel PSA 135:16; ISA 41:26, ISA 41:28, ISA 46:7; JER 10:5; HAB 2:18-2:19

Spiritual aspects of muteness and silence

Evil silenced by God

JOB 5:16; ; PSA 63:11, PSA 107:42; ; EZK 16:63; ; MRK 3:4; ; ROM 3:19

Evil silenced by godliness

1PE 2:15

Silence on earth

HAB 2:20

Silence in heaven

REV 8:1

God opens believers' mouths in praise

PSA 40:3

Voluntary muteness

Of David

PSA 38:13-38:14 See also PSA 39:1-39:3, PSA 39:9

Of Jesus Christ

ISA 53:7 See also ACT 8:32; PSA 38:13; MAT 26:62-26:63 parallel MRK 14:60-14:61; MAT 27:12-27:14 parallels MRK 15:5, JHN 19:9; LUK 23:8-23:9

5169: nakedness

Nakedness was innocent before the fall

GEN 2:25

The shame of nakedness a result of the fall

GEN 3:7-3:11

Public exposure of nakedness is indicative of shame or humiliation

REV 3:18 See also GEN 9:22-9:23; EXO 20:26; ISA 47:3; EZK 16:8, EZK 16:35-16:37; HOS 2:9-2:10; AMO 2:16; NAM 3:5; HAB 2:15; REV 17:16

Exposure of nakedness is symbolic of adultery and prostitution

EZK 23:18 See also ISA 57:8; LAM 1:8; EZK 16:36

Nakedness is symbolic of dire poverty

REV 3:17 See also DEU 28:48; 2CH 28:15; JOB 1:21, JOB 24:4-24:10; ISA 58:6-58:7; MIC 1:8, MIC 1:11; ROM 8:35; 2CO 11:27

5170: neck**The neck may express human pride**

“Stiff-necked” as a term for obstinacy

EXO 32:9 See also EXO 34:9; DEU 9:6, DEU 31:27; 2KI 17:14; NEH 9:16–9:29; PRO 29:1; JER 19:15; ACT 7:51

An outstretched neck as a sign of pride

ISA 3:16 See also PSA 75:5

Placing the foot on the neck as a sign of conquest
JOS 10:24**Ornaments were hung around the neck**

See also PRO 3:3, PRO 6:20–6:21

A millstone placed around the neck as punishment

MAT 18:6 parallel MRK 9:42

5171: nose**The nose as part of the human body**

Human life is given and sustained through the nostrils

GEN 2:7 See also GEN 7:22; NUM 11:20; JOB 27:3; ISA 2:22

The nose and the sense of smell

GEN 27:27 See also JOB 39:25; SNG 4:11; DAN 3:27; AMO 4:10; 1CO 12:17

Animals snort and sniff through their noses

JOB 39:20, JOB 41:18, JOB 41:20; ; JER 2:24, JER 8:16

The nose and sneezing

2KI 4:35

The nose as an object of beauty

SNG 7:4

The nose may be adorned with rings

EZK 16:12 See also GEN 24:22, GEN 24:30, GEN 24:47; ISA 3:21

The nose is vulnerable to attack

PRO 30:33 See also EZK 23:25

Captives are led by rings or hooks in the nose

2KI 19:28 parallel ISA 37:29 See also 2CH 33:11; AMO 4:2

Contempt is communicated by means of the nose

PSA 10:5; ; ISA 57:4; ; MAL 1:13; ; LUK 16:14, LUK 23:35; ; ACT 17:32

Offence is taken, metaphorically, by the nose**People take offence**

2SA 16:21 See also GEN 34:30; EXO 5:21; 2SA 10:6 parallel 1CH 19:6

God takes offence

ISA 65:5

God's power is indicated by the blast of his nostrils

EXO 15:8 See also 2SA 22:9 parallel PSA 18:8; 2SA 22:16 parallel PSA 18:15

Lifeless idols have noses

PSA 115:6 See also DEU 4:28

5172: offal

The internal organs of an animal, traditionally regarded as being inferior to meat, and used as a symbol of disgrace.

Offal is symbolic of disgrace

MAL 2:3 See also NAM 3:6

In animal sacrifices the offal was removed and burnt outside the camp

EXO 29:14 See also LEV 4:11–4:12, LEV 8:17, LEV 16:27; NUM 19:3–19:5, NUM 19:5

Jesus Christ bears the believer's disgrace

HEB 13:11–13:13

5173: outward appearance

That which is visible on the outside may reveal the true person, but is sometimes misleading. Judging by it and boasting in it are typical of sinful humanity. God sees the inner reality.

Outward appearance can reveal the truth**Spiritually**

MAT 7:16–7:20 parallel LUK 6:43–6:45 See also MAT 5:16, MAT 12:33–12:37; JHN 15:8; JAS 2:17–2:18

Emotionally

PRO 15:13 See also 1SA 1:16–1:18; PRO 17:22; ECC 8:1; DAN 5:5–5:6; MRK 10:22

Outward appearance can be deceptive

MAT 23:25–23:28 See also ISA 29:13, ISA 53:2–53:3; MAT 7:15; LUK 11:39–11:41; 2CO 11:13–11:15; COL 2:23; HEB 13:2

While people may judge by outward appearance, God does not

People take note of outward appearance

JHN 7:23–7:24 See also LUK 16:14–16:15; JHN 8:15; 2CO 10:7; JAS 2:1–2:4; REV 3:17

God looks at the heart

1SA 16:6–16:7 See also 1KI 8:39 parallel 2CH 6:30; PSA 139:1–139:2; PRO 16:2, PRO 21:2; ISA 11:3–11:5; LUK 16:15; GAL 2:6; REV 2:23

The folly of boasting in outward appearance

LUK 20:45–20:47 See also MAT 6:2, MAT 6:5, MAT 6:16; 2CO 5:12; GAL 6:12

What is unseen is more important than outward appearance

2CO 4:16–4:18 See also PSA 51:6, PSA 147:10–147:11; ROM 2:28–2:29

Beautiful physical appearance

Examples of the problems and opportunities caused by beautiful outward appearance

GEN 12:11–12:15 Sarah's beauty led to Abraham's folly; ; GEN 39:6–39:7 Joseph's handsome appearance led to his being tempted by Potiphar's wife; ; 1SA 9:2, 1SA 16:12, 1SA 25:3; ; 2SA 11:2–11:3 Bathsheba's beauty tempted David; ; 2SA 14:25–14:26; ; EST 1:10–1:11, EST 2:7 Esther's beauty was an opportunity for God.

The cultivation of inner beauty encouraged

1PE 3:3–3:5; ; 1TI 2:9–2:10

5174: prostration

The act of falling down upon one's face in front of someone, as a gesture of fear or reverence before God or a person of high rank.

Prostration before God

In reverence or fear

NUM 20:6; 1CH 29:20; REV 7:11 See also GEN 17:3; LEV 9:24; NUM 24:4; 1SA 5:3; 1KI 18:39; NEH 8:6; EZK 1:28; MAT 2:11, MAT 17:6, MAT 26:39; LUK 5:12

As an expression of grieving over sin

DEU 9:18, DEU 9:25; ; JOS 7:6; ; ISA 15:3; ; EZK 9:8

Prostration before God's messenger

NUM 22:31 See also JOS 5:14; JDG 13:20; 1CH 21:16; DAN 8:17; LUK 24:5

Prostration before other people

1SA 24:8; ISA 51:23 See also RUT 2:10; 1SA 25:23, 1SA 28:14; 2SA 14:4, 2SA 19:18; ISA 49:23; DAN 2:46

5175: reading

The gaining of information through written documents. The Law was read regularly in the synagogue. Jesus Christ expected the Scriptures to be read. NT letters were read in the churches to which they were sent.

Reading of the Law to Israel

By Moses

EXO 24:7 See also DEU 31:10–31:11

By Joshua

JOS 8:34–8:35

By Josiah

2KI 23:2 parallel 2CH 34:30

In Ezra's time

NEH 8:2–8:3, NEH 8:18, NEH 9:3, NEH 13:1

Reading of the Law in the synagogue

ACT 15:21 See also LUK 4:16; ACT 13:15, ACT 13:27; 2CO 3:14–3:15

Other examples of reading

DEU 17:18–17:20; JER 36:6–36:8, JER 51:61; DAN 9:2 Daniel foresaw the end of the exile through reading the Scriptures.

Jesus Christ expected the Scriptures to be read

MAT 12:3–12:5 parallels MRK 2:25–2:26, LUK 6:3–6:4 See also MAT 19:4, MAT 21:16, MAT 21:42 parallels MRK 12:10–12:11, LUK 20:17; MAT 22:31, MAT 24:15 parallel MRK 13:14

Reading of NT letters

COL 4:16 See also ACT 15:31; 1TH 5:27

Reasons for reading the Scriptures

They are God-breathed

2TI 3:16

God's word is true

JHN 17:7

To understand the truth about Jesus Christ

LUK 24:26–24:27; ; EPH 3:4

To believe and be saved from God's wrath

JHN 20:31; ; 2TI 3:15

To learn how to serve and please God

PSA 119:105, PSA 119:130; ; 2TI 3:16; ; REV 1:3

They teach Christians and give them hope

ROM 15:4; ; 1JN 2:1, 1JN 2:12–2:14, 1JN 2:21

They enable Christians to discern truth from error

ACT 18:28 See also ACT 17:11; GAL 1:6–1:9; 2PE 3:14–3:16; 1JN 2:26, 1JN 4:1

5176: ring

An ornament or a status symbol, sometimes used in sacred furnishings or as a charm.

Rings worn as jewellery

Gold nose rings, worn especially by women

These were often given by a suitor as a symbol of betrothal: GEN 24:22, GEN 24:30, GEN 24:47; ; PRO 11:22; ; ISA 3:21; ; EZK 16:12

The signet ring as a sign of authority

GEN 41:42; ; NUM 31:50; ; EST 3:10, EST 3:12, EST 8:8; ; DAN 6:17; JER 22:24; ; HAG 2:23

Gold ear-rings, worn by men and women

Ear-rings were sometimes used as charms or amulets: GEN 35:4; ; EXO 32:2–32:3, EXO 35:22; ; JDG 8:24–8:25

Rings as indications of wealth or status

JOB 42:11; ; HOS 2:13; ; LUK 15:22; ; JAS 2:2

Rings used in sacred furnishings

On the ark of the covenant

EXO 25:12–25:15

On the table

EXO 25:26–25:27

In the tabernacle

EXO 26:24–26:29

On priestly garments

EXO 28:23–28:24

For carrying altars

EXO 27:4–27:7, EXO 30:4, EXO 37:27

5177: robes

A formal style of clothing, often indicating priesthood, royalty or elevated social status.

Priestly robes

Aaron's priestly robes

EXO 28:4 See also EXO 28:31–28:34, EXO 29:5, EXO 39:22–39:26; LEV 8:7; PSA 133:2

Other wearers of priestly robes

1SA 2:19; ; 1CH 15:27

Royal robes

The majestic robes of God

PSA 93:1; ; ISA 6:1, ISA 63:1

Robes for kings and queens

EST 5:1 See also 1KI 22:10 parallel 2CH 18:9; 1KI 22:30 parallel 2CH 18:29; EST 8:15; JON 3:6; ACT 12:21

Jesus Christ robed as a king and mocked

MRK 15:17 parallel MAT 27:28 See also JHN 19:2, JHN 19:5

Robes indicating office, favour or wealth

GEN 41:42 See also GEN 37:3; JOS 7:21; 1SA 18:4; 2SA 13:18; 1KI 10:25; EST 6:7–6:11; ISA 3:18–3:23, ISA 22:21; MIC 2:8; MRK 12:38; LUK 20:46, LUK 15:22

Robes associated with righteousness and purity

ISA 61:10 See also REV 6:11, REV 7:9, REV 7:13–7:14, REV 22:14

Tearing of robes to show mourning or repentance

JOB 2:12 See also 2CH 34:27

5178: running

Scripture gives pictures of running in both its literal and metaphorical senses, the image of the Christian life as a race being particularly significant.

Running away

Fleeing in battle

EXO 23:27 See also LEV 26:36–26:37; JOS 7:12, JOS 8:3–8:19; 1SA 14:20–14:22

Escaping from danger

PRO 18:10 See also GEN 19:12–19:22; NEH 6:10–6:11; ISA 10:1–10:3; JER 17:16, JER 48:4–48:6, JER 51:6, JER 51:44–51:45; AMO 2:14–2:16; JHN 10:12–10:13

Running away from individuals

1SA 19:11–19:12 See also GEN 16:6–16:8, GEN 31:20–31:21, GEN 39:11–39:15; JHN 10:2–10:5

Running away from God

JON 1:1–1:10

Running away from evil

2TI 2:22 See also 1CO 6:18, 1CO 10:14; 1TI 6:11

Running after people or things

PSA 16:4 See also RUT 3:10; ISA 5:11; JER 2:23–2:25; EZK 16:32–16:34; MAT 6:28–6:34 parallel LUK 12:27–12:31

Running in eagerness

JHN 20:1–20:4 See also 2CH 23:12; MRK 9:25; LUK 17:22–17:23; ACT 3:11, ACT 21:30

Running swiftly

JOB 9:25 See also JOB 39:13–39:18; ECC 9:11; JER 12:5

Heralds running ahead of a dignitary**ISA 8:11** See also 2SA 15:1; 1KI 1:5, 1KI 18:46**Messages carried by runners****2SA 18:19** See also 2SA 18:21–18:32; 2KI 4:25–4:31, 2KI 5:20–5:23, 2KI 9:1–9:3; PSA 147:15; JER 23:21; HAB 2:2; ZEC 2:3–2:5**The life of the believer likened to running a race****GAL 2:2** See also PSA 119:32; PRO 4:10–4:12; ISA 40:30–40:31; ACT 20:24; 1CO 9:24–9:27; GAL 5:7; PHP 2:14–2:16; 2TI 4:6–4:8; HEB 12:1; 2JN 1:9**5179: sandal**

A form of open shoe worn in warm climates, and the only form of foot-covering to be of major importance in Scripture. Both the wearing and the removal of sandals is often seen as symbolic; to go barefoot was often a sign of shame, mourning or poverty.

Sandals were normally worn by an official, soldier or messenger

1KI 2:5; ; EPH 6:15

Untying and carrying sandals was the task of a servant**MAT 3:11** parallels MRK 1:7, LUK 3:16, JHN 1:27 John considers himself unworthy even to be a slave of Jesus Christ. See also ACT 13:25**The removal of sandals as a gesture****As a mark of respect in the presence of God****EXO 3:5** See also JOS 5:15; ACT 7:33**To show rejection of any claim to property**

DEU 25:9–25:10; ; RUT 4:7–4:8; ; PSA 60:8 parallel PSA 108:9

To predict the defeat and disgrace of Egypt and Assyria

ISA 20:2–20:4

As a sign of mourning and repentance

2SA 15:30; ; EZK 24:17, EZK 24:23; ; MIC 1:8

The symbolic use of sandals**As symbols of readiness for action****EXO 12:11****As symbols of oppression and injustice**

See also AMO 2:6, AMO 8:6

Fine sandals as a status symbol

EZK 16:10; ; LUK 15:22

Sandals as an example of the need for minimum possessions in God's service

MAT 10:10 parallels MRK 6:9, LUK 10:4; ; LUK 22:35

5180: shaving

The removal of hair with a razor or other sharp implement. Both male and female Israelites allowed their hair to grow long. Barbers trimmed, but did not crop, men's hair, so giving special significance to the shaving of the head or whole body. These actions indicated shame or grief.

Personal toilet

GEN 41:14; ; 2SA 14:26

Symbolic shaving**Shaved head a sign of grief****JOB 1:20** See also DEU 21:10–21:14; ISA 15:2; JER 47:5, JER 48:36–48:37; EZK 27:31; AMO 8:10; MIC 1:16; JER 7:29, JER 41:5**A shaved head a sign of shame****2SA 10:4** parallel 1CH 19:4 See also EZR 9:3; ISA 7:20, ISA 50:6; JER 2:16; EZK 7:18; 1CO 11:5–11:6**Shaving in ritual cleansing**

LEV 14:8–14:9; ; NUM 8:7; ; ACT 21:24

Shaving as a visual aid

EZK 5:1–5:4

After a period of dedication

NUM 6:18

Shaving forbidden**As a pagan practice****LEV 19:27, LEV 21:5** See also DEU 14:1 Pagans shaved the front of their heads as a sign of mourning. God's people should have a different attitude to bereavement from those who have no hope; EZK 44:20**For the sake of a Nazarite vow****NUM 6:5** See also JDG 16:17; 1SA 1:11**5181: sitting**

A bodily posture associated with resting, eating or instruction. When used of God, the image often conveys the idea of kingly authority over creation.

Sitting to rest**GEN 18:1; JHN 4:6** See also EXO 2:15, EXO 17:12; 1KI 19:4; MAT 26:36

Sitting to eat

EXO 32:6; LUK 17:7 See also JDG 19:6; RUT 2:14; 1SA 20:24; PRO 23:1; JER 16:8; MAT 14:19; 1CO 10:7

Sitting to teach or to learn

MAT 5:1–5:2 See also MAT 13:2; MRK 9:35; LUK 2:46, LUK 10:39; JHN 8:2

Sitting for prayer

JDG 21:2 See also 2SA 7:18

Sitting as a sign of authority**Human authority**

EXO 11:5 See also 1KI 1:13, 1KI 3:6; 2KI 10:30; ZEC 6:13; MRK 10:37

Divine authority

PSA 29:10 See also 1KI 22:19; PSA 47:8, PSA 80:1; ISA 6:1; MAT 26:64; LUK 20:42; HEB 1:3, HEB 10:12, HEB 12:2; REV 3:21, REV 4:10, REV 7:10

Sitting to judge

EXO 18:13; MAT 25:31 See also 2SA 19:8; PRO 20:8; ISA 28:6; JER 38:7; DAN 7:26; JOL 3:12; MAT 27:19; LUK 22:30; ACT 23:3

Sitting as a sign of possession and peace

MIC 4:4 See also ZEC 3:10

Jesus Christ seated at God's right hand

LUK 22:69; ; EPH 1:20, EPH 2:6; ; COL 3:1

5182: skin

The outer covering of the body. Diseased skin is often subject to pain and regarded as unclean.

Skin as the outer covering of the body

JOB 10:10–10:11 See also GEN 3:21, GEN 27:11; EZK 37:6, EZK 37:8

Violence against the skin

MIC 3:2–3:3 See also JOB 2:4–2:5

Skin and bones

PSA 102:5 To be reduced to skin and bones is a mark of severe suffering. See also NUM 4:8–4:14 animal skins used for covering the ark of the Testimony; JOB 19:20; LAM 3:4, LAM 4:8

Skin diseases**Skin diseases are painful**

JOB 30:30 See also JOB 7:5, JOB 18:13; LAM 5:10

They can be defiling

NUM 5:2–5:3 See also LEV 13:1–13:11, LEV 13:43–13:46, LEV 22:4

As God's punishment for sin

NUM 12:10–12:11 Miriam; ; 2KI 5:26–5:27 Naaman; ; 2CH 26:19–26:20 Uzziah

Healed by Jesus Christ

MAT 8:2–8:3 parallels MRK 1:40–1:42, LUK 5:12–5:13; ; LUK 17:12–17:14

Skin cannot be changed

JER 13:23

A person can know God even when the skin has been destroyed

JOB 19:26–19:27

5183: smell

An aroma; God is pleased by the aroma of sacrifice, whether a literal sacrifice or the figurative offering of Christian service is a picture of its acceptability to him. Bad smells can indicate physical decay or the results of judgment. To be a stench to someone is to be held in contempt or hated by that person.

The aroma of sacrifice

GEN 8:21 See also LEV 1:9, LEV 2:2, LEV 3:5, LEV 4:31, LEV 6:15, LEV 6:21, LEV 8:21, LEV 23:13, LEV 23:18; NUM 15:14, NUM 15:24 offerings to be made for unintentional breaking of the LORD's commandments; NUM 18:17, NUM 28:2, NUM 29:2

Substances to create a pleasing smell

EXO 30:7–30:8 See also EXO 30:22–30:29, EXO 30:34–30:38, EXO 35:28, EXO 37:29, EXO 40:26–40:27; NUM 4:16; 2CH 2:4, 2CH 13:11

The aroma of sacrifice is not always pleasing to God
LEV 26:31; ; EZK 8:11–8:13, EZK 20:27–20:29

Jesus Christ was the supreme fragrant offering
EPH 5:2

God accepts his people as fragrant incense

EZK 20:41 See also HOS 14:5–14:6

A pleasing aroma depicts acceptable Christian service

2CO 2:14–2:16 See also PHP 4:18

Fragrance associated with the expression of love

SNG 1:2–1:3, SNG 4:16–5:1 The beloved's garden is an image of her body. See also PSA 45:8; SNG 1:12–1:13, SNG 3:6, SNG 4:10–4:11, SNG 5:13, SNG 7:8 **JHN 12:3**

A bad smell

Indicating decay

JHN 11:39 See also EXO 16:20 Manna soon smelled bad if kept. This meant the Israelites had to trust God afresh for each day's supply.

As the result of God's judgment

The first plague on Egypt, which made the Nile smell bad: EXO 7:18, EXO 7:21; ISA 34:3; ; AMO 4:10

As a picture of the results of judgment

ISA 3:24, ISA 19:6; ; JOL 2:20

As a figurative cause of contempt or hatred

GEN 34:30; ; EXO 5:21; 1SA 13:4; ; 2SA 10:6 parallel 1CH 19:6; ; 2SA 16:21

Idols cannot smell

PSA 115:4–115:6 See also DEU 4:28

5184: standing

The bodily posture of being in a stationary upright position.

Standing as a sign of authority

ACT 7:55

Standing merely to wait or rest

EXO 33:21 See also JOS 3:8; 1KI 20:38; MAT 12:47, MAT 20:3, MAT 26:73; LUK 19:24; JHN 8:9

Standing ready for action

NUM 22:23; ACT 5:23 See also DEU 10:8; JOS 5:13; 1SA 17:16; 1CH 21:16; LUK 1:11; ACT 16:9; REV 7:1

Standing to show respect or honour

DAN 2:2 See also 1KI 10:8, 1KI 22:19; 2CH 6:3; NEH 8:4; JER 36:21; DAN 10:11

Standing in the presence of God

In heaven

LUK 1:19 See also ZEC 6:5; REV 7:9, REV 8:2

On earth

GEN 19:27; EXO 3:5; NEH 9:5 See also EXO 33:10; DEU 4:10, DEU 29:10; 1SA 1:26; 1CH 23:30; 2CH 20:9; PSA 24:3; JER 28:5; MAT 6:5; MRK 11:25; LUK 18:11; ROM 14:4

Standing for trial or judgment

EXO 18:13; ROM 14:10 See also NUM 5:16, NUM 35:12; DEU 19:17; 1SA 12:3, 1SA 12:7; ZEC 3:1; MAT 27:11; LUK 11:32; ACT 23:6, ACT 25:10; REV 20:12

Standing firm as a believer

PRO 10:25; 1CO 15:58 See also LUK 21:28; ROM 5:2, ROM 11:20; 1CO 15:1, 1CO 16:13; 2CO 1:21, 2CO 1:24; GAL 5:1; PHP 4:1; COL 4:12; 2TH 2:15; JAS 5:8; 1PE 5:12

Against evil and temptation

1CO 10:13; ; EPH 6:11–6:14

Against enemies and opposition

PSA 94:16 See also EXO 14:13; 2CH 20:17; ISA 7:9; JER 1:17; EPH 6:11–6:14; PHP 1:27

Other metaphorical uses of standing

God's purpose will stand

ISA 46:10 See also ISA 14:24

Standing in the gap

EZK 22:30 See also PSA 106:23

5185: stomach

As well as the physical stomach, the term is used in association with God's judgment or in a figurative sense.

Stomach as part of the physical body

1CO 6:13 See also JOB 40:16; SNG 7:2; DAN 2:32

Jonah in the stomach of a huge fish

MAT 12:40 See also JON 1:17–2:1

Ritual laws concerning the stomach

MRK 7:18–7:19 parallel MAT 15:17 See also LEV 11:41–11:45

Afflictions of the stomach

LUK 15:16 hunger; ; 1TI 5:23 illness

Fatal wounding in the stomach

JDG 3:21; ; 2SA 2:23, 2SA 3:27, 2SA 4:6, 2SA 20:10

The stomach and God's judgment

Severe stomach pain

JER 30:6–30:7 See also NUM 5:20–5:22, NUM 5:27

Crawling on one's stomach as a sign of submission

GEN 3:14 Part of God's curse upon Satan. See also PSA 72:9; ISA 49:23, ISA 65:25; MIC 7:17

Hunger as a result of God's judgment

MIC 6:14 See also JOB 20:12–20:15, JOB 20:20–20:23; PRO 13:25; ISA 9:20; EZK 7:19

An empty stomach as a warning

AMO 4:6

The stomach and God's blessing

In the OT a full stomach was one sign of God's blessing: PSA 34:9–34:10, PSA 37:19, PSA 37:25; ; PRO 10:3

Figurative uses of the stomach**Stomach as a symbol of inner thoughts**

EZK 3:3 See also PRO 18:8, PRO 26:22; REV 10:9–10:10

Stomach as a symbol of worldliness

PHP 3:19 See also ROM 16:18

Stomach as something to be filled

PRO 18:20 See also JOB 15:2; JER 51:34

5186: stumbling

Faltering or falling in the course of running or walking. The term is also used metaphorically to refer to failure, hesitation or difficulty.

Physical stumbling

LEV 19:14; LEV 26:37; ; ISA 21:4; ISA 28:7 through drunkenness; NAM 2:5, NAM 3:3

God protects his people from stumbling

PSA 56:13 See also 1SA 2:4; JOB 4:4; PSA 37:24, PSA 116:8

The enemies of God's people will stumble

JER 20:11 See also PSA 9:3, PSA 27:2

God's people will stumble if they sin

ISA 8:14; ; JER 13:16

Avoiding stumbling by keeping God's law

PSA 119:165 See also PRO 3:23, PRO 3:26, PRO 4:11–4:12; ISA 26:7–26:8, ISA 40:30–40:31

The wicked stumble because they reject God's way

PRO 4:19; ; HOS 14:9

Causes of stumbling**Dishonesty**

ISA 59:14

Arrogance

JER 50:32; ; HOS 5:5

False teaching by religious leaders

HOS 4:5; ; MAL 2:8

Idolatry

JER 18:15

Trust in riches

EZK 7:19

Trust in secular political alliances

ISA 31:3

Stumbling as a consequence of sin and divine judgment**Making one's own stumbling-block**

EZK 14:3–14:4, EZK 14:7

Stumbling over obstacles sent by God

JER 6:21, JER 13:16; ; EZK 3:20

Some stumbling is educative or disciplinary

DAN 11:35; ; ROM 9:32–9:33

Jesus Christ as the light that prevents believers from stumbling

JHN 9:5, JHN 11:9–11:10

Jesus Christ as a stumbling-block for unbelievers

1CO 1:23 See also 1PE 2:8

Stumbling and sin**All sin and stumble**

JAS 2:10, JAS 3:2

None should feel superior to others

PRO 24:17; ; 1CO 10:12

None should cause others to stumble

ROM 14:20; ; 1CO 10:32

5187: taste

The act of tasting is used figuratively of experiencing the goodness of God and his word and of a variety of experiences: misery, sin, wisdom, love, death and blessing.

The taste of food or drink

EXO 16:31 See also GEN 25:28, GEN 27:4, GEN 27:7, GEN 27:9, GEN 27:14, GEN 27:17, GEN 27:31; NUM 11:7–11:8; 2SA 19:34–19:35; JHN 2:9

Legalistic prohibitions against tasting certain foods are condemned by Paul

COL 2:20–2:22

Taste used figuratively**Of the experience of misery**

JOB 6:6–6:7 In his complaint against God, Job compares the unacceptability of his lot to inedible food. See also JOB 27:2

Of the experience of the goodness of God

PSA 34:8 See also HEB 6:4–6:5; 1PE 2:3

Of the experience of the goodness of the word of God
PSA 119:103 See also PSA 19:10; JER 15:16; EZK 3:3; REV 10:9–10:10

Of the experience of sin
PRO 20:17

Of the experience of wisdom
PRO 24:13–24:14

Of the experience of love
SNG 2:3 See also SNG 4:11, SNG 4:16

Of the effectiveness of Christian influence
MAT 5:13 parallel LUK 14:34–14:35

Of the experience of death
HEB 2:9 See also MAT 16:28 parallels MRK 9:1, LUK 9:27; JHN 8:52

Of the blessings of the kingdom of God
 LUK 14:24, LUK 22:29–22:30

To determine not to taste food until a task was completed was commonly used as an oath
 1SA 14:24–14:46; ; 2SA 3:35; ; JON 3:7; ; ACT 23:14

5188: tearing of clothes

Primarily associated with mourning, such action was an expression of deep sorrow and heartfelt grief. It was also a natural reaction at times of great distress and in cases of sincere repentance.

The tearing of clothes was a sign of mourning

It was a demonstration of grief
2SA 1:11–1:12 See also 2SA 13:30–13:31; 2KI 2:11–2:12; JOB 1:20, JOB 2:12

It was often associated with wearing sackcloth
GEN 37:34 See also 2SA 3:31–3:32

The high priest was forbidden to tear his clothes in mourning
LEV 21:10–21:12 See also LEV 10:1–10:7

The tearing of clothes indicated deep distress
JDG 11:34–11:35 Jephthah had vowed to sacrifice whatever came out of the door of his house to meet him. See also GEN 37:29, GEN 44:12–44:13; NUM 14:1–14:9; JOS 7:3–7:6; 2KI 6:26–6:30, 2KI 18:28–19:4 parallel ISA 36:13–37:4; EST 3:13–4:1; ACT 14:8–14:18

Repentance was sometimes accompanied by the tearing of clothes

1KI 21:20–21:27 See also JER 36:21–36:24 an indication of the lack of repentance; JOL 2:12–2:14 God requires that the tearing of clothes should express genuine repentance.

Other references to the tearing of clothes

As an expression of anger
MAT 26:63–26:65 parallel MRK 14:61–14:63

To stop the spread of mildew
 See also LEV 13:53–13:58

As a symbol of the dividing of the kingdom
 1SA 15:27–15:28

5189: teeth

Scripture often uses teeth symbolically, to refer to the power of individuals or to human rage (as in the “gnashing of teeth”).

Teeth in a literal sense

In eating
NUM 11:33 See also DAN 7:5, DAN 7:7, DAN 7:19; ZEC 9:7; REV 9:8

As an object of beauty
SNG 4:2 See also GEN 49:12; SNG 6:6

As an object of fear
JOB 41:14 See also DEU 32:24; JOB 20:16; JOL 1:6

Teeth used symbolically

To represent offensive weapons
 PSA 57:4; ; PRO 30:14

To symbolise military power
ISA 41:15 See also JOL 1:6; AMO 1:3; HAB 3:12

God rescues his people from the teeth of their enemies
PSA 124:6 See also JOB 4:10; DAN 6:20–6:21

Breaking the teeth of the wicked ends their power
PSA 3:7 See also JOB 29:17; PSA 58:6 Enemies are often described as dangerous animals.

Gnashing of teeth

In rage
ACT 7:54 See also JOB 16:9; PSA 35:16, PSA 37:12

In frustration
 PSA 112:10

In anguish
 MAT 8:12, MAT 13:42, MAT 13:50, MAT 22:13, MAT 24:51, MAT 25:30; ; LUK 13:28

In gloating
 LAM 2:16

Under demonic influence
 MRK 9:18

Proverbial sayings about teeth

JOB 19:20; ; PRO 10:26; ; JER 31:29–31:30; ; EZK 18:2

5190: thigh**The human thigh****A symbol of strength**

JOB 40:17; ; DAN 2:32

Weapons strapped to the thigh

JDG 3:16, JDG 3:21

The hand is placed under the thigh when taking an oath

GEN 24:2, GEN 24:9, GEN 47:29

The priests' undergarments covered the thigh

EXO 28:42–28:43 See also EXO 20:26; LEV 6:10, LEV 16:3–16:4; EZK 44:17–44:18

The wasting of the thigh

The wasting away of the thigh is part of the judgment on an unfaithful wife: NUM 5:21–5:22, NUM 5:27

The thigh as a place of identification

REV 19:16

The right thighs of animals used in sacrificial offerings

EXO 29:22, EXO 29:27; ; LEV 7:32–7:34, LEV 8:25–8:26, LEV 9:21, LEV 10:14–10:15; ; NUM 6:20, NUM 18:18

5191: thought

The human ability to reason and reflect. Believers are called to reflect upon the words and works of God as they are made known through Scripture and to avoid speculation based purely upon human reason.

Human thought and God**God's thoughts are infinitely higher than human thoughts**

ISA 55:8–55:9 See also PSA 92:5, PSA 139:17–139:18; 1CO 2:10–2:11

God knows all human thoughts

1CH 28:9 See also GEN 6:5; PSA 94:11, PSA 139:1–139:4; MAT 9:4, MAT 12:25 parallel LUK 11:17; LUK 9:47; HEB 4:12

Meditating on God's words

PSA 1:1–1:2 See also DEU 6:6–6:7, DEU 11:18; JOS 1:8; PSA 119:15, PSA 119:23, PSA 119:78, PSA 119:97

Meditating on God's works

PSA 77:12 See also 1SA 12:24; PSA 106:7, PSA 107:43, PSA 119:27, PSA 143:5, PSA 145:4–145:5; ISA 1:18

Warnings against founding faith on speculative thought or human wisdom

COL 2:8 See also ISA 29:14; 1CO 1:20, 1CO 2:6, 1CO 3:19–3:20; 2CO 10:5; JAS 3:13–3:15

Believers are to give thought to others**To think about their needs**

PHP 2:4 See also ZEC 7:10; LUK 10:36–10:37; ROM 12:13; 1CO 12:26, 1CO 14:11–14:12; 1TI 5:3; 1JN 3:17

To think about their abilities

PHP 2:3 See also 1CO 12:24–12:25, 1CO 14:26–14:33; HEB 10:24

To think about, and learn from, their shortcomings

GAL 6:1 See also ACT 8:20–8:21; ROM 1:21; EPH 4:17–4:19

Believers are to give thought to themselves**To think accurately about themselves and their God-given abilities**

ROM 12:3 See also 1CO 1:26, 1CO 3:18, 1CO 10:12, 1CO 14:20, 1CO 14:37; 2CO 11:5–11:6; GAL 6:3; PHP 2:3; 1TI 4:4

To think about their shortcomings and temptations

2CO 10:12 See also PRO 6:6; MAT 15:19; ROM 2:15; 1CO 13:11; 2CO 10:7; EPH 2:3; PHP 3:13; COL 1:21

To think about their needs

PHP 3:7–3:9 See also MAT 6:31–6:34; PHP 2:4

To think rightly about their plans and ambitions

1PE 1:13–1:14 See also DEU 15:9; PRO 5:6, PRO 14:8, PRO 14:15; ISA 55:7; HAG 1:5; LUK 14:31 Jesus Christ wanted his followers to consider carefully the cost of being a disciple; ACT 5:35; ROM 13:14; PHP 4:8; COL 3:1–3:2; HEB 3:1, HEB 11:15; JAS 1:2; 1PE 4:1; 2PE 3:1–3:2

5192: thumbs**The role of the thumb in sacrificial ritual**

EXO 29:20; ; LEV 8:23–8:24, LEV 14:14, LEV 14:17, LEV 14:25, LEV 14:28

Thumbs cut off

JDG 1:6–1:7

5193: tongue

The organ of speech, which Scripture stresses can be the source of both praise and blame. The tongue is to be kept under control, on account of its capacity for evil words.

The tongue as a bodily organ

As part of the body

JAS 3:5 See also JDG 7:5; JOB 41:1; MRK 7:33; LUK 16:24; REV 16:10

Used for eating

NUM 22:4; ; JOB 12:11, JOB 34:3; ; PSA 68:23

Used for drinking

JDG 7:5

Used for licking

1KI 21:19, 1KI 22:38; ; LUK 16:21

Parched with thirst

PSA 22:15, PSA 137:6; ; ISA 41:17; ; LAM 4:4

The tongue as an organ of speech

It is God-given

EXO 4:10–4:11 See also EZK 3:26; LUK 1:20–1:22, LUK 1:62–1:64

God is able to loose the tongue of the mute

MRK 7:33–7:35 See also ISA 32:4, ISA 35:6; MAT 15:30–15:31; LUK 1:64

Reasons for holding one's tongue

To restrain sin

PRO 10:19 See also PRO 11:12, PRO 17:27–17:28, PRO 21:23; JAS 1:26; 1PE 3:10

As a mark of respect and awe

JOB 29:9–29:10; ; HAB 2:20

The tongue's potential for good

Right use of the tongue requires an act of the will

JOB 27:4 See also PSA 39:1, PSA 141:3

The tongue can praise God

PSA 35:28 See also PSA 16:9, PSA 45:1, PSA 51:14, PSA 66:17, PSA 71:24, PSA 119:172, PSA 126:2; ACT 2:26; JAS 3:9

The tongue can speak God-given words

2SA 23:2 See also PRO 16:1; ISA 50:4; MIC 3:8; LUK 21:14–21:15

Every tongue will acknowledge God

ISA 45:23 See also ROM 14:11; PHP 2:10–2:11

The tongue can speak wisdom

PSA 37:30 See also PRO 10:19–10:20, PRO 12:18, PRO 15:23, PRO 31:26

The tongue can bring healing

PRO 15:4 See also PRO 12:18

The tongue's potential for evil

The tongue's power needs to be controlled

PRO 18:21; JAS 3:3–3:10 See also JOB 27:4; PSA 34:13; PRO 11:12; JAS 1:26

The tongue can speak deceitfully

PSA 5:9 See also PSA 50:19, PSA 52:4, PSA 120:2–120:3; PRO 15:4, PRO 17:20; JER 9:8; MIC 6:12; ROM 3:13

The tongue can speak lies

JER 9:3 See also PRO 6:17, PRO 21:6, PRO 26:28

Other evil uses of the tongue

PSA 10:7 See also PSA 12:3–12:4, PSA 52:2; PRO 6:24; ISA 57:4, ISA 59:3; JER 18:18

The punishment for a perverse tongue

PRO 10:31

Tongue in the sense of language

As a foreign language

ACT 2:8–2:11 See also EST 1:22; PSA 114:1; ISA 28:11, ISA 33:19, ISA 66:18; 1CO 14:10

As a language given by the Holy Spirit

ACT 2:4 See also MRK 16:17; ACT 10:46, ACT 19:6; 1CO 12:10, 1CO 12:28, 1CO 12:30, 1CO 13:1, 1CO 13:8, 1CO 14:2–14:23

Metaphors used to describe the tongue

The tongue as a dangerous weapon

PSA 57:4, PSA 64:3; ; JER 9:3, JER 9:8

Other metaphors

PSA 140:3; ; PRO 10:20; ; ISA 5:24; ; ACT 2:3; ; JAS 3:6

5194: touch

God prohibits physical contact in certain circumstances and warns of serious consequences of violating the ritual law in this respect. Great significance is attached to the touch of God, Jesus Christ and angels and the disciples' touching of the risen Christ.

God's prohibits touch in certain circumstances

At Mount Sinai

EXO 19:12–19:13 See also HEB 12:18–12:24

With the furnishings and articles of the tabernacle

NUM 4:15 See also 2SA 6:6–6:7

The law concerning touching certain articles

Anyone or anything touching what is ritually unclean also becomes unclean

NUM 19:21–19:22 See also LEV 5:2–5:3, LEV 7:19–7:21, LEV 11:8, LEV 11:24–11:40, LEV 12:4, LEV 15:5–15:12, LEV 15:19–15:27, LEV 22:4–22:6; NUM 19:11–19:16 the law con-

cerning dead bodies; DEU 14:8 Pigs are unclean; ISA 52:11; HAG 2:10–2:14

Touching what is purified confers consecration
EXO 29:37, EXO 30:29; ; LEV 6:18, LEV 6:27

Man-made rules against touching certain things are condemned by Paul
COL 2:20–2:22

The touch of God

Upon Jacob, to humble him
GEN 32:25, GEN 32:32

Upon those he calls to be prophets
JER 1:9 See also ISA 6:7; EZK 2:8–3:4; DAN 10:16

Upon the world he has made, to display his glory
PSA 104:32 See also PSA 144:5; AMO 9:5

The touch of Jesus Christ

To heal
MAT 8:3 parallels MRK 1:41–1:42, LUK 5:13 See also MAT 9:29–9:30, MAT 20:34; MRK 7:33, MRK 8:22–8:25; LUK 22:51

To raise the dead
MAT 9:18–9:25 parallels MRK 5:22–5:42, LUK 8:41–8:55
In touching the dead, Jesus Christ shows his willingness to become unclean so that others can be healed. See also LUK 7:14

To bring reassurance and show acceptance
MAT 17:6–17:7; ; MRK 10:13 parallels MAT 19:13, LUK 18:15

The touch of angels
1KI 19:5, 1KI 19:7; ; DAN 8:18, DAN 10:10, DAN 10:18

The reality of Jesus Christ's incarnation and resurrection is confirmed by touch
1JN 1:1; JHN 20:24–20:27

The figurative use of touch

To mean harming people
EZK 9:6 See also GEN 20:6; JOS 9:19; 1CH 16:22 parallel PSA 105:15; PRO 6:29; ZEC 2:8–2:9; HEB 11:28

To mean separation from sin
2CO 6:17 See also ISA 52:11

5195: veil

Generally, an item of female dress worn by an unmarried woman in the presence of her future husband and also by a prostitute. Head-coverings were worn by men and women as a sign of mourning. The term is also used metaphorically to indicate a lack of under-

standing of God's truth. Scripture uses the imagery of "removing a veil" to refer to God's final self-revelation at the end of the age, or the making known of God's will and nature through Jesus Christ or other means.

The veil as an item of female dress

Worn by women in general

SNG 4:1 The veil covered the lower part of the face, so focusing attention on the eyes and temples. See also GEN 24:65 Rebekah veils herself in the presence of her future husband, Isaac; SNG 4:3, SNG 6:7

Worn by prostitutes

GEN 38:14–38:15 See also SNG 1:7

Worn by female sorcerers

EZK 13:18, EZK 13:21

Worn as a sign of wealth and status

ISA 3:19, ISA 47:2 Babylon's veil will be removed as a mark of her humiliation.

Veils worn as a sign of grief

Faces covered in sorrow and dismay

2SA 15:30 See also LEV 13:45 A veil worn by the ceremonially unclean signifies grief at separation from God; JER 14:4

Veils customarily worn by mourners

2SA 19:4 See also EZK 24:17, EZK 24:22

Faces covered as a sign of disgrace

EST 6:12, EST 7:8; ; MIC 3:7

Head-coverings in worship

1CO 11:4 A man's uncovered head in worship signifies submission to his spiritual head, i.e., Jesus Christ; **1CO 11:5–11:6** A woman's covered head signifies proper submission to her husband. See also 1CO 11:7, 1CO 11:13

God's sight of humanity is not veiled

The wicked foolishly boast that God does not see them

JOB 22:12–22:14 See also PSA 10:11, PSA 94:7; ISA 29:15

God's people complain that God does not see their suffering

PSA 44:24 See also JOB 13:24; PSA 69:17, PSA 88:14

God sees all humanity

JOB 28:24 See also GEN 16:13; JOB 34:21; PSA 33:13, PSA 139:1–139:3

People's deeds will be made known

1CO 4:5 See also JOB 28:11; ISA 26:21; MAT 10:26 parallel LUK 12:2; 1CO 3:13

The truth about God is sometimes veiled

The veil worn by Moses

2CO 3:13 After speaking with God, Moses' face was radiant; the veil, possibly a loose part of his clothing pulled over his face, prevented the Israelites from seeing that the radiance did not last. See also EXO 34:29–34:35

Lack of understanding of God's truth

2CO 3:14–3:15 See also ISA 44:18; LAM 3:65; 1CO 2:14; 2CO 4:3; EPH 4:18

The unveiling of God's truth

God's hidden truth is revealed to believers

1CO 2:7–2:10; COL 1:26 See also ISA 64:4; ROM 16:25–16:26; 2CO 3:16–3:18; EPH 1:9, EPH 3:3–3:6; 2TI 1:10; TIT 1:2–1:3

God's self-revelation at the end of the age

DAN 12:2–12:4 See also ISA 25:7–25:8; ROM 8:19; 1JN 3:2

5196: voice

The organ of speech; someone's voice expresses a person's character, thoughts and emotions, and attracts attention by its tone and volume.

The human voice

The sound of familiar voices

ACT 12:14 See also GEN 27:22; JDG 18:3; 1SA 24:16, 1SA 26:17; SNG 2:14, SNG 8:13

Groups of people speaking in unison

EXO 24:3 See also 1SA 10:24; 2CH 5:13, 2CH 23:11; EZR 10:12; ACT 12:22, ACT 19:34, ACT 22:22

Voices communicate in various ways

Voices expressing defiance

1SA 17:8 See also 2KI 19:22 parallel ISA 37:23

Voices that give a battle cry

1SA 17:20; ; 2CH 13:15; ; ISA 8:9; ; JER 4:16, JER 4:19

Festive voices

2SA 19:35; ; JER 7:34, JER 16:9, JER 25:10, JER 33:11

Voices expressing distress

JDG 21:2 See also GEN 27:34; NUM 14:1; 2SA 22:7 parallel PSA 18:6; 1KI 22:36; JER 4:31; EZK 27:30; DAN 6:20; MAT 2:18; JER 31:15

Voices of varying volume

God's loud voice

JOB 37:5 See also DEU 5:22; ISA 33:3; EZK 43:2; JHN 12:28–12:29

Loud human voices

1SA 28:12; ; 2CH 20:19; ; EZR 10:12; ; ISA 40:9; ; LUK 4:33; ; ACT 7:57

God's quiet voice

1KI 19:12–19:13 See also JOB 26:14

Quiet human voices

JOB 4:16; ; ECC 9:17; ; ISA 42:2

Voices addressed to God

In praise

LUK 17:15 See also JDG 5:11; 1KI 8:55; EZR 3:11; PSA 47:1, PSA 100:1–100:4; ISA 24:14; LUK 19:37

In prayer

PSA 27:7 See also DEU 33:7; PSA 64:1

Assurance that God hears his people's voice

PSA 5:3 See also EXO 22:23; DEU 24:15; PSA 55:17; ISA 19:20

God's response to his people's voice

NEH 9:9 See also GEN 21:17; EXO 2:23–2:25, EXO 3:9; NUM 20:16

God sometimes refuses to hear his people's voice

EZK 8:18 See also ISA 1:15, ISA 59:1–59:2; JER 14:12; AMO 5:23

The futility of lifting up one's voice to an idol

JDG 10:14; ; 1KI 18:26, 1KI 18:28; ; JER 11:12

Voices that proclaim God's word

ROM 10:18 The original sense of the voice of the heavens is reapplied to all who proclaim the gospel. See also ISA 58:1; MIC 3:8; ACT 2:14

The voice of God

God's voice addresses individuals

GEN 3:9 See also EXO 3:4; 1SA 3:4; ISA 6:8; JER 1:4; EZK 1:28

God's voice is awe-inspiring

PSA 29:3–29:9 See also DEU 5:26, DEU 18:16; JOB 37:2; PSA 46:6, PSA 68:33; ISA 30:30–30:31, ISA 42:13; EZK 1:24; HEB 12:19, HEB 12:26

God's voice demands obedience

EXO 15:26; ; DEU 30:20; ; 1SA 15:22; ; ISA 30:21; ; HEB 3:7–3:8

God's voice affirms his Son

MAT 3:17 parallels MRK 1:11, LUK 3:22 at Jesus Christ's baptism; ; MAT 17:5 parallels MRK 9:7, LUK 9:35–9:36 at the transfiguration; ; JHN 12:28; ; 2PE 1:17–1:18

The voice of Jesus Christ

His voice is recognisable

JHN 10:1–10:5, JHN 10:14–10:16, JHN 10:27

His voice calls people to him

JHN 7:37 See also ACT 9:4–9:7 parallels ACT 22:7–22:9, ACT 26:14–26:16; REV 3:20

His voice raises the dead

JHN 5:25, JHN 5:28, JHN 11:43

His voice cries out

MAT 27:46 parallel MRK 15:34; ; MAT 27:50 parallel LUK 23:46

Other voices

The voices of angels

JOB 38:7; ; DAN 10:6; ; MAT 1:20–1:21, MAT 2:13; ; REV 5:2, REV 5:11–5:12, REV 14:7–14:9, REV 18:2

The voice of wisdom

PRO 1:20, PRO 8:1–8:4

The voices of the natural world

PSA 19:1–19:4 See also JOB 38:41; PSA 93:3; ROM 10:18

5197: walking

The action of travelling on foot at a normal pace. The image of walking with God is used in Scripture to represent the behaviour of believers in their relationship with God.

The physical activity of walking

For travel

GEN 13:17; DEU 6:7 See also JDG 5:10; 1KI 18:7; AMO 3:3; MAT 4:18; LUK 24:17

As a miracle

MAT 11:5, MAT 14:25–14:26 See also ACT 3:6–3:8, ACT 14:10

God walking

LEV 26:12 See also GEN 3:8

Walking used figuratively of human behaviour

Walking in sin and darkness

1KI 15:26; PRO 2:12–2:13 See also PSA 1:1, PSA 82:5; PRO 2:12–2:13; 1JN 1:6

Sometimes darkness represents depressing circumstances

LAM 3:2 See also PSA 23:4; ISA 9:2, ISA 59:9

Walking with God

GEN 5:22–5:24, GEN 17:1; REV 3:4 See also GEN 6:9; DEU 8:6, DEU 10:12; 1KI 2:3–2:4; ISA 2:3; JER 7:23; MIC 4:5, MIC 6:8; ZEC 3:7; MAL 2:6

Walking in the truth or in the light

DEU 5:33; 1JN 1:7 See also PSA 15:2, PSA 26:2–26:3, PSA 56:13, PSA 86:11, PSA 89:15; PRO 4:12; ISA 2:5; 2JN 1:4–1:6; 3JN 1:3–1:4; REV 21:24

Walking as a way of living or behaving

EPH 2:1–2:2 See also ROM 8:1; 2CO 5:7; EPH 4:1, EPH 5:2; COL 1:10

5198: weeping

The physical act of shedding tears as the result of sadness or joy or in recognition of sin.

Weeping in personal grief

GEN 23:2; PSA 42:3; REV 5:4 See also GEN 27:38, GEN 37:35; JDG 11:37; RUT 1:9; 1SA 1:8, 1SA 20:41; 2SA 3:16, 2SA 13:19, 2SA 15:30, 2SA 18:33 David weeps for Absalom; 2KI 8:11, 2KI 13:14, 2KI 20:3; JOB 16:16, JOB 16:20; PSA 39:12, PSA 56:8, PSA 102:9; JHN 11:33, JHN 20:11

Weeping in shared grief

DEU 34:8; PSA 137:1 See also NUM 14:1; 1SA 11:4–11:5, 1SA 20:41, 1SA 30:4; 2SA 1:12 David and his men mourn for Saul and Jonathan; 2SA 1:24, 2SA 3:34; JOB 2:12; PSA 80:4–80:5; ISA 15:2–15:3, ISA 33:7; MRK 5:38; ACT 21:13

Weeping in personal remorse over failure and sin

MAT 26:75 parallels MRK 14:72, LUK 22:62 See also 1SA 2:33; LUK 7:38; HEB 12:17

Weeping in group response to sin

NEH 8:9; JER 3:21; JAS 5:1 See also NUM 25:6; DEU 1:45; JDG 20:26, JDG 21:2; EZR 3:12–3:13 the people's response to the rebuilding of the temple; ISA 22:12–22:13; JER 25:34, JER 31:9, JER 50:4; LAM 1:2, LAM 2:18; JOL 2:12; AMO 5:16–5:17, AMO 8:10; ZEC 12:10–12:11; MAT 8:12

Weeping in response to others' sin and judgment

PSA 119:136; JER 13:17; 2CO 2:4 See also EZR 10:1; NEH 1:4; ISA 16:9; JER 9:1, JER 14:17, JER 22:10; LAM 1:16, LAM 3:48; EZK 27:31; MIC 1:8; LUK 19:41 Jesus Christ weeps over Jerusalem; LUK 23:28; ACT 20:31; PHP 3:18; REV 18:15–18:16

Divine weeping

ISA 16:9

Jesus Christ's weeping

JHN 11:35 See also HEB 5:7

Weeping for joy

GEN 29:11, GEN 42:24, GEN 45:14–45:15

False weeping

MAL 2:13

Comfort promised to those who weep

PSA 126:5–126:6; REV 21:4 See also PSA 30:5, PSA 116:8; ISA 25:8, ISA 30:19, ISA 65:19; JER 31:16; LUK 6:21; JHN 16:20

5199: womb

The part of the female body where offspring are conceived and developed. A barren womb can be indicative of God's displeasure or a test of faith, while a fruitful womb may be a sign of his favour. It is God who creates within the womb. In ancient Israel, the first offspring of every womb belonged to God.

The womb as the place of conception and gestation

PSA 139:13–139:16 See also GEN 25:23–25:24, GEN 38:27; DEU 28:53, DEU 28:57; JOB 3:10–3:12, JOB 10:18–10:19, JOB 31:15; PSA 22:9–22:11; ECC 11:5; ISA 44:2, ISA 44:24, ISA 49:5, ISA 66:7–66:9; JER 1:5, JER 20:14–20:18; HOS 12:3; LUK 1:41–1:45; JHN 3:4; ROM 4:19–4:21

The barren womb

Indicating divine displeasure

GEN 20:18 See also GEN 29:31; HOS 9:11, HOS 9:14

As a test of faith

LUK 1:6–1:25 See also GEN 30:22–30:23; ISA 1:5–1:6

A blessing in times of persecution

LUK 23:29–23:31 See also MAT 24:19 parallels MRK 13:17, LUK 21:23

A fruitful womb may indicate God's favour

DEU 7:13 See also GEN 29:31, GEN 30:22–30:23, GEN 49:25; DEU 28:4, DEU 28:11, DEU 30:9; PSA 127:3–127:5, PSA 128:3–128:4

The first offspring of every womb belonged to God

EXO 13:1–13:2 See also EXO 13:12, EXO 13:15; NUM 18:15

Proverbial use of the womb

JOB 1:21 See also JOB 15:34–15:35, JOB 24:20, JOB 38:8, JOB 38:29; PSA 110:3; PRO 30:15–30:16, PRO 31:2; ECC 5:15; HOS 13:13

Spiritual life beginning in the womb

PSA 22:9–22:10 See also PSA 51:5, PSA 58:3, PSA 71:6

5200: Human civilisation

- 5201: accusation
- 5202: accusation, false
- 5203: acquittal
- 5204: age
- 5205: alliance

- 5206: archers
- 5207: architecture
- 5208: armies
- 5209: armour
- 5210: arrows
- 5211: art
- 5212: arts and crafts
- 5213: assembly
- 5214: attack
- 5215: authority
- 5222: baking
- 5223: banner
- 5224: barn
- 5225: barrenness
- 5226: basin
- 5227: basket
- 5228: battering-rams
- 5229: bed
- 5230: beggars
- 5231: birthday
- 5232: book
- 5233: borrowing
- 5234: bottle
- 5235: boundary
- 5236: bow and arrow
- 5237: breastplate
- 5238: bribery
- 5239: bricks
- 5240: building
- 5241: burial
- 5242: buying and selling
- 5243: byword
- 5244: camp
- 5245: captain
- 5246: captivity
- 5247: carpenters
- 5248: cart
- 5249: census
- 5250: centurion
- 5251: chains
- 5252: chariots
- 5253: cheating
- 5254: citadel
- 5255: citizenship
- 5256: city
- 5257: civil authorities
- 5258: cloth
- 5259: coat
- 5260: coinage
- 5261: commander
- 5262: commendation
- 5263: communication
- 5264: compensation
- 5265: complaints

- 5266: conscription
- 5267: control
- 5268: cooking
- 5269: cornerstone
- 5270: court
- 5271: courtyard
- 5272: craftsmen
- 5273: creativity
- 5274: credit
- 5275: cremation
- 5276: crime
- 5277: criminals
- 5278: cripples
- 5279: crowds
- 5280: crown
- 5281: crucifixion
- 5282: crushing
- 5283: cup
- 5284: cupbearer
- 5285: cures
- 5286: custom
- 5287: dance
- 5288: dead, the
- 5289: debt
- 5290: defeat
- 5291: defence
- 5295: destruction
- 5296: disabilities
- 5297: disease
- 5298: doctors
- 5299: door
- 5300: drowning
- 5301: dyeing
- 5302: education
- 5303: embalming
- 5304: embroidery
- 5305: empires
- 5306: engraving
- 5307: envoy
- 5308: equality
- 5309: eunuchs
- 5310: exploitation
- 5311: extortion
- 5312: feasting
- 5313: flogging
- 5314: flute
- 5315: fortifications
- 5316: fortress
- 5317: foundation
- 5318: fraud
- 5319: fugitives
- 5320: funeral
- 5321: furnace
- 5322: gallows
- 5323: gate
- 5324: gatekeepers
- 5325: gifts
- 5326: government
- 5327: governors
- 5328: greeting
- 5329: guarantee
- 5330: guard
- 5331: hanging
- 5332: harp
- 5333: healing
- 5334: health
- 5335: herald
- 5336: highway
- 5337: hiring
- 5338: holiday
- 5339: home
- 5340: house
- 5341: hunger
- 5342: hunting
- 5343: idleness
- 5344: imprisonment
- 5345: influence
- 5346: injury
- 5347: injustice
- 5352: inscriptions
- 5353: interest
- 5354: invasions
- 5355: invitations
- 5356: irony
- 5357: journey
- 5358: judges
- 5359: justice
- 5364: key
- 5365: kidnapping
- 5366: king
- 5367: kingdoms
- 5368: kingship
- 5372: knife
- 5373: lamp and lampstand
- 5374: languages
- 5375: law
- 5383: lawsuits
- 5384: lawyer
- 5385: leisure
- 5389: lending
- 5390: leprosy
- 5391: letters
- 5392: linen
- 5393: literacy
- 5394: lordship
- 5398: loss
- 5399: luxury
- 5400: lyre

- 5401: madness
- 5402: market
- 5403: masons
- 5404: masters
- 5405: medicine
- 5406: mercenaries
- 5407: merchants
- 5408: messenger
- 5409: metaphor
- 5410: midwife
- 5411: mirror
- 5412: money
- 5418: monotony
- 5419: mourning
- 5420: music
- 5421: musical instruments
- 5422: musicians
- 5423: myths
- 5424: nationalism
- 5425: net
- 5426: news
- 5427: nomads
- 5428: nurse
- 5429: oaths
- 5433: occupations
- 5434: officer
- 5435: ovens
- 5436: pain
- 5437: palaces
- 5438: parables
- 5439: pen
- 5440: perjury
- 5441: philosophy
- 5442: pilgrimage
- 5443: pillars
- 5444: pledges
- 5445: potters and pottery
- 5446: poverty
- 5452: power
- 5459: prince
- 5460: prison
- 5461: prisoners
- 5463: proclamations
- 5464: proconsul
- 5465: profit
- 5466: promises
- 5471: proof
- 5475: property
- 5480: protection
- 5481: proverb
- 5482: punishment
- 5487: queen
- 5488: quivers
- 5489: rank
- 5490: refuge
- 5491: refugees
- 5492: restitution
- 5493: retribution
- 5494: revenge
- 5498: reward
- 5503: rich, the
- 5504: rights
- 5505: roads
- 5506: roof
- 5507: rope and cord
- 5508: ruins
- 5509: rulers
- 5510: rumours
- 5511: safety
- 5512: scales and balances
- 5513: sceptre
- 5514: scribes
- 5515: scroll
- 5516: sculpture
- 5517: seafaring
- 5518: seal
- 5519: secretary
- 5520: servants
- 5526: shibboleth
- 5527: shield
- 5528: shouting
- 5529: sieges
- 5530: sifting
- 5531: skill
- 5532: sleep
- 5537: sleeplessness
- 5538: sling
- 5539: sluggard
- 5540: society
- 5544: soldiers
- 5545: spear
- 5546: speech
- 5551: spinning and weaving
- 5552: spies
- 5553: stairways
- 5554: status
- 5555: stealing
- 5556: stewardship
- 5557: stoning
- 5558: storing
- 5559: stress
- 5560: suffering
- 5571: surgery
- 5572: sword
- 5573: table
- 5574: tablet
- 5575: talk, idle
- 5576: tax collectors

- 5577: taxation
- 5578: tents
- 5579: tetrarch
- 5580: thirst
- 5581: throne
- 5582: tiredness
- 5583: tools
- 5584: torture
- 5585: towers
- 5586: town
- 5587: trade
- 5588: traditions
- 5589: trap
- 5590: travel
- 5591: treasure
- 5592: treaty
- 5593: trial
- 5594: tribute
- 5595: trumpet
- 5596: victory
- 5601: village
- 5602: vomit
- 5603: wages
- 5604: walls
- 5605: warfare
- 5611: watchman
- 5612: weapons
- 5613: weights and measures
- 5621: wheel
- 5622: witnesses
- 5627: word
- 5628: work
- 5638: writing

5201: accusation

A charge brought against a person in a legal, ecclesiastical or spiritual context.

In legal affairs in general

In the OT legal systems

DEU 19:15–19:21 See also DEU 17:2–17:7; 1KI 21:8–21:13; EZR 4:6; NEH 5:6–5:7; DAN 6:4–6:5

In the NT legal systems

ACT 19:38–19:41 See also ACT 7:1, ACT 18:12–18:13, ACT 23:23–23:30, ACT 24:1–24:9, ACT 25:1–25:2, ACT 28:19

In God's covenant dealings with his people

MIC 6:1–6:2 See also JER 2:5–2:9; HOS 4:1–4:3, HOS 11:12–12:6

In the earthly experience of Jesus Christ

JHN 19:6 See also MAT 27:12–27:14, MAT 27:37 parallels MRK 15:26, LUK 23:38, JHN 19:19–19:22; LUK 23:4; JHN 18:29, JHN 19:4

In the experience of God's people

In the context of justification

ROM 8:33 See also ISA 50:8–50:9; COL 1:22

In their standing in the eyes of the world

EPH 5:3–5:4 See also MAT 5:16; 1TH 3:13

In the conduct of church affairs

Christian involvement in litigation

MAT 5:25–5:26 parallel LUK 12:58–12:59 See also 1CO 6:1–6:8

In the qualification for church leaders

1TI 3:2 See also TIT 1:6

In church disputes

1TI 5:19 See also MAT 18:15–18:20

In the character and activity of Satan

ZEC 3:1–3:2 See also JOB 1:9–1:11; PSA 109:6; REV 12:9–12:10

5202: accusation, false

Scripture expressly forbids making false accusations, but God's people have often been subjected to them and many false accusations were made against Jesus Christ.

False accusation forbidden

EXO 23:7 See also EXO 23:1; LEV 19:16; LUK 3:14

Satan associated with false accusation

ZEC 3:1 Although taken as a proper name in English, "Satan" is in fact simply the Hebrew word meaning "accuser". See also JOB 1:6–1:12; REV 12:10

Examples of false accusation

In the OT

PSA 41:5–41:6 See also GEN 39:7–39:18; 2SA 10:1–10:3; 1KI 21:7–21:14; EZR 4:6–4:16; NEH 6:5–6:7; PSA 35:19–35:20

In the experience of Jesus Christ

MAT 26:59–26:61 parallel MRK 14:55–14:59 See also MAT 9:34, MAT 12:24 parallels MRK 3:22, LUK 11:15; LUK 23:2

In the experience of the first Christians

ACT 16:19–16:21 See also MAT 5:11–5:12; ACT 6:11–6:14

5203: acquittal

The declaration of innocence and release from custody. It may be literal, in the context of human courts of justice, or figurative, God being portrayed as the judge of all the earth.

Divine justice

Acquittal of the innocent

MAT 12:33–12:37 See also 1KI 8:31–8:32 parallel 2CH 6:22–6:23; JOB 4:7; PRO 10:16; DAN 6:16–6:22; MAT 12:5

Punishment of the guilty

EXO 23:6–23:7 See also EXO 34:5–34:7; JOB 4:8–4:9; MIC 6:9–6:16; NAM 1:1–1:6

The acquittal of sinners in justification

ROM 5:1–5:2 See also ROM 4:23–4:25

Human justice

DEU 25:1–25:3 See also EXO 22:2, EXO 23:7–23:8; DEU 19:15–19:19; 2KI 10:1–10:9; ISA 29:20–29:21

Unjust acquittal of the guilty

PRO 17:15 See also PRO 18:5, PRO 24:23–24:25; ISA 5:22–5:23

Examples of acquittal of the innocent

ACT 18:12–18:17 See also ACT 16:35–16:39

Instances when the innocent were not acquitted

Jesus Christ was not acquitted because of pressure from the chief priests and the elders

MAT 27:11–27:26 parallels MRK 15:2–15:15, LUK 23:2–23:3, LUK 23:18–23:25, JHN 18:29–19:16

Paul was not acquitted because he had appealed to Caesar

ACT 26:30–26:32 See also ACT 25:1–25:12, ACT 25:23–26:25

5204: age

The number of years reached or expected to be reached in a human life. The span of life is determined by God and may be divided into distinct phases, each with its own characteristics. The term may also refer to an era of history, particularly in contrasting the present age with the coming age to be inaugurated at Jesus Christ's return.

The span of life

In God's hands

MAT 6:27 parallel LUK 12:25 See also 1SA 2:6; PSA 139:16; ECC 8:8; JAS 4:14–4:15

Longevity in the OT

GEN 5:5 See also GEN 5:27, GEN 9:29 GEN 6:3, GEN 25:7, GEN 47:28

The present-day span of life

PSA 90:10 See also 2SA 5:4–5:5 David lives to be 70; 2SA 19:34–19:35 Barzillai, aged 80, expects to die soon; ISA 23:15

Its apparent brevity

PSA 39:4–39:6 See also GEN 47:9; JOB 7:6; PSA 89:47, PSA 90:3–90:6

Long life is a blessing from God

PRO 10:27 See also PSA 91:16; PRO 3:1–3:2

Phases of human life

Importance associated with age

GEN 43:33; ; 1SA 16:6–16:11; ; LUK 22:26

The age of discretion

JHN 9:21–9:23 See also LUK 2:42

The age of maturity: 20 years

LEV 27:3 Adulthood reckoned from the age of 20; **NUM 26:2–26:4** See also NUM 1:3, NUM 1:45, NUM 14:29, NUM 32:11; JOS 5:41CH 23:24; 2CH 31:17; EZR 3:8

Full maturity reckoned from the age of 30

LUK 3:23 See also NUM 4:3 Levites assumed their duties at the age of 30; NUM 8:24 From the ages of 25 to 30, Levites may have served an apprenticeship.

Old age

LEV 27:7 NUM 4:47, NUM 8:25–8:26

Mountains as symbols of age

HAB 3:6 See also GEN 49:26; JOB 15:7; PSA 90:2; PRO 8:25

Ages of history

Before Jesus Christ was revealed

EPH 3:9 See also ROM 16:25–16:26; 1CO 10:11; COL 1:26; HEB 1:1–1:2

The present evil age

GAL 1:4 See also 1CO 1:20, 1CO 2:6–2:8; 2CO 4:4; EPH 2:2; TIT 2:12

The end of this age

MAT 13:49 See also MAT 13:39–13:40, MAT 24:3, MAT 24:10

The age to come

MAT 19:28–19:29 See also MRK 10:30 parallel LUK 18:30; LUK 20:34–20:36; EPH 2:7; 1TI 6:19

Blessing in the present age

HEB 6:5 See also MAT 28:20; MRK 1:15; EPH 1:21; HEB 9:26

5205: alliance

The coalition of two or more parties in order to achieve a particular aim. Political alliances might be formalised in a treaty or sealed by marriage. Human rebellion against God is demonstrated in hostile alliances against his people culminating in the rejection of Christ and the final gathering and overthrow of the nations outside Jerusalem. Because God's people are to depend on him alone, unholy alliances are condemned; however God does work in partnership with human allies and encourages his people to work together.

Political alliances

General examples

GEN 14:1–14:3, GEN 14:13; ; 1SA 27:2

Alliances formalised in a treaty

GEN 21:27, GEN 26:31; ; 1KI 5:12, 1KI 15:19 parallel 2CH 16:3

Alliances sealed by marriage

1KI 3:1; ; 2CH 18:1; ; DAN 11:6, DAN 11:17

Alliances against God and his people

Surrounding nations against God's people

PSA 83:5–83:8 See also JOS 10:5–10:6, JOS 11:4–11:5; 2CH 20:1; ISA 7:1–7:2; NEH 4:8

The nations against Jesus Christ

ACT 4:25–4:27 See also PSA 2:1–2:2

The nations against Jerusalem

ZEC 14:2; ; REV 20:8–20:9

The wicked against the righteous

PSA 31:13 See also PSA 56:6, PSA 59:3, PSA 71:10

The rich and powerful against the weak

MIC 7:3 See also PSA 94:20–94:21

God is greater than human alliances

PSA 48:4–48:5; NAM 1:12 See also 2CH 20:22; ISA 7:4; EZK 30:6, EZK 31:17; OBA 1:7; NAM 3:8–3:10

Unholy alliances condemned by God

God's people forbidden to ally with the unrighteous

EXO 34:12; 2CO 6:14–6:16 See also DEU 23:6; JOS 9:7, JOS 23:12

Examples of alliances condemned by God

2KI 16:7 parallel 2CH 28:16 Ahaz's proposed alliance with Assyria; ; 2CH 20:35–20:37 Jehoshaphat's alliance

with Ahaziah of Israel; ISA 30:1, ISA 31:1; HOS 12:1 Israel's vacillation between Egypt and Assyria

The futility of trust in human allies

ISA 31:3 See also JER 13:21, JER 22:20–22:21; LAM 1:19

God works with human allies

God uses Cyrus to deliver Israel

ISA 48:14 See also ISA 13:4, ISA 41:2; JER 50:9, JER 51:20–51:23

Fellow-workers with God

2CO 6:1 See also 1CO 3:9; 2CO 5:20

Believers allied in God's service

Working together

EZR 5:2; ; NEH 4:6; ; 1CO 15:10

Paul's fellow-workers

PHP 4:3 See also ROM 16:3, ROM 16:21; 2CO 8:23; PHP 2:25; PHM 1:24

5206: archers

Those armed with arrows, whether for hunting or warfare. Archers were particularly valued on account of their accuracy.

Men who were archers

Ishmael

GEN 21:20

Esau

GEN 27:3 See also GEN 25:27

Jonathan

1SA 20:18–20:23 See also 1SA 20:35–20:38; 2SA 1:22

Archers in the army of Israel and Judah

From the tribe of Reuben

1CH 5:18

From the tribe of Benjamin

1CH 8:40, 1CH 12:1–12:2

In Asa's army

2CH 14:8

In Uzziah's army

2CH 26:14

Archers in the armies of other nations

The Philistines

1SA 31:1–31:3

The Assyrians

2KI 19:32

The Medes

ISA 13:17–13:18; ; JER 50:9, JER 50:14, JER 51:11

The Lydians

ISA 66:19

The Babylonians

JER 4:29 a prophecy of Babylon besieging Judah

Men shot by archers**Saul**

1SA 31:3

Uriah

2SA 11:24 See also 2SA 11:14–11:17

Ahab, king of Israel

1KI 22:34

Joram

2KI 9:24

Josiah

2CH 35:23

God likened to an archer

LAM 3:12–3:13 See also PSA 7:12–7:13; LAM 2:4; EZK 5:16; ZEC 9:13

5207: architecture

The design of buildings, for religious or secular use. Building designs were often regarded in Scripture as embodying spiritual truths, and capable of being divinely inspired.

Examples of architecture**The tabernacle**

HEB 8:5 See also EXO 25:8–25:9, EXO 26:1–26:37

The temple

1CH 28:11–28:12 See also 1KI 6:1–6:10, 1KI 6:15–6:38; 1CH 28:19; 2CH 3:1–3:17, 2CH 4:1–4:22

Altars

JOS 8:31 See also EXO 20:25; 2KI 16:10–16:11 Adopting the design of a pagan altar indicated both idolatry and submission to Assyria.

Ordinary dwellings

DEU 22:8

Ezekiel's vision of a restored temple

EZK 40:1–40:49, EZK 41:1–41:26, EZK 42:1–42:20, EZK 43:10–43:17

Other structures

GEN 11:4; ; 1KI 7:1–7:12; ; PRO 24:3–24:4 implies that a house must be more than bricks and mortar; ; JER 22:13–22:14

Divinely dictated design**The ark**

GEN 6:14–6:16 the earliest recorded example of naval architecture

Building design as a spiritual metaphor**The prophecy of the rejected stone**

PSA 118:22; ; MAT 21:42 parallels MRK 12:10, LUK 20:17; ; 1PE 2:7; ; MAT 7:24–7:27 parallel LUK 6:48–6:49 the two foundations; ; 1CO 3:10–3:13 the work of Christian ministers; ; EPH 2:19–2:22 the church; ; 1PE 2:4–2:7; ; ISA 54:11–54:12 the heavenly city; ; HEB 11:10; ; REV 21:9–21:22

God as the architect of creation

JOB 38:4–38:5

5208: armies

An organised military force for the defence or expansion of national borders. Israel's national life was characterised by many battles with foreign nations such as Egypt, Philistia, Assyria and Babylon and by Roman occupation.

Examples of armies in conflict with Israel**The Egyptian army when Israel left Egypt**

EXO 14:5–14:9, EXO 14:23–14:25

The inhabitants of Canaan when Israel entered the promised land

JOS 3:10, JOS 12:1, JOS 12:7, JOS 23:9; ; JDG 3:1–3:3

The Philistines, a constant enemy

1SA 13:5, 1SA 14:20–14:23, 1SA 17:1–17:3, 1SA 31:1, 1SA 31:7 parallel 1CH 10:7

Assyria, defeating the northern kingdom of Israel

2KI 15:29, 2KI 17:5–17:6; ; ISA 36:1

Babylon, defeating the southern kingdom of Judah

2KI 24:1, 2KI 25:1; ; JER 39:1 parallel JER 52:4; ; 2KI 25:10–25:11 parallel 2CH 36:17

Palestine occupied by the Roman army in NT times**Roman law in force at the time of Jesus Christ**

LUK 2:1; ; JHN 18:28

Roman military personnel in the life of Jesus Christ and in the lives of the first Christians

MAT 8:5 parallel LUK 7:3; ; MAT 27:54 parallel LUK 23:47; ; ACT 10:1, ACT 21:31

Development of Israel's army from the time of the exodus to the reign of Solomon

A military census taken after the exodus

NUM 1:3, NUM 26:2

Fighting men to possess the promised land

DEU 7:1-7:2; ; JOS 1:10-1:11, JOS 12:1

The army as a tribal militia assembled in times of crisis

JDG 4:1-4:6

Certain tribes gaining reputations for proficiency in particular forms of combat

JDG 20:16; ; 1CH 12:2, 1CH 12:8, 1CH 12:24-12:37

Saul and David having regular contingents of special forces

1SA 13:2; ; 2SA 15:18, 2SA 23:8-23:12 parallel 1CH 11:10-11:14

Forces divided into twelve battalions, each serving for a month at a time

1CH 27:1

Chariot forces hardly known in David's time, but much used by Solomon

2SA 8:3-8:4; ; 1KI 4:26, 1KI 10:26

God's sovereignty over the armies of Israel and over his spiritual armies

JOS 5:13-5:15; ; 1SA 17:45; ; 1KI 22:19; ; 2KI 6:17

In the final battle between good and evil, Jesus Christ appearing as the leader of the armies of heaven

REV 19:14, REV 19:19

God as the commander of armies

PSA 89:8 The term here, and in the following verses, translated as "LORD God Almighty" may also be translated "LORD God of hosts" or "LORD God of armies". See also 1KI 19:10; JER 5:14; HOS 12:5; AMO 4:13

5209: armour

Protective covering worn by soldiers to prevent injury in battle. However, those who wore it were not impregnable. Christians are to be equipped with spiritual armour.

Coat of armour

The breastplate

2CH 26:14 See also 1SA 17:5, 1SA 17:38; 2SA 20:8; EPH 6:14

The belt

2SA 20:8 The belt was an essential item of armour as it held the protective parts of the tunic in place. See also 1SA 18:4; 2SA 18:11; EPH 6:14

The helmet

1SA 17:5 See also 1SA 17:38; 2CH 26:14; JER 46:4; EZK 38:5

The shield

JER 46:3 See also 2CH 11:12, 2CH 32:5; NEH 4:16; EPH 6:16

Armour worn by soldiers

2CH 26:14 See also NUM 31:3-31:5, NUM 32:20-32:21, NUM 32:27; JOS 4:13; JER 46:3-46:4

Armour-bearers

1SA 16:21 Armour-bearers were sometimes used to carry the shield and additional weapons for a military leader or outstanding warrior. See also JDG 9:54; 1SA 14:1, 1SA 14:6-14:14, 1SA 17:7

Those wearing armour were not impregnable

1KI 20:11, 1KI 22:34 parallel 2CH 18:33 See also 1SA 17:48-17:49, 1SA 31:3-31:4; LUK 11:21-11:22

Christians are to be equipped with spiritual armour

EPH 6:11 See also EPH 6:13-6:17; ROM 13:12; 2CO 6:7; 1TH 5:8

5210: arrows

Pointed pieces of wood, shot from a bow, used in hunting and warfare. In the hands of skilful archers they are accurate and deadly weapons. Figuratively, they represent conviction and judgments from God, or the hurtful words of men and women.

Characteristics of arrows

Deadly

PSA 64:3 See also DEU 32:42; PSA 7:13; EZK 5:16

Accurate

2KI 9:24

Sharp and piercing

PSA 45:5 See also 2KI 9:24; JOB 20:24; PSA 120:4; ISA 5:28

Arrows used as a sign

To warn David

1SA 20:19-20:22

Of victory over Aram

2KI 13:17-13:19

Of divination by the Babylonians

EZE 21:21

Arrows referred to figuratively**To describe conviction from God****PSA 38:2** See also JOB 6:4, JOB 34:6; LAM 3:12–3:13**To describe judgment from God****PSA 64:7** See also DEU 32:23, DEU 32:42; PSA 45:5; EZE 5:16**To describe false accusations****PSA 64:3–64:4** See also PSA 11:2, PSA 57:4**To describe false testimony****PRO 25:18** See also PRO 26:18–26:19; JER 9:3, JER 9:8**To describe attacks of Satan****EPH 6:16****As lightning****PSA 77:17** See also 2SA 22:15; PSA 144:6; ZEC 9:14**As sons as a blessing from God****PSA 127:3–127:5****5211: art**

Skilful, creative work, carried out using a variety of materials. Purposes included decoration, ornamentation and representation of objects of worship, the last of which Scripture firmly condemns.

Painting**EZE 8:10** See also EZE 23:11–23:15**Decorative panelling****2CH 3:5–3:7** See also 1KI 6:14–6:15; PSA 74:3–74:6; JER 22:14**Decoration and ornamentation in gold****1KI 6:21–6:22** parallel 2CH 3:4–3:7 See also 1KI 6:31–6:35, 1KI 10:14–10:21 parallel 2CH 9:13–9:20**Decoration and ornamentation in ivory****SNG 5:14** See also 1KI 10:18 parallel 2CH 9:17; 1KI 22:39; PSA 45:8; AMO 3:15, AMO 6:4**Carving and sculpture****1KI 6:18** See also 1KI 6:29–6:35; 2CH 3:7; PSA 144:12; EZE 41:15–41:26**Engraving****As an artistic skill****1KI 7:34–7:37** See also EXO 28:9–28:12, EXO 28:15–28:21, EXO 28:36–28:38, EXO 39:6–39:7, EXO 39:8–39:14, EXO 39:30–39:31; 1KI 7:31, 1KI 7:36; 2CH 2:5–2:7, 2CH 2:13–2:14**Metaphorical references to engraving****JOB 19:23–19:24** See also ISA 49:16; JER 17:1; ZEC 3:9**Art in the tabernacle****EXO 26:1** See also EXO 25:18–25:21, EXO 36:8, EXO 36:35–36:38, EXO 37:7–37:9**Art in the temple****1KI 7:48–7:50** parallel 2CH 4:19–4:22 See also 1KI 7:13–7:22, 1KI 7:27–7:37, 1KI 7:40–7:45 parallel 2CH 4:11–4:16; 2CH 3:15–3:17**Art associated with idolatry****Forbidden****DEU 27:15** See also EXO 20:3–20:6 parallel DEU 5:7–5:10; EXO 20:22–20:23, EXO 34:10–34:17; LEV 19:4, LEV 26:1; DEU 4:16–4:19, DEU 4:23–4:24, DEU 29:16–29:18**Examples of idols and images****2KI 21:7** parallel 2CH 33:7 See also EXO 32:1–32:4; JDG 17:1–17:6, JDG 18:11–18:31; ISA 46:1–46:2; JER 50:1–50:2; EZE 8:9–8:12**Condemned****HAB 2:18** See also EXO 34:10–34:14; NUM 33:51–33:52; DEU 7:25–7:26; 2CH 34:1–34:4; ISA 44:9–44:20; EZE 7:20–7:22; HOS 13:1–13:3; MIC 5:13–5:14; NAM 1:14**5212: arts and crafts**

Artistic skills, usually practised by craftsmen and passed on from generation to generation, of which a wide variety are mentioned in Scripture.

Metalwork**EXO 39:2–39:3** See also EXO 31:1–31:5 parallel EXO 35:30–35:33; 1SA 13:19–13:21; 1KI 7:13–7:14; ISA 41:7; JER 10:9; ACT 19:23–19:41**Stonework****1KI 5:17–5:18** See also 1KI 6:36, 1KI 7:9–7:12; 2KI 22:3–22:6 parallel 2CH 34:8–34:11; 1CH 22:2; 2CH 2:13–2:14; EZE 40:42**Building****1CO 3:10–3:15** See also 2CH 34:11; EZR 3:10; ISA 9:8–9:10; AMO 5:11; HEB 3:3–3:4**Pottery****ISA 41:25** See also 2SA 17:27–17:29; 1CH 4:21–4:23; ISA 29:16, ISA 45:9, ISA 64:8; JER 18:1–18:10, JER 19:1; ROM 9:19–9:21

Carpentry

ISA 44:13 See also GEN 6:14; 2SA 5:11 parallel 1CH 14:1; 1KI 6:31–6:33; 2KI 12:10–12:12 parallel 2CH 24:11–24:12; MAT 13:54–13:55 parallel MRK 6:2–6:3

Engraving

EXO 28:9–28:12 parallel EXO 39:6–39:7 See also EXO 28:36–28:37 parallel EXO 39:30–39:31; 1KI 7:30–7:36; 2CH 2:13–2:14

Dyeing

EXO 36:19 parallel EXO 26:14 See also EXO 35:22–35:23

Weaving and embroidery

EXO 35:34–35:35 See also EXO 28:39–28:40 parallel EXO 39:22–39:29; 2KI 23:7; 1CH 4:21; ISA 19:9–19:10, ISA 38:12

Tanning

ACT 9:43 See also ACT 10:5–10:6, ACT 10:32–10:33

Making idols

LEV 26:1 See also 2KI 17:14–17:16; ISA 40:18–40:20, ISA 41:5–41:7, ISA 44:9–44:20

5213: assembly

Assemblies of the Israelites

LEV 23:1–23:2 See also EXO 35:1; LEV 4:14, LEV 8:1–8:5; NUM 10:1–10:7, NUM 15:35–15:36, NUM 16:45–16:47; 1SA 7:5; 1KI 8:22; 1CH 15:3; 2CH 29:28; EZR 3:1; PSA 22:25, PSA 40:9–40:10, PSA 149:1; AMO 5:21

Assembling armies for war and groups for self-protection

JDG 20:2 See also JDG 10:17; 1SA 7:6, 1SA 13:5, 1SA 17:2; EST 8:11, EST 9:16

Assemblies of the Christian church

ACT 14:27 The Greek word for “church” can also be translated “assembly”. See also MAT 16:18; ACT 13:1–13:2, ACT 14:23; 1CO 11:18, 1CO 14:23, 1CO 16:19

Assemblies for other purposes

ACT 19:39 See also LUK 23:1; ACT 19:32, ACT 19:41, ACT 23:7

5214: attack

A violent act of aggression often associated with intent to invade, sometimes as an act of retribution and occasionally as a strategic act of self-defence. Scripture also recognises the possibility of spiritual aggression through attack by evil forces.

Examples of God’s people attacking others

GEN 14:14–14:16 Abraham attacks the captors of the king of Sodom; ; JDG 7:19–7:21 Gideon attacks the Midianites; ; 1SA 14:13–14:14 Jonathan attacks the Philistines; ; 2SA 5:6–5:7 parallel 1CH 11:4–11:5 David attacks the Jebusites; ; DEU 20:1–20:20 Moses gives detailed instruction on going to war.

The Israelites attack the inhabitants of Canaan

JOS 6:2, JOS 6:20 See also JOS 8:1–8:3, JOS 8:21–8:22, JOS 10:9–10:10, JOS 10:29–10:42, JOS 11:7–11:8, JOS 11:16–11:23

Examples of God’s people attacked by others

By the Amalekites

EXO 17:8–17:13

By the Midianites

See also JDG 6:1–6:6

By the Ammonites

JDG 10:9, JDG 11:4–11:6; ; 2SA 10:8 parallel 1CH 19:9; ; 2CH 20:1

By the Philistines

1SA 7:7 See also 2SA 5:17, 2SA 5:22 parallels 1CH 14:8, 1CH 14:13; PSA 56:1–56:2

By Syria (Aram)

1KI 20:1 See also 1KI 20:26; 2KI 3:21–3:27 the Moabites seek to attack Israel but are routed; 2KI 5:2, 2KI 6:24–6:25, 2KI 12:17; 2CH 16:1–16:4, 2CH 28:5

By the Egyptians

2CH 12:1–12:4, 2CH 12:7–12:9

Attacks on God’s people resulting in exile

Israel attacked by the Assyrians

2KI 17:3–17:6 See also 2KI 18:9–18:12

Judah attacked by the Babylonians

2CH 36:5–36:7 parallel 2KI 24:1 See also 2KI 24:10–24:16, 2KI 25:1, 2KI 25:8–25:11 parallel 2CH 36:15–36:20; JER 32:24; EZK 33:21

God’s people attack each other

Intertribal warfare

JDG 9:22–9:23, JDG 9:39–9:45, JDG 20:18–20:48

The north (Israel) and south (Judah) attack each other

2KI 14:11–14:14 parallel 2CH 25:20–25:24 See also 2CH 13:1–13:3

Attacks within the church

JAS 4:1–4:2 See also PHP 3:2; 1TH 5:15; JAS 4:11–4:12; 1PE 3:9

Examples of individuals who were attacked

GEN 4:8; ACT 16:22 See also EXO 21:12–21:20; 1SA 19:9–19:10; 1SA 24:7

The danger of attack by Satan and his agents

1PE 5:8–5:9 See also MAT 4:1–4:11 parallel LUK 4:1–4:13; EPH 6:12; REV 11:7

God provides protection against both physical and spiritual attack

EPH 6:13–6:18 See also PSA 7:10; PSA 18:1–18:3; PSA 138:7; 2TI 4:18

5215: authority

The right to act or speak in certain ways, in accordance with the authorisation of a higher power. All human authority derives from God, and is to be exercised in a responsible manner.

5216: authority, nature of

The God-given freedom of action expressed in rightful power to control the actions of others.

Ultimate authority belongs to God, who does as he pleases

PSA 115:3 See also 2CH 20:6; JOB 9:12; JOB 23:13; JOB 42:2; PSA 135:6; ISA 14:27; ISA 43:13; ISA 45:9; ISA 46:10; DAN 4:35 Nebuchadnezzar acknowledges God's authority; ROM 9:19–9:21; EPH 1:11 God's authority is demonstrated in election.

Human authority

All human authority is given and established by God
ROM 13:1 See also DAN 2:21; DAN 4:17; DAN 5:18–5:21; JHN 19:11

It involves the rightful freedom to give orders

MAT 8:9 parallel LUK 7:8 The centurion to Jesus Christ. See also GEN 41:35; NUM 27:20; DEU 1:15 Moses delegates authority; JDG 9:29; EZR 7:24; NEH 3:7; EST 9:29; ISA 22:21; JER 38:10; MAT 25:23 parallel LUK 19:17 the parable of the talents; MRK 13:34; LUK 20:20; LUK 23:7; JHN 19:10 ACT 9:14; ACT 26:10; ACT 26:12 1PE 2:13

It is limited, unlike God's authority

JHN 19:10–19:11

Responsibilities of those with authority**They are to act as servants, not lording it over people**

MAT 20:25–20:28 parallel MRK 10:42–10:45 See also JHN 13:4–13:15

Their authority is to be used for the benefit of others

2CO 10:8 See also 2CO 13:10

It is sometimes necessary to withhold exercising authority for others' good

1CO 9:4–9:18 See also 1CO 6:1–6:7; 1CO 8:8–8:13; 1CO 10:23–10:24

Examples of the authority of believers**Authority over possessions**

ACT 5:4 Peter to Ananias regarding the land he sold.

Authority over the will

1CO 7:37 Paul on marriage.

Authority to become children of God

JHN 1:12

The authority of the law over believers during their lifetime

ROM 7:1

5217: authority, in the church

The exercise of freedom under Jesus Christ's authority for the good of the church.

Supreme authority belongs to Jesus Christ as head of the church

EPH 5:23 See also EPH 1:22; EPH 4:15; EPH 5:24; COL 1:18

Spiritual authority under Jesus Christ in the church is possessed by elders**As shepherds who teach and care for the flock**

ACT 20:28 See also JHN 21:15–21:17; EPH 4:11–4:13; 1TI 3:2; 1TI 5:17; TIT 2:1–2:10; 1PE 5:2

As overseers ruling the church

ACT 20:28 See also ROM 12:8; 1TH 5:12 Those serving as overseers must rule their own homes well; 1TI 5:17

The response of the church to the authority of elders**Elders are to be obeyed**

HEB 13:17

Elders are to be honoured and respected

1TH 5:12–5:13 See also 1TI 5:17

Paul limits the authority of women in the church

1TI 2:12 Some believe Paul's restriction to apply to the women in the Ephesian church who were seizing authority rather than having been granted it. Others believe Paul is prohibiting women from being official teachers in the assembled church. See also 1CO 11:5–11:6; 1CO 11:10; 1CO 14:33–14:37

The reason for this prohibition derives from God's order of creation

1TI 2:13–2:14 See also 1CO 11:3; 1CO 11:7–11:10

Kinds of authority within the church

Authority to preach the gospel

MAT 28:18–28:19; ; MRK 16:15

Authority to excommunicate

MAT 18:15–18:18; ; 1CO 5:1–5:5 “hand this man over to Satan” here means “send back into the world ruled by Satan”; ; 1CO 5:9–5:13

Authority to forgive sins

MAT 18:18; ; JHN 20:23

5218: authority, in the home

The exercise of God-given authority within the husband-wife and parent-child relationships.

A husband is given headship over his wife

EPH 5:23

The basis for this headship

God’s headship over Jesus Christ

1CO 11:3

Jesus Christ’s headship over the church

EPH 5:23

God’s order of creation

1CO 11:8–11:9 See also GEN 2:20–2:22

This headship has been affected by the fall

GEN 3:16

How this headship is to be exercised

Lovingly and sacrificially

EPH 5:25 See also EPH 5:28, EPH 5:33; COL 3:19; 1PE 3:7

As Jesus Christ rules as head of the church

EPH 5:25–5:29

Regarding his wife as part of himself

EPH 5:28–5:29 See also 1PE 3:7

Christian wives are to submit to their husbands

EPH 5:22 parallel COL 3:18

They are to follow the example of the submission of the church to Jesus Christ

EPH 5:24

Fathers are heads of their families

GEN 18:19 See also GEN 35:2; JOS 24:15; EPH 6:4; 1TI 3:4, 1TI 3:12; TIT 1:6

Fathers’ authority is to be exercised reasonably

EPH 6:4 See also COL 3:21

The response of children to parental authority

Obedience

EPH 6:1 parallel COL 3:20 See also PRO 6:20, PRO 23:22

Respect

EPH 6:2–6:3 See also DEU 5:16; EXO 20:12, EXO 21:15, EXO 21:17; DEU 27:16; PRO 19:26, PRO 20:20; MAT 19:19 parallels MRK 10:19, LUK 18:20

Kinds of authority within the family

Authority to discipline

PRO 19:18 See also PRO 23:13, PRO 29:17

Authority to teach

PRO 1:8 See also PRO 3:1, PRO 13:1

Authority to command

COL 3:20 parallel EPH 6:1 See also PRO 6:20–6:23

5219: authority, of human institutions

The exercise of God-established freedom to regulate society for the good of its members.

Without authority sin is unrestrained

ROM 1:24–1:26 See also GEN 6:5 This was before the giving of the law; JDG 21:25; ROM 13:4

All human authorities are instituted and established by God

ROM 13:1–13:2 See also GEN 9:5–9:6; DAN 2:21, DAN 2:37–2:38, DAN 4:17, DAN 5:18–5:21, DAN 5:26; JHN 19:11; 1PE 2:13

Rulers are God’s servants to do good and restrain evil

ROM 13:4 See also ISA 45:1; JER 25:9, JER 27:6, JER 43:10; ROM 13:6; 1TI 2:2; 1PE 2:14

The proper response to human authorities

They are to be obeyed by everyone

ROM 13:1 See also ECC 8:2; MAT 22:17–22:21 parallels MRK 12:14–12:17, LUK 20:22–20:25; ROM 13:5–13:7; TIT 3:1; 1PE 2:13–2:14

They are to be honoured and respected

PRO 24:21 See also ROM 13:7; 1PE 2:17

They are not to be obeyed if their demands conflict with the law of God

ACT 4:19 See also EXO 1:17; 1KI 21:3; DAN 3:18, DAN 6:12; MAT 22:21 parallels MRK 12:17, LUK 20:25; HEB 11:23

They are to be prayed for

1TI 2:1–2:2 See also JER 29:7

Christians are to use rights granted by the authorities

ACT 16:35–16:39, ACT 22:22–22:29, ACT 25:1–25:12

5220: authority, abuse of

The misuse of a person's freedom of action in order to exploit, oppress or treat other people in a way that is not for their good.

Warnings against the abuse of authority

By employers over employees

EPH 6:9 See also LEV 25:43; DEU 24:14

By fathers over children

EPH 6:4 parallel COL 3:21

By husbands over wives

COL 3:19

By elders over the church

1PE 5:2–5:3 See also EZK 34:2–34:7

By those mistreating foreigners

EXO 22:21 See also EXO 23:9

By leaders over those who are led

MAT 20:25–20:27 parallel MRK 10:42–10:44 See also LUK 22:25–22:26

By those taking advantage of the helpless or poor

EXO 22:22 See also PRO 22:22; EZK 22:29; ZEC 7:10

By those who oppress others

JER 22:17 See also PSA 73:8, PSA 119:134; EZK 22:7

Examples of the abuse of authority

GEN 16:6 See also EXO 1:11; 1KI 12:14; JAS 2:6

5222: baking

Cooking in an oven or over an open fire. Bread baked in this way was the staple diet of the population in biblical times. Bricks were also sometimes produced by baking.

Baking bread

In ovens

LEV 26:26 See also EXO 8:3; LEV 7:9, LEV 11:35

Over open fires

1KI 19:6 See also ISA 44:14–44:19; EZK 4:9–4:15; JHN 21:9

Unleavened bread

EXO 12:39 Bread was usually baked with yeast, but where there was insufficient time for kneading and proving, the raising agent was omitted. See also GEN 19:1–19:3; LEV 6:14–6:17; 1SA 28:24

Baking of offerings

LEV 2:4–2:10 See also LEV 6:14–6:18, LEV 7:9–7:10, LEV 23:15–23:18, LEV 24:5–24:6; 2KI 4:42

Baking of manna

EXO 16:21–16:23

Baking of clay

DAN 2:32–2:33 See also GEN 11:3; DAN 2:41–2:43

Bakers

At home

GEN 18:6 See also LEV 26:26 Women baked at home or in communal ovens; 2SA 13:6–13:8

At royal courts

1SA 8:13 See also GEN 40:1–40:22, GEN 41:10

In the temple

1CH 9:31 See also 1CH 23:28–23:29; EZK 46:20

As tradesmen in towns

JER 37:21 See also HOS 7:4

5223: banner

Generally, a standard raised in battle as a rallying point for armies. God is described as Israel's banner in recognition of his powerful defence of his people. The Messiah will raise a banner to rally the scattered exiles of Israel.

Israel's tribes identified by banners

NUM 2:2 See also NUM 1:52, NUM 2:17, NUM 2:34, NUM 10:14

Banners carried into battle

Battle standards carried by armies

PSA 20:5 See also PSA 74:4; SNG 6:4; ISA 30:17 Banners to rally armies were often set up on the top of a hill; JER 4:21

The LORD as Israel's banner

EXO 17:15–17:16 The LORD is the rallying point for Israel and the source of the nation's confidence in battle. See also PSA 60:4–60:6

God's banner raised against his people

ISA 5:25–5:26 God raises a banner to rally nations to battle against Israel. See also JER 4:6, JER 6:1

God's banner raised against the nations

ISA 13:2–13:5 See also ISA 18:3, ISA 31:9; JER 50:2, JER 51:12, JER 51:27–51:28

The Messiah as a banner to the peoples

ISA 11:10–11:12 See also ISA 49:22, ISA 62:10; ZEC 10:8; JHN 12:32

Other references to banners

SNG 2:4 The king's love is like a banner, displayed for all to see; ; EZK 27:7 a banner made from embroidered linen

5224: barn

Barns were associated with industry and prosperity

Full barns were a sign of blessing

PRO 3:9–3:10 See also DEU 28:8; PSA 144:12–144:15

Empty barns were a sign of poverty

HAG 2:15–2:19

The priority of spiritual over material prosperity

LUK 12:15–12:21 See also MAT 6:25–6:26; LUK 12:23–12:24

God's barn is a metaphor for the kingdom of heaven

LUK 3:16–3:17 parallel MAT 3:11–3:12 See also MAT 13:24–13:30

5225: barrenness

A lack of fertility, especially the inability of a woman to conceive.

Barren land

Barrenness describes waste and unproductive land

JER 2:6 See also DEU 32:10; JOL 2:20

Barren land as a sign of God's disfavour

GEN 3:18 Thorns and thistles are often used to designate barren or unproductive land. See also HOS 10:8; HEB 6:8

Fertility, as opposed to barrenness, a sign of God's blessing

EXO 23:25–23:26 Consequently, the inability to conceive was regarded as a sign of God's displeasure. See also DEU 7:13–7:14; DEU 11:14–11:15; PSA 113:9; ISA 41:18; ISA 54:1; GAL 4:27

The barren woman

Her desire for children

GEN 30:1–30:2 See also PRO 30:16

Examples of barren women

GEN 16:1 Sarah; ; GEN 29:31 Rachel; ; JDG 13:3 Manoah's wife; ; ISA 2:5 Hannah; ; LUK 1:7 Elizabeth; ; LUK 1:36–1:37 The ability to bear a child in these circumstances, especially in old age, was seen as a sign of God's blessing and his miraculous power.

Barrenness was sometimes seen as a sign of God's disfavour

GEN 16:1–16:4; GEN 20:17–20:18; GEN 29:31–29:34; ; 1SA 1:1–1:20; ; ISA 4:1; ; LUK 1:5–1:25

Childlessness was not always the result of barrenness

DEU 28:41

Barrenness might be an advantage in some circumstances

LUK 23:29 Referring to the disasters about to come upon Jerusalem.

Metaphorically, barrenness may describe an unproductive or desperate condition

HEB 6:7–6:8 See also JOB 3:7; LUK 13:6–13:9

5226: basin

A receptacle for liquids, often used for washing or purification rites.

Basins used as receptacles

EXO 12:22 A basin is used to collect the blood of sacrifices. See also EXO 24:6; LEV 14:5; LEV 14:50

Basins used for ritual washing

Between the altar and the Tent of Meeting

EXO 30:18; EXO 40:11; EXO 40:30; ; LEV 8:11

In Solomon's temple

2CH 4:6 See also 1KI 7:30; 1KI 7:38 parallel 2CH 4:14; 2KI 16:17; 1KI 7:40; JER 52:17–52:18

A basin used for ritual washing

JHN 13:5

5227: basket

Flat, open baskets to carry bread

In the chief baker's dream

See also GEN 40:16–40:18

For offering unleavened bread

EXO 29:23 parallel LEV 8:26 See also EXO 29:2–29:3 parallel LEV 8:1–8:2; NUM 6:15–6:17

Baskets used to hold food

To store household provisions

DEU 28:5 Signifying the continued provision of food for the household. See also DEU 28:17

To collect food

MAT 14:20 parallels MRK 6:43; LUK 9:17; JHN 6:13 See also MAT 13:48; MAT 15:37 parallel MRK 8:8; MAT 16:9–16:10 parallel MRK 8:19–8:20

Baskets used to carry fruit

JER 24:1–24:2 See also DEU 23:24; PSA 81:6; AMO 8:1–8:2

Other uses of baskets

EXO 2:3–2:5 Moses is put into a papyrus basket; ; DEU 26:2–26:4 firstfruits presented in a basket; ; 2KI 10:7 the heads of Ahab's sons sent to Jehu in baskets; ; ZEC 5:6–5:11 The wickedness of Jerusalem is removed, figuratively, to Babylon in a basket.; ACT 9:25; ; 2CO 11:33

5228: battering-rams

Battering-rams used to make breaches in the walls of besieged cities

Historic references to the breaking down of walls

2SA 20:15 The wall of Abel Beth Maacah. References to breached or broken walls are evidence that the use of battering-rams was common; ; 2KI 14:13 parallel 2CH 25:23; ; JER 39:2 parallels 2CH 36:19, JER 52:7; ; NEH 1:3

Figurative references to the breaking down of walls

PSA 89:40 referring to God's displeasure with David's dynasty

Prophetic references to the breaking down of walls as a picture of the LORD's power

ISA 22:5, ISA 24:12; ; EZK 21:22, EZK 26:9; ; MIC 2:13

Peace is symbolised by no breaching of walls

PSA 144:14

Model battering-rams were part of the symbolic representation of the siege of Jerusalem

EZK 4:2

5229: bed

A household item of furniture set aside for sleep, rest and quietness.

Various kinds of bed

DEU 3:11; AMO 6:4; ACT 9:34 See also MAT 9:6 parallels MRK 2:11–2:12, LUK 5:18–5:19; MRK 2:4 parallels MAT 9:2, LUK 5:24; ACT 5:15

The bed as a place of rest

2KI 4:10 See also 1SA 3:2; 2SA 4:5, 2SA 4:7, 2SA 11:13; EST 7:8; JOB 33:15; PSA 139:8; PRO 7:16–7:17, PRO 26:14; ISA 28:20 Beds were not always comfortable; DAN 4:5, DAN 7:1; LUK 11:7

The bed as a place of recuperation

PSA 41:3; ACT 28:8 See also GEN 48:2; EXO 21:18; 2SA 13:5; 1KI 17:19; 2KI 1:4, 2KI 4:21; JOB 7:13–7:14, JOB 33:19; DAN 8:27; MAT 8:14 parallel MRK 1:30; REV 2:22

The bed as a place in which to be alone

PSA 4:4; MIC 2:1 See also 1KI 21:4; 2KI 6:12, 2KI 11:2; PSA 6:6, PSA 63:6; ECC 10:20

The bed representing sexual union

DEU 22:30; HEB 13:4 See also GEN 39:7; DEU 27:20; 2SA 13:11; 1CH 5:1; EZK 22:10, EZK 23:17

Unusual places used as beds

GEN 28:11; ; 1KI 19:5; ; JON 1:5; ; MRK 4:38

Bed associated with a description of apostasy

ISA 57:7

5230: beggars

People in great need who appeal for help, both from others and from God.

Appeals for material help

2KI 6:26 During a time of famine; **LUK 16:3** See also 2KI 8:3–8:5; JOB 19:16, JOB 24:4–24:5, JOB 29:11–29:12; PSA 37:25 never having to beg seen as God's blessing; PSA 109:10 begging seen as God's judgment; LAM 4:4

Appeals for mercy from others

EST 8:3 See also 1SA 15:25; 2SA 14:4; 2KI 1:13; EST 4:8, EST 7:7; JOB 30:28; MAT 18:26–18:32

Examples of beggars

MRK 10:46 parallel LUK 18:35 blind Bartimaeus; ; LUK 16:20–16:21 Lazarus; ; JHN 9:8 the man born blind; ; ACT 3:2–3:3 the crippled man at the temple gate

Care for the destitute commended

ISA 58:6–58:7; MAT 26:11 parallels MRK 14:7, JHN 12:8 Jesus Christ implies that we should care for them. See also DEU 15:11; PRO 19:17 kindness to the poor rewarded; PRO 21:13, PRO 22:9, PRO 28:27, PRO 31:9, PRO 31:20 the behaviour of the wife of noble character; ZEC 7:10; MAT 5:42 parallel LUK 6:30; MAT 19:21 parallels MRK 10:21, LUK 18:22 Jesus Christ and the rich young man; LUK 12:33, LUK 14:13

Pleas for God's help

From the Israelites

EXO 2:23 In the OT there are many examples of the Israelites begging God for his help in times of dire need. See also JOS 24:7; JDG 4:3, JDG 6:6; 2CH 14:11; AMO 7:5

From individuals

PSA 18:6 See also 2SA 24:10 parallel 1CH 21:8; PSA 28:2; JON 2:2; HAB 1:2; LUK 16:27

People begged Jesus Christ for help

MAT 14:35–14:36 parallel MRK 6:56 See also MAT 8:31 parallels MRK 5:12, LUK 8:32; MAT 15:22 parallel MRK 7:26; MRK 7:32, MRK 10:47; LUK 5:12 parallel MRK 1:40; LUK 8:28, LUK 9:38–9:40; JHN 4:47

5231: birthday

Birthday celebrations

MRK 6:21 parallel MAT 14:6 See also GEN 40:20

Cursing the day of birth

JOB 3:1–3:4 See also JER 20:14–20:15

5232: book

Used most frequently to refer to a particular book of the Bible being written, another book of the Bible or a source no longer available. It is used occasionally of books in general or metaphorically of God's record of events.

References to books being written

JER 25:13, JER 30:2; ; NAM 1:1; ; JHN 20:30; ; REV 22:7, REV 22:9–22:10, REV 22:18–22:19

References to other books of Scripture

2CH 35:12; ; EZR 6:18; ; NEH 13:1; ; MRK 12:26; ; LUK 3:4, LUK 20:42; ; ACT 1:1 Luke's Gospel; ; ACT 1:20, ACT 7:42, ACT 8:28

References to books no longer available

The Book of the Wars of the LORD

NUM 21:14 This was probably an ancient collection of war songs in praise of God.

The Book of Jashar

JOS 10:13 An early account of Israel's wars, possibly in poetic form, but never a part of canonical Scripture. See also 2SA 1:18

The book of the annals of the kings of Israel and Judah

2CH 16:11 These sources were probably records of the reigns of the kings of Israel and Judah, compiled by the succession of Israel's prophets spanning the kingdom period (see e.g., 1Ch 29:29; 2Ch 12:15; 20:34; 26:22; 32:32). See also 1KI 11:41, 1KI 14:19, 1KI 14:29; 2KI 1:18, 2KI 8:23; 1CH 9:1, 1CH 27:24; 2CH 24:27, 2CH 27:7

The book of the annals

NEH 12:23 This was probably the official temple chronicle, containing various lists and records (compare with Ne 7:5);; EST 2:23, EST 6:1, EST 10:2

References to books in general

ECC 12:12 See also JHN 21:25; ACT 19:19 as sources of magical knowledge

Books used metaphorically of God's infallible record of events

REV 20:11–20:12 See also DAN 7:10, DAN 10:21, DAN 12:1

5233: borrowing

Asking for and receiving money or goods for temporary use as a neighbourly kindness.

Believers should respond to requests to borrow

MAT 5:42 See also DEU 15:7–15:11; LUK 6:35, LUK 11:5–11:8

God's blessing on Israel made borrowing unnecessary

DEU 28:12 See also DEU 15:6

The responsibilities of those who borrow

Repayment

PSA 37:21; ; ROM 13:8

Restitution

EXO 22:14–22:15; ; 2KI 6:5–6:7

Borrowing can bring debt and servitude

PRO 22:7 See also MAT 18:23–18:25

Security for borrowing

Warnings against putting up security

PRO 11:15 See also PRO 6:1–6:5, PRO 17:18, PRO 22:26–22:27

Security may be required

PRO 20:16, PRO 27:13

Security must be just

DEU 24:6 See also JOB 22:6; NEH 5:3–5:13

Jesus Christ was willing to borrow

Examples of borrowing

LUK 5:3 See also MAT 21:1–21:3 parallels MRK 11:1–11:3, LUK 19:30–19:31; MAT 26:17–26:19 parallels MRK 14:12–14:16, LUK 22:10–22:12

Other examples

EXO 3:21–3:22, EXO 11:2–11:3, EXO 12:35–12:36; ; 2KI 4:3; ; NEH 5:3

5234: bottle

Bottles made from animal skins

Holding wine

JOS 9:4, JOS 9:13; ; 1SA 1:24, 1SA 10:3, 1SA 16:20; ; 2SA 16:1; ; JOB 32:19; ; MAT 9:17 parallels MRK 2:22, LUK 5:37–5:38

Holding water

GEN 21:14–21:15, GEN 21:19; ; PSA 56:8

Holding milk

JDG 4:19

Earthenware bottles

1KI 14:3; ; JOB 38:37; ; PSA 33:7; ; JER 19:1, JER 19:10

Bottles for oil and ointment

1SA 10:1; ; 2KI 9:1; ; ISA 3:20; ; MAT 26:7 parallels MRK 14:3, LUK 7:37

5235: boundary

The agreed limits to the lands of an individual or people. Designated by God and protected by law, both national and local boundaries could be subject to dispute.

The importance of boundary marks

DEU 19:14; PRO 23:10 See also DEU 27:17; PRO 22:28

Examples of significant boundaries

Boundaries of the promised land

EXO 23:31; 1KI 4:21 See also NUM 34:1–34:12; DEU 3:12–3:17; JOS 13:1–13:33, JOS 15:1–15:63, JOS 16:1–16:10, JOS 17:1–17:18, JOS 18:11–18:28, JOS 19:1–19:48; ISA 26:15; EZK 47:15–47:20, EZK 48:1–48:8

Boundaries of other nations

ACT 17:26 See also GEN 10:18–10:19; NUM 21:13, NUM 33:37, NUM 33:44; DEU 32:8; JOS 12:2–12:5; JDG 1:36, JDG 11:18; EZK 29:10

City boundaries

NUM 35:26

Religious boundaries

EXO 19:12 See also EXO 19:23

Boundary problems and disputes

JOB 24:2 See also JOS 22:25; HOS 5:10; AMO 1:13; MIC 5:6

God establishes other boundaries

JOB 26:10 See also JOB 38:9–38:11; PSA 104:9; PRO 8:29; JER 5:22

Metaphorical boundaries

PSA 16:6

5236: bow and arrow

A weapon used for hunting and in warfare. In the Scriptures the tongue is likened to a bow and unfaithful Israel to a faulty bow. The bow is also symbolic of military power.

The bow and arrow used for hunting

GEN 27:3 See also ISA 7:24

The bow and arrow used in warfare

GEN 48:22; 1KI 22:34 parallel 2CH 18:33 See also JOS 24:12; 1SA 2:4, 1SA 18:4; 2SA 1:22, 2SA 22:35 parallel PSA 18:34; 2KI 9:24; 2CH 14:8 Asa's army; 2CH 26:14; NEH 4:13, NEH 4:16; ISA 5:28, ISA 13:18; JER 6:23, JER 50:14, JER 50:29

The tongue likened to a bow

JER 9:3 See also PSA 64:2–64:4

Unfaithful Israel likened to a faulty bow

PSA 78:57 See also HOS 7:16

The bow as a symbol of power and strength

Of military power

PSA 44:6–44:7, PSA 60:4 See also GEN 49:24; PSA 46:9; HOS 1:5, HOS 1:7, HOS 2:18; ZEC 9:10

Of God's power in judgment

PSA 7:11–7:12 See also PSA 21:11–21:12; LAM 2:4, LAM 3:12; HAB 3:9; ZEC 9:13; REV 6:2

Of personal strength and vigour

JOB 29:20 See also JOB 30:11

5237: breastplate

A coat of armour comprising one or more pieces of bronze, iron or chain mail covering the chest and back to protect the heart and other vital organs. Used figuratively it refers to righteousness, faith and love.

Breastplates were coats or tunics of armour

They were part of military dress

2CH 26:14 See also 1SA 17:5, 1SA 17:38; 2SA 20:8

They were worn by soldiers

2SA 20:8 See also NEH 4:16; JER 46:4, JER 51:3

Bronze breastplates

1SA 17:5

Iron breastplates

REV 9:9

Those wearing breastplates were not impregnable

1KI 22:34 parallel 2CH 18:33 See also 1SA 31:3; 1KI 20:11

The breastplate was often referred to figuratively

As a picture of righteousness

ISA 59:17; EPH 6:14

As a picture of faith and love

1TH 5:8

As a picture of invincibility

See also REV 9:9

5238: bribery

The practice of offering an incentive, usually money, in order to dishonestly or illegally procure a decision or action in favour of the giver.

Bribery is sin

It is forbidden by God on the grounds of truth and justice

EXO 23:8; 2CH 19:7 See also DEU 10:17; DEU 16:18–16:20; JOB 36:18

The prevalence of the sin

PRO 17:8 See also PRO 6:32–6:35; PRO 21:14

The seriousness of the sin

JOB 15:34 See also DEU 27:25; ISA 1:23–1:24; ISA 5:22–5:23; ISA 33:15; AMO 5:12; MIC 3:9–3:12

The results of bribery

Personal corruption

ECC 7:7 See also PSA 26:9–26:10; 1TI 6:10

The perversion of justice

PRO 17:23 See also EXO 23:8; DEU 16:19

The decay of society

PRO 29:4 See also EZK 22:12 Corruption, violence and decay render society subject to God's judgment.

Examples of bribery

Balak and Balaam: NUM 22:16; ; 2PE 2:15; JDG 16:5 Delilah; 1SA 8:1–8:3; 1SA 12:2–12:3; 1KI 15:18–15:19 King Asa; ; 2KI 16:7–16:9 King Ahaz; ; EST 3:9 Haman; ; MAT 26:14–26:16 parallels MRK 14:10–14:11, LUK 22:4–22:6 Judas; ; MAT 28:11–28:15 the soldiers at the tomb; ; ACT 24:26 Governor Felix

5239: bricks

Bricks used in construction

The tower of Babel

GEN 11:3–11:4

Altars

See also ISA 65:3

Pavements

JER 43:9

Bricks were cheaper than stone

ISA 9:10

Repair of brickwork

NAM 3:14

Making bricks as a punishment

EXO 1:14; 2SA 12:30–12:31 See also EXO 5:7–5:19

5240: building

The construction of something together with the skilled people involved. Scripture also uses the term figuratively.

Building materials

GEN 11:3; 1KI 5:17; HAG 1:8 See also EXO 27:1; 1KI 6:9; 2CH 2:3; ISA 54:11

Building skills

1KI 5:18 See also EXO 36:1; 1KI 6:7; 2KI 12:11, 2KI 22:5–22:6; 1CH 22:1–22:2

The variety of building projects

Towns and cities

1KI 16:24 See also GEN 4:17; JDG 1:26; 1CH 11:8

Houses

ECC 2:4 See also JER 35:8–35:9

Temples

ACT 17:24 See also 1KI 6:2; 1KI 8:13; EZR 3:10

Altars

JOS 8:30–8:31 See also GEN 8:20; EXO 24:4; 2SA 24:25

Palaces

2SA 5:11 See also 1KI 3:1; 1KI 7:2; HOS 8:14

Walls

PSA 51:18 See also NEH 2:17–2:18; MIC 7:11

The tower of Babel

GEN 11:4–11:5

Building used figuratively

MAT 16:18; 2CO 5:1; 1TH 5:11; 1PE 2:4–2:5 See also 1KI 11:38 PSA 118:22; MAT 21:42 parallels MRK 12:10, LUK

20:17; ACT 4:11; 1PE 2:7 PRO 9:1 the house of wisdom; MAT 7:24–7:26 parallel LUK 6:48–6:49 the wise and foolish builders; ROM 15:20; 1CO 3:9–3:15; 2CO 10:8; EPH 2:20–2:22, EPH 4:12, EPH 4:29; COL 2:7; HEB 3:3–3:4, HEB 11:10

5241: burial

The burying of a dead body, usually in a family tomb. The lack of a proper burial was regarded as a great misfortune and disgrace. Burial was usually accompanied by mourning.

Burial in a family tomb

GEN 49:29–49:31 See also GEN 23:19–23:20, GEN 25:9–25:10, GEN 50:13; JDG 8:32, JDG 16:31; 1SA 25:1 “at his home” probably refers to the family tomb, but could mean more literally under the floor of the house or yard; 2SA 2:32, 2SA 17:23

Other places of burial

GEN 35:8, GEN 35:19–35:20

Burial of criminals hung on a tree

DEU 21:22–21:23 See also JHN 19:31 The request of the Jews was probably not only to avoid desecrating a special Sabbath, but also to identify Jesus Christ as one cursed by God.

Burial of an executed criminal or enemy under a heap of stones

JOS 7:26, JOS 8:29, JOS 10:27; ; 2SA 18:17

Lack of a proper burial

JER 22:18–22:19 See also DEU 28:26; 2SA 21:12–21:14; 1KI 13:22; ECC 6:3; JER 7:33, JER 16:4, JER 25:33

Common burial-grounds

2KI 23:6; ; JER 26:23; ; MAT 27:7

Burial accompanied by mourning

ACT 8:2 See also DEU 34:5–34:8

Preparation of Jesus Christ's body for burial

JHN 19:39–19:40 See also MAT 26:12 parallel MRK 14:8; MRK 16:1 parallels LUK 24:1, JHN 12:7

5242: buying and selling

Buying and selling are an integral part of the everyday life of the world. Scripture makes it clear that God expects moral dealings by his people in this area of life as in every other.

Some biblical transactions

The first recorded transaction

GEN 23:3–23:4 Many other transactions had obviously taken place before this, from the earliest times.

Transactions in land

See also GEN 47:20–47:22; RUT 4:3; PRO 31:16; JER 32:9–32:10; MAT 27:7; LUK 14:18; ACT 4:34

Buying animals

LUK 14:19

Buying food and drink

GEN 41:57; ; DEU 2:28; ; JHN 6:5, JHN 13:29; ; REV 6:6

Transactions in other goods

REV 18:11–18:13

Buying of slaves

GEN 17:12; ; EXO 21:2; ; LEV 25:44–25:45; ; HOS 3:1–3:2

The labour market

LEV 25:39–25:40; ; MAT 20:1–20:2

God's standards in buying and selling

Fairness

GEN 23:5–23:13; ; 2SA 24:24

Honesty

LEV 19:35–19:36 See also GEN 23:14–23:16; DEU 25:13–25:16; PRO 11:1, PRO 16:11, PRO 20:10, PRO 20:23

Sins to avoid in buying and selling

Dishonesty

PRO 20:14; ; AMO 8:5; ; MIC 6:10–6:11

Greed

PRO 11:26

Exploitation

LEV 25:14 See also LAM 5:4; AMO 8:6

Extravagance

LUK 15:13

Desecration of the Sabbath

NEH 10:31, NEH 13:15–13:22; ; AMO 8:5

Desecration of the temple

MAT 21:12–21:13 parallels MRK 11:15–11:17, LUK 19:45–19:46 The merchants were operating within the outer court of the temple, itself consecrated as a place of prayer and worship. See also JHN 2:14–2:16

Worldliness

EZK 7:12; ; 1CO 7:29–7:31; ; JAS 4:13

Oppression through the control of buying and selling

REV 13:16–13:17

Spiritual transactions

Sinners sold to sin

See also 1KI 21:20; ROM 7:14

Israel sold and redeemed

JDG 2:14; ; PSA 44:12; ; ISA 43:1, ISA 50:1, ISA 52:3

Jesus Christ has bought his people

ACT 20:28 See also 1CO 6:20, 1CO 7:23; 1PE 1:18–1:19; 2PE 2:1

Spiritual wealth to be bought

PRO 23:23 See also ISA 55:1; MAT 13:44–13:46, MAT 25:9; REV 3:18

Gifts money cannot buy

JOB 28:12–28:19; ; PSA 49:7–49:8; ; MRK 8:37; ; ACT 8:20

5243: byword

Individuals become a byword

As a punishment for idolatry

EZK 14:7–14:8

As a trial of faith

JOB 17:6 See also JOB 30:9

God's people become a byword

As a punishment for disobedience

DEU 28:37 See also 1KI 9:6–9:9 parallel 2CH 7:19–7:22; JER 24:8–24:10; EZK 23:1–23:10; JOL 2:17

As a trial of faith

PSA 44:9–44:26

5244: camp

A dwelling-place in the desert, often linked with the idea of a wandering people.

Camps and the nomadic lifestyle of early Israel

At the time of the patriarchs

GEN 25:16 See also GEN 26:17, GEN 31:25, GEN 32:21, GEN 33:18

During Israel's wanderings in the wilderness

NUM 1:52, NUM 9:17–9:18 See also EXO 13:20, EXO 16:13, EXO 19:16–19:17, EXO 32:26–32:27

During the entry into the promised land

JOS 4:19

The camp as a symbol of God's holy presence

All that was unclean was put outside the camp

LEV 13:46; DEU 23:14 See also EXO 29:14; LEV 24:14; NUM 5:2–5:4; HEB 13:11–13:13 a picture of Jesus Christ's rejection

The camp and God's protection

GEN 32:2 See also PSA 34:7

The camp as a military base

1SA 17:1 See also JDG 7:8–7:11, JDG 7:13–7:15; 2KI 3:24; JER 50:29; EZK 4:2

5245: captain

A senior military officer, usually in charge of a ruler's personal guards or bodyguards, the temple guard or a group of soldiers. The word is also used to refer to the commander of a ship's crew.

Captains in charge of a ruler's personal guards or bodyguards

Potiphar, captain of Pharaoh's guard

GEN 37:36, GEN 39:1, GEN 40:3–40:4, GEN 41:10, GEN 41:12

David, captain of Saul's bodyguard

1SA 22:14

The captain of the guard arrests Jeremiah

See also JER 37:13

Captains in charge of the temple guard

ACT 4:1 See also ACT 5:24, ACT 5:26

Captains in charge of soldiers

King Ahaziah sends a captain with fifty men to Elijah

2KI 1:9–1:14

Captains come to the help of Deborah

JDG 5:14

Solomon's captains were Israelites

1KI 9:22 parallel 2CH 8:9

God will remove captains in judgment

ISA 3:1–3:3

Captains in charge of a ship's crew

The ship's captain orders Jonah to call on his god

JON 1:6

Sea captains will bemoan the fall of Babylon

REV 18:17–18:19

5246: captivity

The state of individuals, communities or nations held in bondage by a foreign power. Such captivity may be punishment from God who, nevertheless, hears the cry of his captive people. God will punish those who, in their arrogance, take others captive. The term is sometimes used metaphorically of the bondage of sin. Jesus Christ alone can free people from such a state.

Individuals and communities taken into captivity**ISA 30:1–30:3** See also GEN 14:11–14:14**Nations taken into captivity****JER 48:46** See also EXO 6:9; NUM 31:9–31:12; ISA 20:3–20:4**The captivity of Israel****As a punishment from the LORD****PSA 106:39–106:43** See also PSA 78:58–78:61**The LORD hears the cry of his people****EXO 2:23** See also EXO 6:5–6:6; 1KI 8:46–8:51; PSA 69:33; PSA 106:44–106:46**The Israelites were never to forget their captivity in Egypt****DEU 5:15** See also EXO 13:3; EXO 13:14; DEU 6:12; DEU 6:20–6:21; DEU 15:12–15:15; DEU 16:11–16:12; DEU 24:17–24:18; DEU 24:21–24:22; JOS 24:17; JER 34:12–34:14**God will punish those who take others into captivity****AMO 1:6–1:7** See also 2CH 28:9–28:15; NEH 4:4; AMO 1:9–1:10; ACT 7:6–7:7**Captivity used metaphorically****Of the bondage of sin****JHN 8:34** See also ACT 8:23; ROM 7:14; ROM 7:25; 2TI 2:26; 2PE 2:19**Jesus Christ alone can free from such sin****2CO 10:5** See also ISA 42:6–42:7; ISA 61:1; LUK 4:18; JHN 8:36; GAL 2:4–2:5; GAL 5:1; EPH 4:8; PSA 68:18**5247: carpenters****Examples of carpenters at work****In the building of the ark**

GEN 6:14–6:16

In the construction of the tabernacle**EXO 31:2–31:5** See also EXO 35:30–35:33**In the building of David's palace****2SA 5:11** parallel 1CH 14:1**In the building of the temple****1KI 5:18** See also 1CH 22:15; 2CH 2:13–2:14**In the restoration of the temple****2KI 12:11** See also 2KI 22:6; 2CH 24:12; 2CH 34:11**In rebuilding the temple****EZR 3:7****In boatbuilding**

See also EZK 27:5–27:6

Carpenters among the exiles in Babylon**2KI 24:16** Carpenters are literally “craftsmen in wood”.

See also JER 24:1; JER 29:2

Joseph as a carpenter**MAT 13:55****Jesus Christ as a carpenter****MRK 6:3****5248: cart****General description of carts**

See also NUM 7:3; ISA 6:7; ISA 6:14 made of wood; ISA 5:18 pulled by ropes; ISA 28:27–28:28 equipped with heavy wheels

Carts as a means of transport**Carts used to transport people****GEN 46:5** See also GEN 45:19–45:21; GEN 45:27; ISA 66:20**Carts used as military transport****EZK 23:24** See also EZK 26:10**Carts used to transport grain****AMO 2:13** See also PSA 65:11**Carts used to transport the tabernacle**

NUM 7:6–7:8 The heavier items of the tabernacle and its furniture were carried on covered carts drawn by oxen.

A new cart to transport the ark of the LORD**1SA 6:8** The Philistines send the ark back to Israel. See also 1SA 6:10–6:11; 2SA 6:2–6:3 parallel 1CH 13:7 The ark is started on its journey to Jerusalem.**5249: census**

The counting of individuals, usually for the purpose of war or taxation.

Motivations for a census**To count the number of fighting men available****NUM 1:1–1:4, NUM 26:1–26:4** See also NUM 1:5–1:49; NUM 26:5–26:65**For ascertaining those qualified to be included in the Jewish community**

EZR 2:1–2:65 parallel NEH 7:6–7:67

For purposes of taxation**LUK 2:2; ACT 5:37** See also EXO 30:12

God's anger at David's unauthorised census

2SA 24:1–24:9 parallel 1CH 21:1–21:6 David's sin in taking this census was probably that he did so from a motive of self-sufficiency rather than trusting in God.

5250: centurion

A Roman military officer in charge of one hundred soldiers.

The centurion who asked Jesus Christ to heal his servant

MAT 8:5–8:9 parallel LUK 7:2–7:8

The centurion present at the death of Jesus Christ

MAT 27:54 parallels MRK 15:39, LUK 23:47 See also MRK 15:44–15:45

The centurion Cornelius

ACT 10:1–10:48, ACT 11:1–11:18

The centurions involved in guarding Paul

ACT 22:25–22:26, ACT 23:17–23:18, ACT 23:23, ACT 24:23, ACT 27:1, ACT 27:3, ACT 27:6, ACT 27:11, ACT 27:31, ACT 27:43

5251: chains

Used to hold people in captivity, both physically and spiritually, but also an emblem of honour and public office.

Chains as a means of physical restraint

MRK 5:4 parallel LUK 8:29 **ACT 12:6–12:7** See also 2KI 23:33; JER 40:1–40:4; ACT 16:26, ACT 21:33, ACT 22:29, ACT 26:29, ACT 28:20; EPH 6:20; PHP 1:7, PHP 1:13–1:17 Paul in chains for Christ; COL 4:3, COL 4:18; 2TI 1:16, 2TI 2:9; PHM 1:10, PHM 1:13; HEB 11:36

Chains as a metaphor of captivity**Political bondage**

ISA 45:14 See also JOB 36:8–36:9; PSA 2:3, PSA 107:10–107:14; ISA 28:22, ISA 52:2; EZK 7:23; NAM 3:10

Spiritual bondage to sin

PSA 116:16 See also ISA 58:6–58:10; LAM 3:7

God's binding of sinful angels

JUD 1:6 See also REV 20:1–20:2

The domination of others

ECC 7:26

Chains as a form of ornament**As emblems of honour or rank**

DAN 5:29 See also GEN 41:42; DAN 5:7, DAN 5:16

As a form of jewellery

PRO 1:9 See also EXO 28:22–28:25 the high priest's breastplate; EXO 39:15–39:18; JDG 8:26; ISA 3:20

As adornment of idols

ISA 40:19

As adornment of places of worship

2CH 3:16 See also EXO 28:13–28:14; 1KI 6:21, 1KI 7:17; 2CH 3:5

5252: chariots

Horse-drawn vehicles used for carrying important people when travelling or on ceremonial occasions, and in war for carrying warriors. The chariot is used as a symbol of military power, the power of God and as a picture of God's angelic army.

Chariots used for travelling

GEN 46:29 See also GEN 50:9; JDG 4:15; 2SA 15:1; 1KI 12:18, 1KI 18:44, 1KI 20:33; 2KI 5:21, 2KI 9:16, 2KI 9:21, 2KI 10:16; ACT 8:28

Chariots used on ceremonial occasions

GEN 41:43 See also GEN 50:9; JER 17:25

Chariots used for carrying warriors

EXO 14:6–14:7 See also DEU 11:4, DEU 20:1; JOS 11:4, JOS 17:16; JDG 1:19, JDG 4:13; ISA 8:11, ISA 13:5 the Philistines prepare for battle; 2SA 1:6, 2SA 8:4 parallel 1CH 18:4; 1KI 10:26 parallel 2CH 1:14; 1KI 20:1; 2KI 6:14, 2KI 8:21, 2KI 10:2; 1CH 19:6 the Ammonites hire chariots and charioteers; 2CH 12:3, 2CH 14:9; EZK 23:24, EZK 26:7, EZK 26:10; NAM 2:4

The chariot as a symbol of military might

PSA 20:7 See also 2KI 19:23 parallel ISA 37:24; ISA 2:7, ISA 22:7, ISA 22:18, ISA 31:1, ISA 36:9; JER 50:37, JER 51:21; MIC 5:10; NAM 2:13; HAG 2:22

The chariot as a symbol of God's mighty power

PSA 104:3 See also 2KI 2:11; PSA 68:4, PSA 68:33; ISA 19:1; EZK 1:15–1:21; ZEC 6:1–6:8

God's mighty angelic army depicted by chariots

2KI 6:17 See also PSA 68:17; ISA 66:15; JER 4:13; HAB 3:8

5253: cheating**Cheating is condemned**

LEV 6:1–6:5 See also 1CO 6:7–6:8; 1TH 4:6

Examples of cheating**Not paying fair wages**

GEN 31:6–31:9; ; JAS 5:4

Using dishonest weights or scales

DEU 25:13–25:16; ; HOS 12:7–12:8; ; AMO 8:5

Charging excess taxes

LUK 19:8

Offering blemished animals for sacrifice

MAL 1:12–1:14

Moving boundary stones

DEU 19:14, DEU 27:17

Samuel as an example of someone who did not cheat

1SA 12:3–12:4

5254: citadel

An especially secure city, or part of a city, where soldiers were often based.

Examples of citadels

PSA 48:12–48:13 See also 2SA 12:26; 1KI 16:18; 2KI 15:25; NEH 1:1–1:2, NEH 2:8, NEH 7:2; EST 1:2, EST 1:5, EST 3:15, EST 9:6; PSA 48:1–48:3, PSA 122:7; ISA 34:13; DAN 8:2

Proverbial use of citadel

PRO 18:19

5255: citizenship

The privilege of belonging to a city or country. Scripture portrays believers as living in two realms, being members of both human society and of the heavenly city. In both realms there are duties as well as privileges.

Dual citizenship

MAT 22:21 parallels MRK 12:17, LUK 20:25 See also EZR 7:26

Earthly citizenship**Privileges and duties of citizens**

ROM 13:1–13:7 See also ECC 8:2; MAT 17:27; TIT 3:1; 1PE 2:13–2:17

Privileges and duties of Roman citizenship

ACT 16:37, ACT 22:25–22:29, ACT 23:27, ACT 25:10

Heavenly citizenship and the Christian hope

PHP 3:20; HEB 13:14 See also LUK 22:29–22:30; JHN 14:2; 1PE 1:4; REV 21:2, REV 21:27, REV 22:3–22:5

Gentiles are included in the citizenship of heaven

EPH 2:19 See also EPH 2:12–2:13

5256: city

A large walled centre of population providing security for its inhabitants. The OT often uses the term as a symbol of the security of heaven.

Types of city**Ancient cities**

GEN 4:17, GEN 10:10–10:12

Fortified cities

NUM 32:34–32:36; ; DEU 9:1; ; JOS 10:20, JOS 14:12

Royal cities

JOS 10:2; ; 1SA 27:5; ; 1CH 11:7

Cities of refuge

DEU 4:41–4:43, DEU 19:1–19:13

Cities were frequently large

DEU 1:28; JON 3:2–3:3 See also DEU 6:10, DEU 9:1; NEH 7:4; JON 4:11

Cities were surrounded by walls

DEU 3:5; EZR 4:12; 2CO 11:32–11:33 See also DEU 28:52; JOS 2:15; 1KI 3:1, 1KI 4:13; 2CH 33:14

Cities were places of security

NUM 32:17 See also JOS 10:20; 2CH 11:5–11:12, 2CH 14:6, 2CH 17:2; JER 4:5

Cities could fall

2SA 5:7; NEH 1:3; JER 51:58 See also DEU 20:12, DEU 20:19–20:20; 1KI 16:17–16:18; 2KI 25:1–25:4; ISA 13:19; JER 32:24–32:25; AMO 5:9

The holy city

PSA 48:1–48:2 See also 1KI 11:36, 1KI 14:21; 1CH 11:7; NEH 11:1; ISA 52:1; JER 25:29; DAN 9:16; MAT 5:35

City law

LEV 25:29–25:30

The city as a symbol**Of strength**

JER 1:18

Of heaven

HEB 11:10 See also HEB 11:16, HEB 12:22, HEB 13:14; REV 21:2, REV 21:20–21:27, REV 22:1–22:5

5257: civil authorities

Divinely appointed servants and agents of God exercising their God-given authority for the good of those they govern and punishing those who do wrong, and to whom all must submit.

Civil authorities are divinely appointed

JHN 19:11; ROM 13:1 See also 1SA 9:17, 1SA 16:1; PSA 78:70–78:71; PRO 8:15–8:16; JER 27:6, JER 43:10; DAN 2:21, DAN 2:37–2:38, DAN 4:17, DAN 4:32, DAN 5:18–5:21, DAN 5:26–5:28

Civil authorities are God's servants and agents

ROM 13:4 See also ISA 45:1; JER 25:9, JER 27:6, JER 43:10; ROM 13:6

Civil authority exercised for the good of all and in order to punish wrongdoers

PRO 21:15; 1PE 2:13–2:14 See also GEN 9:6; EZR 7:26; PSA 72:12–72:14, PSA 78:72; PRO 19:12, PRO 29:4, PRO 29:14; ACT 25:11; ROM 13:3–13:4; 1TI 2:2

Everyone must submit to civil authorities

PRO 24:21–24:22; TIT 3:1 See also ECC 8:2–8:5; MAT 17:24–17:27, MAT 22:15–22:21 parallels MRK 12:13–12:17, LUK 20:20–20:25; ROM 13:1, ROM 13:5–13:7; 1PE 2:13–2:14, 1PE 2:17

Civil authorities are only to be obeyed in what is lawful according to Scripture

ACT 5:29 See also EXO 1:17; 1KI 21:2–21:3; DAN 1:8, DAN 3:28, DAN 6:7–6:10; MAT 22:21 parallels MRK 12:17, LUK 20:25; ACT 4:19; HEB 11:23

5258: cloth

A woven material from which garments or coverings were made. Different kinds of material are associated with different ranks and social positions.

Cloth for daily wear

PRO 31:22 See also NUM 15:38; JDG 5:30, JDG 14:12; 2SA 1:24; 1CH 15:27; PSA 45:14; EZK 16:10, EZK 16:13; MAT 9:16; JHN 19:23; ACT 9:39

Cloth for general coverings

1SA 21:9 See also 2SA 17:19; PRO 7:16

Cloth for special uses

For religious garments

EXO 28:6 See also EXO 28:8, EXO 28:31, EXO 28:39, EXO 28:42, EXO 35:19, EXO 39:1, EXO 39:5, EXO 39:22, EXO 39:41

For the tabernacle

EXO 26:1 See also EXO 26:4, EXO 36:8; 2CH 3:14

To cover religious objects

NUM 4:5–4:13

Sackcloth as a sign of mourning

GEN 37:34 See also 2SA 3:31; 1KI 21:27; 2KI 19:1; NEH 9:1; PSA 35:13; ISA 3:24; JER 4:8; JOL 1:13

For burials

MAT 27:59 parallels MRK 15:46, LUK 23:53 See also JHN 11:44, JHN 20:7

To wrap babies in

EZK 16:4 See also LUK 2:7, LUK 2:12

Rules relating to cloth

LEV 13:47–13:49, LEV 19:19

5259: coat

Various objects were given an outer coating to fit them for their particular purpose.

An outer coating given to various objects

An outer coat of pitch made wood and papyrus waterproof

GEN 6:14 See also EXO 2:3

An outer coat of plaster made stone suitable for writing on

DEU 27:2–27:4

An outer coat of glaze rendered earthenware suitable for food use

PRO 26:23

Coats of armour for protection

2CH 26:14 See also 1SA 17:4–17:7, 1SA 17:38

Coat used metaphorically

JOB 41:13–41:17

5260: coinage

Coinage was not used until the late 7th century B.C. Weights of silver and gold were earlier used as “currency”. By the later exile a variety of minted coinage, made from gold, silver, bronze or copper, gradually replaced the method of reckoning currency by weighing out precious metals. Israelite, Persian, Greek and Roman coins are mentioned in Scripture.

The talent

A unit of weight

1KI 10:14 parallel 2CH 9:13 See also EXO 38:25, EXO 38:29; 1KI 9:28 parallel 2CH 8:18; 1KI 10:10 parallel 2CH 9:9; 1CH 22:14

A weight for precious metals used as currency

1KI 20:39 See also 1KI 9:14, 1KI 16:24; 2KI 5:5, 2KI 5:22–5:23, 2KI 15:19, 2KI 18:14, 2KI 23:33 parallel 2CH 36:3; 1CH 19:6; 2CH 25:6, 2CH 25:9, 2CH 27:5; EST 3:9

Adopted as the name of a coin

MAT 18:23–18:35 See also MAT 25:14–25:30

The shekel

Its value

EZK 45:10–45:12 See also EXO 30:13, EXO 38:25–38:26; LEV 27:25; NUM 3:46–3:47, NUM 18:16

Used as currency

ISA 7:23 See also EXO 30:15; LEV 27:1–27:8; DEU 22:19, DEU 22:29; JDG 9:4, JDG 16:5, JDG 17:10; 1SA 13:21; 2SA 18:12; 2KI 6:25, 2KI 7:1, 2KI 7:16, 2KI 7:18; 1CH 21:25 David's payment for the threshing-floor as the temple site; 2CH 1:17; NEH 5:15, NEH 10:32; JER 32:9; HOS 3:2

The denarius

Referred to in Jesus Christ's parables

MAT 20:1–20:16 One denarius was the average worker's daily wage. See also MAT 18:21–18:35; LUK 7:41–7:47

As the unit for the payment of taxes to Rome

MAT 22:15–22:21 parallels MRK 12:13–12:17, LUK 20:20–20:26

The penny

MAT 10:29 parallel LUK 12:6 The "penny" was not a coin in use in biblical times, but the term is employed in the NIV for two different copper coins, the "assarion" and the "quadrans", which were of relatively little value. See also MAT 5:25–5:26 parallel LUK 12:58–12:59; MRK 12:42

The gerah

LEV 27:25 See also EXO 30:13; NUM 3:47, NUM 18:16; EZK 45:12

The drachma

ACT 19:19 See also EZR 2:69; NEH 7:70–7:72

The four-drachma coin

MAT 17:24–17:27

The daric

1CH 29:7 See also EZR 8:27

Unnamed coins

General references to coins

JHN 2:13–2:16 See also MAT 27:6

Silver coins

MAT 26:14–26:15 See also MAT 27:3–27:10; ZEC 11:12–11:13; LUK 10:30–10:35, LUK 15:8–15:10 Although translated simply as "silver coins", it is the "drachma" which is referred to here.

Copper coins

MRK 12:41–12:42 parallel LUK 21:1–21:2 The Greek coin "lepton" is translated as "copper coin" in these passages.

5261: commander

A general term referring to a senior military officer in charge of soldiers.

Commanders of various ranks

Supreme commander

See also 2KI 18:17

Field commander

ISA 36:2

Provincial commander

1KI 20:14

Commander of captains

2CH 8:9

Commander of the citadel

NEH 7:2

Commanders over various numbers of men

DEU 1:15; ; NUM 31:14

Commanders serving under various rulers

GEN 21:22 Abimelech; ; JDG 4:2 Jabin; ; 1SA 14:50 Saul; ; 2KI 5:1 the king of Aram; ; 2KI 11:4 Jehoiada; ; 2KI 25:8 Nebuchadnezzar; 1CH 11:6, 1CH 12:8, 1CH 12:14, 1CH 15:25, 1CH 25:1, 1CH 28:1; 2CH 1:2 Solomon; ; MRK 6:21 Herod

The commander of the Roman troops

ACT 21:31–21:34, ACT 22:26–22:30, ACT 23:10, ACT 23:17–23:23, ACT 24:22

The commander of the army of the LORD

JOS 5:13–5:15

Commanders in spiritual warfare

2TI 2:4

5262: commendation

The act of speaking favourably of someone. Scripture commends those who are faithful and obedient to God.

Commendation as speaking favourably of others

PRO 15:2 See also PSA 145:4; ECC 8:15

Examples of those commended by God

MAT 26:10; LUK 7:9 See also MAT 15:28 a Canaanite woman; MAT 16:17–16:18 Simon Peter; LUK 21:3 a poor widow; HEB 11:4 Abel; HEB 11:5 Enoch

Commendation for obedience and faith

PSA 40:4; HEB 11:1–11:2 See also PSA 119:1; PRO 16:20; ISA 56:2; JER 17:7; MAT 25:34; ROM 14:18; 2CO 8:18; HEB 11:39

Commendation for perseverance

ISA 30:18 See also JAS 1:12, JAS 5:11; 1PE 2:19–2:20

Examples of human commendation of others

2SA 14:25; 2CO 10:18 See also GEN 12:15, GEN 49:8; NEH 11:2; EST 2:17; JOB 29:11; PRO 12:8, PRO 27:2, PRO 27:21, PRO 28:4, PRO 31:28, PRO 31:30–31:31; ECC 8:10; SNG 6:9; DAN 10:11; LUK 16:8; JHN 5:41, JHN 5:44, JHN 12:43; ACT 18:27; ROM 2:28, ROM 13:3, ROM 16:1; 1CO 11:2, 1CO 11:17, 1CO 11:22; 2CO 3:1, 2CO 12:11; 1TH 2:6; 1PE 2:14

Self-commendation is to be avoided

2CO 5:12 See also 2CO 6:4–6:10

5263: communication

The effective conveyance of a message. God has communicated with humanity, especially through his Son. Christians are encouraged to communicate God's word effectively to others.

God communicates with people**Through his creation**

PSA 19:1–19:4 See also ROM 1:20

Through the Scriptures

2PE 1:20–1:21 See also JER 36:2; EZK 1:3; ZEC 7:12; 2TI 3:16

Through his Son

JHN 1:18; HEB 1:1–1:3 See also JHN 1:14; COL 1:15, COL 2:9

Through the human conscience

JHN 8:9; ; ROM 2:14–2:15

Through the providential ordering of life

ACT 14:16–14:17, ACT 17:26–17:27

Through angelic appearances

JDG 6:11–6:12, JDG 13:3; ; ZEC 1:9; ; MAT 1:20; ; LUK 1:11–1:13, LUK 1:28, LUK 2:9–2:11; ; ACT 8:26; ; REV 1:1

Through dreams

1KI 3:5; ; DAN 7:1; ; MAT 2:13

Through visions

ISA 1:1; ; EZK 11:24–11:25; ; DAN 8:1; ; OBA 1:1–1:21; ; ACT 10:3, ACT 10:9–10:17

Through a donkey

NUM 22:27–22:31

Through miracles

JHN 11:25, JHN 11:43–11:44; ; ACT 2:22 The miracles of Jesus Christ were not merely wonderful occurrences; they were also signs that conveyed spiritual truth.

God has communicated directly with individuals

EXO 3:2–3:6 See also EXO 33:9, EXO 33:21; 1KI 19:12–19:13

Jesus Christ and communication**Jesus Christ communicated his Father's will**

JHN 12:49 See also JHN 14:9–14:10, JHN 14:24, JHN 15:15, JHN 17:8

Jesus Christ used parables in order to communicate with some but not with others

MRK 4:10–4:12 parallels MAT 13:10–13:15, LUK 8:9–8:10; ; ISA 6:9–6:10; ; JHN 9:39

The Holy Spirit and communication

JHN 16:15 See also JHN 14:26, JHN 15:26, JHN 16:8, JHN 16:13; ROM 8:16; GAL 4:6; 1JN 3:24

Christians are to communicate the good news to other people

LUK 24:46–24:48 See also MAT 10:7, MAT 28:19–28:20; MRK 6:12, MRK 16:15, MRK 16:20; ACT 1:8, ACT 4:20, ACT 20:27, ACT 26:17–26:20; ROM 10:14–10:15; 1TH 1:8

The failure of communication**Inadequate perception of the truth**

MRK 8:16–8:21 See also MRK 4:13; JHN 1:10, JHN 8:27, JHN 10:6, JHN 13:22, JHN 14:9, JHN 16:18

Wilful rejection of the truth

EPH 4:18 See also JHN 8:44, JHN 8:47; ROM 1:21–1:25; HEB 3:12–3:13

5264: compensation**Compensation under the law of Moses****For personal injuries**

EXO 21:26–21:27 See also EXO 21:32

For the loss of an animal

EXO 21:33–21:34 See also EXO 21:35–21:36

For theft

EXO 22:1, EXO 22:3–22:4 See also EXO 22:7–22:9

For damage to property

EXO 22:5–22:6

For breach of trust

EXO 22:10–22:15; ; LEV 6:1–6:7; ; NUM 5:5–5:7 Compensation was only paid when someone was at fault. Similar laws apparently existed in patriarchal times: see Ge 31:39.

Compensation later in the OT**The law applied by David**

2SA 12:4–12:6

Sevenfold compensation for theft

PRO 6:30–6:31 presumably “sevenfold” here means “manifold”; he will pay in full

Adultery beyond compensation

PRO 6:32–6:35

Compensation a mark of repentance

EZK 33:15

Compensation in the NT**For losses inflicted**

LUK 19:8 In his zeal, after being converted, Zacchaeus goes beyond the requirements of the law. See also PHM 1:18–1:19

For losses sustained for the gospel

MAT 19:29 parallel LUK 18:29–18:30 God is far more generous under grace than he required wrongdoers to be under law.

5265: complaints

The expression of a grievance or displeasure, usually against the actions and attitudes of others including God himself.

Complaints against God**Israel in the wilderness**

NUM 11:1, NUM 14:26–14:27 See also EXO 16:8, EXO 16:12; NUM 21:5; 1CO 10:10–10:11

Moses**EXO 5:22–5:23** See also NUM 11:11–11:15**Elijah**

1KI 19:4

Job

JOB 10:1–10:2 See also JOB 7:11–7:21, JOB 9:27–9:28, JOB 21:4, JOB 23:2, JOB 33:13

The psalmists

PSA 64:1 See also PSA 73:13–73:21, PSA 77:7–77:9, PSA 88:3–88:18, PSA 142:2

The prophets

JER 20:7–20:8 See also JER 12:1–12:4; JON 4:1–4:3; HAB 1:2–1:4, HAB 1:12–1:17

Complaints against Jesus Christ

MAT 9:11 parallels MRK 2:16, LUK 5:30 See also MAT 12:2 parallels MRK 2:24, LUK 6:2; MAT 15:2 parallel MRK 7:5; MRK 2:7 parallel MAT 9:3; LUK 15:2; JHN 6:41–6:43

Examples of justified complaints**ACT 6:1** See also GEN 21:25; 2SA 15:2–15:4**Examples of unjustified complaints**

EXO 17:3 See also EXO 14:11–14:12, EXO 15:24, EXO 16:2–16:3; ACT 18:14–18:15

Scripture denounces unjustified complaints**PHP 2:14** See also ISA 40:27; LAM 3:39; JAS 5:9; 1PE 4:9**5266: conscription**

The compulsory calling up of people to service, especially military service. The OT refers to men being conscripted to serve in the army, or in major building projects.

Men conscripted to serve in the army

Moses drew up lists of potential fighting men for the conquest of Canaan

NUM 1:2–1:3 See also NUM 1:17–1:19, NUM 1:45–1:46 NUM 26:2, NUM 26:3–26:4, NUM 26:63–26:65

Deborah called up troops to attack Jabin, a Canaanite king

JDG 4:4–4:7

God restricted the number of men conscripted by Gideon

JDG 7:1–7:8 The purpose of this was to make clear that Israel's victory was in God's strength alone.

The Benjamites raised a tribal militia to fight the rest of Israel

JDG 20:15–20:17

King Saul chose men to fight the Philistines

1SA 13:2, 1SA 14:52

King David maintained a regular army

1CH 27:1–27:15

The conscription of labourers

Those in charge of conscription

2KI 25:19 parallel JER 52:25

Solomon used conscripts to build the temple and other projects

1KI 5:13–5:15 parallel 2CH 2:2; ; 1KI 9:15, 1KI 9:20–9:21 parallel 2CH 8:7–8:8

5267: control

The exercise of authority and restraint over individuals and events. Scripture stresses that God is in sovereign control over his creation. A limited degree of control over creation is delegated to humanity.

God controls the whole world

GEN 1:1, GEN 1:3 See also NEH 9:6; PSA 102:25; ACT 17:24; HEB 11:3

God controls the affairs of heaven and earth

DEU 4:39; ; DAN 4:35

He gives wealth

DEU 8:18 See also 1CH 29:12

He appoints and deposes earthly rulers

PSA 75:6–75:7; ; DAN 2:21, DAN 4:17, DAN 4:32, DAN 5:18, DAN 5:21, DAN 5:26

He controls human hearts

PRO 21:1

He controls times and seasons

GEN 8:22 See also PSA 31:15; DAN 2:21; AMO 4:9; ACT 1:7

He controls the weather

AMO 4:7; ; MAT 5:45

He saves those whom he wills

ROM 9:11–9:16

He fixes human destiny

MAT 25:34, MAT 25:41

Human control over creation

GEN 1:26–1:28 See also GEN 2:15, GEN 2:19–2:20, GEN 3:16–3:19 After the fall it became difficult for human beings to control creation.

Human control over earthly territories

JOS 18:1; ; 2SA 8:1, 2SA 8:3; ; 2CH 17:5; ; DAN 11:43

Both the godly and ungodly should control themselves

PRO 16:32, PRO 29:11; ; 1CO 7:9, 1CO 7:37; ; 2CO 10:5; ; 1TH 4:4

Prophecy should be under the control of the prophets

1CO 14:32

The evil one has limited control

1JN 5:19 See also JOB 1:6–1:7; EPH 6:12; COL 1:13

Jesus Christ will have final control over all things

PHP 3:21 See also 1CO 15:24–15:28 Jesus Christ himself will be finally made subject to God.

5268: cooking

Scripture contains much evidence of methods of cooking and types of food cooked in biblical times. Cooking was an essential part of sacrificial worship, as well as being a domestic necessity.

Cooks

1SA 8:10–8:13 See also 1SA 9:23–9:24

Cooking utensils

1SA 2:13–2:14 See also LEV 2:7, LEV 6:28, LEV 7:9, LEV 11:35; NUM 11:8; EZK 11:3; ZEC 14:20–14:21

Cooking methods

Baking

GEN 19:3; ; EXO 16:23; ; LEV 26:26; ; 1SA 28:24; ; EZK 46:20

Boiling

EXO 16:23 See also NUM 6:19; 1SA 2:13

Roasting

1SA 2:15 See also EXO 12:8–12:9; DEU 16:5–16:7; PRO 12:27; ISA 44:16, ISA 44:19

Food cooked

Meat

EZK 24:10 See also GEN 27:3–27:19; EXO 29:31; LEV 8:31; 1KI 17:6; MIC 3:3 EXO 23:19, EXO 34:26; DEU 14:21

Grain

1SA 17:17 See also JOS 5:11; RUT 2:14; 1SA 25:18; 2SA 17:27–17:28; 1KI 17:10–17:16

Stew

GEN 25:29 See also 2KI 4:38–4:41

Human flesh

LAM 4:10 See also 2KI 6:26–6:29

Cooked offerings

LEV 2:7 See also LEV 2:14, LEV 7:9, LEV 8:31; 2CH 35:13; EZK 46:20, EZK 46:24

5269: cornerstone

A stone that can be in the foundation, above ground level or at the summit of the roof (the “capstone”). The cornerstone of a large building gives it a reliable and firm foundation, leading to the cohesion and stability of the whole building. In Scripture, such foundation-stones are taken as symbolic of the basis of faith in Jesus Christ and the church. Jesus Christ is thus repre-

sented as both the foundation upon which the church is built, and the capstone which crowns the whole.

The place of the cornerstone in buildings

JOB 38:4–38:6 See also JER 51:26; 1PE 2:4–2:8

The cornerstone is prominent, indispensable and should be reliable

ISA 28:16 See also PSA 118:22; ISA 19:13

Jesus Christ is the cornerstone of the church

EPH 2:19–2:22 See also 1PE 2:5–2:6; ISA 28:16

The cornerstone is a sure foundation for believers, but a stumbling-block for unbelievers

Rejection of the cornerstone leads to stumbling and rejection

MAT 21:42–21:44 parallels MRK 12:10–12:11, LUK 20:17–20:18 See also PSA 118:22–118:23; ISA 8:13–8:15; ROM 9:33; ISA 28:16; 1PE 2:7–2:8

Reliance on the cornerstone gives security to believers

1PE 2:6–2:7 See also ISA 28:16; ACT 4:10–4:12; EPH 2:20–2:22

The capstone as the crowning glory of a building

PSA 118:22 MAT 21:42–21:44 parallels MRK 12:10, LUK 20:17–20:18; ; ACT 4:10–4:12; ; 1PE 2:4–2:8

5270: court

Usually, a legal body dispensing justice, but the word may also refer to a royal court, the original function of which was the dispensation of justice by the monarch.

Courts of law

Provision for and procedures of courts

EXO 18:25–18:26; ; DEU 1:15–1:17, DEU 17:9; ; RUT 4:2–4:5; ; 1CH 26:29; ; 2CH 19:8–19:11

Justice dispensed by the court

DEU 25:1 See also JOB 11:10; AMO 5:15; ZEC 8:16–8:17

Disputes settled in court

JDG 4:4–4:5 See also EXO 21:22; JOB 5:4, JOB 9:32–9:35; PRO 25:7–25:8, PRO 29:9; MAT 5:25–5:26 parallel LUK 12:58–12:59; ACT 18:12–18:17, ACT 19:38–19:39, ACT 25:1–26:27

Provision for a court of appeal

DEU 17:8–17:13

Corruption in the court

PRO 22:22–22:23 See also EXO 23:1–23:3, EXO 23:6–23:8; JOB 31:21–31:22; ISA 29:20–29:21; AMO 5:7–5:15; JAS 2:6

The divine lawcourt

DAN 7:9–7:10 See also ISA 3:13–3:17; DAN 7:23–7:27; 1CO 4:2–4:5

Royal courts

Egyptian

GEN 50:4–50:7

Israelite

JER 29:2 See also 1KI 3:15; JER 34:19–34:20, JER 41:16

Babylonian

DAN 2:48–2:49 See also DAN 1:3–1:5

Persian

EST 4:11 See also EST 5:1–5:2

The divine courts

PSA 84:10 See also PSA 65:4, PSA 84:1–84:2, PSA 92:12–92:13, PSA 96:8, PSA 100:4

5271: courtyard

An enclosed, uncovered area within the precincts of large buildings such as temples, palaces and houses. The wilderness tabernacle also incorporated a courtyard.

The courtyard of the tabernacle

EXO 27:9–27:19 See also EXO 38:9–38:20

The courtyard of the temple

1KI 7:12 See also 1KI 8:64 parallel 2CH 7:7; 2CH 4:9, 2CH 23:5, 2CH 24:21; JER 26:2, JER 36:10; EZK 40:14

Courtyards of palaces

EST 2:11 See also JER 32:2, JER 39:15

Courtyards of private houses

NEH 8:16 See also 2SA 17:18; MAT 26:69 parallels MRK 14:66, LUK 22:55; JHN 18:15

5272: craftsmen

Skilled workers and artisans. God is sometimes compared to a master craftsman in his work of creation. Scripture also identifies God as the giver of talent and ability to certain individuals, in particular those employed in the construction of the tabernacle and the temple.

God the Creator seen as a master craftsman

PRO 3:19–3:20 See also GEN 1:1–1:31; JOB 38:4–38:38 inanimate creation; JOB 38:39–39:30 animate creation; PRO 8:22–8:31

Craftsmen employed in the construction of the tabernacle and its furnishings

EXO 31:1–31:11 See also EXO 26:1, EXO 26:31, EXO 28:6–28:8, EXO 28:15, EXO 35:30–36:3, EXO 36:8–38:11, EXO 39:1–39:3

Craftsmen employed in the construction of the temple and its furnishings

1KI 7:13–7:45 parallels 2CH 4:2–4:6, 2CH 4:10–4:16 See also 1KI 5:17–5:18; 1CH 22:14–22:16, 1CH 29:3–29:5; 2CH 2:5–2:7, 2CH 2:13–2:14

Craftsmen employed in the manufacture of idols

ISA 40:19–40:20 See also ISA 41:5–41:7, ISA 44:9–44:20; JER 10:3–10:10; HOS 8:4–8:6, HOS 13:2; ACT 19:23–19:41

Carpenters

2SA 5:11 parallel 1CH 14:1 See also 2CH 24:12; ISA 44:13; EZK 27:9; MAT 13:55 parallel MRK 6:3

Gem cutters

EXO 28:11

Masons

2CH 24:12 See also 1CH 22:14–22:16; EZR 3:7

Goldsmiths

ISA 46:6 See also NEH 3:31–3:32; JER 51:17

Silversmiths

PRO 25:4 See also JDG 17:4; ACT 19:24

Potters

ROM 9:21 See also 1CH 4:23; ISA 64:8; JER 18:2–18:4

Weavers and embroiderers

Skilled craftsmen

EXO 35:35 See also EXO 26:1, EXO 26:31, EXO 28:6, EXO 28:15, EXO 39:22, EXO 39:27; ISA 19:9–19:10, ISA 38:12

A weaver's shuttle

JOB 7:6

A weaver's rod

1CH 20:5 See also 1SA 17:7; 2SA 21:19; 1CH 11:23

Craftsmen taken into exile

2KI 24:10–24:17 See also ISA 3:1–3:3; JER 24:1, JER 29:2, JER 52:12–52:16

Craftsmen in place-names

1CH 4:14 See also NEH 11:31–11:35

Metaphorical references to craftsmen

PRO 8:22–8:31 See also ISA 41:25, ISA 64:8; JER 18:6; ZEC 1:20–1:21; 1CO 3:10

5273: creativity

Imagination and skill used in the expression of visual or performing arts. Human creativity has its source in God, but may be used either to his honour or dishonour.

God's creativity

ISA 64:8 See also JOB 38:1–38:41; PSA 139:13–139:16; ECC 3:11; ISA 45:7–45:12, ISA 45:18; EPH 2:10 Redemption may be described in terms of re-creation.

God is the source of human creativity

EXO 35:30–35:35 See also EXO 31:1–31:6, EXO 36:1–36:2

Creativity for its own sake

ECC 2:4–2:6

Creativity used in the service of God

Building the tabernacle and temple

EXO 36:8 See also 1CH 22:15–22:16; 2CH 2:5–2:7, 2CH 2:13–2:14

Music and dancing

PSA 149:3 See also 1CH 6:31–6:32, 1CH 25:1–25:7; PSA 92:1–92:3, PSA 98:5, PSA 144:9

The abuse of human creativity

HAB 2:18 Human creativity, like all of God's gifts, can be abused by sinful human beings, and used to dishonour him rather than serve him. See also DEU 27:15; 2KI 19:18; ISA 40:19–40:20, ISA 44:10–44:13; ACT 19:23–19:26

5274: credit

Money or goods lent under pledge of repayment (with or without interest). In the spiritual sense, Jesus Christ's righteousness is credited to believers.

Credit in Israel: charitable, not commercial

DEU 23:19–23:20 See also EXO 22:25; PSA 15:5; EZK 18:7, EZK 18:16–18:17

The pledge (security): laws protecting the borrower

DEU 24:10–24:13 See also EXO 22:26–22:27; LEV 25:39–25:40, LEV 25:42; DEU 24:6

Standing security for another may be hazardous

PRO 22:26–22:27 See also PRO 6:1–6:5, PRO 11:15, PRO 17:18 The binding nature of the commitment cautions against a hasty and unwise engagement.

Violations of Israel's ``credit controls'' roundly condemned

NEH 5:1-5:12; ; JOB 22:6, JOB 24:3, JOB 24:9; ; EZK 18:12; ; AMO 2:8

The credit system not condemned by Jesus Christ

MAT 25:27 parallel LUK 19:23

Christians to view this subject in the light of God's grace

LUK 6:34-6:35 See also MAT 18:23-18:27 God is a model creditor.

Creditors demanding a pledge to assure repayment

A personal effect

DEU 24:6, DEU 24:10-24:13; ; JOB 24:3; ; PRO 22:26-22:27

Mortgage of property

NEH 5:3

The surety of a guarantor

PRO 6:1-6:5, PRO 11:15, PRO 17:18, PRO 22:26, PRO 27:13

Creditors exacting repayments cruelly

2KI 4:1 See also JOB 22:6, JOB 24:3, JOB 24:9; PSA 109:11; ISA 50:1; EZK 18:12-18:13, EZK 22:12; AMO 2:6, AMO 2:8; MAT 5:25-5:26, MAT 18:25-18:26, MAT 18:34

Creditors to be considerate in their demands

DEU 24:6 See also EXO 22:26-22:27; LEV 25:35-25:43; DEU 24:10-24:13

Creditors perhaps remitting the debt entirely

MAT 18:27 See also NEH 5:10-5:12; MAT 6:12; LUK 7:41-7:43

Under Mosaic law creditors to cancel debts eventually

DEU 15:1-15:3 See also DEU 31:10; NEH 10:31

Spiritual aspects of credit

Faith credited as righteousness

ROM 4:1-4:11 See also GEN 15:6; PSA 32:2, PSA 106:31; EZK 18:20; ROM 4:22-4:24; JAS 2:23

Jesus Christ's righteousness credited to believers

2CO 5:21 See also ROM 3:22; 1CO 1:30; PHP 3:9

Moral aspects of credit

PHP 4:17 See also MAT 10:40-10:42, MAT 25:34-25:36; LUK 6:32-6:35; 2CO 5:10; EPH 6:7-6:8 Good deeds will be remembered and rewarded in heaven.

5275: cremation

The burning of a dead body. Cremation was not practised by Israel or the first Christians. In difficult circumstances a corpse might be burnt and the remains buried

Cremation of corpses

1SA 31:12-31:13 This was done to prevent any further abuse of the bodies by the Philistines. David later reburied the remains in a family grave (see 2Sa 21:12-14).

Burning a body as a punishment

See also LEV 20:14, LEV 21:9; JOS 7:15, JOS 7:25; 2KI 23:20

Funeral fires for the kings of Judah

These were not for the purpose of cremating the king's corpse, but public demonstrations in his honour: 2CH 16:14; ; JER 34:5

5276: crime

An offence against the established laws of society including murder, adultery, theft, perjury and treason. Scripture contains both warnings and teaching to help young people avoid a life of crime.

Crime in Israel

DEU 6:1-6:2 Crime in Israel was the breaking of laws given by God.

Examples of crimes covered by Israel's laws

See also EXO 20:13 murder; EXO 20:14 adultery; EXO 20:15 theft; EXO 20:16 perjury; JOS 1:16-1:18; 2SA 15:7-15:10; 1KI 16:15-16:18; 2KI 11:1-11:3 parallel 2CH 22:10-22:12

Examples of crime in the NT

Murder

MAT 2:16; ; ACT 7:58

Adultery

JHN 8:3-8:4; ; 1CO 5:1

Theft

JHN 12:6

Perjury

MAT 26:59-26:60 parallel MRK 14:55-14:56; ; ACT 6:13, ACT 25:7

Scripture warns young people that temptation may lead to crime

Violence

PRO 1:10-1:19

Sexual immorality

PRO 5:1–5:23, PRO 6:20–6:29, PRO 7:6–7:27

Scripture teaches parents to discipline their children

PRO 13:24, PRO 19:18, PRO 22:6, PRO 22:15, PRO 23:13

5277: criminals

Individuals who are guilty of crimes such as murder, adultery, theft, perjury or treason. Scripture refers to and gives examples of young law-breakers (delinquents).

Criminals guilty of murder

Cain

GEN 4:8

Abimelech

See also JDG 9:5

Doeg the Edomite

1SA 22:18

David

2SA 11:14–11:17

Absalom

2SA 13:23–13:29

Herod the Great

MAT 2:16

Barabbas

MRK 15:7 parallel LUK 23:19

Criminals guilty of adultery

David

2SA 11:2–11:5

Gomer (Hosea's wife)

See also HOS 3:1

Criminals guilty of theft

Rachel

GEN 31:19, GEN 31:30

Achan

JOS 7:21

Judas Iscariot

JHN 12:6

Criminals guilty of perjury

Joel and Abijah (sons of Samuel)

1SA 8:3

Two who gave false evidence against Naboth

1KI 21:13

Examples of criminals guilty of treason

Zimri

1KI 16:15–16:18

Athaliah

2KI 11:1–11:3 parallel 2CH 22:10–22:12

Examples of delinquents

Those who break the fifth commandment as minors may have been treated as criminals

EXO 20:12

Manasseh, king of Judah

2KI 21:1–21:2

Youths who jeered Elisha

2KI 2:23–2:24

Those who ignore the wise counsel of Solomon

PRO 1:1–1:4 It seems that sections of Proverbs were written with young people in mind. Those who choose to act upon its wisdom will please God and keep themselves out of the troubles common to youth.

Those who succumb to the evil desires of youth

See also 2TI 2:22 Young people are warned that the strength of their desires can easily get them into trouble. Young Christians are, with God's help, able to control such desires.

The punishment of criminals

By hanging

DEU 21:22–21:23 See also 2SA 21:9; EZR 6:11; EST 7:9–7:10

By stoning

DEU 22:23–22:24 See also LEV 20:1–20:2; JOS 7:24–7:25

By beating

DEU 25:2–25:3 See also ACT 16:20–16:23; 2CO 11:24–11:25

By confiscation of property

EZR 7:26 See also EZR 10:8

By crucifixion

LUK 23:32–23:33 parallels MAT 27:38, MRK 15:27 See also LUK 23:40–23:41

5278: cripples

People whose walk, physical or spiritual, is hindered by deformity, permanent or temporary.

Physically crippled from birth

ACT 3:2 See also ACT 14:8

Physically crippled in life

By accident

2SA 4:4 See also 2SA 9:3, 2SA 9:13

By God

GEN 32:24–32:25 God had a purpose in the crippling of Jacob: it was a mark of his meeting with God. See also GEN 32:31–32:32; HEB 11:21

By Satan

LUK 13:11 See also LUK 13:16

Cripples healed

By Jesus Christ

LUK 7:22 parallel MAT 11:4–11:5 See also MAT 15:30–15:31; JHN 5:1–5:9

By others

ACT 3:7 See also ACT 4:9–4:10, ACT 8:7, ACT 14:9–14:10

Cripples and OT sacrifice

LEV 21:18–21:19 A man must be without defect. Physical disability is a defilement to holiness. See also LEV 21:6

Crippled animals

MAL 1:8 Animals, like people, must be holy, without defect, when brought to the LORD. See also EXO 12:5; LEV 3:1, LEV 4:3, LEV 22:18–22:25; NUM 6:14, NUM 28:3; DEU 15:21, DEU 17:1; MAL 1:13–1:14

Spiritual aspects of being crippled

Physical crippling preferable to spiritual lameness

MAT 18:8 See also MRK 5:29–5:30, MRK 9:43

Cripples disadvantaged in life but welcome in the kingdom of God

MIC 4:6–4:7 See also JER 31:8; EZK 34:16; LUK 14:13, LUK 14:21

Spiritual cripples healed

ISA 35:6 See also HEB 12:13

5279: crowds

Multitudes of people feature prominently in the narrative parts of Scripture, particularly in the Gospels and Acts. The attitudes of the crowds to Jesus Christ throw light on his ministry, as do his attitudes to them.

Crowds tend towards evil

EXO 23:2; ; PSA 64:2; ; ISA 53:6; ; JER 9:2; ; EZK 23:42; ; MRK 15:8–15:15

Crowds and worship

PSA 42:4 See also EZR 10:1

God's judgment is pronounced on crowds of people

EZK 7:11–7:14 **JOL 3:14**

Multitudes are seen by John in his vision

REV 7:9 The redeemed in heaven; **REV 17:15** Sinful people on earth.

Crowds played a large part in Jesus Christ's ministry

Gathering round him: MAT 13:2 parallels MRK 4:1, LUK 8:4; ; MRK 3:20, MRK 5:21; ; LUK 12:1; MAT 8:1; ; MRK 3:7; ; LUK 14:25; ; JHN 6:2; MRK 9:25 running to the scene of his healings; ; LUK 8:42 almost crushing him; ; LUK 3:7 coming to him to be baptised; ; MAT 15:30 bringing people to him to be healed; ; LUK 5:29 eating with him; ; JHN 12:34 questioning him; ; JHN 12:17 spreading news of him; ; JHN 7:12 whispering about him

Jesus Christ often taught crowds

MRK 2:13 See also MAT 4:25–5:2 parallel LUK 6:17–6:20; MAT 11:7 parallel LUK 7:24; MAT 13:1–13:3 parallels MRK 4:1–4:3, LUK 8:4–8:5; MAT 13:34, MAT 15:10 parallel MRK 7:14; MAT 23:1; MRK 6:34, MRK 10:1

Jesus Christ had compassion on the crowds

MAT 9:36 See also MRK 6:34

He healed them

MAT 14:14 See also MAT 19:2

He fed them

MAT 14:15–14:21 parallels MRK 6:35–6:44, LUK 9:12–9:17, JHN 6:5–6:13; ; MAT 15:32–15:38 parallel MRK 8:1–8:10

Jesus Christ's other contacts with crowds

MAT 26:55 parallel MRK 14:48 questioning them; MAT 9:23–9:25; ; MRK 2:4 parallel LUK 5:19; MAT 14:22 parallel MRK 6:45 dismissing them; ; LUK 4:30 passing through them; ; MRK 4:36 leaving them; ; JHN 5:13 slipping away from them; ; MRK 7:33 leading a man away from the crowd to heal him

Individuals mentioned in connection with a crowd

MRK 9:17 parallel LUK 9:37–9:40 the man with a demon-possessed son; ; MRK 5:21–5:34 Jairus and the woman with a haemorrhage; ; LUK 7:12 the widow with a dead son; ; LUK 19:2–19:3 Zaccheus, unable to see Jesus Christ because of the crowd; ; MRK 10:46–10:48 parallel LUK 18:35–18:39 blind Bartimaeus, rebuked by the crowd and healed by Jesus Christ; ; LUK 11:27 the woman who blessed Jesus Christ; ; JHN 5:3–5:9 the man, in the crowd of disabled people by the pool, whom Jesus Christ healed; JHN 11:42, JHN 12:17

The crowds' varied reactions to Jesus Christ's teaching

Awe, amazement, delight and faith

MAT 9:8; ; MRK 1:22, MRK 12:37; ; JHN 7:31

Accusation, confusion and questioning

JHN 7:20, JHN 12:29, JHN 12:34

Crowds played a large part in the final events of Jesus Christ's life

MAT 21:46 parallels MRK 12:12, LUK 20:19 Fear of the crowds restrained the Jewish leaders. See also MAT 21:8–21:11 Crowds demonstrated on Jesus Christ's entry into Jerusalem; MRK 15:8–15:15 The crowd, stirred up by the chief priests, asked for the release of Barabbas; MAT 27:24 Pilate washed his hands in front of the crowd; MAT 26:47 parallels MRK 14:43, LUK 22:47 A crowd came with Judas to Gethsemane.

A crowd gathered in Jerusalem at Pentecost

ACT 2:6 See also ACT 2:14

Crowds featured prominently in the ministry of the apostles

ACT 5:16 bringing the sick to be healed; ; ACT 8:6 listening to Philip's preaching in Samaria; ; ACT 13:44–13:45 listening to Paul and Barnabas in Pisidian Antioch; ; ACT 14:11–14:19 attempting to worship Paul and Barnabas in Lystra; ; ACT 16:22 attacking Paul and Silas in Philippi; ; ACT 17:5–17:13 being stirred up against Paul in Thessalonica and Berea; ; ACT 19:30–19:35 rising up against Paul in Ephesus; ; ACT 21:27–21:40 rising up against Paul in Jerusalem; ; ACT 22:22 giving Paul a limited hearing in Jerusalem

Crowds as the source of loud noise

ISA 13:4 See also DAN 10:6; REV 19:1, REV 19:6

5280: crown

An encircling ornament for the head, worn by monarchs as symbol of royal authority. Also a wreath, worn on joyful occasions or presented to the winner of a race. Used figuratively, the word indicates honour and blessing, the reward awaiting believers in heaven.

A crown as an ornament worn by monarchs

By kings

2KI 11:12 parallel 2CH 23:11 Crowns worn by the kings of Israel and Judah signified their consecration to God. See also 2SA 1:10; PSA 89:39, PSA 132:18; PRO 27:24; ZEC 9:16

By queens

EST 1:11, EST 2:17

A crown as a symbol of royal authority

2SA 12:30 parallel 1CH 20:2 See also PSA 21:3; ISA 23:8; JER 13:18; EZK 21:26; ZEC 6:11, ZEC 6:14; REV 12:3, REV 13:1, REV 19:12

A crown as a symbol of honour

EST 8:15; ; JOB 19:9, JOB 31:36; ; EZK 23:42

A crown as a wreath

Worn on joyful occasions, such as a wedding

SNG 3:11 See also PRO 4:9; ISA 61:3; EZK 16:12, EZK 23:42

A wreath of laurel leaves, worn by the winner of a race

1CO 9:25 See also 2TI 2:5

The mock crown (wreath) of thorns put on Jesus Christ's head

MAT 27:29 parallel MRK 15:17 See also JHN 19:2, JHN 19:5

Crown is used figuratively to indicate honour and blessing

ISA 62:3 See also PRO 4:9, PRO 12:4, PRO 14:24, PRO 16:31, PRO 17:6; ISA 28:5, ISA 61:3; LAM 5:16; REV 6:2, REV 9:7, REV 12:1, REV 14:14

Paul's joy and crown

1TH 2:19 See also PHP 4:1

Crown represents the honour and blessing that await believers in heaven

1CO 9:25 See also 2TI 4:8; JAS 1:12; 1PE 5:4; REV 2:10, REV 3:11, REV 4:4, REV 4:10

5281: crucifixion

A most painful, cruel and protracted form of execution which involved the victim being roped or nailed to an elevated wooden cross. This form of execution was favoured by the Romans, who regarded it as a deterrent to political rebellion against the authority of Rome at the time of Jesus Christ.

The method of crucifixion

The victim was scourged before crucifixion

JHN 19:1 parallels MAT 27:26, MRK 15:15, LUK 23:22 See also LUK 23:16

The victim carried his cross

JHN 19:17 MAT 27:32–27:33; ; MRK 15:21–15:22; ; LUK 23:26

The victim was fixed to the cross

LUK 23:33 parallels MAT 27:35, MRK 15:24, JHN 19:23 See also JHN 20:25

A charge board was fixed to the cross**MAT 27:37** parallels MRK 15:26, LUK 23:38, JHN 19:19**The victim's sufferings were protracted****MAT 27:54** parallels MRK 15:39, LUK 23:47 **JHN 19:32–19:33, JHN 19:34** See also MRK 15:25, MRK 15:33, MRK 15:37**OT prophecies concerning Jesus Christ's crucifixion****PSA 22:16–22:18** EXO 12:46; ; NUM 9:12; ; PSA 34:20; ; JHN 19:36; PSA 22:1, PSA 22:7–22:8, PSA 69:21, PSA 109:25; ; ISA 50:6, ISA 53:5, ISA 53:9; ; AMO 8:9–8:10; ; ZEC 12:10, ZEC 13:6–13:7**Jesus Christ's predictions concerning the manner of his death****JHN 12:32–12:33** See also JHN 3:14, JHN 8:28, JHN 18:31–18:32**Responsibility for the crucifixion ascribed to Jews and Gentiles alike****1CO 2:8** See also JHN 19:15; ACT 2:23**The crucifixion involved a curse****DEU 21:22–21:23** See also GEN 2:17; ACT 5:30, ACT 10:39, ACT 13:29; GAL 3:13; 1PE 2:24**The crucifixion involved shame****HEB 12:2** See also 1CO 1:23; PHP 2:8; HEB 13:13**Believers are united with Jesus Christ in his crucifixion****GAL 2:20** See also ROM 6:6**Crucifixion illustrates discipleship****MRK 8:34** parallels MAT 16:24, LUK 9:23 See also MAT 10:38; LUK 14:27; GAL 5:24, GAL 6:14**The crucifixion is remembered in glory****REV 5:6** See also REV 1:7**5282: crushing****Crushing as physically breaking in pieces****DEU 9:21** See also 2CH 34:7; JOB 39:14–39:15; ISA 27:9; DAN 2:40**Crushing in the preparation of food and drink**

LEV 2:14, LEV 2:16; ; NUM 11:8; ; JOB 24:11; ; MIC 6:15

Crushing denoting physical violence**2SA 22:38–22:39; PSA 110:5–110:6; ISA 53:5** See also LEV 22:24; DEU 23:1; JOB 6:8–6:9; ISA 3:15; AMO 2:13; MAL 1:4**Crushing used metaphorically****GEN 3:15** Widely regarded as being the earliest prediction of Jesus Christ's triumph over Satan; **PRO 18:14; 2CO 4:8** See also JOB 19:2; PRO 15:4; MAT 21:44 parallel LUK 20:18; ROM 16:20**5283: cup**

A drinking vessel, usually made of pottery but sometimes, in wealthy households especially, of gold or silver. Cups might take the form of goblets or of shallow bowls large enough for several people to share, as a sign of fellowship. The word is also used figuratively to refer to the portion of blessing or judgment divinely allotted to individuals or nations.

General references to drinking vessels**JER 35:5** See also GEN 40:11, GEN 44:2–44:5; PRO 23:31; SNG 7:2; DAN 5:2–5:3; MAT 10:42 parallel MRK 9:41**Golden goblets as a sign of wealth****1KI 10:21** parallel 2CH 9:20 See also EST 1:7**Sharing a cup as a sign of fellowship****2SA 12:3****The shared cup at the Lord's Supper****MAT 26:27** parallels MRK 14:23, LUK 22:17 See also 1CO 11:25 **1CO 10:16** See also 1CO 10:21**Cups symbolising corrupt lives****MAT 23:25–23:26** The Pharisees observed ceremonial washings but neglected the need for inward cleansing. See also LUK 11:39; REV 17:4**The cup of God's wrath****The cup drunk by the nations****JER 25:15–25:17** See also PSA 75:8; JER 51:7; ZEC 12:2–12:3; REV 14:10 **JER 49:12; LAM 4:21** **HAB 2:16; REV 16:19, REV 18:6****The cup drunk by God's people****EZK 23:32–23:34; ISA 51:17** Following judgment, God promises to restore his people. See also ISA 51:22**The cup drunk by Jesus Christ****JHN 18:11** See also MAT 20:22–20:23 parallel MRK 10:38–10:39 **MAT 26:42** The cup of God's wrath may pass from guilty humanity only if Jesus Christ drinks it. **MAT 26:39** parallels MRK 14:36, LUK 22:42**The cup of God's blessing****PSA 16:5** See also PSA 23:5, PSA 36:8, PSA 116:12–116:13

5284: cupbearer

One who served a king with wine, often having himself first tasted it for quality and as a safety measure. Some cupbearers became favourites of the king and so wielded considerable political influence.

Pharaoh's cupbearer**Imprisoned**

GEN 40:1, GEN 40:5

His dream

See also GEN 40:9–40:11

Dream interpreted by Joseph

GEN 40:12–40:14

Restored to court

GEN 40:21

Forgetful of Joseph

GEN 40:23

Remembers Joseph

GEN 41:9

Solomon's cupbearers

1KI 10:4–10:5 parallel 2CH 9:4

Artaxerxes' cupbearer, Nehemiah

NEH 1:11, NEH 2:1

5285: cures

The removing of illness or other disorder, either mental or physical. Scripture describes the curing of various diseases and conditions. It also points to humanity's area of spiritual need, its sinful condition, declaring Jesus Christ to be the only effective cure.

God's curing of illness

JOB 5:17–5:18 See also PSA 30:2, PSA 103:2–103:5, PSA 147:3; JER 33:6

Illnesses and conditions cured by Jesus Christ

MAT 11:4–11:5 parallel LUK 7:21–7:22 See also ISA 35:5–35:6

Demon-possession

MAT 15:22–15:28; ; MRK 5:1–5:20 parallel LUK 8:26–8:39

Deafness and muteness

MAT 12:22 parallel LUK 11:14; ; MRK 7:31–7:37

Paralysis and lameness

MAT 9:2–9:8 parallels MRK 2:3–2:12, LUK 5:18–5:26; ; JHN 5:1–5:14

Bleeding

MRK 5:25–5:34

Blindness

MRK 8:22–8:26; ; JHN 9:1–9:7

Leprosy

MAT 8:2–8:4 parallels MRK 1:40–1:44, LUK 5:12–5:14; ; LUK 17:11–17:19

Death itself is cured by Jesus Christ

JHN 11:1–11:44 See also MRK 5:35–5:43; LUK 7:11–7:16

Illnesses and conditions cured by the apostles

ACT 5:12–5:16 See also ACT 3:1–3:10, ACT 19:11–19:12

Illnesses cured by the grace of God

PHP 2:26–2:27 Epaphroditus, Paul's fellow-worker; ; JAS 5:15–5:16 the importance of prayer in curing illness

Illnesses cured in the name of Jesus Christ

MRK 9:39; ; ACT 3:6, ACT 3:16, ACT 4:10, ACT 4:30

Humanity's sinfulness cured by Jesus Christ**Sinfulness affects all humanity**

ROM 3:23

Prophecy of healing through Jesus Christ's death

ISA 53:5

Jesus Christ's mission to cure humanity

MAT 9:12–9:13 parallels MRK 2:17, LUK 5:31 See also LUK 19:10

5286: custom

An established way or rule (often unwritten) of behaviour, either for an individual or in a society.

Examples of the customs of individuals

1SA 27:11; ; JOB 1:5; ; MRK 10:1; ; LUK 4:16; ; ACT 17:2

Examples of group customs

1SA 2:13; ; 1KI 18:28; ; LUK 1:9; ; ACT 16:20–16:21

Examples of social customs

GEN 29:26 The older daughter is married before the younger; ; JDG 8:24 The Ishmaelites wore gold earrings; ; JDG 14:10 wedding feasts; ; RUT 4:7 exchanging sandals as symbol of closing deals; ; 1SA 20:25; 2KI 11:14; ; EST 1:13; EZK 24:17, EZK 24:22; MAT 27:15 parallels MRK 15:6, JHN 18:39 release of prisoners at Passover; LUK 2:27, LUK 2:42; JHN 19:40 burial customs; ; ACT 25:16 Roman legal customs

A custom can commemorate a particular event

JDG 11:39–11:40; ; EST 9:27

God's people are not to follow improper customs

LEV 18:30 See also LEV 20:23; 2KI 17:7–17:8, 2KI 17:19, 2KI 17:33, 2KI 17:40–17:41; EST 3:8; PSA 106:34–106:35, PSA 106:40–106:41; JER 10:2–10:3

The issue of whether or not Gentile Christians should follow Jewish customs

GAL 2:14–2:16 See also ACT 6:11–6:14, ACT 15:1–15:2, ACT 15:28–15:29, ACT 21:21, ACT 21:24, ACT 28:17; GAL 4:9–4:10; COL 2:8

5287: dance

Movement, usually in response to music, which is often a spontaneous expression of joy and delight in the Lord.

Dance as an expression of joy

EXO 15:20; PSA 30:11 See also JDG 11:34, JDG 21:21–21:23; 1SA 18:6–18:7, 1SA 21:11, 1SA 29:5; ECC 3:4; SNG 6:13; JER 31:4, JER 31:13; LAM 5:15; MAT 11:17 parallel LUK 7:32; MRK 6:22 The daughter of Herodias dances for Herod; LUK 15:25

Dance as an expression of praise

PSA 150:4 See also PSA 149:3; 2SA 6:14, 2SA 6:16; 1CH 15:29

Dance as an aspect of pagan worship

1KI 18:26 See also EXO 32:19

5288: dead, the

Human beings who have died. Scripture provides illustrations of the manner in which the dead are to be buried, as well as explaining the doctrines of resurrection and judgment.

Preparation of the dead for burial

Washing

ACT 9:37 A custom common to both Jews and Greeks.

Embalming

MAT 26:12 See also GEN 50:2, GEN 50:26; 2CH 16:14

Grave clothes

JHN 11:44 See also MRK 15:46 parallels MAT 27:59, JHN 19:40; JHN 20:7; ACT 5:6

Provision for the dead

Burial

GEN 49:29–49:30 It was the normal practice for the people of God to be buried. See also JOS 24:30; RUT 1:17; 1KI 11:15; ACT 8:2

Cremation

JOS 7:25 Cremation was not a Hebrew practice, except in cases of difficulty. See also 1SA 31:12; AMO 6:10

The plight of the unburied dead

PSA 79:2 To be unburied was a disgrace, a mark of judgment. See also ECC 6:3; ISA 14:19; JER 7:33, JER 16:6

Personal contact with a dead body conferred uncleanness

NUM 19:11 See also LEV 21:11; NUM 6:6

The place of the dead

Sheol and Hades

EZK 31:16 Sheol is the OT term for the place of the dead; a grave, an underworld, a pit. Hades is the NT equivalent. See also 2KI 21:26; PSA 88:3–88:4, PSA 89:48, PSA 116:3; ECC 9:10; ISA 14:9–14:10; ACT 2:31

A place of judgment

PSA 49:13–49:14 See also PSA 31:17, PSA 88:3–88:5; NAM 1:14; MAT 5:22, MAT 11:23 parallel LUK 10:15; MAT 16:18; REV 1:18, REV 20:13–20:14

A place of deliverance

PSA 139:8 See also PSA 16:10, PSA 30:3, PSA 86:13, PSA 107:20; HOS 13:14; JON 2:2; ACT 2:27

The plight of the dead outside of Christ

Physical death is the result of sin

ROM 6:23 See also GEN 2:17; EZK 18:20; ROM 1:32, ROM 5:12, ROM 8:6; JAS 1:15

Final judgment will follow resurrection

REV 21:8 The “second death” is the throwing of the lost into the lake of fire. See also MAT 10:28, MAT 25:41; 1JN 5:16–5:17; JUD 1:12

Promises to the dead in Christ

Death is but a sleep

1TH 4:13–4:14 See also JHN 11:11–11:14; 1CO 15:17–15:22, 1CO 15:51–15:53

Death has no hold on believers

JHN 8:51 See also JHN 11:25–11:26; ROM 8:38–8:39

Believers will be delivered from the second death

REV 2:11 See also REV 20:6

5289: debt

God is the Maker and sustainer of all things and therefore all creatures owe everything to him. Scripture provides guidance concerning both debt and debtors.

Everyone is in debt to God as Creator

1CO 4:7 See also DEU 8:17–8:18; 1CH 29:11–29:13; PSA 24:1–24:2; ECC 5:19; ACT 14:17, ACT 17:25; 1TI 6:17

Everyone is in debt to God as law-giver

ROM 3:19; JAS 2:10 See also DEU 27:26; PSA 49:7–49:8; MAL 3:8–3:10; LUK 7:41–7:42; GAL 3:10, GAL 5:3

Believers are in debt to God as Redeemer

He has paid their debt

GAL 3:13 See also 2CO 8:9; 1PE 1:18; REV 5:9

A sense of debt inspires devotion to God

PSA 116:12 See also LUK 7:41–7:47; ROM 8:12; 1CO 6:20

Indebtedness to God affects attitude to others

MAT 10:8 See also MAT 6:12 parallel LUK 11:4; MAT 18:21–18:35; 1JN 3:16, 1JN 4:11

Examples of people in debt

1SA 22:2; ; 2KI 4:1; ; NEH 5:4; ; MAT 5:25–5:26, MAT 18:23–18:35; ; LUK 16:1–16:8; ; ROM 4:4; ; JAS 5:4

Debts must be paid

LEV 19:13; ; 2KI 4:7; ; PSA 37:21; ; ROM 13:7–13:8

Social ills result from debt

NEH 5:3–5:5; ; JOB 24:3, JOB 24:9; ; PSA 109:11; ; EZK 18:12–18:13, EZK 22:12; ; AMO 2:6

OT laws sought to minimise debt

By commanding generous lending to the poor

EXO 22:25; ; LEV 25:35–25:36; ; DEU 15:7–15:11; ; PSA 15:5; ; PRO 19:17

By curbing exploitation of debtors

LEV 25:37–25:43; ; DEU 24:6

By cancelling debts every seventh year

DEU 15:1–15:3, DEU 31:10; ; NEH 10:31

Preventatives against needless debt

Keeping short accounts

MAT 5:25; ; ROM 13:8

Remembering the evil consequences

PRO 22:7; ; MAT 5:26

Debts to the state

Paying taxes

MAT 22:17–22:21 parallels MRK 12:14–12:17, LUK 20:22–20:25 See also ROM 13:6–13:7

Civic honour

ROM 13:7

Debts to employees

ROM 4:4 See also LEV 19:13; JAS 5:4

Debts within the church

Towards Christian workers

PHM 1:18–1:19 See also 1CO 9:7–9:12; GAL 6:6

Towards the unsaved

ROM 1:14

The indebtedness of the Gentile church towards the Jerusalem church

ROM 15:26–15:27

Debts to be cancelled

MAT 6:12 parallel LUK 11:4 See also 1CO 13:5

Debts one should never pay

ROM 12:17 See also 1PE 3:9

A debt one can never cease paying

ROM 13:8–13:10

5290: defeat

The overcoming of or being overcome by a physical, spiritual or circumstantial enemy. Those humbled before God by such a defeat eventually come to see it as a positive experience, leading to increased spiritual maturity. The way to avoid being defeated is to trust in God and to wear the spiritual armour he provides.

Defeat as the overcoming of enemies

Physical enemies such as armies

GEN 14:5–14:6 See also GEN 14:15, GEN 36:35; DEU 1:4, DEU 4:46, DEU 7:1–7:2, DEU 29:7; JOS 10:33, JOS 11:1–11:9; JDG 7:19–7:22; 1SA 7:10, 1SA 11:11, 1SA 14:48, 1SA 17:50; 2SA 2:17, 2SA 5:17–5:25 parallel 1CH 14:8–14:17; PSA 92:11; JER 37:10; ZEC 9:15; HEB 7:1, HEB 11:34

Spiritual enemies such as Satan

GEN 3:15 See also LUK 10:19; JHN 12:31, JHN 14:30; ROM 16:20; COL 2:15; 2TH 2:8; HEB 2:14; 1JN 2:13–2:14, 1JN 3:8; REV 12:11, REV 15:2, REV 17:14, REV 20:10

The world as the realm of sin

JHN 16:33 See also ROM 8:37, ROM 12:21; 1JN 4:4, 1JN 5:4–5:5; REV 2:7, REV 2:11, REV 2:17, REV 2:26, REV 3:5, REV 3:12, REV 3:21, REV 5:5, REV 21:7

Defeat as being overcome by enemies

By physical enemies

LEV 26:17 The Israelites were often defeated by their enemies as a punishment for disobeying God. See also NUM 14:41–14:43; DEU 1:42, DEU 28:25; JOS 7:4; JDG 2:15, JDG 3:12–3:14; 1SA 4:1–4:11; 1KI 8:33 parallel 2CH 6:24;

PSA 13:4, PSA 44:9–44:12, PSA 78:62; JER 19:7–19:9, JER 21:7

By spiritual enemies

JAS 1:13–1:15 See also GEN 3:6–3:22; 2SA 11:2–11:17; 1CO 6:7; 1TH 2:18, 1TH 3:5; 1TI 5:11; 2PE 2:20

By circumstances

PSA 39:10 This refers to God's chastisement through affliction; **PSA 116:3** See also PSA 32:4, PSA 38:2; 2SA 22:5–22:6 parallel PSA 18:4–18:5; 1KI 19:1–19:4; JOB 36:8–36:9; JER 23:9; DAN 10:16; LUK 8:37; ROM 12:21

Defeat as a positive experience

JAS 4:10 See also 2CH 7:14–7:15; PSA 119:67, PSA 119:71; 2CO 12:7–12:10; HEB 12:9–12:11; 1PE 5:6

Defeat can be avoided

By trusting in God

PSA 25:1–25:3 See also 2CH 13:18; PSA 22:5, PSA 31:1–31:4 parallel PSA 71:1–71:3; PSA 112:6–112:8, PSA 125:1; ISA 26:3; ROM 9:33, ROM 10:11; 1PE 2:6

By wearing the spiritual armour God provides

EPH 6:10–6:18 See also ROM 13:12; 1TH 5:8

5291: defence

A means of protection and security against the attacks of others. Scripture insists that the most reliable form of defence for believers is trust in the Lord.

5292: defence, divine

God defends his people, especially the most vulnerable. Because of God's defence, although Christians sometimes face trials and persecutions their eternal security is never threatened.

God defends his people

ISA 41:10–41:12 See also EXO 23:20, EXO 23:27; 1SA 2:9; 2KI 6:16–6:17; PSA 34:7, PSA 144:10; ISA 19:20, ISA 51:16, ISA 51:22, ISA 54:16–54:17; JER 50:34, JER 51:36; ZEC 9:8; MAT 16:18; JHN 10:28–10:29; 2TI 4:16–4:18

God defends especially the most vulnerable of his people

PSA 10:17–10:18 See also DEU 10:17–10:18; PSA 68:5, PSA 146:9; PRO 23:10–23:11

God defended the city of Jerusalem

2KI 19:32–19:34 parallel ISA 37:33–37:35 See also 2KI 20:6 parallel ISA 38:6; PSA 48:3; ISA 31:5; ZEC 2:4–2:5, ZEC 12:8

God's defence of his people is pictured in various ways

As a hiding-place

PSA 32:7 See also PSA 17:8, PSA 27:5, PSA 31:20

As a refuge

PSA 57:1 See also DEU 33:27; PSA 46:1; PRO 14:26, PRO 18:10; JOL 3:16; NAM 1:7

As a shield

PSA 115:9–115:11 See also GEN 15:1; PSA 84:11, PSA 119:114; PRO 30:5

As a combination of images

2SA 22:1–22:4 parallel PSA 18:2–18:3 See also PSA 71:3, PSA 91:1–91:4, PSA 144:1–144:2; ISA 25:4

The most reliable defence for God's people is to trust only in him

ISA 31:1 See also 2CH 16:7–16:9; PSA 20:6–20:8, PSA 37:16–37:19, PSA 125:1–125:2; ISA 17:7–17:8; DAN 3:16–3:18; HOS 14:3

Examples of prayers for God's defence

PSA 25:20 See also 2KI 19:14–19:19 parallel ISA 37:14–37:20; 2CH 20:10–20:12, 2CH 32:17, 2CH 32:20; PSA 35:23, PSA 74:22, PSA 86:2

Because of God's defence the eternal security of believers is never threatened

1PE 1:3–1:5 See also MAT 10:28–10:31 parallel LUK 12:4–12:7; JHN 10:28–10:29, JHN 17:15; ROM 8:31–8:39; 2TI 4:18; HEB 11:32–11:39; 1PE 5:8–5:10; JUD 1:24; REV 2:10, REV 7:13–7:17

5293: defence, human

God's people are to defend the needy and those in their care. They are also to defend the truth entrusted to them.

Defence of the needy

God commands his people to defend the needy

PRO 31:8–31:9 See also ISA 1:17, ISA 10:1–10:2, ISA 58:6–58:7, ISA 58:9–58:10

Examples of those who defended the needy

PSA 72:4 EXO 2:17; ; ACT 7:24; RUT 2:15–2:16 Boaz

Neglect of the cause of the needy is condemned

PSA 82:2–82:4 See also JOB 5:4; ISA 1:23–1:24, ISA 29:20–29:21; JER 5:26–5:29, JER 22:15–22:17

Church leaders are to defend the flock of God

ACT 20:28–20:31 See also JHN 21:15–21:17; 1TI 4:6; TIT 1:10–1:11; HEB 13:17; 1PE 5:2

Christians are urged to defend the faith

It is the responsibility of all believers

JUD 1:3 See also PHP 1:27–1:28; 2TH 2:15

It is the responsibility of Christian leaders in particular

2TI 1:13–1:14 See also 1TI 1:3–1:10, 1TI 6:20–6:21; TIT 1:12–1:14

Examples of leaders who defended the faith

PHP 1:16 See also ACT 6:8–6:10 Stephen; ACT 18:27–18:28 Apollos GAL 1:6–1:9, GAL 2:11–2:14; PHP 1:7

5295: destruction

The demolition or eradication of buildings, peoples or individuals. Since God is the Creator and sustainer of all things, wanton ruin is contrary to his will as his original purposes cannot be fulfilled. God will bring about the final destruction of all that is evil in the last judgment.

God disapproves of wanton destruction

Of human life

EXO 20:13 parallel DEU 5:17 See also GEN 4:8–4:12, GEN 9:5–9:6; 2SA 12:7–12:10

Of the world in general

REV 11:18 GEN 1:28, GEN 2:15; ; DEU 20:19–20:20

Of spiritual life

ROM 14:15 See also 1CO 8:9–8:11; 2TI 2:17–2:18; 2PE 2:1

Agents of destruction

Satan

JOB 1:12–1:19; ; JHN 8:44, JHN 10:10

The wicked

PSA 55:11; ; PRO 1:10–1:12; ; LUK 13:1–13:3

Nature

MAT 6:19; ; LUK 13:4–13:5

God himself brings destruction on the wicked

God decrees destruction for sinners

PSA 37:38 See also GEN 6:5–6:7; PSA 5:6, PSA 46:8; ISA 34:2; AMO 1:3–1:8, AMO 2:1–2:3; LUK 3:9; 1JN 3:8

By the forces of nature

GEN 7:4 See also GEN 19:24–19:25; DEU 28:15–28:24; PSA 48:7; EZK 5:16, EZK 13:13; LUK 17:29; REV 6:12–6:14

By means of angels

1CO 10:10 See also EXO 12:23; 2SA 24:15–24:17 parallel 1CH 21:14–21:17; 1CH 21:12; 2KI 19:35 parallels 2CH 32:21, ISA 37:36; ACT 12:23; REV 7:2–7:3

By means of human beings

DEU 7:16 See also NUM 21:3; DEU 2:34, DEU 3:6, DEU 28:47–28:48; JOS 6:21, JOS 8:26, JOS 11:20; JER 25:9

Destruction in the final judgment

2TH 1:8–1:9 See also MAL 4:1; 2TH 2:8; REV 17:8, REV 17:11, REV 18:21, REV 20:10, REV 20:14

Destruction is sudden

1TH 5:3 See also PRO 6:15, PRO 24:21–24:22, PRO 29:1; ECC 9:12; ISA 30:13, ISA 47:11; JER 15:8; 2PE 3:10

Warnings against the way of destruction

MAT 7:13 See also JOS 6:18; 1TI 6:9

God keeps his people from destruction

EXO 12:13 See also PSA 91:9–91:10; ROM 8:35–8:39

God's kingdom is indestructible

HEB 12:28 See also PSA 46:5, PSA 125:1; DAN 2:44

There will be no destruction in the world to come

ISA 11:9 See also DAN 7:27; REV 21:3–21:5, REV 22:15

5296: disabilities

Physical incapacities resulting from physical or spiritual causes.

Examples of disabilities

Barrenness

GEN 11:30, GEN 25:21; ; MAT 19:12

Blindness

MAT 12:22, MAT 15:30, MAT 20:30; ; MRK 8:22; ; JHN 9:1

Deafness

PSA 38:13; ; MRK 7:32

Muteness

PSA 38:13; ; MAT 12:22; ; LUK 11:14

Lameness

LEV 21:18; ; 2SA 5:6; ; MAT 15:31, MAT 21:14; ; ACT 14:8

Causes of disabilities

God's judgment

DEU 28:28

Accident

2SA 4:4; ; 2KI 1:2

Old age

GEN 27:1; ; 1SA 4:15; ; 2SA 19:35; ; PSA 71:9; ; ECC 12:3–12:4; ; ZEC 8:4; ; HEB 11:21

Congenital defects

MAT 19:12; ; JHN 9:1; ; ACT 14:8

Cruelty

JDG 1:6–1:7, JDG 16:21; ; 1SA 11:2; ; 2KI 25:7; ; EZK 23:25

Illness

1KI 15:23 parallel 2CH 16:12; ; GAL 4:13–4:15

Acts of God

GEN 19:11, GEN 32:25, GEN 32:31–32:32; ; LEV 26:16; ; 1KI 13:4; ; 2KI 6:18, 2KI 15:5; ; 2CH 21:18–21:19, 2CH 26:19–26:21; ; LUK 1:20; ; ACT 9:8 Saul's blindness; ; ACT 13:11, ACT 22:11

Acts of evil spirits

MAT 9:32–9:33, MAT 12:22; ; MRK 9:17, MRK 9:25–9:26; ; LUK 11:14, LUK 13:11, LUK 13:16

Unfavourable aspects of disability**Unfair advantage taken of the disabled**

LEV 19:14; ; 2SA 19:26; ; JHN 5:7

Disabilities restrict service for God

LEV 21:16–21:23; ; 2SA 19:31–19:37

Favourable aspects of disabilities**Prayer to the Lord**

GEN 25:21; ; 1SA 1:10; ; MAT 9:27, MAT 20:30; ; MRK 7:32, MRK 8:22; ; 2CO 12:8

Prevention of overconfidence

2CO 12:7

Proof of God's grace

2CO 12:9–12:10

Demonstration of God's power

JHN 9:2–9:3

Disability and God's people**God's blessing may prevent or remove disability**

GEN 25:21; ; EXO 23:25–23:26; ; PSA 113:9; ; ISA 49:21, ISA 54:1; ; LUK 1:36; ; HEB 11:11

God's providence

EXO 4:11

God protects his servants by disabling their enemies

2KI 6:18

Human attitudes to disabilities**Bitterness**

1SA 1:10

Contempt

GEN 16:4; ; 1SA 1:6; ; 2KI 2:23; ; PRO 17:5

Inertness

JHN 5:6

Rejoicing

2CO 12:9–12:10

God's compassion towards those with disabilities**Revealed in the precepts of the law**

LEV 19:14; ; DEU 27:18

Revealed in the promises of the prophets

ISA 42:16; ; JER 31:8; ; MIC 4:6–4:7; ; ZEP 3:19

Revealed in the deeds of Jesus Christ

MAT 9:27–9:33, MAT 15:29–15:31 parallel MRK 7:31–7:37; ; MAT 21:14; ; LUK 7:21–7:23

Responsibilities towards those with disabilities**To treat them with respect**

LEV 19:14

Not to take advantage of them

DEU 27:18

To provide help for them

JOB 29:15; ; PRO 31:8; ; LUK 14:13–14:14

5297: disease

An illness or other condition which prevents people or animals from achieving their full potential or adversely affects their abilities.

General and specific examples of disease**General references**

MAT 8:17; MRK 3:10 See also EXO 15:26; DEU 7:15; 2CH 16:12; JHN 5:3; ACT 28:9

Blindness

JHN 9:1

Boils and sores

EXO 9:9; ; JOB 2:7; ; ISA 38:21; ; LUK 16:20

Depression

PRO 13:12

Dropsy

See also LUK 14:2

Dysentery

ACT 28:8

Epilepsy

MAT 17:15 See also MAT 4:24; MRK 9:17–9:18

Fever

JOB 30:30 See also MAT 8:14 parallels MRK 1:30, LUK 4:38; ACT 28:8

Haemorrhaging

MAT 9:20 parallels MRK 5:25, LUK 8:43

Inflammation

DEU 28:22

Insanity

1SA 21:13; ; DAN 4:33–4:35

Leprosy

NUM 12:10; ; 2CH 26:21; ; MAT 11:5; ; LUK 17:11–17:19

Paralysis

MAT 4:24, MAT 8:6, MAT 9:2 parallels MRK 2:3, LUK 5:18; ; LUK 13:11; ; ACT 3:2, ACT 8:7, ACT 9:33

Sunstroke

2KI 4:18–4:19; ; PSA 121:5–121:6; ; ISA 49:10; ; JON 4:8

Tumours

DEU 28:27; ; 1SA 5:6

Voluntary starvation

1SA 1:7, 1SA 28:20; ; PSA 102:4, PSA 107:18

Wasting

LEV 26:16; ; DEU 28:22

Even the righteous suffer disease**JOB 2:3, JOB 2:7** See also PSA 38:2–38:3, PSA 41:7–41:8**Examples of the righteous suffering**

2KI 20:1 parallel 2CH 32:24; ; DAN 8:27; ; LUK 7:2; ; JHN 11:1; ; ACT 9:36–9:37; ; GAL 4:13; ; PHP 2:25–2:27; ; 1TI 5:23; ; 2TI 4:20

Causes of disease**JHN 9:2****Original sin****GEN 3:16–3:17****Accident**

See also 2KI 4:39–4:40

Judgment**PSA 107:17–107:18** See also EXO 9:8–9:10; LEV 26:14–26:16; NUM 16:41–16:49; 2KI 5:27; JER 14:12; 1CO 11:29–11:30**Testing****JOB 2:5****Response to sickness and disease****The compassion of God****MRK 1:32–1:34** See also PSA 41:3; MAT 8:17**Compassion**

EZE 34:4; ; MAT 25:36; ; LUK 9:2, LUK 10:30–10:37

Humble submission**JOB 13:15** See also 2CO 12:8–12:10**Prayer****JAS 5:14** See also GEN 20:17; 2CO 12:8**Spiritual disease****ISA 1:5–1:6** See also JER 8:22, JER 30:12; MIC 1:9; MAT 9:12–9:13 parallel LUK 5:31–5:32**Salvation and healing from disease****Salvation achieved through the cross of Jesus Christ**
ISA 53:4–53:5**Salvation made perfect in heaven****REV 22:1–22:3** See also EZE 47:12; REV 7:17, REV 21:1–21:4**5298: doctors**

People who are qualified in medicine and treat those who are ill. Doctors do not feature extensively in Scripture; rather God is portrayed as the source of health and healing for his people. Prophets were sometimes intermediaries in healing and priests were responsible for diagnosing certain diseases in accordance with the law. Luke, the author of the Gospel of that name and Acts, was a doctor.

God as the source of physical health and healing**EXO 15:26** See also NUM 12:10–12:15, NUM 21:4–21:9; DEU 32:39; PSA 6:2**God as the source of spiritual healing****JOB 5:18** See also ISA 53:5; JER 33:6; HOS 6:1**Jesus Christ as a healer****MAT 8:16–8:17** parallels MRK 1:32–1:34, LUK 4:40 See also ISA 53:4; MAT 4:24, MAT 14:14 parallel LUK 9:11**Prophets as intermediaries in healing**

2KI 5:1–5:14, 2KI 20:1–20:7 parallels 2CH 32:24, ISA 38:1–38:5; ; ISA 38:21

Priests in a medical role

LEV 13:1–13:46, LEV 15:1–15:33

Medical treatments mentioned in Scripture**Use of oils and emollients on wounds****ISA 1:6** See also JER 46:11**Splinting and bandaging of broken limbs****EZE 30:21****Poultices****2KI 20:7** See also ISA 38:21**Human doctors mentioned in Scripture****Their limited ability contrasted with God's power****2CH 16:12–16:13** See also JOB 13:4; MRK 5:25–5:29 parallel LUK 8:43–8:44

Non-Israelite doctors

GEN 50:2 These were Egyptian physicians. See also COL 4:14 Luke was a Greek.

Figurative use

MRK 2:17 parallels MAT 9:12, LUK 5:31 See also LUK 4:23

5299: door

A point of entry, especially to a house. The door-frame was given special significance within the law of Moses, and temple doorkeepers had a special status. Used figuratively, it relates to opportunity, and Jesus Christ used it of himself as the means of access to God.

The function of doors: gaining or barring entry

PSA 24:7 See also GEN 19:6, GEN 19:9–19:11; EXO 12:22; 2SA 13:17–13:18; 2KI 4:4–4:5 Elisha and the widow's oil; NEH 13:19; PSA 24:9; PRO 5:8 warning against adultery; MAT 6:6 Jesus Christ advocates secret prayer; MRK 1:33; LUK 11:7; JHN 18:15–18:16; ACT 5:19; REV 3:8

The status and role of temple doorkeepers

PSA 84:10 See also 2KI 25:18 parallel JER 52:24; 1CH 15:23–15:24; 2CH 23:19, 2CH 34:13

The door and its surroundings as a symbol of a household

EXO 12:22–12:23 See also EXO 12:7, EXO 21:6; DEU 6:9, DEU 11:20, DEU 15:16–15:17, DEU 22:21; ISA 57:8; EZK 45:19

Figurative use of opening a door**The door as a symbol of opportunity**

1CO 16:8–16:9 See also GEN 4:7; HOS 2:15; ACT 14:27; COL 4:3; REV 3:7–3:8

Opening the door as a symbol of allowing Jesus Christ into one's life

REV 3:20 See also LUK 12:35–12:36

The door opened in answer to prayer

MAT 7:7–7:8 parallel LUK 11:9–11:10

Jesus Christ as the means of access to God

JHN 10:7 "Door" is sometimes used as a synonym for "gate". See also JHN 10:9

The door is indicative of imminent arrival

MAT 24:33 parallel MRK 13:29

The door as the entry to the coming kingdom

MAT 25:10–25:12; ; LUK 13:23–13:25

5300: drowning**The Egyptians pursuing Israel drowned in the Red Sea**

HEB 11:29 See also EXO 14:21–14:28, EXO 15:1–15:5

Jonah was delivered from drowning

JON 2:2–2:7

The demon-possessed herd of pigs drowned in the Sea of Galilee

MRK 5:1–5:13 parallels MAT 8:28–8:32, LUK 8:26–8:33

Jesus Christ's disciples feared they would drown in a storm

MRK 4:35–4:41 parallels MAT 8:23–8:27, LUK 8:22–8:25

Drowning in the teaching of Jesus Christ

MAT 18:6

Metaphorical use

JOB 10:15

5301: dyeing**Dyeing cloth or animal skin**

EXO 26:14 See also EXO 25:5, EXO 35:7, EXO 35:23, EXO 36:19, EXO 39:34

5302: education

The imparting of spiritual, intellectual, moral and social instruction, the basis for which is the fear of the LORD. People continue learning throughout the whole of life. The education of children in the OT was centred on the home and synagogue and was largely of a religious and ethical nature. In the NT, children were included in the community of the church, but the home was still the main sphere of their education.

The fear of the LORD is the basis for all education

PSA 111:10 See also 2CH 26:5; PSA 25:12; PRO 1:7, PRO 2:1–2:8, PRO 9:10, PRO 15:33; ISA 11:1–11:3

Faith is an essential element of Christian education

HEB 11:3 See also 2TI 3:15

Education should not oppose the truth about God

2CO 10:5 See also MAT 18:6; 1TI 6:20–6:21

Education should emphasise that the world has a richness and coherence derived from God

PSA 24:1; JHN 1:3 See also JOB 12:7–12:10; PSA 104:5–104:26; 1CO 10:26; COL 1:17; HEB 1:3

Education in the home

Through parental instruction

DEU 6:4–6:9; PSA 78:4–78:6 See also DEU 4:9–4:10, DEU 6:20–6:25, DEU 11:18–11:21; PRO 22:6; ISA 38:19; EPH 6:4; COL 3:21

Examples of parents teaching their children

GEN 18:19; ; PRO 31:1–31:9; ; 2TI 3:14–3:15

Through parental example

2TI 1:5 See also 2CH 20:31–20:32, 2CH 26:3–26:4

Through discipline

PRO 29:15 See also PRO 1:7; 2TI 4:2; TIT 1:13

Education through religious worship

JOS 8:34–8:35 See also 2CH 20:13; EZR 8:21; NEH 12:43; MAT 21:15–21:16

Education through religious festivals

DEU 31:9–31:13 See also EXO 12:24–12:27, EXO 13:6–13:8

5303: embalming

The Jewish custom of preparing a body for the grave. However, the technically correct use of the term describes the removal of the internal organs of the dead and filling the cavity with spices. This originated with the Egyptians but was not practised by the Jews. Biblical teaching concerning life after death makes embalming unnecessary.

Jacob and Joseph were embalmed in Egypt

GEN 50:2–50:3 See also GEN 50:26

Jesus Christ was embalmed

JHN 19:39–19:40 parallels MAT 27:59, MRK 15:46, LUK 23:53

Further embalming of Jesus Christ was planned

MRK 16:1 parallel LUK 24:1

5304: embroidery

Examples of embroidery

The entrance curtain to the tabernacle

EXO 26:36 See also EXO 27:16, EXO 36:37, EXO 38:18

Aaron's sash

EXO 28:39 See also EXO 39:29

Costly robes

PSA 45:14 See also EZK 16:10, EZK 16:13, EZK 16:18, EZK 26:16

An expensive sail

EZK 27:7

Embroidery was important in trade

EZK 27:16, EZK 27:24

Embroidered garments were the spoils of war

JDG 5:30

The developing human embryo is likened to God's embroidery

PSA 139:15

5305: empires

Spheres of influence of major powers in the ancient world. The most important empires to relate to the history of the people of God are those of Assyria, Babylon and Rome. Scripture stresses that the grandeur and power of such empires are temporary; only God remains.

Empires of biblical times

The Hittite empire

JOS 1:4 Canaan was still known as “the land of the Hittites” for centuries after the Hittites withdrew to the north. See also GEN 23:10, GEN 49:29–49:30, GEN 50:13; 2SA 11:3–11:24 Hittites continue to feature in the OT histories, despite the earlier withdrawal of the Hittites to Anatolia. The Hittite most commonly referred to in the OT is Uriah, husband of Bathsheba.

The Egyptian empire

GEN 12:10; ; EXO 12:40–12:41; ; DEU 6:21; ; 2CH 35:20, 2CH 36:3

The Assyrian empire

2KI 15:19–15:21, 2KI 16:7–16:18, 2KI 17:3–17:6, 2KI 17:23–17:27; ; 2CH 32:1–32:22; ; ISA 7:17–7:20, ISA 36:1–36:18; ; HOS 11:5, HOS 14:3

The Babylonian empire

EZR 5:12–5:17; ; NEH 7:6; ; EST 2:6; ; PSA 137:1; ; ISA 39:1–39:7; ; JER 20:4–20:6, JER 21:2–21:7, JER 27:6–27:22, JER 29:10

The Roman empire

ACT 16:37, ACT 18:2, ACT 19:21, ACT 22:25 Roman citizenship brought considerable privileges to those who possessed it; ; ACT 23:11, ACT 25:25, ACT 28:16

The transience of human empires

DAN 2:44 See also ISA 13:1–13:22, ISA 40:6–40:8; JER 51:37–51:40; DAN 2:31–2:45REV 14:8, REV 18:1–18:8

5306: engraving

Engraving on the high priest's equipment

EXO 28:9–28:12, EXO 28:21, EXO 28:36, EXO 39:6, EXO 39:14, EXO 39:30

Engraving in the temple**2CH 2:7** See also 1KI 7:31, 1KI 7:36; 2CH 2:14**Engraving on stone**

JOB 19:24; ; ZEC 3:9

The Ten Commandments engraved on tablets**EXO 32:15–32:16** See also 2CO 3:7–3:8**Figurative use of engraving****ISA 49:16; JER 17:1****5307: envoy**

An official representative sent on behalf of a king or government to other kings or nations. Believers are God's envoys to his world, bearing the good news of salvation on his behalf.

Envoys sent to other kings or governments

See also PSA 68:31; PRO 13:17; ISA 30:4

To continue or promote good relations

1KI 5:1 See also 2SA 10:2 parallel 1CH 19:2; 2KI 20:12–20:13 parallel ISA 39:1–39:2; ISA 30:6, ISA 57:9 in this instance with godless nations

To deceive

JOS 9:4

To ask for military help

2KI 17:4; ; EZK 17:15

To make enquiries

2CH 32:31; ; ISA 14:32

With a message to prepare for war

ISA 18:2; ; JER 49:14 parallel OBA 1:1

To negotiate for peace

ISA 33:7; ; LUK 14:32

With a message of God's judgment to the nations

JER 27:3

With a message of rebellion

LUK 19:14

Believers are God's envoys to his world

2CO 5:20 See also MAT 28:19; JHN 17:18, JHN 20:21; ROM 10:15; ISA 52:7; 2CO 2:17; EPH 6:20

5308: equality

Scripture declares that all people are equal in the sight of God, and that all are equally in need of the redemption achieved through the saving death of Jesus Christ. All believers have equal status before God, despite differences in their social standing and background.

The equality of Father and Son**Jesus Christ claims equality with God****JHN 5:18** See also JHN 10:30; MAT 11:27; JHN 17:10–17:22**The apostles treat Jesus Christ as equal with God**

2TH 2:16–2:17 See also ACT 2:38; GAL 1:3; PHP 2:6; 1TH 3:11; 1JN 5:20

The equality of all people before God**God is the maker of all people, whatever their status****PRO 22:2** See also ACT 17:26**All people have sinned, whatever their origin or status****ROM 3:22–3:24****God shows no partiality in his dealings with people**

DEU 10:17 See also JOB 31:13–31:15; ROM 2:11; EPH 6:9; 1PE 1:17

The gospel is proclaimed equally to all**ACT 10:34****All believers are one, whatever their origin, status or gender****GAL 3:28****Equality among believers**

See also 1CO 12:25; 2CO 8:13–8:14, 2CO 11:12

Believers must not give preferential treatment to the rich**JAS 2:2–2:4** See also LEV 19:15**Believers must not show favouritism****JAS 2:9** See also 1TI 5:21; JAS 2:1**5309: eunuchs**

Castrated men. In the Bible eunuchs are usually portrayed as having positions of responsibility in royal courts. Though eunuchs were excluded from certain privileges under the old covenant, they were at no disadvantage under the new.

Eunuchs as royal servants

EST 1:10–1:11 See also 2KI 20:16–20:18 parallel ISA 39:5–39:7; EST 2:1–2:3, EST 2:15, EST 4:4–4:11; JER 38:7; ACT 8:27

Eunuchs among the people of God**Exclusions of eunuchs from the assembly and the priesthood****DEU 23:1** See also LEV 21:16–21:23**Eunuchs not excluded from God's blessings if obedient****ISA 56:3–56:5**

Eunuchs could become Christians like anyone else

See also ACT 8:26–8:39 the Ethiopian eunuch

Eunuch as an image for celibacy

MAT 19:10–19:12 Jesus Christ teaches that castration is not the only legitimate reason for celibacy. Some men may be called to voluntary celibacy because of the demands of their role in the kingdom of heaven.

Paul suggests that a dogmatic demand for circumcision might lead to a demand for emasculation

See also GAL 5:12

5310: exploitation

Taking advantage of weak and vulnerable groups within society, especially financially; a practice that is prohibited in Scripture. Rather, such groups of people should be treated with special care and concern.

Exploitation is forbidden

PRO 22:23 See also JOB 22:5–22:9; PRO 23:10; ISA 5:8, ISA 59:12–59:15; EZK 45:9–45:10; MIC 2:1–2:3; ZEC 7:10

God protects those who are liable to exploitation

DEU 10:18; PSA 12:5 See also DEU 10:17; PSA 10:17–10:18, PSA 68:5; ISA 25:4

God provides for those liable to exploitation

EXO 23:10; ; DEU 14:28–14:29, DEU 26:12–26:13; ; PSA 22:26, PSA 68:10, PSA 132:15

Examples of groups of people who must not be exploited**The poor**

PRO 17:5; ; ISA 3:14–3:15; ; AMO 2:6–2:7, AMO 5:11; ; ZEC 7:10

Orphans and the fatherless

PSA 10:17; ; ISA 1:23; ; JER 5:27–5:29, JER 22:3

Widows and aliens

PSA 94:1–94:6, PSA 146:9; ; JER 22:3, JER 49:11; ; ZEC 7:10

The weak

PSA 41:1, PSA 72:13, PSA 82:3

Believers' responsibilities towards those vulnerable to exploitation**To pray for them**

PSA 82:3

To care and provide for them

JAS 1:27

Particular responsibilities towards the weak

ACT 20:35 See also 1TH 5:14

Particular responsibilities for widows

ACT 6:1–6:6; ; 1TI 5:3–5:16; ; JAS 1:27

Particular responsibilities towards orphans

JAS 1:27

Particular responsibilities towards the poor and needy

PRO 22:9 See also MAT 6:2–6:3, MAT 19:16–19:21; LUK 19:8; ACT 4:34–4:35, ACT 9:36, ACT 10:2; ROM 15:25–15:27

Examples of exploitation

2SA 23:15–23:17 David; ; MAT 23:15 the Pharisees; ; ACT 8:18–8:23 Simon Magus

5311: extortion

Literally “twisting out”; obtaining money, etc., by violence, threats or unreasonable demands.

Extortion condemned

PSA 62:10 See also ECC 7:7; ISA 10:1–10:2; EZK 22:13; 1CO 6:9–6:10

Extortioners can be saved

1CO 6:9–6:11

What God requires from extortioners**Repentance**

LUK 3:12–3:14

Restitution

See also LEV 6:4–6:5; LUK 19:8

Curses upon those who are guilty of extortion

JER 22:17–22:19 See also EZK 18:18, EZK 22:12–22:14; AMO 5:11; HAB 2:6

Blessings upon those who avoid extortion

ISA 33:15–33:16

Examples of extortion

See also 1SA 2:12–2:17 Eli's sons; 1SA 8:11–8:18 the wicked king foretold by Samuel; 1SA 13:19–13:21 the Philistines; NEH 5:1–5:5 the Jews in Nehemiah's day; EZK 22:29 Israel under the kings; MAT 18:28 the servant in the parable; MAT 23:25 the Pharisees; LUK 18:11 sinners in the eyes of the Pharisee; 1CO 5:9–5:11 some Christians before conversion

5312: feasting

Taking part in festive meals that were often a feature of Israel's celebrations of religious festivals.

Feasting on special occasions

To mark a covenant

GEN 31:54 The sacrifice and the meal were important elements in the covenant-making process. See also GEN 26:28–26:31; EXO 24:11; 1CO 11:25–11:26

Weddings

JDG 14:10 See also GEN 29:22; EST 2:18; MAT 22:2; JHN 2:1–2:10; REV 19:9

Family celebrations

GEN 21:8 See also LUK 15:23–15:24

National celebrations

1KI 1:25 See also EST 9:17

Israel's religious feasts

Passover (or the Feast of Unleavened Bread) to celebrate the exodus

EXO 23:15; ; DEU 16:1–16:3; ; LEV 23:4–23:6; ; 2CH 35:17; ; MAT 26:17; ; LUK 2:41

Pentecost, to celebrate the early harvest

EXO 34:22 Pentecost was also known in the OT as “the Feast of Weeks” or the “Feast of Harvest”. See also EXO 23:16; NUM 28:26

The Feast of Tabernacles, to celebrate the autumn harvest

EXO 23:16 See also LEV 23:34; DEU 16:13; EZR 3:4; NEH 8:14; ZEC 14:16

The Feast of Dedication, to celebrate the rededication of the temple

JHN 10:22

The Feast of Purim, to celebrate deliverance

EST 9:17 See also EST 9:22, EST 9:26

Feasting amongst God's people

NEH 8:10; ACT 2:46 See also 1KI 3:15; EST 8:17, EST 9:17; JOB 1:4

Feasting amongst the heathen

Examples of pagan feasts

1SA 30:16; ; DAN 5:1; ; MRK 6:21–6:28

Warnings and instructions to Christians regarding pagan feasts

1CO 10:27–10:28; ; 1PE 4:3–4:4

Feasting as an occasion to sin

1CO 10:7 See also EXO 32:6; 1SA 25:36; 2SA 13:28; HAB 2:15; 1CO 10:28

Feasting as an evangelistic occasion

LUK 5:29 See also MRK 2:16–2:17; LUK 15:2

Feasting defended by Jesus Christ

MAT 11:19 parallel LUK 7:34–7:35 See also MAT 9:14–9:15 parallels MRK 2:18–2:20, LUK 5:33–5:35

Feasting as a symbol of spiritual blessings

MAT 22:2 See also PRO 9:1–9:6; ISA 25:6, ISA 55:1–55:2; LUK 14:15; REV 3:20

Feasting in heaven

REV 19:9 See also MAT 8:11

5313: flogging

Physical beating inflicted as punishment.

Flogging and beating in the law

DEU 25:2–25:3 See also EXO 21:20

Justified flogging

PRO 19:25; 1PE 2:20 See also NEH 13:25; PRO 17:10, PRO 18:6, PRO 19:29; LUK 12:47–12:48

Unjustified flogging

ISA 50:6; HEB 11:36 See also EXO 5:14; PRO 17:26; JER 20:2, JER 37:15

Jesus Christ flogged

MRK 15:15 parallels MAT 27:26, JHN 19:1 See also ISA 53:5; MAT 20:19 parallels MRK 10:34, LUK 18:32

The apostles flogged

MAT 10:17; ACT 5:40 See also MAT 23:34; MRK 13:9; ACT 16:22–16:23, ACT 16:37, ACT 18:17, ACT 22:19, ACT 22:24–22:25; 2CO 6:5, 2CO 11:24–11:25

Flogging used figuratively

2SA 7:14 See also JOB 5:21; PSA 89:32; ISA 10:26, ISA 54:11

5314: flute

Early origin of the flute

GEN 4:19–4:21 Jubal was descended from Cain and was in the seventh generation after Adam.

The flute used in worship

In Israelite worship

PSA 150:1–150:6 See also 1SA 10:5; PSA 5:0; ISA 30:29

In pagan worship

DAN 3:7 See also DAN 3:5, DAN 3:10–3:11, DAN 3:15

The flute played at celebratory events

1KI 1:38–1:40 See also JOB 21:12; ISA 5:12; MAT 11:17 parallel LUK 7:32; REV 18:22

The flute used in mourning

MAT 9:23–9:24 See also JOB 30:31; JER 48:36

The flute used metaphorically by Paul

1CO 14:6–14:10

5315: fortifications

Structures erected as part of a defence policy. Fortifications protected the inhabitants and their possessions, and also guarded the trade routes. Scripture sees God as the secure fortification of his people in times of danger.

City fortifications

Fortified cities

NUM 13:28 See also NUM 32:17; DEU 3:4–3:5, DEU 28:52; JOS 14:12, JOS 19:35–19:38; 2KI 18:13; 2CH 8:5, 2CH 11:5–11:12, 2CH 11:23; NEH 9:25; ISA 36:1; JER 4:5, JER 34:7; EZK 21:20; ZEP 1:16

Walled cities

JOS 6:5 See also DEU 1:28, DEU 9:1; JOS 6:20; 1SA 31:10, 1SA 31:12; 1KI 3:1; 2CH 36:19; NEH 1:3, NEH 2:8, NEH 2:17; JER 49:27, JER 51:44; EZK 26:4

Fortification systems

Garrisons

2SA 8:6 See also 2SA 8:14, 2SA 23:14; 1CH 11:16, 1CH 18:6, 1CH 18:13; 2CH 1:14, 2CH 8:6, 2CH 9:25, 2CH 17:2

Towers

2CH 26:10 See also JDG 9:46, JDG 9:50–9:52; 2KI 9:17; 2CH 27:4

Regional outposts

1KI 9:17–9:19 parallel 2CH 8:3–8:6 See also 1SA 22:4, 1SA 23:14; 2SA 5:17, 2SA 23:14; 2CH 1:14, 2CH 9:25, 2CH 17:2, 2CH 27:3–27:4

Peoples at risk without fortifications

EZK 38:11 See also JER 49:31

God and fortresses

God as a fortress for his people

PSA 18:2 parallel 2SA 22:2–22:3 See also PSA 9:9, PSA 37:39, PSA 46:1, PSA 61:3, PSA 71:3, PSA 73:28, PSA 91:2, PSA 91:9–91:10; PRO 14:26

God warns against trusting in human fortifications

DEU 28:52 See also ISA 2:12–2:18; JER 5:17; HOS 8:14; JOL 2:7–2:9; ZEP 1:14–1:16

God's judgment against fortresses

AMO 5:9–5:10 See also ISA 17:3, ISA 25:2, ISA 25:12; LAM 2:2; HOS 10:14; AMO 1:3–2:5; MIC 5:11

5316: fortress

A secure dwelling-place, often a city, protected by walled defences. God is seen as the fortress of his people, their security and divine protector.

Fortresses were places of security

JER 4:5–4:6 See also 1SA 23:14; 2SA 5:9 parallel 1CH 11:7–11:8; 2SA 20:6, 2SA 24:7; 1KI 15:17

Examples of fortified cities

NUM 32:34–32:36 See also DEU 3:4–3:5; JOS 19:35–19:38; 2SA 5:6–5:7 parallel 1CH 11:4–11:5; 1KI 4:13, 1KI 12:25

Fortresses were symbolic of self-reliance

DEU 28:52 See also PRO 10:15; EZK 24:21; DAN 11:38–11:39

Fortresses cannot withstand the judgment of God

JER 51:53 See also ISA 2:12–2:18, ISA 17:1–17:3, ISA 25:2, ISA 25:12; JER 48:1; LAM 2:2AMO 1:4, AMO 1:7, AMO 1:10, AMO 1:12, AMO 1:14, AMO 2:2, AMO 2:5 HOS 10:13–10:14 punishment for Israel; NAM 3:12 judgment on Nineveh

God is the secure fortress of his people

PSA 9:9 See also 2SA 22:2–22:3 parallel PSA 18:2; PSA 31:2–31:3, PSA 59:9, PSA 59:16–59:17, PSA 144:2; PRO 14:26; ISA 17:10, ISA 25:4; NAM 1:7

5317: foundation

The solid base on which a secure structure may be built; used chiefly for the base of the temple. It is used figuratively of Jesus Christ and the apostles and prophets as the secure foundation on which the church is built. Obedience to the teaching of Jesus Christ is the true foundation of Christian living.

The place of foundations in building

1KI 5:17 JOS 6:26; ; 1KI 16:34; 1KI 6:37, 1KI 7:10; ; 2CH 3:3, 2CH 8:16; EZR 3:3, EZR 3:11–3:12, EZR 4:12 restoring the walls of Jerusalem; ; EZR 5:16, EZR 6:3; ; JOB 4:19; ; ISA 44:28; ; EZK 41:8; ; HAG 2:18; ; ZEC 4:9, ZEC 8:9; ; ACT 16:26

Destruction of foundations is an indication of divine judgment

LAM 4:11 See also DEU 32:22; 2SA 22:16; JER 51:25–51:26; EZK 13:14, EZK 30:4; MIC 1:6

The foundation of the church

Jesus Christ

1CO 3:11 See also ISA 28:16

The apostles and prophets

ROM 15:20; ; 1CO 3:10; ; EPH 2:19–2:20

The church as the foundation of God's truth

1TI 3:14–3:15 See also 2TI 2:19

Obedience as a secure foundation

MAT 7:24–7:27 parallel LUK 6:46–6:49 See also JOB 22:15–22:18; 1CO 3:12–3:15; 1TI 6:18–6:19

The foundation of the earth

PSA 102:25 See also 1SA 2:8; JOB 38:4; PSA 18:7, PSA 18:15, PSA 24:1–24:2, PSA 82:5; PRO 8:22–8:31; ISA 48:13, ISA 51:13, ISA 51:16; MIC 6:2; ZEC 12:1; HEB 1:10

The foundations of the city of God

HEB 11:10 See also REV 21:14, REV 21:19

Figurative use of foundation**God himself as the foundation**

ISA 33:5–33:6

The foundation of God's throne

PSA 89:14 See also PSA 97:2

The need for a firm foundation in the Christian life

MAT 7:24–7:27, MAT 16:18; ; EPH 2:19–2:22; ; HEB 6:1–6:2; ; 1PE 2:4–2:5

5318: fraud

The obtaining of goods or money by deception. Scripture condemns this practice, requiring believers to be honest in their dealings with one another.

Fraud of all kinds is forbidden

LEV 19:11 See also LEV 19:13; MRK 10:19; 1CO 6:8

The importance of integrity in public life

2KI 12:15 See also NUM 16:15; 1SA 12:4; 2SA 18:12; 1KI 13:8; 2KI 5:16

Kinds of fraud**Stealing**

EXO 20:15 parallel DEU 5:19 See also DEU 23:24; EPH 4:28; TIT 2:12; 1PE 4:15

Breach of trust

LEV 6:2; ; EZK 16:17; ; LUK 16:12

Not repaying loans

PSA 37:21

Not paying fair wages

See also GEN 31:6–31:9; JAS 5:4

Using dishonest weights or scales

LEV 19:35–19:36; PRO 20:23 See also DEU 25:13–25:16; HOS 12:7–12:8; AMO 8:5

Charging excess taxes

LUK 19:8

Moving boundary stones

PRO 23:10 See also DEU 19:14, DEU 27:17

Extortion

HAB 2:6 See also ISA 10:2; EZK 22:12; AMO 5:11; MAT 18:28

5319: fugitives

People fleeing, especially from persecution or punishment and seeking refuge. The OT makes special provision for the needs of such people.

Fugitives are those in flight**From family**

GEN 35:1 See also GEN 35:7; JDG 9:21; 2SA 13:34, 2SA 15:13–15:15

From war

2SA 24:13; OBA 1:14 See also LEV 26:36; NUM 21:29; JOS 8:20, JOS 8:22; 2SA 10:14; JER 46:22, JER 48:19; EZK 17:21, EZK 24:26

From other people

EXO 2:15; MAT 2:13 See also EXO 14:27; 1SA 22:17; 1KI 2:39, 1KI 11:40; ISA 15:5, ISA 15:9, ISA 45:20; JER 48:6, JER 48:45; MAT 24:15–24:20 parallels MRK 13:14–13:17, LUK 21:21–21:23; ACT 8:1

From vengeance

JER 50:28 See also GEN 4:14; JOB 15:22; PRO 28:17; JER 44:14, JER 48:19

Comfort for the fugitives

ISA 21:14 See also NUM 35:6; DEU 23:15; ISA 16:3–16:4

5320: funeral**Funerals were times for expressing grief**

GEN 50:10; ; ACT 9:36–9:39

Hired musicians sometimes played a funeral dirge

MAT 9:23

The funeral bier

2SA 3:31–3:32; ; LUK 7:14

Funeral fires lit in honour of worthy kings of Judah

2CH 16:14, 2CH 21:19; ; JER 34:5

Funerals often concluded with burial in a family tomb

GEN 49:29–49:31

Jesus Christ had no funeral ceremony

LUK 23:53 parallels MAT 27:59, MRK 15:46, JHN 19:40–19:42

5321: furnace

A closed fireplace made of brick or stone for domestic or industrial usage. Used figuratively, it represents God's presence, testing and judgment.

Everyday use of furnaces

As a stove or oven

NEH 3:11, NEH 12:38; ; LAM 5:10; ; DAN 3:6

As a kiln

EXO 9:8

For smelting metals

PSA 12:6; ; PRO 27:21

Figurative use of furnaces

As a symbol of God's majestic presence

GEN 15:17; ; ISA 31:9

As a symbol of affliction and testing

ISA 48:10 See also DEU 4:20; 1KI 8:51; PRO 17:3; JER 11:4

As a symbol of God's wrath

MAT 13:42 See also GEN 19:28; PSA 21:9; EZK 22:17–22:22; MAL 4:1; MAT 13:50; REV 9:2

5322: gallows

A wooden structure, sometimes a tree, used to impale or display a body after death, or for execution by hanging. Those hanged on gallows were deemed to be under God's curse.

A gallows used for impalement and display of bodies

EZR 6:11 See also JOS 8:29, JOS 10:26; 2SA 4:12

A gallows used for execution

EST 7:9–7:10 See also EST 2:23, EST 9:13

Those hanged on gallows are under God's curse

GAL 3:13 See also DEU 21:23

5323: gate

A point of entry to a walled city or walled-off area, such as the temple. It was a place where business was transacted and where justice and punishment were

dispensed. It is used figuratively of the entry to death and also of the starting-point of the Christian life.

The purpose of gates as defended points of entry

DEU 3:5 JOS 2:5, JOS 2:7, JDG 5:8; ; 1SA 23:7; ; 2CH 8:5, 2CH 14:7; ; PSA 107:16, PSA 147:13; ; ISA 22:7, ISA 45:1–45:2; JER 51:30, JER 51:58; EZK 38:11, EZK 46:9; ; HOS 11:6; ; LUK 7:12 Jesus Christ approaches Nain; ; ACT 9:24, ACT 12:10, ACT 16:13; REV 21:25, REV 22:14

Examples of gates

The gates of Jerusalem

NEH 2:13–2:15 See also 2KI 14:13 parallel 2CH 25:23; NEH 1:3, NEH 2:3, NEH 2:8NEH 3:1, NEH 3:32; JHN 5:2 NEH 3:3, NEH 3:6, NEH 3:13–3:15 the Valley Gate, Dung Gate and Fountain Gate; NEH 3:26 the Water Gate; NEH 3:28–3:29, NEH 3:31, NEH 6:1, NEH 7:3, NEH 11:19, NEH 12:39; PSA 122:2; ISA 60:11; JER 1:15

The gates of the temple

ACT 3:2 See also 2CH 23:19, 2CH 24:8, 2CH 31:2; JER 20:2; EZK 44:11; ACT 3:10

Other examples of gates

JOS 6:26 See also GEN 28:17; 1SA 17:52; 1KI 16:34; MAT 16:18; JHN 10:1–10:3; ACT 10:17

Uses of the area around the gate

A place of (sometimes false) worship

2CH 31:2 See also 2KI 23:8; PSA 9:14, PSA 118:19–118:20; EZK 46:2; ACT 14:13

A place of business

GEN 23:10–23:11 See also RUT 4:1, RUT 4:11; 2KI 7:1, 2KI 7:18; NEH 13:19–13:22

A place where decisions are made and justice dispensed

GEN 34:19–34:20 See also DEU 21:19, DEU 22:13–22:19, DEU 25:7–25:10; JOS 20:4; 2SA 15:2; 1KI 22:10; EST 2:19, EST 2:21, EST 3:2–3:3

A place of punishment, banishment and begging

DEU 17:5 See also DEU 22:23–22:24; JOS 8:29; 2KI 7:3; JER 20:2; EZK 21:15; LUK 16:20; HEB 13:12; REV 22:14–22:15

A place of counsel

PRO 1:20–1:21, PRO 8:1–8:3

Figurative use of the gate

Coming to worship

PSA 24:7–24:10, PSA 100:4

The entrance to death

ISA 38:10 See also JOB 17:16, JOB 38:17; PSA 9:13, PSA 107:18

The entrance to the Christian life**MAT 7:13–7:14** See also JHN 10:7–10:10**The entry to the heavenly city of God****REV 22:14** See also EZK 48:30–48:34; REV 21:12–21:15, REV 21:21, REV 21:25**5324: gatekeepers**

Levite temple servants, responsible for protecting the palace and the temple from those who would desecrate it or steal its treasures. City gatekeepers also existed.

The ancestry of gatekeepers**1CH 9:17–9:22** See also 1CH 26:1–26:13; EZR 2:42; NEH 7:45**The special status of gatekeepers****EZR 7:24** See also EZR 2:70; NEH 7:73, NEH 12:47, NEH 13:5**The functions of gatekeepers****1CH 9:23–9:27** See also 2CH 8:14; NEH 11:19**Examples of gatekeepers****2CH 35:15** See also 1CH 15:16–15:18, 1CH 16:37–16:38, 1CH 23:3–23:5, 1CH 26:14–26:19; NEH 10:28–10:29, NEH 10:39, NEH 12:25, NEH 12:45**City gatekeepers****2KI 7:10–7:11** See also NEH 7:1–7:3**5325: gifts**

Presents, given freely and without payment. Scripture lays considerable emphasis on salvation as a gift given by God to sinful, undeserving men and women.

Gifts given by God**His one and only Son, Jesus Christ****JHN 3:16** See also 2CO 9:14–9:15**Salvation and eternal life****ROM 6:23** See also JHN 4:10; ROM 5:12–5:17, ROM 11:25–11:32; 1PE 3:7; REV 22:17**Grace****EPH 2:8–2:9** See also 2CO 9:8–9:11, 2CO 9:14–9:15; EPH 3:7, EPH 4:7–4:8**Holy Spirit****ACT 2:38** See also LUK 11:13; ACT 1:4, ACT 8:18, ACT 10:44, ACT 11:15; HEB 6:4**Spiritual gifts****1CO 12:1–12:11** See also ROM 12:4–12:8; 1CO 1:4–1:7, 1CO 12:27–12:31, 1CO 13:2, 1CO 14:1; 1TI 4:14; 2TI 1:6; HEB 2:4; 1PE 4:10**Other gifts from God****JAS 1:17** GEN 30:20; ; ISA 1:27; JAS 1:5 wisdom; ; 1CO 7:1–7:7; ECC 3:13, ECC 5:19**Gifts given to God****PSA 68:18** See also NUM 7:3, NUM 18:9, NUM 31:52; DEU 12:11, DEU 16:16–16:17; 2CH 31:12–31:14; PSA 68:29, PSA 76:11; ISA 18:7; EZK 20:39; MAT 5:23–5:24, MAT 15:3–15:6 parallel MRK 7:9–7:13 condemnation concerning the Corban oath; LUK 21:1–21:4**Gifts given to false gods****DAN 11:38** See also EZK 20:25–20:26, EZK 20:30–20:31**Gifts given by kings****To their subjects****EST 2:18** See also 2SA 6:19 parallel 1CH 16:2–16:3; 2SA 11:8; EZK 46:16–46:17; DAN 2:6, DAN 2:48, DAN 5:13–5:17**To other kings****2KI 16:8** See also 1KI 15:18–15:19; 2KI 12:17–12:18, 2KI 20:12 parallel ISA 39:1; PSA 72:10**Gifts given to kings****2CH 17:11** See also 1SA 10:27; 1KI 10:25 parallel 2CH 9:24; 2CH 17:5, 2CH 32:23; ISA 1:23; MIC 7:3**Gifts given to the poor and needy****ACT 11:29–11:30** See also EST 9:20–9:22; PSA 112:9; ACT 10:4, ACT 24:17; 1CO 16:1–16:3; 2CO 8:16–8:21, 2CO 9:5**Gifts given by fathers****GEN 25:6** See also MAT 7:7–7:11 parallel LUK 11:9–11:13**Gifts given at marriage****1KI 9:16** See also GEN 24:53, GEN 34:11–34:12; EXO 22:16–22:17; DEU 22:28–22:29; 1SA 18:24–18:27**Gifts given to assuage anger****PRO 21:14** See also GEN 32:13–32:21, GEN 43:1–43:26; 1SA 25:4–25:35**5326: government**

God's gracious rule over the nations, particularly Israel. Also, the divinely established ruling of people by God's appointed authorities for the good of society and to prevent anarchy.

God governs the nations

PSA 22:28 See also 1CH 29:12; 2CH 20:6; PSA 9:7–9:8, PSA 47:2, PSA 47:7–47:8, PSA 66:7, PSA 67:4, PSA 103:19; DAN 4:32, DAN 4:35; 1TI 6:15

Jesus Christ also governs the nations

ISA 9:6 See also PSA 72:8–72:11, PSA 110:2; ZEC 6:13, ZEC 9:10; REV 2:27; PSA 2:9; REV 12:5, REV 19:15

The manner of God's government of Israel was unique

JDG 8:23 See also 1SA 8:7, 1SA 12:12

God governs individuals

PRO 21:1 See also PRO 16:1, PRO 16:9, PRO 19:21, PRO 20:24; JER 10:23; LAM 3:37; DAN 5:23; ACT 17:26; JAS 4:13–4:15

God has established human agencies for the government of people

ROM 13:1 See also GEN 9:5–9:6; PRO 8:15–8:16; DAN 2:37–2:38, DAN 4:17, DAN 4:32, DAN 5:21; MAT 22:17–22:21; JHN 19:11; 1TI 2:2–2:3; 1PE 2:13

Government is for the good of society

ROM 13:4 See also PSA 72:12–72:14, PSA 82:3–82:4

Government is established to prevent anarchy

ROM 13:2–13:3 See also GEN 9:6; EZR 7:26; PRO 21:15, PRO 28:2, PRO 29:4; ACT 25:11; ROM 13:4; 1PE 2:14

5327: governors

Those who ruled with an authority delegated to them by a higher ruler to whom they were responsible.

Joseph as governor of Egypt

GEN 42:6 See also GEN 41:41, GEN 41:43, GEN 41:55, GEN 45:8, GEN 45:26

Governors of Judah

Gedaliah had a short period in office

2KI 25:22–25:23 See also JER 40:7, JER 40:11, JER 41:2, JER 41:18

Sheshbazzar laid the temple foundations

EZR 5:14 See also EZR 1:8

Zerubbabel

Zerubbabel is possibly the same person as Sheshbazzar: HAG 1:1, HAG 1:14, HAG 2:2, HAG 2:21

Nehemiah rebuilt the walls of Jerusalem

NEH 5:14 See also NEH 8:9, NEH 10:1, NEH 12:26

Governors before Nehemiah

NEH 5:15

Persian governors

Tattenai

EZR 5:3 “Trans-Euphrates” (literally “beyond the river”, i.e., the Euphrates River) to the Persians included the areas of Aram, Phoenicia and Palestine. See also EZR 5:6, EZR 6:6, EZR 6:13

Other governors of Trans-Euphrates

EZR 8:36 See also NEH 2:7, NEH 2:9, NEH 3:7

Other Persian governors

EST 3:12 See also EST 8:9, EST 9:3; DAN 3:2–3:3, DAN 3:27, DAN 6:7

Satrap

Satrap was Persian provincial governor: EZR 8:36; ; EST 3:12, EST 8:9, EST 9:3; ; DAN 3:2–3:3, DAN 3:27, DAN 6:1–6:4, DAN 6:6, DAN 6:7

Other OT references to governors

JDG 9:30; ; 1KI 4:7 Solomon's twelve district governors; ; 1KI 4:19; ; 2KI 10:5, 2KI 23:8; ; 2CH 9:14; ; JER 51:23, JER 51:28, JER 51:57; ; EZK 23:6, EZK 23:12, EZK 23:23; ; MAL 1:8

Roman governors

Quirinius, governor of Syria

LUK 2:1–2:2

Pilate, governor of Judea

See also MAT 27:2, MAT 27:11, MAT 27:14, MAT 27:15, MAT 27:21, MAT 27:27, MAT 28:14; LUK 3:1, LUK 20:20; JHN 18:28

Felix, governor of Judea

ACT 23:24, ACT 23:26, ACT 23:33–23:34, ACT 24:1, ACT 24:10

Festus, governor of Judea

ACT 26:30–26:32 Festus did not understand Paul but might well have released him but for his (Paul's) appeal to Rome.

The governor of Damascus

2CO 11:32

Other NT references to governors

See also MAT 10:18; MRK 13:9 parallel LUK 21:12; 1PE 2:14

Standards of performance of governors

Some were good

GEN 41:39–41:40; ; 1KI 4:27; ; 2KI 10:1; ; EZR 5:16

Some were bad

NEH 5:14–5:15; ; ACT 24:26

5328: greeting

Spoken greetings

Formal greetings

2SA 8:9–8:10 parallel 1CH 18:9–18:10 See also GEN 14:17–14:20, GEN 47:7; 1SA 25:14; MAT 10:11–10:15, MAT 23:7 parallels MRK 12:38, LUK 20:46; LUK 11:43

Less formal greetings

EXO 18:7 See also GEN 33:4, GEN 46:29; JDG 18:15; 1SA 10:3–10:4, 1SA 13:10, 1SA 17:22, 1SA 30:21; 2KI 10:12–10:15; ISA 14:9; MAT 5:47, MAT 26:49 Judas betrays Jesus Christ; MAT 28:9; MRK 9:15; LUK 1:39–1:41 Mary visits Elizabeth; ACT 18:22, ACT 21:7, ACT 21:19

Examples of spoken greetings

RUT 2:4 See also 1SA 25:4–25:6

Written greetings

Greetings at the beginning of letters

1TH 1:1 See also EZR 4:17, EZR 5:7, EZR 7:12; ACT 15:23, ACT 23:26; ROM 1:1–1:7; 1CO 1:1–1:3; 2CO 1:1–1:2; GAL 1:1–1:5; EPH 1:1–1:2; PHP 1:1–1:2; COL 1:1–1:2; 2TH 1:1–1:2 1TI 1:1–1:2; 2TI 1:1–1:2; TIT 1:1–1:4; PHM 1:1–1:3; JAS 1:1; 1PE 1:1–1:2; 2PE 1:1–1:2; 2JN 1:1–1:3; 3JN 1:1; JUD 1:1–1:2

Greetings at the close of letters

EPH 6:23–6:24 See also ROM 16:3–16:27; 1CO 16:19–16:24; 2CO 13:12–13:14; PHP 4:21–4:23; COL 4:10–4:18; 1TH 5:25–5:28; 2TH 3:16–3:18; 2TI 4:19–4:22; TIT 3:15; PHP 1:23–1:25; HEB 13:24–13:25; 1PE 5:13–5:14; 2JN 1:12–1:13; 3JN 1:13–1:14

Messengers forbidden to greet fellow travellers

2KI 4:29 See also LUK 10:1–10:4

5329: guarantee

A pledge given that a promise will be fulfilled; a deposit or down payment making fulfilment obligatory. All God's promises are guaranteed in and through Jesus Christ.

Laws relating to guarantees

Promises must be kept

NUM 30:2 See also PSA 15:4–15:5

The poor must not be oppressed

EXO 22:26–22:27 See also DEU 24:6, DEU 24:10–24:12, DEU 24:17

Special laws relating to women

NUM 30:3–30:16

Guarantees could be written or spoken

NUM 30:2; ; EZR 10:19

Examples of guarantees

Judah's pledge to bring Benjamin back

GEN 43:8–43:9 See also GEN 44:32

The people's pledge to keep the law

2KI 23:3; ; 2CH 34:32

Other examples of guarantees

JOB 17:3 Job's need of a pledge; ; JOB 22:6 Eliphaz' accusation against Job; ; JOB 24:3 Job's complaint against the wicked; ; EST 8:8 the king's seal; ; EZK 17:18 Zedekiah's broken pledge; ; AMO 2:8 the priests taking pledges; ; MIC 7:20 God's pledge to his people; ; 1PE 3:21 Baptism understood as a pledge

God's promises are guaranteed in Jesus Christ

Jesus Christ, the guarantee of salvation for believers

HEB 7:22 See also 2CO 1:18–1:20

The Holy Spirit, the guarantee of believers' inheritance

2CO 1:21–1:22; EPH 1:13–1:14 See also 2CO 5:5

Salvation guaranteed to all who believe

ROM 4:16 See also REV 7:2–7:3, REV 9:4, REV 14:1

The oath of God is unbreakable

NUM 23:19 See also TIT 1:2; HEB 6:17–6:20

5330: guard

A watchman, sentinel or bodyguard for a king or ruler. The word is also used metaphorically.

Bodyguards for kings

1SA 22:14 See also 1SA 26:14–26:15, 1SA 28:2; 2SA 16:6, 2SA 23:23 parallel 1CH 11:25; 1KI 1:8, 1KI 1:10; 2KI 11:7–11:8; 2CH 12:11

Guards at the tomb of Jesus Christ

MAT 27:65–27:66 See also MAT 28:4

Other examples of human guards

NEH 4:9, NEH 4:23; LUK 22:4 See also GEN 37:36; 2KI 25:11 parallel JER 39:9; JER 51:12; MAT 27:54; LUK 2:8, LUK 11:21, LUK 22:52, LUK 22:63; ACT 4:1, ACT 12:4, ACT 12:6, ACT 12:10, ACT 12:19, ACT 16:23, ACT 22:20, ACT 23:35, ACT 24:23, ACT 28:16; PHP 1:13

Angelic guards

PSA 91:11–91:12 See also GEN 3:24; 1CO 4:15

The LORD guards his people himself

DEU 32:9–32:11; PSA 97:10 See also GEN 28:15; 1SA 2:9; 2SA 22:31 parallel PSA 18:30; PSA 1:6, PSA 121:3–121:8; PRO 2:7–2:8, PRO 30:5; ISA 27:3, ISA 31:5, ISA 52:12, ISA 58:8

Figurative references to guarding

Guarding one's conduct

PRO 4:23; 1TI 4:16 See also DEU 4:9; PRO 7:2, PRO 16:17, PRO 19:16; ECC 5:1; MAL 2:15–2:16; MAT 16:6, MAT 16:11–16:12; ACT 20:28; 1CO 16:13; PHP 4:7; 2PE 3:17; 2JN 1:8

Guarding one's tongue

PSA 141:3 See also PRO 13:3; JAS 3:3–3:8

Christians are to guard the gospel

2TI 1:14 See also ACT 20:30–20:31; 1TI 6:20; 2TI 4:14–4:15

Church leaders are to guard those in their care

ACT 20:28–20:31 See also HEB 13:17; 1PE 5:2

5331: hanging

Death by suspension from the neck or impaling on a pole, or the suspension of a body after execution by another means.

Suicide by hanging

2SA 17:23; ; MAT 27:5

Execution by hanging or impaling

GEN 40:18–40:22; ACT 5:30; ACT 10:39; EZR 6:11; ; EST 2:23, EST 7:9–7:10, EST 9:12–9:13

Hanging after execution

DEU 21:22; ; JOS 8:29, JOS 10:26; ; 2SA 4:12, 2SA 21:9–21:10

Anyone hung on a tree was under God's curse

DEU 21:23; ; GAL 3:13

5332: harp

Early origins of the harp

GEN 4:19–4:21 Jubal was descended from Cain and was in the seventh generation after Adam.

The harp used in worship

In joyous religious celebrations

2SA 6:2–6:5 parallel 1CH 13:6–13:8 See also 1CH 15:28; 2CH 20:27–20:28; NEH 12:27; PSA 49:4, PSA 137:1–137:4; ISA 30:32; AMO 5:23; REV 14:2–14:3

In temple worship

2CH 5:12 See also 1KI 10:12 parallel 2CH 9:11; 1CH 15:16, 1CH 15:21, 1CH 16:5, 1CH 25:1, 1CH 25:3, 1CH 25:6; 2CH 29:25

Associated with praising God

PSA 43:4 See also PSA 33:2, PSA 57:7–57:8, PSA 71:22, PSA 81:1–81:2, PSA 92:1–92:4, PSA 98:4–98:6, PSA 108:1–108:2, PSA 147:7, PSA 149:3, PSA 150:3; REV 5:8–5:10, REV 15:2–15:4

In pagan worship

DAN 3:7 See also DAN 3:5, DAN 3:10, DAN 3:15

The harp used to elicit divine inspiration

2KI 3:15–3:19 See also 1SA 10:5–10:6, 1SA 18:10

The harp used to relieve depression

1SA 16:23 See also 1SA 16:16, 1SA 19:9–19:10

The harp in secular use

In joyous celebrations

GEN 31:27 See also JOB 21:12; ISA 5:12, ISA 14:11, ISA 24:8; EZK 26:13; AMO 6:5–6:6; REV 18:22

At times of mourning

ISA 16:11 See also JOB 30:31

By prostitutes

ISA 23:16

5333: healing

The bringing about of a state of physical or spiritual health. Scripture recognises a close link between physical and spiritual health, with healing often being seen as an image of salvation in Christ.

God as the author of healing

EXO 15:26; PSA 103:2–103:3 See also LUK 5:15

General aspects of healing

Requests for healing

2KI 20:1–20:11 parallels 2CH 32:24–32:26, ISA 38:1–38:8 See also 2KI 1:2; JAS 5:14

Quarantine regulations

LEV 12:1–12:4, LEV 13:4, LEV 13:26, LEV 13:46, LEV 14:8; ; NUM 5:2, NUM 31:19; ; 2KI 15:5; ; LUK 17:12

Healing results in discipleship

MRK 10:52 See also JHN 6:2

Healing results in praise

ACT 3:8–3:9 See also MRK 2:12; JHN 9:30–9:33, JHN 9:38

Miraculous healing

By Jesus Christ

MAT 8:2–8:3; LUK 4:18 See also MAT 9:27–9:30, MAT 14:34–14:36 parallel MRK 6:53–6:56; MAT 15:21–15:28 parallel MRK 7:24–7:30; MRK 1:32–1:34 parallel LUK 4:40; LUK 6:17–6:19, LUK 8:48, LUK 9:11, LUK 17:19

Through the prophets

1KI 17:17–17:24; ; 2KI 4:29–4:37, 2KI 5:10–5:14

Through the apostles

MAT 10:1 parallel LUK 9:1–9:2; ; ACT 3:6–3:8, ACT 5:15–5:16, ACT 9:34, ACT 14:8–14:10, ACT 19:11–19:12, ACT 28:8–28:9

In the church

1CO 12:8–12:9 See also MRK 16:17–16:18; 1CO 12:28, 1CO 12:30

Healing of fever

MAT 8:15 parallels MRK 1:31, LUK 4:39; ; JHN 4:46–4:54

Healing of demon-possession

MAT 9:32–9:33, MAT 12:22; ; MRK 5:1–5:20, MRK 9:17–9:27 parallel LUK 9:38–9:43; ; ACT 16:16–16:19, ACT 19:11–19:12

Healing withheld

2CO 12:8–12:9; ; 2TI 4:20

Medical treatments to bring healing

Consulting doctors

2CH 16:12; MAT 9:12 See also JER 8:22; COL 4:14

Taking medicine

1TI 5:23

Disinfecting the house

LEV 14:41–14:42

Using splints

EZK 30:21

Using bandages and oil

ISA 1:6 See also LUK 10:34

The spiritual significance of healing

As an image of salvation

PSA 41:4, PSA 103:2–103:5, PSA 147:3; ; JER 3:22, JER 14:19, JER 17:14; ; EZK 47:12; ; HOS 6:1; ; MAL 4:2; ; MAT 8:17; ; ISA 53:4–53:5

Heaven is the place of ultimate healing

REV 21:4 See also ROM 8:18; REV 22:2

5334: health

A state of physical and spiritual well-being, which Scripture declares to be possible only through faith in Jesus Christ.

Salvation as spiritual health

The need for salvation

PSA 38:3, PSA 38:7; ; MAT 9:12–9:13; ; LUK 5:31–5:32

The promise of salvation

EXO 15:2; ; PSA 32:4–32:5, PSA 149:4; ; 1TH 5:9; ; TIT 2:11; ; 2PE 3:15; ; REV 12:10

The experience of salvation

PSA 13:5–13:6, PSA 91:16, PSA 118:14; ; ISA 12:1–12:3

The importance of health

Health is to be sought after

3JN 1:2 See also JER 8:15; JHN 5:6, JHN 5:9; 1TH 5:23

Health as a wish in greeting people

1SA 25:6; ; 2SA 20:9

Health promised by God to his people

JER 33:6

A cause for praise

MAT 15:31 See also ACT 4:9–4:12

The pursuit of health

Hygiene

DEU 23:13

Care of the body

1CO 6:18–6:20 See also PRO 4:20–4:22; ACT 27:34; ROM 6:13; 1CO 9:24–9:27; EPH 5:29; 1TI 4:7–4:8

The balance of work and rest

EXO 34:21 See also EXO 20:8–20:11

Mental health

State of the natural mind

ROM 8:6–8:7 See also COL 2:18

Mental disorder

DEU 28:28; ; 1SA 16:14–16:15; ; DAN 4:28–4:37; ; JHN 10:20; ; ACT 26:25

An anxious mind

JOB 10:1; ; JER 15:10; ; LUK 10:41, LUK 21:34, LUK 24:17

Anxiety resulting from judgment

DEU 28:65 See also DEU 28:34; ZEC 12:4; ROM 1:28

The healthy mind

PSA 42:6; PRO 12:25; ROM 12:2 See also MAT 22:37 parallels MRK 12:30, LUK 10:27; PHP 4:6–4:8; 1PE 5:7

5335: herald

One who proclaims a message or paves the way for a promised event. In Scripture both angels and human beings are employed as heralds, and on occasions even specific events may herald future happenings.

Heralds in human affairs

2KI 18:28 See also EXO 5:10; 1SA 11:7; 2SA 18:19; 1KI 21:12; 2KI 10:20, 2KI 11:12; 2CH 30:6; EST 1:19–1:22, EST 6:11; DAN 3:4; JON 3:7

To preach is to act as a herald

Pronouncing judgment

JON 3:4 See also JER 4:5, JER 46:14

Bringing good news

ISA 40:9 See also ISA 48:20, ISA 52:7–52:8; NAM 1:15

Preaching the gospel

MAT 24:14; ACT 5:42; 1TI 2:7 See also ACT 4:2, ACT 8:5 Philip proclaims the gospel; ACT 9:20, ACT 10:42 Peter at Cornelius' house; ACT 15:7, ACT 17:3, ACT 28:31 Paul preaches at Rome; 1CO 1:23; 2CO 1:19; GAL 2:2; COL 1:23; 1TI 3:16; 2TI 1:11

John the Baptist as a herald

MAT 11:10 parallels MRK 1:2, LUK 7:27 See also MAL 3:1; MAT 3:1–3:3; ISA 40:3; LUK 1:17, LUK 1:76; JHN 1:15, JHN 3:28

Angels as heralds

LUK 2:10 See also JDG 6:12; MAT 1:20–1:21, MAT 28:5–28:6 parallels MRK 16:5–16:6, LUK 24:4–24:6; LUK 1:13, LUK 1:30–1:31, LUK 2:13–2:14; REV 14:6

Events heralding what is to happen

MAT 24:32–24:33 parallels MRK 13:28–13:29, LUK 21:29–21:31; ; 2TH 2:3

Jesus Christ as a herald

LUK 4:43 parallel MRK 1:38 See also MAT 4:17 parallels MRK 1:14–1:15, LUK 4:18–4:19; ISA 61:1–61:2; LUK 8:1

5336: highway

A major road through Edom and Moab

NUM 20:17 Moses to the king of Edom. See also NUM 20:19, NUM 21:22 parallel DEU 2:27; NUM 21:33 parallel DEU 3:1; DEU 2:8

Main roads deserted in time of trouble and war

ISA 33:8

Highways for the large-scale movement of people

ISA 19:23 Isaiah prophesies the future harmony that will exist between former enemies, who will then worship the LORD together. See also ISA 11:16, ISA 35:8–35:10, ISA 49:11, ISA 62:10; JER 31:21

The ``highway for our God''

ISA 40:3–40:4 Isaiah foresees how God will bring his people home from exile in Babylon. See also MRK 1:2–1:4 parallels MAT 2:1–2:3, LUK 3:2–3:6 John the Baptist's call to repentance is seen as the necessary preparation for the coming of the Messiah.

Used metaphorically

PRO 15:19 See also PRO 7:27, PRO 16:17

5337: hiring

Laws relating to hiring

Hired workers must be paid on time

LEV 19:13 See also DEU 24:14–24:15; JAS 5:4

Regular rates of pay must be established

LEV 25:50

Hired workers are to be treated with kindness

LEV 25:6, LEV 25:39–25:40, LEV 25:53

Hired foreigners were excluded from the Passover

EXO 12:43–12:45

Hired workers must be carefully chosen

PRO 26:10

Loss of a hired animal is covered by the price

EXO 22:15

Various kinds of hiring

A hired husband

GEN 30:16

A hired prophet

DEU 23:4 See also NEH 6:12–6:13, NEH 13:2; JUD 1:11

A hired priest

JDG 17:10, JDG 18:4

Hired soldiers

JDG 9:4; ; 2SA 10:6; ; 2KI 7:6; ; 1CH 19:6–19:7; ; 2CH 25:6; ; JER 46:21 No hired mercenary army was ever approved by the LORD (see 2Ch 25:7–10).

Other hirings

1SA 2:5 hirings for food; ; 2CH 24:12 masons and carpenters; ; EZR 4:5 counsellors; ; ISA 7:20 a razor, symbolising the judgment to be brought by the king of Assyria; ; ISA 23:17 prostitutes; ; ISA 46:6 goldsmiths; ; MRK 1:20 fishermen

Teachings illustrated by hired workers

The brevity and hardness of life

JOB 7:1–7:3 See also JOB 14:6

Christian workers

MAT 20:1–20:15 This parable teaches that believers should not serve in a mercenary spirit but recognise that God's reward is based upon grace.

The severity of the world and the kindness of God

See also LUK 15:15–15:19

The difference between hired and good shepherds

JHN 10:11–10:13 See also 1PE 5:2

5338: holiday

A day or period of time during which regular work is suspended. In Israel, the Sabbath provided a weekly break from everyday labour, giving opportunity for rest and religious assembly, and was the pattern for set days of rest and annual festivals. The NT records events in the life of Jesus Christ which are marked by Christian holidays.

The Sabbath day

GEN 2:2–2:3 See also EXO 31:13–31:17 Their observance of the Sabbath marked Israel out as the distinctive people of God; JER 17:24; MRK 2:27; HEB 4:4

The purpose of holidays

For rest and refreshment

EXO 23:12 The Sabbath provided a rest period each week. See also EXO 20:8–20:11 parallel DEU 5:12–5:14; EXO 34:21

To restore society

LEV 25:2–25:5 The sabbath year allowed the land to be rested; ; LEV 25:10 The restoration of family property in the Year of Jubilee; ; DEU 15:12 The sabbath year marked the release of Hebrew slaves.

To assemble for worship

LEV 23:3 Release from the ties of everyday labour gives opportunity for the people of God to meet together in worship; **NUM 29:12** See also LEV 23:27 parallel NUM 29:7; DEU 16:8; ISA 1:13 **PSA 42:4** See also PSA 68:24–68:27, PSA 118:27

To recall God's deliverance

DEU 5:15 See also DEU 16:3, DEU 16:12; HEB 4:11

Israel's seven annual holidays

EXO 12:16 parallel LEV 23:7–23:8 the first and seventh days of the Feast of Unleavened Bread; ; LEV 23:21 parallel NUM 28:26 the day of firstfruits (Pentecost); ; LEV 23:24–23:25 parallel NUM 29:1 the Feast of Trumpets; ; LEV 23:28–23:32 parallel LEV 16:29–16:31 the Day of Atonement; ; LEV 23:34–23:36 the first and eighth days of the Feast of Tabernacles

Christian holidays linked with the life of Jesus Christ

The Lord's Day

ACT 20:7 See also MRK 16:9 The church meets together on the first day of the week: the day of Jesus Christ's resurrection; 1CO 16:2; REV 1:10

Christmas Day

LUK 2:7 See also JHN 1:14

Epiphany

MAT 2:1–2:2, MAT 2:9–2:11

Lent

MAT 4:1–4:2 parallels MRK 1:12–1:13, LUK 4:1–4:2

Good Friday

MAT 27:45–27:50 parallels MRK 15:33–15:37, LUK 23:44–23:46; ; JHN 19:28–19:30

Easter Sunday

MRK 16:5–16:6 parallels MAT 28:5–28:6, LUK 24:4–24:6

Ascension Day

See also LUK 24:50–24:51; ACT 1:9

Pentecost (Whit Sunday)

ACT 2:1–2:4

5339: home

The place of origin or residence, to which people feel attached and where they belong. The term is used of houses, towns, lands and in various figurative and spiritual senses.

Divine blessing upon homes

It brings peace and security

ISA 32:18 See also 2KI 13:5; PSA 127:1–127:2

It is promised to the righteous

PRO 3:33 See also PRO 12:7, PRO 14:11, PRO 15:6, PRO 24:3–24:4

It is granted because of a godly presence

2SA 6:11 parallel 1CH 13:14 See also GEN 30:27–30:30, GEN 39:4–39:5

Human affection for homes

2SA 19:37 See also GEN 31:30; NUM 10:29–10:30; RUT 1:6–1:18 Ruth's loyalty to Naomi is stronger than her attachment to her homeland; 1SA 7:17; JOB 29:18; PSA 102:13–102:14, PSA 137:1–137:6

Instructions for home life

DEU 6:6–6:9, DEU 20:5–20:8, DEU 24:5; ; EPH 6:1–6:4; ; COL 3:18–4:1; ; 1TI 5:4, 1TI 5:8, 1TI 5:11–5:14; ; TIT 2:4–2:5

Homes as places of hospitality

GEN 29:13–29:14; ; JDG 19:18–19:21; ; 2KI 4:8–4:10; ; JHN 19:25–19:27; ; PHM 1:22; ; HEB 13:2

Israel's home in Canaan

It is promised to them

2SA 7:10–7:11 parallel 1CH 17:9–17:10 See also EXO 6:8; NUM 14:30; PSA 78:55

It was taken from them

2KI 17:22–17:23, 2KI 25:21 See also 2KI 17:5–17:6, 2KI 18:10–18:11; 2CH 36:20–36:21; PSA 79:6–79:7; JOL 3:6

It was restored to them

ZEP 3:20 See also EZK 36:8

Homes for animals

JOB 39:5–39:6; ; PSA 84:3, PSA 104:17–104:18; ; PRO 30:26–30:28

Homes in Jesus Christ's ministry

LUK 9:58 Jesus Christ had no permanent home.; LUK 10:38–10:42, LUK 14:1; MRK 5:18–5:20 parallel LUK 8:38–8:39 The healed demoniac is sent back to his home town and family to be a witness.; MAT 10:11–10:14 parallels MRK 6:10–6:11, LUK 9:4–9:5; ; LUK 10:5–10:7; MAT 19:29 parallels MRK 10:29–10:30, LUK 18:29–18:30

Homelessness

1CO 4:11 Paul had no permanent home; ; JOB 24:1–24:12 the suffering of the homeless; ; HEB 11:8–11:10 People of faith do not see this world as their final home.

Home in a spiritual and figurative sense

JHN 14:2, JHN 14:23 See also JOB 17:13–17:15; ECC 12:5; LUK 16:9; 2CO 5:1–5:10; 2PE 3:13

5340: house

The place where someone lives. Its extended use includes a household and dynasty and its figurative use includes the house of God and heaven.

The construction of houses**Foundations**

1KI 5:17; ; EZR 6:3–6:4; ; JER 51:26; ; EZK 41:8

Building materials

GEN 11:3–11:4; ; EXO 1:11–1:14; ; LEV 14:40–14:45; ; 1KI 5:18, 1KI 7:9–7:12; ; SNG 1:17; ; ISA 9:10

Rooms and decoration

GEN 43:30; ; JDG 3:20, JDG 3:23–3:25; ; 1KI 7:6 Solomon's palace; ; 1KI 17:19 Elijah stays with the widow at Zarephath; ; 1KI 22:25; ; 2KI 1:2, 2KI 4:10 Elisha's room at the Shunammite's house; ; NEH 8:16; ; JER 22:14; ; EZK 8:10; ; DAN 5:5; ; AMO 3:15; ; ACT 20:8–20:9

Roofs

JOS 2:6; ; 1SA 9:25–9:26; ; MRK 2:4 parallel LUK 5:19

Regulations regarding houses

LEV 14:33–14:53, LEV 25:29–25:34, LEV 27:14–27:15; ; DEU 22:8

Various uses for houses**House arrest**

JER 37:15 See also GEN 40:2–40:3; 2SA 20:3; ACT 28:16, ACT 28:30–28:31

Church gatherings

COL 4:15 See also ACT 1:13–1:14, ACT 2:1–2:2, ACT 5:42, ACT 12:12; ROM 16:5; 1CO 16:19; PHM 1:1–1:2

Parables and proverbs about houses

PRO 21:20 See also PRO 9:1–9:4 the house of wisdom; PRO 9:13–9:18 the house of folly; PRO 14:1, PRO 17:13, PRO 21:9, PRO 24:27, PRO 25:17; ECC 10:18; SNG 8:7; MAT 12:29 parallels MRK 3:27, LUK 11:21–11:22 plundering the strong man's house; MAT 12:43–12:45 parallel LUK 11:24–11:26 the return of evil spirits to an unoccupied house; MAT 13:52, MAT 24:42–24:51 parallel LUK 12:39–12:46

The house of God**God's heavenly dwelling**

ISA 66:1–66:2 See also 1KI 8:30 parallel 2CH 6:21; 1KI 8:39 parallel 2CH 6:30; 1KI 8:43 parallel 2CH 6:33; 1KI 8:49–8:50 parallel 2CH 6:39; ISA 57:15; JHN 14:2

The earthly tabernacle and temple

EXO 25:8 See also EXO 15:17, EXO 29:44–29:46 the Tent of Meeting; DEU 12:5, DEU 12:11; 2SA 7:1–7:7 parallel 1CH 17:1–17:6 David's desire to build a permanent house for God to dwell in; EZR 5:13–5:16; PSA 23:6, PSA 26:8, PSA 27:4, PSA 84:1–84:4, PSA 84:10; HAG 1:2–1:3, HAG 1:8–1:9, HAG 1:14

The household**Household affairs**

2SA 17:23 See also 2KI 20:1 parallel ISA 38:1; PRO 31:21, PRO 31:27; 1TI 3:4–3:5, 1TI 3:12

Examples of how God relates to households

GEN 17:12–17:14, GEN 17:23–17:27; ; LEV 16:6, LEV 16:11, LEV 16:17; ; NUM 16:31–16:33; ; JHN 4:53; ; ACT 16:15, ACT 16:31–16:34; ; 1CO 16:15

The church as God's household

EPH 2:19–2:22 See also NUM 12:7; 1TI 3:14–3:15; HEB 3:1–3:6; 1PE 2:4–2:5

House in the sense of a dynasty

2SA 7:16 parallel 1CH 17:14 “house” is used here in the sense of “royal house” or “dynasty”. See also EXO 40:38; JOS 21:43–21:45 1SA 2:27–2:36, 1SA 3:11–3:14 2SA 3:1, 2SA 9:1 2SA 3:28–3:29 2SA 7:25–7:29 parallel 1CH 17:23–17:27; 1KI 2:31–2:33 1KI 21:21–21:22, 1KI 21:28–21:29; ZEC 12:10–12:14

5341: hunger

A state of emptiness, reflecting a lack of physical or spiritual food. Scripture recognises the physical aspects of human hunger which can only be met by the living God.

Kinds of hunger

Physical

DEU 8:3

Spiritual

MAT 5:6 See also PSA 63:1, PSA 63:5, PSA 107:9; AMO 8:11; LUK 6:21; JHN 6:35; 1PE 2:2

Causes of hunger

Famine

GEN 41:55; ; 2KI 6:25–6:29; ; NEH 5:1–5:2

Fasting

MAT 4:2 parallel LUK 4:2

Fatigue

ISA 21:3; ; 2SA 17:29; ; MAT 12:1–12:4; ; MRK 6:35–6:36, MRK 8:2–8:3

Folly

PRO 19:15, PRO 20:4; ; LUK 15:14

God's action

LEV 26:26; ; DEU 28:48; ; ISA 5:13, ISA 9:20; ; EZK 7:19

The hardships of gospel work

1CO 4:11; ; 2CO 6:5, 2CO 11:27; ; PHP 4:12

Effects of hunger

Physical deterioration

JOB 30:3; ; LAM 2:19, LAM 4:9

Mental preoccupation

ISA 29:8; ; ACT 10:10–10:13 Peter's consciousness was supernaturally heightened to receive a vision from God.

Moral degradation

LEV 26:29; ; DEU 28:53; ; 2KI 6:28–6:29; ; JER 19:9; ; LAM 2:20, LAM 4:10; ; EZK 5:10

An occasion for temptation

GEN 3:6 Eve; ; GEN 25:29–25:34 Esau; ; PRO 6:30–6:31; ; ISA 8:21; ; MAT 4:3 parallel LUK 4:3 Jesus Christ

An opportunity for proving God

DEU 8:3; ; NEH 9:15; ; PHP 4:12

God satisfies hunger

He provides food for all creation

PSA 107:9, PSA 145:15–145:16 See also DEU 32:13–32:14; PSA 17:14, PSA 37:25, PSA 104:21, PSA 104:27–

104:28, PSA 111:5, PSA 132:15, PSA 136:25, PSA 146:7, PSA 147:9; ISA 49:10

He provides through supernatural means

PSA 78:24–78:25 See also EXO 16:12–16:15; 1KI 17:4–17:16; NEH 9:15; MAT 14:19–14:21 parallels MRK 6:41–6:44, LUK 9:16–9:17, JHN 6:11–6:14 the feeding of the 5,000; MRK 8:7–8:8

He provides through natural means

GEN 3:17–3:19; ; JOS 5:12; ; PRO 16:26; ; ISA 58:7; ; MAT 25:35; ; 2TH 3:10

He provides completely in heaven

REV 7:16

Jesus Christ was hungry

MAT 4:2 parallel LUK 4:2; ; MAT 21:18 parallel MRK 11:12; ; JHN 4:31

5342: hunting

Hunters who pursue a prey, literally or figuratively

Human beings

GEN 10:9; PSA 91:3 See also GEN 25:27, GEN 27:3, GEN 49:9, GEN 49:27; LEV 17:13; ISA 24:11; PSA 124:7

Lions

JOB 38:39 See also NUM 23:24; JOB 4:11; PSA 17:12, PSA 22:13, PSA 104:21; ISA 5:29; EZK 19:6, EZK 22:25; AMO 3:4; NAM 2:12

Eagles

JOB 9:26 See also JOB 39:27–39:30

God

AMO 9:3 See also JOB 19:22; JER 16:16; EZK 12:13

People being hunted by their enemies

PSA 10:2; JER 5:26 See also GEN 31:36; 1SA 23:23, 1SA 26:20; JOB 18:8–18:10; PSA 119:110, PSA 140:5, PSA 140:11, PSA 141:9; PRO 6:5; ECC 9:12; ISA 10:2, ISA 13:14, ISA 59:15; LAM 3:52; MIC 7:2

5343: idleness

Laziness or unproductiveness. As work is hallowed by God's working, idleness is regarded as a sin against oneself and society.

Idleness reproached

In terms of daily labour

1TH 5:14 Paul to the Christians at Thessalonica. See also PRO 19:24, PRO 10:4, PRO 22:13, PRO 26:13–26:16; 2TH 3:6–3:15; 1TI 5:13; TIT 1:12

In matters of faith

HEB 6:11–6:12 To Christians who were tempted to give up.

Idleness discouraged by examples of industriousness

PRO 6:6–6:8 See also PRO 31:27 the good wife; ECC 11:6; 2TH 3:7–3:9 Paul referring to his practice of not depending on others for his living

The results of idleness

PRO 6:9–6:11 See also PRO 10:26, PRO 12:24, PRO 13:4, PRO 15:19, PRO 19:15, PRO 20:4; ECC 10:18

5344: imprisonment

Being confined in prison is used both literally and figuratively in Scripture. Release from prison is used as a picture of freedom from spiritual bondage.

The anticipation or threat of imprisonment

MAT 5:25–5:26 parallel LUK 12:58 See also ACT 20:23; REV 2:10

Imprisonment for law-breaking

EZR 7:26 See also GEN 40:3; 2KI 17:4; JER 52:11; MAT 18:30

Imprisonment while on remand

NUM 15:33–15:34 See also LEV 24:12; MAT 27:16 parallels MRK 15:7, LUK 23:19

Imprisonment of the innocent, often with malicious intent

JER 38:28; LUK 21:12 See also GEN 39:20–39:22, GEN 40:14–40:15, GEN 42:16–42:17 Joseph planning the welfare of his brothers; 1KI 22:27 Ahab orders Micaiah's imprisonment; 2CH 16:10; JER 32:2–32:3, JER 37:15; MAT 14:3 John the Baptist imprisoned by Herod; ACT 8:3, ACT 16:23–16:24 Paul and Silas in prison; ACT 22:4, ACT 22:19, ACT 23:29, ACT 24:27, ACT 26:10, ACT 26:31; 2CO 6:5, 2CO 11:23; HEB 11:36

Release from imprisonment**By earthly rulers**

GEN 41:14; ; 2KI 25:27 parallel JER 52:31; ; JER 39:13–39:14

By divine intervention

PSA 146:7 See also PSA 68:6, PSA 102:20, PSA 107:10–107:14, PSA 142:7; ISA 42:7, ISA 49:9, ISA 51:14, ISA 61:1; ACT 12:1–12:11

Imprisonment used in a figurative or poetic sense

LUK 4:18 See also ISA 61:1; JOB 11:10, JOB 12:14; PSA 66:11; ECC 4:14; ROM 7:23; GAL 3:22–3:23; 1PE 3:19; REV 20:7

5345: influence

The ability to affect others or events. Also, the experience of being affected by someone or something else. Scripture recognises the wide-ranging power of influence for both good and evil.

Teaching on influence**Exhortations to be influenced by good and to influence others for good**

MAT 5:13–5:16 See also PRO 1:8–1:9, PRO 7:1–7:5, PRO 25:15; PHP 4:8–4:9

Exhortations to resist evil influence and not to be a bad influence

DEU 4:15–4:19; ; PRO 5:1–5:14, PRO 6:20–6:26; ; MAT 18:5–18:6; ; ROM 12:2, ROM 14:13; ; 1CO 5:6–5:8, 1CO 8:9–8:13; ; 2CO 6:14–6:18; ; 2TI 2:14; ; JAS 4:7

Good influence in its various contexts**The influence of the Holy Spirit**

ACT 2:1–2:13, ACT 8:26–8:40, ACT 16:6–16:10; ; ROM 8:5–8:17, ROM 8:26–8:27; ; 1CO 2:10–2:16, 1CO 12:3

People of good influence

2TI 1:5 See also GEN 41:41–41:43; 1KI 10:1–10:9, 1KI 15:11–15:14; 2KI 18:1–18:8, 2KI 23:1–23:25

Evil influence in its various contexts**People of evil influence**

2KI 9:22 See also MAT 15:1–15:14, MAT 16:5–16:12, MAT 23:13–23:15, MAT 27:20; 2CO 11:3–11:4, 2CO 11:13–11:15; 2PE 2:1–2:3

Corrupting influence of evil cultures

JOS 23:6–23:8, JOS 23:12–23:13; ; JDG 2:10–2:13; ; 1KI 11:1–11:6; ; EZR 9:1–9:2; ; NEH 13:15–13:27; ; 1CO 12:1–12:2, 1CO 15:33

The influence of Satan

MAT 16:23 See also MRK 1:23–1:26 parallel LUK 4:33–4:35; MRK 4:15 parallels MAT 13:19, LUK 8:12; LUK 22:3–22:4; JHN 13:27–13:30; 2CO 12:7

Further aspects of influence**The influence of prayer**

GEN 18:20–18:33; ; EXO 32:9–32:14; ; 2CH 7:13–7:15; ; DAN 9:1–9:23; ; JON 3:3–3:10

The influence of words

PRO 12:18 See also PRO 15:4, PRO 16:23–16:24, PRO 28:23; JAS 3:5–3:6

The influence of parents

PRO 1:8–1:9 See also 2CH 22:2–22:3; PRO 4:1–4:4, PRO 6:20–6:22; 2TI 1:5

5346: injury

Physical or mental hurt, usually resulting from the deliberate actions or words of others.

Physical injury

JDG 1:6 See also GEN 32:25; LUK 10:30; 2CO 11:23–11:25

Reparation must be made for physical injury

EXO 21:19, EXO 21:22; ; LEV 24:17–24:22

Jesus Christ suffered physical injury

MAT 16:21; ; JHN 19:1

God's people may suffer physical injury for his sake

JER 38:6; ; GAL 6:17; ; COL 1:24; ; 1PE 2:19

Mental injury

Injury by slander

LEV 19:16; ; PRO 30:10; ; MAT 5:11; ; TIT 3:2; ; JAS 4:11; ; 1PE 2:1

Injury by injustice

PSA 58:1–58:2; ; ECC 3:16; ; ISA 59:4–59:6; ; EZK 34:4

Jesus Christ suffered mental injury

MAT 26:59–26:60; ; 1PE 2:20–2:23

God's people may suffer mental injury for his sake

MAT 5:11 See also PSA 38:20; JER 15:15; 1TH 2:2; 1PE 2:19

All deliberate injury ruled out by love

ROM 13:10

Spiritual injury suffered by God's people

See also ISA 1:5–1:6; JER 10:19, JER 30:12; HOS 6:1 Sometimes this is God's judgment.

5347: injustice

The unnecessary and unjustified ill treatment of others, through false accusation or through the inflicting of pain or punishment. Having its origin in Satan, it works through the sinful human heart and shows itself in every sphere of life. It merits the wrath of God.

5348: injustice, nature and source of

Characterised by deception, dishonesty and heartlessness, injustice is the oppression of the needy and the weak. Its origin is Satan and it works through the sinful hearts of men and women. **PSA 64:6**

The nature of injustice

Injustice seen in false accusation

See also GEN 39:19–39:20; 1KI 21:8–21:10

Injustice seen in dishonesty

1SA 8:3; ; ISA 59:14; ; MAT 26:59–26:61; ; ACT 24:26–24:27

Injustice seen in pain inflicted on the innocent

MAT 2:16–2:18, MAT 27:26; ; ACT 4:3, ACT 23:3

Injustice seen in oppression of the poor, the needy and the helpless

EXO 1:11–1:14; ; 1SA 8:11; ; 2CH 10:14; ; JOB 31:13–31:14; ; PSA 10:2, PSA 10:8–10:11, PSA 105:17–105:18; ; PRO 22:16; ; ISA 5:8; ; JER 22:13; ; AMO 5:11; ; MRK 12:38–12:40; ; JAS 5:4–5:6

The sources of injustice

The devil

1JN 3:10 The word “devil” means “slanderer”. See also JHN 8:44; REV 2:10; 2TH 2:9–2:11 The word “Satan” means “adversary”–the same person as the devil; JAS 3:14–3:15; REV 2:13

The world

1JN 2:16 “the world” here means society without God and hostile to him. See also EXO 23:2; PSA 69:4; PRO 31:4–31:5; EZK 22:12; MAT 5:11–5:12; JHN 15:18–15:19

Sinful hearts

MAT 15:19 See also PSA 140:2; JER 6:13–6:15; MIC 2:2; GAL 5:19–5:21

5349: injustice, examples of

Injustice can be found, in varying degrees of intensity, in every area of human relationships. It produces exploitation and suffering, both mental and physical.

Injustice occurs in family life

MRK 7:9–7:13 parallel MAT 15:3–15:6 See also GEN 27:35; LEV 20:9–20:10; MAL 2:13–2:14; 1CO 7:4–7:5; EPH 6:4; COL 3:19, COL 3:21

Injustice occurs in the community

ISA 59:14–59:15 See also LEV 19:16; DEU 19:14, DEU 23:24–23:25, DEU 24:6–24:7; PSA 101:5; PRO 3:28–3:30, PRO 22:28, PRO 23:10–23:11; JER 17:11

Injustice occurs in the business world

HOS 12:7 See also LEV 19:35; PRO 11:1; 1TI 6:10

Injustice occurs in courts of law

PRO 24:23–24:24 See also PSA 26:10; PRO 14:5, PRO 28:21; ISA 5:22–5:23, ISA 29:21; HOS 10:4; AMO 5:12; HAB 1:4; MAL 2:9; ACT 16:36–16:37

Injustice can be caused by rulers and governments

ISA 10:1–10:2 See also EXO 1:10–1:11; PSA 58:1–58:2, PSA 94:20–94:21; PRO 29:4, PRO 31:4–31:5; ECC 5:8–5:9; ISA 1:21; MIC 3:8; HAB 2:9 **LUK 23:4–23:25** parallels MAT 27:15–27:26, MRK 15:6–15:15, JHN 18:38–18:40 See also ROM 13:1–13:4 the proper role of governing authorities

5350: injustice, hated by God

God's hatred of injustice is seen in his vindication of its victims, his solemn warnings, his penalties against the guilty and his commands to his people to renounce it.

God hates injustice

PRO 6:16–6:19 See also PRO 11:1, PRO 12:22, PRO 17:15

God will vindicate the victims of injustice

They cry for justice

PSA 43:1 There are some OT passages where vengeance upon persecutors is called for (e.g., Ps 35:1–8; Ps 69:22–28; Jer 11:18–20; 18:19–23). These are called “imprecatory”. They arose from zeal for God's honour and from the desire for moral stability in society. They reflect an under-developed view of God's ultimate judgments and the failure to distinguish between the guilty and their innocent families. In the light of the NT the motives behind these prayers may be applauded but it is recognised that now they are best expressed in the denunciation of injustice accompanied by gospel witness, through which the hearts of oppressors are changed, leaving the matter of judgment as God's prerogative alone. See also NEH 4:4–4:5; PSA 94:1–94:7; REV 6:10; JOB 19:25 In OT times a redeemer was a near relative responsible for securing the just rights of a poor kinsperson.

God will answer their cry

LUK 18:1–18:8 See also PSA 12:5, PSA 94:20–94:23; 2TH 1:6–1:7; 2TI 4:14; 2PE 2:9; REV 18:20, REV 19:2

God condemns injustice

ISA 10:1–10:3 See also DEU 16:19; AMO 1:3–1:4

God will punish the unjust

MIC 2:1–2:3 See also DEU 27:17, DEU 27:19; 1KI 21:19; PRO 19:5, PRO 21:28; AMO 5:11–5:12, AMO 8:4–8:7; NAM 3:1; MAL 3:5; LUK 12:45–12:46 1CO 6:6–6:8; 1TH 4:6 JAS 5:1–5:6; REV 1:7

The apparent present success of the unjust

PSA 37:1–37:2 See also PSA 73:3–73:11, PSA 73:15–73:17; ISA 26:10–26:11; HAB 1:12–1:13

God's people must hate injustice

Injustice forbidden by God

PRO 22:22 See also EXO 20:16, EXO 22:21–22:22, EXO 23:6–23:8; LEV 19:13, LEV 19:15, LEV 19:35; DEU 24:14–24:15, DEU 24:17; EZK 45:9; ZEC 7:10; EPH 6:9

Injustice should be renounced by God's people

PSA 119:163 See also DEU 24:7; PSA 82:2; PRO 29:27; COL 3:21

Injustice displaced by love

MRK 12:31; ; ROM 13:10; ; COL 3:19

God's people must bear injustice patiently

JAS 5:7–5:8 See also MAT 5:39, MAT 5:44–5:45; 1CO 6:7

5352: inscriptions

An inscription can signify ownership or jurisdiction

MAT 22:20–22:21 parallels MRK 12:16–12:17, LUK 20:24–20:25; ; ACT 17:23

The inscription on objects set apart for God

ZEC 14:20–14:21 See also EXO 39:30

An inscription can be symbolic of permanence

Of a person's words

ISA 30:8; 2TI 2:19 See also JOB 19:23–19:24

Of the effect of sin

JER 17:1

Inscriptions written by the finger of God

EXO 31:18 See also EXO 32:15–32:16; DEU 9:10; DAN 5:5, DAN 5:22–5:28; ZEC 3:9

5353: interest

The charge for the lending of money on a commercial or private loan. The practice of charging interest (known as usury) is treated with caution by OT writers on account of its potential for exploitation.

Usury forbidden among the Israelites

EXO 22:25 See also LEV 25:35–25:37; DEU 23:19

Lending without interest: a characteristic of the righteous

PSA 15:5; ; EZK 18:8, EZK 18:17; ; LUK 6:30, LUK 6:31

Exactng interest: a characteristic of the wicked

PRO 28:8; ; JER 15:10; ; EZK 18:13, EZK 22:12; ; 1TI 6:9, 1TI 6:10

Lending: a charitable, not a commercial, activity

DEU 15:8; ; PSA 112:5; ; LUK 6:35

Example of oppression through usury

NEH 5:6–5:11

Usury permissible for commercial transactions involving “outsiders”

DEU 23:20 This legislation permits rather than encourages usury and remains subject to considerations protecting the poor. See also DEU 15:1–15:11; MAT 25:27 parallel LUK 19:23

5354: invasions

A hostile incursion into the territory of another tribe or nation, often with the object of its permanent annexation.

The Israelites’ invasion of Canaan**Their success had been preordained**

DEU 7:22; LEV 20:23–20:24 See also EXO 12:25; LEV 14:34, LEV 23:10; DEU 6:10–6:12, DEU 7:17–7:24

Moses gave instructions on how to proceed

DEU 7:1–7:5, DEU 20:10–20:20

Joshua followed Moses in leading the invasion

JOS 11:23 See also JOS 6:20, JOS 8:18–8:19, JOS 10:29–10:43

The invasion continued under other leaders

JDG 1:4, JDG 4:23–4:24, JDG 11:21–11:22, JDG 11:32–11:33; ; 2KI 3:24; ; 1CH 4:41–4:43

Invasion of the Israelites’ land**By the Philistines**

JDG 10:6–10:10; ; 1CH 14:9; ; 2CH 21:16–21:17

By other nations

JDG 6:3–6:5 See also JDG 2:14; 2KI 13:20; 2CH 20:1, 2CH 24:23

Israel taken into captivity by Assyrian invaders

2KI 17:5–17:6 parallel 2KI 18:9–18:11

Judah taken into captivity by Babylonian invaders

2KI 25:1 parallel JER 39:1**2KI 25:10–25:11** parallels JER 39:8–39:9, JER 52:4

Invasion of the promised land was a cause of great sadness

PSA 79:1 See also NEH 1:1–1:4; LAM 1:1–1:3; DAN 9:4–9:6

Examples of non-human invasion**By locusts**

EXO 10:14

By evil spiritual forces

MAT 12:43–12:45 parallel LUK 11:24–11:26**LUK 22:3** See also MRK 9:17–9:18 parallels MAT 17:14–17:16, LUK 9:38–9:40; ROM 5:12–5:14; EPH 6:12

5355: invitations

A request for attendance, often to a celebration or feast. Invitations to the blessings of the gospel are sometimes presented as requests to attend a banquet. In a negative sense one can be invited to sin.

Invitations to receive hospitality

ACT 16:15 See also GEN 24:31–24:33 Laban shows hospitality to Abraham’s servant and his animals; GEN 31:54; EXO 2:20; NUM 10:29–10:32; 1SA 9:22–9:24 Saul dines with Samuel; 1KI 13:7; JOB 1:4; JER 35:2**LUK 7:36**, LUK 11:37 JHN 21:12; ACT 10:23; 1CO 10:27

Invitations to a wedding or a banquet

LUK 14:8–14:14 See also EST 5:4, EST 5:12; JHN 2:2

Invitations requesting help

ACT 16:9 See also JDG 1:3, JDG 11:6; 2KI 16:7; ACT 8:30–8:31

Invitations of the lovers in the Song of Solomon

SNG 2:13, SNG 4:8, SNG 7:11, SNG 8:14

Invitations to join in worshipping God

PSA 34:3 See also PSA 66:5–66:6, PSA 66:16, PSA 95:1–95:2, PSA 95:5–95:6

Invitations of the Lord Jesus Christ to follow him

MAT 4:19 parallels MRK 1:17, LUK 5:10 See also MRK 10:21 parallels MAT 19:21, LUK 18:22

Invitations to the blessings of the gospel**Invitations given in varied terms**

MAT 11:28–11:30 See also ISA 1:18; ZEC 3:10 “to sit under his vine and fig-tree” refers to the peaceful security of the kingdom of God. See 1KI 4:25; Mic 4:4; MAT 25:34; JHN 4:29; REV 3:20, REV 22:17

Invitations using the imagery of a banquet

LUK 14:16–14:17 See also ISA 55:1–55:3; MAT 22:1–22:14; REV 19:7–19:9

Invitations given with deceitful motives

2SA 15:10–15:12 See also 2SA 13:23–13:29; 1KI 1:5–1:10; NEH 6:1–6:8

Invitations to do what is sinful

GEN 39:7 See also GEN 3:1–3:4, GEN 39:12; EXO 34:15–34:16; NUM 22:6, NUM 22:11, NUM 22:17, NUM 23:7, NUM 25:1–25:2; PRO 1:10–1:11

5356: irony

Irony directed against idolaters

1KI 18:27 See also ISA 44:12–44:19

Irony in the speeches of Job and his friends

JOB 12:2 See also JOB 16:2–16:3

Irony in declarations of impending punishment

JER 34:17 See also JDG 9:1–9:21

Irony used for instruction

1CO 4:7–4:14

Other examples of irony

See also 2SA 6:20; MRK 2:17, MRK 15:17–15:19; ACT 26:28

5357: journey

People going on journeys

NUM 33:1–33:2; ROM 15:24 See also GEN 29:1, GEN 45:21; NUM 9:10; JOS 9:11–9:13; 1KI 19:4; NEH 2:6; PRO 7:19; ACT 9:3; 1CO 16:3

Journeys of Jesus Christ

From Egypt to Nazareth

MAT 2:19–2:23

Journeys in Galilee

MRK 6:1–6:56

Journeys in Judea

MAT 20:17–21:11

Journeys in Samaria

LUK 9:51–9:56; ; JHN 4:6

God's guidance on journeys

GEN 24:27; DEU 1:33 See also GEN 28:20; DEU 2:7; JOS 24:17; JDG 18:5; EZR 7:9, EZR 8:21

The disciples' evangelistic journeys

MAT 10:5–10:15 parallels MRK 6:7–6:11, LUK 9:1–9:5

Journeys used figuratively

JOB 16:22 See also MAT 21:33 parallel MRK 12:1; MAT 25:13–25:14; LUK 11:6

5358: judges

Individuals responsible for the administration of justice and/or the operation of government. In the OT the term “judge” is also used in a special sense meaning a leader of Israel. God is portrayed in Scripture as the judge of all the earth; in the NT Jesus Christ is presented as the judge appointed by God.

Judges as leaders of Israel

1SA 7:15 See also JDG 2:16–2:19, JDG 3:9–3:11, JDG 4:4–4:10; RUT 1:1; 2KI 23:22

The role of judges

Judicial and punitive

DEU 25:1–25:2 See also GEN 19:6–19:9; EXO 18:13–18:26, EXO 22:7–22:9; NUM 25:5; DEU 1:16, DEU 19:16–19:21, DEU 21:1–21:2; 2CH 19:5–19:7; EZK 44:24; LUK 12:14; 1CO 6:2–6:5; REV 20:4

Administrative

EXO 21:2–21:6; ; EZR 10:14; ; ACT 24:10

The status of judges in ancient Israel

JOS 8:33 See also JOS 23:1–24:1; 2KI 23:22; 2CH 1:2–1:3

The jurisdiction of judges

Local judges

DEU 16:18 See also 2CH 19:5

Judges with national authority

1SA 7:15–7:17 See also DEU 17:8–17:9; 2SA 15:4

Regulations relating to judges

DEU 1:16 See also DEU 17:12, DEU 25:2–25:3

Corrupt judges

MIC 7:3 See also LUK 18:2–18:8

Levitical judges

EZK 44:24 See also 1CH 23:3–23:4, 1CH 26:29

Judges during periods of foreign rule

Under the Babylonian empire

DAN 3:2–3:3

Under the Medo-Persian empire

EZR 7:25 See also EZR 4:9

Under the Roman Empire

MAT 27:19 See also MAT 5:25 parallel LUK 12:58; JHN 19:13; ACT 24:10

God as judge

ISA 33:22 See also JDG 11:27; 1SA 24:12, 1SA 24:15; 1KI 8:31–8:32; 1CH 16:33; JOB 9:15; PSA 58:11, PSA 94:2; JHN 8:50, JHN 12:48; HEB 12:23

The righteousness of God's judgment

GEN 18:25 See also PSA 7:11, PSA 50:6

Jesus Christ appointed as judge

ACT 10:42 See also JHN 5:22, JHN 5:27, JHN 5:30; ACT 17:31; 2CO 5:10; 2TI 4:1, 2TI 4:8

5359: justice

A concern to act rightly, and to be seen by others to act rightly. Divine justice embraces every aspect of the right ordering of human society according to the will of God, its creator.

5360: justice, of God

The moral righteousness of God is revealed in his laws and expressed in his judicial acts. God's commands and judgments meet perfect standards of justice, and his apportioning of punishments and rewards is also perfectly just. God's justice is impartial. Special praise is his for vindicating the penitent and the needy who have no human champions. Ultimately, all God's ways will be seen as just and equitable.

God's justice declared

God the Father

PSA 92:15; 1PE 1:17 See also GEN 18:25; JOB 36:3; PSA 11:7, PSA 25:8, PSA 33:5, PSA 51:4; ISA 61:8; JER 9:24; ZEP 3:5; REV 15:3

God the Son

1JN 2:1 See also PSA 45:6; HEB 1:8-1:9; PSA 72:1-72:4 ISA 9:7, ISA 11:3-11:5, ISA 42:1, ISA 42:3; MAL 3:1-3:3 ACT 3:14; 1CO 1:30; REV 19:11

God the Spirit

JHN 16:8-16:11 See also ACT 5:3, ACT 5:9; EPH 4:1, EPH 4:28, EPH 4:30

God's justice described

As impartial

1PE 1:17 See also DEU 10:17; 2CH 19:7; JOB 34:19; DAN 5:27; ACT 10:34; ROM 2:5, ROM 2:11; GAL 2:6; EPH 6:9; COL 3:25

As inescapable

ROM 2:3 See also PSA 68:21-68:23; JER 11:11, JER 16:16-16:18, JER 51:53; LAM 2:22; AMO 9:1-9:4; OBA 1:4; HEB 2:2-2:3

As infallible

HEB 4:13 See also ISA 2:3; 1CH 28:9; PRO 16:2, PRO 21:2, PRO 24:12; LUK 16:15; ROM 2:2, ROM 2:16

God's justice desired

By the oppressed

PSA 9:19 See also JDG 3:9; PSA 7:6, PSA 10:12-10:14

By those who are misrepresented

PSA 26:1 See also ISA 24:15; PSA 35:23-35:24

God's justice doubted

MAL 2:17 See also JOB 6:29, JOB 27:2, JOB 34:5; PSA 73:2-73:14; ECC 8:11, ECC 8:14; ISA 40:27; ROM 9:14, ROM 9:19-9:20

God's justice demonstrated

In his demands for social justice

MIC 6:8 See also DEU 16:18, DEU 16:20; ISA 1:16-1:17; AMO 5:21-5:24; MAL 3:5; MAT 23:23; LUK 20:46-20:47

In his defence of the oppressed

PSA 103:6 See also PSA 72:2, PSA 140:12; PRO 22:22-22:23; ISA 11:4; EZK 34:16; LUK 18:7-18:8

In his vindication of the righteous

ROM 8:33 See also PSA 17:1-17:2, PSA 24:5; ISA 50:8-50:9, ISA 54:17, ISA 61:8

In the cross

ROM 3:25-3:26 See also 2CO 5:21; GAL 3:13

In the resurrection

ACT 17:31

On the day of judgment

ROM 2:5 See also PSA 9:8; ACT 17:31; REV 16:5, REV 16:7, REV 19:2

5361: justice, human

God created the world in justice, and expects that his creatures will deal fairly and justly with one another as a result. Sin brings injustice into the world, by disrupting the justice established by God at creation. As a result, human justice often falls short of God's standards.

God shows his concern for human justice

By commanding it

ISA 56:1; MIC 6:8 See also EXO 23:1-23:9; DEU 24:17; PSA 82:3; PRO 21:3; HOS 12:6; ROM 13:7

By commending its maintenance

PSA 106:3 See also GEN 20:5-20:6; 1KI 3:11-3:12, 1KI 3:28; JOB 1:8; PSA 37:37, PSA 112:5

By condemning its neglect

MAL 3:5 See also DEU 27:19; JOB 31:13-31:14; ISA 3:14, ISA 3:15, ISA 10:1; JER 7:5-7:8, JER 7:14 destruction follows ignored warnings; EZK 22:29-22:31

Justice in relationships within the family

Parents and children

EXO 20:12 parallel DEU 5:16 See also MAT 15:4; EPH 6:1-6:3; COL 3:20-3:21; 1TI 3:4

Brothers and sisters

GEN 4:9-4:10

Husband and wife

MAL 2:14; ; 1CO 7:4-7:5; ; COL 3:18-3:19

Justice in the community

PRO 29:7; JAS 1:27 See also JOB 29:16; PSA 82:3; PRO 29:14, PRO 31:8-31:9; ISA 1:17; JER 22:16

Justice in the business world

COL 4:1 See also LEV 19:35-19:36; DEU 25:15; EPH 6:9; JAS 5:1-5:4

Justice in courts of law

EXO 23:6-23:8 See also LEV 19:15; DEU 1:16, DEU 16:18-16:20, DEU 17:6, DEU 25:1-25:3, DEU 27:25; 2CH 19:5-19:7; PRO 12:17PRO 18:5, PRO 24:23-24:25, PRO 28:21 PRO 18:17; JHN 18:23; ACT 23:3

Justice in rulers and governments

PRO 8:15 See also 1KI 10:9; 1CH 18:14; PRO 16:12-16:13, PRO 29:26-29:27, PRO 31:8-31:9; JER 22:13-22:16 judgment against the son of King Josiah; EZK 45:9; ROM 13:1-13:4; 1PE 2:13-2:14, 1PE 2:17

Justice in the community of faith

AMO 5:21-5:24; LUK 11:42 See also ISA 58:6-58:7; HOS 6:6, HOS 12:6; MAT 23:23; 1CO 6:1-6:8; JAS 2:1-2:4, JAS 2:12-2:13

Justice in a believer's life

MIC 6:8 See also PRO 21:3; PHP 4:8; TIT 2:12; 1PE 3:16

5362: justice, in believers' lives

God requires justice to be evident in the lives of his people. Through justification, believers are granted the status of being righteous in his sight, and are called upon to live out that righteousness in their lives.

God's law demands justice**The law is written on the conscience**

ROM 2:14-2:15 See also GEN 20:5-20:6; PRO 20:27**ISA 51:7** See also ECC 8:5

The law in the OT

EXO 20:1-20:3; DEU 6:4-6:5 See also EXO 20:4-20:17 parallel DEU 5:6-5:21; PSA 119:1, PSA 119:165 parallel MAT 22:37-22:40

The law in the NT

MAT 5:17 See also ROM 7:7, ROM 7:12, ROM 7:22, ROM 13:10; 1TI 1:8-1:11

Justification is by faith

ROM 1:17 See also HAB 2:4; GEN 15:6; ROM 3:21-3:24, ROM 4:24-4:25, ROM 5:1, ROM 9:30; GAL 3:6, GAL 3:24; PHP 3:9

The marks of the just person

JAS 2:17 Although justification is by faith alone it is always to be accompanied by righteous behaviour. See also MAT 25:34-25:36; EPH 2:10; 1JN 3:7, 1JN 3:9

Thinking justly

PSA 1:2 See also PSA 24:4, PSA 40:8, PSA 119:111-119:112; MAT 5:8; PHP 4:8

Speaking justly

PSA 141:3 See also PRO 4:24, PRO 8:6-8:8; EPH 4:25; 1PE 3:10

Behaving justly

MIC 6:8 See also DEU 6:25; PSA 106:3; PRO 21:3; ISA 33:15-33:16; ACT 24:16

Examples of just people

JOB 1:8 See also 2SA 8:15; 1KI 3:11-3:12, 1KI 3:28; LUK 23:50-23:51; ACT 25:8, ACT 25:11

The vindication of the just

2TI 4:8 See also PSA 86:17; DAN 12:3; REV 7:9-7:17

5364: key

A tool for opening a locked door. Used mainly symbolically in Scripture to speak of Jesus Christ's victory over death and his authority over believers, or of the need of deliverance from the imprisonment brought to human nature by sin and the law.

Keys for opening doors

JDG 3:23-3:25; ; 1CH 9:27; ; LUK 3:20, LUK 11:7; ; JHN 20:19, JHN 20:26; ; ACT 5:23

The symbolic use of keys**As a symbol of Jesus Christ's complete authority**

REV 3:7 See also ISA 22:22

As a symbol of Jesus Christ's ultimate victory over death and hell

REV 1:18

As a symbol of Satan's ultimate defeat

REV 20:1-20:3 See also REV 9:1

As a symbol of Jesus Christ's authoritative ministry through his church

MAT 16:19 Usually understood as illustrating how God's forgiveness is made effective through preaching the gospel.

As a symbol of living faith**ISA 33:6** See also MAT 13:52**Being locked up as a symbol of obstacles to faith****GAL 3:23** See also LUK 11:52**5365: kidnapping**

The abduction of a person, normally for the purpose of selling into slavery.

Examples of kidnapping**Joseph**

GEN 37:23–37:28, GEN 40:15, GEN 45:3–45:5

The girls at Shiloh

JDG 21:16–21:23

The penalty for kidnapping**EXO 21:16** See also DEU 24:7; 1TI 1:9–1:10**5366: king**

The ruler or monarch of a country or realm. God is king of all the earth and human kings are called to rule in accordance with his will. The failure of kings in Israel and Judah after David led to the expectation of a coming king like David. This was fulfilled in Jesus Christ: the true King of Israel and all the world.

God is king of his people and of all the earth

PSA 47:8 The Hebrew refers to the rule of a king; **1TI 6:15–6:16** See also EXO 15:18; 1SA 12:12; 2CH 20:6; PSA 24:10; PSA 47:2; PSA 47:6–47:7; PSA 93:1; PSA 96:10; PSA 97:1; PSA 99:1; ISA 6:5; ISA 44:6; 1TI 1:17; REV 15:3; REV 19:6

Significant kings**Melchizedek, king of Salem**

GEN 14:18; ; HEB 5:6, HEB 5:10, HEB 6:20–7:17; ; PSA 110:4

The Pharaohs, the kings of Egypt

GEN 12:14–12:20, GEN 41:39–41:40; ; EXO 12:30–12:32, EXO 14:4; ; 1KI 3:1; ; 2KI 23:29, 2KI 23:33–23:34; ; EZK 32:1–32:10; ; ROM 9:17

Saul

Israel's demand for a king is seen as a rejection of God's rule: 1SA 8:4–8:9, 1SA 8:19–8:22, 1SA 10:17–10:19, 1SA 12:12–12:15; 1SA 9:1–9:2, 1SA 10:1, 1SA 10:24, 1SA 11:14–11:15, 1SA 13:1, 1SA 13:11–13:14, 1SA 15:17, 1SA 15:26; 1SA 31:1–31:4 parallel 1CH 10:1–10:4; ; 1CH 10:13–10:14

David

1CH 29:26–29:28 parallel 1KI 2:10–2:12 See also 1SA 16:13; 2SA 5:3–5:5 parallel 1CH 11:3; 2SA 8:1–8:14 parallel 1CH 18:1–18:13; 1KI 11:38; PSA 18:50, PSA 78:70–78:72 2SA

7:8–7:16 parallel 1CH 17:7–17:14; 1KI 9:4–9:5; 2CH 7:17–7:18; PSA 132:11–132:12

Solomon

2SA 12:24–12:25; ; 1KI 2:12 parallel 2CH 1:1; ; 1KI 4:29–4:34, 1KI 6:1 parallel 2CH 3:1 Solomon began to build the temple; ; 1KI 10:23–10:25 parallel 2CH 9:22–9:24; ; 1KI 11:1, 1KI 11:4, 1KI 11:42–11:43 parallel 2CH 9:30–9:31 Solomon's death

Nebuchadnezzar, king of Babylon

2KI 24:1 parallel 2CH 36:6–36:7; 2KI 25:1 parallels 2CH 36:17, JER 39:1, JER 52:4; ; DAN 1:1; JER 21:7, JER 27:6, JER 27:8; ; EZK 29:18–29:19 Nebuchadnezzar besieged Tyre for 15 years; ; DAN 2:1, DAN 2:46–2:47, DAN 3:1 the image of gold; ; DAN 3:28–3:29, DAN 4:28–4:37

Cyrus, king of Persia

2CH 36:22–36:23 parallel EZR 1:1–1:4; ; EZR 5:13–6:5; ; ISA 44:28–45:1, ISA 45:13; ; DAN 6:28

The Herods, rulers in Palestine

Herod the Great: MAT 2:1–2:3, MAT 2:16; MAT 14:1–14:2 parallels MRK 6:14–6:16, LUK 9:7–9:9; ; MRK 8:15; ; LUK 3:19–3:20, LUK 13:31, LUK 23:7–23:12; ; ACT 4:27; ACT 12:1–12:4, ACT 12:19–12:23

The kings of the united kingdom**Saul**

1SA 10:20–10:24, 1SA 11:12–11:15

David

1SA 16:13; ; 2SA 2:1–2:4, 2SA 5:1–5:5; ; 1KI 2:11; ; 1CH 11:1–29:30

Solomon

1KI 1:39; ; 2CH 1:1–9:31

The kings of Israel, the northern kingdom**Jeroboam I**

1KI 12:20, 1KI 12:25–14:20

Nadab

1KI 15:25–15:31

Baasha

1KI 15:32–16:7

Elah

1KI 16:8–16:14

Zimri

1KI 16:15–16:20

Tibni

1KI 16:21–16:22

Omri

1KI 16:23–16:28

Ahab

1KI 16:29–22:40

Ahaziah

1KI 22:51–22:53; ; 2KI 1:1–1:18

Joram (Jehoram)

2KI 3:1–8:15

Jehu

2KI 9:3–10:36

Jehoahaz

2KI 13:1–13:9

Jehoash (Joash)

2KI 13:10–13:25, 2KI 14:8–14:16

Jeroboam II

2KI 14:23–14:29

Zechariah

2KI 15:8–15:12

Shallum

2KI 15:13–15:15

Menahem

2KI 15:16–15:22

Pekahiah

2KI 15:23–15:26

Pekah

2KI 15:27–15:31

Hoshea

2KI 17:1–17:6

The kings and queen of Judah, the southern kingdom**Rehoboam**

1KI 12:1–12:24 parallel 2CH 10:1–11:4; ; 2CH 11:5–12:8; ; 1KI 14:21–14:31 parallel 2CH 12:9–12:16

Abijah

1KI 15:1–15:8 parallel 2CH 13:1–14:1

Asa

1KI 15:9–15:24 parallel 2CH 14:2–16:14

Jehoshaphat

1KI 22:41–22:50 parallel 2CH 20:31–21:1; ; 2CH 17:1–21:3

Jehoram (Joram)

2KI 8:16–8:24 parallel 2CH 21:4–21:20

Ahaziah

2KI 8:25–8:29 parallel 2CH 22:1–22:6; ; 2KI 9:21–9:29 parallel 2CH 22:7–22:9

Queen Athaliah

2KI 11:1–11:21 parallel 2CH 22:10–23:21

Joash (Jehoash)

2KI 11:2–12:21 parallel 2CH 22:10–24:27

Amaziah

2KI 14:1–14:22 parallel 2CH 25:1–25:28

Azariah (= Uzziah)

2KI 14:21–14:22, 2KI 15:1–15:7 parallel 2CH 26:1–26:23

Jotham

2KI 15:32–15:38 parallel 2CH 27:1–27:9

Ahaz

2KI 16:1–16:20 parallel 2CH 28:1–28:27

Hezekiah

2KI 18:1–20:21 parallels 2CH 29:1–32:33, ISA 36:1–39:8

Manasseh

2KI 21:1–21:18 parallel 2CH 33:1–33:20

Amon

2KI 21:19–21:26 parallel 2CH 33:21–33:25

Josiah

2KI 22:1–23:30 parallel 2CH 34:1–35:27

Jehoahaz

2KI 23:31–23:34 parallel 2CH 36:2–36:4

Jehoiakim

2KI 23:36–24:6 parallel 2CH 36:5–36:8

Jehoiachin

2KI 24:8–24:17 parallel 2CH 36:9–36:10

Zedekiah (= Mattaniah)

2KI 24:18–25:7 parallels 2CH 36:11–36:21, JER 52:1–52:11

The expectation of a future king like David**JER 23:5–23:6** See also ISA 9:6–9:7, ISA 11:1–11:5, ISA 16:5; JER 30:8–30:9, JER 33:15; EZK 34:23–34:24, EZK 37:24–37:25; AMO 9:11; MIC 5:2–5:5; HAG 2:20–2:23**The duties of the king****To fear God****2SA 23:3–23:4; PRO 20:28** See also DEU 17:14–17:20; 1SA 10:25; PSA 2:10–2:11**To maintain righteousness and administer justice****PRO 29:4, PRO 29:14** See also 1KI 3:28; PSA 72:1–72:4; PRO 16:12–16:13, PRO 20:8, PRO 20:26, PRO 31:4–31:5, PRO 31:8–31:9; ISA 11:4; JER 33:15; ROM 13:4**To read the law of God and ensure it was obeyed****DEU 17:18–17:20** See also 1KI 2:1–2:4, 1KI 9:4–9:5; 2KI 11:12**The coronation of the king****His anointing by the prophet of God**

1SA 10:1, 1SA 16:1–16:13

His proclamation as king before the people

2KI 11:12 parallel 2CH 23:11 See also 1SA 10:17–10:25, 1SA 11:15; 2SA 2:4, 2SA 5:1–5:3 parallel 1CH 11:1–11:3; 2SA 15:10; 1KI 1:28–1:40, 1KI 12:1 parallel 2CH 10:1; 1KI 12:20

Royal Psalms

These Psalms, although used in honour of the king of the day, possibly at his coronation, share the expectation of a greater king. The NT regards them as fulfilled in Jesus Christ: PSA 2:6–2:9, PSA 45:1, PSA 72:1, PSA 110:1, PSA 132:10

Jesus Christ is the true King of Israel and of the world

MAT 27:37 parallels MRK 15:26, LUK 23:38 **JHN 1:49** See also MAT 21:5; MRK 15:2 parallels MAT 27:11, LUK 23:3; JHN 18:36–18:37; ACT 17:7; 1CO 15:25; HEB 1:8; PSA 45:6; REV 17:14, REV 19:16

Jesus Christ fulfils the expectation of a son of David who will be a king like David

LUK 1:32–1:33 See also LUK 1:69; ACT 13:22–13:23; ROM 1:3; 2TI 2:8; REV 5:5, REV 22:16

5367: kingdoms

Realms or reigns of kings. The kingdoms of this world have power under the sovereignty of God. They are ultimately judged by God and will be superseded by the kingdom of God. The phrase “the kingdom of the air” is used to describe the spiritual realm in which Satan operates.

Israel and the kingdoms around her

1KI 4:21 See also DEU 3:21–3:22, DEU 28:25; JOS 11:10; JDG 2:20–3:4; 1SA 10:18; 2CH 17:10, 2CH 20:29; NEH 9:22; JER 34:1

The kingdoms of this world**God is sovereign over the kingdoms of this world**

2KI 19:15 parallel ISA 37:16 See also 2KI 5:1, 2KI 19:19; 2CH 20:6, 2CH 36:23 parallel EZR 1:2; PSA 46:6; PRO 21:1; ISA 45:1

The kingdoms of this world will honour and worship God

PSA 102:21–102:22 See also PSA 68:32; REV 21:24–21:26

Under the sovereignty of God a succession of kingdoms will rule the earth

DAN 2:36–2:43, DAN 7:17, DAN 7:23–7:25, DAN 8:19–8:22

The kingdom of God will supersede and be greater than the kingdoms of this world

REV 11:15; JHN 16:33 See also DAN 2:44–2:45, DAN 6:26, DAN 7:13–7:14, DAN 7:18, DAN 7:27

God’s judgment on the kingdoms of this world

ZEP 3:8 See also PSA 79:6; ISA 10:10–10:11, ISA 13:19; JER 28:8; DAN 7:26; HAG 2:22; REV 6:15–6:17

God’s people will be given sovereignty over the kingdoms of this world

DAN 7:27 See also JER 1:10; REV 2:26–2:27

In this world God enables his people to overcome “kingdoms” by faith

HEB 11:32–11:33; ; 1JN 5:4

The devil tempts Jesus Christ by offering him the kingdoms of this world if he will worship him

MAT 4:8–4:10 parallel LUK 4:5–4:8

The kingdom of the air

EPH 2:1–2:2

The kingdom of Satan

See also MAT 12:26 parallel LUK 11:18

The kingdoms of the sea

ISA 23:11 The Phoenicians, who were great sailors, appeared to have dominion over the sea (see Isa 23:1–4), but in reality it belongs to God.

5368: kingship

The sovereignty and rule of a king. Scripture stresses that all human authority derives ultimately from God, and that human kings are required to acknowledge and respond to this divine authority.

5369: kingship, divine

God is sovereign over all the earth. Jesus Christ is the true King of Israel and David’s greater son.

The kingship of God**God is sovereign over all the earth**

1CH 29:11–29:12 See also EXO 15:18; 1CH 16:31; PSA 9:7–9:8, PSA 45:6, PSA 103:19; ISA 37:16

God is called king

PSA 29:10, PSA 47:6–47:7 See also 1SA 12:12; PSA 47:2, PSA 95:3; ISA 6:5, ISA 44:6; 1TI 1:17, 1TI 6:15; REV 15:3

God rules as king

PSA 96:10 See also PSA 47:8, PSA 93:1, PSA 97:1, PSA 99:1

The kingdom of God

MRK 1:14–1:15 See also PSA 145:11–145:13; MAT 4:17, MAT 4:23, MAT 11:12; LUK 4:43, LUK 11:20, LUK 16:16; 1CO 15:24; REV 11:15

The kingship of Jesus Christ

Jesus Christ is the true king of Israel and of the world
JHN 1:49 See also MAT 21:5; ZEC 9:9; MRK 15:2 parallels MAT 27:11, LUK 23:3; JHN 18:36–18:37; ACT 17:7; HEB 1:8; PSA 45:6; REV 17:14, REV 19:16

Jesus Christ is David's greater son

LUK 1:32–1:33; ACT 13:36–13:37 Jesus Christ is not only David's son but he is greater than David. See also MAT 1:1; MRK 12:35–12:37 parallels MAT 22:41–22:45, LUK 20:41–20:44; LUK 1:69; ACT 2:29–2:36, ACT 13:22–13:23; ROM 1:3; 2TI 2:8; REV 5:5, REV 22:16

The kingship of believers

2TI 2:12 See also EPH 2:6; 1PE 2:9; REV 2:26–2:27, REV 3:21, REV 5:10

5370: kingship, human

Human kings are to be respected. Israel demanded and received a king from God but the failure of kings after David led to the expectation of a coming great king in succession to David.

Human kingship

Human kingship is to be respected as ordained by God

ROM 13:1–13:7 See also 1TI 2:1–2:2; 1PE 2:13, 1PE 2:17

Allegiance to God is greater than allegiance to human kings

DAN 2:47; ; ACT 5:29; ; HEB 11:23, HEB 11:27

Kingship in Israel

Israel is ruled by God and his appointed leader

JDG 8:22–8:23, JDG 19:1, JDG 21:25; ; 1SA 7:15–7:17, 1SA 12:12

Israel demands and receives a king from God

1SA 8:4–8:9 See also DEU 17:14–17:20; 1SA 8:19–8:22, 1SA 10:1, 1SA 10:17–10:19, 1SA 10:24, 1SA 11:14–11:15, 1SA 12:12–12:15 The demand for a king is seen as a rejection of God's rule but at the same time the king is seen as a gracious gift from God; HOS 13:10–13:11

David is Israel's greatest king

1CH 29:26–29:28 parallel 1KI 2:10–2:12 **PSA 78:70–78:72** See also 1SA 16:13; 2SA 5:3–5:5 parallel 1CH 11:3; 2SA 8:1–8:14 parallel 1CH 18:1–18:13; 1KI 3:14, 1KI 11:6, 1KI 11:38; 2KI 14:3; PSA 18:50

God's covenant with David

2SA 7:8–7:16 parallel 1CH 17:7–17:14 See also 1KI 9:4–9:5 parallel 2CH 7:17–7:18; PSA 132:11–132:12

The failure of the kingship after David leads to the expectation of a future king like David

JER 33:15 See also ISA 9:6–9:7, ISA 11:1–11:5, ISA 16:5; JER 23:5–23:6, JER 30:8–30:9; EZK 34:23–34:24, EZK 37:24–37:25; AMO 9:11; MIC 5:2–5:5; MRK 11:10

Royal Psalms

These Psalms, although used for the king of the day, share the expectation of a greater future king. The NT regards them as fulfilled in Jesus Christ: PSA 2:6–2:9, PSA 45:1, PSA 72:1, PSA 110:1, PSA 132:11

5372: knife

The knife as a domestic cutting implement

Used for general purposes

PRO 23:2, PRO 30:14; ; JER 36:23 cutting a scroll

Knives used for shaving

LEV 19:27, LEV 21:5; ; JDG 16:17; ; ISA 15:2; ; EZK 7:18; ; MIC 1:16

Knives used in religious ceremonies

In circumcision

Flint rather than metal knives were used because of their sharpness: EXO 4:25; ; JOS 5:2–5:3

In sacrifice

GEN 15:10, GEN 22:10; ; EXO 29:17; ; LEV 8:20

Knives used for wounding

For self-mutilation

This practice was associated with pagan worship, sometimes as an expression of mourning: LEV 19:28, LEV 21:5; ; DEU 14:1–14:2; ; 1KI 18:28; ; JER 16:6, JER 41:5, JER 47:5, JER 48:37

In mutilation of others

As a punishment: EXO 21:23–21:25; ; LEV 24:17–24:20; ; DEU 25:12; JDG 1:6, JDG 16:21; 1SA 11:7

Knives used in figures of speech

For self-discipline

PRO 23:2; ; MAT 5:29–5:30, MAT 18:8–18:9; ; MRK 9:43–9:47

As a symbol of pruning

ISA 18:5; ; JHN 15:1–15:2

As a symbol of wickedness

PRO 30:14

5373: lamp and lampstand

A device to give light, especially in buildings, and the stand on which it was placed. They were both used as

symbols of the gospel or of churches which resulted from the preaching of the gospel.

Domestic lamps

PRO 31:18 See also 2KI 4:10; JER 25:10; DAN 5:5; LUK 15:8; ACT 20:8; REV 18:23

Lamps in the tabernacle and temple

2CH 4:7; HEB 9:2 See also EXO 25:31–25:40, EXO 26:35, EXO 30:27, EXO 31:8, EXO 35:14, EXO 37:17–37:24, EXO 39:37, EXO 40:4, EXO 40:24–40:25; NUM 4:9–4:10, NUM 8:1–8:4; 1KI 7:49; 2CH 4:19–4:21; JER 52:19

Tending the lamps

EXO 27:20–27:21 See also EXO 30:7–30:8; LEV 24:2–24:4; NUM 3:31; ISA 3:3; 2CH 13:11, 2CH 29:7

Lamps used metaphorically

2SA 21:17 The lamp of Israel represents the king; **PSA 119:105; MAT 5:15–5:16** See also MRK 4:21; LUK 8:16, LUK 11:33 **JHN 5:35; REV 1:12–1:13** The lampstands represent the seven churches. See also 2SA 22:29; JOB 18:5–18:6, JOB 29:2–29:3; PSA 18:28; PRO 13:9; ZEP 1:12; ZEC 4:2; MAT 6:22 parallel LUK 11:34–11:36; MAT 25:1–25:13 the parable of the ten virgins; LUK 12:35; REV 11:4, REV 22:5

5374: languages

The means of communication shared in common by groups of people. Scripture teaches that the diversity of languages in the world is a result of sin, but the outpouring of the Holy Spirit in Acts broke down the barriers of language and nationality.

The origin of different languages

GEN 11:1–11:9 See also GEN 10:2–10:5, GEN 10:20, GEN 10:30–10:31

The close relationship between language and national identity

ISA 19:18 See also NEH 13:23–13:27; ZEC 8:23; REV 5:9, REV 7:9, REV 10:11, REV 11:9, REV 13:7, REV 14:6, REV 17:15

Language barriers

NEH 13:23–13:24 See also DEU 28:49–28:50; PSA 81:5; JER 5:15; EZK 3:5–3:6; DAN 1:4; 1CO 14:10–14:11

The diversity of languages in the Persian empire

EST 8:9 See also EZR 4:7; EST 1:22, EST 3:12

God's revelation not limited to any single language

ACT 2:1–2:11 See also PSA 19:1–19:4; ACT 10:44–10:48

Aramaic

Aramaic in the OT

2KI 18:26 parallel ISA 36:11 Aramaic is a language related to Hebrew, known from Assyrian times. Under the influence of the Persian empire Aramaic was the diplomatic language in later OT times. In Palestine, by the time of the NT, it was spoken widely, having largely displaced Hebrew as the everyday language of the Jews. See also EZR 4:7 The text of Ezr 4:8–6:18 and 7:12–26 is in Aramaic; JER 10:11 The text of Jer 10:11 is in Aramaic; DAN 2:4 The text of Da 2:4–7:28 is in Aramaic.

By NT times Aramaic had become the common language of Palestinian Jews

JHN 20:16 See also JHN 5:2, JHN 19:13, JHN 19:17, JHN 19:20; ACT 21:40–22:2, ACT 26:14

Aramaic expressions found in the NT

MAT 27:46 parallel MRK 15:34 See also MAT 5:22; MRK 5:41, MRK 7:34, MRK 14:36; JHN 20:16; ROM 8:15; 1CO 16:22; GAL 4:6

Hebrew

2KI 18:26 parallel ISA 36:11 Hebrew was the language of Israel in the period of the OT. By the time of the NT, it had been partially displaced in everyday use by Aramaic. See also 2KI 18:28 parallels 2CH 32:18, ISA 36:13; REV 9:11, REV 16:16

Greek

JHN 19:20 Greek was the major cultural and commercial language of the eastern Mediterranean world. The NT was written in this language, ensuring the rapid spread of the gospel in this region. See also ACT 21:37–21:39; REV 9:11

5375: law

The God-given regulation of the life of the people of God in relationship with him. As the command of God, it enables and gives shape to the relationship between God and human beings on the one hand, and between fellow human beings on the other.

5376: law, purpose of

The law covers and regulates every area of life of the covenant people of God in accordance with the commands of God. Although the laws may be divided into categories of civil, criminal, social and cultic (or ritual) law, these distinctions are not clear-cut, and occasionally overlap with one another.

The origins of the law

Law as God's command is found in the story of creation

GEN 2:16–2:17

The law expresses the covenant relation between God and his people

DEU 4:44–4:45, DEU 5:1 See also EXO 20:1–20:17 parallel DEU 5:6–5:21; DEU 10:12–10:13, DEU 30:1–30:16

The purpose of the law

The law shows the proper response to the holiness of God

LEV 19:2

The law ensures that the people continue to receive the blessings of the covenant promises

DEU 6:24–6:25 See also GEN 22:17–22:18; EXO 20:12; DEU 6:3–6:7

Breaking the law leads to forfeiting the covenant blessings

JER 11:9–11:11 See also EXO 32:1–32:4

The law deepens the believer's knowledge of God through meditation

PSA 1:1–1:2 See also DEU 6:2; PSA 19:7–19:14, PSA 119:25–119:32, PSA 119:105–119:120

The law will finally be written on believers' hearts

JER 31:33 See also EZK 11:19–11:20

The general principles underlying the law

Justice

DEU 16:20

Righteousness

DEU 16:18

Holiness

LEV 19:2

Love

LEV 19:18–19:19

5377: law, Ten Commandments

The basic laws given to Israel through Moses following the exodus from Egypt (Ex 20:1–17; Dt 5:6–21). The first four commandments safeguard Israel's special relation to God; the remaining six protect individuals within the community and promote their well-being.

The Ten Commandments are to govern the life of Israel as the people of God

Israel should obey God alone

EXO 20:2–20:3 parallel DEU 5:6–5:7 See also DEU 6:13–6:15

Idolatry forbidden

EXO 20:4–20:6 parallel DEU 5:8–5:10 See also EXO 32:1–32:8; LEV 19:4; 1CO 10:7

God's name should not be misused

EXO 20:7 parallel DEU 5:11 See also MAT 7:21

A day of rest is commanded

EXO 20:8–20:11 parallel DEU 5:12–5:15 See also EXO 16:23; LEV 19:3; ISA 56:2; JER 17:21–17:22

Parents are to be honoured

EXO 20:12 parallel DEU 5:16 See also MAT 15:4; EPH 6:1–6:3

Murder is forbidden

EXO 20:13 parallel DEU 5:17 See also GEN 4:8–4:16; MAT 5:21

Adultery is forbidden

EXO 20:14 parallel DEU 5:18 See also LEV 18:20; 2SA 11:2–11:5; MAT 5:27; HEB 13:4

Stealing is forbidden

EXO 20:15 parallel DEU 5:19 See also LEV 19:11, LEV 19:13

False witness is forbidden

EXO 20:16 parallel DEU 5:20 See also LEV 19:11

Coveting is forbidden

EXO 20:17 parallel DEU 5:21 See also LEV 19:17–19:18; JOB 31:9–31:12; ROM 7:7

The circumstances surrounding the giving of the Ten Commandments

The Ten Commandments written on stone tablets

EXO 24:12 See also DEU 4:13, DEU 9:9–9:10

The stone tablets broken

EXO 32:19 Moses broke the stone tablets when he saw that the Israelites had sinned by making the golden calf. See also DEU 9:16–9:17

A second set of stone tablets made

EXO 34:1, EXO 34:28 See also DEU 10:1–10:2

The second set of stone tablets put in the ark of the covenant

EXO 40:20 See also DEU 10:1–10:2

5378: law, OT

OT laws and legal traditions govern every aspect of the life of the covenant people of God.

Kinds of OT law

Criminal law

EXO 21:12–21:14 Criminal law deals with crimes against persons punishable by a court.

Civil law

DEU 16:18–16:20 Civil law deals with the upholding in court of legally established rights against possible abuse. See also DEU 15:12–15:18

Social law

EXO 22:21–22:22 Social law deals with behaviour or standards of behaviour which are not strictly enforceable in the courts. See also DEU 24:19–24:22

Cultic law

Cultic law deals explicitly with the ritual or religious life of the people of God. Leviticus chapters 1–7 are totally devoted to this kind of law: LEV 1:10–1:13, LEV 4:13–4:21, LEV 7:11–7:18

Examples of OT law

Conditions for freeing servants

EXO 21:2–21:6 parallel DEU 15:12–15:18 See also EXO 21:3–21:11; LEV 25:39–25:55

Dealing with injuries

EXO 21:23–21:25 See also MAT 5:38

Property is to be protected

EXO 22:1 See also LEV 6:1–6:7; LUK 19:8

The rights of aliens must be respected

EXO 22:21 See also LEV 19:33; DEU 10:19

Justice must be universally respected

EXO 23:2–23:3 See also LEV 19:15

The Sabbath must be observed by all

EXO 23:12 See also EXO 20:8–20:11

Three annual festivals are to be celebrated

EXO 23:15–23:16 See also EXO 12:17; DEU 16:16

Worship must be in accordance with God's will and must be kept pure

DEU 12:1–12:7, DEU 13:6–13:8

Certain foods are declared to be unclean

LEV 11:1–11:23 parallel DEU 14:3–14:20

A tenth of all produce must be given to God

DEU 14:22 See also LEV 27:30

Cultic laws are grounded in the holiness of God

LEV 11:44, LEV 19:1–19:2 See also 1PE 1:16 LEV 1:3, LEV 2:1–2:2, LEV 3:1–3:2, LEV 4:27–4:28, LEV 5:17–5:18

Rules governing infectious or contagious diseases

LEV 13:2, LEV 15:13

There must not be unlawful sexual relations

LEV 18:6

A Day of Atonement must be held

See also LEV 23:26–23:32 parallels LEV 16:2–16:34, NUM 29:7–29:11

5379: law, Jesus Christ's attitude to

Jesus Christ accepted the authority of the OT law and saw himself as coming to fulfil its purpose.

Jesus Christ's disputes with the Pharisees and teachers of the law

The Pharisees and teachers of the law accuse Jesus Christ's disciples of not following tradition

MRK 7:5 parallel MAT 15:2

Jesus Christ accuses the Pharisees and teachers of the law of hypocrisy

MRK 7:6–7:8 parallel MAT 15:7–15:9 See also ISA 29:13

Jesus Christ gives examples where human tradition is observed rather than God's law

MRK 7:10–7:13 parallel MAT 15:3–15:6; ; MAT 23:1–23:36 parallels MRK 12:38–12:39, LUK 20:45–20:46

The Pharisees accuse Jesus Christ of breaking the Sabbath

MRK 2:23–2:24 parallels MAT 12:1–12:2, LUK 6:1–6:2

Jesus Christ demonstrates his authority over the Sabbath

MRK 2:27–3:4 parallels MAT 12:8–12:10, LUK 6:5–6:7

Jesus Christ challenges the religious leaders to think about principles not rules

MRK 3:4 parallels LUK 6:9, MAT 12:11–12:12 See also LUK 13:10–13:17

Jesus Christ came to fulfil the law

MAT 5:17, MAT 5:21–5:22 Jesus Christ went beyond the literal rules of the law, to the thought behind the act. See also EXO 20:13 **MAT 5:27–5:28** See also EXO 20:14

Jesus Christ asserts the continuing validity of the law

MAT 5:18–5:19; LUK 10:25–10:28 parallels MAT 22:37–22:39, MRK 12:29–12:34 See also LUK 10:29–10:37, LUK 16:16

Jesus Christ himself was obedient to the law and its commands

In honouring his parents

LUK 2:41–2:51

In being baptised

MAT 3:13–3:15

In resisting temptation

See also LUK 4:1–4:13

In observing the Passover

LUK 22:7–22:8

In submitting to the will of God

MAT 26:39 parallels MRK 14:35–14:36, LUK 22:41–22:42

5380: law, and gospel

The law, which bears witness to the grace of God, points ahead to its fulfilment and climax in the gospel of Jesus Christ. The gospel does not abolish the law, but fulfils it, by allowing it to be seen in its proper light.

Human beings cannot fulfil the law by their own efforts

ROM 3:20; GAL 2:15–2:16 See also ACT 13:39; ROM 4:13–4:15

The law brings knowledge of human sin and the need for redemption

ROM 3:20; ROM 5:20 See also 1TI 1:9–1:10; 1JN 3:4

The law points to the coming of Jesus Christ

GAL 3:24

Believers are not justified by works of the law, but through faith in the blood of Jesus Christ

ROM 3:28; GAL 3:11 See also HAB 2:4; ROM 4:1–4:5; GAL 3:10–3:14; EPH 2:15

The relationship between believers and the law

Dying to the law through Jesus Christ

GAL 2:19

The law remains valid for believers

ROM 7:11–7:12; 1TI 1:8; 1PE 1:15–1:16 See also LEV 11:44–11:45, LEV 19:2, LEV 20:7; ROM 7:7–7:11, ROM 13:8–13:10; JAS 2:8–2:11

The Holy Spirit enables believers to fulfil the law through Jesus Christ

ROM 8:3–8:4 See also JER 31:31–31:34; EZK 11:19–11:20; GAL 5:13–5:18

5381: law, letter and spirit of

A rigid adherence to the letter of the law often masks hypocrisy and neglect of its spirit, namely having God at the centre of one's life and putting others before oneself, or recognising that the law points to Jesus Christ.

The letter of the law

Overemphasis on keeping some parts of the law

MRK 7:1–7:8 parallel MAT 15:1–15:2 See also ISA 29:13; MAT 9:10–9:13 parallels MRK 2:15–2:17, LUK 5:29–5:32

Hypocrisy with regard to keeping the law

MRK 7:9–7:13 parallel MAT 15:3–15:6 See also MAT 23:1–23:33; LUK 11:37–11:52, LUK 18:9–18:14; JHN 9:1–9:16; ROM 2:17–2:24; ISA 52:5

The spirit of the law

Jesus Christ and the law

MAT 5:17–6:19 See also MAT 19:16–19:30 parallels MRK 10:17–10:30, LUK 18:18–18:30

Jesus Christ's attitude to the Sabbath

MRK 2:23–3:6 parallels MAT 12:1–12:14, LUK 6:1–6:11 See also MRK 1:21–1:28 parallel LUK 4:31–4:37; LUK 13:10–13:17, LUK 14:1–14:6; JHN 5:1–5:16, JHN 7:21–7:24

Jesus Christ's treatment of the woman taken in adultery

JHN 8:2–8:11

The greatest commandment

MAT 22:34–22:40 parallel MRK 12:28–12:34 See also MAT 25:31–25:46

The importance of obedience and right attitudes outweighs that of outward actions

ROM 2:25–2:29 See also 1SA 15:22–15:23; PSA 51:16–51:17; PRO 21:3; ISA 1:11–1:17; JER 7:21–7:23; HOS 6:6; AMO 5:21–5:24; MIC 6:6–6:8; GAL 3:1–3:5

The spirit of the law is embodied in the new covenant

2CO 3:3–3:6 See also JHN 4:19–4:24; ROM 7:4–7:6, ROM 8:1–8:11; 1CO 15:45–15:46; 2CO 3:13–3:18; GAL 5:18; HEB 7:18–7:22, HEB 8:1–8:13; JER 31:31–31:34

5383: lawsuits

Legal trials in which the court decides between two opposing parties. OT law makes provision for such trials, insisting on justice for all, regardless of social status.

Regulations relating to lawsuits

Warnings against discrimination on the basis of social status

EXO 23:6 See also EXO 23:3; LEV 19:15; DEU 1:17; PRO 22:22–22:23

Warnings against false testimony

EXO 23:1–23:2 See also EXO 20:16 parallel DEU 5:20; DEU 19:15–19:21; ZEC 8:16

Provision for a court of appeal

DEU 17:8–17:13 See also DEU 1:15–1:18

Lawsuits to judge between two parties

DEU 25:1 See also EXO 18:16, EXO 21:22; JOB 9:32–9:35; PRO 25:7–25:10, PRO 29:9; MAT 5:25–5:26; JAS 2:5–2:7

Believers should not bring lawsuits against each other

1CO 6:1–6:8

Injustice in lawsuits

AMO 5:15 See also ISA 29:20–29:21; AMO 2:7, AMO 5:7–5:12

Excess of lawsuits a symptom of social disorder
HOS 10:4

Examples of lawsuits

2SA 15:1–15:4 See also 2SA 14:1–14:20; 1KI 3:16–3:27; 2KI 6:26–6:29; ACT 18:12–18:16, ACT 19:35–19:41

5384: lawyer

A lawyer as a person skilled in the Mosaic law

MAT 22:35; ; LUK 7:30, LUK 10:25, LUK 10:37, LUK 11:45–11:46, LUK 11:52, LUK 14:3; ; TIT 3:13

A lawyer as a person trained in rhetoric

ACT 24:1 The word translated “lawyer” means literally “orator”: a person trained in rhetoric who served as an attorney-at-law in a court trial.

5385: leisure

Time for rest and recreational activities. Economic conditions in biblical times did not allow ordinary people much free time for leisure. However Scripture does give principles which apply to leisure.

5386: leisure, nature and purpose of

Scripture affirms that periods of rest and leisure are part of God’s creation order. These periods of rest are to be used wisely.

The need for leisure

The Sabbath rest

GEN 2:2; EXO 20:8–20:10 parallel DEU 5:12–5:15 See also EXO 23:11 During the sabbath year, the labourers presumably also rested; LEV 23:3

Rest commanded by Jesus Christ

MRK 6:31–6:32

Leisure a gift of God

PSA 23:2 See also MAT 11:28; MRK 2:27; REV 14:13

Loss of leisure a judgment

ISA 48:22 See also ECC 2:23, ECC 5:12; ISA 57:20–57:21; REV 14:11

Responsible use of leisure

Work must come first

PRO 10:5; ; LUK 17:7–17:8

Remember God’s presence

1CO 10:31 See also ECC 9:7–9:10

Use time wisely

EPH 5:15–5:16

The dangers of leisure

Idleness

1TI 5:13 See also PRO 6:9–6:11, PRO 24:30–24:31, PRO 26:14; ECC 10:18; 2TH 3:11; HEB 6:12

Preoccupation with pleasure

LUK 8:14 See also PRO 21:17; ISA 5:11; LUK 15:13; 1TI 5:6; 2TI 3:4; JAS 5:5

Susceptibility to sin

1TI 5:13 See also 2SA 11:1–11:5; EST 1:10–1:11; AMO 4:1

Spiritual complacency

AMO 6:1, AMO 6:4–6:7 See also ISA 5:11–5:13; LUK 12:16–12:21, LUK 21:34

5387: leisure, and pastimes

Scripture gives examples of many different kinds of leisure activity.

Necessary leisure activities

Sleeping

PSA 127:2; ECC 5:12 See also PSA 4:8; MRK 4:38; ACT 12:6

Eating and drinking

GEN 24:54; ; ECC 3:13

Pleasurable pastimes

Hospitality

GEN 18:3–18:5; ; 1PE 4:9

Feasting

1KI 3:15; ; NEH 8:10; ; EST 8:17; ; JOB 1:4

Music

1SA 16:23 See also 1SA 16:16–16:18; 2KI 3:14–3:15

Dancing

ECC 3:4 EXO 15:20; ; JDG 11:34; ; 1SA 18:6; ; JOB 21:11; ; JER 31:4; JDG 21:19–21:21; MRK 6:22 dancing in revelry; 2SA 6:14–6:16, 2SA 6:21; ; PSA 149:3, PSA 150:4

Physical recreation

1TI 4:8 See also 1CO 9:24–9:27 Although Paul never mentions Christians taking part in the games (which were often associated with pagan festivals), he does show an appreciation of the discipline necessary; 2TI 2:5

Gardening

ECC 2:5–2:6 See also GEN 2:15

Enjoyment of nature

PSA 8:3, PSA 104:10–104:14

Sightseeing

MRK 13:1; ; ACT 17:16

Education and literature

ECC 1:13 See also 1KI 4:32–4:34; EST 6:1; PRO 1:5; ECC 12:12; ACT 17:21; 2TI 4:13

Children's games

ZEC 8:5 See also MAT 11:16–11:17 parallel LUK 7:32

Harmful pastimes

Licentious amusements

1PE 4:3 See also GEN 9:20–9:21; EXO 32:19; PRO 23:29–23:30; ROM 13:13; EPH 5:4, EPH 5:12

Cruel amusements

JDG 16:25; ; 2SA 2:14

5389: lending

Freely giving the temporary use of property or possessions at no personal advantage. Scripture lays down conditions for lending and emphasises the responsibilities that it brings.

The motivation for lending

Generosity

PSA 37:25–37:26 See also DEU 15:11; PRO 3:27–3:28; MAT 5:42

Pity

DEU 15:7–15:8 See also LEV 25:35–25:36; MRK 14:7

Not necessarily expecting repayment

LUK 6:34–6:36

The dangers of lending

Domination

PRO 22:7 See also DEU 15:6, DEU 28:12–28:13, DEU 28:43–28:44; NEH 5:4–5:5

Loss

EXO 22:14; ; 2KI 6:5; ; ISA 24:1–24:2

Exploitation

LEV 25:36–25:37

Usury

EXO 22:25 See also DEU 23:19; PSA 15:5; EZK 18:8, EZK 18:12–18:13

Safeguards for the lender

Under the old covenant

EXO 22:14 This specific case probably represents a general principle of restitution governing all kinds of lending.

Under the new covenant

LUK 6:30–6:31

Generosity may be risky but brings its reward

PRO 19:17 See also PSA 112:5; MAT 5:7

Jesus Christ was lent a donkey

MAT 21:3 parallels MRK 11:3, LUK 19:31; ; LUK 19:34

5390: leprosy

An infectious skin disease. The leprosy mentioned in Scripture, however, covers a wider range of dermatological conditions than that now referred to as the modern Hansen's disease, known colloquially as leprosy.

Regulations for the control of leprosy

Sufferers are banned from society

NUM 5:2 See also LEV 13:1–13:46; DEU 24:8–24:9; 2KI 7:3

Sufferers are banned from Levitical service

LEV 22:4

Sufferers are to report to a priest on being cured

MAT 8:4 See also LUK 17:14; LEV 14:1–14:9

The healing of leprosy

2KI 5:1, 2KI 5:14; ; MAT 8:2–8:3 parallel MRK 1:40–1:41; ; LUK 17:12–17:15

Spiritual significance of leprosy

As a validating sign from God

EXO 4:6–4:7

As a judgment from God

NUM 12:10–12:15; ; 2KI 5:27; ; 2CH 26:19–26:23

5391: letters

A form of written communication often used for the transfer of instruction, information and advice or important news.

Letters of encouragement or exhortation

EST 9:30; 2TH 2:15; HEB 13:22 See also 2CH 2:11, 2CH 21:12; ISA 39:1; JER 29:1; ACT 15:23–15:31; 1CO 5:9; 2CO 10:9–10:11; COL 4:16; 1TH 5:27; 2PE 3:1

Malicious, threatening or devious letters

2SA 11:14–11:15; 2TH 2:1–2:2 See also 1KI 21:8; 2KI 19:14 parallel ISA 37:14; 2CH 32:17; EZR 4:7; NEH 6:5; NEH 6:19; ACT 9:1–9:2, ACT 22:5

Letters of authorisation or identification

EZR 7:11; 1CO 16:3 See also 2KI 5:5–5:6; NEH 2:7–2:9; ACT 23:25, ACT 23:33–23:34; 2CO 3:1

Affairs of state conducted by letter

EST 1:22 See also 2KI 10:1–10:3, 2KI 10:6–10:7; EZR 5:6–5:7

Letters as invitations to worship

2CH 30:1, 2CH 30:6; ; EST 9:20, EST 9:26, EST 9:29

Letters attributed to specific authors

Paul

ROM 1:1; ; 1CO 1:1 with Sosthenes; 2CO 1:1; ; PHP 1:1; ; COL 1:1; ; PHM 1:1; GAL 1:1; ; EPH 1:1; 1TH 1:1; ; 2TH 1:1; 1TI 1:1; ; 2TI 1:1; ; TIT 1:1; ; 2PE 3:15–3:16

James

JAS 1:1

Peter

1PE 1:1; ; 2PE 1:1

Jude

JUD 1:1

Jesus Christ

REV 2:1, REV 2:8, REV 2:12, REV 2:18, REV 3:1, REV 3:7, REV 3:14

Letters written by a secretary

ROM 16:22; ; 1PE 5:12

Letters of the alphabet

The letter of the law

MAT 5:18

Paul writing in large letters

GAL 6:11

5392: linen

Fine cloth woven from flax used in clothing and curtains. It was also used in burials.

People dressed in linen

Linen clothing

JDG 14:12–14:13 See also JER 13:1; HOS 2:5, HOS 2:9; MRK 14:51

It expressed prosperity

GEN 41:42 See also EST 8:15; ISA 3:23; EZK 16:10, EZK 16:13; LUK 16:19; REV 18:16, REV 19:8

It was worn by priests

LEV 16:23 See also EXO 28:39, EXO 28:42; LEV 6:10, LEV 16:4, LEV 16:32; 1SA 2:18, 1SA 22:18; 2SA 6:14; 1CH 15:27; 2CH 5:12; EZK 44:17–44:18

It was worn by angelic visitors

REV 15:6 See also EZK 9:2–9:3, EZK 9:11, EZK 10:2, EZK 10:6–10:7, EZK 40:3; DAN 10:5, DAN 12:6–12:7; REV 19:8, REV 19:14

Linen as an offering

EXO 25:3–25:4, EXO 35:5–35:6, EXO 35:23

Linen used to make things

In the tabernacle

EXO 26:1 See also EXO 26:31, EXO 26:36, EXO 27:9, EXO 27:16, EXO 27:18, EXO 28:5, EXO 28:8, EXO 28:15, EXO 38:9, EXO 38:16, EXO 38:18

Other products

PRO 31:22 See also EST 1:6; PRO 7:16; EZK 27:7

People skilled in working with linen

1CH 4:21 See also EXO 35:25, EXO 35:35, EXO 36:8, EXO 36:35, EXO 36:37, EXO 38:23, EXO 39:2, EXO 39:5, EXO 39:8, EXO 39:24, EXO 39:27–39:29; 2CH 2:13–2:14, 2CH 3:14; ISA 19:9

Regulations for wearing linen

DEU 22:11

Linen as merchandise

EZK 27:16 See also PRO 31:24; REV 18:12

Contaminated linen

LEV 13:47–13:48, LEV 13:52, LEV 13:59

Linen used as grave clothes

MAT 27:59 parallels MRK 15:46, LUK 23:53, JHN 19:40
See also LUK 24:12; JHN 11:44, JHN 20:5–20:7

5393: literacy

Literacy in the OT

2KI 19:14 See also 2KI 5:7, 2KI 23:2; NEH 8:2; JER 29:29, JER 51:61

Literacy in the NT

LUK 4:16; ACT 8:28; REV 1:3 See also ACT 13:15; 2CO 1:13; EPH 3:4; COL 4:16; 1TH 5:27; 1TI 4:13

The use of secretaries for reading and writing

2KI 22:8–22:10; ; EZR 4:18, EZR 4:23; ; EST 6:1; ; JER 36:4; ; ROM 16:22

Examples of literacy in Scripture

NEH 9:38; JHN 8:8; PHM 1:19 See also DEU 31:24–31:26; JOS 18:9; 1CH 28:19; LUK 1:63; JHN 19:20; ACT 15:27

Examples of illiteracy in Scripture

ISA 29:12

5394: lordship

The exercise of power and authority. Lordship belongs to God by nature but may be delegated to human beings. The lordship of Jesus Christ over humanity rests upon his divine nature.

5395: lordship, human and divine

Scripture recognises that human beings exercise authority in various capacities and ways. However, it insists that all human authority derives ultimately from God himself.

Human lordship within society

LUK 12:42

The lordship of masters over their servants

See also PSA 123:2; MAT 18:25, MAT 25:19; LUK 12:36, LUK 16:3; EPH 6:5, EPH 6:9; COL 3:22

The lordship of owners over their possessions

JDG 19:23; ; MRK 12:9 parallels MAT 21:40, LUK 20:15; ; LUK 19:33; ; GAL 4:1

The use of Lord (NIV ``Sir´) as a title of respect

MAT 27:63; ; LUK 13:8; ; JHN 12:21, JHN 20:15; ; ACT 16:30; ; 1PE 3:6

Human lordship within the church

MRK 10:42–10:45 parallels MAT 20:25–20:28, LUK 22:25–22:27

Christian lordship as a pastoral responsibility

1PE 5:2–5:3

The lordship of God

``Lord´ as a title for God

EXO 3:14–3:15 In the NIV, “Lord” indicates a person with authority (this can be used of God) and “LORD” indicates Yahweh, the special Israelite name for God, revealed here to Moses. EXO 6:3, EXO 6:6; ; ISA 6:1–6:5, ISA 45:5–45:8, ISA 45:18; ; HOS 2:20; LUK 1:32, LUK 2:9; ; REV 11:15, REV 16:7

God is Lord of heaven and earth

PSA 135:5–135:6; MAT 11:25 parallel LUK 10:21 See also PSA 2:2–2:4, PSA 57:11, PSA 97:9; DAN 2:47; ACT 17:24; 1TI 6:15

The revelation of the lordship of God

The word of the LORD is the authoritative revelation of God’s lordship

EZK 3:11; 1PE 1:25 See also ISA 40:8, ISA 1:2, ISA 45:19; JER 1:2, JER 1:9; EZK 1:3, EZK 2:4ROM 12:19; DEU 32:352CO 6:16–6:18; LEV 26:12; ISA 52:11; EZK 20:34, EZK 20:41; 2SA 7:14 JAS 5:10ACT 8:25, ACT 13:49, ACT 15:36, ACT 16:32, ACT 19:10, ACT 19:20

God’s lordship will be revealed to all on the day of the LORD

ISA 2:11–2:12, ISA 2:17; ZEP 1:14–1:18 See also ISA 13:6, ISA 13:9–13:11; JOL 2:1–2:2; AMO 5:18–5:20; 1CO 5:5; 1TH 5:2; 2TH 2:2; 2PE 3:101CO 1:8; 2CO 1:14

5396: lordship, of Jesus Christ

Jesus Christ has authority and dominion over the church and the world on account of his divine status, which was publicly demonstrated through his resurrection from the dead and exaltation to the right hand of God.

Lord as a title for Jesus Christ

ROM 10:9 In view of the OT background to the word “LORD” it is clear that this confession was not just of Jesus Christ’s authority but also of his divinity; **2CO 4:5** See also MRK 2:28 parallels MAT 12:8, LUK 6:5; JHN 13:13, JHN 20:28; ACT 9:17; 1CO 8:6, 1CO 12:3; EPH 4:5

Jesus Christ is the Lord of the church

COL 1:18 See also ROM 14:8; 1CO 5:4–5:5; 2CO 10:8, 2CO 13:10; EPH 1:22; COL 2:6

Jesus Christ is Lord over all

MAT 28:18; 1PE 3:21–3:22 See also ACT 10:36; 1CO 15:24–15:25; EPH 1:10; COL 2:10

The lordship of Jesus Christ is grounded in his resurrection from the dead

ACT 2:36; ROM 14:9 See also JHN 13:3; ROM 1:4; EPH 1:20–1:22; PHP 2:6–2:11; HEB 1:3–1:4

The exaltation of Jesus Christ to God's right hand

HEB 1:13 See also PSA 110:1; MRK 12:36 parallels MAT 22:44, LUK 20:42–20:43; MRK 14:62 parallels MAT 26:64, LUK 22:69; ACT 2:33–2:35; 1CO 15:25; EPH 1:20; COL 3:1; HEB 1:3, HEB 8:1, HEB 10:12–10:13, HEB 12:2

The coming of the Lord Jesus Christ will reveal his lordship

PHP 3:20; JAS 5:7–5:8 See also 1CO 1:7, 1CO 4:5; PHP 4:5; 1TH 3:13, 1TH 4:15–4:17; 2TH 2:1; 1TI 6:14

Believers look forward to the Lord's coming

1CO 16:22 See also REV 22:20

5398: loss

In a fallen world, believers are always liable to lose those things that they hold precious. Whilst offering comfort, Scripture urges believers to set their hearts upon eternal treasures, which cannot be lost.

Loss is part of a fallen world

MAT 6:19

Loss of property

Through theft

See also JOB 1:15, JOB 1:17

Through accident

GEN 31:39; ; EXO 21:33–21:34, EXO 22:15; ; 2KI 6:5

Through disaster

JOB 1:16; ; ACT 27:10, ACT 27:18–27:21

Through one's own fault

PRO 6:10–6:11, PRO 24:33–24:34, PRO 13:11, PRO 13:18; ; LUK 15:13

Through the judgment of God

JER 17:4; ; MAL 1:4

Loss of family and friends

Through bereavement

GEN 23:2, GEN 37:34, GEN 50:3; ; NUM 20:29; ; DEU 34:8; ; RUT 1:21 Naomi had lost her husband and her two sons; ; 2SA 12:18–12:23; ; 2KI 4:18–4:21; ; EZK 24:15–24:18; ; LUK 7:11–7:13

Through violence and disaster

2SA 1:12; ; JOB 1:18–1:19; ; ISA 47:8–47:9

Through alienation

JOB 19:13–19:22; ; PSA 31:11–31:12; ; 1CO 7:10–7:15

Losses in warfare

GEN 14:11–14:12; ; 1SA 4:17, 1SA 23:5, 1SA 30:1–30:2; ; 1KI 20:21; ; 2CH 13:17, 2CH 36:17–36:20; ; LUK 21:24

Other kinds of loss

Health and strength

PSA 31:9–31:10, PSA 32:3–32:4, PSA 102:3–102:5, PSA 102:11

Reputation

PSA 102:8; ; 2CO 6:8

Dignity

JOB 30:15

Power

DAN 4:31, DAN 7:26

Employment

LUK 16:1–16:3

Time

EXO 21:19; ; ACT 27:9

Spiritual loss

Of the ungodly

PRO 6:12–6:15; ; 2TH 1:8–1:10

Of the worldly

MAT 16:26 parallels MRK 8:36, LUK 9:25 See also LUK 12:20–12:21; HEB 12:16–12:17

Of the disobedient

MAT 7:26–7:27 parallel LUK 6:49

Of the Jewish nation

JER 50:6; ; MAT 21:43

Of the lazy servant

MAT 25:26–25:30

Of the careless worker

1CO 3:12–3:15

Of the apostate

See also HEB 6:4–6:6

Voluntary loss

By Jesus Christ for the salvation of humanity

PHP 2:6–2:11

For Jesus Christ

MAT 16:25 parallels MRK 8:35, LUK 9:24 **PHP 3:7–3:9** See also MAT 10:39, MAT 19:12; 1CO 4:9–4:13; HEB 10:34, HEB 11:24–11:26

Losses made good

By restitution

EXO 21:19, EXO 21:34

By recovery

LUK 15:4, LUK 15:8, LUK 15:20

By God's goodness

JOB 42:10; ; MAT 19:29 parallels MRK 10:29–10:30, LUK 18:29–18:30; ; ROM 11:12

God seeks the lost soul

LUK 19:10 See also LUK 15:4, LUK 15:8, LUK 15:20

Comfort in loss**God's comfort**

PSA 146:9; ; 2CO 1:3–1:4

The comfort of others

JOB 2:11; ; JHN 11:19; ; ACT 11:28–11:29; ; JAS 1:27

Treasures that cannot be lost

MAT 6:20 See also LUK 12:33; JHN 16:22; 1PE 1:3–1:5

5399: luxury

Opulence or grandeur of lifestyle which may be associated with wealth or status, especially royalty. Scripture warns of the dangers of unnecessary displays of luxury but encourages the right kind of splendour to reflect the glory and honour due to God.

Examples of luxurious lifestyles**The opulence of Solomon's court**

1KI 10:21 parallel 2CH 9:20 See also 1KI 4:22–4:24 Solomon's daily provisions; 1KI 7:1 Solomon's palace 1KI 10:18–10:20 parallel 2CH 9:17–9:19

Luxury enjoyed by other kings

LUK 7:25 parallel MAT 11:8 See also 1SA 8:11–8:17 Samuel warns Israel about what a king will demand of them; 2SA 7:2 David; 2CH 32:27–32:29 Hezekiah; EST 1:4–1:7 Xerxes; DAN 4:30 Nebuchadnezzar

Luxury enjoyed by the wealthy

LUK 16:19 The rich man in Jesus Christ's parable. See also ISA 3:18–3:23 upper-class women of Zion; AMO 6:4–6:6 the wealthy of Israel

Luxury accompanying high status

GEN 41:41–41:43 EST 6:7–6:8, EST 8:15; DAN 5:29 Daniel

Luxury enjoyed by a bride

PSA 45:13–45:15 See also ISA 61:10; JER 2:32; REV 21:2

Luxury and poverty**Luxury at the expense of the poor**

JAS 5:4–5:5 See also JER 22:13–22:14 King Jehoiakim; EZK 34:3 the leaders of Israel

Luxury brings responsibility to the poor

1TI 6:18 See also JER 22:15–22:16; LUK 16:20–16:21, LUK 19:8; ACT 4:34–4:35

The perils of luxury**Luxury brings a false sense of security**

LUK 12:19 See also JOB 31:24–31:25; PRO 11:28; 1TI 6:17

Luxury distracts from God

DEU 32:15 See also DEU 8:13–8:14; MAT 13:22 parallels MRK 4:19, LUK 8:14; MAT 19:21–19:24 parallels MRK 10:21–10:23, LUK 18:21–18:24; 1TI 6:10

Earthly luxury does not last

MAT 6:19 See also PRO 23:5, PRO 27:24; ISA 13:22 The luxurious lifestyle of the wicked will be swept away by God's judgment; JAS 5:1–5:3; REV 18:7–18:9

The right attitude to luxury

PHP 4:11–4:12 See also 1SA 2:7; JOB 1:21

The true source of beauty

1PE 3:3–3:4 See also 1TI 2:9–2:10

Luxury reflecting God's glory

EXO 25:3–25:9 parallel EXO 35:5–35:9 materials for the tabernacle; ; EXO 28:4–28:5 the priestly garments; ; 1KI 6:14–6:35 parallel 2CH 3:4–3:14 the splendour of Solomon's temple; ; MRK 13:1 parallel LUK 21:5 the magnificence of Herod's temple; ; REV 21:15–21:21 the glory of the new Jerusalem

5400: lyre**The lyre used in Israelite worship****In joyful religious celebrations**

2SA 6:2–6:5 parallel 1CH 13:6–13:8 See also 1SA 10:5; 1CH 15:25–15:28; NEH 12:27

In temple worship

2CH 5:12 See also 1KI 10:12 parallel 2CH 9:11; 1CH 15:16, 1CH 15:20, 1CH 16:5–16:6, 1CH 25:1, 1CH 25:6; 2CH 29:25

In praising God

PSA 71:22 See also PSA 33:1–33:3, PSA 57:7–57:8, PSA 81:1–81:2, PSA 92:1–92:4, PSA 108:1–108:2, PSA 144:9, PSA 150:3

The lyre used in pagan worship

DAN 3:7 See also DAN 3:5, DAN 3:10, DAN 3:15

The lyre in secular use

ISA 5:12

5401: madness

A term used in two different senses. The OT suggests that God may occasionally inflict a state of insanity upon individuals as a punishment. The term may also be used of someone whose words or actions are difficult to understand or easy to reject, as with Jesus Christ's preaching and healing.

Madness as a punishment

JER 25:15–25:16 See also DEU 28:28, DEU 28:32–28:34; JER 50:35–50:38, JER 51:7; DAN 4:28–4:37; ZEC 12:4

Madness linked with folly

ECC 7:25 See also PRO 26:18; ECC 1:17, ECC 2:12, ECC 9:3, ECC 10:13; 2PE 2:16

Accusations of madness against God's servants

JHN 10:19–10:21 See also 2KI 9:1–9:11; JER 29:25–29:28; HOS 9:7–9:8; MAT 12:24 parallels MRK 3:20–3:22, LUK 11:15; ACT 26:24–26:25; 2CO 5:13

David feigned madness to save his life

PSA 34:0 See also 1SA 21:10–21:15

5402: market

The market was a central feature of life in biblical times. Some of the biblical terms for redemption are drawn from the market-place.

Ancient market-places

1KI 20:34 Ahab's treaty with Ben-Hadad suggests that by the 9th century B.C. there was a highly developed system of international trade.; ISA 23:3; ; EZK 27:24

The market as a place of commerce

Methods of trading

Cash: GEN 23:10–23:18; ; JHN 2:14–2:16; GEN 47:17; ; HOS 3:2

Sealing transactions

RUT 4:7 with a sandal; ; JER 32:11–32:12 by signature

Other activities in the market-place

It was where children played

MAT 11:16–11:17 parallel LUK 7:32

It was where labourers waited for hire

MAT 20:3

It was where meat was sold

1CO 10:25 Some of this meat had come from pagan sacrifices.

It was where magistrates were present

ACT 16:19

God's work in the market-place

Jesus Christ healed the sick

MRK 6:56

Paul preached

ACT 17:16–17:17

Sins in the market-place

Greed, dishonesty and materialism

See also HOS 12:7; AMO 8:5; MIC 6:11

The hypocrisy of the Pharisees

MAT 23:7 parallels MRK 12:38, LUK 20:46; ; MRK 7:4 the problem was ritual defilement; ; LUK 11:43

Rough crowds

ACT 16:22, ACT 17:5

The temple courts become a market

JHN 2:14–2:16 parallels MAT 21:12–21:13, MRK 11:15–11:17, LUK 19:45–19:46

Markets will be destroyed in judgment

See also ZEP 1:11; REV 18:11–18:13

Biblical terms for redemption are drawn from market language

In the gospel call

PRO 8:3–8:5 The city gates were often places for business deals; ; ISA 1:18, ISA 55:1, ISA 55:2; ; MAT 13:45–13:46

God's people have been bought

ACT 20:28 See also EXO 15:16; PSA 74:2; 1CO 6:20, 1CO 7:23; 2PE 2:1; REV 5:9, REV 14:4

God's people have been redeemed

GAL 4:4–4:5 The Greek word "exagorazo" means "to buy" and was used, for example, of the buying of slaves. See also GAL 3:13–3:14; REV 14:3 The Greek "agorazo", translated here as "redeemed", may also be translated as "bought". Elsewhere (e.g., Tit 2:14; 1Pe 1:18), "lutro" meaning "to release" is used, conveying a similar idea.

Redeeming the time

The Greek "exagorazo" here translated as "make the most of"; EPH 5:16; ; COL 4:5

5403: masons

Building projects on which masons were employed

David's palace

2SA 5:11 parallel 1CH 14:1

Solomon's palace

See also 1KI 7:9–7:12

The temple

1KI 6:7; 1CH 22:14–22:15 See also 1KI 5:15–5:18 parallel 2CH 2:2; 2CH 2:18

The repair of the temple

2KI 12:11–12:12 parallel 2CH 24:12; ; 2KI 22:5–22:6 parallel 2CH 34:11

The rebuilding of the temple

EZR 3:7

Herod's temple

MRK 13:1–13:2

The work of masons**Skilled work**

2CH 2:13–2:14

Dressed stone was superior

ISA 9:10 The arrogant boast of the inhabitants of Samaria.

Dangerous work

ECC 10:9

Masons could make mistakes

PSA 118:22 See also MAT 21:42 parallels MRK 12:10, LUK 20:17 Jesus Christ interprets the saying as referring to his rejection by the Jews; ACT 4:11; 1PE 2:7

God is described as a mason

1PE 2:4–2:6 See also JOB 38:6; ISA 28:16

5404: masters

Those who obtain work from others, whether in the capacity of unpaid service or paid employment. Scripture sets out both the obligations and rights of masters in relation to those who work for them.

Masters have obligations to their servants**To deal fairly with them**

JOB 31:13–31:14 See also 2KI 22:7; JOB 31:38–31:40; MAT 10:10–10:11 parallel LUK 10:7; 1TI 5:18

To be generous

DEU 15:12–15:15, DEU 15:18 See also PHM 1:12–1:16

To make provision for rest and worship

DEU 5:12–5:15 parallel EXO 20:8–20:11 See also EXO 12:43–12:44; DEU 16:11–16:16

Not to defraud them

LEV 19:13 Day labourers were paid in the evening (see Mt 20:8). Delaying payment could cause great

hardship to a poor man. See also DEU 24:15; MAL 3:5; JAS 5:4

Not to exploit them

DEU 24:14 See also GEN 31:7, GEN 31:41; ISA 58:3; JER 22:13; ACT 16:16, ACT 16:19

Not to neglect them

DEU 12:19 See also DEU 14:27

Not to oppress them

EPH 6:9 See also GEN 16:6; EXO 1:11–1:14, EXO 21:20–21:21, EXO 21:26–21:27; LEV 25:39–25:55; 1KI 12:4, 1KI 12:10–12:14; ISA 30:12–30:13

God is the heavenly Master over earthly masters

COL 4:1 See also EPH 6:9; MAT 25:14–25:30 parallel LUK 19:12–19:26

Blessings promised to good masters

PRO 19:17 See also DEU 15:10; PRO 28:27

Examples of good and bad masters**Good masters**

GEN 18:19 Abraham; ; JOB 31:13–31:15 Job; ; LUK 7:2 a Roman centurion

Bad masters

GEN 16:6 Sarah; ; GEN 31:7 Laban; ; GEN 39:7–39:20 Potiphar's wife

5405: medicine

The means that God has given for the cure of physical troubles. Medicine often symbolises the application of the gospel of God's grace in Jesus Christ for the healing of moral and spiritual ills.

Preventative medicine**A cheerful disposition**

PRO 17:22

Disinfection

See also LEV 14:41, LEV 15:5

Salt

EZK 16:4

Physical exercise

1TI 4:8

Curative medicine**Balm**

JER 51:8 An example of medicine used as a picture of the gospel. The nation had the cure for its ills in the mercy of God if only it would repent and turn to him. See also JER 8:22, JER 46:11

Leaves**EZK 47:12** See also REV 22:2**Mud**

JHN 9:6 The connection between the medium used and the cure is not always clear. For example, the use of mud, spittle, oil and water appears sometimes to be more symbolic than practical.

Oil

MRK 6:13; ; LUK 10:34; ; JAS 5:14

A poultice**2KI 20:7** See also ISA 38:21**Spittle**

MRK 7:33

Water

LEV 15:5; ; 2KI 5:10; ; JHN 9:7

Wine**1TI 5:23** See also LUK 10:34**Eye salve****REV 3:18****Music**

The music was intended to cure moods of depression in Saul's case, and extreme agitation in Elisha: 1SA 16:23, 1SA 18:10; ; 2KI 3:14-3:15

Spiritual surgery

MAT 5:27-5:30; ; ROM 8:13

Soothing medicine**Myrrh****MRK 15:23****Oil**

See also ISA 1:6

Wine

PRO 31:6; ; MAT 27:48; ; LUK 23:36

Medicine cannot cure everything

DEU 28:27; ; JER 17:9, JER 30:12-30:13, JER 46:11; ; MRK 5:25-5:26

Application of the gospel as medicine**MAT 11:28** See also LUK 5:31-5:32**Resurrection as the ultimate medicine for all ills****1CO 15:42-15:44** See also PHP 3:20-3:21**5406: mercenaries**

Soldiers who offers their services for money, irrespective of the nationality of the army in question.

Mercenaries in the Egyptian army

JER 46:20-46:21 These mercenaries were drawn from Cush to the south of Egypt, Put to the west of Egypt and Lydia in north Africa.

Mercenaries in the Ammonite army

See also 2SA 10:6 parallel 1CH 19:7

Mercenaries hired by Jehoiada the priest

2KI 11:4, 2KI 11:19 The Carites were from Caria in south-west Asia Minor.

Mercenaries in the army of Judah

2CH 25:6

Fear of mercenary attack

2KI 7:6-7:7

5407: merchants

Traders who bought and sold goods and articles of value, often transporting their wares from one country to another according to the demands in different localities.

Some merchants transported their goods by caravan**GEN 37:25-37:28** See also JOB 6:15-6:21**Some merchants traded by sea**

PRO 31:14 See also 1KI 9:26-9:28 parallel 2CH 8:17-8:18; 1KI 10:11-10:12 parallel 2CH 9:10-9:11; 1KI 22:48 parallel 2CH 20:35-20:37; PSA 107:23; ISA 23:2-23:3; EZK 27:25

Merchants often lived close to one another**ZEP 1:11** See also NEH 3:31-3:32; EZK 17:4**Merchants set the standards for weights and measures****GEN 23:16** See also HOS 12:7; AMO 8:4-8:6**Ordinary citizens sold goods to merchants****PRO 31:24** See also GEN 37:28; PRO 31:18-31:19**Merchants were credited with wisdom and shrewdness****MAT 13:44-13:46****Goods traded by merchants****REV 18:11-18:13** See also SNG 3:6; EZK 27:12-27:24**Merchants flourished during Solomon's reign**

1KI 10:14-10:15 parallel 2CH 9:13-9:14 See also 1KI 10:21-10:22 parallel 2CH 9:20-9:21; 1KI 10:26-10:29 parallel 2CH 1:14-1:17

Foreign merchants in Jerusalem NEH 13:15–13:22

Cities famed for their merchants

Tyre

See also EZK 27:1–27:36

Tarshish

EZK 38:13; ; JON 1:3

Babylon the Great

REV 18:2–18:24

5408: messenger

An individual whose task is to convey information from one person to another. The word “angel” derives from the Greek word for “messenger”. The word “apostle” comes from the Greek work meaning “sent”.

Messengers conveying information from one person to another

PRO 13:17, PRO 25:13 There are many references to messengers in this sense. See also GEN 32:3; NUM 20:14; JDG 6:35; 1SA 23:27; 2SA 11:22, 2SA 15:13; 1KI 19:2, 1KI 22:13; 2KI 1:3 Elijah intercepts the messengers of Ahaziah; 2KI 5:10 Elisha sent a messenger with instructions for Naaman’s healing; 2KI 6:32; JOB 1:14; ISA 37:9 Sennacherib sends messengers to Hezekiah; JER 51:31; DAN 3:4; PHP 2:25

Messengers from God to humanity

The OT prophets

NUM 16:28; ISA 6:8 See also DEU 18:18; JDG 6:8; 2SA 12:25; 1KI 16:7; 2KI 17:13; ECC 5:6; ISA 41:27, ISA 42:19, ISA 48:16; JER 1:5 the call of Jeremiah; JER 7:25, JER 25:4, JER 26:4–26:6, JER 44:4 EZK 38:17; HAB 2:2; HAG 1:13; ZEC 4:9; MAL 1:1 “Malachi” means “my messenger”.

The priests

MAL 2:7

John the Baptist

See also MAT 11:10 parallels LUK 7:27, MRK 1:2; JHN 1:6; MAL 3:1

Apostles and teachers

GAL 1:1 See also MAT 23:34; MRK 3:14; LUK 11:49; ROM 1:5, ROM 11:13; 1TI 1:1, 1TI 2:7; 2TI 1:11

Angelic messengers

DAN 4:13; LUK 1:19 See also JDG 6:11–6:12; 1KI 19:5; ZEC 1:14, ZEC 3:6; MAT 1:20, MAT 2:13, MAT 2:19 LUK 1:11, LUK 1:28, LUK 2:9–2:10 The shepherds at Bethlehem heard God’s message through an angel; ACT 8:26, ACT 10:3 Cornelius receives instructions from an angel; GAL 1:8; HEB 2:2–2:3; REV 1:1, REV 22:16

Jesus Christ as God’s ultimate messenger

JHN 7:28–7:29 See also JHN 8:42, JHN 9:4, JHN 10:36, JHN 13:16, JHN 17:8; HEB 1:1–1:2, HEB 3:1

A messenger of Satan

2CO 12:7

5409: metaphor

An image which suggests similarities between two different ideas, without implying that they are identical. Scripture uses metaphors extensively, as a way of illustrating aspects of its teaching.

Examples of metaphors for God

Father

DEU 32:6; ; ISA 64:8; ; MAL 2:10; ; EPH 4:6

Rock

DEU 32:4 See also 1SA 2:2; 2SA 22:2; PSA 62:2, PSA 78:35

Shepherd

PSA 23:1 See also PSA 28:9, PSA 80:1; EZK 34:11–34:16

Examples of metaphors for Jesus Christ

Bread of life

JHN 6:35–6:51

Good shepherd

JHN 10:11, JHN 10:14

Light of the world

JHN 8:12, JHN 9:5

Examples of metaphors for the Holy Spirit

Counsellor

JHN 14:16, JHN 14:26, JHN 15:26, JHN 16:7

Breath

GEN 2:7; ; JOB 32:8, JOB 33:4, JOB 34:14

Wind

JHN 3:8

Examples of metaphors for the church

Bride

REV 19:7, REV 21:2–21:9, REV 22:17

Household of God

EPH 2:19; ; 1TI 3:15

Body of Christ

ROM 12:4; ; 1CO 12:12–12:27; ; EPH 1:22–1:23; ; COL 1:24

5410: midwife

Midwives assist at childbirth

GEN 35:17 See also GEN 38:28

Midwives ordered to kill all newborn boys**EXO 1:15–1:21****5411: mirror****Actual mirrors**

JOB 37:18 Mirrored glass was unknown in ancient times. Metal mirrors gave an adequate though imperfect reflection. See also EXO 38:8; ISA 3:23

Mirrors illustrating human attitudes

JAS 1:23–1:25 See also PRO 27:19; 2CO 3:18

Mirrors illustrating an imperfect human view of God

1CO 13:12

5412: money

Scripture stresses the positive and negative aspects of money, making it clear that the pursuit or love of money can easily lead to spiritual decay.

5413: money, attitudes to

Money can be a blessing or a snare according to one's attitude.

Money as a gift from God

DEU 8:18 See also 1SA 2:7; 1KI 3:13; PRO 8:18–8:21; 1TI 6:17

The dangers of money**Being ruled by money**

MAT 6:24 parallel LUK 16:13 See also EPH 5:5

Loving money

1TI 6:10 See also ECC 5:10; LUK 8:14, LUK 16:14; 1TI 3:3, 1TI 3:8; 2TI 3:2; TIT 1:7; HEB 13:5; 1PE 5:2

Trusting in money

1TI 6:17 See also DEU 8:12–8:14; JOB 31:24; PSA 52:7, PSA 62:10; PRO 11:4, PRO 11:28, PRO 27:24; ISA 10:3; JER 48:7; LUK 12:16–12:21 the parable of the rich fool; JAS 1:11, JAS 5:1–5:3; REV 18:14

Boasting in money

PSA 49:5–49:6 See also JER 9:23–9:24; HOS 12:8; JAS 4:13–4:16

Examples of those led astray by the love of money

Balaam: DEU 23:4; ; 2PE 2:15; JOS 7:20–7:21 Achan; ; 2KI 5:19–5:27 Gehazi; ; MAT 19:22–19:23 parallels MRK 10:22–10:23, LUK 18:23–18:24 the rich young ruler; ; MAT 26:14–26:15 parallels MRK 14:10–14:11, LUK 22:4–22:5 Judas Iscariot

Gifts and qualities that are better than money**Redemption**

PSA 49:7–49:9 See also ISA 52:3; MAT 16:26 parallels MRK 8:37, LUK 9:25; 1PE 1:18–1:19

Wisdom

PRO 4:7 See also PSA 49:20; PRO 3:13–3:16, PRO 8:10–8:11, PRO 16:16, PRO 17:16, PRO 20:15

A good reputation

PRO 22:1

A good wife

PRO 31:10

Healing

ACT 3:6

Spiritual power

ACT 8:19–8:20

Spiritual riches

ISA 55:1 See also REV 3:18

5414: money, stewardship of

The righteous handling of money is an important practical test of godliness.

Money must be obtained honestly**Not by theft**

EXO 20:15 parallel DEU 5:19 See also PRO 10:2, PRO 19:26; MRK 10:19

Not by fraudulent practices

LEV 19:13 See also PRO 11:1, PRO 13:11, PRO 20:10; EZK 28:18

Not by usury

EXO 22:25 See also PSA 15:5; PRO 28:8

Not at the expense of justice

EXO 23:8 See also PRO 15:27, PRO 16:8; JER 17:11

Not by extortion

LUK 3:13 See also EZK 22:12

Not by oppression

JAS 5:4 See also PRO 22:16; EZK 18:7–18:8; AMO 5:11; MAL 3:5

Not at the expense of health

PRO 23:4

Not at the expense of witness

GEN 14:22–14:23; ; 3JN 1:7

Not at the expense of spiritual well-being

MAT 16:26 parallels MRK 8:36, LUK 9:25; ; LUK 12:16–12:21; ; 1TI 6:9

By work, trade, investment or inheritance

2TH 3:12 See also GEN 15:2, GEN 34:21; PRO 13:11, PRO 13:22, PRO 14:23, PRO 19:14; MAT 25:27 parallel LUK 19:23

Money must be cared for diligently**Personal money**

PRO 27:23–27:24

Money held on trust

2KI 22:4–22:7; ; MAT 25:14–25:27; ; LUK 16:10–16:12; ; 1CO 4:2

Money must be used in a God-honouring way**For the support of the family**

1TI 5:8 See also 1TI 5:16

For benefiting the poor, especially God's people

GAL 6:10 See also PRO 19:17, PRO 28:27; MAT 6:3–6:4; LUK 12:33; JHN 13:29; ACT 2:45; ROM 15:26; GAL 2:10; 1TI 6:18

For the work of God's kingdom

GAL 6:6 See also PRO 3:9–3:10; MAL 3:10; LUK 8:3, LUK 16:9; PHP 4:14–4:19; 1TI 5:17–5:18

Examples of godly people who have used their money well**Those who were wealthy but godly**

GEN 13:2, GEN 26:14, GEN 30:43; ; 2SA 19:32; ; 2CH 9:22; ; JOB 1:3; ; MAT 27:57; ; ACT 4:34–4:36

Those who had little but gave much

MRK 12:41–12:44 parallel LUK 21:1–21:4; ; 2CO 8:1–8:4

5415: money, uses of

Monetary transactions have taken place from the earliest biblical times. Originally precious metals were weighed out; coins were introduced later.

The first mention of money

GEN 17:12

The use of money**For the purchase and sale of land**

GEN 23:14–23:15 See also JER 32:9–32:10; MAT 27:7; ACT 4:34, ACT 5:1–5:2, ACT 7:16

For the purchase and sale of food

GEN 41:57, GEN 42:5, GEN 42:35; ; 2KI 7:16; ; JHN 6:5, JHN 6:7; ; REV 6:6

For other merchandise

REV 18:11–18:13 See also GEN 37:25; JAS 4:13

For religious offerings

EXO 30:11–30:16 See also NUM 3:44–3:48; DEU 12:4–12:6; 2KI 22:4–22:6 parallel 2CH 34:9–34:11; EZR 7:15–7:17

For gifts to the poor

MAT 26:9 parallels MRK 14:5, JHN 12:5 See also ACT 3:3

For wages

MAT 20:2 See also JAS 5:4

For investment and moneylending

MAT 25:27 parallel LUK 19:23 See also EXO 22:25; NEH 5:10–5:11; LUK 6:34–6:35

For provision for the future

ECC 7:12

For the settlement of disputes

EXO 21:8–21:11, EXO 21:35, EXO 22:15

For taxes

MAT 17:24 See also 1KI 10:15; NEH 5:4; MAT 22:17–22:19 parallels MRK 12:15, LUK 20:22–20:24

For tribute money

2KI 15:19–15:20

For the purchase of slaves

LEV 22:11

For bribery

EST 3:9; ; MAT 28:12–28:13; ; ACT 24:26

Fortune-telling for money

MIC 3:11; ; ACT 16:16

Blood money

MAT 27:6

Money changers

MAT 21:12 parallels MRK 11:15, JHN 2:14

5418: monotony

The sameness that arises through dull and wearisome routines, and which cause individuals to feel bored. Scripture often portrays monotony as a cause of sin, in that individuals, in seeking excitement, often fall into sinful practices.

Monotony can give rise to sin**Discontent in the desert**

NUM 11:4–11:6 See also EXO 16:2–16:3, EXO 16:35; NUM 14:33 The monotony of 40 years in the desert was a judgment on Israel's unbelief.

At Sinai impatience leads to idolatry

EXO 32:1 See also EXO 32:23; ACT 7:40

Situations which give rise to monotony

Desert

PSA 107:4–107:5 See also DEU 1:19; ISA 40:30; MRK 1:12–1:13

Prison

PSA 107:10 See also JDG 16:21; PSA 66:11; JER 38:6; MAT 4:12; REV 2:10

Illness

PSA 107:17–107:18 See also LEV 26:15–26:16; JOB 30:16–30:17; PSA 6:3; LUK 13:11; JHN 5:5

Storm at sea

PSA 107:25–107:26 See also JON 2:3; ACT 27:27

Darkness

PSA 143:3 See also EXO 10:22; PSA 130:6; MRK 15:33; LUK 2:8

Work

GEN 3:17–3:19 See also JOB 7:2; ECC 2:11; GAL 6:9; REV 2:2–2:3

Siege

2KI 6:25 See also 2KI 25:2; ISA 36:12

Slavery

EXO 2:23 See also JOB 7:2; 1TI 6:1; 1PE 2:18

Sleeplessness

JOB 7:4 See also EST 6:1; JOB 30:17; ECC 5:12; DAN 6:18; HEB 12:3

Monotony arising from difficult human relations

A nagging wife

PRO 19:13 See also PRO 27:15

Unhelpful counsellors

JOB 6:6 This refers to the useless advice of Job's friends. See also COL 4:6 This, by contrast, is how the conversation of Christians is to be characterised.

5419: mourning

The expression of grief at a time of bereavement or repentance, often accompanied by weeping, tearing of clothes and wearing sackcloth.

Regulations for the mourning of priests after bereavement

LEV 21:1–21:4, LEV 21:10–21:11

Mourning of God's people after bereavement

Israel for Aaron

NUM 20:29

Israel for Moses

DEU 34:8

David for Saul and Jonathan

2SA 1:11–1:12 See also 2SA 1:17–1:27

David for Absalom

2SA 18:33

Job for his children

JOB 1:20–1:21

Other examples

See also GEN 37:34–37:35, GEN 50:11; 2SA 13:31, 2SA 14:2; 2CH 35:23–35:25; MAT 2:18; JHN 11:31, JHN 11:33; ACT 8:2

Examples of heathen mourning after bereavement

ISA 15:2–15:3; ; JER 47:5, JER 48:37; ; EZK 27:30–27:32

Mourning as an expression of repentance

EXO 33:4; ; EZR 9:3–9:6

Mourning because of misfortune

2SA 13:9; ; JOB 2:12–2:13

The employment of professional mourners

JER 9:17–9:18; ; AMO 5:16; ; MAT 9:23 parallels MRK 5:39, LUK 8:52

Mourning spoken of metaphorically

JER 7:29 See also ISA 3:18–3:24; EZK 7:18; JOL 1:8; AMO 8:10; MIC 1:16

As a sign of repentance for sin

JOL 2:12–2:13 See also ISA 22:12

5420: music

Music played a major role in the lives of people in biblical times. It was used in both sacred and secular activities and was most often associated with joy and celebration.

Music comes from God

God's presence inspires music

PSA 96:13 See also PSA 98:4

It is a gift of God

JOB 35:10

Music was closely associated with praise and worship

PSA 33:2 See also JDG 5:3; NEH 12:27; PSA 27:6, PSA 57:7, PSA 81:1–81:2, PSA 87:7, PSA 92:3, PSA 95:2, PSA 98:4, PSA 108:1, PSA 144:9, PSA 147:7, PSA 149:3, PSA 150:1–150:6; EPH 5:19–5:20; COL 3:16

Music was employed extensively in the tabernacle and the temple

1CH 25:6–25:7 See also 1CH 6:31–6:32, 1CH 25:1; 2CH 5:12–5:14, 2CH 35:15; EZR 2:65

Music and the psalms

Many psalms are dedicated to the “director of music”

PSA 11:0 See also PSA 13:0, PSA 31:0, PSA 42:0, PSA 49:0, PSA 77:0, PSA 139:0; HAB 3:19

The titles of some psalms probably give an indication of melody

PSA 9:0 See also PSA 22:0, PSA 45:0, PSA 56:0, PSA 57:0, PSA 58:0, PSA 59:0, PSA 60:0, PSA 69:0, PSA 75:0, PSA 80:0

The titles of some psalms indicate specific musical accompaniment

PSA 4:0 See also PSA 5:0, PSA 6:0, PSA 54:0, PSA 55:0, PSA 61:0, PSA 67:0, PSA 76:0; HAB 3:19

Uses of music

To celebrate victory

2CH 20:27–20:28 See also EXO 15:1–15:21; JDG 5:1–5:31; 1SA 18:6–18:7; ISA 30:32

At times of celebration

GEN 31:27 See also JOB 21:12; ISA 16:10; LAM 5:14; EZK 26:13; LUK 15:25; REV 18:22

At banquets

ISA 5:12 See also AMO 6:4–6:6

As an expression of joy

1SA 18:6–18:7 See also 2SA 6:5; 1KI 1:40; JOB 21:12; JAS 5:13

For pleasure

ECC 2:8 See also 2SA 19:35

For divine inspiration

2KI 3:14–3:15; ; 1SA 18:10

To relieve depression

1SA 16:23 See also 1SA 16:16–16:18

At times of mourning

2SA 1:17–1:18; MAT 9:23 See also JOB 30:31, JOB 35:10; JER 48:36

Prophets sometimes prophesied to musical accompaniment

1SA 10:5–10:6 See also 2KI 3:14–3:19

Lack of music is a sign of judgment

ISA 24:8 See also REV 18:22

Music in pagan worship

DAN 3:5 See also DAN 3:7, DAN 3:10, DAN 3:15

Music played by prostitutes

ISA 23:16

The misuse of music

PSA 69:12 See also PSA 137:3; DAN 3:4–3:7; AMO 5:23, AMO 6:5

5421: musical instruments

Scripture names a large number of musical instruments, particularly in the OT, reflecting the importance of music in Israelite worship and culture.

Wind instruments

Trumpets

EXO 19:16, EXO 20:18; ; LEV 25:9; ; JDG 3:27; ; 1KI 1:39; ; PSA 150:3; ; REV 8:7–8:13

Flutes

GEN 4:21; ; JOB 21:12; ; PSA 150:4; ; DAN 3:5–3:15; ; MAT 9:23, MAT 11:17

Horns

PSA 98:4–98:6 The NIV translates several different Hebrew words as “ram’s horn” or “horn”, including “shophar” (Ps 81:3) which is translated elsewhere as “trumpet”. The horn was a very similar instrument to the trumpet, being made from the horn of an animal, usually a ram. See also EXO 19:13; 2CH 15:14; PSA 81:3

Stringed instruments

Harps

GEN 4:21; ; 1SA 16:18; ; JOB 30:31; ; PSA 43:4, PSA 81:2, PSA 149:3, PSA 150:3; ; DAN 3:5–3:11; ; REV 5:8

Lyres

PSA 33:2, PSA 71:22, PSA 81:2, PSA 108:2, PSA 144:9; ; DAN 3:5–3:10

Several of the psalms were intended to be sung to the accompaniment of stringed instruments

PSA 4:0 See also PSA 6:0, PSA 54:0, PSA 55:0, PSA 61:0, PSA 67:0, PSA 76:0

Percussion instruments

Tambourines

PSA 149:3; ISA 5:12 See also GEN 31:27; EXO 15:20–15:21; JDG 11:34; 1SA 10:5, 1SA 18:6–18:7; 2SA 6:5 parallel 1CH 13:8; JOB 21:12; PSA 68:24–68:25, PSA 81:1–81:2, PSA 150:4; ISA 24:8, ISA 30:32; JER 31:4

Cymbals

PSA 150:1–150:6; 1CO 13:1 See also 2SA 6:5 parallel 1CH 13:8; 1CH 15:16, 1CH 15:19, 1CH 16:5, 1CH 16:42, 1CH

25:1, 1CH 25:6 1CH 15:28; 2CH 5:12–5:13, 2CH 29:25; EZR 3:10; NEH 12:27

Sistrums

2SA 6:3–6:5

Babylonian instruments

DAN 3:4–3:5 See also DAN 3:7, DAN 3:10, DAN 3:15; REV 18:21–18:22

5422: musicians

Players of musical instruments. Levitical musicians played an extensive role in Israelite worship. Other musicians are also mentioned in Scripture, in both sacred and secular contexts.

Levitical musicians in the tabernacle

Appointed by David

1CH 6:31–6:47 See also 1CH 15:16–15:17, 1CH 25:1–25:5

Responsibilities

1CH 15:19–15:21 See also 1CH 15:16, 1CH 25:6–25:7

Allocation of duties

1CH 25:8–25:31

Levitical musicians in the temple

2CH 5:12–5:13 See also 1CH 9:33; 2CH 35:15

Other musicians

Jubal was the first musician

GEN 4:17–4:21

King David was a renowned musician

1SA 16:15–16:18 See also 1SA 16:23, 1SA 18:10–18:11, 1SA 19:9–19:10; 2SA 6:5, 2SA 23:1

Unidentified musicians

PSA 68:24–68:25 See also 2KI 3:11–3:19; PSA 137:1–137:3; REV 18:21–18:22

5423: myths

Stories that are made up and which are contrary to right doctrine or holy living.

Some prefer myths to truth

2TI 4:3–4:4

Myths are harmful to the body of Christ

1TI 1:3–1:4 See also 1TI 4:6–4:8

Sound teaching by God's servants dispels myths

TIT 1:13–1:14 See also 1TI 4:1–4:6; TIT 1:9–1:11

5424: nationalism

A concern to preserve or proclaim the distinctive features of a nation or people.

The recognition of different national groups

GEN 10:32 Ge 10:32 is the summary conclusion of the table of nations which begins in Ge 10:1. See also GEN 17:4–17:6, GEN 19:36–19:38; EXO 3:8; 1KI 9:20 parallel 2CH 8:7

Israel was to be a special nation set apart for God

The choosing of the nation of Israel

EXO 19:5–19:6 See also GEN 12:1–12:3; EXO 33:13; DEU 7:6–7:8, DEU 14:2; 2SA 7:23 parallel 1CH 17:21; PSA 33:12; ROM 9:4–9:5

The mission of Israel to the nations

EXO 34:10 See also DEU 4:6

Examples of nationalism

Positive examples

RUT 1:16–1:17 See also EXO 8:23, EXO 34:24; DEU 26:5; ISA 10:6

Negative examples

ISA 1:4 See also NUM 13:31–13:32, NUM 24:14; 1KI 22:4; PRO 14:34; ISA 14:1–14:2; JER 49:31; EZK 36:5; JOL 1:6, JOL 3:2

The people of God transcend all national boundaries

The church is God's holy nation

1PE 2:9–2:10 See also EPH 2:19

People of all nations are included

MAT 8:11 See also MAT 28:19; ACT 11:18, ACT 11:20–11:21; REV 5:9, REV 7:9, REV 14:6

Christian unity is greater than nationalism

GAL 3:26–3:29 See also ROM 9:6–9:8; EPH 2:11–2:13

5425: net

Instruments of meshed string, used for fishing or hunting. The term can also be used in a symbolic manner, to refer to the way in which people are ensnared by sin or by their enemies.

Nets used in fishing and hunting

ISA 51:20; EZK 47:10; MAT 4:18 See also PRO 1:17; ISA 19:8; EZK 26:5; MAT 4:21 parallel MRK 1:19; MAT 13:47; MRK 1:18; LUK 5:2–5:4; JHN 21:6

Nets used metaphorically

To describe people being caught by others

PRO 29:5; HAB 1:15–1:17 See also JOB 18:8; PSA 9:15, PSA 10:9, PSA 25:15, PSA 35:7, PSA 57:6, PSA 140:5, PSA 141:10; ECC 9:12; EZK 19:8; HOS 5:1; MIC 7:2

To describe being caught by the Lord

JOB 19:6; HOS 7:12; LUK 5:10 See also LAM 1:13; EZK 12:13, EZK 17:20, EZK 32:3

Networks used in design

EXO 27:4–27:5; ; 1KI 7:17; ; JER 52:22

5426: news

Information on significant or recent events conveyed through a variety of official or unofficial means. The ministry of Jesus Christ centred on the good news of the kingdom. The Greek word for “gospel” means “good news”.

Political news reported by official and self-appointed messengers

1SA 31:8–31:9 See also 2SA 1:1–1:10, 2SA 15:13, 2SA 18:19–18:32; 2KI 7:8–7:11

Personal news conveyed through friends, relatives and by letter

COL 4:7–4:9 See also GEN 29:11–29:13; PHP 2:19–2:20

Divine news announced by angels

LUK 1:19 See also GEN 19:1; LUK 1:26–1:33, LUK 2:8–2:12

The effect of good news

PRO 25:25 See also GEN 45:16; PRO 15:30; NAM 3:18–3:19; JHN 4:51–4:53; 1TH 3:6–3:10

Reactions to bad news

JER 49:23 See also 1SA 4:12–4:22; 2SA 4:10; JOB 1:14–1:21; JON 3:1–3:10; JHN 11:1–11:6

The good news of Jesus Christ

Foretold

NUM 24:17; ; ISA 7:14, ISA 9:7, ISA 11:2, ISA 53:3–53:12, ISA 61:1–61:3; ; MIC 5:2; ; ZEC 9:9, ZEC 11:12–11:13

Announced and demonstrated by Jesus Christ

MAT 4:23 See also MAT 11:5; MRK 1:15; LUK 4:17–4:19, LUK 4:43

Proclaimed by apostles and preachers

ACT 14:21 See also MRK 16:15; ROM 10:14–10:15; 2TI 1:11

Spread by word of mouth

ACT 11:19–11:20 See also MAT 4:24

Receiving the good news

ACT 8:12

Rejecting the good news

ROM 10:16

5427: nomads

People who moved about from place to place, having no settled abode. They lived in tents and frequented desert places

Examples of nomads

The patriarchs

PSA 105:12–105:13; HEB 11:8–11:9 See also GEN 12:8, GEN 13:3, GEN 13:15, GEN 13:18, GEN 26:25, GEN 31:25, GEN 35:21; DEU 26:5; 1CH 16:18–16:20

Israel during her desert wanderings

NUM 32:13 See also 1CH 17:5–17:6 The Tabernacle was designed as a place of worship during this nomadic existence.

Other nomadic peoples

GEN 4:20 Jabbal; ; JDG 4:17 the Kenites; JDG 6:3; ; HAB 3:7; PSA 120:5; ; JER 49:28–49:29; ; EZK 25:4; ISA 13:20 Arabs; ; JER 35:1–35:11 The Recabites retained their nomadic ways long after Israel had settled in the land of Canaan.

Desert tracks followed by nomads

JDG 8:11; ; JER 3:2

The nomadic life as a spiritual symbol

1PE 2:11 See also HEB 11:13–11:16; 1PE 1:17

Jesus Christ as a nomad

MAT 8:20

5428: nurse

A woman who breast-feeds an infant.

The child's mother as nurse

GEN 21:7 See also 1KI 3:21

A servant as nurse

EXO 2:7 See also EXO 2:9

Often wet-nurses remained in the family after the child was weaned

GEN 24:56–24:59 See also GEN 35:8; 2SA 4:4; 2KI 11:2–11:3 parallel 2CH 22:11

Metaphorical use

NUM 11:12 See also ISA 66:9–66:13; LAM 4:3

5429: oaths

Solemn, binding promises, the truth of which are affirmed by appeal to God as witness. God himself makes solemn oaths to individuals. Scripture makes clear that oaths should be made wisely and not be broken.

5430: oaths, human

Solemn, binding statements made in God's name. The OT forbids the making of oaths in the name of other gods and the NT suggests that it is best to refrain from making oaths.

Oaths are considered binding

NUM 30:2 See also DEU 23:21; MAT 23:16–23:22

Oaths to be taken only in God's name

DEU 6:13 See also PSA 24:3–24:4; JER 12:16

False oaths forbidden

LEV 19:12 See also EXO 20:7 parallel DEU 5:11; LEV 6:3–6:5; ZEC 5:3–5:4

Examples of oaths

In bearing witness

EXO 22:11; ; NUM 5:19; ; 1KI 8:31

In showing allegiance

2KI 11:4; ; ECC 8:2; ; JER 38:16; ; EZK 17:13

In covenants

GEN 21:22–21:31, GEN 26:26–26:31, GEN 31:44–31:53; ; JOS 9:3–9:21

As a curse

JOS 6:26; ; MAT 26:71–26:74 parallel MRK 14:70–14:71

As assurance that a promise will be kept

GEN 14:22–14:23 See also GEN 24:3–24:9, GEN 24:37–24:41, GEN 47:28–47:31, GEN 50:24–50:25; PSA 132:1–132:5

Unwise or thoughtless oaths

GEN 25:33 See also LEV 5:4; MAT 14:6–14:7 parallel MRK 6:22–6:23

Advice against taking oaths

JAS 5:12 See also MAT 5:33–5:37

5431: oaths, divine

Solemn promises made by God to individuals and their offspring. He swears by himself because there is nothing greater to swear by.

God swears by himself

HEB 6:13–6:14 See also GEN 22:16; PSA 89:35; ISA 45:23, ISA 62:8; HEB 6:16–6:18

Examples of God's promises by oath

To Abraham

GEN 22:15–22:18 See also GEN 24:7, GEN 26:3; EXO 33:1; DEU 6:18, DEU 7:8; LUK 1:72–1:73

To David

PSA 132:11–132:12 See also 2SA 3:9–3:10, 2SA 7:11–7:16; PSA 89:3–89:4, PSA 89:35–89:37; ACT 2:30

To his anointed one

PSA 110:4 See also HEB 7:17–7:28

To the generation in the wilderness

DEU 1:34–1:36 See also NUM 14:20–14:35; HEB 3:10–3:11; PSA 95:10–95:11

To Israel

DEU 29:12–29:15 See also EZK 16:8

5433: occupations

Professions, trades and means of employment. A great variety of occupations, both secular and religious, are mentioned in Scripture.

Builders

PSA 127:1 See also PSA 118:22; MAT 21:42 parallels MRK 12:10, LUK 20:17; ACT 4:11; 1CO 3:10–3:15; HEB 3:3; 1PE 2:7

Embroiderers

EXO 38:23

Weavers and spinners

EXO 39:22; ; PRO 31:19

Stonemasons

2KI 12:12, 2KI 22:5–22:6

Carpenters and woodworkers

2KI 22:5–22:6; ; MAT 13:55

Musicians

1CH 15:19–15:22, 1CH 16:42; ; HAB 3:19

Tanners

ACT 9:43 See also ACT 10:6, ACT 10:32

Linen workers

1CH 4:21

Washermen

ISA 7:3 See also 2KI 18:17 parallel ISA 36:2

Blacksmiths

ISA 44:12 See also 1SA 13:19–13:21; ISA 54:16

Merchants

NEH 3:31–3:32 See also 1KI 10:14–10:15, 1KI 10:28–10:29 parallel 2CH 1:16–1:17; NEH 13:19–13:21; HOS 12:7; MAT 13:45–13:46

Tentmakers

ACT 18:1–18:3

Soldiers

2KI 5:1 See also MAT 8:5–8:13 parallel LUK 7:1–7:10; LUK 3:14; ACT 10:1–10:8; 2TI 2:3–2:4

Priests

GEN 46:20 See also GEN 14:18; EXO 18:1, EXO 28:3, EXO 40:13; JDG 17:12–17:13; 1SA 2:27–2:29; 1KI 4:2–4:5; MAL 2:7; MAT 8:4

Levites and temple servants

NUM 1:50–1:51 See also 1CH 15:16, 1CH 15:22, 1CH 16:4; EZR 2:70; NEH 12:44–12:47; LUK 10:32

Watchmen

PSA 127:1 See also 2SA 18:24–18:27; SNG 3:1–3:4, SNG 5:7; ISA 21:11–21:12, ISA 56:10; EZK 33:2–33:6; JHN 10:1–10:3

Shepherds

GEN 47:3 See also GEN 29:1–29:10, GEN 46:31–46:34; EXO 2:16–2:17; 1SA 17:20, 1SA 21:7; AMO 1:1; LUK 2:8–2:18; JHN 10:2–10:4

Farmers

ZEC 13:4–13:5 See also ISA 28:24–28:25; JER 31:5; JOL 1:11; MAT 13:3–13:9 parallels MRK 4:3–4:8, LUK 8:5–8:8; MAT 21:33 parallels MRK 12:1, LUK 20:9; 2TI 2:6; JAS 5:7

Fishermen

MAT 13:48 See also ISA 19:8; JER 16:16; EZK 47:10; MAT 4:18–4:19 parallel MRK 1:16–1:17; LUK 5:2

Doctors

MRK 5:25–5:26 parallel LUK 8:43 See also MAT 9:12 parallels MRK 2:17, LUK 5:31; COL 4:14

Lawyers

ACT 24:1 See also TIT 3:13

5434: officer

A person holding a position of authority (serving others), in a government, an army or navy, the church or other organisation.

Examples of officers

Government officers

1KI 4:5 See also 1KI 4:7–4:19, 1KI 4:27–4:28, 1KI 20:14; 2KI 15:25, 2KI 18:24 parallel ISA 36:9; EZR 4:8; NEH 11:9; ISA 33:18

Army officers

EXO 14:7 See also EXO 15:4; DEU 20:8–20:9; 2SA 8:7; 2KI 6:8; 1CH 27:16–27:22; ISA 21:5; JER 38:17–38:18; EZK 23:15; ACT 21:32, ACT 25:23

Navy officers

2CH 8:18

Church officers

PHP 1:1 See also ACT 20:17, ACT 20:28; 1TI 3:1, 1TI 3:8–3:10, 1TI 5:17; TIT 1:5, TIT 1:7

Other kinds of officer

The officer in charge of the king's palace

1KI 4:6, 1KI 18:3; ; 2KI 18:18, 2KI 19:2

The officer in charge of the treasuries

1CH 26:24; ; 2CH 24:11

The priest in charge of punishing troublemakers in the temple court

JER 20:1–20:2

The commander of the king's guard

DAN 2:14–2:15

A court attendant

MAT 5:25 parallel LUK 12:58

A member of the temple guard

LUK 22:4, LUK 22:52; ; ACT 5:22, ACT 5:26

The attendant of a Roman magistrate

ACT 16:35, ACT 16:38

5435: ovens

Ovens were a common feature of domestic life and activity

EXO 8:1–8:4

Uses for ovens

For baking bread

See also LEV 26:23–26:26

For baking grain offerings

LEV 2:4, LEV 7:9

Ovens could be rendered unclean

LEV 11:35

Ovens were characterised by great heat

LAM 5:10; ; HOS 7:4, HOS 7:6-7:7

The Tower of the Ovens was a place in Jerusalem in Nehemiah's day

NEH 3:11, NEH 12:38

5436: pain

A sense of physical suffering, anguish or distress, which has a number of causes. Scripture indicates the sources of pain and its potential spiritual implications and results.

Pain is universal

ROM 8:22 See also GEN 3:16-3:17; JOB 5:7

The origins of pain

Satanic activity

GEN 3:15 See also JOB 1:12, JOB 2:6-2:7; LUK 13:16; 2CO 12:7

Human activity

PSA 37:14 See also GEN 4:8; EXO 1:10-1:11; NAM 3:1-3:4; HAB 2:6, HAB 2:8, HAB 2:10, HAB 2:12

God's judgment and glory

JHN 9:2-9:3 See also EXO 9:11; NUM 12:10-12:11; 2CH 26:19-26:20; PSA 38:3-38:5; PRO 5:11; ACT 12:23, ACT 13:11; 2CO 12:9

Kinds of pain

Physical pain

PSA 38:7 See also JOB 30:17; MAT 10:28; LUK 23:33; 2CO 4:16-4:18, 2CO 11:23-11:27

Mental pain

JER 15:18 See also PSA 42:5-42:6, PSA 42:11; JER 12:6; MAT 26:38; 2CO 2:13; 2PE 2:8

Bereavement

JHN 11:33-11:35 See also GEN 35:18, GEN 50:1; 2SA 12:22-12:23; PHP 2:27; 1TH 4:13

Spiritual pain

Conviction of sin

JHN 16:8 See also PSA 32:3-32:5, PSA 51:1-51:2; LUK 7:38; ACT 26:14

The anguish of hell

MRK 9:47-9:48 See also MAT 5:22, MAT 8:12; LUK 13:28; REV 6:16

Perplexity

ISA 50:10 See also JOB 23:8-23:9; PSA 22:1, PSA 88:1-88:3; JER 20:7

Concern for others

GAL 4:19 See also ACT 20:19; 2CO 2:1-2:5, 2CO 11:28; PHP 3:18; COL 1:28-2:1; HEB 5:7

The failure of others

MAT 26:56 See also MAT 26:40; JHN 13:21; GAL 4:16; 2TI 4:10, 2TI 4:16; 3JN 1:10

Fruitful results of pain

It draws believers to God

1PE 4:19 See also JHN 14:1, JHN 14:18; ROM 8:26; 2CO 7:5-7:6; HEB 4:15-4:16, HEB 5:8

It equips believers to help others

2CO 1:4 See also ROM 5:3-5:5, ROM 12:15; HEB 2:18, HEB 12:11

It helps believers to anticipate the resurrection

1CO 15:54-15:57 See also ROM 8:19; 2CO 4:17; 1TH 4:14

It points believers to heaven

REV 21:4 See also ROM 8:18; REV 7:15-7:17

5437: palaces

Fortified, luxurious residences for kings. They normally served as the seat and symbol of royal authority.

David's palace on Mount Zion

1CH 14:1 See also 2SA 5:6-5:11 parallel 1CH 11:4-11:8; 2SA 7:1-7:2 parallel 1CH 17:1

Solomon's palace in Jerusalem

1KI 10:4-10:5 parallel 2CH 9:3-9:4 See also 1KI 7:1-7:12, 1KI 10:16-10:21 parallel 2CH 9:15-9:20; 2CH 8:11

Gold and valuable items were stored in the palace in Jerusalem

1KI 15:18-15:19 parallel 2CH 16:2-16:3 See also 1KI 14:25-14:26 parallel 2CH 12:9; 2KI 12:17-12:18, 2KI 14:13-14:14 parallel 2CH 25:23-25:24; 2KI 16:7-16:8 parallel 2CH 28:20-28:21; 2KI 18:14-18:15, 2KI 24:13; 2CH 21:16-21:17; JER 27:18-27:22

The royal palace in Jerusalem was destroyed by the Babylonians

2KI 25:9 parallels 2CH 36:19, JER 52:13 See also JER 22:1-22:6, JER 39:8

Other palaces

The kings of Israel had palaces in Samaria

1KI 21:1 See also 1KI 16:18, 1KI 20:5-20:6, 1KI 20:43; 2KI 15:25

Foreign palaces

Pharaoh's palace in Egypt: GEN 12:15, GEN 41:40, GEN 47:14; ; EXO 8:3; DAN 4:29–4:30, DAN 5:5; EST 1:9 King Xerxes' palace in Persia and Media

Summer palaces

JDG 3:20–3:21

Palaces in NT times

MAT 26:3–26:4; ; JHN 18:28; ; ACT 23:35; ; PHP 1:12–1:13

Features of palaces**Palace gardens**

2KI 21:18 See also 2KI 21:25–21:26; EST 1:5–1:6

The luxury of palaces

1KI 22:39 See also NUM 22:18; PSA 45:8–45:9; ISA 13:22; JER 22:13–22:17; MAT 11:8 parallel LUK 7:25

Palaces were administered by royal officials

2KI 10:5 See also 1KI 4:6, 1KI 18:3; 2KI 15:5; 2CH 28:7; ISA 22:15

5438: parables

Stories told to convey a general truth or spiritual message, often requiring explanation or interpretation. They were used by the prophets and featured extensively in Jesus Christ's ministry.

Parables in the OT**Told by prophets**

HOS 12:10 See also 2SA 12:1–12:10; 1KI 20:35–20:42; EZK 17:1–17:18, EZK 20:49, EZK 24:3–24:13

Told by others

PSA 78:1–78:2 See also JDG 9:7–9:20; 2SA 14:4–14:14; 2KI 14:9–14:10 parallel 2CH 25:18–25:19; PRO 1:5–1:6

Parables in the ministry of Jesus Christ**Reasons for Jesus Christ's use of parables**

MAT 13:10–13:15 parallels MRK 4:10–4:12, LUK 8:9–8:10 See also ISA 6:9–6:10

Examples of parables told by Jesus Christ

MAT 13:3–13:8 parallels MRK 4:3–4:8, LUK 8:5–8:8 See also MAT 7:24–7:27 parallel LUK 6:47–6:49 the wise and foolish builders; MAT 13:24–13:30, MAT 13:31–13:32 parallels MRK 4:30–4:32, LUK 13:18–13:19 the mustard seed; MAT 13:33, MAT 13:44–13:50, MAT 18:12–18:14 parallel LUK 15:4–15:7 the lost sheep; MAT 18:23–18:35, MAT 20:1–20:16, MAT 21:33–21:41 parallels MRK 12:1–12:9, LUK 20:9–20:16 the tenants; MAT 22:1–22:14, MAT 25:1–25:13, MAT 25:14–25:30; MRK 4:26–4:29, MRK 7:14–7:15; LUK 10:25–10:37, LUK 12:16–12:21, LUK 12:35–12:48, LUK 14:16–14:24, LUK 15:8–15:32, LUK 18:9–18:14, LUK 19:12–19:27

Interpretations of parables given by Jesus Christ

MRK 4:33–4:34 See also MAT 13:18–13:23 parallels MRK 4:14–4:20, LUK 8:11–8:15; MAT 13:36–13:43; MRK 7:17–7:23

5439: pen**The pen as an implement for writing**

ISA 8:1 See also 3JN 1:13

By extension, referring to what is written

JER 8:8 This means that what they wrote was untrue. See also MAT 5:18; LUK 16:17

Used symbolically

PSA 45:1

Sharpened with a penknife

See also JER 36:23

5440: perjury

Swearing falsely, usually in a legal context, either by taking a false oath or by breaking one's oath later. God hates perjury.

God hates perjury

ZEC 8:16–8:17 See also PSA 24:3–24:4; ISA 48:1; JER 5:2, JER 7:9–7:10; HOS 10:4; ZEC 5:3–5:4; MAL 3:5; 1TI 1:9–1:10

The Law forbade perjury

EXO 20:16 parallel DEU 5:20; ; EXO 23:1–23:3; ; LEV 19:12; ; NUM 30:2

Punishment for perjury

LEV 6:1–6:7; ; DEU 19:16–19:21

Examples of perjury**Against Naboth**

1KI 21:1–21:19

Against Jesus Christ

MAT 26:59–26:61 parallel MRK 14:55–14:59

Against Stephen

ACT 6:12–6:14

5441: philosophy

An ideology or system of values which seeks to understand and, through rational argument, to investigate the nature and meaning of reality. Scripture exposes the emptiness of philosophy based purely upon human wisdom, while affirming that, at its best, human wisdom points towards God, and can serve as a preparation for the gospel.

The gospel represents the height of human reason

ACT 17:18–17:23

The quest for understanding

ECC 7:25; ACT 17:18–17:21 See also JOB 34:2–34:4; ECC 1:13, ECC 7:27, ECC 7:29–8:1, ECC 12:12

The benefit of received wisdom

JOB 15:17–15:18; ; PRO 1:2–1:4; ; ECC 12:9–12:11

The limits of human enquiry

JOB 11:7–11:9; ECC 8:16–8:17 See also JOB 38:36–38:37; PSA 145:3; ECC 3:11; ISA 40:28, ISA 55:8–55:9; ACT 17:23; ROM 11:33–11:34; ISA 40:13; 1CO 1:20–1:21

The danger of philosophical speculation

COL 2:8; 1TI 6:20–6:21 See also GAL 4:3; COL 2:20; 1TI 1:4, 1TI 6:4; TIT 3:9

True insight is given by God

JOB 12:13; ; ECC 2:26; ; MAT 13:11 parallel LUK 8:10; ; 2TI 3:7

True meaning is found in relationship with God

ACT 17:24–17:28 See also ECC 12:1; REV 4:11

Epicureanism

Paul meets some Epicureans in Athens

ACT 17:16–17:18 Followers of the Greek philosophy founded by Epicurus (341–270 B.C.). In strong contrast to the Stoics, they taught that pleasure, and the avoidance of all disturbance, pain and fear, was the chief goal of life.

Epicureans' assessment of Paul and his message

ACT 17:18, ACT 17:18 Paul's listeners mistook the Greek word for "resurrection" ("anastasis") for the name of a strange god. While Epicureans did not deny the existence of gods, they believed they had no interest in the lives of human beings, and that therefore everything in life was the result of mere chance.

Epicurean and Stoic philosophers bring Paul to the Areopagus

ACT 17:19–17:20

The response of Epicureans and others to Paul's preaching

ACT 17:32

Docetism

Docetism questions the reality of the incarnation

2JN 1:7 Docetism is a denial of the physical reality of Jesus Christ's incarnation that may have been prompted by the typically Greek perception of physical

matter as evil. See also 1JN 2:22–2:23JHN 1:14; 1TI 3:16; HEB 2:14ROM 8:3; PHP 2:6–2:8; 1JN 4:10

Docetic views are identified as heretical

1JN 4:1–4:3 See also JHN 6:53–6:56

Gnosticism

Contrary to the teaching of Gnosticism, the world is not inherently evil

1TI 4:4 Gnosticism was a religious philosophy whose fundamental belief in the inherent evil of the created realm led to a number of heretical teachings about creation, human nature, the person of Jesus Christ, salvation and ethics. GEN 1:31; ; NEH 9:6; ; PSA 19:1; ; ACT 17:24; ; COL 1:15–1:17; ; REV 4:11; ROM 8:20–8:21; ; EPH 1:9–1:10; ; COL 1:19–1:20

Contrary to the teaching of Gnosticism, human beings are not sparks of divinity trapped in evil, fleshly bodies

ACT 17:26 GEN 1:26–1:27, GEN 2:7; ; PSA 8:3–8:8; ROM 6:12–6:13, ROM 8:22–8:23, ROM 12:1; ; 1CO 6:12–6:18, 1CO 6:19–6:20; ; 1TH 5:23; ROM 8:10–8:11; ; 1CO 15:35–15:44; ; 2CO 5:1–5:4; ; PHP 3:20–3:21; ; 2TI 2:16–2:18

Contrary to the teaching of Gnosticism, Jesus Christ did not merely appear in human form

JHN 1:14 LUK 24:36–24:43; ; COL 2:9; ; HEB 2:14; ; 1JN 1:1–1:3, 1JN 4:2–4:3; ; 2JN 1:7; JHN 19:33–19:34; ; 1CO 2:8; ; PHP 2:6–2:8; ; COL 1:19–1:22; ; 1JN 5:6

Contrary to the teaching of Gnosticism, salvation is not found simply in a divine revelation of special knowledge

Salvation is by faith in the crucified Christ: 1CO 3:18–3:20; ; COL 2:8, COL 2:18–2:19; ; 1TI 6:20–6:21; 1CO 1:18–1:25; ; COL 1:19–1:20, COL 2:2–2:4, COL 2:8–2:10; ; 2PE 1:3

Contrary to the teaching of Gnosticism, Christian behaviour is not to be marked by licence and ritualistic self-denial

There is no value in empty ceremonial observance or ritualistic self-denial: MAT 15:10–15:11 parallel MRK 7:14–7:15; ; ROM 14:5–14:6; ; COL 2:16–2:17, COL 2:20–2:23; ; 1TI 4:1–4:5; 1CO 6:12–6:20; ; GAL 5:13; ; COL 3:5–3:14; ; TIT 1:15–1:16; ; 1PE 2:16; ; 1JN 1:5–1:6, 1JN 2:3–2:6, 1JN 3:3–3:10; ; JUD 1:4

Stoicism

Paul encounters the Stoics in Athens

ACT 17:16–17:18 The Stoics were a leading philosophical group based, like their rivals the Epicureans, in Athens. Stoics held that God was the inner reason of the universe and that salvation lay in accepting one's place in the established order.

Stoics ridicule Paul**ACT 17:18****Stoics misunderstand Paul's message****ACT 17:18**

Paul presents a view of God very different from that of the Stoics

ACT 17:24–17:25 In contrast to Stoic belief God is the Creator; **ACT 17:26–17:27** In contrast to Stoic belief God is a personal being.

Response of the Stoics to Paul's message**ACT 17:32–17:34****5442: pilgrimage**

A journey made to a holy or revered place as an act of devotion or duty. As well as Jerusalem, there were several such holy places in Israel.

The annual pilgrimages

EXO 34:23–34:24; LUK 2:41–2:42 See also EXO 23:14, EXO 23:17; DEU 16:16, DEU 31:11; 2CH 5:2–5:3, 2CH 30:1, 2CH 30:13; LAM 1:4; EZK 46:9; ZEC 14:16–14:19; JHN 5:1, JHN 7:14

Pilgrimages to Jerusalem

PSA 122:1–122:4 See also PSA 84:5; ISA 2:3, ISA 30:29; MIC 4:2; ACT 2:5–2:11

Accompanying sacrifices

1KI 12:27–12:28; ; ISA 1:12

Other centres of pilgrimage

ISA 1:3; ; 1KI 3:4, 1KI 12:26–12:30

Used metaphorically

GEN 47:9 See also HEB 11:13–11:16

5443: pillars

Supports or decorations in buildings and free-standing memorial monuments. The word is also used figuratively, with reference to strength and beauty.

Pillars in the temple

1KI 7:21

Pillars erected as memorials

GEN 28:18–28:22 See also GEN 31:45–31:53, GEN 35:14–35:15, GEN 35:19–35:20; EXO 24:4; DEU 27:2–27:6; JOS 4:1–4:9; 2SA 18:18

The pillar of cloud and fire

EXO 13:21–13:22 See also EXO 33:9; NEH 9:12

The figurative use of pillars

JER 1:18 See also JOB 9:6, JOB 26:11; PSA 75:3, PSA 144:12; SNG 5:15; GAL 2:9; REV 3:12, REV 10:1

Kings were sometimes crowned beside a pillar

JDG 9:6 See also 2KI 11:12–11:14 parallel 2CH 23:11–23:13

Other notable incidents connected with pillars**Lot's wife and the pillar of salt**

GEN 19:24–19:26

Samson's destruction of a temple

JDG 16:25–16:30

5444: pledges

A solemn, binding promise, often involving the deposit of valuable items or property as a guarantee that the promise will be kept. To break a pledge is to sin against God.

Pledges were binding

NUM 30:2 See also NUM 30:3–30:15 In certain cases pledges made by daughters or wives could be nullified by fathers or husbands respectively.

Pledges were solemn promises

2KI 23:3 parallel 2CH 34:31–34:32 See also 1CH 29:24; EZR 10:19; EZK 17:16–17:18; MIC 7:20; 1PE 3:21

Pledges were guarantees that a promise would be kept**Items deposited to secure a pledge**

GEN 38:17–38:18 See also EXO 22:26–22:27; DEU 24:10–24:13; PRO 20:16, PRO 27:13

Unjust exaction of pledges condemned

DEU 24:17 See also JOB 22:4–22:6, JOB 24:2–24:3; AMO 2:6–2:8

Warning against making pledges on behalf of others

PRO 11:15 The foolishness of making a pledge as security for someone else's debt. See also PRO 6:1–6:5, PRO 17:18, PRO 22:26–22:27

Pledges and betrothal

MAT 1:18–1:19 Betrothal was a pledge to marry and as such was much more binding than the modern Western practice of engagement. It could only be broken by divorce and the betrothed woman was already described as a wife. See also EXO 22:16; DEU 22:23–22:25; LUK 1:27

5445: potters and pottery

Pottery was in common use for both household and ceremonial utensils, though for sacred use precious metals were often preferred. Broken pottery symbolises worthlessness and judgment. The potter formed clay with his hands on a wheel which he turned with his feet. The descriptions of God as a potter and of his people as clay emphasise God's sovereignty and also his concern for what he has made.

Potters in Scripture

Examples of potters

JER 18:2 See also 1CH 4:23; JER 19:1; ZEC 11:13 Potters may have been associated with the temple, possibly because of the continuing need for new vessels to be used in religious ceremonies; MAT 27:7

Description of the potter's work

PRO 26:23; ; JER 18:3-18:4

God depicted as a potter

God's authority over what he has made

JER 18:6 See also ISA 29:16, ISA 45:9-45:10; ROM 9:20-9:21

God's concern for what he has made

ISA 64:8-64:9 See also GEN 2:7-2:8 "Formed" commonly describes the action of the potter. God "formed" both individuals and the nation; JOB 10:8-10:9; PSA 103:14, PSA 119:73; ISA 43:1

Broken pottery

Contaminated pottery to be broken

LEV 11:33-11:35, LEV 15:12

Broken pottery as a symbol of judgment

JER 19:10-19:11 See also PSA 2:9; REV 2:27; ISA 30:14; JER 25:34, JER 48:12

Broken pottery as a symbol of worthlessness

PSA 31:12 See also JER 22:28, JER 19:2 The Potsherd Gate was so called because it overlooked the dump for broken pottery.

Pottery of little value

LAM 4:2 See also PSA 60:8 parallel PSA 108:92 **CO 4:7** Valuables were often concealed in apparently worthless clay jars which did not attract attention.

Examples of items of pottery

See also 2SA 17:28; 2TI 2:20

Cooking pots

JDG 6:19; ; 1SA 2:14; ; 2KI 4:38-4:41; ; JOB 41:20; ; MIC 3:3

Pitchers to carry water

GEN 24:17-24:20; ; JDG 7:16; ; MRK 14:13 parallel LUK 22:10; ; JHN 4:28

Water jugs

1SA 26:11-26:12; ; 1KI 17:10, 1KI 19:6

Drinking vessels

JDG 5:25; ; JER 35:5; ; MAT 26:27-26:28 parallels MRK 14:23-14:24, LUK 22:20, 1CO 11:25

Other pottery containers

1KI 14:3; ; 2KI 4:3-4:4, 2KI 21:13; ; JER 32:14 Documents could be kept intact in clay jars for many years; ; MAT 26:23; ; JHN 13:5

Household lamps

2KI 4:10; ; MAT 5:15

Pottery used in religious rituals

Basins to hold the blood of sacrifices

EXO 12:21-12:22 See also EXO 24:6; LEV 14:5, LEV 14:50

Utensils to cook or bake offerings

LEV 6:28 The sin offering was cooked in a pot which was then broken. See also LEV 2:5 The grain offering might be baked on a clay griddle; LEV 6:21, LEV 7:9

Clay water jars

NUM 5:17, NUM 19:17

Lamps

EXO 25:37 A clay lamp was held on each of the golden lampstand's seven branches. See also EXO 27:21, EXO 30:8; LEV 24:3-24:4; 1SA 3:3; 1KI 7:49

5446: poverty

The state of being without material possessions or wealth. Scripture indicates that poverty is contrary to God's intention for his people, and that those who are poor and destitute are to be treated with special consideration and compassion.

5447: poverty, causes of

To want for the necessities of life is ultimately the result of human sin.

Poverty arises from human sin

GEN 3:17-3:19 Compare this with the description of Eden in Ge 2:9-14.

Causes of poverty

Divine retribution brings poverty

DEU 28:47-28:48 See also PRO 22:16; ISA 3:1; AMO 4:6, AMO 5:11

Idleness brings poverty

PRO 6:10–6:11 See also PRO 10:4, PRO 14:23, PRO 20:13, PRO 24:33–24:34

Dissolute living brings poverty

PRO 21:17 See also PRO 6:26, PRO 28:19; LUK 15:14

Lack of discipline brings poverty

PRO 13:18, PRO 21:5

Rash promises bring poverty

PRO 22:26–22:27

Debt brings poverty

MAT 18:23–18:25

Neglect of God's law of giving brings poverty

PRO 11:24, PRO 28:22; ; ACT 20:35

Neglect of God's work brings poverty

HAG 1:9

Oppression brings poverty

JDG 6:6; ; JOB 20:19; ; PRO 13:23; ; ISA 1:7; ; JAS 5:4

Famine brings poverty

GEN 45:11, GEN 47:20–47:21

Misfortune brings poverty

JOB 1:13–1:21 These trials were inflicted by Satan but allowed by God as a test of Job's faith.

Poverty affects good as well as evil people**The righteous often escape poverty**

DEU 8:7–8:9; ; PSA 34:9–34:10, PSA 37:25

Many of the godly have been poor

2KI 4:1; ; LUK 16:20; ; ROM 15:26

Jesus Christ was poor

MAT 8:20

Results of poverty**Poverty results in ruin**

PRO 10:15

Poverty results in shame

See also PRO 13:18; LUK 16:3

Poverty results in misery

PRO 31:7

Poverty results in crime

PRO 6:30, PRO 30:8–30:9

Poverty need not lead to ungodliness

PSA 119:71; ; MRK 12:44 parallel LUK 21:4; ; 2CO 8:2; ; JAS 2:5; ; REV 2:9

Voluntary poverty**Jesus Christ's example of voluntary poverty**

2CO 8:9

Voluntary poverty commanded of some

MAT 19:21–19:22 Jesus Christ did not say this to everyone.

Voluntary poverty experienced by others

See also HEB 10:34

Love essential in voluntary poverty

1CO 13:3; ; 2CO 6:10

5448: poverty, attitudes towards

The plight of those in need calls for compassionate action of which Jesus Christ is the great example and in which the early church was faithful. Such compassion will be rewarded.

The treatment of the poor**They are not to be neglected**

DEU 15:7–15:8 See also PRO 17:5; ROM 12:13; GAL 6:10; JAS 2:15–2:16; 1JN 3:17

They are not to be unjustly treated

EXO 23:6 See also LEV 25:35–25:37; DEU 24:14–24:15; 2SA 12:1–12:4 Nathan rebukes David in the parable about the rich man and the poor man; JOB 24:1–24:4; PRO 22:22, PRO 29:7; JER 22:2–22:3, JER 22:16; EZK 18:10–18:13; AMO 2:6–2:7; ZEC 7:10; JAS 2:2–2:4 favouritism forbidden in Christian meetings

They are to have special rights and privileges

DEU 14:28–14:29 See also EXO 23:11; LEV 19:9–19:10, LEV 25:5–25:6; PRO 19:17

They are to be cared for

PSA 82:3–82:4 See also JOB 29:11–29:17; LUK 3:11; ACT 9:36

They are to be helped generously

DEU 15:9–15:11 See also DEU 14:29; RUT 2:14; PSA 112:9; JER 39:10; LUK 19:8; ACT 10:2; 2CO 9:7

They are to be helped without ostentation

MAT 6:2

Jesus Christ's compassion for the poor

MAT 15:32 parallel MRK 8:1–8:3 See also LUK 4:18–4:19; JHN 13:29; ACT 10:38

The attitude of the first Christians towards poverty

ACT 2:44–2:45 See also ACT 4:32–4:35, ACT 11:29–11:30, ACT 20:35, ACT 24:17; ROM 15:25–15:27; 2CO 8:13–8:15; GAL 2:10

Compassion for the poor will be rewarded

PSA 41:1 See also PRO 19:17, PRO 28:27; MAT 19:21, MAT 25:34–25:36; MRK 9:41; HEB 13:16

Examples of the poor who need help**Orphans**

DEU 10:18, DEU 14:28–14:29; ; PSA 10:14, PSA 146:9; ; PRO 23:10; ; ISA 10:2

Widows

DEU 14:29, DEU 16:11; ; RUT 4:5; ; 2KI 4:1; ; JOB 22:9; ; MAL 3:5; ; ACT 6:1; ; 1TI 5:3, 1TI 5:9, 1TI 5:16; ; JAS 1:27

5449: poverty, remedies for

Although poverty can never be totally eliminated from this sinful world, it can be alleviated. Scripture provides guidance concerning how this may be done.

Poverty will always exist in this world

MAT 26:11 parallel JHN 12:8 See also DEU 15:11

God's concern over poverty**God cares for the poor**

PSA 35:10, PSA 68:10 See also DEU 15:4–15:5; JOB 5:16; PSA 14:6, PSA 113:7, PSA 140:12; ISA 25:4

The law made concessions for poverty

LEV 5:7, LEV 5:11, LEV 12:8, LEV 14:21–14:22, LEV 27:8

God judges those who oppress the poor

EZK 18:12–18:13; ; AMO 4:1–4:2

The poor should be encouraged to help themselves**Mosaic law enabled the poor to help themselves**

EXO 23:11; ; LEV 19:10, LEV 23:22, LEV 25:25, LEV 25:28, LEV 25:39, LEV 25:41 The jubilee helped towards release from the poverty trap; ; DEU 23:25

Paul exhorts the poor to work

1TH 4:11; ; 2TH 3:10

Paul sets the poor an example

ACT 20:34; ; 1TH 2:9; ; 2TH 3:8

The relatives of the poor should help

1TI 5:4 See also GEN 45:9–45:11; LEV 25:25; 1TI 5:8, 1TI 5:16

Those better off should help the poor**The poor can be helped by means of gifts**

ACT 10:4 See also DEU 15:7–15:8; PSA 112:9; PRO 31:20; MAT 19:21 parallels MRK 10:21, LUK 18:22; LUK 19:8; ACT 9:36; EPH 4:28; 1TI 6:17–6:18

The poor can be helped in practical ways

MAT 25:34–25:40; ; LUK 11:41, LUK 14:13; ; ACT 9:36, ACT 9:39; ; 1TI 5:9–5:10; ; JAS 2:15–2:16; ; 1JN 3:17

The poor can be helped by others upholding justice

PSA 82:3 See also DEU 24:12–24:15; PRO 22:22, PRO 29:7, PRO 29:14, PRO 31:9; ISA 10:1–10:2; JER 22:16

The church should help the poor

GAL 2:10 See also ACT 24:17; ROM 15:26; 1TI 5:16

God's greatest gift to the poor is the good news of Jesus Christ

LUK 4:18 See also ISA 61:1; MAT 11:5 parallel LUK 7:22; LUK 14:21 Scripture regards spiritual and social welfare as closely connected.

5450: poverty, spiritual

The lack of spiritual riches and gifts is seen by Scripture as an especially distressing cause of poverty. Awareness of spiritual poverty leads to a turning towards God in order to receive the riches he graciously offers through the gospel.

The ungodly are spiritually poor**They lack faith**

MAT 13:58 parallel MRK 6:6

They lack understanding

PRO 10:21; ; ISA 5:13, ISA 56:10–56:11; ; JER 5:4; ; HOS 4:6; ; 1TI 6:5

They lack God

EPH 2:12

They lack eternal life

MAT 16:26 parallel LUK 9:25; ; LUK 12:20–12:21, LUK 16:22–16:23; ; JAS 5:1–5:6

They lack knowledge of their spiritual poverty

REV 3:17

Spiritual poverty may be a judgment

AMO 8:11 See also PSA 51:11, PSA 74:9; LAM 2:9; EZK 7:26; MAT 13:14–13:15; REV 2:5

The godly are aware of their poverty**David recognised that he was poor and needy**

PSA 40:17 See also PSA 34:6, PSA 35:10, PSA 70:5, PSA 86:1, PSA 109:22

Others recognise their spiritual poverty

ROM 7:18 See also JOB 42:6; PSA 8:3–8:4; LUK 5:8, LUK 7:6; ROM 7:24

Those who know that they are poor will be blessed by God

God will satisfy the poor in spirit

MAT 5:3 parallel LUK 6:20–6:21 See also MAT 5:6

God will save the poor in spirit

PSA 116:6

God will accept the poor in spirit

PSA 51:17; ; ISA 66:2

God will be close to the poor in spirit

PSA 34:18; ; ISA 57:15

God will hear the prayers of the poor in spirit

PSA 102:17

God will give grace to the poor in spirit

JAS 4:6, JAS 4:10; ; 1PE 5:5–5:6; ; PRO 3:34

God will meet the needs of the poor in spirit

ISA 61:1; ; LUK 1:53

Spiritual riches are better than material riches

Poverty with righteousness is better

PSA 37:16; ; PRO 15:16–15:17, PRO 16:8, PRO 19:1, PRO 19:22, PRO 28:6

Poverty with wisdom is better

PRO 16:16, PRO 19:1, PRO 19:22, PRO 28:6

Poverty with humility is better

PRO 16:19

Poverty with peace and quiet are better

PRO 17:1

Spiritual riches exalt the poor

JAS 1:9

Spiritual riches endure

HEB 10:34, HEB 11:37–11:40; ; 1PE 1:4

Spiritual riches more than compensate for material poverty

2CO 6:10; ; JAS 2:5; ; REV 2:9

5452: power

The quality which enables individuals to achieve their aims. Scripture stresses the power of God, demonstrated in Jesus Christ's resurrection and bestowed through the Holy Spirit. Scripture also stresses the relative powerlessness of humanity in God's sight.

5453: power, of God

See [1105: God, power of](#)

5454: power, God's saving

God has power to save and protect and through his power he will defeat those who oppose him.

God's power to save

PSA 20:6 See also 2CH 20:12, 2CH 20:15; ISA 40:9–40:10; 2PE 1:3–1:4

Jesus Christ's power to perform miracles

LUK 6:19 See also MAT 13:54, MAT 14:2 parallel MRK 6:14; MRK 5:30 parallel LUK 8:46; LUK 4:36, LUK 5:17; ACT 10:38

God's power to protect

1PE 1:3–1:5 See also DAN 6:26–6:27; JHN 17:11; ROM 8:38–8:39

God's people pray for God to act in power

2CH 14:11 See also 2CH 20:12; PSA 68:1–68:2, PSA 68:28; JER 14:9; ACT 4:23–4:31; 2CO 10:4

The power of the gospel

ROM 1:16 See also ROM 4:21 God has power to fulfil his promises; ROM 5:6, ROM 8:3; 1CO 1:18

The power of God's kingdom

MAT 6:13; ; MRK 9:1; ; 1CO 4:19–4:20

Preaching and power

1CO 2:4–2:5 See also ACT 4:33, ACT 9:22; ROM 15:18–15:19; 1CO 1:17–1:18; EPH 3:7; 1TH 1:5; 2TI 1:7–1:8

The powers that oppose God will be defeated

1CO 15:24; COL 2:15 See also ISA 24:21, ISA 59:15–59:20; DAN 7:26–7:27, DAN 8:25; EPH 6:12; REV 12:10, REV 18:10

The power of God over death

PSA 89:48; ; ECC 8:8; ; ISA 25:8; ; HOS 13:14; ; 1CO 6:14, 1CO 15:26, 1CO 15:42–15:44, 1CO 15:54–15:57; ; HEB 2:14–2:15

5455: power, of Jesus Christ

See [2066: Jesus Christ, power of](#)

5456: power, of Holy Spirit

See [3030: Holy Spirit, power of](#)

5457: power, human

All human power and authority comes from God. God also gives special power to his people.

All human power comes from God

DEU 8:17–8:18; ROM 13:1 See also JDG 3:12; 2KI 13:3, 2KI 13:5; 2CH 25:8; DAN 2:37, DAN 4:29–4:32; JHN 19:10–19:11; ACT 4:28; COL 1:16; 1PE 2:13–2:14

God gives power to his people

God's power is at work in believers

PSA 68:35 See also ISA 40:29–40:31; 2CO 4:7, 2CO 10:4, 2CO 12:9; EPH 3:20, EPH 6:10; COL 1:11; 2TH 1:11

Examples of God giving power to believers

Moses: EXO 4:21; ; DEU 34:12; ; ACT 7:22; 2SA 5:10 parallel 1CH 11:9 David; ; 1KI 18:46 Elijah; ; 2CH 27:6 Jotham; ; DAN 2:23 Daniel; ; LUK 1:17 John the Baptist; LUK 9:1 parallels MAT 10:1, MRK 6:7; ; LUK 10:19; ACT 4:7, ACT 4:10, ACT 6:8; ; 1CO 12:10

God gives resurrection power to believers

EPH 1:19–1:20 See also 2CO 13:4; PHP 3:10; COL 1:29, COL 2:12

The Holy Spirit equips individuals for special tasks

JDG 3:10 Othniel; JDG 14:6, JDG 14:19, JDG 15:14; 1SA 10:6, 1SA 10:10, 1SA 11:6; 1SA 16:13 David; ; ISA 61:1 the Messiah, fulfilled in Jesus Christ (Lk 4:18); ; MIC 3:8 Micah; ; LUK 1:35 Mary; ; LUK 4:14 Jesus Christ

The Holy Spirit gives power to believers

ACT 1:8 See also LUK 24:49; ROM 15:13; EPH 3:16

Human power derives from wisdom

ECC 7:19 See also PRO 3:27, PRO 8:14, PRO 24:5; ECC 9:13–9:18

The abuse of human power

PRO 28:28 See also JDG 6:2; JOB 21:7; PRO 28:12; ECC 4:1; JER 5:27–5:28, JER 23:10; EZK 22:6; MIC 2:1, MIC 7:3

The absence of human power

DEU 28:32; ; 2CH 14:11; ; NEH 5:5; ; JOB 5:15–5:16, JOB 6:11–6:13

The power of the wicked is temporary

PSA 37:16–37:17 See also EST 9:1; PSA 37:32–37:33; PRO 11:7; EZK 13:20–13:21

5459: prince

The son of a king, or a very important official, leader or ruler. The title is given to Jesus Christ and also to angelic spirits (in particular Michael and Satan).

A prince as the son of a king

2CH 11:22 See also 2SA 13:32; 2KI 10:6–10:8, 2KI 11:2; PSA 45:16

A prince as someone occupying a very important position

GEN 49:26 parallel DEU 33:16 See also GEN 23:6; 1SA 2:8; 2SA 3:38; PSA 113:8

A prince as a very important official, leader or ruler

EST 1:3 See also NUM 21:18, NUM 22:8, NUM 22:13–22:15; JOS 13:21; JDG 5:15; 2CH 21:4, 2CH 22:8; EZR 1:8; EST 6:9; PSA 68:27; PRO 8:16; EZK 21:12EZK 22:6, EZK 45:8–45:9 EZK 38:2–38:3; DAN 9:6; HOS 3:4

The Messiah is described as a prince

ISA 9:6 See also EZK 34:24, EZK 37:25, EZK 44:3; DAN 8:11, DAN 8:25

Angelic spirits (whether good or evil) are described as princes

DAN 10:13 The prince of the Persian kingdom was possibly a demon, exercising influence in the interests of Satan. See also DAN 10:20–10:21, DAN 12:1

Satan is described as a prince

MAT 9:34 See also MAT 12:24 parallels MRK 3:22, LUK 11:15; JHN 12:31, JHN 14:30, JHN 16:11; EPH 2:2

The splendour of the princess

PSA 45:13 See also PSA 45:9

5460: prison

A place of confinement, such as a jail or dungeon, used to imprison individuals.

Irregular prisons

GEN 37:22 A cistern was usually a plaster-coated underground rock cavity used for storing water. See also NUM 12:14–12:15 Miriam's confinement may have been as much isolation as punishment; JER 38:6, JER 38:13

Houses used as prisons

JER 37:15 See also 2SA 20:3; LUK 22:54; ACT 28:16

Legally established prisons

GEN 39:20; ACT 5:18 See also GEN 42:16–42:19; JDG 16:21; 1KI 22:27; 2KI 17:4, 2KI 25:27; 2CH 16:10; MAT 14:3; LUK 21:12; ACT 4:3, ACT 12:4–12:7, ACT 16:37

Barracks or guardhouses as prisons

JER 32:2; ; ACT 22:24; ; PHP 1:12–1:13

Figurative and poetic use of prisons

ISA 42:7 See also JOB 11:10; PSA 88:8, PSA 142:7; ISA 24:22; LUK 12:58; 1PE 3:19; 2PE 2:4; REV 1:18REV 20:1, REV 20:7

5461: prisoners

People who have been deprived of their liberty and confined against their will.

People imprisoned out of anger, envy or jealousy

GEN 37:24; JER 52:11 See also GEN 39:19, GEN 40:3, GEN 41:14, GEN 42:16JDG 16:21, JDG 16:25 2KI 17:4 Hoshea, king of Israel; 2KI 25:18; 2CH 28:5, 2CH 28:17, 2CH 33:11 Manasseh; ISA 14:17, ISA 20:4; HAB 1:9

People imprisoned for lawlessness

EZR 7:26; MAT 27:16 parallels MRK 15:6–15:7, LUK 23:19 See also EXO 12:29; ISA 42:22–42:24

People imprisoned for their faithfulness to God

Micaiah

1KI 22:27 parallel 2CH 18:26

Hanani, seer to Asa

2CH 16:10

Jeremiah

JER 32:2, JER 33:1, JER 37:15, JER 37:18, JER 37:21, JER 38:6, JER 38:9, JER 39:15

John the Baptist

MAT 4:12 parallel MRK 1:14; ; MAT 11:2, MAT 14:3 parallel MRK 6:17; ; MAT 14:10 parallel MRK 6:27; ; LUK 3:20

The apostles

ACT 5:18

Simon Peter

ACT 12:5

The early Christian believers

ACT 8:3, ACT 9:21, ACT 22:4, ACT 22:19, ACT 26:10; ; HEB 10:34

Paul

ACT 12:4, ACT 22:27, ACT 23:29, ACT 28:17; ; 2CO 6:5, 2CO 11:23; ; EPH 3:1, EPH 4:1; ; PHM 1:1

Paul and Silas

ACT 16:23–16:24

Aristarchus

COL 4:10

Epaphras

PHM 1:23

The saints of old

HEB 11:36

Figurative and poetic use of imprisonment

GAL 3:22–3:23 See also PSA 142:7; ISA 24:22, ISA 42:6–42:7, ISA 42:22; EZK 19:9; ZEC 9:11–9:12; MAT 18:30

The LORD does not abandon prisoners

PSA 79:11 See also GEN 39:21; PSA 68:6, PSA 69:33, PSA 102:20, PSA 107:10, PSA 146:7; ISA 49:8–49:9, ISA 61:1; LAM 3:31–3:36

Christians should show concern for prisoners

HEB 13:3 See also MAT 25:36, MAT 25:39, MAT 25:43

5463: proclamations

Edicts or public declarations issued by the civil or religious authorities.

Examples of proclamations in biblical times

EXO 1:15–1:22 Pharaoh's edict that all Hebrew boys were to be drowned; ; EXO 32:5 Aaron's proclamation of a festival to the LORD; ; 1KI 21:9–21:10 Jezebel's proclamation to ensnare Naboth; ; 2KI 10:20 Jehu's proclamation of an assembly in honour of Baal; ; 2CH 24:9 Joash's proclamation of a tax for the LORD; ; 2CH 30:1–30:10 Hezekiah's invitation to celebrate the Passover; EZR 1:1, EZR 5:13, EZR 6:3, EZR 7:13; NEH 8:14–8:15 the Levites' proclamation of festival arrangements; EST 1:20, EST 2:8, EST 3:14, EST 4:3, EST 8:11; DAN 6:7, DAN 6:15; JON 3:7 the king of Nineveh's proclamation of a fast of repentance; ; LUK 2:1 Caesar Augustus' proclamation of a census

5464: proconsul

The ex-consul who ruled the Roman province of Asia was a proconsul

ACT 19:38

The governor of a Roman senatorial province was a proconsul

The proconsul of the province of Cyprus

ACT 13:7–13:8, ACT 13:12

The proconsul of the province of Achaia

ACT 18:12

5465: profit

In the financial sense, gain through trading. The word is also used in Scripture of spiritual gain.

Legitimate profit

As the result of hard work

PRO 14:23, PRO 21:5 See also PRO 31:18

As the reward of generosity

PRO 11:24; ; LUK 6:38

As the gift of God

DEU 8:18

It is withheld by God in judgment

DEU 28:15–28:20; ; JER 12:13; ; HAG 1:9

It is for this life only

ECC 1:3–1:4; ; 1TI 6:7

Profiting by oppression**A common practice of the wicked****ECC 5:8–5:9****It is often cloaked in hypocrisy**

See also EZK 33:31

It is against God's law**LEV 25:37****It is of little worth**

See also PRO 11:16, PRO 16:8

It is short-lived

JOB 20:18–20:19; ; ISA 23:17–23:18; ; JER 17:11

It is judged by God

PRO 1:18–1:19; ; EZK 22:12–22:14; ; MIC 4:13; ; HAB 2:9

Its avoidance is rewarded

PRO 28:16; ; ISA 33:15–33:16

Profiting by dishonesty**It is common amongst the wicked**

JER 22:17

It is forbidden to God's servants

EXO 18:21; ; 1SA 8:3; ; 1TI 3:8; ; TIT 1:7

Profiting selfishly**It is common amongst the wicked**

ISA 56:11

It is avoided by the godly**PSA 119:36****Using religion for profit****In the OT**

See also NUM 22:16–22:17; 1SA 2:12–2:16; JER 6:13, JER 8:10

In the NT**2CO 2:17** See also ACT 8:18–8:23; 1TI 6:5; TIT 1:11; JUD 1:11**Profiting spiritually****Through the Scriptures**

1TI 4:13–4:15; ; 2TI 3:16–3:17

Through wisdom**PRO 3:13–3:14****Through doctrine****TIT 3:8****Through godliness and contentment****1TI 6:6** See also 1TI 4:8**Through chastening**

HEB 12:10

Through spiritual gifts

1CO 12:7

Through service

MAT 25:14–25:30; ; LUK 19:11–19:27

Through sacrifice

MAT 19:29 parallels MRK 10:29–10:30, LUK 18:29–18:30; ; HEB 11:35

Through death**PHP 1:21** See also PHP 1:23**Doubts expressed about profiting spiritually**

JOB 9:29–9:31, JOB 21:15, JOB 34:9, JOB 35:1–35:3; ; PSA 73:13; ; ECC 2:15, ECC 6:8; ; MAL 3:14

It is better than worldly wealth**MAT 16:26** parallels MRK 8:36, LUK 9:25**Unprofitable things**

See also ECC 6:11 mere words; ECC 10:11 delayed action; ISA 44:10 idolatry; PHP 3:7 legalistic works; 1CO 13:1–13:3 zeal without love; 1CO 14:6 speech without understanding; HEB 4:2 hearing without faith; TIT 3:9 needless controversy

5466: promises

Binding offers or commitments on the part of one person or people to another. The value of such promises depends upon the reliability and trustworthiness of the person who makes the promises. Scripture stresses the total reliability of God, including his promise to bestow his Spirit and urges believers to demonstrate the same trustworthiness in their dealings with one another.

5467: promises, divine

The promises of God reveal his particular and eternal purposes to which he is unchangeably committed and upon which believers can totally depend. These promises are, however, conditional upon obedience on the part of believers.

God's promises are irrevocable**He is absolutely trustworthy****NUM 23:19** See also TIT 1:2; HEB 6:13–6:18**He is unchanging**

PSA 110:4; ; MAL 3:6–3:7; ; JAS 1:17–1:18

He has the power and will to fulfil his promises**ISA 55:11** See also ROM 4:21**He is faithful in keeping all his promises**

JOS 21:45, JOS 23:14–23:15; ; 1KI 8:56; ; PSA 145:13; ; HEB 10:23

His promises stem from his goodness and glory

2PE 1:3–1:4

God may confirm his promises with an oath**GEN 22:15–22:18** See also GEN 26:3; ISA 45:23; AMO 6:8, AMO 8:7**Examples of God's promises through covenant relationship**

GEN 9:8–9:17 with Noah; GEN 15:9–15:21, GEN 17:1–17:22; ; HEB 11:8–11:9, HEB 11:17–11:19; GEN 26:3–26:4 with Isaac; GEN 28:13–28:15, GEN 46:2–46:4; EXO 19:1–19:6, EXO 24:1–24:8; NUM 25:10–25:12 with Phinehas; 2SA 7:5–7:16 parallel 1CH 17:4–17:14; ; 1KI 8:15, 1KI 8:24; JER 31:31–31:34 with Jeremiah

The grounding of God's promises in Christ**God's promises are fulfilled in Jesus Christ****2CO 1:18–1:20** See also MAT 5:17; LUK 4:16–4:21; ACT 2:29–2:31, ACT 3:21–3:26, ACT 7:37; DEU 18:15–18:18; ACT 13:23, ACT 13:32–13:34, ACT 26:6–26:7; ROM 1:2–1:3, ROM 15:8; HEB 9:15**Jesus Christ brings superior promises through the new covenant****HEB 8:6–8:8** Jesus Christ mediates a covenant of inner transformation, willing obedience, intimate relationship with God and forgiveness of sins forever. See also EPH 1:13–1:14; HEB 7:22, HEB 11:13, HEB 11:39–11:40; 2PE 1:1–1:4**Jesus Christ has the right to make promises on God's behalf****JHN 3:34–3:35** See also JHN 1:1–1:2, JHN 1:14, JHN 8:25–8:29; HEB 1:1–1:3**God's promises must be received by believers****They are received by faith****GAL 3:22** See also JHN 1:12; ROM 4:13–4:16**They are received by perseverance and obedience****HEB 10:36** See also ROM 4:19–4:24; 2CO 7:1; HEB 6:12**God's promises unite believing Jews and Gentiles****EPH 3:6** See also ACT 2:38–2:39; ROM 9:8; GAL 3:29, GAL 4:28; EPH 2:11–2:18; HEB 11:39–11:40**Disaster awaits those who reject God's promises**

JOS 23:12–23:16; ; JHN 3:18–3:20, JHN 3:36; ; 2TI 2:11–2:13; ; HEB 6:4–6:12; ; 2PE 3:3–3:10

Particular promises of God in Christ**The gift of the Holy Spirit**

LUK 24:49; ; ACT 1:4, ACT 2:33; ; EPH 1:13

The fulness of life and eternal life

2TI 1:1; ; HEB 12:26–12:28; ; JAS 1:12, JAS 2:5; ; 1JN 2:25

Resurrection

JHN 5:29, JHN 11:25–11:26; ; 1CO 15:48–15:57; ; 2CO 4:14; ; 1TH 4:16

The forgiveness of sins

1JN 1:9

The presence of God

EXO 3:12, EXO 33:14; ; JOS 1:9; ; ISA 58:9; ; MAT 28:20; ; HEB 13:5

The peace of God

1CH 22:9; ; PSA 85:8; ; ISA 9:6–9:7; ; ROM 5:1; ; PHP 4:4–4:9

Joy in God

PSA 16:11, PSA 132:16; ; JHN 16:20–16:24

The knowledge of God

JER 31:33–31:34; ; JHN 17:25–17:26; ; 1JN 5:20

5468: promises, human

Believers must be faithful in keeping promises made to others and to God, because they have been called to live in integrity and truth. False or broken promises are considered as sin.

Examples of promises between people

GEN 14:22–14:24 Abraham and the king of Sodom; ; GEN 21:22–21:24 Abraham and Abimelech; ; GEN 47:29–47:31 Jacob and Joseph; ; NUM 30:1–30:16 in family life; ; JOS 2:12–2:21 Rahab and the spies

Examples of people making promises to God

GEN 28:20–28:21 Jacob; ; JDG 11:29–11:40 Jephthah; ; 1SA 1:11–1:20 Hannah; ; 2SA 15:7–15:12 Absalom; ; NEH 10:28–10:29 returning exiles

Accompaniments to human promises**Taking an oath****DEU 6:13** See also GEN 14:22, GEN 21:24, GEN 47:31; JOS 2:12–2:14; NEH 10:29**Declaring a curse****2SA 3:35** See also RUT 1:17; 1SA 14:24; 2SA 3:9–3:10; 1KI 2:23; MAT 26:73–26:75 parallel MRK 14:70–14:72**Instructions regarding human promises****The importance of keeping promises****NUM 30:1–30:2** See also PSA 50:14; PRO 5:18–5:23; MAL 2:14–2:16; MAT 19:4–19:9

The sin and peril of false promises

LEV 19:12 See also EXO 20:7; DEU 23:21; JER 8:11–8:12; EZK 13:1–13:7, EZK 13:10–13:12; ZEC 8:17; 2PE 2:17–2:19

The danger of making promises rashly, lightly or in ignorance

ECC 5:1–5:7 See also PRO 20:25; MAT 14:1–14:11 parallel MRK 6:21–6:28; MAT 23:16–23:22

The call of Jesus Christ to integrity and truth in making promises

MAT 5:33–5:37 See also DEU 23:22–23:23; ECC 5:2, ECC 5:5

5469: promise, of Holy Spirit

See [3040: Holy Spirit, promise of](#)

5471: proof

A confirmation and verification of a belief, such as belief in the existence of God, in the trustworthiness of a witness or in the resurrection of Jesus Christ.

5472: proof, as evidence

In the judicial sense, evidence is required to confirm the testimony of a witness. In the lives of believers, practical evidence should be obvious as proof of the reality of their faith.

The Mosaic law required proof to be offered in various legal contexts**In giving testimony**

DEU 19:15 See also EXO 23:2; LEV 5:1; DEU 17:6

In accusations of immorality

DEU 22:13–22:21 See also NUM 5:11–5:31

In accusations of idolatry

DEU 13:12–13:15

Evidence offered as proof of the gospel**The evidence of witnesses**

2PE 1:16–1:18 See also ACT 1:3; 1CO 15:5–15:7; HEB 2:3–2:4; 1JN 1:1–1:3

Believers' lives are to prove the reality of their faith

JHN 15:8 See also MAT 25:31–25:46; ACT 26:20; 1CO 4:2; 2CO 8:24

Evidence and signs given as proof**Looking for signs of the will of God**

JDG 6:36–6:38

The signs of Jesus Christ as a basis of faith

JHN 2:11

Jesus Christ's criticism of those who demanded other signs

MAT 16:4 The “sign of Jonah” is a reference to the resurrection of Jesus Christ.

5473: proof, through testing

God seeks proof of genuine love, faith and growth in the lives of his people. To this end, he tests them in various ways. However, when people test him, it is often a symptom of lack of trust.

Reasons for God's testing of Israel**To refine them**

ZEC 13:8–13:9 See also PSA 66:10–66:12; PRO 17:3; ISA 48:10; JER 6:27–6:30, JER 9:7

To prove their obedience

EXO 16:4 See also EXO 15:25–15:26; DEU 8:2–8:5, DEU 8:15–8:16; JDG 2:22, JDG 3:1–3:4; 1CH 29:17

To prove their love for him

DEU 13:1–13:3

God tests individuals

1PE 1:6–1:7 See also GEN 22:1–22:18 Abraham; JOB 23:10 Job; 2CH 32:31 Hezekiah; JHN 6:5–6:6 Philip; JAS 1:2–1:3, JAS 1:12

Those who test God are usually motivated by lack of trust

PSA 78:18–78:22 See also EXO 17:1–17:7; NUM 14:22–14:23; DEU 6:16; PSA 78:40–78:44, PSA 78:56–78:57, PSA 106:13–106:15; 1CO 10:9; HEB 3:7–3:11; PSA 95:7–95:11

God may invite certain people to test him

MAL 3:10 See also ISA 7:10–7:14

God's people are to seek proof through testing in certain areas**Believers are to test themselves**

2CO 13:5 See also GAL 6:4

Believers are to test what they hear

1TH 5:21 See also 1CO 14:29; 1JN 4:1–4:3

5475: property

The ultimate source of all property is God. While property is entrusted to human beings, they have responsibilities towards God as a result of their stewardship.

5476: property, nature of

Possessions are a gift from God to be used for his glory, for human pleasure and in benefiting others.

Possessions are a cause for thanksgiving

ECC 5:19 See also GEN 39:2–39:4; DEU 8:18; 1CH 29:12; 2CH 31:21; HOS 2:8

Owning possessions is open to abuse**They can be coveted**

EXO 20:17 See also 1KI 21:1–21:4; JER 6:13; MIC 2:2; LUK 12:15; 1CO 7:29–7:31

They can cause deceit

ACT 5:1–5:9

They can cause pride and forgetfulness

PRO 30:9 See also 2KI 20:13–20:17; DAN 4:30, DAN 5:20; HOS 13:6; MAT 19:24; LUK 12:13–12:21

Abuse of ownership leads to judgment

ISA 3:16–3:24, ISA 5:8; ; HAB 2:6–2:9

Property is for benefiting others**It is to be used to help others**

ACT 2:44–2:45, ACT 4:32–4:35; ; GAL 6:6, GAL 6:10; ; EPH 4:28; ; 1TI 6:17–6:18; ; JAS 2:15–2:16; ; 1JN 3:17–3:18

It is to be used to assist strangers

LEV 25:35; ; NUM 35:15; ; DEU 10:19; ; MAT 5:42

Property provides no lasting satisfaction

ECC 2:26 See also JOB 27:16–27:17; PSA 39:6; ECC 2:21; EZK 28:4–28:7; HAG 1:6; MAT 6:19–6:21; LUK 12:20–12:21; JAS 5:3

Laws governing the inheritance of property

NUM 27:3–27:11; ; DEU 21:15–21:17; ; EZK 46:16–46:18

Godly men of property

GEN 13:2 Abraham; ; GEN 26:14 Isaac; GEN 30:43, GEN 32:5, GEN 36:7; 2SA 19:32 Barzillai; ; 1CH 29:28 David; 2CH 1:15, 2CH 9:22; 2CH 32:27–32:29 Hezekiah; ; JOB 1:3 Job; ; MAT 27:57 Joseph of Arimathea; ; ACT 4:36–4:37 Barnabas

5477: property, land

All land belongs to God, and he allows people to care for it and use it for their own needs and the needs of others. The land promised to Israel is a special case illustrating the spiritual inheritance of all believers and God's ultimate purpose for the world.

All land belongs to God**It is in his possession and care**

PSA 24:1 See also EXO 9:29; PSA 33:5; 1CO 10:26

It is given to human beings to manage

GEN 2:15 All exploitation of land is therefore contrary to God's purpose. See also PSA 8:6, PSA 115:16

The land promised to Israel**It was promised on oath**

GEN 12:6–12:7 See also GEN 13:14–13:17, GEN 15:7, GEN 15:18, GEN 17:8, GEN 50:24; EXO 6:8; DEU 6:10–6:11, DEU 31:20–31:21; JDG 2:1

It was a fruitful land

EXO 3:8 See also LEV 20:24; NUM 14:7–14:8; JOS 5:6

The distribution of the land

LEV 25:34; ; NUM 33:53–33:54, NUM 35:2–35:5

Individual land rights**Legitimate purchase or sale**

GEN 23:15–23:16, GEN 33:19, GEN 47:20; ; 2SA 24:24; ; PRO 31:16; ; JER 32:6–32:15 Jeremiah's purchase was an act of faith; ; MAT 27:7–27:10; ; ACT 1:18

Examples of renting

SNG 8:11; ; MAT 21:33–21:41 parallels MRK 12:1–12:9, LUK 20:9–20:16

Laws of inheritance

NUM 36:6–36:9; ; MIC 2:2

Encroachment was forbidden

DEU 19:14 Land boundaries were marked out by stones, the removal of which was a serious offence; ; DEU 27:17; ; JOB 24:2; ; PRO 22:28, PRO 23:10; ; HOS 5:10

Redemption of land

LEV 25:23–25:28; ; RUT 4:2–4:9

God's ultimate purpose for the world**The heavenly land**

HEB 11:13–11:16 See also HEB 11:8–11:10

A new heaven and earth

ISA 65:17 See also ISA 66:22; REV 21:1–21:2

The inheritance of the righteous

MAT 5:5 See also PSA 37:11, PSA 37:29; 2PE 3:13

5478: property, houses

From at least the time of the flood people have built houses to live in and these have been a major part of their property; the temple was seen as God's house.

Houses are a major part of people's property

EXO 12:22; ; HAG 1:4; ; MAT 7:24–7:27; ; HEB 3:3

The homeless have no property

1CO 4:11 See also JOB 24:8; LAM 4:5; LUK 9:58

Property has no lasting value

HEB 10:34 See also DEU 6:11–6:12; MAT 19:29

Materials used in house building

Clay

JOB 4:19

Brick

EXO 1:11–1:14; ; ISA 9:10

Stone and wood

LEV 14:40, LEV 14:42; ; HAB 2:11

Luxurious building materials

1KI 22:39; ; EST 1:6; ; AMO 3:15

Houses are protected by God

PSA 127:1 See also EXO 12:27

Houses as dwellings

For sinners

JOS 2:1; ; PRO 7:27, PRO 21:9

For friends

ZEC 13:6; ; LUK 10:38; ; JHN 12:1–12:2

Other uses for houses

For work

JER 18:2

For hospitality

LUK 10:5–10:7 parallels MAT 10:11, MRK 6:10 See also GEN 19:3; MAT 25:35; ACT 16:15; 1TI 5:10; HEB 13:2

For church gatherings

ACT 20:20 See also ROM 16:5; 1CO 16:19; COL 4:15; PHM 1:2

As palaces

2SA 7:2; ; 1KI 7:1–7:2, 1KI 22:39; ; DAN 4:29–4:30; ; MAT 11:8

Legislation concerning houses

Respecting the houses of others

EXO 20:17; ; MIC 2:2

Redemption of property

LEV 25:29–25:33

The LORD's house

God's promise to David

2SA 7:11; ; 1KI 5:5

Solomon's building

1KI 6:1, 1KI 6:2, 1KI 6:7, 1KI 6:12, 1KI 6:14

Ezra's rebuilding

EZR 3:9–3:10

It was a place to meet God

PSA 23:6, PSA 27:4, PSA 84:10, PSA 122:1; ; ISA 56:7; ; JOL 3:18; ; JHN 2:16–2:17; ; PSA 69:9

It is a picture of the church

EPH 2:19–2:20 See also 1CO 3:9–3:11

5480: protection

Defence from attack, hurt or exploitation. The ultimate protector is God but he also uses others in defending the weak and needy.

Protection from oppression

PSA 72:4 See also DEU 10:18; PSA 12:5, PSA 35:10; LUK 1:51–1:53

Protection from exploitation

JOB 24:3–24:4 See also PRO 30:14; EZK 18:10–18:13; AMO 4:1, AMO 8:4–8:6; MRK 12:38–12:40; JAS 5:1–5:6

Means of protection against physical attack

Armour

1SA 17:38; ; 1KI 20:11; ; JER 46:4

Shields

JER 46:3

Helmets

1SA 17:38; ; JER 46:4

Spiritual protection

JHN 17:11–17:12 See also JHN 10:28–10:29; 1CO 10:13; PHP 1:6, PHP 4:7; 2TI 1:12; 1PE 1:5; JUD 1:24

Believers need protection from spiritual dangers

From Satan

1PE 5:8 See also JOB 1:9; MAT 6:13; JHN 17:15; EPH 6:11–6:12; 2TH 2:9, 2TH 3:3

From Satan's agents in the world

JHN 15:18–15:19 See also PSA 27:2, PSA 31:15, PSA 109:1–109:3, PSA 109:31; MIC 7:2–7:3; MAT 10:28–10:29, MAT 10:36; LUK 1:68–1:74; ROM 8:36; 1JN 3:13, 1JN 4:4

God protects his people

By watching over them and helping them

PSA 121:5 See also 1SA 2:9; PSA 1:6, PSA 34:15, PSA 37:40, PSA 40:17, PSA 140:1; 2CO 1:10

By his presence with them

HEB 13:5 See also JOS 1:5; PSA 119:116, PSA 119:170; ISA 43:1–43:3; JHN 16:33; ACT 18:10

By sending angels to protect them

PSA 34:7 See also GEN 21:17; EXO 23:20; NUM 22:22, NUM 22:24, NUM 22:26, NUM 22:31, NUM 22:34; 2KI 6:17; PSA 91:11; MAT 18:10; HEB 1:14

By using people to defend them

PRO 31:8–31:9 See also NUM 35:25; ISA 1:17, ISA 58:6; JER 5:28, JER 22:16; LUK 10:33–10:35; JAS 1:27

Conditions of God's protection**Prayer**

PSA 72:12 See also JOB 6:23; PSA 59:1, PSA 82:3, PSA 145:19; JHN 17:11

Right attitudes

PSA 91:14 See also DEU 23:14; PSA 116:6; PRO 2:7–2:8, PRO 2:11, PRO 11:6, PRO 14:3; 1CO 13:7

5481: proverb

A popular saying, regarded as conveying wisdom. Scripture records a great number of didactic proverbs and also preserves some popular sayings.

Proverbs identified with wisdom

PRO 26:7 See also PSA 49:1–49:4; PRO 1:1–1:6, PRO 26:9; ECC 12:9–12:11

Solomon's many proverbs

1KI 4:29–4:34 See also PRO 1:1, PRO 10:1, PRO 25:1; ECC 12:9–12:10

Kinds of proverb**On wisdom**

PRO 15:33 See also PRO 10:13, PRO 11:2, PRO 12:8, PRO 13:10, PRO 14:8, PRO 16:16, PRO 18:4, PRO 19:8, PRO 21:30, PRO 23:4, PRO 23:9, PRO 28:26, PRO 29:15

On righteousness and wickedness

PRO 10:3 See also PRO 10:16, PRO 10:28–10:32, PRO 11:10, PRO 12:3, PRO 12:10, PRO 12:21, PRO 12:26, PRO 13:9, PRO 14:32, PRO 16:31, PRO 18:10, PRO 21:15, PRO 25:26, PRO 29:2

On wealth and poverty

PRO 10:22 See also PRO 11:4, PRO 11:28, PRO 15:16, PRO 22:1–22:2, PRO 22:4, PRO 23:4–23:5, PRO 28:6, PRO 28:11, PRO 29:3

On speech and silence

PRO 10:19 See also PRO 11:12, PRO 12:18–12:19, PRO 15:4, PRO 17:20, PRO 17:28, PRO 18:21, PRO 21:6, PRO 21:23, PRO 25:15, PRO 28:23

Longer discourses

PRO 1:10–1:19 See also PRO 3:1–3:10, PRO 3:13–3:18, PRO 5:1–5:23, PRO 7:1–7:5, PRO 30:15–30:16, PRO 30:21–30:31, PRO 31:10–31:31

Popular sayings

1SA 24:12–24:13 See also 1SA 10:9–10:12, 1SA 19:23–19:24; EZK 12:21–12:25, EZK 16:44–16:48, EZK 18:1–18:4; LUK 4:23–4:30; 2PE 2:17–2:22

5482: punishment

A form of physical pain or deprivation, generally in proportion to the offence which gives rise to it. Scripture stresses the reality of punishment by God for sin, while urging that human punishment should be humane.

5483: punishment, nature of

Punishment is the inevitable and equitable consequence of breaking the law of God. In keeping with God's justice and righteousness, punishment is administered by him or by human beings as his agents.

God warned Adam and Eve of the punishment for disobedience

GEN 2:16–2:17 See also GEN 3:1–3:5

Adam and Eve's original disobedience brought inevitable punishment**Upon the serpent**

GEN 3:14–3:15 See also COL 2:15; REV 12:9, REV 20:1–20:3, REV 20:10

Upon the woman

GEN 3:16 See also PSA 48:6; ISA 13:8, ISA 21:3; JER 4:31; 1TI 2:14–2:15

Upon the man

GEN 3:19 See also JOB 5:7, JOB 7:1; PSA 90:5, PSA 90:7, PSA 90:8; ECC 1:3; ISA 40:2

Upon creation

GEN 3:17 See also GEN 5:29; JER 12:4; ROM 8:19–8:22

The punishment of death

ROM 6:23 See also EZK 18:4, EZK 33:8; ROM 5:12, ROM 6:21; 1CO 15:21–15:22

Banishment as punishment

GEN 3:23 See also GEN 4:10–4:16; DEU 29:27, DEU 29:28; 2KI 25:21; MAT 8:12

Punishment must be appropriate to the crime

GEN 9:6 See also EXO 21:23–21:25; LEV 24:17–24:22; JDG 9:24

Punishment reflects the obligations of the offenders towards their victims

EXO 22:3 See also EXO 21:2, EXO 21:26–21:27, EXO 22:4–22:9

Divine punishment is always totally just

GEN 18:25 See also GEN 20:4; EXO 34:7; DEU 32:35; 2CH 6:23; ISA 3:11; MAT 16:27; 1CO 3:12–3:15; 1TH 4:6

God appoints human agents to administer his punishment

ROM 13:4 See also ISA 45:1, ISA 45:14; JER 51:20; MIC 4:13; 1PE 2:13–2:14

5484: punishment, by God

God's chastening of his children and his judgment on impenitent sinners and supernatural evil powers.

God's punishment of his children**Through the discipline of suffering and hardship**

HEB 12:5–12:7 See also PRO 3:11–3:12; DEU 4:36, DEU 8:5; 2SA 7:14; JOB 5:17JOB 33:19, JOB 36:10 PSA 32:3–32:4, PSA 94:12–94:13, PSA 118:18, PSA 119:75; ZEP 3:7; JAS 1:12; REV 3:19

Through death

1CO 11:30–11:32 See also LEV 10:1–10:3; NUM 11:1–11:3; 1SA 4:17–4:21; 2SA 6:6–6:8 parallel 1CH 13:9–13:11

God's punishment of the ungodly**Their punishment is certain**

ROM 1:18 See also PRO 10:24; ISA 13:11, ISA 26:21, ISA 66:16; JHN 5:28–5:29; EPH 5:6; COL 3:6; 1TH 5:3; HEB 2:2–2:3

Their punishment is just

PSA 96:13 See also GEN 18:25; EXO 9:27; PSA 98:9; JHN 5:28–5:30; ROM 3:5–3:8; 1PE 2:23; REV 16:5–16:7

Their punishment involves destruction in hell

LUK 12:5 parallel MAT 10:28 See also MAT 5:29–5:30

Fire as an image of destruction

MAT 5:22 See also ISA 33:14, ISA 66:15; NAM 1:6; MAL 4:1; MAT 13:40–13:43; MRK 9:43, MRK 9:48; LUK 16:22–16:24; JUD 1:7, JUD 1:23; REV 20:14–20:15

Their punishment will involve exclusion from God's presence

MAT 7:23 See also MAT 22:13, MAT 25:41; LUK 13:24–13:28; REV 21:27

Their punishment will be eternal

2TH 1:8–1:9 Interpreters differ over whether “everlasting destruction” implies an experience which continues for ever, or annihilation that is everlasting in the sense of being irreversible. See also DAN 12:2; MAT 25:46; REV 14:11

The punishment of the second death

REV 2:11 The “second death” refers to the final state of the unrepentant. See also REV 20:6, REV 21:8

There will be degrees of punishment

MRK 12:40 parallel LUK 20:47 See also MAT 11:22, MAT 11:24; LUK 12:47–12:48

The punishment of God's spiritual enemies**Satan**

REV 20:2 See also ISA 14:12–14:15; 1TI 3:6; HEB 2:14; REV 12:9, REV 20:10

Fallen angels

2PE 2:4 See also ISA 24:21–24:22; MAT 25:41; JUD 1:6

5485: punishment, legal aspects of

The law sets out details of penalties which may be imposed upon people as a result of their committing of offences.

Just punishments**Banishment**

GEN 3:23 See also 2SA 14:13–14:14; EZR 7:26; JOB 18:18; JER 16:15, JER 23:8, JER 29:14; ZEC 5:3

Beating

DEU 25:2–25:3

Burning

GEN 38:24 See also LEV 20:14, LEV 21:9; DAN 3:6

Confiscation of property

EST 8:1 See also EZR 10:8

Hanging

JOS 8:29 See also DEU 21:22–21:23; JOS 10:26; 1SA 31:8–31:10; 2SA 4:122SA 17:23; MAT 27:5 2SA 21:9–21:10; GAL 3:13

Impaling

EZR 6:11 See also GEN 40:19–40:22EST 2:23, EST 5:14

Stoning

EXO 19:12–19:13 See also EXO 21:29; LEV 20:2, LEV 20:27LEV 24:14, LEV 24:16, LEV 24:23 NUM 15:36; DEU 13:10, DEU 17:5, DEU 21:21, DEU 22:21, DEU 22:24; JOS 7:25; 1KI 21:13–21:15

Unjust punishments and persecutions**Banishment**

ACT 18:2

Beating

MAT 27:26 parallels MRK 15:15, JHN 19:1 See also ISA 53:5; ACT 16:37; 2CO 11:24

Beheading

MAT 14:9–14:10 parallel MRK 6:27 See also MRK 6:16; ACT 12:2; REV 20:4

Being thrown to wild animals

DAN 6:16; ; 1CO 15:32

Hanging

ACT 5:30 See also ACT 10:39

Imprisonment

ACT 5:18 See also GEN 39:20–39:22; 1KI 22:27; JER 37:15, JER 38:6; ACT 12:4, ACT 16:23, ACT 23:35, ACT 26:10; 2CO 11:23; HEB 11:36

Stoning

ACT 7:59 See also 1KI 12:18 parallel 2CH 10:18; LAM 3:53; MAT 21:35; ACT 14:19; 2CO 11:25; HEB 11:37

Confiscation of property

1KI 21:15–21:16 See also 2SA 16:4

5487: queen

In OT times the chief wife of a king's harem or a female monarch. A queen mother, as a king's widow and the mother of the reigning king, would have held a position of some authority and influence.

A queen as the wife of a king**A chief wife among several**

EST 2:17 See also EST 1:9–1:12, EST 2:4

Enjoying a position of some influence

EST 1:15–1:18, EST 2:22, EST 5:12, EST 7:5–7:8

Enjoying the king's special favour

EST 5:2–5:3 See also EST 7:1–7:3, EST 8:1, EST 8:7, EST 9:12; SNG 6:8–6:9; NEH 2:6; PSA 45:9

Sometimes granted considerable authority

EST 9:29 See also EST 9:31

A queen as a female monarch**The queen of Sheba**

1KI 10:1 parallel 2CH 9:1 See also 1KI 10:2–10:10 parallel 2CH 9:1–9:9; 1KI 10:13 parallel 2CH 9:12; MAT 12:42 parallel LUK 11:31

Queen Athaliah of Judah

2KI 11:1–11:21 parallel 2CH 22:10–23:21

Queen used figuratively**Of Jerusalem**

LAM 1:1; ; EZK 16:13

Of Babylon

ISA 47:5, ISA 47:7; ; REV 18:7

Queen of Heaven: a title for the Babylonian goddess Ishtar

JER 7:18, JER 44:17–44:19, JER 44:25

A queen mother as a king's widow and mother of the reigning king

1KI 2:19 See also 1KI 15:13 parallel 2CH 15:16; 2KI 10:13, 2KI 24:8, 2KI 24:12, 2KI 24:15; JER 13:18, JER 22:26, JER 29:2; DAN 5:10; ACT 8:27

5488: quivers

A case for carrying arrows on hunting expeditions or in battle.

Quivers used on hunting expeditions

GEN 27:3

Loaded quivers taken into battle

JOB 39:23; ; ISA 22:6

Quivers referred to figuratively**To depict the deadly fire-power of an enemy**

JER 5:16

As a symbol of a man's many sons

PSA 127:5

To depict the LORD's concealment of his servant

ISA 49:2

As an instrument of the LORD's discipline

LAM 3:13

5489: rank

A person's seniority and/or status, especially in military, government or priestly positions. Christians should not be concerned about rank or status.

Differences in rank amongst those in charge of both military and civil affairs**Emperor**

LUK 2:1, LUK 3:1

King

2SA 5:3–5:5; ; 1KI 4:1

Judge

JDG 2:16–2:19 The book of Judges calls individual judges "deliverers" e.g., 3:9, 15.

Prince

JDG 5:15; ; 2SA 3:38

Leader

NUM 2:3–2:7, NUM 2:10–2:12; ; JDG 4:4; ; 1SA 10:1

Military ranks**Commander**

2SA 2:8; ; ACT 24:22

Captain

GEN 39:1; ; JDG 5:14; ; 2KI 1:9–1:13; ; ISA 3:3

Officer

1KI 4:5; 1KI 9:22; ; 1CH 27:1; ; ACT 25:23

Centurion

MAT 8:5; ; ACT 27:43

Civil ranks**Noble**

EST 1:3; EST 2:18

Official

1CH 28:1; ; JER 52:10

Governor

1KI 4:7–4:19; ; HAG 1:1; ; ACT 23:24

Tetrarch

LUK 3:1

Heads of clans/tribes

JOS 14:1; ; 1KI 8:1

Heads of families

NUM 7:2; ; JOS 2:12–2:13

Division of labour involving different degrees of responsibility

EXO 18:20–18:23

Rank was conferred as a reward

1SA 18:5

Rank within the priesthood**The high priest**

LEV 21:10; ; NUM 35:25; NUM 35:28; NUM 35:32; ; HAG 1:1; ; ZEC 3:1; ; LUK 3:2

Priests

EXO 28:1–28:2; ; LEV 8:5–8:12; ; NUM 4:16; ; JOS 22:31; ; 2KI 11:9

Levites

EXO 32:26; ; NUM 1:50; ; DEU 12:18–12:19; ; 2CH 11:13–11:14

Officers in the NT church

In contrast to the priesthood, offices within the NT Church are according to gifts; individuals with different gifts are listed but do not form a hierarchy: ROM 12:4–12:8; ; 1CO 12:28–12:30; ; EPH 4:11; PHP 1:1; ; 1TI 3:1–3:13

Some elders are worthy of double honour

1TI 5:17 Comparison between verses 17 and 28 of Acts 20 shows that the same individuals could be called “elders”, “overseers” or “shepherds” (pastors).

All believers are called priests

1PE 2:5; 1PE 2:9; ; REV 1:6; REV 5:10; REV 20:6

Jesus Christ taught his disciples not to seek rank or status

MAT 18:1–18:4 parallels MRK 9:33–9:37; LUK 9:46–9:48

5490: refuge

A safe retreat; a place of healing and renewal; also a stronghold from which to launch a counter-attack.

False refuges**Flight**

GEN 3:8–3:9; PSA 139:7–139:12 See also ISA 28:15; ISA 28:17

Idolatry

ISA 44:9 See also DEU 32:31; DEU 32:37–32:38

Human support

JER 17:5 See also PSA 20:7–20:8; PSA 142:4; ISA 30:1–30:2; ZEC 4:6; PHP 3:3

False confidence

JER 6:14 See also EZK 13:10–13:12; MAT 7:26–7:27; REV 6:15–6:17

God alone is the true refuge of believers

DEU 33:27 See also 1SA 2:2; 2SA 22:32; PSA 18:31; PSA 46:1; PSA 62:6–62:7; JHN 10:28–10:29; ROM 8:31–8:32; ROM 8:38–8:39; PHP 4:7

Pictures to describe God as a refuge**A fortress**

PSA 46:7 See also PSA 28:8; PSA 48:3; PSA 59:16; PSA 59:16; PSA 62:2; PSA 71:3; PSA 91:2; PSA 144:1–144:3

A rock

2SA 22:2–22:3 parallel PSA 18:2 See also GEN 49:24; DEU 32:4; DEU 32:15; 2SA 22:47; PSA 31:2; PSA 94:22; ISA 26:4; HAB 1:12

A shade

PSA 91:1 See also PSA 121:5; SNG 2:3; ISA 25:4–25:5

Sheltering wings

PSA 57:1 See also DEU 32:10–32:11; RUT 2:12; PSA 17:8; PSA 36:7; MAT 23:37

A shield

GEN 15:1 See also DEU 33:29; 2SA 22:31; PSA 3:3; PSA 28:7; PSA 84:11; PRO 30:5; EPH 6:16

A tower

PRO 18:10 See also PSA 61:3

Cities of refuge

NUM 35:11 See also DEU 4:41–4:43, DEU 19:1–19:13; JOS 20:1–20:9

5491: refugees

Fugitives driven from home because of personal, political or religious persecution, or because of physical danger.

Examples of refugees

GEN 16:6–16:8 Hagar; ; GEN 46:1; ; EXO 12:37–12:39; ; RUT 1:1; ; MAT 2:13–2:15 Mary, Joseph and Jesus Christ; ; ACT 18:2

Refugees are to be treated kindly

DEU 23:15–23:16; ; MAT 25:35; ; PHM 1:10–1:16

Refugees from legal accusation are to be provided for

NUM 35:6; ; JOS 20:1–20:6

The LORD is a place of spiritual refuge

DEU 33:27; ; 2SA 22:3; ; PSA 9:9, PSA 59:16; ; ISA 25:4; ; JER 16:19; ; NAM 1:7

5492: restitution

The return of something lost or stolen so that the original situation is restored. This central theme of the OT law is supremely fulfilled through Jesus Christ making restitution for Adam's sin, thus restoring fellowship with God and hope of eternal life.

Reasons for restitution

For crimes committed

EXO 22:2–22:3 See also EXO 22:7, EXO 22:16–22:17; LEV 6:1–6:6, LEV 24:17–24:21; NUM 5:6–5:7; EZK 33:14–33:15

For accidental loss

EXO 22:5–22:6 See also EXO 21:33–21:34, EXO 22:10–22:15

For unintentional sin

LEV 5:14–5:16

As part of confession

NUM 5:5–5:7

In cases of misplaced accusation

PSA 69:4

The basis of decisions regarding restitution

Arbitration

EXO 22:8–22:9

The amount of restitution is to exceed the amount stolen

EXO 22:1 See also EXO 22:4; LEV 6:5; 2SA 12:5–12:6; PRO 6:31

Land should belong to its rightful owners

2SA 9:7

Examples of restitution

1SA 6:17 The Philistines make restitution for desecrating the ark of God; ; 1KI 20:34 Ben-Hadad makes restitution for the cities his father had taken from Israel; ; 2KI 8:1–8:6 The king makes restitution to the Shunammite by returning her house and land; ; NEH 5:10–5:12 Nehemiah orders restitution to be made to the poor; ; LUK 19:8–19:9 Zacchaeus makes restitution to those he had cheated.

The act of restitution is to be motivated by love

ROM 13:8–13:10 See also MAT 5:23–5:24, MAT 5:44; COL 3:13–3:14

God promises physical restitution

ISA 57:18, ISA 61:3–61:4; ; JER 30:17–30:18

Jesus Christ makes restitution for sin

He restores fellowship with God

ROM 5:19 See also 2CO 5:21; HEB 9:28

He restores the hope of eternal life

1CO 15:21–15:22 See also 1CO 15:45–15:49

Restitution is made to Jesus Christ

PHP 2:8–2:9 Here God's exaltation of Jesus Christ is seen as restitution to his position of glory. See also ISA 53:10–53:12

Restitution is made to those who make sacrifices for the gospel

MAT 19:21 parallels MRK 10:21, LUK 18:22 See also MAT 19:29 parallels MRK 10:29–10:30, LUK 18:29–18:30; MRK 8:35 parallels MAT 16:25, LUK 9:24; JHN 12:24–12:25; PHP 3:8–3:10

5493: retribution

Recompense for evil. In Scripture this is the prerogative of God and of the authorities ordained by God, and never of individuals.

The principle of retribution

EXO 20:5–20:6; ROM 12:19; HEB 10:30 See also DEU 32:35; EXO 32:33–32:34; LEV 26:23–26:25; DEU 7:9–7:10, DEU 32:41–32:43; JOB 34:11; PRO 24:12; ISA 1:24; NAM 1:2

Divine retribution is just

GEN 18:25 See also DEU 32:3–32:4; 2CH 12:1–12:6; PSA 58:10–58:11; JER 5:7–5:9, JER 5:26–5:29; HOS 4:6

Retribution is often built into the nature of wrongdoing

PSA 7:15–7:16 See also PSA 37:14–37:15; PRO 1:18, PRO 26:27, PRO 28:10; ECC 10:8; MAT 26:52; GAL 6:7–6:8

Retribution is placed in the hands of governments

GEN 9:6; EXO 21:23–21:25 This “lex talionis” (law of exacting like for like) was not for private retribution. It insisted that justice be fair and not out of proportion to the crime; **ROM 13:4** See also LEV 24:17–24:22; NUM 35:16–35:25; 1PE 2:14

Private retribution is forbidden

PRO 24:29 See also MAT 5:38–5:39; ROM 12:19

Prayer for retribution

PSA 28:4 Christians can agree with these prayers, hating all that opposes the Lord and goodness, and gladly anticipating the ultimate vindication of God’s glory. Christians leave judgment in God’s hands, but nonetheless grieve over the world’s pain and over the death of every unrepentant sinner; **2TH 1:6–1:10** See also PSA 79:10, PSA 94:1–94:2, PSA 137:8–137:9; LAM 3:64–3:66

The final retribution

REV 20:13 See also PSA 62:11–62:12; JHN 5:28–5:29; ROM 2:5–2:11

Examples of direct divine retribution on people**In the fall**

GEN 3:14, GEN 3:17 See also GEN 3:15–3:16, GEN 3:18–3:19

In the flood

GEN 6:5–6:7

At the Tower of Babel

See also GEN 11:5–11:7

On Sodom and Gomorrah

GEN 19:24

In the ten plagues on Egypt

EXO 7:16–7:17, EXO 11:1, EXO 12:29

On the Israelites in the wilderness

EXO 32:35 See also 1CO 10:6–10:10

On the heathen nations

LEV 18:25; ; DEU 9:4

On the rebellious nation of Israel

LEV 18:28; ; DEU 28:47–28:48

On idolatrous Judah

ISA 65:6–65:7, ISA 66:6; ; EZK 5:11–5:13

On Babylon

JER 51:6, JER 51:24, JER 51:56

Upon all the nations

OBA 1:15–1:16

On Jerusalem

MAT 23:35–23:36 This judgment came on Jerusalem in A.D. 70.

Upon persecutors and unbelievers

1TH 2:14–2:16

Examples of divine retribution on individuals

ACT 12:23 See also NUM 16:30; 2SA 6:7, 2SA 12:10; JER 23:2; ACT 5:3–5:5, ACT 5:9; 1CO 11:29–11:30

Examples of divine retribution through human beings

JDG 1:7, JDG 9:56–9:57; ; 2SA 18:17; 2KI 9:7, 2KI 9:24, 2KI 9:30–9:33

Natural retribution

ROM 1:27; 2TI 3:13

Examples of retribution by the state

See also JOS 7:25; 1KI 2:31–2:32; EST 7:10; LUK 23:40–23:41

National retribution

JOS 10:13–10:14; ; JDG 11:36; ; EST 9:5 The special case of God’s dealings with the nation of Israel and her enemies is not a basis on which to argue for a concept of a war, just or otherwise. A just war has to be in defence of the nation or of the defenceless, and involve a minimum of suffering.

Warnings of future retribution

ACT 17:31 See also MAT 25:31–25:32

5494: revenge

The returning of injury or insult. Scripture insists that human revenge is unacceptable and is to be left in the hands of God.

5495: revenge, and retaliation

Scripture teaches that it is wrong to strike back or to return evil for evil, whether by immediate retaliation or by taking revenge later. Justice must be done, but this must be left in the hands of God, or of the authorities ordained by God.

OT teaching about revenge

Revenge forbidden in the OT

GEN 4:15; LEV 19:18; DEU 32:35; PRO 20:22 See also DEU 19:5–19:7, DEU 19:11–19:13, DEU 23:7; PRO 24:29; JER 29:7

The “lex talionis” (law of exacting like for like)

EXO 21:23–21:25 This was not a rule for personal revenge but to ensure that judicial punishments were neither unjust nor malicious. See also LEV 24:17–24:21; DEU 19:18–19:21

Personal revenge forbidden in the NT

By Jesus Christ

MAT 5:38–5:45 See also LUK 6:27–6:36

By the apostles

ROM 12:17; 1TH 5:15; 1PE 3:9 See also 1CO 13:4–13:5

The evil effects of revenge illustrated in the life of Samson

JDG 15:1–15:8, JDG 15:9–15:10, JDG 15:11–15:12

Alternatives to revenge

Avoiding the problem

ROM 12:18; ; 1PE 4:8

Evading the attack

MAT 10:23; ; LUK 4:29–4:30

Accepting the injury

1CO 6:7; ; HEB 10:32–10:34

Using the law

ACT 22:25; ; 1CO 6:1–6:6 going to law

Forgiving and setting an example

LUK 23:34; ; ACT 7:59–7:60; ROM 12:19–12:21; ; PRO 25:21–25:22

God will avenge his people

LUK 18:7–18:8 See also DEU 32:43; 1SA 24:12; 2KI 9:7; PSA 18:47; REV 6:10, REV 19:2

5496: revenge, examples of

Ungodly people are often vengeful, and even Christians are not always exemplary in this respect. However, each case should be considered on its merits, and the claims of justice taken into account.

Revenge among the ungodly

LUK 6:11 parallels MAT 12:14, MRK 3:6 See also GEN 4:24 Compare Lamech's words with those of Jesus Christ in Mt 18:21–22; 1KI 19:2 Jezebel; 1KI 22:27 Ahab; EST 3:6 Haman; EZK 25:15 the Philistines MRK 6:19, MRK 6:24 ACT 5:33 the Sanhedrin; ACT 23:12 unbelieving Jews

Revenge among God's people

JDG 8:4–8:9; EST 9:1, EST 9:5 See also GEN 16:5–16:6; GAL 4:30; JDG 16:28–16:30 Samson; 1SA 25:10–25:13; 2SA 10:4–10:7 David did not retaliate at once, but only when a military threat appeared; 2SA 3:27 Joab; LUK 9:51–9:56 James and John; JHN 18:10–18:11 Peter; ACT 23:2–23:5 Paul

Examples of non-retaliation

By Jesus Christ

1PE 2:23 See also ISA 50:6–50:7, ISA 53:7; LUK 23:34

By David

1SA 24:1–24:12; ; PSA 35:11–35:14, PSA 35:17, PSA 38:12–38:15

By others

GEN 50:15–50:21 Joseph; ; 1SA 12:23 Samuel; ; 1KI 22:24–22:25 Micaiah; ; JOB 31:29 Job; ; ACT 7:59–7:60 Stephen

Expressions of desire for revenge

PSA 28:4, PSA 109:8–109:14, PSA 137:8–137:9; ; JER 15:15, JER 18:21; ; GAL 1:8–1:9, GAL 5:12; ; REV 6:10, REV 16:5–16:7, REV 18:6, REV 18:20

5498: reward

Recompense in recognition of services rendered. Scripture stresses that while salvation is a gift of God, believers will be rewarded according to their deeds. Believers should be honest in rewarding others for their work.

5499: reward, divine

God's dealings with people are always in harmony with his grace and his justice, hating evil and loving good. No gift of God is on the basis of merit, but on the basis of his faithfulness to his promises.

God's reward is in harmony with his character

His graciousness

ROM 4:4–4:5 See also PSA 103:10; MAT 20:14–20:15; LUK 17:7–17:10; ROM 11:6–11:7; EPH 2:8–2:10

His justice

ROM 2:6–2:11 See also DEU 28:1–28:2 blessings for obedience; DEU 28:15 curses for disobedience; PSA 19:9–19:11, PSA 62:12; PRO 13:21, PRO 14:14; JER 17:10, JER 32:19; 1CO 3:8; 2CO 9:6; GAL 6:7–6:9; EPH 6:8; COL 3:25

The reward of the ungodly

ROM 6:23 See also EXO 20:5; DEU 7:9–7:10; PRO 22:22–22:23; ISA 13:11, ISA 26:21, ISA 59:18, ISA 65:6–65:7, ISA 66:6; EZK 7:4, EZK 9:10, EZK 11:21; HOS 9:7; ZEP 1:12; 2TH 1:6; HEB 2:1–2:2

The reward of the godly

God's treatment of the righteous

ROM 8:17–8:18 See also EXO 19:5; RUT 2:12; 2SA 22:25 parallels PSA 18:20, PSA 18:24; 1KI 3:14; 2CH 15:7; PSA 19:9–19:11, PSA 58:11; PRO 11:18, PRO 11:28, PRO 13:21, PRO 19:17, PRO 31:31; ISA 62:10–62:12; JER 31:16; MAT 5:12; LUK 6:34–6:35; 1CO 2:9–2:10; JAS 1:25

The example of Jesus Christ

PHP 2:8–2:11 See also HEB 12:2–12:3

Apparent unfair treatment of the godly

PSA 73:13–73:14 See also JOB 1:1, JOB 2:11–2:13, JOB 9:29–9:31; ISA 49:4; HAB 1:12–1:13; MAT 5:10; 2TI 3:12

5500: reward, for God's people

God gives blessings to his people who serve him faithfully and who suffer for him. God himself is his people's greatest reward. The fulness will be theirs at the coming of Jesus Christ.

God promises to reward his people

For faithful service

1CO 3:12–3:15; COL 3:23–3:24 See also EXO 32:28–32:29; NUM 14:30, NUM 25:10–25:13; ISA 40:10, ISA 62:11; DAN 12:3; MAT 10:41–10:42, MAT 25:28–25:29; MRK 9:41

In and through self-denial

MAT 19:29 parallel MRK 10:29–10:30 See also MAT 16:24–16:26, MAT 19:21; LUK 18:28–18:30; 1CO 9:26–9:27; HEB 10:33–10:34, HEB 11:36–11:40

At the coming of Jesus Christ

MAT 19:27–19:28 See also MAT 16:27, MAT 25:31–25:36; LUK 14:12–14:14; 2TI 4:7–4:8; 1PE 5:4; REV 22:12

God himself is his people's greatest reward

GEN 15:1 See also DEU 32:9; PSA 73:26; REV 21:3

The certainty of future reward is an incentive to holiness

PHP 3:12–3:14 See also HEB 10:35, HEB 11:6, HEB 11:24–11:26; 2JN 1:8; REV 2:10

5501: reward, human

Honest reward for services rendered is commended. Even though such reward is often deserved, it is not always given.

Reward for services rendered

Payment for work done

COL 4:1 See also GEN 29:28–29:29; 2SA 19:32–19:36; PRO 13:13; MAT 20:1–20:2, MAT 25:23; ROM 4:4; 1CO 9:24–9:25; 1TI 5:17–5:18

Favour for help received

1SA 17:23–17:25 See also GEN 41:41–41:45; JOS 2:14; EST 6:1–6:3, EST 6:6–6:10; DAN 2:46–2:49

Unjust treatment and reward

ACT 10:37–10:39 GEN 29:22–29:25, GEN 39:19–39:20, GEN 40:23; ; NUM 14:1–14:4; ; 1SA 25:21; ; 2SA 15:1–15:4; ; PSA 41:9, PSA 55:12–55:14; ; JER 38:4–38:6; ; JHN 13:18

Dishonest reward forbidden

DEU 16:19 In a fallen world there are many opportunities to gain by wrongdoing. See also NUM 22:7, NUM 22:16–22:17, NUM 24:11; 1KI 13:7–13:8; 2KI 5:20–5:24; JOB 17:5; ISA 1:23; MIC 3:11, MIC 7:3; MAT 26:14–26:15 parallel MRK 14:10–14:11; ACT 1:18

Rewarding the undeserving

ROM 12:20 See also GEN 47:11–47:12; 1SA 12:23, 1SA 24:16–24:19; MAT 5:38–5:41, MAT 5:44–5:47

5503: rich, the

It is hard but not impossible for rich people to enter God's kingdom. They must put their hope in God, not in their riches. Rich people who live selfishly, abuse their position and fail to repent and live for Jesus Christ, are in peril.

Parables concerning rich people

2SA 12:1–12:10; ; MAT 13:44–13:46, MAT 18:23, MAT 22:2 parallel LUK 14:16; ; MAT 25:14 parallel LUK 19:12; ; LUK 12:16, LUK 15:11–15:13, LUK 16:1, LUK 18:10

Rich people have received blessing

1TI 6:17 See also PSA 1:3, PSA 112:1–112:3

They have friends

PRO 14:20, PRO 19:4

They have power

PRO 22:7

They have security

PRO 10:15, PRO 18:11

Warnings to rich people

They should recognise that God is the giver of riches

DEU 8:17–8:18 See also DEU 32:13–32:15; HOS 2:8

They should not be arrogant or complacent on account of their riches

JER 9:23–9:24 See also PSA 49:5–49:6; JER 49:4; HOS 12:8; 1TI 6:17; REV 3:17

They should not trust in their riches

PRO 11:28 See also PSA 49:6, PSA 52:7, PSA 62:10; JER 48:7

They face disaster if they lack wisdom**PSA 49:20** See also PRO 28:11; JER 9:23–9:24**They must live moral lives****PRO 28:6** See also PRO 22:16; JER 5:27–5:28, JER 17:11; MIC 6:12**Wealth can bring anxiety****ECC 5:12** See also MAT 6:25–6:34 parallel LUK 12:22–12:31**Riches are of fleeting value****LUK 12:16–12:21** See also PSA 49:5–49:12; PRO 27:24; ECC 5:15; ISA 10:3; MAT 6:19; 1TI 6:7; JOB 1:21; JAS 1:10–1:11**Ultimate security is found in God alone**

EXO 15:2; ; 2SA 22:33; ; 1CH 16:11; ; PSA 28:7, PSA 29:11, PSA 46:1, PSA 52:6–52:7; ; ISA 12:2; ; HAB 3:19

It is hard for rich people to enter God's kingdom**MAT 19:23–19:26** parallels MRK 10:23–10:27, LUK 18:24–18:27 See also MAT 13:22 parallels MRK 4:18–4:19, LUK 8:14; MAT 19:16–19:22 parallels MRK 10:17–10:22, LUK 18:18–18:23**Rich people will be judged for their behaviour**

ZEC 11:5–11:6; ; LUK 1:53

If they exploit, oppress or kill the poor**JAS 5:1–5:4** See also PRO 14:31, PRO 22:16, PRO 28:3; EZK 18:12–18:13, EZK 22:29–22:31; JAS 2:6, JAS 5:6**If they hoard wealth and live selfishly****JAS 5:5** See also LUK 12:16–12:21, LUK 16:19–16:31**If they slander the name of Jesus Christ**

JAS 2:7

Commands to rich people**To seek God's kingdom as first priority**

MAT 6:19–6:21, MAT 6:31–6:33 parallel LUK 12:29–12:31; ; 1TI 6:19

To repent from sin

REV 3:17, REV 3:19

To be generous towards the needy**1TI 6:18** See also MAT 19:21 parallels MRK 10:21, LUK 18:22; LUK 3:11, LUK 11:41, LUK 12:33–12:34, LUK 14:12–14:14, LUK 16:9, LUK 19:8; 2CO 8:1–8:5, 2CO 8:9 Jesus Christ's example the motivation for generosity; 2CO 8:13–8:15, 2CO 9:6–9:15**Incorrect attitudes to the rich**

ECC 10:20 cursing them; ; PSA 49:16–49:17 living in awe of them; ; PSA 49:5–49:6 fearing them; JOB 34:18–34:19; ; PRO 22:2; ; JAS 2:1–2:4

God brings good news for rich people

PSA 22:29–22:31; ; MAT 9:9–9:10 parallels MRK 2:14–2:15, LUK 5:27–5:29; ; MAT 27:57 parallels MRK 15:43, LUK 23:50–23:51; ; LUK 19:1–19:10

Examples of rich people

Abraham: GEN 12:10–12:16, GEN 13:2; GEN 26:1–26:14 Isaac; GEN 27:19, GEN 27:28, GEN 30:29–30:43, GEN 35:11–35:12; GEN 15:14; ; EXO 3:22, EXO 12:36; ; PSA 105:37; 1KI 10:23 parallel 2CH 9:22 Solomon; 2KI 20:13; ; 2CH 32:27–32:29 Joseph of Arimathea; ; MAT 27:57–27:60 parallels MRK 15:43–15:46, LUK 23:50–23:53; ; JHN 19:38–19:42

5504: rights

The basis of a claim to respect, and just and fair treatment. God has rights over his creation as a result of his sovereignty and authority. Through being the height of his creation, human beings also have rights, which are to be respected.

The rights that God gives**God gives rights to the poor and needy****EXO 22:22** See also EXO 22:25–22:27; LEV 19:9–19:10; JOB 36:6**God gives rights to slaves****LEV 22:11** See also EXO 21:2–21:6 parallel DEU 15:12–15:18; EXO 21:7–21:11, EXO 21:26–21:27**God gives rights to strangers****LEV 19:33–19:34** See also EXO 22:21; LEV 19:10**God gives rights to those who commit manslaughter****NUM 35:9–35:12** See also DEU 4:41–4:42; JOS 20:1–20:6**God gives rights in marriage****1CO 7:3–7:5** See also EXO 21:7–21:11; DEU 22:13–22:21; EPH 5:22–5:33**God gives rights to parents****COL 3:20** parallel EPH 6:1 See also EXO 20:12 parallel DEU 5:16; 1TI 5:4**God gives rights to children****HEB 12:16** See also GEN 25:29–25:34; DEU 21:15–21:17; 1CH 5:1–5:2; EPH 6:4**God gives rights to Christians****JHN 1:12** See also GAL 3:26–4:7; REV 2:7, REV 3:21, REV 22:14**God gives rights to leaders****1CO 9:18** See also 1CO 9:1–9:17; 1TI 5:17–5:18

Why God gives rights

God gives rights to keep an orderly society

LEV 19:29 See also DEU 15:1–15:6

God gives rights to protect people

DEU 19:15 See also LEV 25:23–25:43, LEV 25:47–25:55

The defence of rights

God, the defender of rights

MIC 7:8–7:10 The implied speaker here is Israel. See also DEU 10:18; PSA 68:5; PRO 23:10–23:11

Abuse of rights punished by God

ISA 10:1–10:4 See also JER 5:26–5:29; AMO 2:6–2:8

Leaders are to protect the rights of others

PSA 72:1–72:4 See also PRO 31:4–31:9; ECC 5:8

The rights which God has

God has a right to be worshipped

2KI 17:36 See also MAT 4:10 parallel LUK 4:8; DEU 6:13; JHN 4:24

God has a right to be obeyed

DEU 10:12–10:13 See also DEU 26:16–26:18, DEU 30:16

5505: roads

Recognised routes for travellers, or streets in towns and cities. In biblical times travelling by road was recognised as dangerous.

Kinds of road

In the open country

EXO 13:17–13:18; ACT 19:1 See also GEN 16:7; NUM 20:17; DEU 1:2; JOS 10:10–10:11; JDG 21:19; 1SA 17:52; ISA 15:5

In towns and cities

ACT 9:11 See also EST 6:9; JER 37:21

Activities associated with roads and streets

Travelling

JDG 5:10; ; 2KI 2:23; ; LUK 9:57, LUK 10:30–10:33; ; ACT 8:36

Talking

LUK 24:32 See also DEU 6:7; MRK 9:33; LUK 10:4, LUK 13:26

Waiting

1SA 4:13; ; 2SA 15:2; ; 1KI 20:38

Helping others

DEU 22:4, DEU 27:18; ; LUK 10:30–10:33

Leisure and play

ZEC 8:4–8:5

Begging

LUK 18:35

Living on the streets

MAT 22:9–22:10 parallel LUK 14:21–14:23 See also JOB 31:32

Prayer

MAT 6:5

Idolatry

2CH 28:24; ; JER 44:17; ; EZK 16:25

Injustice and dishonesty

ISA 59:14 See also JER 5:1

Dangers of the road

EZR 8:31 See also 1KI 13:24; EZR 8:22; ECC 12:5; PRO 22:13; HOS 7:1; LUK 10:30–10:33

Troubled times affecting roads and streets

PSA 55:11; NAM 2:4 See also JOS 2:19; JER 6:25; HOS 6:9; ISA 5:25, ISA 33:7–33:8, ISA 51:20; AMO 5:16

Roads and streets deserted

JDG 5:6 See also JER 9:21, JER 33:10; LAM 1:4; ZEP 3:6

Escape

JER 48:19

The road back from exile

ISA 40:3 See also ISA 11:16, ISA 35:8, ISA 57:14

Roads used figuratively

MAT 7:13–7:14 See also GEN 49:17; PRO 15:19; ISA 59:8; JER 3:2, JER 18:15, JER 31:21; LUK 3:5; REV 22:2

Roads of special importance in the NT

The road to Emmaus

LUK 24:13–24:32

The road to Damascus

ACT 9:3–9:9, ACT 9:17, ACT 22:6, ACT 26:13

5506: roof

Most buildings in biblical times had flat roofs. With the hot climate, they had a wider range of uses than merely providing shelter for the building.

Uses of roofs

Shelter erected on the roof to make an extra room

2KI 4:10 See also 2SA 16:22; PRO 21:9, PRO 25:24

Guests lodged on the roof

JOS 2:8 See also 1SA 9:25–9:26

The roof used as a place for leisure and relaxation

2SA 11:2 See also DAN 4:29; MAT 24:17 parallels MRK 13:15, LUK 17:31

The roof used as a place of religious observance

NEH 8:16 See also 2KI 23:12; JER 19:13, JER 32:29; ZEP 1:5; ACT 10:9

In cities, some roofs were open, public places

ISA 15:3 See also JDG 9:50–9:52; 2SA 18:24; JER 48:38; MAT 10:26–10:27 parallel LUK 12:2–12:3

Roofs were usually constructed with a thick layer of clay

MRK 2:4 parallel LUK 5:19

Roof as a synonym for house

MAT 8:8 parallel LUK 7:6

5507: rope and cord

Items normally used in domestic and military situations, but also used in Scripture in a symbolic sense to refer to bondage or constraint.

Various uses for rope and cord**In clothes and furnishing**

EXO 28:28, EXO 28:37; ; NUM 15:38; ; 1KI 20:31; ; EST 1:6; ; EZK 27:24

For tents

EXO 35:18, EXO 39:40; ; NUM 3:37, NUM 4:32; ; ISA 54:2

In sailing

ACT 27:17, ACT 27:32, ACT 27:40

In military use

2SA 17:13; PSA 7:12, PSA 11:2; ; JER 51:3

For rescue and escape

JOS 2:15; ; 1SA 19:12; ; JER 38:6, JER 38:13; ; ACT 9:25; ; 2CO 11:33

To restrain animals

JOB 39:5, JOB 41:1–41:2; ; PSA 32:9; ; MAT 21:2 parallels MRK 11:2, LUK 19:30

To restrain people

JDG 15:13–15:14; ; EZK 3:25, EZK 4:8; ; MAT 14:3 parallel MRK 6:17

Rope and cord as symbols of bondage**Of evil**

PRO 5:22 See also PSA 129:4, PSA 140:5; ISA 5:18, ISA 58:6; ROM 7:6

Of suffering

LUK 13:16 See also JOB 16:8, JOB 36:8; PSA 119:61; DAN 3:21; MAT 14:3 parallel MRK 6:17; MRK 15:1; JHN 18:12, JHN 18:24

Of death

PSA 18:4–18:5 parallel 2SA 22:6 See also PSA 116:3

Rope and cord as symbols of spiritual and emotional ties**Symbols of loving relationships**

HOS 11:4 See also ECC 4:12; JER 10:20; ROM 7:2

Symbols of obedience

PRO 7:2–7:3 See also DEU 6:8, DEU 11:18; PRO 3:3, PRO 6:20–6:21

Symbols of life

ECC 12:6 See also PSA 16:6

5508: ruins

The remains of a city, town or building after destruction or neglect. In Scripture it mainly describes the aftermath of divine judgment.

Israel's reduction to ruins**As a covenant curse for disobeying God**

LEV 26:27–26:33 See also DEU 13:16, DEU 28:49–28:52

The ruin prophesied

JER 9:11; MIC 1:6–1:7 See also ISA 5:5–5:7, ISA 6:11–6:13; JER 4:7, JER 4:20, JER 4:23–4:26, JER 22:5; EZK 6:6–6:7, EZK 6:14, EZK 21:27; AMO 3:13–3:15, AMO 7:9

The ruin described

2KI 25:8–25:15 parallels 2CH 36:17–36:19, JER 39:8–39:10, JER 52:12–52:19

The ruin lamented

PSA 89:39–89:41 See also PSA 74:3, PSA 80:12–80:16; ISA 64:8–64:12; LAM 2:5–2:9

The ruin explained

JER 44:2–44:6 See also EZK 33:23–33:29

Restoration of Israel's ruins**Restoration of the ruins prophesied**

ISA 51:3, ISA 61:4 See also ISA 44:24–44:26, ISA 58:12; JER 30:18–30:19, JER 31:27–31:28; EZK 36:8–36:12, EZK 36:33–36:36; AMO 9:11–9:12

Restoration of the ruins fulfilled at the return from exile

EZR 3:1–3:13; ; NEH 1:3–1:4, NEH 2:11–2:20; ; HAG 1:1–1:15

Ruins through God's judgment on Israel's enemies

Assyria

Nineveh was the capital of Assyria: NAM 3:7; ; ZEP 2:13–2:15

Babylon

ISA 13:19–13:22, ISA 23:13; ; JER 51:37

Edom

EZK 35:1–35:4, EZK 35:9; ; MAL 1:2–1:4

Egypt

JER 46:19; ; EZK 29:8–29:12

Moab

JER 48:1, JER 48:18

Philistia

ZEP 2:4–2:6

Tyre

EZK 26:3–26:4, EZK 26:11–26:14, EZK 26:19–26:21

Towns and sites ruined

In warfare

JOS 8:24–8:29; ; 1CH 20:1

In natural disaster

JOL 1:6–1:12, JOL 1:16–1:17

Apocalyptic prophecies of ruin

ISA 24:1–24:13, ISA 27:9–27:10; ; REV 16:17–16:21, REV 18:21–18:23

Repairs to the ruined temple, altar and defences

1KI 18:30 See also 2KI 12:1–12:12 parallel 2CH 24:4–24:13; 2KI 22:3–22:7 parallel 2CH 34:8–34:13

Proverbial references to ruins

PRO 25:28 See also JOB 3:13–3:14, JOB 15:27–15:28; PSA 102:6; PRO 24:30–24:31

5509: rulers

Officials who, acting as God's servants, govern others and exercise authority over them. Also the originators of the laws of their realms. In the NT, rulers are also spiritual powers.

Officials exercising authority over people

MAT 20:25 parallel MRK 10:42 See also 2CH 23:20; PSA 2:2; PRO 28:2; ISA 16:1; DAN 5:7; HOS 13:10; LUK 1:52, LUK 12:11; ACT 7:27; EXO 2:14; 1CO 2:6–2:8

Godly rulers in foreign lands

PSA 105:16–105:22; ; DAN 2:48

Importance of submitting to civil authorities

ROM 13:3; ; TIT 3:1

Examples of rulers

Rulers of areas apart from Israel

GEN 25:16, GEN 34:2, GEN 41:41, GEN 45:8; ; 2CH 32:31; ; EZK 28:2, EZK 31:11; ; DAN 9:1; ; ACT 7:10, ACT 7:18

The five Philistine rulers

JOS 13:3 The Hebrew word translated “rulers” is related to the word “tyrant” and is only used of Philistines rulers. See also JDG 3:3, JDG 15:11, JDG 16:18; 1SA 5:8, 1SA 6:16, 1SA 29:2; 1CH 12:19

The king of Israel is referred to as a ruler

2SA 5:1–5:2 parallel 1CH 11:1–11:2 See also 1KI 1:34–1:35, 1KI 11:34; 1CH 5:2; MIC 5:1

Other rulers of Israel (or parts of it)

1KI 22:26 parallel 2CH 18:25; ; NEH 3:9; ; ISA 1:23; ; JER 30:21; ; MIC 3:1; ; MAT 2:6; ; LUK 18:18

One of three groups that made up the Sanhedrin

ACT 4:5 See also LUK 23:13, LUK 24:20; JHN 7:48; ACT 4:8, ACT 13:27

Jesus Christ is described as a ruler

REV 1:5 See also MAT 2:6; MIC 5:2; REV 3:14

God the Father is also called a ruler

1TI 6:15

A ruler as the originator of the laws of his realm

PRO 8:15

Rulers are appointed by God

ROM 13:1–13:2 See also 2SA 6:21, 2SA 7:7–7:8 parallel 1CH 17:6–17:7; 1KI 11:34; PSA 2:7; ISA 44:28; JER 27:6; DAN 2:38, DAN 4:17; JHN 19:11; ROM 9:17; EXO 9:16

Rulers are God's servants

ROM 13:4 See also ISA 45:1; JER 25:9, JER 43:10

Rulers are God's representatives

PSA 58:1 The Hebrew word translated “rulers” literally means “gods” a title given to those whose position called for them to act as earthly representatives of God's heavenly court. See also PSA 82:1; JHN 10:34–10:35; PSA 82:6; ACT 23:5; EXO 22:28

Rulers as spiritual powers

EPH 3:10 See also EPH 1:21 In the NT, rulers are spiritual powers, some of whom exercise a Satanic authority; EPH 6:12; COL 1:16

Synagogue rulers

MRK 5:22 parallels MAT 9:18, LUK 8:41 The ruler of a synagogue looked after the building and supervised

the worship in it. See also MRK 5:35–5:36 parallel LUK 8:49–8:50; MRK 5:38; LUK 13:14; ACT 13:15, ACT 18:8, ACT 18:17

5510: rumours

Insubstantial information, frequently not factual and leading to groundless fears.

Rumours can give rise to fear

JER 51:46; MAT 24:6 parallel MRK 13:7 See also JOB 28:22; EZK 7:26; 1TI 4:7

Rumours can come from misunderstanding what has been said

JHN 21:23

Rumours are sometimes maliciously spread

PRO 17:4; 3JN 1:10 See also PRO 16:28, PRO 26:24; 1TI 3:11, 1TI 5:13, 1TI 6:11

5511: safety

Being free from danger or harm. God promises to keep his people from all lasting spiritual and physical danger; he requires, however, that his people act responsibly.

God promises safety

To his people

DEU 12:10 See also DEU 33:12, DEU 33:26–33:29; PSA 48:8; JER 32:37–32:38; ZEC 14:11; ROM 8:31

To those who trust in him

PSA 91:9–91:10 See also JOB 11:13–11:19; PSA 37:3; PRO 18:10, PRO 29:25

To those who obey him

LEV 25:18–25:19 See also LEV 26:5; PRO 1:33, PRO 3:21–3:26, PRO 28:26

To those in need

JOB 5:11, JOB 5:15; ; ISA 14:30

But not to the wicked

JOB 5:4; ; PRO 28:18; ; JER 12:12

Safety from enemies

HEB 13:6 See also JOS 10:21; PSA 3:5–3:6, PSA 12:7, PSA 31:20, PSA 78:53; EZK 28:26; REV 3:10

Safety from dangers

ISA 43:2 See also PSA 23:4; EZK 34:25, EZK 34:28

Spiritual safety

1JN 5:18 See also ROM 8:35–8:39; 2TI 4:18; REV 2:11

Safety in God alone

PSA 4:8 See also ZEC 8:10

Safety in Jesus Christ

JHN 17:12 See also JER 23:5–23:6 parallel JER 33:15–33:16; JHN 10:11–10:15, JHN 10:28–10:30

Angels providing safety

MAT 4:6 parallel LUK 4:10–4:11 See also GEN 19:16, GEN 48:15–48:16; EXO 23:20; PSA 91:11–91:12; DAN 3:28, DAN 6:22; ACT 5:19, ACT 12:11; REV 7:2–7:3

Human responsibility for safety

Personal

PRO 11:15; ; JER 4:6, JER 6:1; ; MAT 24:15–24:16 parallels MRK 13:14, LUK 21:20–21:21; ; ACT 2:40, ACT 27:44

Family

GEN 4:9, GEN 43:9, GEN 44:32; ; MAT 2:13

Friends

1SA 20:12–20:13, 1SA 22:22–22:23

Neighbours

EXO 22:5–22:15

Officials

NEH 2:7; ; ACT 23:24

Kings

1KI 4:25; ; 2CH 15:5, 2CH 15:15; ; PRO 20:28

Pastors

HEB 13:17 See also JHN 10:11–10:15; ACT 20:28; PHP 3:1

Concern for safety

David for Absalom

2SA 18:29, 2SA 18:32

Mephibosheth for David

2SA 19:24, 2SA 19:30

Father for son

LUK 15:27

Prayers for safety

PSA 16:1 See also EXO 33:15; EZR 8:21–8:23; JOB 30:15, JOB 30:20; PSA 17:8–17:9, PSA 19:13, PSA 27:4–27:5, PSA 119:29, PSA 140:1–140:4, PSA 141:8–141:10; MAT 6:13

Possible dangers inherent in safety

False security

1TH 5:3 See also DEU 29:19; 1KI 22:27–22:28 parallel 2CH 18:26–18:27; JOB 21:9, JOB 21:16–21:18; EZK 39:6; DAN 8:25; OBA 1:3–1:4; ZEP 2:15

Complacency

PRO 1:32; ; LUK 12:16–12:21

Wickedness

JER 7:9–7:10; ; EZK 39:26

Perfect safety in God's kingdom

ISA 11:6–11:10 See also ISA 2:4, ISA 65:25; HOS 2:18; MIC 4:3–4:4; REV 7:16; ISA 49:10

5512: scales and balances

Weighing devices designed to ensure fair dealing. The terms are also used metaphorically in Scripture.

Scales and balances were used in business transactions

JER 32:10

Scales and balances should not be used dishonestly**Exhortations to honest dealing**

LEV 19:35–19:36 See also EZK 45:10

The LORD hates dishonest dealing

PRO 20:10 See also PRO 11:1, PRO 16:11, PRO 20:23

Dishonest dealing was one of the reasons for God's judgment on his people

JER 5:1 See also HOS 12:6–12:7; AMO 8:4–8:8; MIC 6:10–6:13

Scales and balances used metaphorically**To emphasise Job's distress**

JOB 6:2

To highlight God's greatness

ISA 40:15 See also ISA 40:12

Of God's judgment

DAN 5:25–5:30 See also EZK 5:1–5:2; REV 6:5–6:6

5513: sceptre

A staff, generally ornate, held as a symbol of sovereign authority.

God's own authority is symbolised as a sceptre

PSA 45:6 See also GEN 49:10; NUM 24:17; PSA 60:7 parallel PSA 108:8; ISA 30:31

The sceptre is a symbol of Jesus Christ's reign

HEB 1:8 See also PSA 45:6; GEN 49:10; NUM 24:17; PSA 110:2; REV 2:27; PSA 2:9; REV 19:15, REV 12:5

Earthly rulers had sceptres as symbols of authority**Their description**

EST 4:11; EZK 19:11 See also EST 5:2, EST 8:4; EZK 19:14

OT examples

NUM 21:18 See also PSA 125:3; ISA 14:5; JER 48:17; EZK 19:11, EZK 19:14, EZK 21:10, EZK 21:13; AMO 1:5, AMO 1:8; ZEC 10:11

The extension of a ruler's sceptre to one of his subjects was a sign of favour

EST 5:2 See also EST 4:11, EST 8:4

Jesus Christ's tormentors gave him a mock sceptre

MAT 27:29

5514: scribes

Experts in the understanding and study of the law of Moses. Scribes had political power in NT times, and sat on the Sanhedrin. They were also referred to as lawyers and teachers of the law. They opposed Jesus Christ, who condemned their hypocrisy.

The duties of scribes**Writing records, legal contracts, letters and accounts**

See also 2SA 8:16 parallel 1CH 18:15; 1KI 4:3; 2KI 12:10 parallel 2CH 24:11; JER 32:12, JER 36:26

Advising the king

2KI 18:18 parallel ISA 36:3; ; 2KI 19:2; ; 1CH 27:32

Conscripting people to the army

2KI 25:19 parallel JER 52:25

Examples of scribes who are mentioned by name**Shaphan**

2KI 22:8 parallel 2CH 34:18

Baruch

JER 36:4–36:32

Ezra

After the exile, scribes became copyists and interpreters of the law: EZR 7:6; ; NEH 8:1–8:4, NEH 8:9

Clans or families of scribes

1CH 2:55

The office of priest and scribe

Up to the time of the Babylonian exile only priests were allowed to be scribes: EZR 7:6; ; NEH 8:9, NEH 12:26

Scribes had political power in NT times and sat on the Sanhedrin

By this time, scribes were also referred to as teachers of the law" and lawyers": MAT 16:21 parallels MRK 8:31, LUK 9:22; ; MAT 26:3 parallels MRK 14:1, LUK 22:2

Scribes opposed Jesus Christ

MAT 21:15; LUK 19:47 parallels MAT 21:15, MRK 11:18

Jesus Christ condemned the scribes' hypocrisy

MAT 23:27–23:28 See also MAT 23:1–23:7 parallels MRK 12:38–12:39, LUK 20:45–20:46

5515: scroll

A long strip of leather or papyrus on which people wrote.

Writing on a scroll

EXO 17:14; ; NUM 5:23; ; DEU 17:18; ; EZR 6:2; ; PSA 40:7; ; ISA 30:8; ; JER 36:2, JER 36:4, JER 36:18; ; LUK 4:17; ; HEB 10:7; ; REV 1:11

With a pen

ISA 8:1

In ink

JER 36:18

In columns

JER 36:23

A scroll written on both sides was unusual

These references indicate a saturation of the scroll with words of God's judgment: EZK 2:9–2:10; ; ZEC 5:2–5:3; ; REV 5:1

A scroll was often sealed to protect its contents

ISA 29:11; ; DAN 12:4; ; REV 5:1–5:2, REV 5:9

Scrolls were of various sizes

ISA 8:1; ; REV 10:2

Unrolling and rolling up a scroll

EZK 2:9–2:10; ; LUK 4:17, LUK 4:20; ISA 34:4; ; REV 6:14

A scroll may represent the word of God

REV 10:2; EZK 2:9–3:4; ; REV 10:8–10:10

A scroll may represent the revelation of God's purposes

REV 5:1–5:5

5516: sculpture

Sculpture created by carving

1KI 6:29 parallel 2CH 3:7 See also 1KI 6:32, 1KI 6:35; 2KI 21:7; EZK 41:17–41:18, EZK 41:25

Sculpture created out of metal

1KI 7:23 See also EXO 25:18; 1KI 7:24, 1KI 7:30, 1KI 7:37; 2CH 4:3, 2CH 28:2

Sculpture used in the setting of idolatry

EXO 32:4; ACT 19:24 See also DEU 4:15–4:18; 2KI 17:16; ISA 40:19–40:20, ISA 44:12–44:13, ISA 48:5; DAN 3:1; HAB 2:18; ACT 17:29

5517: seafaring

Ideas and images drawn from seafaring are used in Scripture to illustrate important aspects of the Christian life. Although Israel was not a seafaring nation, ships and sailing played a part in her history, as they did in the spreading of the gospel in the NT.

Israel's harbours

GEN 49:13 See also JDG 5:17

The art of shipbuilding

EZK 27:3–27:9

Ships used for various purposes

Deliverance from danger: Noah's ark

GEN 6:1–9:17

Trade

1KI 9:27–9:28 parallel 2CH 8:18 **EZK 27:25** See also 1KI 10:11, 1KI 10:22 parallel 2CH 9:21; 1KI 22:48–22:49 parallel 2CH 20:35–20:37

Slavery

DEU 28:68; ; REV 18:11–18:13

Invasion

NUM 24:24 See also EZK 30:9; DAN 11:30, DAN 11:40

To carry refugees

ISA 60:9

To carry passengers

JON 1:3; MAT 9:1; ACT 13:4 See also MAT 14:13, MAT 15:39; MRK 3:9; ACT 13:13, ACT 14:26, ACT 15:39, ACT 16:11, ACT 18:18 Paul sails for Syria with Aquila and Priscilla; ACT 18:21, ACT 20:3, ACT 20:6, ACT 20:13–20:16, ACT 21:1–21:3, ACT 21:6–21:7, ACT 27:1–27:8, ACT 28:11–28:13

Seafarers

PSA 107:23–107:30; 2CO 11:25 See also 1KI 22:48 parallel 2CH 20:37; JON 1:3–1:15; MAT 8:23–8:27 parallels MRK 4:35–4:41, LUK 8:22–8:26; MAT 14:22–14:33 parallels MRK 6:45–6:53, JHN 6:16–6:21; ACT 27:9–27:44

Judgment on seafarers

ISA 23:1 See also ISA 2:16, ISA 23:14, ISA 33:21–33:23, ISA 43:14; EZK 27:26–27:36; REV 18:17–18:19

Metaphorical references to ships and seafaring

Spiritual immaturity as a ship tossed at sea

EPH 4:14

Abandoning sound teaching as shipwreck**1TI 1:19****Faith as an anchor****HEB 6:19****Other seafaring analogies****JAS 3:4–3:5** See also PSA 48:7; PRO 31:14; JAS 1:6**Noah's ark as a symbol of Jesus Christ**

1PE 3:20

5518: seal

A personalised design used to produce an imprint in clay or wax which was then attached, usually to documents and letters as a mark of ownership, authenticity and authority. A seal might also refer to what is given as a pledge or guarantee or be used to keep something secure.

The nature and use of a seal**Seals engraved on precious stone****EXO 28:11** parallel EXO 39:6 See also EXO 28:21 parallel EXO 39:14; EXO 28:36 parallel EXO 39:30**Seals used to imprint soft clay**

JOB 38:14

Ways of carrying a personal seal**Figuratively used**

SNG 8:6

Worn round the neck**GEN 38:18** The seal took the form of an engraved cylinder pierced from end to end and worn on a cord round the neck. See also GEN 38:25**Worn as a signet ring****JER 22:24** See also NUM 31:50; ISA 3:21**A seal as a mark of authority****Given to signify delegation of authority**

GEN 41:42; ; EST 3:10, EST 8:2; ; REV 7:2

God's seal validates his servants' ministry

JHN 6:27; ; 1CO 9:2

A seal authenticates documents**EST 8:8–8:10** See also 1KI 21:8; EST 3:12**A seal used to keep something secure****DAN 6:17** See also DEU 32:34; JOB 14:17; PSA 40:9; SNG 4:12; MAT 27:65–27:66; REV 20:3**Documents sealed to prevent alteration****Binding agreements****NEH 9:38–10:1** See also JER 32:10–32:11, JER 32:14, JER 32:44**The words of prophecy****DAN 12:4** See also ISA 8:16–8:17, ISA 29:10–29:11; DAN 8:26, DAN 9:24, DAN 12:9; REV 10:4, REV 22:10**The scroll and its seals****REV 5:1–5:4, REV 5:9** See also REV 5:5, REV 6:1–6:12, REV 8:1**A seal as a pledge or guarantee**

DEU 29:12; ; HAG 2:23; ; ROM 4:11

A seal as a mark of belonging**The mark of the beast**

REV 13:16–13:17, REV 14:9–14:11

God's seal of ownership**2TI 2:19; REV 7:3–7:8** See also EZK 9:4; GAL 6:17; REV 9:4**The Spirit as a pledge of final redemption****2CO 1:21–1:22** The Holy Spirit both seals believers as belonging to God and guarantees their future inheritance. See also EPH 1:13–1:14, EPH 4:30**5519: secretary****A secretary was a royal official often responsible for correspondence**

2SA 8:17, 2SA 20:25; ; 1KI 4:3; ; 2KI 18:18, 2KI 18:37, 2KI 19:2, 2KI 22:12; ; 2CH 34:13, 2CH 34:15–34:18 Shaphan takes the Book of the Law to King Josiah; ; EZR 4:8–4:9, EZR 4:17, EZR 4:23; ; EST 3:12, EST 8:9; ; JER 36:10

A secretary collected the temple repair money

2KI 12:10–12:12; ; 2CH 24:11

A secretary was in charge of conscripting soldiers

2KI 25:19 parallel JER 52:25; ; 2CH 26:11

Secretaries to writers of NT letters

Tertius and Silas acted in the capacity of secretary, writing down what the apostles told them to: ROM 16:22; ; 1PE 5:12

5520: servants

Someone who serves another. Scripture provides guidance concerning the roles of servants, noting in particular that Jesus Christ chose to be a servant and commands believers to serve one another.

5521: servant, Jesus Christ as

See [2327: Jesus Christ, as servant](#)

5522: servants, working conditions of

Those who serve are to be treated fairly and with respect. Jesus Christ himself chose to be a servant and lays responsibility of service on those who follow.

Servants are to be treated fairly

They are not to be exploited

EPH 6:9 See also LEV 25:39–25:40, LEV 25:53

They are to be paid fairly and promptly

DEU 24:14–24:15 See also GEN 29:15; LEV 19:13; NUM 18:29–18:31; 1KI 5:6; JOB 7:1–7:2; JER 22:13; MAT 20:4, MAT 20:8; ROM 4:4; COL 4:1; 2TH 3:10

Examples of servants treated unfairly

JAS 5:4 See also GEN 31:7, GEN 31:41; EXO 2:23–2:24; JOB 24:10–24:11; MAL 3:5

Jesus Christ as a servant

MAT 20:28 See also PHP 2:7

Believers follow Jesus Christ's example as servants

They are servants of Jesus Christ and his church

ROM 1:1 See also LUK 1:38; 1CO 12:5, 1CO 16:15; EPH 4:12; COL 1:23, COL 3:24

They work to please God

EPH 6:5–6:6 See also COL 3:22–3:24; TIT 2:9–2:10

Christian workers should be paid honourably

1TI 5:17–5:18 See also LUK 10:7; 1CO 9:7–9:11; GAL 6:6

God rewards his servants

EPH 6:8 See also JOB 34:10–34:11; PRO 10:16; MAT 6:3–6:4, MAT 25:23; JHN 4:36; 2TI 4:8

Service of sin has its reward

ROM 6:23 See also PRO 11:18; HOS 9:1; 2PE 2:15

5523: servants, good

Scripture identifies certain qualities which are found in good servants and requires that these qualities should be found in believers' service of God.

Qualities found in good servants

Diligence

ECC 9:10 See also 1KI 11:28; PRO 10:4, PRO 22:29; MAT 25:14–25:23 parallel LUK 19:12–19:19

Faithfulness

1CO 4:2 See also EXO 21:5–21:6; 2SA 15:21; 2CH 34:11–34:12; NEH 13:13; PRO 25:13; DAN 6:4

Honesty

2KI 22:7 See also GEN 39:6; 2KI 12:15; TIT 2:9–2:10

Obedience

EPH 6:5 See also LUK 17:10; COL 3:22

Perseverance

GEN 31:40–31:41 See also 2TH 3:12–3:13

Respect

1TI 6:1–6:2 See also MAL 1:6; 1PE 2:18

Willingness

EPH 6:6–6:7 See also 1CH 28:21; TIT 2:9

Examples of good servants

Abraham's servant: GEN 24:9, GEN 24:49; 2SA 12:18, 2SA 23:13–23:17; 2KI 5:13 Naaman's servants; ; MAT 8:9 a centurion's servants

Good servants are often rewarded by their employers

They are advanced by them

GEN 39:4–39:5; ; PRO 27:18; ; MAT 25:21, MAT 25:23

They have their confidence

GEN 24:2–24:4, GEN 24:10

Good servants often bring blessings on their employers

GEN 30:27–30:30, GEN 39:2–39:4

Good servants have God with them

GEN 24:7, GEN 24:27, GEN 31:7, GEN 31:42, GEN 39:3, GEN 39:21; ; MAT 24:46; ; ACT 7:9–7:10

5524: servants, bad

Bad servants are characterised by disobedience, idleness and dishonesty.

Characteristics of bad servants

Idleness

2TH 3:11 See also PRO 18:9; MAT 25:24–25:30 parallel LUK 19:20–19:26

Dishonesty

LUK 16:12 See also GEN 21:25; LEV 6:2; 2KI 5:20–5:25; EPH 6:6; COL 3:22

Disloyalty

LUK 16:13 See also 2SA 19:24–19:27; JHN 10:13; ACT 27:30

Quarrelsomeness

MAT 24:48–24:49 See also GEN 13:7, GEN 26:20; MAT 18:23–18:30

Discontentment

LUK 3:14 See also MAT 20:9–20:15

Refusing correction

PRO 29:19

Examples of bad servants

Ziba: 2SA 16:1–16:4, 2SA 19:26–19:29; 1KI 2:39 Shimei's slaves; ; 1KI 16:9–16:10 Zimri; ; 2KI 5:19–5:27 Gehazi; ; JOB 19:16 Job's servants; ; PHM 1:8–1:16 Onesimus was a bad servant who became good.

5526: shibboleth**Shibboleth“ a Hebrew word meaningflood“ or “ear of corn“**

PSA 69:15 See also PSA 69:2; ISA 27:12 “Shibboleth” is here translated as flowing.

Dialectal variation in the pronunciation of “shibboleth“

JDG 12:6

The pronunciation of “shibboleth“ featured in a civil war between Gilead and Ephraim

The Gileadites had defeated the Ammonites

See also JDG 10:7–10:9, JDG 10:17–10:18, JDG 11:4–11:11, JDG 11:32–11:33

This victory led to civil war between Gilead and Ephraim

JDG 12:1–12:4

Ephraimites were identified on the basis of their pronunciation of “shibboleth“

JDG 12:5–12:6

5527: shield

A piece of armour used to fend off blows or missiles such as arrows. God is described as the shield of his people; protecting, giving help, strength and favour. Faith is the shield with which believers are to ward off spiritual attack.

Shields are pieces of armour

See also 2CH 11:11–11:12, 2CH 32:5; NEH 4:16; NAM 2:5 A number of shields were used to make a wall of defence.

Kinds of shield**Large and small shields**

JER 46:3 See also 1KI 10:16–10:17 parallel 2CH 9:15–9:16; 2CH 14:8

Gold shields

2SA 8:7 parallel 1CH 18:7 See also 1KI 10:16–10:17, 1KI 14:26

Bronze shields

1KI 14:27

Shields made of combustible materials
EZK 39:9**Shields covered with leather**

ISA 21:5 Leather shields were rubbed with oil to preserve them and to deflect blows from swords or arrows.

Shields in warfare**As part of an army's equipment**

2CH 14:8 See also 1CH 12:23–12:24; 2CH 11:12, 2CH 26:14; NEH 4:16

Their use in battle

1CH 5:18 See also 1SA 17:7; 2KI 19:32; JER 46:3, JER 46:9, JER 51:11; EZK 23:24

The figurative use of shields**God is called a shield of his people**

GEN 15:1 See also 2SA 22:3; PSA 7:10, PSA 18:2; PRO 2:7

God acts as a shield

EXO 14:19–14:20 See also ISA 52:12, ISA 58:8

God protects his people

ISA 31:5 See also PSA 3:3, PSA 12:7, PSA 32:10, PSA 125:2, PSA 140:7; ZEC 2:5, ZEC 12:8

God is a refuge for his people

PSA 144:2 See also PSA 18:30, PSA 119:114; PRO 30:5

God is the help and strength of his people

PSA 28:7 See also DEU 33:29; PSA 33:20, PSA 115:9–115:11

God gives victory to his people

2SA 22:36 parallel PSA 18:35

God's favour is compared to a shield

PSA 5:12 See also PSA 3:3, PSA 32:10, PSA 84:9–84:11

God's faithfulness is compared to a shield

PSA 91:4

A shield is used as a picture of defiance towards God

JOB 15:25–15:26

Faith is given to the believer to act as a shield

EPH 6:16 See also 1PE 1:5

5528: shouting

A loud cry of joy, excitement or distress. Scripture often speaks of praise in terms of shouting, reflecting both the joy of the speaker and the greatness of God.

Shouting to be heard

1SA 17:20; LUK 23:21; ACT 22:23–22:24 See also JDG 7:20, JDG 15:14; 2KI 9:27; 2CH 13:15; JOB 39:25; PSA 60:8; ZEP 1:14; MAT 20:30–20:31; JHN 19:12; ACT 16:17, ACT 17:6, ACT 21:36

Shouting in distress

NUM 16:34; LUK 4:41 See also 1KI 18:26–18:28; LUK 8:28; ACT 14:14, ACT 19:28, ACT 21:28, ACT 25:24

Shouting for joy

EZR 3:11–3:13; JHN 12:13; REV 19:6 See also EXO 32:17; LEV 9:24; NUM 23:21; 1SA 4:6; 2SA 6:15; 1KI 1:39; 1CH 15:28; 2CH 15:14; JOB 3:7, JOB 8:21, JOB 33:26, JOB 38:7; PSA 20:5, PSA 33:3, PSA 42:4, PSA 65:13; PRO 11:10; ISA 16:9–16:10, ISA 26:19; MAT 21:15; LUK 17:15; REV 5:12, REV 19:1

Joyful shouting commanded

JOS 6:5; PSA 47:1; ZEP 3:14 See also PSA 66:1, PSA 95:1, PSA 100:1; ISA 40:9, ISA 44:23, ISA 58:1; JER 31:7; ZEC 9:9

5529: sieges

Sustained battle against fortified cities, preventing renewal of supplies; a common tactic in OT times. Samaria and Jerusalem both fell to sieges.

Sieges used by and against Israel

DEU 20:12, DEU 20:19–20:20; ; JDG 9:50; ; 1SA 11:1; ; 2SA 11:1, 2SA 20:15

Ben-Hadad II twice besieged Samaria, unsuccessfully

1KI 20:1 See also 1KI 20:15–20:20; 2KI 6:24, 2KI 7:3–7:7

Shalmaneser V besieged Samaria

2KI 17:5–17:6 See also 2KI 18:9–18:12

Sennacherib besieged Jerusalem, unsuccessfully

2KI 18:17, 2KI 18:35–18:36; ; 2CH 32:1–32:5; ; ISA 29:5–29:8, ISA 37:36–37:37

Nebuchadnezzar besieged Jerusalem

2KI 25:1 See also 2KI 25:2–25:11 parallel JER 39:1–39:10; 2CH 36:17–36:20 parallel JER 52:4–52:15

Jesus Christ warned that Jerusalem would be besieged and destroyed

LUK 19:43 The Roman army destroyed Jerusalem in A.D. 70 using an embankment to besiege the city. See also LUK 21:20–21:24

Sieges caused great suffering and people adopted desperate measures for survival

DEU 28:51–28:57; ; 2KI 6:24–6:29, 2KI 18:27

5530: sifting

The process of separating different substances, especially grain and chaff, normally by passing them through sieves. It is used as a symbol of judgment in which the good are separated from the evil.

Sifting as an act of separation

JDG 7:4

Sifting as a symbol of judgment

ISA 30:28 See also AMO 9:9; LUK 22:31

5531: skill

A trade or craft acquired by training or practice, or a special ability or expertise that may be an endowment of the Holy Spirit. Scripture lists many skills and abilities, particularly used in the building of the tabernacle and temple.

Skill offered in God's service

EXO 35:10; 1CH 22:15–22:16 See also 1CH 28:21

Skill in particular crafts

In working metal

2CH 2:7 JDG 17:4; ; ACT 19:24; 1KI 7:14–7:15, 1KI 7:41–7:45 parallel 2CH 4:12–4:16; 2CH 3:5–3:7; ; ISA 46:6; 2TI 4:14

In working stone

1CH 22:2 See also 1KI 5:15–5:18 parallel 2CH 2:2; 1KI 6:36, 1KI 7:9–7:12

With timber

1KI 5:6 parallel 2CH 2:8–2:9 See also 1KI 6:14–6:36

With fabrics

EXO 38:23 EXO 26:1, EXO 26:36, EXO 28:39; EXO 29:5, EXO 39:1–39:5; EXO 35:25 skill in spinning

With music

1CH 15:22; ; 2CH 34:12–34:13; ; PSA 33:3

Other skills

GEN 25:27 hunting; 1KI 9:27; ; EZK 27:8; JOB 32:22 flattery; ; PSA 45:1 writing; PSA 58:5; ; ISA 3:3; PSA 78:72 leadership; ; JER 2:33 love; ; JER 9:17 Mourning: profes-

sional mourners were a feature of life in Bible times; ; JER 50:9 fighting; ; EZK 28:5 trading

Undesirable skills

In constructing idols

ISA 44:13 See also ISA 40:19–40:20, ISA 41:7; JER 10:9; HOS 13:2; ACT 17:29

Doing evil

JER 4:22 See also ISA 25:11; EZK 21:31; MIC 7:3

Acquiring skill

Through training

1CH 5:18; 2CH 2:13–2:14 GEN 14:14; ; 2CH 26:11; 1CH 25:7 musical skill; ; LUK 6:40 teaching abilities; ; 1CO 9:25 Athletic prowess requires strict training; ; HEB 5:14 distinguishing good from evil through proper training

Skills given by God

EXO 31:1–31:6 parallel EXO 35:30–35:35 These skills may well have been developed through training, but they are recognised as gifts from God. See also EXO 36:1–36:2; DEU 33:11 Moses prays for Levi's skills to be blessed by God; ISA 50:4 Skill in the right use of words comes from God; ROM 12:6–12:8 Special abilities are given by God to believers.

5532: sleep

A state of slumber or rest, reflecting tiredness and the need for refreshment. Although sleep is a natural physical process, Scripture also uses the term in a number of important spiritual senses.

5533: sleep, physical

A gift from God providing necessary rest, usually at night, for the restoration of mind and body. It is sometimes denied, sometimes used by God for his purposes and sometimes abused by people.

Sleep is a gift from God

It is pleasant and refreshing

ECC 5:12 See also 1KI 19:5; JER 31:26; JHN 11:12–11:13

It is God's gift to his faithful people

PSA 127:2 See also PRO 3:21–3:24

It is often denied to the wicked

ISA 48:22

Sleep as a nocturnal activity

It is associated with night-time

1TH 5:7 See also LUK 17:34; JHN 9:4; ROM 13:11–13:12

It is associated with dreams

GEN 28:11–28:12, GEN 41:1, GEN 41:5; ; ISA 29:7–29:8; ; DAN 2:1, DAN 4:5, DAN 7:1

It is associated with sexual activity

GEN 30:15–30:16; 2SA 11:4 GEN 16:2, GEN 16:4; GEN 26:10, GEN 30:3–30:5, GEN 35:22, GEN 38:18, GEN 39:14; ; EXO 22:16; ; DEU 22:22; ; 2SA 3:7; ; HEB 13:4

Blessings in sleep

Peace

PSA 4:8 See also MAT 8:24 parallels MRK 4:38, LUK 8:23; ACT 12:6

Protection

PSA 121:3–121:4 See also PSA 3:5–3:6, PSA 68:13; EZK 34:25

Deep and light sleep

Deep sleep for the creation of Eve

GEN 2:21

Deep sleep for revelation

See also GEN 15:12; JOB 4:12–4:13, JOB 33:14–33:18; DAN 7:2, DAN 7:13; ACT 16:9

Deep sleep as a judgment

ISA 26:12; ; ISA 29:10 The sleep in this instance is symbolic.

Light sleep

SNG 5:2

Sleeping at the wrong time

While on duty

PRO 19:15; ; MAT 28:13; ; MRK 13:36

During harvest

PRO 10:5

Instead of praying

JON 1:5–1:6; ; MAT 26:40 parallels MRK 14:37, LUK 22:45–22:46

During a sermon

ACT 20:9

At the transfiguration

LUK 9:32

Amidst danger

JDG 16:13–16:14, JDG 16:19; ; PRO 6:1–6:5, PRO 23:34; ; MAT 13:25

Excessive sleep

PRO 6:9–6:11 See also PRO 20:13, PRO 23:21; ISA 56:10

5534: sleep, spiritual

Scripture often uses sleep as an image of spiritual laziness or a lack of alertness towards God.

Sleep as an image of spiritual laziness

Lack of watchfulness

ISA 56:10 See also MAT 24:43–24:44 parallel LUK 12:39–12:40; MRK 13:35–13:36

Spiritual dullness

ACT 28:25–28:27 See also ISA 6:9–6:10; PRO 23:34–23:35 ROM 11:8; ISA 29:10

God's call to awake from sleep

The need to arise

ROM 13:11–13:12 See also ISA 51:17, ISA 52:1, ISA 60:1; EPH 5:14; REV 3:2

The command to be alert

REV 16:15 See also MAT 26:41; MRK 13:32–13:34; LUK 12:35; EPH 6:18; 1TH 5:6–5:8; 1PE 5:8

The plea for revival

PSA 80:18, PSA 85:6

The image of God awaking from sleep

From his past judgments

PSA 78:65

Prayers for God to rise up against his enemies

PSA 7:6 See also PSA 35:23, PSA 44:23–44:24, PSA 73:20, PSA 80:1–80:2; ISA 51:9

The contrast between God who never sleeps and false gods

PSA 121:3–121:4 See also 1KI 18:27; HAB 2:19

5535: sleep, and death

Scripture often uses sleep as an image of death, indicating that believers will be awakened to resurrection on the last day.

Death described in the imagery of sleep

The sleep of death for human beings in general

PSA 90:3–90:6 See also JOB 7:21, JOB 14:10–14:12; PSA 13:3; DAN 12:2; MAT 9:24 parallels MRK 5:39, LUK 8:52–8:53

Death as resting with the ancestors

1KI 2:10 See also DEU 31:16; 2SA 7:12; 1KI 11:43 Solomon; 1KI 14:20, 1KI 14:31, 1KI 16:6, 1KI 22:50 Jehoshaphat; 2KI 14:16, 2KI 15:7, 2KI 16:20, 2KI 20:21 Hezekiah; 2KI 21:18 Manasseh

Those who fall asleep in Christ

REV 14:13 See also JHN 11:11–11:14; ACT 7:60; 1CO 15:6, 1CO 15:17–15:19

Death is not the end of existence

JHN 5:28–5:29 See also JOB 14:13–14:15; PSA 17:15; ISA 26:19; DAN 12:3; LUK 16:22–16:23; 1CO 15:20, 1CO 15:51–15:57; 1TH 4:13–4:18

Sleep denoting the finality of judgment for the lost

JER 51:57 See also PSA 7:3–7:5, PSA 76:5; JER 51:39

5537: sleeplessness

The absence of or inability to sleep. Scripture suggests that sleeplessness will sometimes result from divine intervention. Scripture also provides examples of deliberate sleeplessness in order to seek God.

Anxiety and sorrow as causes of sleeplessness

ECC 2:22–2:23 See also PRO 6:1–6:4; ECC 5:12; JER 45:3

Other causes of sleeplessness

Work

PSA 127:2

Pain and sickness

JOB 30:17 See also JOB 7:4–7:5, JOB 33:19; REV 14:11

Evil deeds

PRO 4:14–4:16 See also ISA 5:27

Concern for God's cause

PSA 132:4–132:5 See also ISA 62:6; LUK 2:37, LUK 6:12; ACT 12:12

People who experienced sleeplessness

Jacob

GEN 31:40

Saul

1SA 16:14 Loss of sleep probably among the troubles of Saul alleviated by David's playing. See also 1SA 16:15–16:23

Xerxes

EST 6:1

Job

JOB 7:4 See also JOB 7:11–7:15

Darius

DAN 6:18

Paul

2CO 11:27 See also 2CO 6:5

God deprives sinners of rest

ISA 48:22 parallels HEB 3:11, HEB 4:1–4:5

Restlessness because of judgment on sin

REV 14:11 See also DEU 28:67; 1SA 16:14; ISA 21:4, ISA 23:12, ISA 57:20–57:21; LAM 5:5

Sleeplessness allows people to receive messages from God

DAN 2:1; ZEC 4:1 See also 1SA 3:1–3:10; DAN 2:29; MAT 27:19

A challenge to abandon sleep**Abandoning actual sleep**

LUK 6:12 See also MAT 26:36–26:46 parallels MRK 14:32–14:42, LUK 22:47–22:53; LUK 2:37; REV 16:15

Abandoning spiritual lethargy

PSA 57:8 See also PRO 6:10; ECC 5:2; ISA 51:9

God's watchfulness

PSA 121:3–121:4; ISA 40:28–40:31

The blessing of sleep

PSA 4:8 See also LEV 26:6; PSA 3:5, PSA 127:2; PRO 3:24

5538: sling

Used by shepherds to defend their flocks, it consisted of a strip of leather broad enough to contain a stone. A string was attached to each end of this strip. It was swung around fast and when one string was released the stone could be hurled out with great force and accuracy.

David felled Goliath with a stone from his sling

1SA 17:40, 1SA 17:49–17:50

Slings were also used by soldiers as weapons

JDG 20:16; ; 2KI 3:25; ; 1CH 12:2; ; 2CH 26:14

Slings were known for their destructive power

JOB 41:28; ; ZEC 9:15

Slings used metaphorically

1SA 25:29; ; PRO 26:8; ; JER 10:18

5539: sluggard

Someone characterised by a settled attitude of slothfulness and idleness. Such people are consistently condemned throughout Scripture.

Sluggards are characterised by slothfulness and idleness**They are lazy and refuse to work**

PRO 6:6–6:8 See also PRO 12:27, PRO 15:19, PRO 19:24, PRO 20:4, PRO 21:25, PRO 24:30–24:31, PRO 26:15

They love to stay in bed when they should be up and active

PRO 6:9 See also PRO 26:14

They make excuses to avoid work

PRO 22:13 See also PRO 26:13

Their desires are not met

PRO 13:4 See also PRO 20:4, PRO 21:25–21:26

Their laziness leads to poverty

PRO 6:10–6:11 See also PRO 10:4–10:5, PRO 12:24, PRO 18:9, PRO 19:15, PRO 20:13, PRO 24:33–24:34; ECC 4:5, ECC 10:18

Their attitude is irritating to others

PRO 10:26

They are conceited

PRO 26:16

Sluggards condemned throughout Scripture**In the book of Proverbs**

PRO 10:4 See also PRO 6:6–6:11, PRO 12:11, PRO 12:24, PRO 12:27, PRO 13:4, PRO 14:23, PRO 18:9, PRO 28:19

By Jesus Christ

MAT 20:3, MAT 20:6, MAT 25:24–25:30

In the epistles

1TH 5:14 See also 2TH 3:6, 2TH 3:10–3:11; 1TI 5:13; TIT 1:12, TIT 3:14; HEB 6:12

5540: society

The network of relationships, institutions and shared values that together make up the corporate aspect of human life. Though often regarded as hostile to God and threatening to faith, society can be viewed positively as capable of redemption and an object of God's saving activity.

5541: society, negative aspects of

Often pictured as an immoral city or a world of evil, it is regarded as corrupt and godless, hostile to true faith and therefore destined for judgment.

The city as a symbol of corrupt society

REV 18:2–18:3 Babylon stands for the corrupt Roman state and also for godless society in general. See also GEN 11:1–11:9, GEN 19:1–19:13; EZK 22:1–22:5; MAT 23:37–23:39 parallel LUK 13:34–13:35; REV 14:8

“The world” as a description of society alienated from, and hostile to, both God and his people

GAL 3:22 The Greek word translated “world” often means not the physical world, but the world of human life. See also JHN 15:18; EPH 6:12; 1JN 5:19; REV 12:9

Fallen society becomes pluralistic

Israel was continually threatened by the pluralism of the surrounding societies

JOS 23:6–23:8 See also EXO 23:32–23:33; JOS 24:14–24:23; 1KI 11:1–11:6, 1KI 18:16–18:40 Baal was a name used for a variety of local Canaanite deities; EZR 9:1–9:2; ISA 2:6–2:8; DAN 3:1–3:12

Pluralism was also a feature of the societies of the NT

ACT 17:16–17:23 See also 1CO 8:4–8:6; 2TI 4:3–4:4; 1JN 5:21

Pluralism is to be resisted and faith in one God and Saviour maintained

1TI 2:5 See also ISA 43:10–43:11; JHN 14:6; ACT 4:12

Fallen society becomes secular

Life in a godless society becomes spiritually futile and morally depraved

ROM 1:21 See also ROM 1:18–1:32; 2TI 3:1–3:5; REV 18:1–18:3

Israel ignores warnings about becoming a society which has forgotten God

PSA 81:11–81:12 See also JER 3:19–3:21; HEB 3:7–3:11

Israel became an example of a society which, though outwardly religious, lived without reference to God

AMO 5:21–5:24 Amos here summarises, and rejects, current religious practices in Israel in the 8th century B.C. See also AMO 2:6–2:7, AMO 5:4–5:15 Bethel and Gilgal were popular national shrines, where religion had taken the place of righteousness and relationship; AMO 8:4–8:10

5542: society, positive aspects of

The object of God’s love and the sphere of God’s blessing. God’s people should adopt a positive but critical attitude to, and involvement in society, and should seek to influence it for good, while guarding against its corrupting influence.

Society is the object of God’s redeeming love and the sphere of his blessing

The city as a positive image of society

ISA 1:26–1:27 See also PSA 122:6–122:9; ISA 54:11–54:14; HEB 11:10, HEB 11:15–11:16; REV 21:1–21:4, REV 21:22–22:5

The world as the object of God’s love

JHN 3:16–3:17 See also JHN 6:33; 2CO 5:19; 1JN 4:14; REV 11:15

God’s people are to be positively involved in society

They are to seek to be a positive influence

JHN 17:15–17:18 See also JER 29:7 God’s people, in exile in Babylon, are to seek the welfare of that society, rather than simply long to return home; MAT 5:13–5:16; 1CO 5:9–5:10

They are to avoid being corrupted by society’s worldliness

JAS 1:27 See also ROM 12:2; JAS 4:4; 1JN 2:15–2:17

They do not owe society their ultimate loyalty

JHN 17:16 See also JHN 15:19; HEB 13:14; 1PE 2:11

They are to adopt a positive attitude to society’s properly instituted authorities

ROM 13:1–13:7; TIT 3:1 See also MAT 22:17–22:21 parallels MRK 12:14–12:17, LUK 20:22–20:25; 1PE 2:13–2:17

While being submissive, they are not to give absolute obedience to any merely human authority in society

ACT 4:18–4:20 See also ACT 5:27–5:29

Examples of those positively involved in society

DAN 2:48–2:49 See also GEN 41:41–41:49 Joseph; EST 10:1–10:3 Mordecai; DAN 1:1–1:21 Daniel and his friends

5544: soldiers

Active members of an army, whatever their rank. Paul uses the term frequently in his letters to draw attention to the fact that believers are engaged in spiritual warfare.

Armies of soldiers under different commanders

Moses’ soldiers

NUM 31:27–31:28, NUM 31:32

Joshua’s soldiers

JOS 8:10–8:19

Abimelech’s soldiers

JDG 9:34–9:35

Benjamin’s soldiers

JDG 20:14–20:16

Philistine soldiers

1SA 13:5

Saul’s soldiers

1SA 13:22, 1SA 15:4, 1SA 15:15, 1SA 15:21, 1SA 26:7

Hadadezer's soldiers

2SA 8:4

Aramean soldiers

2SA 10:6

Jehoahaz' soldiers

2KI 13:7

David's soldiers

2SA 3:23 David's soldiers under Joab; ; 2SA 23:8–23:39 parallel 1CH 11:10–11:47 David's mighty men; ; 2SA 24:1–24:9 parallel 1CH 21:1–21:16 David displeased the LORD by counting his fighting men; ; 1CH 12:23–12:38, 1CH 27:1–27:22

Zedekiah's soldiers

2KI 25:5

Babylonian soldiers

JER 41:3

Individual soldiers**2KI 5:1** See also 1SA 14:28; 2CH 17:17; DAN 3:20–3:22**Soldiers came to John the Baptist**

LUK 3:14

Soldiers involved in the last events of Jesus Christ's life on earth**In his arrest and trial**

LUK 23:11, LUK 23:36; ; JHN 18:3, JHN 18:12, JHN 19:2

In his crucifixion

MAT 27:27; ; JHN 19:16, JHN 19:23–19:24, JHN 19:32–19:34

After his crucifixion

MAT 27:65–27:66

After his resurrection

MAT 28:2–28:4, MAT 28:12, MAT 28:15

Soldiers involved in the lives of the apostles**Peter**

ACT 12:4, ACT 12:6, ACT 12:18

Paul

ACT 21:32, ACT 21:35, ACT 21:37

Soldiers used metaphorically

EZE 27:27, EZE 39:20; ; JOL 2:7; ; AMO 2:15–2:16

Paul draws parallels between a soldier and a Christian**1CO 9:7** An apostle has a right to be supported in material things by those to whom he preaches.**Christians are called fellow-soldiers**

See also PHP 2:25; PHM 1:2

Christians must put Jesus Christ first**2TI 2:3–2:4****God as the commander of an army of soldiers****PSA 89:8** The term here translated “LORD God Almighty” can be translated “LORD God of hosts” or “LORD God of armies”. See also 1KI 19:10; JER 5:14; HOS 12:5; AMO 4:13**5545: spear**

A weapon of warfare for stabbing or throwing. God promises a time when they will be changed into instruments of peace.

People killed by spears

NUM 25:6–25:8; ; 2SA 2:23, 2SA 18:14, 2SA 23:21 parallel 1CH 11:23

Jesus Christ pierced by a spear**JHN 19:34** See also ISA 53:5; ZEC 12:10; JHN 20:27; REV 1:7**Armies of Judah armed with spears**

2CH 11:12, 2CH 14:8, 2CH 25:5, 2CH 26:14; ; NEH 4:13

Armies of other nations that used spears**The Philistines**

1SA 17:7

The Babylonians

JER 6:22–6:23

The Egyptians

2SA 23:21 parallel 1CH 11:23; ; JER 46:2–46:4

The Romans

JHN 19:34

God's people are not to trust in spears but in God**1SA 17:47** See also 1SA 17:45–17:46**King Saul and his spear****Used against David****1SA 18:10–18:11** See also 1SA 19:9–19:10**Used against Jonathan****1SA 20:33****David takes Saul's spear**

See also 1SA 26:5–26:24

Joshua's spear used as a sign of victory**JOS 8:18** See also JOS 8:19, JOS 8:25–8:26**Goliath's spear symbolises his strength**

1SA 17:7, 1SA 17:45–17:47; ; 2SA 21:19; ; 1CH 20:5

Spears will be turned into pruning hooks

ISA 2:4 parallel MIC 4:3 Some believe that the peace described in Isa 2:1–4 has been inaugurated with the coming of Jesus Christ. Others maintain that it refers to conditions that will obtain during a future reign of Jesus Christ on earth. The details are generally taken to be figurative rather than literal. See also PSA 46:9

Pruning hooks will be turned into spears

JOL 3:10

5546: speech

The human capacity to express oneself and communicate with others through the spoken word. God addresses humans through the spoken word, and supremely in and through Jesus Christ.

5547: speech, power and significance of

A person's speech has an enormous influence for good or ill and is a sure guide to character.

The impact of speech

It has the power of life and death

PRO 18:21; JAS 3:1–3:12 See also PRO 15:2, PRO 15:4

It can bring ruin or joy to the speaker

PRO 12:13–12:14 See also PSA 140:9; PRO 10:14, PRO 13:3, PRO 14:3, PRO 18:6–18:7, PRO 18:20, PRO 21:23; ECC 10:12–10:14

It can destroy others

PRO 11:9 See also JOB 19:2; PSA 55:20–55:21, PSA 57:4, PSA 64:3–64:4, PSA 140:3; PRO 11:11, PRO 12:6, PRO 12:18, PRO 16:27

It can bring life to others

PRO 10:11 See also PRO 10:20–10:21, PRO 10:31–10:32, PRO 16:21, PRO 16:23–16:24, PRO 25:12; ISA 50:4; EPH 4:29

The timing of speech

There is an appropriate time for speaking

ECC 3:1–3:8 See also PRO 15:23, PRO 15:28, PRO 25:11–25:12

There is an appropriate time for silence

PRO 11:12–11:13 See also ISA 10:27; PRO 10:19, PRO 17:27–17:28, PRO 21:23, PRO 26:4; ECC 5:2–5:3; AMO 5:13; HAB 2:20; ZEP 1:7; JAS 1:19

Spoken witness produces faith

ROM 10:17 See also ISA 50:4; ACT 2:40–2:41, ACT 28:23–28:24; 1PE 3:15

Jesus Christ was silent before his accusers

1PE 2:22–2:23 See also MAT 26:63 parallel MRK 14:61; MAT 27:14 parallel MRK 15:5; LUK 23:9; JHN 19:8–19:9

Speech is an expression of a person's character

MAT 12:34–12:37 See also PSA 5:9, PSA 15:1–15:5; MAT 15:10–15:20 parallel MRK 7:14–7:23; LUK 6:45; JAS 1:26; REV 14:5

5548: speech, divine

Scripture assumes and affirms that God has spoken to many different people throughout the ages in a variety of ways.

Speech as a synonym for revelation

HEB 1:1–1:2 See also DEU 8:3; 1SA 3:1, 1SA 3:7; PSA 147:19; JHN 17:6–17:8, JHN 17:14; 1CO 2:6–2:10

Different modes of divine speech

The voice of nature

ISA 30:30–30:31 See also PSA 29:3–29:9; JOB 37:1–37:5 God's voice is depicted as thunder, the most awesome sound in nature; ISA 33:3

A literal, audible voice

MAT 17:5 parallels MRK 9:7, LUK 9:34 See also 1KI 19:9–19:13; DAN 4:31; JHN 12:28–12:29; ACT 9:3–9:7

Visions

GEN 46:2 See also ISA 6:8–6:13; JER 1:11–1:14; EZK 1:28–2:1; ACT 18:9–18:10, ACT 22:17–22:18

Dreams

GEN 31:24 See also GEN 20:3–20:7; 1KI 3:5–3:14; JOB 33:15–33:18; MAT 1:20–1:21, MAT 2:13, MAT 1:19–1:20

Divine speech through human messengers

Jesus Christ

JHN 14:10 See also JHN 7:16, JHN 8:28, JHN 12:49–12:50, JHN 14:24

Prophets

2PE 1:21 See also ISA 8:7–8:9; 1KI 17:24; 2CH 36:15; ISA 38:4–38:8; EZK 3:10–3:11; ZEC 7:4–7:12

Apostles

1TH 2:13 See also GAL 1:11–1:12; 2PE 3:2; 1JN 1:1–1:3

Divine speech through angels

ACT 8:26 See also DAN 9:20–9:23; LUK 1:11–1:20, LUK 1:26–1:38

Examples of divine communication

Dialogues between individuals and God

GEN 4:9–4:15 See also GEN 18:16–18:33; EXO 3:3–4:17; ACT 9:10–9:16

Messages received by people

GEN 35:1 See also GEN 12:1–12:3; JOS 1:1–1:9; 2SA 7:4–7:16; 1KI 6:11–6:13

Descriptions of divine speech**The sound of God's voice**

EZK 43:1–43:2 See also 1KI 19:12; REV 1:15

The effect of God's word

ISA 55:10–55:11 See also PSA 119:105; JER 23:29; ZEC 1:13; HEB 4:12; REV 19:15

The character of divine speech

PSA 12:6 See also PSA 18:30, PSA 19:7–19:11, PSA 119:89, PSA 119:160; 1PE 1:24–1:25; ISA 40:6–40:8

God's word is recognised and loved by his people

PSA 119:103 See also EZK 3:1–3:3; JHN 10:3–10:5, JHN 10:27; ACT 13:48

God's word is supremely revealed in Jesus Christ

JHN 1:14 See also HEB 1:2

5549: speech, positive aspects of

The way in which believers speak should reflect their calling as Christians. Christian speech should be sincere, godly and honouring to God.

The desire for godly speech**In oneself**

PSA 19:14 See also PSA 17:3, PSA 39:1, PSA 141:3

In others

EPH 4:29–4:31 See also PRO 4:24; ECC 5:6; EPH 5:4; COL 3:8–3:10; 1PE 3:9–3:10; PSA 34:12–34:13

Characteristics of godly speech in relation to God**It gives glory to God**

HEB 13:15 See also PSA 34:1, PSA 35:28, PSA 51:15; 1PE 2:9

It gives thanks and praise to God

COL 3:17 See also DEU 8:10; 1CH 16:4, 1CH 16:7–16:8, 1CH 16:34–16:36; PSA 100:4, PSA 118:1, PSA 118:19, PSA 118:21, PSA 118:28–118:29; JOL 2:26; MRK 8:6–8:7; COL 2:7; 1TH 5:18; JAS 3:9–3:10

It confesses Jesus Christ as Lord

ROM 10:9–10:10 See also MAT 10:32–10:33 parallel LUK 12:8–12:9; MAT 16:16; 1CO 12:3

Characteristics of godly speech in relation to others**It is gentle, gracious and tactful**

COL 4:6 See also JDG 8:1–8:3; PRO 10:32, PRO 15:1, PRO 16:24; ECC 10:12; DAN 2:14–2:16; 1PE 3:15

It is kind

PRO 12:25 See also GEN 50:19–50:21; JOB 4:3–4:4; 1CO 4:13; 2TI 2:24–2:25

It is instructive and edifying

COL 3:16 See also PRO 12:18, PRO 15:2, PRO 15:4, PRO 15:7, PRO 20:15, PRO 25:11–25:12, PRO 31:26; MAL 2:7; EPH 4:15, EPH 4:29

It is prudent and restrained

PRO 17:27 See also PRO 15:28, PRO 18:13; ECC 5:2, ECC 9:17; JAS 1:19

It is honest and unadorned

MAT 5:37 See also PSA 15:2–15:3, PSA 141:5; PRO 24:26, PRO 27:5–27:6, PRO 27:9, PRO 28:23

It is truthful and sincere

ZEC 8:16 See also EXO 20:16 parallel DEU 5:20; PRO 12:17, PRO 12:19, PRO 12:22; MAL 2:6; 2CO 2:17, 2CO 4:2, 2CO 6:7; EPH 4:25

It is wise

PSA 37:30 See also PRO 10:13, PRO 10:31, PRO 13:14; ACT 6:10

It will speak of God and his works

DEU 6:6–6:9 See also PSA 40:9–40:10, PSA 145:7; MAL 3:16

Jesus Christ's speech was perfect and unique

JHN 7:46 See also MAT 7:28–7:29, MAT 13:54 parallel MRK 6:2; LUK 4:22; 1PE 2:22–2:23; ISA 53:9

Speech as a means of blessing people

NUM 6:22–6:27 See also GEN 1:22, GEN 1:28; DEU 21:5; 1CH 23:13

5550: speech, negative aspects of

The sinfulness of fallen human nature can express itself in speech, provoking God's displeasure and causing enmity and division amongst people.

Evil speech comes from a corrupt heart

MAT 12:33–12:35 See also PRO 2:12–2:15, PRO 24:1–24:2; MAT 15:10–15:11 parallel MRK 7:14–7:15; LUK 6:43–6:45

Evil speech is a feature of a corrupt society

MIC 6:12–6:13 See also ISA 6:5, ISA 59:1–59:4, ISA 59:12–59:15; JER 9:1–9:9; ROM 1:29–1:32; 2TI 3:1–3:5

Evil speech provokes God's displeasure**PRO 12:22** See also PRO 6:16–6:19**Kinds of evil speech****Profaning God's name****EXO 20:7** parallel DEU 5:11 See also EXO 22:28; LEV 19:12; PSA 139:19–139:20**Lies and deceit****PSA 5:9** See also PSA 36:3, PSA 52:1–52:4, PSA 62:4; PRO 14:5, PRO 14:25, PRO 15:4, PRO 17:20**Foolish boasting****PSA 94:4** See also PSA 10:2–10:6, PSA 12:3–12:4; ISA 10:12–10:14; 2TH 2:3–2:4; JAS 4:13–4:16; 2PE 2:17–2:18**Ridicule and insults****PRO 11:12** See also 1SA 17:41–17:44; 2KI 2:23–2:24; NEH 2:19; PRO 9:7; LAM 2:15–2:16; MAT 5:22, MAT 27:39–27:44 parallels MRK 15:29–15:32, LUK 23:35–23:39; JHN 9:28–9:29**Criticism and complaint****NUM 12:1–12:15** See also NUM 16:1–16:50; 1SA 17:28; PRO 19:13, PRO 21:9, PRO 21:19, PRO 25:24; ACT 11:2–11:3; PHP 2:14–2:15**Slander****LEV 19:16** See also 1KI 21:1–21:14; PRO 10:18; JAS 4:11**Cursing****EXO 21:17** See also 2SA 16:5–16:8; PRO 20:20; JAS 3:9–3:10**Gossip****PRO 16:28** See also PRO 11:13, PRO 17:9, PRO 20:19**Obscenity****EPH 5:4** See also COL 3:8**Evil speech is silenced****By God's actions****PSA 107:41–107:42** See also PSA 63:11; EZK 16:63**By believers' blameless lives****1PE 2:15** See also TIT 2:7–2:8**5551: spinning and weaving****Spinning as the process of making thread**

PRO 31:19; ; MAT 6:28 parallel LUK 12:27

Weaving as the process of making cloth

EXO 28:39

Weavers and spinners**ISA 19:9** See also EXO 35:25, EXO 35:35, EXO 39:22, EXO 39:27; 2KI 23:7**The figurative use of spinning and weaving****JOB 7:6; ISA 38:12** See also JDG 16:13; 1SA 17:7; ISA 59:5**5552: spies****Spies were used to collect information, usually of a military nature**

Joseph's brothers accused of being spies: GEN 42:9–42:11, GEN 42:14–42:16, GEN 42:30–42:34; NUM 13:1–13:20, NUM 21:32; ; DEU 1:22; ; JOS 2:1–2:3; JOS 6:17, JOS 6:22, JOS 6:25; ; HEB 11:31; ; JAS 2:25; JOS 7:2; ; JDG 1:23–1:24, JDG 18:2, JDG 18:14, JDG 18:17; ; 2SA 10:3 parallel 1CH 19:3

Spies were used to incriminate Jesus Christ and the first Christians

LUK 20:20–20:22 parallels MAT 22:15–22:16, MRK 12:13–12:14; ; GAL 2:4

5553: stairways

Steps which provide access to upper levels, usually of buildings. The term is also used figuratively as a means of ascent from earth to heaven.

Stairways relating to places of worship**In Solomon's temple****1KI 6:8****Used by the Levites****NEH 9:4****In Ezekiel's vision of the new temple****EZK 40:49** See also EZK 40:6, EZK 40:22, EZK 40:26, EZK 40:31, EZK 40:34, EZK 40:37, EZK 40:49, EZK 41:7, EZK 43:17**Steps forbidden for the altar****EXO 20:26****Stairways relating to royalty****1KI 10:19–10:20** parallel 2CH 9:18–9:19 See also 2KI 9:13, 2KI 20:11 parallel ISA 38:8**Stairways in city walls and fortresses****NEH 3:15** See also NEH 3:19, NEH 12:37; ACT 21:35, ACT 21:40**Stairways in houses****For access to upper floors and basements****ACT 9:39** See also 2SA 18:33; 1KI 17:19; ACT 1:13, ACT 9:37, ACT 10:20, ACT 20:8, ACT 20:11**Figurative use of stairways****GEN 28:12** See also JHN 1:51

5554: status

A person's standing in society in the sight of others. The status of individuals in the sight of the world often differs radically from their status in the sight of God, but it is the latter that really matters.

Factors contributing to high social status

High status associated with a position of secular authority

DAN 2:37–2:38 See also 2SA 15:1–15:6; 1CH 29:26–29:28

High status based upon a position of domestic authority

MAL 1:6 See also PSA 123:2; LUK 17:7–17:10; 1CO 11:3

High status owing to recognition of religious authority

ACT 5:34 See also MAT 23:1–23:2, MAT 23:8–23:10; ACT 23:1–23:5

High status owing to pious conduct

MAT 23:5–23:7 parallels MRK 12:38–12:39, LUK 20:45–20:46 See also MAT 6:2, MAT 6:5, MAT 6:16; LUK 7:4–7:5

High status based on wealth

PRO 19:4 See also 1KI 10:4–10:7 parallel 2CH 9:3–9:6; JOB 1:1–1:3; JAS 2:1–2:4

Factors contributing to low social status

Low status on account of occupation

MAT 9:11 parallels MRK 2:16, LUK 5:30 See also LUK 15:1–15:2, LUK 18:11

Low status through sickness

LEV 13:45–13:46 See also MAT 20:29–20:31 parallels MRK 10:46–10:48, LUK 18:35–18:39; LUK 17:12–17:13

Low status through poverty

AMO 5:11–5:12 See also JOB 24:1–24:12; LUK 16:20; JAS 2:1–2:4

Status in God's kingdom

The reversal of human status

MAT 5:3–5:6 parallel LUK 6:20–6:21 See also MAT 19:13–19:15 parallels MRK 10:13–10:16, LUK 18:15–18:17; MAT 19:16–19:30 parallels MRK 10:17–10:31, LUK 18:18–18:30; LUK 1:52–1:53, LUK 16:19–16:26; 1CO 1:26–1:29

Believers must take the lowest status

MAT 18:1–18:5 parallels MRK 9:33–9:37, LUK 9:46–9:48 See also MAT 20:20–20:28 parallel MRK 10:35–10:45; LUK 14:7–14:11; JHN 13:12–13:15; PHP 2:3–2:5

All believers enjoy equal status before God

GAL 3:28 See also 1CO 7:22, 1CO 11:11–11:12; PHM 1:15–1:17; JAS 1:9–1:10

5555: stealing

Theft is always condemned in Scripture, though the possibility of mitigating circumstances is recognised. Converted thieves must show their repentance, if possible, in a practical way.

Stealing is condemned as a sin

It is prohibited

EXO 20:15 parallel DEU 5:19 See also LEV 19:11; PSA 62:10; MRK 10:19 parallel LUK 18:20; ROM 2:21, ROM 13:9

Punishment for stealing

1CO 6:9–6:10 See also EXO 21:16, EXO 22:1–22:4; LEV 6:2–6:5

The disgrace of thieves

JER 2:26

The company of thieves is to be avoided

See also PRO 29:24; ISA 1:23

Stealing is denied

GEN 44:8; ; ISA 12:3–12:5

Mitigating circumstances for stealing

Poverty

PRO 6:30–6:31 See also PRO 30:7–30:9

Stealing is commonplace in this world

It is part of life in a sinful world

HOS 4:2; MAT 6:19 See also MAT 15:19

Roadside robbery

LUK 10:30 See also PRO 1:10–1:15; 2CO 11:26

Sheep stealing

JOB 24:2; ; 2SA 12:4

Dishonesty in trade

JER 22:17; ; EZK 28:18; ; HOS 12:7; ; AMO 8:5

Dishonest tax collectors

LUK 3:13, LUK 19:8

Theft in the temple

MAT 21:12–21:13 parallels MRK 11:15–11:17, LUK 19:45–19:46; ; JER 7:11

Theft in the family

GEN 31:19; ; JDG 17:1–17:2

Wife stealing

2SA 11:3

Kidnapping

2KI 11:2 parallel 2CH 22:11

Temple robbers

ACT 19:37; ; ROM 2:22

Body stealing

MAT 27:64

Examples of stealing

GEN 31:19 Rachel; JOS 7:11, JOS 7:20–7:21; JDG 17:1–17:2 Micah the Ephraimite; MAT 27:38 parallel MRK 15:27; ; MAT 27:44; ; LUK 23:32; JHN 12:6 Judas

Stealing as an image**Of forbidden pleasures**

PRO 9:17

Of a captivated heart

2SA 15:6; ; SNG 4:9

Of unexpected loss

PRO 6:10–6:11, PRO 24:33–24:34

Of God's judgment

1TH 5:2 See also JER 49:9–49:10 parallel OBA 1:5–1:6; MAT 24:42–24:44; 2PE 3:10

Spiritual stealing**Stealing from God****MAL 3:8–3:9****Lying prophets**

See also JER 23:30

False shepherds**JHN 10:1** See also JHN 10:8, JHN 10:10**Converted thieves**

LUK 23:39–23:43 the thief on the cross; ; 1CO 6:9–6:11 some of the Corinthians

Repentance must be borne out in practical actions

EPH 4:28 See also EZK 33:15; LUK 19:8 Zacchaeus; TIT 2:10

There is no stealing in heaven**MAT 6:20****5556: stewardship**

The careful use, control and management of the possessions of another that have been entrusted to one. The term is also used to refer to the responsible use of wealth and possessions by Christians.

Individuals acting as stewards**Adam in the Garden of Eden****GEN 2:15****Joseph in Potiphar's household****GEN 39:4–39:6****Daniel as administrator in Babylon****DAN 6:1–6:3****Groups acting as stewards****The priests serving in the tabernacle**

See also LEV 22:9; 1SA 2:15

The seven chosen by the Jerusalem church

ACT 6:1–6:6

Household stewards

GEN 43:16, GEN 44:1–44:12; ; 2SA 16:1, 2SA 19:17; ; EST 1:8

Jesus Christ's teaching on stewardship**Using parables to emphasise accountability**

LUK 16:1–16:12 See also MAT 25:14–25:30; LUK 19:12–19:27

Emphasising each individual's responsibility**LUK 12:48** See also MAT 12:36**The apostles continued this teaching****ROM 14:12** See also 1PE 4:4–4:5**To be a good steward is an honourable thing****1TI 3:13** See also PRO 27:18**Christians are entrusted with the stewardship of the gospel**

1CO 4:1–4:2 See also 1CO 9:17; 2CO 5:19–5:21; GAL 1:15–1:16, GAL 2:7; 1TH 2:4; 1TI 1:11, 1TI 4:14, 1TI 6:20; 2TI 1:14; TIT 1:3, TIT 1:7

Christians are to be wise stewards of their God-given gifts**1CO 4:7****They are to use their gifts to benefit others****1PE 4:10–4:11****They are to develop their gifts**

See also 1TI 4:14–4:15

They are to care for their bodies**1CO 6:18–6:20****Believers are to be wise stewards of their material possessions****DEU 8:17–8:18****Jesus Christ's teaching on sharing possessions**

MAT 19:21 parallels MRK 10:21, LUK 18:22 See also MAT 6:1–6:4, MAT 6:19–6:21; LUK 6:38, LUK 21:1–21:4; ACT 20:35

Sharing of possessions among the first Christians**ACT 4:32–4:35** See also 2CO 8:1–8:5

The apostle Paul's teaching on sharing possessions
ACT 20:35; ; 2CO 9:6–9:11

5557: stoning

To strike an offender with stones until he or she is dead. Stoning normally took place outside the city walls. The prosecution witnesses, of whom there must be at least two, had to throw the first stones, followed if necessary by the spectators.

Stoning was the punishment for certain offences under the Mosaic law

LEV 20:1–20:2, LEV 20:27, LEV 24:13–24:14; ; DEU 13:6–13:10, DEU 17:2–17:7, DEU 22:23–22:24

Examples of stoning in upholding the Mosaic law

LEV 24:23; ; NUM 15:32–15:36; ; JOS 7:24–7:25; ; 1KI 21:13–21:15; ; JHN 8:1–8:11

Examples of the threatened or actual stoning of God's servants

NUM 14:10 Joshua and Caleb; ; 1SA 30:6 David; ; 2SA 16:6; ; 2CH 24:20–24:21; JHN 8:59, JHN 10:31–10:33; ACT 7:58–7:59 Stephen; ACT 14:19; ; 2CO 11:25; HEB 11:37

5558: storing

A laying up of surpluses for times of scarcity. It includes such facilities as store cities and storehouses and also refers to hoarding treasures. Figuratively the word is used of the accumulation of human sin and God's consequent judgment.

Store cities

EXO 1:11 See also GEN 41:35, GEN 41:48; 1KI 9:19; 2CH 8:4–8:6, 2CH 16:4, 2CH 17:12–17:13

Storehouses

GEN 41:56 See also 1KI 4:7, 1KI 7:51 parallel 2CH 5:1; 2KI 14:14, 2KI 18:15, 2KI 24:13; 1CH 26:15, 1CH 27:25; 2CH 8:15, 2CH 16:2, 2CH 31:10–31:11, 2CH 32:27–32:28; EZR 2:69; EST 3:9; PRO 24:4; MAL 3:10; MRK 12:41–12:44 parallel LUK 21:1–21:4

The contents of storehouses

Materials kept in storage

GEN 6:21 See also GEN 41:34–41:35, GEN 41:49; 1KI 7:51 parallel 2CH 5:1; 2CH 11:11, 2CH 31:5, 2CH 31:11–31:12, 2CH 32:27–32:28; EZR 4:15, EZR 5:17, EZR 6:1–6:2, EZR 6:5; NEH 10:37–10:39; ISA 10:28; JER 41:8

Empty storehouses a disaster

JOL 1:17 See also GEN 41:35–41:36; 1CH 27:25

Roofs and watchtowers provided storage space JOS 2:6

God's storehouse

PSA 135:7 See also DEU 28:12, DEU 32:34; JOB 14:17, JOB 38:22–38:23; PSA 33:7, PSA 104:13; PRO 2:7 victory held in store for the righteous; JER 10:13, JER 51:16; COL 1:5; 2TI 4:8; 1PE 1:3–1:5

Warnings against storing up selfishly or thoughtlessly

MAT 6:19 See also JOB 20:20, JOB 31:24–31:28; LUK 12:15–12:21, LUK 19:20–19:23

Storing up treasure in heaven

MAT 6:20 See also MAT 19:21; LUK 12:33–12:34; 1TI 6:17–6:19

Storing up sin and judgment

HOS 13:12 See also ROM 2:5

God's judgment is stored up

2PE 3:7 See also JOB 38:22–38:23; ISA 26:11; 2PE 2:17; JUD 1:12–1:13

5559: stress

A state of personal anxiety, strain or tension resulting from the pressures of human life. Scripture indicates a number of causes and means of dealing with stress.

The experience of stress

PSA 38:8; MRK 14:33–14:39 parallels MAT 26:37–26:44, LUK 22:39–22:46 **2CO 1:8** See also JOB 6:2; PSA 77:2; JER 4:19; JHN 12:27, JHN 13:21; HEB 5:7

Possible causes of stress

Disobedience to God's will

DEU 28:65 See also 2SA 24:14 parallel 1CH 21:13; PSA 38:4; MAT 14:9 parallel MRK 6:26

Family ties

1CO 7:33 See also GEN 21:11, GEN 43:6; 1SA 1:6–1:16

The burdens of leadership

2CO 11:28 See also NUM 11:14; 2CO 2:4; HEB 13:17

Threats of injury or violence

LAM 1:20 See also GEN 32:7; 1SA 28:5; 1KI 19:1–19:2; EST 7:4; PSA 56:1–56:2; JER 19:9

Unjust leaders

EXO 5:19; ; NEH 9:37

The wickedness of others

1KI 19:14 See also ROM 9:2–9:3; 2PE 2:7–2:8

Academic study

ECC 1:13

The effects of stress**PRO 12:25; MAT 13:22** parallels MRK 4:18, LUK 8:14 See also 1KI 19:3–19:4; PSA 31:9–31:10; LUK 10:40–10:41**Appeals to God in stressful situations****PSA 102:2; JON 2:2** See also 2SA 22:7 parallel PSA 18:6; 2CH 20:9, 2CH 33:12; PSA 4:1, PSA 25:17, PSA 106:44, PSA 120:1**God comforts believers under stress****PSA 94:19; MAT 11:28; 1PE 5:7** See also 1SA 30:6; PSA 107:6, PSA 119:143; JHN 14:1, JHN 14:27, JHN 16:33; 2CO 4:8–4:10; PHP 4:6**5560: suffering**

The experience of pain or distress, both physical and emotional. Scripture is thoroughly realistic about the place of suffering in the world and in the lives of believers. To become a Christian is not to escape from suffering, but to be able to bear suffering with dignity and hope.

5561: suffering, nature of

Since the fall, human beings have suffered in various ways. Scripture provides insights into the nature and place of suffering both in the world and in the lives of believers.

Suffering began with the fall

GEN 2:17, GEN 3:16–3:19; ; ROM 5:12

Suffering is universal

JOB 5:7, JOB 14:1

Different kinds of suffering**Physical pain and illness****GEN 48:1** See also 2KI 20:1 parallels 2CH 32:24, ISA 38:1; JOB 2:7; PSA 42:10; MAT 8:6, MAT 17:15; LUK 4:38; ACT 28:8; 2TI 4:20; JAS 5:14**Emotional stress****PSA 55:4–55:5** See also GEN 35:18 “Ben-Oni” means “son of my trouble”; PRO 12:25; JHN 11:32–11:35; PHP 2:27**Spiritual suffering****PSA 22:1** See also MAT 27:46 parallel MRK 15:34**The prospect of death****GEN 3:19** See also ECC 12:7**Major causes of suffering****The disorder in creation****GEN 3:17** See also GEN 12:10; JOL 1:4; MAT 24:7 parallel LUK 21:11; ROM 8:22; REV 11:13**Human cruelty****PSA 54:3** GEN 4:8; ; EXO 1:16, EXO 1:22; ; 1KI 21:19; ; MAT 2:16; GEN 49:5–49:7; EXO 1:11; ; AMO 2:6–2:7, AMO 4:1; ; MAL 3:5; 2KI 6:25, 2KI 19:17 warfare; ; 2CH 10:13–10:14; ; JOB 1:14–1:15, JOB 1:17; ; AMO 1:3, AMO 1:13; ; JAS 5:4–5:6; ; REV 6:4**Family troubles****PSA 27:10** See also 1SA 1:7; 2SA 16:11; JOB 19:14–19:19; MAL 2:14; MAT 10:36; JAS 1:27**Old age****PSA 71:9** See also ECC 12:1–12:7**Satan’s activity****1JN 5:19** See also JOB 1:12, JOB 2:6–2:7; LUK 13:16; 2CO 12:7; REV 2:10, REV 20:7–20:8**Aggravations to suffering****Memories**

JOB 29:2

Fears

JOB 3:25; ; HEB 2:15

Resentment

JOB 2:9

Sin and suffering**They are not necessarily related****JHN 9:3** See also JOB 2:3; LUK 13:2**They are sometimes closely related****ROM 1:18** See also GEN 6:5–6:7; NUM 14:33; DEU 28:15; PSA 107:17; EZK 23:49; ACT 5:5, ACT 5:10; ROM 1:27; 1CO 11:29–11:30; JUD 1:7; REV 2:22**God’s final judgment****MAT 25:41** See also DAN 12:2; MAT 8:12; MRK 9:48; ISA 66:24; REV 20:15**Effects of suffering****Hardness of heart****REV 16:9** See also EXO 7:22; REV 9:20–9:21**Repentance**

2CH 33:12; ; LUK 15:17–15:18

Blessing**PSA 119:71** See also ISA 38:17

5562: suffering, of the innocent

Scripture does not teach that the wicked will suffer, whereas the innocent and blameless will prosper. It offers insights into the place of suffering in the lives of the innocent, and the apparent injustice of this situation.

The apparent injustice of suffering

HAB 1:13 See also JOB 19:7, JOB 24:1, JOB 24:12; PSA 59:3–59:4, PSA 74:1, PSA 74:11, PSA 88:5, PSA 88:14

The wrong answers to suffering

The concept that those who suffer must be sinners: JOB 4:7; ; JHN 9:2–9:3; EZK 18:25 the idea that God is unjust

The wrong reactions to suffering

JOB 2:9–2:10 resentment against God; ; JOB 23:13–23:15 being terrified of God; ; JOB 40:2 arguing with God; ; PSA 73:3 envying the wicked; ; PSA 73:13 disillusionment

The right reactions to suffering

Reverent submission

JOB 1:21 See also JOB 28:28, JOB 34:12, JOB 36:26, JOB 37:19, JOB 40:4; LAM 3:40, LAM 3:49–3:50; MAT 10:28

Trust in God

GEN 18:25; PSA 55:22–55:23 See also EXO 2:23; PSA 56:3–56:4, PSA 59:16, PSA 62:5, PSA 70:2, PSA 107:6, PSA 107:13, PSA 107:19, PSA 107:28 PSA 119:50, PSA 119:153; DAN 3:17–3:18 the trust shown by Shadrach, Meshach and Abednego; HAB 3:17–3:18; 1PE 2:23 the example of Jesus Christ; 1PE 4:19, 1PE 5:7

God's reaction to suffering

Concern for those who suffer

PSA 9:12 See also EXO 2:25; 2KI 14:26; PSA 1:6, PSA 33:18–33:19; JAS 5:4

Anger at the wicked

PSA 11:5, PSA 59:8; ; EZK 36:6–36:7; ; HAB 2:9, HAB 2:12

God's response to suffering

Deliverance for those who suffer

PSA 34:19 See also JOB 42:10–42:12; REV 7:16, REV 21:4

Judgment for the wicked

MAL 3:5 See also EXO 3:19–3:20; PSA 73:16–73:18, PSA 141:10; AMO 1:3; NAM 3:1, NAM 3:19; HAB 2:16; MAT 25:41–25:46; JAS 2:13; 1PE 4:18; REV 18:6–18:7

5563: suffering, of God

See [1135: God, suffering of](#)

5564: suffering, of Jesus Christ

Jesus Christ suffered on behalf of his people, showing both the reality of his human nature, and the extent of his love for humanity. Those sufferings reached their climax in the sufferings of Jesus Christ upon the cross, through which God chose to redeem the world.

The OT foretold Jesus Christ's suffering

NT references to the OT Scriptures

LUK 24:25–24:26 See also LUK 24:46; ACT 3:18, ACT 17:2–17:3, ACT 26:22–26:23; 1CO 15:3

Types and foreshadowings of Jesus Christ's suffering

GEN 22:2, GEN 22:8, GEN 22:13; ; EXO 12:22–12:23; ; ISA 19:5; ; 2SA 16:11–16:12; ; 1KI 21:15; ; PSA 55:12–55:14, PSA 57:4; ; HEB 13:11–13:12

Prophetic statements of Jesus Christ's suffering

GEN 3:15; ; PSA 2:2, PSA 22:1, PSA 22:7–22:8, PSA 22:12–22:18, PSA 69:21; ; ISA 53:3–53:12

Jesus Christ himself foretold his suffering

MAT 16:21 parallel LUK 9:22 See also MAT 17:12 parallel MRK 9:12; MAT 20:18–20:19 parallels MRK 10:33–10:34, LUK 18:31–18:32; MRK 9:31; LUK 17:25, LUK 20:13–20:15 compare with Naboth (1Kings chapter 21); LUK 22:15; JHN 12:27

Aspects in Jesus Christ's suffering

The enmity of Satan

GEN 3:15 MAT 4:1–4:3 parallel LUK 4:1–4:3; ; MAT 4:5 parallel LUK 4:9; ; MAT 4:8 parallels LUK 4:5, MRK 1:13; MAT 16:23; LUK 22:3; ; JHN 13:27; JHN 14:30; ; REV 12:4

The hatred of the world

JHN 7:7 See also MAT 2:13; JHN 1:10, JHN 3:20, JHN 15:18–15:20; 1CO 2:8

Rejection by his own people

JHN 1:11 See also ISA 53:1; MAT 23:37; LUK 19:41–19:42, LUK 24:20; JHN 18:40; ACT 2:36, ACT 3:13, ACT 4:10; 1TH 2:14–2:15

The failure of his disciples

MRK 14:50 parallel MAT 26:56 See also MAT 16:22, MAT 26:40, MAT 26:74–26:75; LUK 18:34

Betrayal by Judas

MAT 26:23 parallels MRK 14:18, LUK 22:21, JHN 13:21

God's judgment of his Son for the sins of the world

MAT 27:46 parallel MRK 15:34 See also PSA 22:1; ISA 53:5–53:6, ISA 53:10; LUK 22:42; ROM 3:25–3:26; 2CO 5:21; GAL 3:13; HEB 2:10, HEB 2:14; 1PE 2:24

Jesus Christ's willing submission to suffering

MAT 26:42 parallels MRK 14:36, LUK 22:42 See also ISA 53:7, ISA 53:11; LUK 23:46; HEB 5:7–5:8, HEB 12:2; 1PE 2:23

5565: suffering, of believers

Believers ought to expect to suffer as an inevitable part of their calling. To believe is not to evade suffering; it is to face it with new confidence and hope. Rightly approached, suffering develops the character of believers, equips them for more effective service, draws believers closer to Jesus Christ and prepares them for eternal life.

Believers must expect suffering

Jesus Christ foretold it

MAT 10:22 parallel MRK 13:13 See also MAT 10:17, MAT 23:34, MAT 24:9; LUK 21:16–21:17

The apostles foretold it

ACT 14:22; 2TI 3:12 See also PHP 1:29; 1JN 3:13; REV 2:10

The experience of the OT shows it

ROM 8:36; ; HEB 11:25–11:26, HEB 11:32–11:38

The experience of the NT shows it

ACT 4:3, ACT 5:40, ACT 9:29, ACT 12:1–12:3; ; 2CO 11:23–11:29; ; GAL 3:4; ; 1TH 2:2, 1TH 2:14; ; 1PE 4:4; ; HEB 10:32–10:34

Suffering for Jesus Christ is commendable

MAT 5:10–5:12 parallel LUK 6:20–6:23 See also ACT 5:41; 2TI 1:8; 1PE 2:19, 1PE 3:17, 1PE 4:12–4:16

Suffering is profitable

It affirms believers' adoption

HEB 12:7 See also JHN 15:19, JHN 17:14; ROM 8:17; GAL 6:17; 2TH 1:4–1:5

It is the price of godliness

HEB 12:11 See also PSA 119:67, PSA 119:71; ISA 38:17; JHN 15:2; 1PE 1:6–1:7

It is a condition of service

2CO 4:10; COL 1:24 See also PSA 126:5–126:6; ACT 9:16, ACT 20:23–20:24; 1CO 4:9–4:13; 2CO 1:3–1:5; GAL 4:19; PHP 3:18; COL 2:1; 2TI 1:11–1:12, 2TI 2:3, 2TI 2:10

It develops trust

2CO 1:9 See also 1PE 4:19

It develops character

ROM 5:3–5:4 See also HEB 5:8; JAS 1:3

It deepens fellowship

1CO 12:26 See also ROM 12:15; 2CO 1:7, 2CO 8:2; GAL 4:14–4:15, GAL 6:2

It draws believers to the Lord

PHP 3:8, PHP 3:10 See also JOB 42:5; 2CO 4:8–4:10, 2CO 12:9–12:10; 1PE 4:13

It prepares believers for heaven

2CO 4:16–5:4

5566: suffering, encouragements in

Believers are encouraged by the loving care and faithful promises of God and by the example, support and prayers of fellow believers. The prospect of heaven helps them to endure.

The encouragement of God's love

The care of the Father

PSA 103:13 See also PSA 86:17; ISA 50:10, ISA 64:8–64:9; LUK 18:6–18:7; JHN 16:27, JHN 17:11, JHN 17:15; ROM 8:32; 2CO 1:3

The sympathetic understanding of Jesus Christ

HEB 2:18 See also ISA 40:11, ISA 42:3, ISA 53:5; LUK 4:18; ISA 61:1; JHN 14:27, JHN 16:22; ROM 8:35–8:39; HEB 4:15, HEB 7:25, HEB 12:3

The comfort of the Spirit

JHN 14:16–14:17 See also LUK 11:13; ROM 5:5, ROM 8:26; GAL 5:22–5:23; EPH 3:16; 1PE 4:14

The promises of God

PSA 119:50; ROM 8:28; 2CO 12:9 See also ISA 41:10, ISA 43:2–43:3; MAT 6:31–6:33; ROM 15:4; PHP 4:7; 1PE 5:10

The encouragement of the fellowship of believers

Examples from the past

HEB 12:1 See also PSA 102:17–102:18; JER 20:11; PHP 4:11; HEB 11:25–11:26; JAS 5:10–5:11

Support from other believers

1TH 5:11 See also RUT 2:13; JOB 42:11; ACT 28:15; ROM 16:4; 2CO 7:6–7:7; PHP 4:14; COL 4:11; 1TH 2:11–2:12, 1TH 4:18; 2TI 4:9, 2TI 4:11; PHM 1:13; HEB 10:25

The encouragement of looking ahead

The assurance of victory

ROM 8:37 See also ROM 16:20; 1CO 15:20, 1CO 15:25, 1CO 15:55–15:57; 1TH 4:16–4:17

The prospect of glory

ROM 8:18 See also JOB 19:25–19:26; ISA 65:17; 2CO 4:17–5:1; 2TH 1:6–1:7; 2PE 3:13; JUD 1:24–1:25; REV 7:16–7:17, REV 21:1–21:4

5567: suffering, emotional aspects of

Suffering gives rise to inner distress, on account of a sense of injustice, frustration, loss or anger. Christ

himself provides an example of such suffering to believers.

Causes of emotional suffering

A sense of injustice

PSA 119:53 See also JOB 19:7; PSA 82:2

Frustration

JOB 19:8 See also JOB 23:8–23:9; 1TH 2:18

Loss

GEN 27:34 See also RUT 1:20–1:21; PRO 5:11–5:14; LAM 1:12

Bereavement

2SA 18:33 See also GEN 23:1–23:2, GEN 37:34–37:35, GEN 50:1–50:3; EXO 12:30; DEU 34:8; 2SA 19:4; MAT 2:16–2:18; JER 31:15; JHN 11:32–11:35

Childlessness

GEN 30:1 See also 1SA 1:4–1:8

Parting from loved ones

ACT 20:38 See also 1SA 20:41; 2KI 2:12; SNG 5:6–5:8

Spiritual loss

LUK 13:28 See also JDG 2:4; MAT 25:11

Great fear

GEN 45:3 See also GEN 20:8, GEN 32:7–32:8; EXO 20:18–20:19; 1SA 17:24; 1KI 19:3–19:4; ISA 21:2–21:4; DAN 5:8–5:9; LUK 21:26

Guilt

MAT 27:3–27:4 See also GEN 3:8; JHN 16:8; ACT 2:37; HEB 10:2, HEB 10:22

Emotional suffering in the Lord's work

Jesus Christ's suffering

ISA 53:3 See also MAT 26:38 parallel MRK 14:34

The apostles' suffering

2CO 11:28–11:29 See also ROM 9:1–9:4; 1CO 15:31; 2CO 1:8–1:9; GAL 4:19

Expressions of emotional suffering

Sadness

NEH 2:1–2:3; ; PSA 107:39, PSA 116:3; ; MAT 26:22 parallel MRK 14:19

Weeping and groaning

JER 9:1 GEN 42:24, GEN 43:30, GEN 45:1–45:2; 2SA 15:30
Covering the head and going barefoot were also signs of sorrow; ; EZR 3:12–3:13; ; NEH 1:4; ; PSA 6:6–6:7, PSA 32:3–32:4, PSA 137:1; ; ISA 15:5; ; JER 14:17; ; MAT 26:75
Peter wept bitterly after disowning Jesus Christ; ; JHN 11:35

Anger

JON 4:1 See also EXO 32:19–32:20; 2SA 6:8; REV 16:10–16:11

Bitterness

EXO 17:3; ; 1SA 30:6; ; JOB 3:1, JOB 7:11; ; JON 4:3; ; ROM 3:14

God's response to the emotional suffering of believers

He comforts them

2CO 1:3–1:4

He has delivered them through Jesus Christ

ISA 53:4

Jesus Christ gives them rest

JHN 14:1 See also MAT 11:28–11:30; JHN 14:27

There is no suffering in heaven

REV 21:4 See also ISA 35:10; REV 7:17

The proper response of believers to emotional suffering

Assessing the problem before God

PSA 73:16–73:17, PSA 119:78; ; ROM 8:28

Controlled emotion before God

JDG 20:23; ; PSA 22:1–22:2, PSA 62:8, PSA 74:1

Prayer

HEB 5:7 See also GEN 18:22–18:25, GEN 32:9–32:11; NUM 16:22; 2SA 12:15–12:17; PSA 38:9, PSA 77:1–77:9; JON 2:1; MRK 5:22–5:23; JAS 5:13

Continuing to do what is right

JOB 1:20–1:22; ; EPH 4:1; ; PHP 1:27

5568: suffering, causes of

The ultimate cause of suffering is sin, which has brought violence, disease and death into the world. All suffering, however, is under the sovereign purpose of God, who is able to use it for his glory.

The ultimate cause of suffering is sin

GEN 3:14–3:19; JOB 1:1; ; JHN 9:1–9:3; JOB 5:6–5:7; ; ROM 5:12–5:14

Suffering as a result of human wickedness

Murder

GEN 4:8 See also GEN 49:5–49:7; 1SA 18:10–18:11

Injury

MAT 26:67

Cruelty

PSA 71:4 See also JDG 1:7; PSA 54:3; AMO 1:13; MAT 2:16–2:18; LUK 10:30

Rioting

2KI 7:17; ; ACT 16:22

Warfare

JER 50:22 See also GEN 14:1–14:2, GEN 14:11–14:12; EXO 13:17; JOS 6:20–6:21, JOS 10:22–10:26; JDG 1:4–1:7; 1KI 22:35; 2KI 17:5–17:6; ZEC 14:2; LUK 21:20–21:24; REV 6:4

Injustice

EZK 9:9 See also GEN 39:19–39:20; 1KI 21:11–21:14; 2KI 21:16; PSA 58:1–58:2, PSA 64:6

Oppression

ECC 4:1 See also EXO 1:11; 1KI 12:1–12:4, 1KI 12:12–12:14; PSA 12:5; JAS 5:1–5:6

Adultery

2SA 12:9; ; MAL 2:14

Theft

MAT 6:19 See also GEN 31:19; JOB 1:14–1:15, JOB 1:17, JOB 24:2

Broken relationships

JOB 19:14–19:19; ; PSA 27:10; ; PRO 16:28; ; ACT 15:39

Hatred

PSA 109:3 See also 2SA 13:15; TIT 3:3

Jealousy

GEN 37:4 See also GEN 4:4–4:5, GEN 16:6, GEN 21:8–21:10; 1SA 18:8–18:9; MAT 27:18

Persecution

JHN 15:20 See also JER 38:6; DAN 3:4–3:6, DAN 6:7; MAT 5:10–5:12, MAT 10:35–10:36; REV 6:9–6:11

Suffering as a result of misfortune**Accidents**

2SA 4:4; ; 2KI 1:2; ; LUK 13:4

Sickness

GEN 48:1 See also 2KI 20:1; JOB 2:7; PSA 42:10; MAT 8:6; ACT 28:8; PHP 2:27; 2TI 4:20; JAS 5:14

Hunger and want

GEN 12:10; ; JOB 30:3; ; ISA 5:13; ; MAT 25:42–25:43

Natural disasters

1KI 22:48; ; JOB 1:16, JOB 1:18–1:19; ; ISA 29:6; ; JOL 1:4; ; ZEC 14:5; ; MAT 24:7; ; ACT 27:18–27:20

Suffering through old age and death**Ageing**

2SA 19:34–19:35; ; PSA 71:9; ; ECC 12:1

Bereavement

GEN 23:1–23:2; ; JOB 1:18–1:19; ; LUK 7:11–7:13; ; JHN 11:33–11:35; ; JAS 1:27

Suffering through anxiety

PRO 12:25 See also DEU 28:65–28:67; LUK 21:26

Suffering through foolishness

PSA 107:17 See also JDG 11:34–11:36; PRO 10:1, PRO 11:15, PRO 14:1, PRO 23:29–23:30; LUK 15:17

Suffering through Satanic activity**The influence of Satan**

GEN 3:1 See also JOB 1:12, JOB 2:6–2:7; LUK 13:16; 1JN 5:19; REV 2:10, REV 20:7–20:8

Demon-possession

MAT 8:28, MAT 12:22, MAT 15:22

Suffering brought about by God himself**All suffering comes within his will**

JHN 9:3; ; EPH 1:11

Some suffering is for his immediate glory

JHN 21:19

Jesus Christ's suffering produces salvation

ISA 53:10 See also ACT 2:23

Christian suffering produces good fruits

ROM 5:3–5:4; ; 2CO 1:9; ; HEB 12:11; ; JAS 1:2, JAS 1:3

God's people must be disciplined

HEB 12:7 See also EXO 32:35; 2SA 12:13–12:14; PSA 119:67, PSA 119:71; PRO 3:11–3:12; HEB 12:8–12:11

The wicked must be punished

ROM 6:23 See also GEN 6:5–6:7; JHN 5:14; 2TH 1:8; REV 9:4, REV 20:15

Suffering accepted voluntarily**By Jesus Christ**

1PE 2:21 See also ISA 53:3–53:5, ISA 53:10; LUK 9:22

By his people

2CO 12:15 See also 2CO 4:10–4:12; PHP 3:10; HEB 11:35

For the good of others

JHN 15:13 See also ROM 5:7; PHM 1:18

5569: suffering, hardship

Scripture provides examples of types of hardship which people may expect to encounter.

Different kinds of hardship

Poverty

PRO 10:15 See also DEU 15:11; JOB 24:5–24:11; MAT 26:11 parallel MRK 14:7; JHN 12:8

Hunger and thirst

PSA 107:4–107:5 See also GEN 41:53–41:57; EXO 15:22–15:24, EXO 16:2–16:3, EXO 17:1–17:3; NUM 11:4–11:6; 1KI 17:7–17:12; NEH 5:1–5:5; MAT 4:2 parallel LUK 4:2

Hard labour

GEN 3:17–3:19 See also GEN 31:38–31:42; 2CH 10:3–10:4; ECC 2:21–2:22; 1TH 2:9

Oppression

JOB 35:9 See also EXO 1:11, EXO 2:23, EXO 5:8–5:9; 2KI 4:1; PSA 12:5, PSA 31:9–31:13; ECC 4:1; JER 6:6; AMO 3:9; JAS 5:4

Danger

NEH 4:21–4:23 See also EXO 18:8; 1KI 2:26; 1CH 11:15–11:19; ACT 27:27–27:44

Examples of those who suffered hardship

Israel

DEU 28:47–28:48 God's people suffered under his chastisement. See also DEU 8:15 their suffering in the wilderness; DEU 26:6–26:7 their suffering in Egypt

David was oppressed by his enemies

PSA 132:1

Paul suffered in serving the Lord

2CO 6:4–6:5

God's people must endure hardship

The example of Jesus Christ

See also 2CO 8:9

The suffering of believers

ACT 14:21–14:22 See also 1CO 4:11–4:13; 2CO 1:8–1:9, 2CO 11:23–11:29; PHP 4:11–4:14; 2TI 2:3; HEB 10:34, HEB 11:37–11:38, HEB 12:7; REV 2:3

The need for faith, courage and endurance

2CO 1:9; ; HEB 3:6, HEB 10:36; ; JAS 1:12; ; REV 1:9, REV 14:12

God helps his people through hardship

He provides for them

DEU 8:16; ; 1KI 17:2–17:9; ; 2CO 1:10; ; PHP 1:19, PHP 4:19

He comforts them with his love

ROM 8:35–8:39; ; 2CO 1:3–1:4; ; HEB 13:5

He sets heaven before them

REV 7:16–7:17

5571: surgery

The physical removal of part of the human body, either in response to severe illness or as a form of punishment.

Medical surgery

EZK 30:21

Punitive surgery

DEU 25:12; ; JDG 1:6–1:7; ; 1SA 17:51, 1SA 31:9; ; 2SA 4:7, 2SA 4:12; ; 2KI 25:7

Ritual or cultural surgery

Castration

The primary meaning of eunuch“ in the OT is court officer“ and need not always imply castration; similarly with the NT counterpart: 2KI 20:18; ; EST 2:3; ; ISA 56:3; ; MAT 19:12; ; ACT 8:27

Circumcision

GEN 17:10–17:14; ; EXO 4:25; ; LEV 12:3; ; JOS 5:8; ; LUK 2:21

Dismemberment

A solemn call to the nation to act: JDG 19:29; ; 1SA 11:7

Ear piercing

EXO 21:5–21:6 There may be a reference to this in Ps 40:6.

Pagan mutilation

LEV 19:28; ; DEU 14:1; ; 1KI 18:28

Animal sacrifices

GEN 15:10; ; EXO 29:17; ; LEV 1:6, LEV 1:12, LEV 3:9

Miraculous surgery

GEN 2:21–2:22; ; LUK 22:50–22:51

Spiritual surgery

Heart transplant

EZK 36:26

Amputation

MAT 5:29–5:30 Jesus Christ is using hyperbole (deliberate exaggeration) to stress the need at times for radical action. See also MAT 18:8–18:9; MRK 9:43–9:47

Grafting

ROM 11:17–11:24

Pruning

ISA 18:5; ; JHN 15:1–15:2

Felling

ISA 10:33–10:34; ; LUK 3:9

5572: sword

A hand-wielded blade in common use throughout biblical times as a weapon of war and in OT times as an instrument of execution. The sword is also a symbol of aggression, authority and power.

The sword as the principal weapon of war

It was in common use

EXO 17:13 See also NUM 21:24–21:35; JOS 11:10–11:12, JOS 19:47

Swordsmen fought and fell in great numbers

JDG 3:28–3:30 See also JDG 20:17; 2SA 24:9

Some swordsmen showed great strength and ability

2SA 23:10 See also 1SA 21:8–21:9; 2SA 23:12

The sword used for other purposes

As an instrument of execution and decapitation

2SA 1:14–1:16 See also 1SA 15:33, 1SA 17:51, 1SA 22:18–22:19; 1KI 19:1; ACT 12:2; ROM 8:35

For murder

2KI 19:37 See also JOS 6:21; 1KI 2:34; ACT 12:2

For committing suicide

1SA 31:4–31:6 parallel 1CH 10:4 See also ACT 16:27

Metaphorical use of the sword

To symbolise God's opposition to the sinful

GEN 3:24 See also NUM 22:21–22:23, NUM 22:31; DEU 33:29

To symbolise warfare

LEV 26:6–26:8

To symbolise temporal power

EZK 32:11–32:12 See also PSA 45:3; MIC 5:6

To symbolise suffering

LUK 2:34–2:35

To symbolise judgment

EXO 5:3; MAT 10:34 See also JDG 7:20–7:22; 2CH 20:9; PSA 7:12; ISA 31:8; JER 50:35–50:37; EZK 11:8–11:10, EZK 21:3, EZK 33:2

To symbolise the word of God

EPH 6:17 See also HEB 4:12; REV 1:16, REV 2:12

5573: table

An item of furniture used principally for putting food on. Sharing at the same table was a mark of fellowship and to eat at the table of rulers was deemed a great privilege. In the tabernacle and temple a special table held the bread of the Presence. Tables were also used for business transactions.

Tables used for eating

A table as household furniture

2KI 4:10

Reclining at table

LUK 7:36 See also MAT 26:7 parallel MRK 14:3; LUK 11:37; JHN 12:2

Tables set for meals

PSA 23:5; ISA 21:5 See also JOB 36:16; PSA 69:22, PSA 78:19 The people of Israel doubted God's ability to provide; PRO 9:2; EZK 23:41

Giving thanks for food at the table

LUK 24:30 See also MAT 26:26–26:27 parallels MRK 14:22–14:23, LUK 22:17–22:19; 1CO 11:23–11:24

Dogs eat scraps from the table

MAT 15:27 parallel MRK 7:28 See also JDG 1:7; LUK 16:21

Eating at the table of rulers

Rulers were required to entertain

NEH 5:17–5:18 See also 1KI 4:27, 1KI 10:4–10:5 parallel 2CH 9:3–9:4

A bestowal of authority

LUK 22:29–22:30 See also MAT 22:2–22:3; LUK 14:15

A mark of honour and favour

GEN 43:34; ; 2SA 9:11; ; 1KI 2:7, 1KI 18:19; ; 2KI 25:28–25:29 parallel JER 52:32–52:33; ; LUK 14:7 Jesus Christ criticises those who seek the most prestigious places at the table.

Sharing at the same table was a mark of fellowship

A sign of participation

1CO 10:16–10:20

Unacceptable table fellowship

DAN 1:5–1:8; 1CO 10:21 See also 1SA 20:34 Jonathan refuses to eat with Saul; 1KI 18:19; ISA 65:11; JER 7:18

Betrayal of table fellowship

PSA 41:9 See also 1SA 20:29–20:31 Saul wishes to kill David while inviting him to share his table; DAN 11:27; MAT 26:20–26:21 parallels MRK 14:18, LUK 22:21

Serving at table

LUK 22:27 See also LUK 12:37; ACT 6:2 The first Christians recognised the importance of practical service by appointing deacons to “wait on tables”.

Tables used in business

JHN 2:14–2:15 See also MAT 21:12 parallel MRK 11:15

Tables used in worship

The table in the tabernacle

EXO 25:23–25:30 The table was for the bread of the Presence: an offering of twelve loaves, one from each of the twelve tribes. See also EXO 37:10–37:16, EXO 26:35, EXO 30:27 The table was anointed for use; EXO 35:13 parallel EXO 39:36; EXO 40:4NUM 3:31, NUM 4:7 HEB 9:2

The tables in Solomon's temple

2CH 4:8 See also 1KI 7:48 parallel 2CH 4:19; 1CH 28:16; 2CH 13:11, 2CH 29:18

The tables in Ezekiel's temple

EZK 40:39–40:43, EZK 41:22, EZK 44:16

Tables in worship after the exile

1CH 9:31–9:32; ; NEH 10:33; MAL 1:7, MAL 1:12

5574: tablet

A flat, usually rectangular, surface used for writing. Stone tablets, symbolising permanence, were usually engraved with an iron tool. Tablets of moist clay and writing boards of wood or ivory containing a layer of wax were inscribed with a stylus. The term is also used figuratively to refer to the human heart.

Tablets engraved with an iron tool

JOB 19:23–19:24 See also JER 17:1

The Ten Commandments were inscribed on stone tablets

The tablets were inscribed by God

DEU 9:9–9:11 In keeping with ancient Near Eastern practice, the two tablets may have been duplicates of a single covenant document. See also EXO 24:12, EXO 31:18; DEU 4:13, DEU 5:22

The tablets were broken

EXO 32:15–32:19 See also DEU 9:15–9:17

New tablets were inscribed by God

DEU 10:1–10:4 See also EXO 34:4, EXO 34:28–34:29

The new tablets were put into the ark

DEU 10:5 See also 1KI 8:9 parallel 2CH 5:10; HEB 9:4

God's commands were copied onto altar stones

DEU 27:2–27:8 See also JOS 8:30–8:32

Writing tablets

Tablets of unspecified material

HAB 2:2 See also ISA 30:8; LUK 1:63

Other surfaces used for writing

1KI 7:36 The bases of the bronze lavers in Solomon's temple were engraved; ; ISA 8:1 Isaiah's inscription is

with a pen on a scroll; ; EZK 4:1 Ezekiel draws a plan of Jerusalem on a clay tablet. This was a common medium for plans in Babylon.

Tablets of the heart

The commands and teachings of Proverbs

PRO 3:3 See also PRO 6:21, PRO 7:3

The new covenant

JER 31:33 Under the new covenant God's law will be inward, written on human hearts rather than on tablets of stone. See also EZK 36:26–36:27; 2CO 3:3; HEB 8:10, HEB 10:16

5575: talk, idle

Loose or careless speech, often motivated by curiosity, which can lead to unacceptable consequences. Scripture emphasises the importance of avoiding careless talk, and considering one's words with care.

Unfounded boasting is idle talk

2PE 2:17–2:19 See also PSA 10:3, PSA 49:6, PSA 52:1; PRO 25:14, PRO 27:1; ACT 8:9–8:10; JAS 4:16

Human questioning of God is idle talk

ROM 9:20–9:21 See also ISA 29:16, ISA 45:9

Flattery is idle talk

ROM 16:18 See also PRO 7:21

Meaningless conversation is idle talk

JOB 27:11–27:12 Job referring to the words of his comforters. JOB 8:2, JOB 11:2, JOB 35:16; PRO 20:14

Examples of idle talk

1KI 20:10–20:11 See also NUM 12:1–12:2; JDG 9:26–9:41; 1SA 17:41–17:44

Idle talk is folly

A mark of the fool

JOB 15:2–15:3 See also PRO 14:3, PRO 14:23; ECC 10:12–10:14; 1TI 1:6–1:7

Talking too much

ECC 5:7 See also PRO 10:19, PRO 17:28, PRO 21:23; ECC 5:3

Speaking rashly

PRO 20:25 See also ECC 5:6; JAS 1:19

Idle talk is combated by upright living

1PE 2:15

Idle talk has no place in the church

1CO 4:20 See also EPH 4:29, EPH 5:4; TIT 1:10–1:11

All idle talk will be judged**MAT 12:36–12:37****5576: tax collectors**

Governments have a right to collect taxes, but those who collect them have often been unpopular, not least because they seem to have demanded more than they were entitled to. Jesus Christ welcomed such people, as he did other sinners, and many repented as a result of his affirming attitude.

Honest tax collectors deserve respect**ROM 13:6–13:7****Temple taxes collected by Levites**

See also 2CH 24:6, 2CH 24:9

Temple tax paid by Jesus Christ

MAT 17:24–17:26

Tax collectors often unpopular

In NT times

LUK 18:11 Tax collectors were widely suspected of corruption.**Tax collectors despised as collaborators with Rome**

Jesus Christ recognises this popular contempt

See also MAT 5:46, MAT 18:17; LUK 18:11

Many tax collectors come to John**LUK 3:12–3:13** See also MAT 21:31–21:32; LUK 7:29**Many tax collectors flock around Jesus Christ****LUK 15:1** See also MAT 9:10 parallels MRK 2:15, LUK 5:29**Jesus Christ criticised for eating with tax collectors****LUK 15:2** See also MAT 9:11 parallels MRK 2:16, LUK 5:30; MAT 11:19 parallel LUK 7:34; LUK 19:1–19:7**Jesus Christ defends his concern****MAT 9:12–9:14** parallels MRK 2:17, LUK 5:31 See also LUK 15:3–15:4 The parables in Luke chapter 15 are in part a defence of Jesus Christ's concern for tax collectors and sinners.**Tax collectors converted**

In the parable

LUK 18:13–18:14

Matthew Levi

MAT 9:9 parallels MRK 2:13–2:14, LUK 5:27–5:28

Zacchaeus

See also LUK 19:1–19:9

5577: taxation

Any form of payment levied on people by a supervising authority.

Taxation exacted from subject nations**Tribute to Moab**

JDG 3:15, JDG 3:17–3:18

Tribute to David

2SA 8:2 parallel 1CH 18:2; ; 2SA 8:6 parallel 1CH 18:6

Tribute to Solomon

1KI 4:21

Tribute to Assyria

2KI 17:3; ; HOS 10:6

Tribute to Egypt

2KI 23:33 parallel 2CH 36:3

Tribute to Judah

2CH 17:11, 2CH 26:8; ; ISA 16:1

Tribute to Persia

EST 10:1

Universal tribute**PSA 72:10** Universal tribute means universal reign. This psalm is widely regarded as Messianic.**Refusal to pay tribute was a sign of rebellion**

See also 2KI 17:4; EZR 4:13

Taxation for the support of the state**Land tax****2KI 23:35** See also GEN 41:34; NEH 5:4**Census tax**

EXO 30:11–30:16; ; LUK 2:1

Trade tax**1KI 10:14–10:15** parallel 2CH 9:13–9:14**Such levies may be unjustly burdensome****1SA 8:10–8:18** See also DAN 11:20**Covenantal taxation: the tithe****Tithing prescribed****LEV 27:30–27:33** As part of their covenantal obligations the Israelites were commanded to offer a tenth of their income to the LORD. See also GEN 14:20**The tithe supported the priests and the poor****NUM 18:21** See also DEU 14:28–14:29**The tithe often seems to have been neglected****MAL 3:8–3:10** See also 2CH 31:4

Taxation for the support of the temple

MAT 17:24–17:26 See also 2CH 24:4–24:12 parallel 2KI 12:4–12:5

Jesus Christ and taxation

Jesus Christ was falsely accused of opposing taxation

LUK 23:1–23:2

He himself paid tax

MAT 17:24–17:27

He commanded others to pay taxes

MAT 22:15–22:22 parallels MRK 12:13–12:17, LUK 20:20–20:26

Believers and taxation

Paying taxes demonstrates submission to God

ROM 13:1, ROM 13:5–13:6; ; 1PE 2:13

Paying taxes should silence unjust criticism

ROM 13:3; ; 1PE 2:15

Paying taxes is reimbursement for services rendered

MAT 22:15–22:22 “Give” in verse 21 means “give back as in settlement of a debt”; ; ROM 13:7

5578: tents

A portable structure made of cloth or skins used mainly by nomads or semi-nomads. God’s tent or tabernacle is a meeting-place with him.

Tents as portable dwellings used especially by semi-nomadic peoples

They were living quarters for God’s people

GEN 4:20 See also GEN 12:8, GEN 13:12, GEN 18:1, GEN 25:27; NUM 11:10; 1SA 4:10; 2SA 20:1; 1KI 12:16

Sometimes women of distinction had their own tents

GEN 24:67 See also GEN 31:33; JDG 4:17–4:18

A tent housed the ark of God

2SA 6:17 parallel 1CH 16:1 See also 2SA 7:2; 1CH 15:1; 2CH 1:4

Tents associated with other peoples

JDG 6:5 See also GEN 9:27; JDG 7:13; HAB 3:7

Kings and armies camped in tents

JDG 7:13 See also NUM 31:10; 2KI 7:7–7:8

Tents for storage

1SA 17:54 See also JOS 7:21–7:23

Tents were illustrative of a nomadic life

JER 35:7; HEB 11:9–11:10 See also GEN 12:8, GEN 13:5, GEN 13:18, GEN 18:1–18:6, GEN 20:13; EXO 16:16, EXO 33:8, EXO 33:10; NUM 1:50

Tents sometimes associated with sin

JOB 8:22 See also GEN 9:21 Noah’s drunkenness; NUM 16:26 the rebellion of Korah, Dathan and Abiram; JOS 7:21–7:23 Achan’s sin; 1KI 20:16; JOB 4:21, JOB 11:14, JOB 12:6, JOB 15:34, JOB 18:6, JOB 21:28, JOB 22:23; PSA 84:10

The construction of tents

Tentmakers

ACT 18:3

The materials used

EXO 26:7 parallel EXO 36:14 See also EXO 26:14–26:29 parallel EXO 36:19–36:34

Tent pegs and ropes

EXO 27:19 See also EXO 35:18, EXO 38:20, EXO 38:31, EXO 39:40; NUM 3:26, NUM 3:37, NUM 4:32; JDG 4:21; ISA 22:25; ZEC 10:4

Colours of tents

SNG 1:5 See also EXO 26:14

Pitching tents

JER 10:20 See also GEN 26:25, GEN 33:19; JDG 4:11; 2SA 16:22

The metaphorical use of tents

As an image of creation

PSA 104:2 See also PSA 19:4

As a metaphor for death

2CO 5:1; ; 2PE 1:13–1:14

God’s tent is a meeting-place with him

The tabernacle

EXO 25:8–25:9 See also EXO 26:1–26:37, EXO 39:32

The Tent of Meeting

EXO 27:21, EXO 33:7 See also EXO 28:43, EXO 29:10–29:11, EXO 29:30, EXO 29:44, EXO 33:11; LEV 1:1; NUM 1:1; DEU 31:14–31:15

God “tenting” with his people

JHN 1:14 See also EXO 25:8, EXO 29:45–29:46, EXO 40:34–40:38; LEV 26:11–26:12; NUM 5:3; DEU 12:11; EZK 37:27; 2CO 6:16; REV 21:3

5579: tetrarch

A ruler over one quarter of a region; a son of Herod the Great who ruled one quarter of the area originally ruled by his father.

Herod Archelaus, governor of Judea, Idumea and Samaria

MAT 2:22 The tetrarchy system had been started by Philip of Macedon and adopted by the Romans.

Herod Antipas, tetrarch of Galilee and Perea

See also MAT 14:1, MAT 14:9 Sometimes a tetrarch would be given the courtesy title of king; MRK 6:14 parallel LUK 9:7; LUK 3:1, LUK 3:19, LUK 23:7; ACT 13:1

Herod Philip, tetrarch of Iturea and Traconitis

LUK 3:1

Lysanias, tetrarch of Abilene

LUK 3:1

5580: thirst

Water is basic to human life. In Scripture the physical need to drink is often used as a picture of human spiritual need that only God can satisfy.

Physical thirst quenched

EXO 17:1–17:6 See also NUM 20:2–20:11; DEU 8:15; JDG 15:18–15:19; NEH 9:15, NEH 9:20; PSA 78:15–78:16, PSA 105:41, PSA 107:4–107:9, PSA 107:33, PSA 107:35, PSA 114:8; ISA 48:21

The satisfaction of spiritual thirst

It is to be found in God

ISA 41:17–41:18 See also PSA 23:1–23:2; ISA 12:2–12:3, ISA 35:6–35:7, ISA 58:11

It is experienced through Jesus Christ

1CO 10:3–10:4 See also JHN 4:7–4:14, JHN 6:35

It is known by the indwelling of the Holy Spirit

JHN 7:38–7:39

The blessing is mediated through believers to others

See also ISA 32:2; JHN 7:38

There is no satisfaction of spiritual thirst apart from God

JER 2:13 See also ISA 65:13; JER 2:17–2:18; 2PE 2:17 False teachers promise blessing and refreshment to others, but prove to be empty and worthless.

Invitations to seek satisfaction for spiritual thirst in God

ISA 55:1 See also JHN 7:37; REV 22:17

Those seeking satisfaction for spiritual thirst in God

Examples of seekers

PSA 42:1–42:2 See also PSA 38:9, PSA 63:1, PSA 143:6; ISA 26:9

They will be rewarded

MAT 5:6

Heaven is their final reward

REV 7:16–7:17 See also EZK 47:1–47:12; ZEC 14:8–14:9; 2CO 5:2; 2TI 4:8; HEB 11:16; REV 21:6–21:7, REV 22:1–22:3

5581: throne

An elevated seat occupied by a person with authority (e.g., a king). It symbolises the dignity, honour, sovereignty and the kingdom of the king whose seat it is. Supremely, these things belong to God himself.

A throne as an elevated seat

1KI 10:18–10:19 parallel 2CH 9:17–9:18

A throne is occupied by a person with authority (usually a king)

See also PRO 20:8; ISA 14:9; LUK 1:52

Thrones of the kings of Israel

1KI 1:46 See also 1KI 2:19, 1KI 7:7, 1KI 22:10 parallel 2CH 18:9; 2KI 11:19 parallel 2CH 23:20; JER 13:18; ACT 12:21

Thrones of the kings of the nations

EXO 11:5, EXO 12:29; ; EST 1:2, EST 5:1; ; JER 1:15; ; EZK 26:16; ; JON 3:6

A throne symbolises dignity and honour

GEN 41:40 See also 1SA 2:8; 2KI 25:28 parallel JER 52:32; ISA 22:23

A throne also symbolises sovereignty

The royal power of earthly kings

1KI 1:13 “Sit upon a throne” means “to exercise royal power”. See also DEU 17:18 1KI 1:17–1:35, 1KI 2:4, 1KI 2:12, 1KI 2:24, 1KI 3:6, 1KI 5:5, 1KI 8:20 parallel 2CH 6:10; 1KI 8:25 parallel 2CH 6:16; 1KI 9:5, 1KI 10:9 parallel 2CH 9:8; 1CH 28:5, 1CH 29:23 1KI 16:11; 2KI 10:32 1KI 10:30, 2KI 15:12 PSA 122:5, PSA 132:11–132:12; JER 22:2, JER 22:30, JER 29:16, JER 33:17 This verse is fulfilled ultimately in Jesus Christ (Lk 1:32); JER 43:10

Satan’s throne on earth

REV 2:13 Satan is seen as “ruling” from Pergamum, the official centre of emperor worship in the province of Asia.

The beast’s throne

REV 13:2 See also REV 16:10

The twenty-four elders are enthroned

REV 4:4 The elders are thought to be representative of either the whole company of believers in heaven or an exalted angelic order. See also REV 11:16

Jesus Christ reigns from his eternal throne

ISA 9:7 See also ZEC 6:13; MAT 25:31; LUK 1:32–1:33

Almighty God is seated in majesty on his holy throne

EXO 17:16 See also PSA 47:8; HEB 8:1, HEB 12:21; KI 22:19 parallel 2CH 18:18; EZK 1:26, EZK 10:1; DAN 7:9; REV 4:2–4:10, REV 5:1, REV 5:7, REV 5:13, REV 7:10, REV 7:15, REV 19:4, REV 21:5; PSA 9:4–9:10, PSA 11:4; JER 49:38; REV 6:16, REV 20:11–20:12; REV 7:11, REV 8:3, REV 14:3; REV 1:4, REV 4:5, REV 7:9, REV 12:5, REV 16:17, REV 21:3, REV 22:1, REV 22:3

A throne symbolises a kingdom

The kingdoms of earthly kings

2SA 3:10 See also 1KI 1:37, 1KI 1:47; PRO 20:28, PRO 25:5, PRO 29:14; DAN 4:36, DAN 5:20; HAG 2:22; 2SA 7:13–7:16 parallel 1CH 17:12–17:14; 1KI 2:33, 1KI 2:45, 1KI 9:5 parallel 2CH 7:18; 1CH 22:10; PSA 89:4, PSA 89:29, PSA 89:36

The unseen kingdom of God's righteous rule

PSA 89:14 See also PSA 93:2, PSA 97:2, PSA 103:19; LAM 5:19

The ark of the covenant seen as God's throne

ISA 4:4 God was understood to be enthroned between the cherubim (i.e., upon the lid, or “mercy seat”) of the ark of the covenant. See also 2SA 6:2; 2KI 19:15 parallel ISA 37:16; PSA 80:1, PSA 99:1; JER 17:12

Jerusalem is also called God's throne

JER 3:17

Heaven described as God's throne

PSA 2:4 See also PSA 123:1; ISA 40:22; MAT 5:34, MAT 23:22; ACT 7:49; ISA 66:1

God's throne is a throne of grace

HEB 4:16

Believers share in the heavenly reign of Jesus Christ

MAT 19:28 See also LUK 22:30; 2TI 2:12; REV 3:21, REV 20:4, REV 20:6

5582: tiredness

A natural outcome of work and stress for which God has provided relief, rest and renewal. Scripture recognises that tiredness may have spiritual, as well as physical, causes.

Causes of tiredness

Work

MAT 8:24 parallels MRK 4:38, LUK 8:23 See also ECC 10:15, ECC 12:12

Afflictions and stress

JOB 16:7 See also 2SA 17:29; 1KI 19:3–19:5; PSA 69:3; 2CO 12:15

Concern and anxiety

PSA 31:9–31:10 See also PSA 6:6, PSA 32:3–32:4, PSA 119:28; JER 45:3; LUK 22:45

Desire for money and possessions

PRO 23:4

Travelling

See also DEU 25:18; JDG 8:4; 2SA 16:14; JHN 4:6

Old age

ECC 12:3

Zeal for the Lord's work

PSA 119:139

Battles

JDG 4:21; ; 1SA 14:31; ; 2SA 21:15, 2SA 23:10; ; JER 51:30

Sin and rebellion

ISA 57:10; ; JER 9:5; ; EZK 23:43

Foolishness

ECC 1:8; ; ISA 46:1, ISA 47:13; ; JER 12:13

Help from God to deal with tiredness

God's promises of help and rest

ISA 40:28–40:31 See also ISA 46:4; 2CO 9:8

Jesus Christ offers rest and encouragement

MAT 11:28–11:30; REV 2:2–2:3 See also MRK 6:31

Trusting God as the antidote to anxiety and sorrow

MAT 6:25–6:27 parallel LUK 12:25–12:27 See also PSA 119:28

God's provision of times for rest

GEN 1:5, GEN 2:2 parallels EXO 20:8–20:11, DEU 5:12–5:15; ; PSA 127:2; ; JER 31:25

Help from others to deal with tiredness

Encouragements to be strong in the Lord and to persevere

PSA 27:14; 1CO 15:58 See also GAL 6:9; 2TH 3:13; HEB 12:1–12:3

God's help channelled through others

ISA 50:4 See also 2CO 1:3–1:4

Physical help from others

2SA 16:2 See also EXO 17:12; JDG 8:15; 2SA 17:28–17:29; 1KI 19:5–19:6

Advice about lifestyle

EXO 18:17–18:23

5583: tools

Implements used for agricultural or mechanical purposes. Early tools were of wood, flint or stone. The development of ironworking brought iron-bladed tools and farm implements into common use. Axes were used to fell trees; hammers, chisels and saws were used by both carpenters and masons. Assyria and Babylon are depicted as tools in God's hand.

Tools made from iron and bronze

General references

GEN 4:22 See also 2SA 12:31 parallel 1CH 20:3 saws, iron picks and axes; 2SA 23:7 iron tools

Iron axe-heads

2KI 6:4–6:5 Axes comprised an iron head fitted to a wooden shaft. See also DEU 19:5

Sharpening iron tools

ISA 13:19–13:21 A ploughshare is the cutting blade of a plough. A mattock is a large pick with a flat edge used for loosening soil and cutting. See also ECC 10:10

Tools used in specific tasks

Axes used for felling trees

JDG 9:48 See also DEU 20:19–20:20; PSA 74:5–74:6 **MAT 3:10** parallel LUK 3:9 Felling trees with an axe as a symbol of judgment. See also JER 46:22–46:23

Woodworking tools

ISA 44:13 See also EXO 21:6 parallel DEU 15:17 awl; JER 10:3–10:4 chisel, hammer and nails

Metalworking tools

JOB 19:24 See also EXO 28:36 parallel EXO 39:30; JER 17:1 **ISA 41:7** See also EXO 32:4; ISA 44:12; JER 10:9

Stoneworking tools

1KI 6:7, 1KI 7:9 Saws were used in both carpentry and stonemasonry. See also EXO 34:1; DEU 10:3; ISA 22:16; JER 23:29 EXO 20:25; DEU 27:5; JOS 8:31

Agricultural tools

ISA 2:4 parallel MIC 4:3 A pruning hook is a curved blade used in pruning. See also JOL 3:10; ISA 18:5 pruning knives; ISA 30:24 fork and shovel JER 15:7; MAT 3:12 parallel LUK 3:17

The nations as tools in God's hand

ISA 10:15 Assyria is used by God to punish his people. See also ISA 10:5; JER 50:23 Babylon is a hammer in God's hand.

5584: torture

The torture of people

JER 52:10–52:11 See also DEU 28:29–28:35; JDG 8:16, JDG 16:21; JOB 19:2; PSA 137:3; ISA 13:15–13:18, ISA 51:23; LAM 5:11–5:13; EZK 23:10; MAT 18:34; ACT 16:22–16:24; HEB 11:35–11:38; REV 9:5, REV 9:10

The torture of Jesus Christ

LUK 22:63 See also MAT 27:27–27:31 parallel MRK 15:16–15:20; JHN 19:2–19:3 **JHN 19:18** parallels MAT 27:35, MRK 15:24, LUK 23:33 Crucifixion was essentially death by torture.

Torture in the setting of judgment

MAT 8:29 parallels MRK 5:7, LUK 8:28 **REV 20:10** See also MAT 25:46; LUK 16:23; REV 14:11, REV 18:7

5585: towers

Tall structures, normally constructed of brick or stone. They were chiefly used for observation of the surrounding countryside in order to warn of the approach of enemies or robbers.

Examples of watchtowers

ISA 32:14 See also JDG 8:17, JDG 9:51–9:52; 1CH 27:25; 2CH 14:7, 2CH 26:9–26:10, 2CH 26:15, 2CH 32:5; NEH 3:25–3:27

Destruction of towers synonymous with defeat

EZK 26:4 See also ISA 30:25, ISA 32:14; JER 50:15; EZK 26:9

Watchmen stationed in towers

2KI 9:17–9:20 See also ISA 21:6–21:9; LAM 4:17

Towers built as protection against thieves

MAT 21:33 parallel MRK 12:1 See also ISA 5:1–5:2

Towers of Jerusalem

2CH 26:9, 2CH 32:5; ; NEH 3:1, NEH 3:11, NEH 3:25–3:26, NEH 12:38–12:39; ; JER 31:38; ; ZEC 14:10; ; LUK 13:4

Towers as place-names and landmarks

GEN 11:4–11:5 See also GEN 35:21 “Migdal Eder” means “tower of the flock”; JDG 8:17, JDG 9:46, JDG 9:51

Parable of building a tower

LUK 18:28–18:29

Figurative use of towers

Symbolic of the security found in God alone

PRO 18:10 See also PSA 48:3, PSA 61:3

Symbolic of God's judgment

EZK 26:4 See also JER 50:15; ZEP 1:15–1:16

Associated with human beauty

SNG 4:4 See also SNG 7:4, SNG 8:9–8:10

The tower of Babel

The building of the tower of Babel

GEN 11:1–11:4 The attempt to build the city and the tower is the result of human pride.; GEN 11:5–11:9; ; PSA 55:9

The confusion of Babel reversed at Pentecost

ACT 2:5–2:11

5586: town

A large concentration of dwellings, often walled, to be distinguished from the larger cities.

A town was a large concentration of dwellings

ISA 23:7 See also JOS 19:50; MRK 6:10; ACT 16:4

Town officials

DEU 16:18; JDG 8:14–8:16 See also DEU 19:12, DEU 21:3, DEU 21:19, DEU 22:15, DEU 25:7; RUT 4:2; 1SA 16:4; EZR 10:14; LUK 18:2–18:3

Town records

RUT 4:10 See also LUK 2:3–2:4

Laws concerning towns

LEV 25:33; ; NUM 35:4–35:5

Town celebrations and worship

DEU 16:5 See also 1SA 9:10–9:14, 1SA 20:29; 2CH 28:25

The town was a close-knit community

RUT 1:19 See also 1SA 4:13

Towns associated with Jesus Christ

MAT 13:54 Nazareth, his home town; ; LUK 4:31 Capernaum in Galilee; ; LUK 8:1, LUK 8:4; ; JHN 4:5 Sychar in Samaria

Wickedness in towns

DEU 13:13 See also JDG 6:30; 2KI 2:23; 2CH 30:10; MAT 23:34

Judgment on towns

DEU 13:15; ISA 25:2 See also 2KI 3:19; MAT 10:11

5587: trade

Fair business transactions are essential to distribute the benefits of God's goodness between individuals and nations. Scripture insists on honesty in trade and warns against abuses.

Trade in ancient Israel

LEV 25:14 Land transactions required the approval of the ruler of the state; ; 2KI 4:7, 2KI 7:1; ; NEH 3:31–3:32; PRO 31:13–31:18, PRO 31:24; ZEP 1:11; ; MAT 21:12 parallels MRK 11:15–11:16, LUK 19:45, JHN 2:14–2:16 trade in Jerusalem in Jesus Christ's day

International trade

Under Solomon

1KI 9:26–9:28 parallel 2CH 8:17–8:18 See also 1KI 10:14–10:15 parallel 2CH 9:13–9:14 Transit taxes were imposed on inter-state trade. Also some taxes were owed to the state by merchants for some kinds of trade; 1KI 10:28–10:29 parallel 2CH 1:16–1:17; 2CH 9:21; SNG 3:6–3:7

Under Jehoshaphat

1KI 22:48 parallel 2CH 20:35–20:37 Soon afterwards the port of Ezion Geber passed back into the hands of Edom (see 2Ki 8:20).

In the Psalms

PSA 107:23

Trade among the nations

Hittites

GEN 23:16

Shechemites

GEN 34:10, GEN 34:21

Ishmaelites

GEN 37:25

Midianites

See also GEN 37:28

Egypt

GEN 42:34; ; ISA 45:14

Sheba

JOB 6:19; ; JER 6:20

Damascus

1KI 20:34

Tyre and the surrounding nations

ISA 23:8 See also EZK 27:1–27:36

Tarshish

EZK 38:13; ; JON 1:3–1:5

Nineveh

NAM 3:16

Ancient Babylon

EZE 16:29, EZE 17:4

Babylon the Great**REV 18:9–18:24** See also REV 18:2–18:3**Honesty is essential in trade****LEV 19:35–19:36** See also DEU 25:13–25:16; PRO 11:1, PRO 16:11, PRO 20:10, PRO 20:23**Warnings against abuses in trade****Dishonesty****AMO 8:4–8:5** See also EZE 28:18; HOS 12:7; MIC 6:10–6:11**Oppression**

JOB 20:18–20:19; ; EZE 28:16

Overconfidence

JAS 4:13–4:16

Pride**EZE 28:5** See also ISA 2:12, ISA 2:16, ISA 23:17–23:18**Sabbath trading**

NEH 10:31, NEH 13:15–13:22

The slave trade

GEN 37:26–37:28, GEN 37:36, GEN 39:1; ; AMO 2:6, AMO 8:6; ; 1TI 1:10; ; REV 18:13

Sacrilegious trade

JHN 2:14–2:16

Immoral trade

JOL 3:3

The imagery of trade applied to spiritual matters**MAT 13:45–13:46** See also PRO 23:23; MAT 25:14–25:18; LUK 19:13; 1CO 6:20**5588: traditions**

Beliefs or customs handed down from previous generations. Believers are to hold to the traditions of the Christian faith. Human traditions can be contrary to God's word and thereby come into conflict with the Christian faith.

Examples of human traditions

RUT 4:7; ; 2CH 35:25; ; EZE 24:17, EZE 24:22; ; MRK 7:3–7:4; ; LUK 2:42; ; JHN 19:40

Believers are to hold to and hand on the traditions of the Christian faith**1CO 11:2; 1TH 5:21; 2TI 2:2** See also DEU 4:9–4:10, DEU 6:6–6:7, DEU 11:19; 1CO 11:23; EPH 2:20; 2TH 2:15, 2TH 3:6**Human traditions can be contrary to God's word****MAT 15:3–15:6** parallel MRK 7:9–7:13 **COL 2:8** See also MIC 6:16; COL 2:20–2:22; TIT 1:13–1:14**The Christian faith is in conflict with traditions of purely human origins****MRK 2:18–2:22** parallels MAT 9:14–9:17, LUK 5:33–5:39 **1PE 1:18–1:19** See also MAT 15:2 parallel MRK 7:5; GAL 2:11–2:16, GAL 4:9–4:11**5589: trap**

A device used as a snare in hunting or warfare to capture animals or people; a tactic, plot or scheme designed to deceive someone into trouble or sin.

Traps used in hunting and warfare

JOB 40:24; ; ISA 42:22; ; EZE 19:4; ; AMO 3:5

Kinds of traps**Words**

JDG 12:5–12:6; ; PRO 6:2, PRO 12:13; ; ISA 29:21; ; JER 9:8; ; MRK 12:13, MRK 12:15

Actions

GEN 27:6–27:12, GEN 37:23–37:24; ; 1SA 28:9; ; 2SA 21:5; ; 2KI 21:24; ; LAM 1:19; ; HAB 2:9–2:11; ; LUK 22:48

Temptation**1TI 6:9** See also EXO 23:33, EXO 34:12; DEU 7:16, DEU 7:25; JOS 23:12–23:13; JDG 2:3, JDG 8:27, JDG 16:15–16:16; PRO 11:6, PRO 20:25, PRO 22:24–22:25; ECC 7:26; EZE 13:18; HOS 5:1**Evil times**

ECC 9:12

Fear of other people

PRO 29:25

Wisdom is alert to traps

1CH 12:16–12:17; ; PRO 13:14

Those who trap others have evil hearts**ISA 32:7** See also PSA 36:3–36:4, PSA 64:6; PRO 6:14, PRO 12:20, PRO 16:27–16:30**Traps prepared by sinners****Against innocent people****PSA 38:12** See also GEN 4:8; 2CH 24:21; NEH 6:1–6:4; EST 2:22, EST 9:25; JOB 30:11–30:12; PSA 10:2, PSA 31:13, PSA 35:4, PSA 119:110, PSA 140:5, PSA 142:3; JER 5:26, JER 9:8, JER 18:22; LAM 3:60–3:61, LAM 4:20; DAN 6:4–6:7; ACT 23:19–23:21

Against God

PSA 2:1–2:2 See also ACT 4:25; PSA 21:11, PSA 83:5; HOS 7:15; NAM 1:11

Against Jesus Christ

MAT 22:15 See also MAT 22:18 parallel MRK 12:15; MAT 26:21, MAT 26:25; MRK 3:6; LUK 20:26; JHN 8:6, JHN 18:3–18:4

Against the truth

HOS 9:8 See also ACT 14:5, ACT 20:3; EPH 4:14

The wicked caught in their own traps

PRO 28:10 See also EST 7:10; JOB 18:7–18:10; PSA 9:16; PRO 1:18, PRO 5:22, PRO 12:13, PRO 18:7, PRO 29:6; JER 8:9; DAN 6:24

The devil sets traps

1TI 3:7 See also ACT 13:10; 2CO 2:11; EPH 6:11; 2TI 2:26

God sets traps for the wicked

JER 50:24 See also ISA 8:14, ISA 28:13; JER 8:9, JER 48:43–48:44; EZK 12:13, EZK 17:20; OBA 1:7; LUK 21:34; ROM 11:9; PSA 69:22

God frees his people from traps

PSA 91:3 See also 2SA 22:5–22:7; NEH 4:7–4:9; JOB 5:13; PSA 31:4, PSA 124:6–124:8, PSA 141:9; PRO 3:26

God forbids the trapping of the innocent

ZEC 8:17

The gospel does not trap people by deception

1TH 2:3 See also 2CO 4:2; 2PE 1:16

5590: travel**Whole communities travelled**

The exodus

EXO 17:1

The exile

2CH 36:20

The return from exile

EZR 2:1–2:2

Nomadic travelling

GEN 12:6

Military forces travelled

See also EXO 14:4; 2SA 10:16; 2KI 25:1

Officials travelled

GEN 41:46 See also 2KI 5:1–5:5 Naaman; NEH 2:5 Nehemiah; ACT 8:27 the Ethiopian eunuch

Refugees travelled

2KI 25:26; ; MAT 2:13–2:14

Business travel

JAS 4:13 See also LUK 10:33

Travelling on pilgrimage

LUK 2:41–2:44

Missionary travels

The Jews

MAT 23:15

Jesus Christ and his disciples

MRK 1:39, MRK 8:27; ; LUK 8:1, LUK 14:25

The apostles

ACT 8:40, ACT 11:19, ACT 13:6, ACT 15:3, ACT 18:23

Modes of travel

GEN 37:25 in caravans; ; LUK 24:13–24:15 on foot; ; ACT 8:28–8:29 by chariot; ; ACT 23:23 on horseback; ; REV 18:17 by ship

The dangers of travel

2CO 11:26 See also 2CH 15:5; EZR 8:21–8:23; JOB 6:15–6:20; LUK 10:30; ACT 27:14–27:44

Guidance while travelling

GEN 24:26–24:27; ; EXO 13:21; ; ACT 16:6–16:7

5591: treasure

Highly valued objects or accumulated riches. Treasure has at best only short-term benefit but can bring spiritual dangers. Spiritual treasure is of eternal value and comes from knowing and serving God.

The limitations of accumulated treasure**It is easily lost**

ISA 64:11 See also 2KI 24:13; JER 15:13, JER 17:3, JER 20:5; LAM 1:10–1:11; HOS 13:15; OBA 1:6; MAT 6:19; JAS 5:2–5:3; REV 18:14

It is no security against God's displeasure

PRO 11:4 See also JOB 20:20; JER 51:13; EZK 7:19; HOS 9:6; ZEP 1:18; LUK 12:16–12:21

It does not satisfy

ECC 5:10 See also PSA 39:6; HAG 1:6

The spiritual dangers of accumulated treasure**It can lead to pride**

1TI 6:17 See also DEU 8:13–8:14; EZK 7:20, EZK 28:4–28:5; DAN 4:30

It can lead a person away from God

REV 3:17 See also JOB 31:24–31:25, JOB 31:28; PRO 11:28

It can lead to greed

LUK 12:15 See also 1TI 6:9–6:10

Acquiring it can lead to dishonesty

JOS 7:21; ; PSA 62:10; ; PRO 21:6

It can lead to idolatry

EXO 32:2–32:4; ; ISA 2:7–2:8; ; EZK 7:20, EZK 16:17

Spiritual treasure

Treasure consists in knowing God and his wisdom

COL 2:2–2:3 See also JOB 28:12–28:19; PRO 2:4, PRO 3:13–3:15, PRO 8:10–8:11, PRO 24:3–24:4; ISA 33:6

God's word is supreme treasure

JOB 23:12; ; PSA 19:9–19:10, PSA 119:72, PSA 119:127

The kingdom of God is supreme treasure

MAT 13:44 See also MAT 13:45–13:46, MAT 13:52

Spiritual treasure is more important than material possessions

HEB 11:26 See also JOB 22:23–22:25; MAT 13:44–13:46

It is of eternal value

LUK 12:33 See also MAT 6:20; 1PE 1:4

It is gained through generosity and wisdom

MAT 19:21 parallels MRK 10:21, LUK 18:22 See also PRO 8:21, PRO 15:6; 1TI 6:18–6:19

Treasure reveals true commitment

MAT 6:21 parallel LUK 12:34 See also MAT 6:24 parallel LUK 16:13

Believers willingly give God their treasures

MAT 2:11 See also EXO 35:22; JOS 6:24; 1CH 29:3–29:5

God's people are his treasured possession

DEU 7:6 See also EXO 19:5; DEU 14:2, DEU 26:18; PSA 135:4; MAL 3:17

The gospel as treasure in clay jars

2CO 4:7

5592: treaty

A formal agreement between individuals or nations, promising commitment to each other's interests. Israel was forbidden to enter into such agreements with other nations in the promised land.

Treaties between individuals

1SA 18:3–18:4 See also GEN 21:22–21:32, GEN 26:26–26:31; 1SA 20:8, 1SA 20:16–20:17, 1SA 22:8, 1SA 23:18; 2SA 3:12–3:13

Treaties between individuals acting on behalf of their nation

1KI 5:12–5:18, 1KI 15:18–15:19; ; ISA 33:8 Probably the agreement made when Hezekiah paid large sums to Sennacherib (2Ki 18:14); ; EZK 17:12–17:14

Treaties between cities or nations

JOS 9:3–9:16, JOS 10:1, JOS 11:18–11:19; ; 1SA 11:1–11:2; ; HOS 12:1

Treaties entered into should be honoured

EZK 17:15–17:18 See also JER 34:8–34:20; DAN 11:22–11:24 “he will act deceitfully” (verse 23), is a reference to Antiochus Epiphanes (of the Seleucid dynasty) who reneged on the friendship shown to Egypt; HOS 10:4; AMO 1:9–1:10; GAL 3:15

Israel forbidden to enter into treaties with other nations in the promised land

DEU 7:1–7:2 See also EXO 23:31–23:32, EXO 34:11–34:12, EXO 34:15–34:16; DEU 23:6; 1KI 20:34, 1KI 20:42–20:43; EZR 9:12

5593: trial

A process of testing or investigation, which may be legal, as in a court case, or spiritual, as in a testing of faith or power. Scripture makes reference to both.

Legal trials

The need for legal trials

DEU 16:18–16:20; ; JHN 7:50–7:51; ; ACT 16:37–16:39

Trials concerning accidental killings

JOS 20:9 See also NUM 35:9–35:12; JOS 20:1–20:6

Unjust trials

MRK 13:9–13:13 parallels MAT 24:9–24:11, LUK 21:12 See also 1KI 21:1–21:14; PSA 37:32–37:33; ACT 12:1–12:4, ACT 16:37

The trial of Jesus Christ

MAT 26:57–26:68 parallels MRK 14:53–14:65, JHN 18:19–18:24 See also MAT 27:11–27:26 parallels MRK 15:2–15:15, LUK 23:2–23:25, JHN 18:28–19:16

The trial of Paul

ACT 27:23–27:24 See also ACT 22:30–23:11, ACT 24:1–24:23, ACT 25:1–25:12, ACT 25:23–26:32

Trials of faith

Through testing or temptation

JAS 1:2–1:3 See also GEN 22:1; LUK 22:28; 2CO 8:1–8:2; 1TH 3:2–3:4; 2TH 1:4; JAS 1:12; 1PE 1:6, 1PE 4:12–4:16; 2PE 2:4–2:9; REV 3:10

Through burdensome responsibilities**GAL 4:14****Trials of strength or power****DEU 7:19** See also EXO 7:8–7:24; DEU 29:2–29:3; 1KI 18:16–18:40**5594: tribute**

Gifts and honours paid as a mark of respect and submission to kings and others in authority; also, praise given to those to whom it is due.

Tribute required by God**The spoils of war****NUM 31:28** See also NUM 31:29, NUM 31:36–31:41**The glory due to his name****PSA 96:7–96:9; HEB 13:15****Tribute paid to kings****Eglon, king of Moab**

See also JDG 3:15, JDG 3:17–3:18

David, from the Moabites**2SA 8:2** parallel 1CH 18:2**David, from the Arameans**

See also 2SA 8:6 parallel 1CH 18:6

Solomon, from all the lands**1KI 4:21** See also EZR 4:20**Ben-Hadad's demands from Ahab**

1KI 20:2–20:9

Ahab, from the king of Moab

2KI 3:4

Isaiah's advice to Moab

ISA 16:1–16:2

Jehoshaphat, from the Philistines and Arabs

2CH 17:11

Uzziah, from the Ammonites

2CH 26:8

Jotham, from the Ammonites

2CH 27:5

The Assyrian kings, from Israel

2KI 15:19–15:20, 2KI 17:3–17:4; ; HOS 10:5–10:6

Pharaoh Neco, from Jehoiakim

2KI 23:35

Babylonian plunder

2KI 24:13; ; 2CH 36:18

Artaxerxes, from the Jews

EZR 4:13, EZR 7:24

Xerxes, from the whole empire

EST 10:1

Roman taxes

MAT 22:17 parallels MRK 12:14, LUK 20:22

Tribute paid to those in authority**David**

2SA 9:6

Daniel

DAN 2:46

Haman

EST 3:2

Herod

ACT 12:21–12:23

Tribute in the form of praise**David, of Saul and Jonathan**

2SA 1:23–1:27

Paul, of faithful friends

ROM 16:3–16:13; ; 2CO 8:22–8:24; ; PHP 2:19–2:30; ; COL 4:7–4:14; ; 2TI 1:16–1:18

John, of Demetrius

3JN 1:12

Christian principles on paying tribute**OT teaching**

PRO 24:21–24:22

Jesus Christ's teaching**MAT 22:21** parallels MRK 12:17, LUK 20:25**Apostolic teaching****ROM 13:7** See also 1PE 2:17**Tribute due to Jesus Christ****Prophesied in the OT****PSA 72:10–72:11** See also PSA 89:22; ISA 52:15**Due because of his exaltation****PHP 2:9–2:11** See also ISA 45:23**Fulfilled in the New Jerusalem****REV 21:24, REV 21:26****5595: trumpet**

A musical instrument with a loud, piercing sound, used as a signal, both in times of war and of peace. It was also used extensively in Israelite worship and was frequently associated with divine activity.

Trumpets used to summon the Israelites**NUM 10:1–10:7** See also ISA 27:13**Trumpets sounded to announce religious festivals****LEV 25:8–25:12** See also LEV 23:24; NUM 10:10, NUM 29:1; PSA 81:3–81:4 The NIV usually translates the Hebrew word “shophar” as “trumpet”, but in this instance it is translated “ram’s horn”; JOL 2:15**Trumpets sounded to attract public attention****2SA 20:1** See also 1SA 13:3; MAT 6:2**Trumpets blown to announce the accession of a king****1KI 1:39** See also 2SA 15:10; 1KI 1:34, 1KI 1:41–1:43; 2KI 9:13, 2KI 11:14 parallel 2CH 23:13**Trumpets used to warn of impending danger****JOL 2:1** See also JER 4:5, JER 6:1, JER 6:17; EZK 33:1–33:6; HOS 8:1; AMO 3:6**Use of the trumpet in war****As a call to arms****JDG 6:33–6:35** See also JDG 3:27–3:28; NEH 4:16–4:20; ISA 18:3; JER 51:27; EZK 7:14; 1CO 14:8**As a battle cry****2CH 13:12** See also JOS 6:2–6:20; JDG 7:8, JDG 7:16–7:22; 2CH 13:14–13:15; JOB 39:24–39:25; JER 4:19–4:21, JER 42:14; HOS 5:8; AMO 2:2; ZEP 1:15–1:16**To signal retreat****2SA 2:28** See also 2SA 20:22**Use of the trumpet in worship****Played by priests****2CH 29:26** See also EZR 3:10; NEH 12:31–12:36, NEH 12:40–12:42**Played in the tabernacle****1CH 16:6** See also 1CH 15:24, 1CH 16:42**Played in the temple****2CH 5:12–5:13** See also 2KI 12:13; 2CH 7:6, 2CH 29:27–29:28**Played to praise God****PSA 150:3** See also 1CH 13:8; 2CH 15:14–15:15, 2CH 20:28, 2CH 29:26; NEH 12:40–12:41; PSA 98:4–98:6**Accompanying the ark of the covenant****1CH 15:28** parallel 2SA 6:14–6:15 See also JOS 6:4, JOS 6:8, JOS 6:13**The trumpet associated with divine activity****In visible manifestations of God****EXO 19:16–19:19** See also EXO 20:18; ZEC 9:14; HEB 12:18–12:21**At the second coming of Jesus Christ****1TH 4:16** See also MAT 24:31; 1CO 15:51–15:52**In metaphorical use****REV 4:1** See also ISA 58:1; REV 1:10**The trumpet associated with angelic activity****REV 8:2** See also REV 8:6–8:8, REV 8:10, REV 8:12–8:13, REV 9:1, REV 9:13–9:14, REV 10:7, REV 11:15**Trumpets sometimes made from silver****NUM 10:2****Trumpets sometimes made from animal horn****JOS 6:4** See also EXO 19:13; PSA 81:3**The trumpet in non-Israelite use****REV 18:22** See also JER 51:27**5596: victory**

The conquest of, or gaining a decisive advantage over, an enemy. The gospel proclaims the victory of God in Christ over the forces of evil in the world.

5597: victory, as an act of God

God is the source of all victory, which he grants to those who obey his commands and put their confidence in him. This principle holds true in all believers’ conflicts, whether physical or spiritual.

God is the source of all victory**DEU 20:1–20:4** See also 2CH 20:15; PSA 18:35; 1CO 15:57; 2CO 2:14**Victory is achieved by God, not people****PSA 20:7–20:8** See also 1SA 17:45–17:47; PSA 44:3–44:7, PSA 60:11–60:12, PSA 146:3; PRO 21:31**Victory should be ascribed to God****PSA 118:15** See also EXO 15:1; PSA 21:1; 1CO 15:57; REV 19:1–19:2**Victory depends on faithfulness****God grants victory to those who are faithful to him****1CH 22:13** See also EXO 23:20–23:23; PSA 112:8; PRO 2:7**Unfaithfulness to God brings defeat****NUM 14:41–14:43** See also DEU 28:15, DEU 28:25; 2CH 24:20

Examples of God giving victory

EXO 17:8-17:15 to Israel over the Amalekites; JOS 6:2-6:5, JOS 6:20; JDG 7:15-7:22 to Gideon over the Midianites; ; JDG 15:12-15:19 to Samson over 1,000 Philistines; ; ISA 7:7-7:12 to the Israelites at Mizpah; ; ISA 17:38-17:50 to David over Goliath; ; 1KI 18:36-18:39 to Elijah at Mount Carmel; ; 1CH 11:4-11:9 when David conquered Jerusalem

God is able to work through defeat

GEN 50:20 See also JDG 16:24, JDG 16:30; ROM 8:28; 2CO 4:7-4:12, 2CO 12:7-12:10

God is able to fulfil his purposes through the victory of unbelievers

ISA 44:28-45:4 See also ISA 41:25, ISA 45:13; EZK 33:27-33:29 This is how Ezekiel is to explain Babylon's victory over Jerusalem; ACT 2:36, ACT 3:17-3:18

5598: victory, over spiritual forces

In spiritual warfare victory is assured since Jesus Christ has already won it on the cross and in the resurrection. Christians will eventually share in Christ's complete victory and through him overcome their spiritual enemies.

The victories won by Jesus Christ

Over sin and temptation

HEB 4:15 See also MAT 4:1-4:11; HEB 2:18; 1PE 2:22

Over the world

JHN 16:33 See also REV 3:21, REV 17:14

Over the devil

1JN 3:8 See also MAT 12:29 parallels MRK 3:27, LUK 11:22; LUK 10:18; JHN 12:31; COL 2:15; HEB 2:14

Over death

ACT 2:24 See also ROM 5:17, ROM 6:9-6:10; 1CO 15:54-15:57; 2TI 1:10

Over every enemy

1CO 15:24-15:25 See also ISA 42:13; PHP 2:9-2:11; HEB 10:13

Believers have victory through Christ

Over the power of sin

ROM 7:24-7:25 See also ROM 6:11-6:14; COL 3:9-3:10

Over temptation

1CO 10:13 See also MAT 6:13 parallel LUK 11:4; HEB 2:18, HEB 4:15-4:16

Over the world

1JN 5:4-5:5 See also JHN 15:19; TIT 2:11-2:13; 2PE 1:3-1:4

Over the devil

REV 12:10-12:11 See also ROM 16:20; EPH 6:12-6:13; 1JN 2:13-2:14, 1JN 4:4

Over death

1CO 15:22-15:23 See also JHN 11:25-11:26; 1CO 15:54-15:57; 1TH 4:13-4:17

Believers share in Christ's victory

ROM 8:37; 1CO 15:57; 1JN 5:4-5:5 See also JHN 11:25; ROM 6:5; 1CO 15:20; 2CO 2:14; PHP 4:13; HEB 11:33-11:34 Victory is received by faith.

The final victory

The vision of final victory in Jesus Christ

REV 2:26, REV 3:5

It will be complete at the end of the age

1CO 15:24 See also REV 21:1-21:3, REV 21:7

Although certain it has not yet been fully realised

HEB 2:8 See also ACT 3:21; ROM 8:24-8:25; EPH 1:10; PHP 3:20-3:21; 2TH 2:8

5599: victory, of Jesus Christ

See [2372: Jesus Christ, victory of](#)

5601: village

Villages were small rural settlements without walls

LEV 25:31 See also DEU 3:5; 1CH 5:16; 2CH 32:27-32:29; EST 9:19; SNG 7:11; MAT 14:15

Villages associated with neighbouring towns and cities

JER 19:15 See also JOS 10:37, JOS 13:23; 1SA 6:18; NEH 12:28

Villages were particularly vulnerable to invasion

EZK 38:11 See also JDG 5:7; 2CH 14:14

Village records and teachers

1CH 4:32, 1CH 9:22; ; LUK 5:17

Villages as the scene of gospel preaching

MRK 6:6 See also ACT 8:25

5602: vomit

The literal act of vomiting

JON 2:10

Proverbial references to vomiting

PRO 26:11 See also PRO 23:6-23:8, PRO 25:16-25:17; 2PE 2:17-2:22

Metaphorical references to vomiting

An illustration of exile and destruction

LEV 18:24–18:28 See also LEV 20:22–20:24

An illustration of punishment

ISA 19:13–19:14 See also JER 25:15–25:29, JER 48:26

An illustration of corruption

ISA 28:7–28:8

An illustration of the fate of the wicked

JOB 20:12–20:15

5603: wages

Payment by an employer for work done; all labourers should be paid fairly and regularly.

Laws relating to wages

Payment should be made regularly

DEU 24:14–24:15 See also LEV 19:13

Regular rates of pay

LEV 25:50; ; MRK 6:37 parallel JHN 6:7; ; MRK 14:5 parallel JHN 12:5

Labourers should not be defrauded

MAL 3:5; JAS 5:4 See also JER 22:13

A fair wage should be paid

MAT 20:2–20:4 A normal day's pay for a labourer in NT times was one denarius. See also COL 4:1

A fair day's work should be done

2TH 3:10–3:12 See also EPH 6:7–6:8; COL 3:23

Labourers should be content with a fair wage

LUK 3:14

Wage earners suffer in times of trouble

Egypt under judgment

ISA 19:10

Jerusalem under judgment

HAG 1:6 See also ZEC 8:10

The world under judgment

REV 6:6

The example of Jacob as a wage earner

HOS 12:12 See also GEN 29:15 He agreed his wages beforehand; GEN 29:18 He was paid in kind; GEN 29:25–29:27 He was cheated by Laban; GEN 30:28–30:34 He makes an arrangement he can turn to advantage; GEN 31:6–31:7 He accuses Laban of dishonesty; GEN 31:8–31:9 He protests his own honesty; GEN 31:38–31:42 He looks back on his experience.

The wages of God's servants

The Levites

NUM 18:30–18:31; ; NEH 12:44, NEH 13:10–13:13

Temple workers

1KI 5:6; ; 2KI 12:11–12:15, 2KI 22:3–22:7 parallel 2CH 34:8–34:11; ; 2KI 22:9 parallel 2CH 34:16–34:17

Zechariah's derisory pay

ZEC 11:12–11:13; ; MAT 27:3–27:10

Labourers in the parable of the workers in the vineyard

MAT 20:1–20:16

Ministers of the gospel

1TI 5:17–5:18 See also DEU 25:4; LUK 10:7; JHN 4:36–4:38; 1CO 9:7–9:14; GAL 6:6

The apostle Paul

It was Paul's choice to work freely: 1CO 9:15; ; 2CO 11:7–11:9; PHP 4:18 He expressed gratitude for gifts he received.

Spiritual lessons from wages

Life's rewards are hard-earned

JOB 7:1–7:3; ; GAL 6:7–6:10

The wages of sin

ROM 6:21–6:23 See also JOB 15:31–15:32; ISA 65:7; JER 51:6; 2PE 2:13

The freeness of God's grace

ROM 4:4–4:5

The generosity of God

MAT 20:9–20:16

The rewards of righteousness

PRO 10:16, PRO 11:18, PRO 31:31; ; MAT 10:42 parallel MRK 9:41; ; 1CO 3:14; ; HEB 6:10; ; 2JN 1:8

5604: walls

Kinds of wall

Walls of houses and palaces

LAM 2:7 See also 1SA 18:10–18:11, 1SA 20:25; ISA 38:2; DAN 5:5

Walls of towns

2CH 14:7 See also NUM 35:4; 1SA 31:10; 2SA 18:24

Walls of cities

DEU 3:5; NEH 2:17 See also JOS 2:15, JOS 6:5, JOS 6:20; 1KI 3:1; 2KI 3:27; 2CH 27:3; PSA 55:10; ISA 58:12; ACT 9:25

Walls of the temple

1KI 6:27, 1KI 7:12

Walls of vineyards**MAT 21:33** See also NUM 22:24–22:25; PSA 80:12**The fragility of walls****Walls broken down by enemies****DEU 28:52; PRO 25:28; JER 50:15** See also 2SA 20:15; 2KI 14:13, 2KI 25:4 the fall of Jerusalem to the Babylonians; 2CH 26:6, 2CH 36:19; NEH 1:3; PSA 89:40; ISA 5:5, ISA 22:5; LAM 2:8; EZK 26:4; AMO 4:3**Walls collapsing of their own accord****ISA 30:13** See also 1KI 20:30; PSA 62:3; EZK 13:10–13:16**The figurative use of walls****Denoting protection****ISA 25:4** See also 1SA 25:16; EZR 9:9; ISA 26:1; ZEC 2:5**Denoting separation and impregnability****EPH 2:14** See also PRO 18:11; ISA 59:10; JER 1:18; EZK 22:30; ACT 23:3**The walls in the new Jerusalem**

REV 21:12–21:19

5605: warfare

The state of being at war with an opposing nation or people. Scripture neither condemns nor glorifies in warfare, but recognises it as a continuing aspect of this fallen world. In particular, the NT stresses the importance of spiritual warfare in the life of faith.

5606: warfare, nature of

Warfare is characteristic of a fallen world. Scripture describes how some wars are justified and others are not.

Warfare is characteristic of a fallen world**It is an aspect of life in a fallen world**

EXO 17:16; ; 2SA 3:1; ; 1KI 14:30

It is caused by sin**JAS 4:1–4:2** See also PSA 140:1–140:2; PRO 10:12, PRO 29:22; 1CO 3:3**It is horrific in nature****NAM 3:3** See also 2CH 25:12; ZEC 14:2**Warfare as a sign of the end times****MAT 24:6–24:7** parallels MRK 13:7–13:8, LUK 21:9–21:10**Sometimes God forbids war****DEU 1:41–1:42** See also 1KI 12:24; 1CH 22:8; PSA 68:30, PSA 120:7**Sometimes God commands war****JOS 8:1** See also NUM 31:7; DEU 20:1–20:4; JOS 10:40; JDG 6:16; PSA 144:1; ISA 13:3–13:4**Warfare is sometimes a means of judgment****1SA 15:2** See also 2KI 21:10–21:15, 2KI 24:2–24:4; ISA 10:12–10:19; JER 4:14–4:18**God's will that warfare will finally cease**

PSA 46:9; ; ISA 2:4; ; MIC 4:3

5607: warfare, examples of

From the time of entering the promised land, Israel was obliged to engage in warfare against other nations. Success is attributed to Israel's trust in the LORD and failure to lack of faith and disobedience.

Israel had to engage in warfare to enter Canaan**It was commanded by God****DEU 7:1–7:2** See also EXO 23:27–23:31; DEU 9:1–9:5, DEU 20:16–20:18**Joshua conquers the land****JOS 11:23** See also JOS 6:2, JOS 8:1–8:2, JOS 10:40–10:42; NEH 9:24; PSA 44:1–44:3**Israel failed to drive out the remaining Canaanites****JDG 1:19** Judah distrusted God's power to destroy their enemy's iron chariots. See also JDG 1:28, JDG 2:1–2:3, JDG 2:14–2:15**Israel was obliged to engage in warfare to defend the land****When unfaithful they were defeated****JDG 3:12–3:14** See also LEV 26:14–26:17, LEV 26:33; DEU 28:15, DEU 28:25; JDG 3:7–3:8, JDG 6:1–6:3; 2CH 12:1–12:4, 2CH 24:23–24:24**When faithful they were victorious****2CH 20:20** See also DEU 28:1, DEU 28:7; 1SA 7:7–7:14, 1SA 11:1–11:11; 2CH 20:15–20:24**Israel's internal struggles****2SA 3:1; 1KI 12:21** See also 2SA 2:8–2:17, 2SA 15:14; 1KI 15:6–15:7, 1KI 15:16; 2KI 13:12, 2KI 14:9–14:15**Israel's constant unfaithfulness led to the exile****1CH 5:25–5:26** See also 2KI 17:5–17:8, 2KI 17:22–17:23**Judah's constant unfaithfulness led to the Babylonian captivity****2CH 36:16–36:17** See also 2KI 25:1 parallel JER 52:4–52:5; 2KI 25:8–25:11 parallel JER 52:12–52:15; 2KI 25:21 parallel JER 52:27; JER 1:13–1:16

5608: warfare, strategies in

Scripture describes the strategies employed by Israel in warfare. Although recognising the importance of military preparation, Scripture stresses that Israel's trust is to be in God, rather than military might or prowess.

Preparations for warfare

Holding a council of war

PRO 20:18 See also PRO 11:14, PRO 24:6; LUK 14:31-14:32

Assembling an army

2SA 18:1 See also NUM 1:2-1:3; 1SA 11:6-11:8; 2CH 25:5-25:6, 2CH 26:11-26:14; DAN 11:10-11:13

Reconnaissance

NUM 21:32 See also DEU 1:22; JOS 2:1, JOS 7:2-7:3; JDG 7:9-7:11, JDG 18:2, JDG 18:5-18:10

Avoiding warfare

Making a treaty

JOS 9:15 See also GEN 26:28-26:29; JOS 10:1; 1SA 11:1; 1KI 5:12

Representative combat

1SA 17:8-17:10 See also 2SA 2:12-2:17

Strategies employed in warfare

Dividing into groups

JDG 9:43-9:44 See also GEN 14:14-14:15, GEN 32:7-32:8; JDG 7:16-7:21; 1SA 11:11; 2SA 18:1-18:2

Attacking by night

JDG 7:19 The Hebrews divided the night into three watches. See also GEN 14:14-14:15; 1SA 14:36; JER 6:5

Setting an ambush

2CH 13:13-13:14 See also JOS 8:4-8:7; JDG 9:34, JDG 9:42-9:44, JDG 20:29-20:44

Swiftiness of action

JOS 8:19 See also JOS 10:6-10:9, JOS 11:7; 2SA 5:22-5:25

Trusting in God in warfare

Of greater importance than military might or prowess

DEU 20:1; PSA 20:7 See also 1SA 17:45-17:47; PSA 33:16-33:17, PSA 147:10-147:11; ZEC 4:6

Demonstrated by seeking God before a battle

JDG 1:1 See also JDG 20:27-20:28; 2SA 5:18-5:19, 2SA 5:22-5:25

Strengthened by seeing God fighting for Israel

EXO 14:29-14:31; ; JOS 10:10-10:14; ; 2KI 19:35

5609: warfare, spiritual

See [8482: spiritual warfare](#)

5611: watchman

A person stationed on the highest part of a city wall to warn inhabitants of an approaching enemy or messenger; also a person who kept watch over pastures, vineyards and sheep. The OT prophets were spiritual watchmen, warning the people of Israel of God's judgment.

Watchmen stationed on the highest part of a city wall

To warn inhabitants of an approaching enemy

2KI 9:17 See also 1SA 14:16; 2SA 13:34; PSA 127:1, PSA 130:6; SNG 3:3, SNG 5:7; JER 51:12

To give notice of approaching messengers

2SA 18:24-18:27 See also 2KI 9:18, 2KI 9:20; 1SA 21:6, 1SA 21:8, 1SA 52:8

Watchmen stationed on towers in pastures and vineyards to guard against thieves

2CH 26:10; ; ISA 27:3; ; MIC 4:8

Watchmen stationed on hills

JER 31:6 This was to give notice of the various phases of the moon in order to fix the times for the most important festivals.

Watchmen who guarded sheep

JHN 10:3

The OT prophets were spiritual watchmen warning the people of Israel of God's judgment

JER 6:17 See also 1SA 21:11-21:12, 1SA 56:10, 1SA 62:6; EZK 3:17, EZK 33:2, EZK 33:6-33:7; HOS 9:8; HAB 2:1

5612: weapons

Instruments of warfare. God's people are to trust in him rather than in weapons. Scripture speaks of a day when weapons will become instruments of peace. The term is also used metaphorically.

Weapons of warfare

1CH 12:23, 1CH 12:33; NEH 4:16-4:18 See also GEN 49:5; 1SA 8:12, 1SA 17:45, 1SA 17:54, 1SA 21:8; 2SA 1:27; 2KI 11:8 parallel 2CH 23:7; 2KI 11:11 parallel 2CH 23:10; 1CH 12:34-12:37; 2CH 32:5; NEH 4:23; EZK 26:7-26:11, EZK 32:27; JHN 18:3

Trust in God rather than in weapons

PSA 20:7-20:8; ISA 31:1 See also DEU 1:41-1:44, DEU 20:1; 1SA 17:45-17:47; 2CH 20:20-20:24, 2CH 32:7-32:8;

PSA 33:16–33:19, PSA 76:3, PSA 147:10–147:11; PRO 21:31; ECC 9:18; ISA 22:8–22:11, ISA 54:16–54:17; ZEC 4:6

A day when weapons of war will become instruments of peace

ISA 2:4 parallel MIC 4:3 See also PSA 46:9; ISA 9:5; EZK 39:7–39:10; HOS 2:18; ZEC 9:10

Weapons used metaphorically by God

ISA 59:15–59:18; JER 50:25 See also PSA 7:11–7:13; ISA 13:5; JER 51:20; EZK 9:1–9:8

Weapons used metaphorically by Christians

2CO 10:4; EPH 6:11–6:17 See also ROM 13:12; 2CO 6:7; 1TH 5:8

5613: weights and measures

The peoples of the ancient Near East used a variety of standards of weights and measures, so that modern equivalents can only be approximate. The focus of Scripture is on the importance of keeping just weights and measures, and the prophets denounced those who used false balances and deceitful measures.

5614: weights and measures, laws concerning

God expects his people to use accurate weights and measures, and to use just balances. This is underlined in the Law, the Prophets and the wisdom literature.

The law demanded honesty in using weights and measures

LEV 19:35–19:36 Cheating by falsifying weights and measures was common in a culture where there was no standardisation or regulatory authority. See also DEU 25:13–25:16

The prophets called for the right use of weights and measures

A call for honesty
EZK 45:9–45:10

Condemnation of dishonesty

AMO 8:4–8:6 See also HOS 12:7–12:8; MIC 6:10–6:14

Instruction from Proverbs on weights and measures

PRO 20:10 See also PRO 11:1, PRO 16:11 Merchants carried stones of different sizes in a pouch for weighing silver for payment; PRO 20:23, PRO 22:28 To move a boundary stone was in effect to steal land.

5615: weights and measures, weights

Ancient weights were usually made of stone or metal, often inscribed with their weight and standard, the shekel being the basic weight of all Semitic nations. Weights of gold and silver served as currency, since coinage was not invented until the seventh century B.C. Weights are given in ascending order, with their approximate imperial and metric equivalents.

Gerah (1/20 shekel): about 1/50 ounce (about 0.6 gram)

LEV 27:25 See also EXO 30:13; NUM 3:47, NUM 18:16; EZK 45:12

Beka (10 gerahs): about 1/5 ounce (about 5.8 grams)

2CH 9:15–9:16 parallel 1KI 10:16–10:17 See also GEN 24:22; EXO 38:25–38:26

Pim (2/3 shekel): about 1/4 ounce (about 7.7 grams)

1SA 13:21 The Hebrew word translated “two thirds of a shekel” is “pim”, its only mention in Scripture.

Shekel (2 bekas): about 2/5 ounce (about 11.5 grams)

The shekel in relation to other weights
EZK 45:12

The shekel as a weight of metal objects
1SA 17:5 See also 1SA 17:7; 2SA 21:16

The shekel as a weight of food
EZK 4:10

The shekel as a weight of gold or silver objects
2CH 3:9 See also GEN 24:22; NUM 7:13–7:14; JDG 8:26

The shekel as a weight of gold or silver
GEN 23:14–23:16 The phrase “the weight current among the merchants” reflects the local variation in standards. See also GEN 37:28; DEU 22:28–22:29; JOS 7:20–7:21; JDG 17:1–17:4; 2SA 18:11–18:12; 1KI 10:29 parallel 2CH 1:17; 2KI 5:4–5:5; NEH 5:15; JER 32:9; DAN 5:25–5:27 “Tekel” can mean “weighed” or “shekel”.

The royal shekel

2SA 14:26 The royal shekel, also known in Babylonia, was slightly heavier (at about 13 grams) than the standard shekel and reflects David’s attempts to bring some standardisation to this weight.

The sanctuary shekel

NUM 18:15–18:16 The sanctuary shekel was more precisely regulated than the common shekel, weighing exactly 20 gerahs. The common shekel may have weighed slightly less as a result of greater handling

and wider circulation. See also EXO 30:13–30:15, EXO 30:22–30:25, EXO 38:24–38:26; LEV 5:15, LEV 27:1–27:7; NUM 3:46–3:50

Mina (50 shekels): about 1 1/4 pounds (about 0.6 kilogram)

EZK 45:12 Although the mina is valued here at 60 shekels, there is some evidence that in the pre-exilic period it was valued at 50 shekels. See also 1KI 10:17; EZR 2:69; NEH 7:71–7:72; DAN 5:25–5:26 “Mene” can mean both “numbered” and “mina”; LUK 19:11–19:27 By NT times the mina had become coinage rather than simply a weight of silver, and was worth about three months’ wages.

Talent (3,000 shekels, 60 minas): about 75 pounds (about 34 kilograms)

1CH 29:7 See also EXO 25:39; 2SA 12:30 parallel 1CH 20:2; 1KI 10:14 parallel 2CH 9:13; 1KI 16:24; 2KI 18:14; EZR 8:26; EST 3:9; MAT 18:24–18:25 By NT times the talent had become coinage, and ten thousand talents would have been the equivalent of millions of pounds sterling; MAT 25:14–25:30

Other minor weights

Kesitah

GEN 33:19 The price in the original Hebrew is “one hundred kesitahs”, a unit of unknown weight and value.

Litra

The word translated pint“ in Jn 12:3 and pound“ in 19:39 is litra“, a loanword from the Latin libra“, meaning “pound“ and weighing 12 ounces (327 grams): JHN 12:3, JHN 19:39

Peres

DAN 5:28 “Peres” means “division” and denotes a half-shekel.

5616: weights and measures, dry

These terms derive originally from the containers used, which held a fixed amount. Measures are given in ascending order, with their approximate imperial and metric equivalents.

Cab (1/18 ephah): about 2 pints (about 1 litre)

2KI 6:25 This is the only mention in Scripture of this measure.

Omer (1/10 ephah): about 4 pints (about 2 litres)

EXO 16:16–16:22 This incident records the only mention in Scripture of this measure. See also EXO 16:32, EXO 16:36

Seah (1/3 ephah): about 13 pints (about 7.3 litres)

GEN 18:6 The seah was a measure used for flour and cereals. See also 1SA 25:18; 1KI 18:32; 2KI 7:1

Ephah: about 3/5 bushel (about 22 litres)

RUT 2:17 The ephah was used only for flour and cereals, and had subdivisions of 1/6 and 1/10. See also LEV 5:11, LEV 24:5; NUM 15:4–15:9; JDG 6:19; 1SA 17:17; EZK 45:10–45:11; ZEC 5:6–5:8 The word for “measuring basket” in the Hebrew is “ephah”.

Lethek (5 ephahs or 1/2 homer): about 3 bushels (about 110 litres)

HOS 3:2 Possibly a Phoenician measure, this is the only mention in Scripture of this measure.

Cor (10 ephahs): about 6 bushels (about 220 litres)

1KI 4:22 The cor was used for measuring flour and cereals, and also appears to have been used for measuring oil. See also 1KI 5:11; 2CH 2:10, 2CH 27:5; EZR 7:22; EZK 45:14

Homer (10 ephahs): about 6 bushels (about 220 litres)

LEV 27:16 The homer is an older word than the cor, but is equivalent to it. It originally meant “a donkey load” and was widely used throughout the ancient Near East from the second millennium B.C. as a measure for cereals. See also NUM 11:32; ISA 5:10; EZK 45:11, EZK 45:13–45:14; HOS 3:2

Other dry measures found in the NT

Quart (choenix): about 1 1/2–2 pints (about 1 litre)

REV 6:6 The word translated “quart” is “choenix”, a Greek measure.

Saton (equivalent to the OT seah)

MAT 13:33 parallel LUK 13:21 The “large amount” referred to is “three sata” in the Greek.

Bowl (modius): about 15 1/2 pints (about 8.75 litres)

MAT 5:15 parallels MRK 4:21, LUK 11:33 The word translated “bowl” is the Roman measure “modius”.

Koros (equivalent to the OT cor)

LUK 16:7 The measure translated as “a thousand bushels” is “one hundred korous” in the Greek.

5617: weights and measures, liquid

These terms derive originally from the containers used, which held a fixed amount. There is some uncertainty about the capacity of the bath, and therefore of other liquid measures dependent upon it. Measures

are given in ascending order, with their approximate imperial and metric equivalents.

Log (1/72 bath): about 1/2 pint (about 0.3 litre)

LEV 14:10 This is the only mention in Scripture of the log, as a measure of oil used in the ritual for cleansing infectious skin diseases. See also LEV 14:12–14:18, LEV 14:21–14:22

Hin (1/6 bath): about 7 pints (about 4 litres)

EXO 29:38–29:41 The hin was used as a measure of oil, wine and water. See also LEV 23:12–23:13; NUM 15:4–15:10; EZK 4:11, EZK 46:5–46:7

Bath (1 ephah): about 5 gallons (about 22 litres)

EZK 45:11 The bath was the equivalent liquid measure of the ephah, and was used to measure oil, wine and water. See also 1KI 5:11, 1KI 7:38; 2CH 2:10; EZR 7:21–7:22; ISA 5:10; EZK 45:14; LUK 16:6 The measure translated as “eight hundred gallons” is “one hundred batous” in the original (“batos” being the Greek form of the Hebrew “bath”); JHN 2:6 The measure translated as “twenty to thirty gallons” is “two to three metretas” in the original, a Greek measure roughly equivalent to the bath.

5618: weights and measures, linear

These terms were based on natural units of measurement that could be easily applied. Measures are given in ascending order, with their approximate imperial and metric equivalents.

Finger (1/4 handbreadth): about 3/4 inch (about 1.85 centimetres)

JER 52:21 The finger was 1/4 handbreadth and was the smallest subdivision of the cubit. This is its only mention in Scripture.

Handbreadth (4 fingers): about 3 inches (about 8 centimetres)

EXO 25:25 parallel EXO 37:12 The handbreadth was the width of the hand at the base of the four fingers. See also 1KI 7:26 parallel 2CH 4:5; PSA 39:5 The handbreadth is here used figuratively of the shortness of human life; EZK 40:5

Span (half a cubit): about 9 inches (about 23 centimetres)

EXO 28:16 parallel EXO 39:9 The span was the width of the outstretched hand from thumb to little finger. See also 1SA 17:4 Goliath’s height is given in the Hebrew as “six cubits and a span”; PSA 90:10 The span is here used figuratively of the shortness of human life; EZK 43:13

Cubit (2 spans): about 18 inches (about 0.5 metre)

EXO 25:10 parallel EXO 37:1 The cubit was the distance from the fingertip to the elbow, and was used to measure height, size, depth and distance. See also GEN 7:20 The Hebrew describes the depth of the water as “fifteen cubits”; EXO 27:9–27:18 parallel EXO 38:9–38:15; 1KI 6:2–6:3 parallel 2CH 3:3–3:4; 1CH 11:23 The Hebrew describes the man as “five cubits tall”; EZK 40:5, EZK 45:1–45:6, EZK 47:3–47:5; JHN 21:8 The Greek text describes the distance as “about two hundred cubits”; REV 21:17

Reed (6 cubits): about 10 feet (about 3 metres)

EZK 41:8 Originally a measuring instrument, the reed became a recognised measure of six cubits (the rod). See also EZK 40:3, EZK 40:5–40:7; REV 11:1, REV 21:15–21:16

Mile

MAT 5:41 The Greek word for “mile” here is “milion”, a transliteration of the Roman measurement “mille passuum”, “a thousand paces”. See also LUK 24:13 The measurement in the Greek is “sixty stadia”. Eight stadia were about one mile (about 1480 metres); JHN 6:19 The measurement in the Greek is “twenty-five or thirty stadia”; JHN 11:18 The measurement in the Greek is “fifteen stadia”.

5619: weights and measures, distance and area

Diverse expressions were used for these measurements, their being determined in the most practical way possible, reckoned by known averages.

Expressions of distance

A bow-shot

GEN 21:15–21:16

Some distance

EXO 33:7 A variety of distance often lies behind this expression, as can be seen in the examples that follow. See also GEN 35:16, GEN 36:6; NUM 2:2; 1SA 26:13; 2SA 15:17; MAT 8:30

A Sabbath day’s journey

ACT 1:12 While this is the only mention of this phrase in Scripture, it was in fact a popular expression, indicating the distance a devout Jew could walk on the Sabbath. It was based on the rabbinical interpretation of Ex 16:29 in the light of Nu 35:5, and was limited to 2,000 cubits.

A day’s journey

1KI 19:3–19:4 See also NUM 11:31

A three-day journey

GEN 30:36 See also EXO 3:18; NUM 10:33; EZR 10:7–10:9; JON 3:3

Far away

DEU 28:49 See also 1KI 8:46 parallel 2CH 6:36; ISA 6:12; EZK 11:15–11:16; JOL 3:8; ZEC 6:15; ACT 22:21

Expressions of area**Area expressed by the yoke**

ISA 14:14 The area translated “about half an acre” in the Hebrew means “half a yoke”. The yoke was the area of land ploughed by a yoke of oxen in one day, approximately one acre. See also ISA 5:10 The Hebrew describes the area as “ten-yoke”, that is, the land ploughed by ten yoke of oxen in one day.

Area expressed by the amount of seed required to sow the land

LEV 27:16

Area expressed by its constituent measurements

EZK 40:47 See also EXO 28:16 parallel EXO 39:9; 1KI 7:23; EZK 45:1–45:6

5621: wheel

Early wheels were solid wooden discs. These were replaced around 1500 B.C. by lighter, spoked wheels. The most common use of wheels is on chariots and carts; they were also used by potters and in machinery for drawing water from a well. The chariot throne of God has wheels which are vividly described.

Chariot wheels

EXO 14:25; NAM 3:2 The sound of chariot wheels announces the approach of the enemy. See also 2KI 7:6; ISA 5:28; JER 47:3; JOL 2:5; REV 9:9

Wagon wheels

The Hebrew word for wheel“ is here used for wagon”: EZK 23:24, EZK 26:10

Threshing wheels

PRO 20:26 Threshing was carried out by driving a sledge or a cart with heavy wheels over the grain. See also ISA 28:27–28:28

Other examples of wheels

1KI 7:32–7:33 The stands for basins in Solomon’s temple were mounted on wheels. See also 1KI 7:30; ECC 12:6 A wheel formed part of the machinery for drawing water from a well; JER 18:3 Potters turned their clay on a wheel.

The wheels of God’s chariot throne

EZK 11:22–11:23; DAN 7:9 See also 2KI 2:11; ISA 66:15; EZK 1:15–1:21, EZK 3:12–3:13, EZK 10:1–10:19

5622: witnesses

Individuals who, having observed something take place, are able to give an accurate and full account of what has happened. Witnesses were of central importance to OT law. The theme of giving account is also of major importance to evangelism, which rests upon believers explaining the impact of Jesus Christ upon their lives.

5623: witnesses, legal

God gave detailed instructions about the conduct of witnesses in the legal processes of Israel and also in the affairs of the church.

God himself as a witness

GEN 31:50; ; MAL 2:14

General legal requirements about witnesses**A witness to a crime was required to give evidence**

LEV 5:1 See also PRO 29:24

Two or more witnesses were required to prove someone guilty

DEU 19:15 See also DEU 17:6; MAT 18:15–18:16; 2CO 13:1

The role of witnesses in capital cases**At least two witnesses were required**

NUM 35:30 See also DEU 17:2–17:6; HEB 10:28

Witnesses were required to participate in the execution

DEU 17:7 See also LEV 24:13–24:16; DEU 13:6–13:11; ACT 7:57–7:58

The role of witnesses in other legal matters**Land transactions**

JER 32:9–32:12 See also GEN 23:10–23:18; RUT 4:1–4:9; JER 32:25, JER 32:44

Levirate marriage

RUT 4:9–4:11

The role of witnesses in disputes concerning believers

MAT 18:15–18:17 See also 2CO 13:1; 1TI 5:19

5624: witnesses, to Jesus Christ

The NT identifies a variety of witnesses to Jesus Christ, who confirm his identity and importance. It also

stresses the importance of believers bearing witness to Christ in the world.

The witness of the OT

ACT 26:22–26:23 See also LUK 24:27; JHN 5:39–5:40; HEB 12:1–12:2

The witness of John the Baptist

JHN 1:6–1:8 See also MAT 3:1–3:3; ISA 40:3; MAT 3:11–3:12 parallels MRK 1:7–1:8, LUK 3:15–3:18; JHN 1:15, JHN 1:19–1:31, JHN 3:26–3:30, JHN 5:33–5:35

The witness of the Holy Spirit

JHN 15:26 See also ACT 5:32; ROM 8:16; 1JN 5:6–5:9

The witness of the Father

JHN 8:18 See also MAT 3:17 parallels MRK 1:11, LUK 3:22; MAT 17:5 parallels MRK 9:7, LUK 9:35; JHN 5:37–5:38

The witness of Jesus Christ to himself

JHN 5:36, JHN 8:14 See also JHN 13:13, JHN 14:11

The witness of Jesus Christ's miracles

JHN 14:11 See also JHN 10:25, JHN 15:24

The witness of the first Christians

Commissioned by Jesus Christ

ACT 1:8 MAT 10:17–10:20; ; LUK 21:12–21:13; ; ACT 4:18–4:21; LUK 1:1–1:2, LUK 24:48; ; JHN 15:27; ; ACT 1:21–1:22, ACT 2:32, ACT 4:33, ACT 13:31; ACT 9:5–9:6, ACT 22:14–22:15, ACT 23:11, ACT 26:16; HEB 2:3; ; 1PE 5:1; ; 2PE 1:16; ; 1JN 1:1

The witness of converts

1PE 3:15–3:16 See also 2TI 1:8

5625: witnesses, false

Scripture prohibits individuals from bearing false witness against their neighbours.

False testimony forbidden

EXO 20:16 parallel DEU 5:20 See also EXO 23:1–23:2; LEV 19:12; PRO 6:16–6:19, PRO 24:28; LUK 3:14; MAT 15:19, MAT 19:18 parallels MRK 10:19, LUK 18:20

The effect of false witnesses on other people and society

PRO 25:18 See also PSA 27:12, PSA 35:11; PRO 12:17, PRO 14:5, PRO 14:25, PRO 18:5, PRO 19:28

False witnesses will be punished

DEU 19:16–19:21 See also LEV 6:1–6:7; PRO 19:5, PRO 19:9, PRO 21:28; ISA 29:20–29:21; ZEC 5:3–5:4

Examples of false witnesses

1KI 21:8–21:13; ; MAT 26:59–26:61 parallel MRK 14:55–14:59; ; MAT 28:12–28:15; ; ACT 6:11–6:14

5627: word

Jesus Christ is described as God's word. The word encompassed the promise of God and the gospel and is a help in trial and temptation. Human beings should use words wisely.

Jesus Christ and God's word

Jesus Christ described as the Word

JHN 1:1–1:3 See also JHN 1:14; HEB 1:1–1:2; 1JN 1:1–1:2; REV 19:13

Jesus Christ preaches the word

MRK 2:2 See also MAT 7:24–7:29 parallel LUK 6:47–6:49; MAT 13:20–13:23 parallels MRK 4:13–4:20, LUK 8:11–8:15 the parable of the sower; LUK 11:28; JHN 3:34, JHN 5:24, JHN 6:63–6:68, JHN 8:31–8:32, JHN 8:47, JHN 8:52, JHN 12:47–12:50, JHN 14:10–14:24, JHN 15:3, JHN 17:6–17:8

The word and the gospel

ACT 4:31 See also ACT 4:29, ACT 13:44–13:46, ACT 19:10, ACT 20:24; DEU 30:14; ROM 10:8–10:10; COL 1:5, COL 2:2; 1TH 1:5; HEB 4:2

God's word is a promise and help in trial and temptation

PSA 119:9–119:11 See also PSA 33:4–33:5, PSA 119:105, PSA 119:133; DEU 8:3; MAT 4:4; JHN 14:23–14:24, JHN 17:17; EPH 6:17; HEB 4:12; 1JN 5:3

Words should be used wisely

MAT 12:36–12:37 See also JDG 8:1–8:3; 2CH 10:13–10:14; PRO 10:19, PRO 12:18, PRO 12:25, PRO 15:1, PRO 16:24, PRO 25:15; ECC 12:11; JAS 3:1–3:12

5628: work

Work was ordained by God as a means of fulfilment, service and praise. It is to be supplemented by rest, following the pattern of God's creation of the world. Despite the effects of sin, work can still be honouring to God.

5629: work, as ordained by God

God ordained work as the normal routine of living. Every legitimate human task, therefore, is of intrinsic worth, however menial it may seem, and is potentially a means of glorifying God.

Work is ordained by God

GEN 1:27–1:28 See also EXO 20:9 parallel DEU 5:13; PSA 104:23 Work is part of the rhythm of life.

God's purposes in ordaining work**That people should be self-supporting****GEN 3:19** See also PSA 128:2; 1TH 4:12**That people should find self-fulfilment****ECC 2:24** See also PRO 14:23; ECC 3:22, ECC 5:19**That people should serve others****EPH 4:28** See also PRO 31:15; 1TH 2:9; 1TI 5:8**That people should glorify God****COL 3:17** See also 1CO 10:31; EPH 6:5–6:8 parallel COL 3:22–3:24**Consequences of viewing work as God's ordinance****Work is seen as a moral duty****TIT 3:14** See also PRO 6:6; ECC 9:10; 1TH 4:11; 2TH 3:7–3:12**Any legitimate work may be seen as God's calling****GEN 2:15** See also EXO 31:1–31:6, EXO 35:30–35:35; PSA 78:70–78:71; MAT 13:55 parallel MRK 6:3; ROM 13:6; 1CO 7:17, 1CO 7:20–7:24**Work is seen as a stewardship from God himself****COL 3:23–3:24** See also MAT 25:14–25:30 parallel LUK 19:12–19:27; EPH 6:5–6:8**Criticism of those who will not work****2TH 3:10–3:11****5630: work, divine and human**

God has ordained that some of his purposes be fulfilled through the co-operation (conscious or unconscious) of human beings.

God works in co-operation with people's work**Human labour is futile apart from God****PSA 127:1** See also GEN 11:8; JHN 15:5**God often works through human means****PSA 77:20** See also ACT 9:15; ROM 13:6; 2CO 7:6**God gives the gifts needed for work**

EXO 31:3, EXO 31:6; ; LUK 12:48; ; 1PE 4:11

Human workers should acknowledge their dependence upon God**DEU 8:18** See also PSA 90:17; NEH 6:9, NEH 6:16; 2CO 3:5**The apostles as God's fellow-workers****1CO 3:9; 2CO 6:1** See also MRK 16:20**Examples of divine and human co-operation in work**

PHP 2:12–2:13

God creates and people cultivate

GEN 2:15; ; ISA 28:23–28:29; ; 1CO 3:7

God gives and people are generous

1KI 17:9; ; 2CO 8:1–8:5

God speaks through prophets' words

DEU 18:15–18:18; ; 2SA 12:25; ; JER 37:2; ; HOS 12:13; ; MAT 1:22; ; 2PE 1:21

5631: work, of GodSee [1300: God, work of](#)**5632: work, of Jesus Christ**See [2300: Jesus Christ, ministry and work of](#)**5633: work, of Holy Spirit**See [3200: Holy Spirit, ministry and work of](#), [3296: Holy Spirit, work in the world](#)**5634: work, and the fall**

Human work, which was once a pleasure, became a burden only on account of human disobedience.

Work is under God's judgment**GEN 3:17–3:19** See also GEN 5:29**Work is often frustrating****ECC 2:22–2:23** See also ECC 2:11, ECC 2:18, ECC 4:8, ECC 5:16–5:17**Work may exploit rather than enhance society****Through dishonesty**

LEV 19:35; ; DEU 25:13; ; HOS 12:7

Through oppression

EXO 1:11–1:14; ; 1KI 12:4, 1KI 12:10–12:14

Work may be undervalued or overvalued**Some people avoid work to their cost**

PRO 6:6–6:11, PRO 13:4, PRO 19:15, PRO 24:30–24:34; ; ECC 10:18; ; 2TH 3:10–3:11

Some people overwork to their cost

EXO 18:17–18:18; ; PSA 127:2; ; LUK 10:41–10:42, LUK 12:15–12:21

5635: work, and redemption

Although human activity cannot merit eternal redemption, work done in this life may, with God's enabling, substantially reflect the divine ideal, in anticipation of the perfect service of heaven.

Human work cannot merit redemption

EPH 2:8–2:9; ; 2TI 1:9; ; TIT 3:4–3:5

Jesus Christ's finished work secures redemption

JHN 17:4 See also JHN 4:34, JHN 19:30; HEB 9:12

Faith leads believers to perform good works

JAS 2:14 See also MAT 7:16–7:20, MAT 12:33; LUK 3:8–3:9; ROM 2:13; HEB 6:10–6:12; JAS 2:17–2:26

Redeemed workers fulfil God's purpose in work**By applying biblical virtues in employment**

PRO 10:4, PRO 14:23; ; GAL 6:9; ; COL 4:1

By the pursuit of excellence

ECC 9:10; ; TIT 2:7–2:8, TIT 3:8; ; 1PE 2:12, 1PE 2:15

By doing their work as those responsible to God

ROM 12:1; ; 1CO 7:24, 1CO 10:31; ; EPH 6:7; ; COL 3:23

Work done, as for the Lord, will be rewarded by the Lord

COL 3:23–3:24 See also 2CH 31:21; MAT 25:21; 1CO 15:58

Work will continue in the life to come

REV 22:3 See also MAT 25:21, MAT 25:23; LUK 19:17, LUK 19:19

5636: work, and rest

In creation, God has established a pattern of work and rest that is to be a model for believers.

Work and rest built into creation

EXO 20:11 See also GEN 2:1–2:3; PSA 104:19–104:23

The pattern of work and rest confirmed in the OT**By Sabbath observance**

EXO 20:10 parallel DEU 5:14; ; LEV 23:3

By observing holy festivals

EXO 12:16; ; LEV 16:29, LEV 23:6–23:8 parallel NUM 28:17–28:18; ; LEV 23:28–23:31 parallel NUM 29:7; ; LEV 23:35–23:36, LEV 23:39 parallel NUM 29:12; ; EST 9:17–9:19

Work and rest in the ministry of Jesus Christ

MRK 6:30–6:32 See also JHN 4:6

Wisdom needed to balance work and rest**To avoid idleness**

PRO 6:9–6:11, PRO 10:4–10:5, PRO 14:23, PRO 20:13, PRO 24:30–24:34

To avoid overwork

EXO 18:13–18:24; ; PSA 127:2; ; LUK 10:38–10:42

Work and rest are both potential means of glorifying God

1CO 10:31 See also ECC 2:24; COL 3:17

Work and rest will be perfectly fulfilled in heaven

REV 14:13, REV 22:3

5638: writing

A form of communication, including the writing of books, letters and scrolls. Many kinds of materials have been written on. Figuratively speaking, the heart can be written on.

Uses of writing**Books**

JER 30:2 See also LUK 1:3

The law

DEU 31:24 See also JOS 24:26; 2KI 23:21

Annals and records

1KI 11:41 See also 2KI 12:19; 1CH 29:29; 2CH 35:25

Agreements

NEH 9:38

Legal documents

DEU 24:1; ; MRK 10:4

Letters

2SA 11:14; ROM 16:22; COL 4:18 In those days the sender would add a few words to a letter dictated to and written by a secretary. See also 1KI 21:8–21:11; EST 3:12; GAL 6:11; 2PE 3:1

Writing materials**Stone**

EXO 32:15–32:16 See also DEU 27:2–27:3; JOB 19:24

Wood

NUM 17:2–17:3; ; DEU 6:9

Metal

ZEC 14:20

Walls

DAN 5:5–5:8

Writing tablets

HAB 2:2; ; LUK 1:63

Scrolls

DEU 17:18; REV 1:11 See also EXO 17:14; NUM 5:23; JOB 19:23; ISA 8:1; JER 36:18, JER 51:60

Writing kits

EZK 9:2–9:3 See also EZK 9:11; 2JN 1:12; 3JN 1:13

God writes

The law

EXO 31:18, EXO 32:15–32:16, EXO 34:1

Figurative writing of God

PSA 139:16 See also PSA 87:6; LUK 10:20

Jesus Christ writes

JHN 8:6

Writing on the heart

JER 31:33 See also HEB 8:10, HEB 10:16 **ROM 2:15** See also PRO 3:3, PRO 7:3; JER 17:1; 2CO 3:2

General references to writing

GEN 5:1; ; DEU 31:19; ; JOS 18:4; ; 2CH 35:4; ; PSA 102:18

5650: Human relationships

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5651: ancestors

The ancestors of Israel

Abraham, Isaac and Jacob

LEV 26:45 See also JAS 2:21

More immediate forebears

AMO 2:4 See also 1KI 19:3–19:4; ACT 28:17

Ancestors of specific groups of people

JOS 17:1 See also GEN 10:21

Ancestors of individuals

ROM 9:5 See also HEB 7:10

The figurative use of ancestors

EZK 16:3

5652: babies

The gift of young children from God is usually seen as a blessing. The term is also used figuratively of those who are young or immature in the faith.

Babies as a blessing from God

PSA 127:3 See also GEN 1:28, GEN 17:16, GEN 24:59–24:60; PRO 17:6; LUK 1:41–1:42

The promise of a baby

GEN 17:15–17:19 See also GEN 18:10–18:14; 2KI 4:14–4:17; LUK 1:11–1:24

Examples of biblical characters as babies

GEN 21:1–21:7 Isaac; ; GEN 25:21–25:26 Esau and Jacob; ; EXO 2:1–2:10 Moses; ; JDG 13:2–13:25 Samson; ; RUT 4:13–4:17 Obed, the father of Jesse; ; 2SA 12:24–12:25 Solomon; ; LUK 1:57–1:66 John the Baptist

Babies as prophetic signs

ISA 7:14 See also ISA 8:3–8:4, ISA 9:6–9:7; HOS 1:2–1:11; LUK 2:8–2:12

OT laws concerned with the birth of babies

LUK 2:21–2:24 See also GEN 17:9–17:12; EXO 13:1–13:2; LEV 12:1–12:8; LUK 1:59

A mother's love for her baby

ISA 49:15 See also 1KI 3:16–3:28; ISA 66:12–66:13

Babies are sinful from birth

PSA 51:5 See also PSA 58:3; JHN 9:34

The death of babies

EXO 1:15–1:22 See also EXO 11:4–11:5; 2SA 12:13–12:23; LAM 2:11–2:12; MAT 2:16–2:18; ACT 7:17–7:19

Jesus Christ and babies

Jesus Christ's own birth and babyhood

MAT 1:18–1:23 See also ISA 7:14; MAT 2:1–2:23; LUK 1:26–1:38, LUK 2:1–2:40

Jesus Christ's response to babies

LUK 18:15–18:17 parallels MAT 19:13–19:15, MRK 10:13–10:16

Babyhood used as a spiritual image

1CO 3:1–3:2 See also PSA 8:2; MAT 21:16, MAT 11:25; ROM 2:20; 1CO 14:20; EPH 4:14; HEB 5:11–5:14; 1PE 2:2–2:3

5654: betrothal

The period of engagement preceding marriage; betrothal was a binding contract established between two families and sealed by the exchange of gifts. During this period the couple did not live together; sexual relations with each other at this stage was regarded as equivalent to adultery. Betrothal describes the relationship between God and his people and between Jesus Christ and the church.

Betrothal and the choice of a spouse

Wives were often chosen by parents for their sons

GEN 21:21 It was usual practice for the groom's parents to choose his wife and arrange the wedding. See also GEN 24:4, GEN 38:6

Suitable husbands were sought by parents for their daughters

RUT 3:1–3:4 Naomi, in the role of parent, assumes responsibility to find a husband for Ruth. See also JDG 1:12–1:13; 1SA 18:17, 1SA 18:21

Betrothal following the couple's wishes

JDG 14:1–14:4 Sometimes the man chose a prospective bride and his parents negotiated the marriage. See also GEN 34:1–34:4, GEN 24:57–24:58, GEN 26:34–26:35 Esau chose a bride against his parents' wishes.

Betrothal preceded marriage

GEN 29:21; ; DEU 20:7 A betrothed soldier was exempted from military service until after his marriage; ; MAT 1:24; ; 1CO 7:36–7:38

An exchange of gifts accompanied betrothal

The bride-price

GEN 34:11–34:12 This gift, which was given by the groom to the bride's family as compensation, sealed the marriage contract. See also GEN 24:53, GEN 29:18, GEN 29:27; EXO 22:16–22:17; DEU 22:28–22:29; 2SA 3:14

The dowry

1KI 9:16 The dowry was a gift from the bride's father to the bride and/or groom. GEN 24:59, GEN 29:24, GEN 29:29; JDG 1:14–1:15

Betrothal was treated as marriage

DEU 22:23–22:24 Though there were no sexual relations within the betrothal period, the commitment was regarded almost as seriously as marriage and infidelity of a betrothed partner was treated as adultery. See also GEN 19:14 The men betrothed to Lot's daughters are described as his "sons-in-law"; MAT 1:18–1:20 Mary's pregnancy during betrothal left her open to the charge and consequences of unfaithfulness.

Betrothal portrays the relationship between God and his people

HOS 2:19–2:20; 2CO 11:2 See also JHN 3:29; EPH 5:25–5:27; REV 19:7–19:9, REV 21:2

5655: birth

The beginning or origin of life, in which a living creature comes into the world. Scripture draws a distinction between physical and spiritual birth, insisting

that a person must be not only physically but also spiritually born in order to have life to the full.

Physical birth

God creates all life

JOB 10:8–10:12; ; PSA 71:6, PSA 139:13

Human beings are sinful from the moment of birth

PSA 51:5 See also JOB 15:14, JOB 25:4; PSA 58:3; JHN 3:6, JHN 9:34; ROM 5:12, ROM 5:17–5:19

The necessity of spiritual birth

Being born again

JHN 3:3

Being born of the Spirit

JHN 3:5–3:8 See also PSA 87:4–87:6; MAT 18:3; JHN 1:12–1:13; 1PE 1:3, 1PE 2:2

The agents of the new birth: word and Spirit

1PE 1:23 See also LUK 10:21; JHN 3:5, JHN 3:7–3:8; TIT 3:5; JAS 1:18

The fruit of the new birth: holiness and love

1JN 3:9, 1JN 4:7 See also MAT 18:4; 1JN 2:29, 1JN 5:3–5:4, 1JN 5:18

Spiritual birth and the nation of Israel

DEU 32:18 See also NUM 11:12 Moses implies that God himself gave birth to the people.

Birth seen as entry into a condition or status

Ethnic identity from birth

EXO 12:48; ; EZK 16:3; ; ACT 17:26, ACT 22:27–22:28; ; GAL 2:15, GAL 4:4; ; EPH 2:11; ; PHP 3:4–3:5

Physical or mental disability from birth

JHN 9:1; ; ACT 3:2, ACT 14:8

5657: birthright

The right of the firstborn son in ancient Israel to inherit his father's estate. Where the property was divided, the firstborn received a double share.

Birthright was recognised amongst the patriarchs

GEN 25:5–25:6, GEN 25:34

Birthright and the law

It was guaranteed under the law

DEU 21:15–21:17 See also 1CH 26:10 some ignored this law

Daughters and others could inherit if there were no sons

NUM 27:1–27:11

Only sons of a lawful marriage qualified

GEN 21:8–21:13; ; JDG 11:1–11:2

Birthright and kingship

Succession was normally to the firstborn

2CH 21:1–21:3 See also 2CH 11:18–11:22 favouritism could intrude here also

Transfer of the birthright

Through misconduct

1CH 5:1 See also GEN 49:3–49:4

By transaction

GEN 25:29–25:34 See also HEB 12:16–12:17

The Christian birthright

ROM 8:17 Jesus Christ is the firstborn over all creation; by the grace of God Christians share in his inheritance. See also GAL 4:7; COL 1:15; HEB 1:2

5658: boys

As those who would continue the family line boys were seen as a great blessing from God. Circumcised on the eighth day, as they grew towards maturity they were to be taught by their fathers. In the story of God's people, Israelite boys are seen serving God, being ministered to by men of God and suffering at the hands of ungodly kings.

Boys in general are seen as a blessing from God

PSA 127:3–127:5 See also RUT 4:13–4:17; PSA 128:3–128:4

Particular boys who are seen as a special gift from God

The boy Isaac, a gift to Abraham and Sarah

GEN 17:15–17:22 See also GEN 21:1–21:7

The boy Samson, a gift to Manoah and his wife

JDG 13:2–13:5 See also JDG 13:24–13:25

The boy Samuel, a gift to Elkanah and Hannah

1SA 1:1–1:20

The boy John, a gift to Zechariah and Elizabeth

LUK 1:5–1:25 See also LUK 1:57–1:66

The boy Jesus, a gift to Mary and Joseph

LUK 1:26–1:38 See also MAT 1:20–1:21

Boys were circumcised on the eighth day

GEN 17:9–17:14 See also LEV 12:3; LUK 1:59, LUK 2:21

Boys were taught by their fathers

PRO 4:1–4:4 While examples of fatherly instruction in Scripture are confined to wisdom literature and liturgical material, other sources indicate that the education provided was more wide-ranging, and would include the teaching of a trade. See also EXO 13:8; DEU 6:20–6:25; PRO 4:10–4:13

Israelite boys who served God

The boy Samuel served God in the temple
1SA 3:1–3:21

The boy David served God by killing Goliath
1SA 17:20–17:51

The boy King Joash served God
2CH 24:1–24:2 parallel 2KI 12:1–12:2

The boy King Josiah served God
2CH 34:1–34:2 parallel 2KI 22:1–22:2

The boy Jesus had a conscious relationship with God
LUK 2:41–2:50

Boys who are ministered to by men of God

Through Elijah, God restored the life of a widow's son
1KI 17:17–17:23

Through Elisha, God restored the life of a Shunammite's son
2KI 4:32–4:37

Jesus Christ healed a demon-possessed boy
MAT 17:14–17:18 parallels MRK 9:14–9:27, LUK 9:37–9:43

Both Herod and Pharaoh ordered that Israelite boys be killed
MAT 2:16 See also EXO 1:15–1:22

5659: bride

A woman who is about to be married or who has just got married. In the NT the church is described as the bride of Christ.

Jewels and ornaments worn by a bride at her wedding

ISA 61:10 See also PSA 45:9, PSA 45:14; SNG 4:9; ISA 49:18; JER 2:32

Joy and happiness associated with a bride

JER 33:10–33:11 See also JER 7:34, JER 16:9, JER 25:10; REV 18:23

The bride as the object of the bridegroom's love and affection

ISA 62:5 See also SNG 4:8–4:15, SNG 5:1

The bridegroom as the object of the bride's love and affection

JER 2:2–2:3

Exemptions for a newly married bride

JOL 2:16 A newly married bride would normally be excused from certain civic and religious duties. See also DEU 24:5

The bride price

GEN 34:11–34:12 A bridegroom was required to pay a bride-price to the father of his bride. See also GEN 29:18–29:30; 1SA 18:20–18:27

Proof of a bride's virginity was required in certain circumstances

DEU 22:13–22:21

The church depicted as the bride of Christ

EPH 5:25–5:27 See also REV 19:7–19:9, REV 21:1–21:2, REV 21:9–21:27, REV 22:17

5660: bridegroom

A man who is to be married or who has just got married. In the NT Jesus Christ is portrayed as a bridegroom and the church as his bride.

The bridegroom and the wedding ceremony

The bridegroom wore special clothing
ISA 61:10

The bridegroom took part in the procession to the bride's home
See also MAT 25:1–25:12

The bridegroom had a group of companions
JDG 14:10–14:11

The bridegroom had a special friend as an attendant
JHN 3:29 See also JDG 14:20–15:2; JHN 2:7–2:10 The "master of the banquet" was probably the friend who attended the bridegroom.

The bridegroom was sometimes responsible for giving the wedding banquet
JDG 14:10 See also JHN 2:9–2:10

The bridegroom led his bride to a specially prepared bridal chamber
JOL 2:16 See also PSA 19:4–19:5

Bridegrooms were associated with happiness and rejoicing

JER 7:34 See also ISA 62:5; JER 16:9, JER 25:10, JER 33:11; REV 18:23

Bridegrooms were excused from military service and certain other duties

DEU 24:5 See also DEU 20:1–20:7

Jesus Christ is portrayed as a bridegroom

MAT 9:14–9:15 parallels MRK 2:18–2:20, LUK 5:33–5:35
Jesus Christ refers to himself as the bridegroom. See also EPH 5:22–5:33

The future coming of Jesus Christ compared to the sudden arrival of the bridegroom

MAT 25:1–25:10

5661: brothers

The son of one's parents, or of either mother or father. God's people may be referred to collectively as brothers, all being children of one heavenly Father.

Close relationship between brothers

LEV 21:1–21:3 See also NUM 6:6–6:7; DEU 28:54; PRO 18:24; EZK 44:25

Duties of brothers

Levirate marriage

DEU 25:5–25:10 See also GEN 38:6–38:11; MAT 22:23–22:30 parallels MRK 12:18–12:25, LUK 20:27–20:36

Participation in arrangement of marriages for sisters

GEN 34:11–34:17 See also GEN 24:50–24:60

Protection of sisters

2SA 13:1–13:33 See also GEN 34:24–34:31; LEV 21:3

Younger brothers taking news of older brothers to their father

1SA 17:17–17:18 See also GEN 37:12–37:17

The priority of the eldest brother

DEU 21:15–21:17 See also GEN 43:33, GEN 44:12; 1SA 20:29; 1CH 5:1–5:2; 2CH 21:1–21:3; PSA 89:27; HEB 12:16

Examples of younger brothers superseding their elder brothers

GEN 25:21–25:23 See also GEN 48:8–48:20; DEU 33:13–33:17; 1SA 16:6–16:13; 1KI 2:22

Brothers as heirs

NUM 27:8–27:11 See also ECC 4:8

Twin brothers

GEN 25:24–25:26 See also GEN 38:27–38:30; MAL 1:2–1:3

Half-brothers

JDG 11:1–11:2 See also GEN 21:8–21:9; JDG 8:30–8:31, JDG 9:1–9:6

Brothers-in-law

NUM 10:29–10:32 See also GEN 38:8; DEU 25:5, DEU 25:7; JDG 4:11

Examples of brothers failing to live up to expectations of them

GEN 4:8–4:12 See also GEN 37:3–37:4, GEN 37:12–37:33, GEN 38:6–38:10; JDG 9:1–9:5; 2CH 21:4

Application of the term ``brothers''

To siblings

GEN 42:32 See also GEN 16:9–16:12, GEN 25:18; JDG 16:31; 1SA 17:17–17:22, 1SA 22:1; 2CH 21:13; NEH 1:2, NEH 5:14; JOB 19:17, JOB 42:11; PRO 17:17; MAT 10:21 parallels MRK 13:12, LUK 21:16; MAT 13:55 parallel MRK 6:3; JHN 7:3–7:5

To relatives

RUT 4:3 See also NUM 36:2; PRO 27:10

To members of the same tribe

2SA 19:11–19:12 See also NUM 8:26

To Israelites

DEU 3:18 See also DEU 10:9, DEU 17:15; JDG 20:23; 2SA 19:41; 1CH 13:2; JER 7:15

To descendants of a common ancestor

NUM 20:14 See also DEU 2:4, DEU 23:7

To equals and fellow-citizens

LEV 19:17 See also DEU 1:16, DEU 15:3, DEU 22:1, DEU 23:19; 2SA 2:26; MAT 5:22–5:24, MAT 7:3–7:5 parallel LUK 6:41–6:42

Love for God must exceed love for brothers

LUK 14:26 See also DEU 33:9; MAT 19:29 parallels MRK 10:29–10:30, LUK 18:29–18:30

Jesus Christ calls his disciples his ``brothers''

MAT 12:49–12:50 parallels MRK 3:34–3:35, LUK 8:21 See also MAT 25:34–25:40, MAT 28:10; JHN 20:17; HEB 2:11

The fraternal relationship among God's people

Fellow Christians called brothers

MAT 23:8 See also ACT 15:23, ACT 28:14; 1CO 5:11; 2CO 1:1, 2CO 9:3, 2CO 11:9, 2CO 12:18; 2TH 2:13; PHM 1:1

Believers urged to love each other

1TH 4:10 See also ROM 12:10; JAS 2:14–2:17; 1PE 2:17; 2PE 1:5–1:9

The church referred to as ``the brothers''

ACT 14:2 See also ACT 9:30, ACT 11:1, ACT 11:29, ACT 15:3, ACT 16:2, ACT 17:14, ACT 21:17

Brother as an honorific term

Equals called ``brothers``

GEN 29:4 See also 1SA 30:22–30:23; 2SA 1:26, 2SA 20:9; 1KI 13:29–13:30; ACT 1:16, ACT 2:37, ACT 3:17, ACT 7:2, ACT 22:1, ACT 28:17

Fellow Christians called ``brothers``

1CO 1:10 See also ACT 9:17, ACT 22:13; ROM 8:12, ROM 11:25; 1CO 2:1, 1CO 7:24; 2CO 8:1; GAL 4:31; 1TH 2:14; HEB 3:1; JAS 1:16, JAS 5:10

5662: certificate of divorce

A certificate of divorce was required under Mosaic law

MRK 10:4 parallel MAT 19:7 The certificate provided a divorced wife with some legal protection and permitted her to remarry. See also DEU 24:1–24:4; HOS 2:2 These words may have been adapted from a divorce bill; MAT 5:31

God gave his unfaithful people a certificate of divorce

JER 3:8 See also ISA 50:1 Unlike Israel, Judah had been given no certificate of divorce. The exile is thus portrayed as only a temporary separation.

5663: childbirth

Seen by Scripture as a token of God's favour, and used figuratively to picture a number of central biblical themes.

Childbirth in the OT

Childbirth as a blessing

GEN 1:28 See also DEU 7:14; PSA 127:3–127:5

Childlessness a cause of shame in Israel

GEN 30:1 See also 1SA 1:6, 1SA 1:10–1:11; LUK 1:24–1:25

The nature of human childbirth

The pain of childbirth a consequence of the fall

GEN 3:16

The need for ceremonial purification after childbirth

See also LEV 12:1–12:8 Under the old covenant, unsanctioned contact with blood was ceremonially defiling; LUK 2:24

The role of midwives in childbirth

EXO 1:15–1:21

The joy of childbirth

GEN 21:6; ; JHN 16:21

Childbirth and salvation

The birth of a Saviour

GEN 3:15 Although childbirth is a focus of judgment, through it the human race continues, and the Messiah comes into the world. See also GEN 12:2–12:3, GEN 15:3–15:6; ISA 7:14, ISA 9:6–9:7; MAT 1:18–1:25; LUK 1:35, LUK 2:4–2:7; GAL 3:16, GAL 4:4; REV 12:5

Salvation in childbearing

1TI 2:15 A Christian mother fulfils her calling in childbearing; some take it to mean she will be kept safe in childbirth. Some, however, take this verse as a reference to Ge 3:15, and the coming of Jesus Christ, as above.

Childbirth used figuratively

To describe weakness and vulnerability

See also EZK 16:4–16:6

To describe weakness under judgment

2KI 19:3 parallel ISA 37:3 See also PSA 48:6; ISA 23:4, ISA 26:17–26:18; JER 4:31; HOS 2:3, HOS 13:13; MIC 4:10

To describe troubles prior to God's final triumph

MAT 24:7–24:8 parallel MRK 13:8 See also ROM 8:22

To describe love and compassion

ISA 49:15

To describe regeneration

JHN 3:6–3:7 See also JHN 1:12–1:13; JAS 1:18; 1PE 1:23

To describe pastoral concern

GAL 4:19

To describe the disciples' joy

JHN 16:21–16:22

To describe triumph and salvation

ISA 54:1 See also GAL 4:27; ISA 26:19, ISA 66:7–66:11

God's sovereignty in childbirth

All children are God's gift

PSA 127:3

God controls the events of childbirth

GEN 25:22–25:23; ; PSA 139:13, PSA 139:16

Childbirth in old age

GEN 17:16–17:19; ; LUK 1:5–1:13, LUK 1:18–1:20, LUK 1:23–1:25

Childbirth as an answer to prayer

GEN 25:21; ; 1SA 1:20; ; LUK 1:13

Childbirth for the barren woman

PSA 113:9 See also GEN 25:21; JDG 13:2–13:5; 1SA 2:5; ISA 54:1

Jesus Christ born of a virgin

ISA 7:14 See also MAT 1:22–1:23, MAT 1:18; LUK 1:30–1:31, LUK 1:34–1:37 “impossible” births demonstrate God’s power and grace and show that salvation comes from the Lord.

5664: children

Scripture indicates that children are a gift from God and are to be loved, disciplined and cared for. The term “children of God” is used to describe Christian believers, who must grow up in the faith which they have accepted.

5665: children, attitudes towards

Christians must welcome children as Jesus Christ did. They are used by Christ as an example of how believers should receive the kingdom, and as an example of immaturity by Paul.

Children as a gift from God

PSA 113:9, PSA 127:3 See also GEN 33:5, GEN 48:9; JOS 24:3

Jesus Christ welcomes children

MAT 19:13–19:14 parallels MRK 10:13–10:16, LUK 18:15–18:17

Those who enter the kingdom must be like children**God’s truth is revealed to the childlike**

MAT 11:25 parallel LUK 10:21 See also 1CO 1:26–1:29

Children as people welcomed by Jesus Christ

MAT 18:2–18:5 parallels MRK 9:36–9:37, LUK 9:47–9:48 See also MAT 10:40–10:42 parallel MRK 9:41; MAT 18:10, MAT 18:14

Children as a picture of immature Christians

1CO 14:20; 1PE 2:2–2:3 See also 1CO 13:11; HEB 5:13

Promises to children

DEU 5:16; ACT 2:39 See also PRO 8:32; EPH 6:2–6:3

Warnings relating to children**Warnings to those who cause children to stumble**

MAT 18:6 parallel MRK 9:42

Warnings to Israel, the disobedient child

ISA 30:1 See also ISA 30:9

5666: children, needs of

Children need love, affection, discipline and guidance from their parents. This is shown through teaching,

training, discipline, the meeting of material needs and the provision of a personal example of faith.

Teaching children

DEU 6:6–6:7 See also EXO 10:2, EXO 12:26–12:27, EXO 13:14–13:15; DEU 4:9, DEU 6:20–6:21, DEU 11:19; PRO 1:8; ISA 38:19; JOL 1:3

Training children

PRO 22:6; EPH 6:4 See also DEU 31:12–31:13; JOS 8:35; 2KI 12:2; PSA 34:11, PSA 78:5; PRO 3:1

Disciplining children

PRO 13:24; HEB 12:7–12:11 See also PRO 19:18, PRO 22:15, PRO 23:13, PRO 29:15, PRO 29:17; 1TI 3:4, 1TI 3:12

Lack of discipline

1SA 3:13; ; 1KI 1:6

Good examples set for children by parents

David: 1KI 9:4; ; 2CH 17:3; 2CH 26:4 Amaziah; 2TI 1:5, 2TI 3:15

Bad examples set for children by parents

Ahab and Jezebel: 1KI 22:52; ; 2CH 22:3; ; JER 9:14; MAT 14:8 Herodias

Provision and care for children

MAT 7:9–7:11 parallel LUK 11:11–11:13 See also 1SA 2:19; PRO 31:15, PRO 31:21; 2CO 12:14

Love for children

TIT 2:4 See also GEN 37:3 Jacob’s special love for Joseph; GEN 44:20, GEN 44:29–44:31 2SA 18:33 David’s love for Absalom; LUK 15:20 the father’s love for the prodigal son

5667: children, responsibilities to God

The responsibilities of children to God as their heavenly Father include honouring and obeying him.

The responsibilities of children to their heavenly Father**To honour and obey him in reverent fear**

PSA 34:11 See also PRO 2:5, PRO 9:10

To seek wisdom

PRO 4:5–4:7 See also PRO 1:1–1:4, PRO 8:32–8:33, PRO 10:1

To listen and learn

PRO 1:8–1:9 See also PRO 4:1–4:4, PRO 23:22

To praise God

PSA 8:2 See also MAT 21:15–21:16

To join in worship**NEH 12:43** See also JOS 8:35**Relationship to Jesus Christ transcends the child-parent relationship****LUK 18:29–18:30** parallels MAT 19:29, MRK 10:29–10:30**5668: children, responsibilities to parents**

Children owe their parents certain important responsibilities, including the duty to honour and obey them.

The duties of children towards their parents**They are to honour their parents****EXO 20:12** parallel DEU 5:16 See also PRO 17:6; MRK 7:10; EPH 6:1–6:3**They are to obey their parents****COL 3:20–3:21** See also EPH 6:1**They are to behave well****PRO 20:11****Children as a blessing and source of joy to their parents****PSA 127:4–127:5; PRO 23:24** See also PSA 128:3; PRO 15:20, PRO 27:11, PRO 29:3; LUK 15:23–15:24**Children born to barren mothers bring special joy**

Sarah: GEN 18:11, GEN 21:2; GEN 29:31, GEN 30:22; JDG 13:2, JDG 13:24; 1SA 1:5, 1SA 1:20; LUK 1:7, LUK 1:24, LUK 1:57

Children as a source of grief and disappointment to their parents**PRO 17:25** See also 1SA 8:3; PRO 17:21, PRO 19:13, PRO 19:26, PRO 28:7, PRO 29:15**The punishment of children****The punishment of wicked children**

EXO 21:15; ; LEV 20:9; ; DEU 21:18–21:21; ; PRO 30:17; ; 2TI 3:2

The punishment of children for the sins of their fathers

EXO 20:5–20:6; ; NUM 14:18; ; JER 31:29–31:30 Jeremiah here stresses the importance of individual responsibility in the present crisis without denying the notion of corporate responsibility; ; JER 32:18

5669: children, examples of

In Scripture specific children are marked out as belonging to the Lord. Mention of others is made in association with miracles or notable situations.

The child Jesus Christ**MAT 1:23** See also MAT 2:11; LUK 2:34, LUK 2:49–2:51**Other notable children**

EXO 2:7–2:8 Moses; ; JDG 11:36 Jephthah's daughter; 1SA 2:18, 1SA 2:26; 1SA 16:11, 1SA 17:33, 1SA 17:41–17:42; 2KI 5:2 the young girl who helped Naaman; ; LUK 1:80 John the Baptist; ; 2TI 3:15 Timothy

Children in the miracles of Jesus Christ

Jairus' daughter: MAT 9:18 parallels MRK 5:22–5:23, LUK 8:41–8:42; ; MAT 9:23–9:25 parallels MRK 5:38–5:43, LUK 8:49–8:55; ; MAT 15:21–15:28 parallel MRK 7:24–7:30 Canaanite woman's daughter; ; MAT 17:14–17:18 parallels MRK 9:17–9:27, LUK 9:38–9:43 boy with epilepsy; ; LUK 7:11–7:15 widow's son at Nain; ; JHN 4:46–4:52 official's son at Capernaum; JHN 6:9 the boy who gave his lunch to help feed the crowd

5671: clan

A social unit, larger than a family but smaller than a tribe.

Membership of a clan**JDG 6:15** See also LEV 25:10; JOS 7:14–7:18; RUT 2:1; 1SA 9:21, 1SA 10:17–10:21, 1SA 18:18**Marriage and the clan****JDG 12:9** See also GEN 24:34–24:41; NUM 36:1–36:12**Inheritance within the clan****NUM 27:8–27:11****The responsibility of the clan for protection and revenge****LEV 25:47–25:49** See also RUT 3:7–3:12, RUT 4:1–4:12; 2SA 14:5–14:7**The clans of Israel listed**

NUM 26:1–26:61

The land allocated to the clans

JOS 13:15–13:33, JOS 15:1–19:48

Non-Israelite clans**GEN 10:5** See also GEN 10:15–10:20, GEN 10:31–10:32, GEN 36:40–36:43**5672: concubines**

A woman, often a servant or slave, with whom a man had regular sexual relations, but to whom he was not married. A concubine did not have the rights of a wife and her children were not rightful heirs, though a wife might offer a servant to her husband as a concubine to have children on her behalf.

Concubines and wives

Concubines were distinguished from wives

1KI 11:3 Having concubines alongside wives was accepted in a polygamous society. See also JDG 8:30–8:31; 2SA 5:13, 2SA 19:5; 2CH 11:21; DAN 5:2–5:3

Concubines were sometimes called wives

GEN 16:3 Hagar was Abraham's "wife" only in a secondary sense. See also GEN 25:1 Keturah was one of Abraham's concubines; JDG 19:1–19:4

Concubines did not have the rights of a wife

GEN 21:8–21:14 They were more easily dismissed; ; EXO 21:7–21:11 They did have some legal protection.

Maidservants were given as concubines

GEN 30:3–30:6 Bilhah's sons would be regarded by Rachel as her own and would thus share the inheritance with Jacob's other sons. See also GEN 30:9, GEN 16:1–16:2; GAL 4:22–4:23

The tension between concubines and wives

GEN 16:4–16:6 Though Abraham's concubine, Hagar's status was still that of servant. See also GEN 21:9; PRO 30:23; GAL 4:29

Children born to concubines were not rightful heirs

GEN 21:10–21:12 See also GEN 25:5–25:6; JDG 9:18; ROM 9:7; GAL 4:30; HEB 11:18

Concubines were a symbol of possession

By taking Jacob's concubine, Reuben laid premature claim to his father's estate

GEN 35:22 See also GEN 49:3–49:4; 1CH 5:1

Taking the concubine(s) of a king was tantamount to laying claim to the kingdom

2SA 3:7 Abner is accused here of trying to usurp Ish-Bosheth's inheritance. See also 2SA 12:8, 2SA 16:21–16:22; 1KI 2:21–2:22

Further examples of concubines

GEN 22:23–22:24 Nahor's concubine, Reumah; ; GEN 36:12 Eliphaz' concubine, Timna; ; JDG 19:1 a Levite's concubine; ; 2SA 15:16 David's concubines; ; 1CH 1:32 Abraham's concubine, Keturah; ; 1CH 2:46–2:48 Caleb's concubines, Ephah and Maacah; ; 1CH 7:14 Manasseh's concubine; ; EST 2:14 Xerxes' concubines; ; DAN 5:23 Belshazzar's concubines

5673: cousins

Marriage to cousins

NUM 36:11 See also 1CH 23:22

Family responsibilities undertaken by cousins where there were no closer relatives

EST 2:7 See also LEV 25:47–25:49; JER 32:6–32:12

Cousins mentioned in Scripture

COL 4:10 See also LEV 10:4

5674: daughters

The female offspring of parents. Daughters lived in their father's house, under his protection, until marriage. Usually they became his heirs only if he had no sons to inherit his estate. Normally they shared in the inheritance of their husbands.

Protection of daughters

Fathers were responsible for protecting their daughters

GEN 31:50 See also GEN 19:12–19:13, GEN 19:15–19:17; NUM 30:3–30:5

Examples of fathers who failed to protect their daughters

GEN 19:8 See also JDG 19:24; 2SA 13:6–13:14

Marriage of daughters

Fathers were responsible for arranging marriages for their daughters

GEN 34:8–34:9 See also GEN 29:26; JOS 15:16–15:17 parallel JDG 1:12–1:13; JDG 12:9, JDG 21:1; 1SA 18:17–18:21, 1SA 25:44

Fathers received a bride-price from their daughters' husbands

1SA 18:25 See also GEN 29:16–29:27

Fathers gave a dowry to their daughters

1KI 9:16 See also JOS 15:17–15:19 parallel JDG 1:13–1:15

Sometimes the marriage of a daughter was the basis of a political alliance

1KI 3:1 See also DAN 11:6, DAN 11:17

In cases of dispute, parents were expected to prove their daughter's virginity

DEU 22:13–22:21

Inheritance of daughters

If a man had no sons, the inheritance went to his daughters

NUM 27:1–27:11 See also JOS 17:3–17:6

Daughters who inherited their father's property were obliged to marry within his clan

NUM 36:1–36:12

Job allocated his daughters an inheritance
JOB 42:13–42:15

Priests' daughters

LEV 10:14 See also LEV 21:1–21:2, LEV 21:9, LEV 22:12–22:13; NUM 18:11, NUM 18:19; EZK 44:25

Slavery of daughters

In dire circumstances fathers sometimes sold their daughters into slavery
NEH 5:5 See also EXO 21:7

A slave girl married to a son was to be accorded the rights of a daughter
EXO 21:9

Immorality of daughters

Prostitution of daughters forbidden
LEV 19:29 See also LEV 21:9

Incest of Lot's daughters
GEN 19:30–19:38

Daughters-in-law

Sexual relations with daughters-in-law forbidden
LEV 18:15 See also LEV 20:12; EZK 22:11

Examples of daughters-in-law
RUT 4:14–4:15 See also GEN 38:6–38:26; RUT 1:3–1:17

Daughters in a spiritual role
ACT 21:9 See also JOL 2:28; ACT 2:17

An adopted daughter
EST 2:7

Daughter in a non-literal sense

Of an area, town or country or its population
MAT 21:5 parallel JHN 12:15 See also 2KI 19:21; PSA 137:8; ISA 10:30, ISA 23:12, ISA 52:2; JER 6:23, JER 48:18, JER 51:33; LAM 1:15, LAM 2:10; MIC 4:8; ZEP 3:14; ZEC 2:7, ZEC 9:9

Of the female inhabitants of an area, town or country
LUK 23:27–23:29 See also GEN 24:3, GEN 24:13; 2SA 1:24; SNG 3:5, SNG 5:8; ISA 32:9–32:11; EZK 13:17, EZK 32:18

Of the female descendants
LUK 13:16 See also 1PE 3:5–3:6

As an honorific term
MAT 9:22 parallels MRK 5:34, LUK 8:48

Daughters in a theological sense

God's people are his sons and daughters
2CO 6:18 See also JER 14:17, JER 31:21–31:22

Family relationships must be subservient to one's relationship with God
MAT 10:37 See also MAT 10:35 parallel LUK 12:53

5675: divorce

The legal dissolution of a marriage. Though not part of God's original intention for marriage, divorce is permitted under certain circumstances, especially marital unfaithfulness. In general, properly divorced parties are free to remarry.

5676: divorce, in OT

Usually initiated by the husband who issued his wife with a certificate of divorce and sent her from his home, divorce broke the marriage bond and allowed parties to remarry. It was not part of God's original purpose for marriage, and is permitted only because of human sinfulness. God is depicted as taking divorce proceedings against adulterous Israel.

The nature of divorce

Divorce dissolves a marriage

MRK 10:4 parallel MAT 19:7 The certificate of divorce was a legal document ending the marriage. See also LEV 22:12–22:13 Divorce ends the restrictions on a priest's daughter which were the result of her marriage; NUM 30:9 Following divorce a husband is no longer responsible for his wife; DEU 24:1–24:2 Divorce properly entered into allows the parties to remarry; HOS 2:2; MAT 5:31

Divorce was not God's original intention

MAL 2:10–2:16 God's displeasure at those of his people who divorced their Jewish wives to marry foreigners, thus breaking faith with their partners and with God; **MAT 19:4–19:8** parallel MRK 10:5–10:9 The Law of Moses did not command divorce, but regulated an existing practice, particularly to protect the wife. See also GEN 1:27, GEN 2:24

Circumstances permitting divorce

Displeasure

DEU 24:1 See also DEU 21:13–21:14; MAT 19:3

Returning exiles were required to divorce their foreign wives

EZR 10:10–10:11 See also EZR 10:2–10:3

Circumstances where divorce was not allowed

DEU 22:13–22:19 where a husband makes false accusations about his wife's virginity; DEU 22:28–22:29 where the marriage is contracted following the rape of a virgin

Restrictions on remarriage after divorce

Former partners who marry others

DEU 24:3–24:4 See also JER 3:1

Priests could not marry divorcees

LEV 21:7, LEV 21:14; ; EZK 44:22

The divorce between God and Israel

It was due to Israel's unfaithfulness

JER 3:6–3:10 See also ISA 50:1; JER 31:32

God's desire for reconciliation

ISA 54:4–54:8 See also ISA 62:4–62:5; EZK 16:60–16:63; HOS 2:14–2:16

5677: divorce, amongst believers

Jesus Christ challenged the liberal approach to divorce taken by some rabbis of his day, and upheld the idea of marriage as a lifelong commitment. Remarriage after divorce is generally classed as adultery and, where possible, divorced parties should seek reconciliation. There are circumstances, however, where remarriage is permissible.

The liberal attitude to divorce

MAT 19:3 See also DEU 21:14, DEU 24:1

The undesirability of divorce

God's plan for marriage

MAT 19:4–19:6 parallel MRK 10:6–10:9 See also GEN 1:27, GEN 2:24; MAL 2:15; EPH 5:31

Divorce is permitted because of human sinfulness

MAT 19:8 parallel MRK 10:5

Christians should not seek divorce

1CO 7:10 This command, echoing Jesus Christ's words, applies where both parties are believers. See also 1CO 7:12–7:14

Remarriage after divorce

Believers should seek reconciliation

1CO 7:11 See also DEU 24:2–24:4 Marriage to another after divorce prevents reconciliation.

Remarriage after divorce is classed as adultery

LUK 16:18 parallel MRK 10:11–10:12 This is a general rule, though there may be exceptions (see below). See also ROM 7:2–7:3; 1CO 7:39

Remarriage may be permissible

1CO 7:27–7:28 “unmarried” means literally “freed from a wife” and thus may be applied to those widowed or properly divorced. It is no sin for them to (re)marry.

Possible grounds for divorce and remarriage

MAT 19:9; 1CO 7:15 See also JER 3:8 God divorced Israel because of her adultery; MAT 1:18–1:19, MAT 5:32

5679: dowry

A present given by a woman's father on her marriage. At betrothal the bridegroom gave a compensatory gift, known as the bride-price, to the woman's family.

The bride-price

EXO 22:16–22:17 See also GEN 34:12

Usually it consisted of payment in kind

GEN 24:53 See also GEN 29:16–29:28, GEN 31:41; 1SA 18:25; 2SA 3:14

The dowry given by the bride's father

1KI 9:16 See also GEN 24:59–24:61, GEN 29:24, GEN 29:29; JDG 1:14–1:15

5680: family

People who are linked by marriage or physical descent. The western idea of a “nuclear” family represents a narrow definition of the scope of the family. The ancient Near East had a broader and more extended understanding of family, which is often reflected in the Scriptural material.

5681: family, nature of

A unit ordained by God for the comfort and protection of its members. It is usually a group of relatives, but the people of God are also seen as a family.

The scope of the family in Scripture

The family unit

GEN 43:7 See also EXO 1:1, EXO 12:3; JDG 11:2; 1SA 1:21, 1SA 27:3; 2SA 2:3; 1KI 17:15; 1CH 13:14 The family of Obed-Edom is blessed by the presence of the ark; PRO 27:27, PRO 31:15 The wife of noble character provides for her family; MRK 3:21; LUK 12:52; ACT 16:33–16:34 The Philippian jailer and his family are baptised; 1TI 5:8

The extended family or clan

GEN 24:37–24:38 See also GEN 24:40, GEN 46:27, GEN 50:22; NUM 2:2, NUM 18:1 the priesthood of Aaron and his family; DEU 25:5 Levirate marriage provides for the continuity of the family; JOS 2:17–2:18, JOS 6:23, JOS 6:25; 1SA 22:22; 1KI 14:14; 2KI 11:1 parallel 2CH 22:10 Athaliah destroys the royal family of Judah; EZR 10:16; JER 35:3, JER 38:17; DAN 1:3

The descendants of any individual

JHN 7:42 See also DEU 25:10; JOS 13:29; 1SA 2:31–2:32, 1SA 2:36, 1SA 3:11–3:13; DAN 11:7

The people of God

HEB 2:10–2:15 See also PSA 22:22; AMO 3:1; GAL 6:10; 1PE 4:17

Marriage obligations and restrictions within the family

Marriage within the wider family circle was preferable in early times

JDG 14:3 See also GEN 24:1–24:9, GEN 24:37, GEN 24:40, GEN 27:46–28:2, GEN 28:6–28:9; EXO 2:1

Incestuous marriage was forbidden

LEV 18:6–18:18 See also LEV 20:17, LEV 20:19–20:21; DEU 27:20–27:23; MAT 14:3 parallel MRK 6:17; 1CO 5:1–5:5

The obligation to marry the widow of a dead brother

DEU 25:5–25:10 See also GEN 38:8–38:10; RUT 2:19–2:20, RUT 4:1–4:10; MAT 22:23–22:32 parallels MRK 12:18–12:27, LUK 20:27–20:38

Laws of inheritance kept property within the family

NUM 27:1–27:11 See also LEV 25:25–25:28; JOB 42:13–42:15

Examples of family solidarity

GEN 14:8–14:16 Abraham and Lot; ; 2SA 18:31–18:33 David and Absalom; ; RUT 1:11–1:18 Naomi and Ruth; ; NEH 4:13; ; ACT 23:12–23:24; ; 1TI 5:3–5:4 Family solidarity is encouraged.

5682: family, significance of

God created the family and is deeply concerned for its welfare. Scripture uses family metaphors to describe the relationship between God and his people.

God created the family

PSA 68:6 See also GEN 1:26–1:27, GEN 2:23–2:24

God cares for the families of those who honour him

GEN 7:1 See also GEN 6:18 parallel DEU 5:8–5:10; 2SA 6:11; JER 35:18–35:19, JER 38:17–38:18

God judges families who disobey him

EXO 20:4–20:5 See also NUM 16:23–16:32; DEU 11:6; JOS 7:24–7:26; 1SA 3:12–3:14; 2SA 24:17

Families in Israel**The extended family was the basic social unit**

NEH 7:5 See also LEV 25:10, LEV 27:16; NUM 2:32, NUM 4:40

Family heads were community leaders

NUM 36:1 See also NUM 1:4, NUM 31:26; 1KI 8:1; 2CH 1:2

Families had religious obligations

DEU 12:7 See also EXO 12:22–12:23; DEU 12:11–12:12; 1SA 1:21

Families were to teach their children God's law

PSA 78:5–78:7 See also GEN 18:19; EXO 12:26–12:27; DEU 4:9, DEU 6:6–6:7; PRO 1:8–1:9

The relationship between God and his people described in family metaphors**They are his family**

GAL 6:10 See also AMO 3:1; EPH 3:15; 1PE 4:17

They are his children

JHN 1:12–1:13 See also DEU 14:1; ISA 63:16; HOS 11:1–11:4; ROM 8:15–8:17; GAL 4:4–4:7; EPH 1:5

They are brothers and sisters in God's family

HEB 2:11 See also PSA 22:22; ISA 8:17–8:18; MAT 12:50 parallel LUK 8:21; MRK 3:31–3:34; HEB 2:12–2:17

The salvation of families

ACT 16:34 See also ACT 11:14, ACT 18:8; 1CO 1:16

Good family management as a qualification for church office

1TI 3:4–3:5 See also 1TI 3:12

Christians are to support their families

1TI 5:8 See also 1TI 5:4

The urgent demands of the kingdom of God should take priority over family responsibilities

LUK 9:59–9:60 parallel MAT 8:21–8:22 See also MRK 3:31–3:34; LUK 9:61–9:62; MAT 10:34–10:38 parallel LUK 12:51–12:53; MIC 7:6

5684: fathers

The male parent of children. Scripture indicates the role and responsibilities of fathers, and shows how God can be thought of as a loving father, who directs and guides his children.

5685: fathers, responsibilities of

Fathers have a responsibility to love, instruct and discipline their children in the ways of the Lord. In return they are to be honoured and obeyed by their children.

The role of fathers**To love and care for their children**

PSA 103:13 See also DEU 1:31; JOB 1:4–1:5; MAT 7:9–7:11 parallel LUK 11:11–11:13; COL 3:21

To discipline their children

PRO 13:24 See also DEU 8:5, DEU 21:18–21:21; PRO 3:11–3:12, PRO 15:5, PRO 19:18, PRO 22:15, PRO 23:13, PRO 29:15; 1TI 3:2–3:5, 1TI 3:12; HEB 12:7–12:11

To instruct their children

PSA 78:2–78:8 See also DEU 4:9, DEU 6:6–6:7, DEU 6:20–6:24, DEU 11:18–11:21, DEU 31:13; PRO 13:1, PRO 22:6; EPH 6:4

The rights of fathers**To be honoured by their children**

EXO 20:12 parallel DEU 5:16 See also LEV 19:3; MAT 15:4 parallel MRK 7:10; EXO 21:17; MAT 19:17–19:19 parallels MRK 10:18–10:19, LUK 18:19–18:20; EPH 6:2–6:3

To be obeyed by their children

COL 3:20 See also DEU 21:18–21:21; PRO 6:20, PRO 8:32; LUK 2:51; EPH 6:1

To be heeded by their children

PRO 23:22 See also PRO 1:8, PRO 4:1, PRO 4:10, PRO 13:1

The joy of fathers

PRO 23:24 See also PSA 127:3–127:5, PSA 128:3–128:4; PRO 10:1, PRO 28:7, PRO 29:3

The sorrow of fathers

PRO 17:21 See also PRO 10:1, PRO 17:25, PRO 19:13

The roles of fathers-in-law

GEN 29:21–29:23, GEN 31:39–31:42; ; EXO 3:1, EXO 18:14–18:27; ; JDG 19:3–19:9; ; 1SA 4:19–4:21; ; JHN 18:13

Children's responsibility to honour their parents

EXO 20:12 parallel DEU 5:16 “Honour” implies respect, obedience and care for the parents’ needs. See also LEV 19:3; MAT 19:19 parallels MRK 10:19, LUK 18:20; EPH 6:1–6:3

Penalties for disobeying parents

EXO 21:15, EXO 21:17; ; DEU 21:18–21:21; ; PRO 20:20; ; MAT 15:4–15:6; ; MRK 7:10–7:13

The ministry of Jesus Christ may produce conflict within families

LUK 12:53 parallel MAT 10:35–10:36

Following Jesus Christ involves a commitment to him even deeper than love of one's parents

MAT 10:37 See also LUK 14:26

5686: fathers, examples of

The ideal father, from a biblical perspective, is one who loves God, is obedient to him and reflects this in

his daily living and in the care and upbringing of his children.

Fathers who followed divine principles within their families**Abraham**

GEN 18:19 See also GEN 17:1–17:7, GEN 17:18–17:20, GEN 21:1–21:5, GEN 21:8–21:13, GEN 22:1–22:18

Zechariah

LUK 1:5–1:20 See also LUK 1:62–1:80

The father of the prodigal

LUK 15:11–15:31

Fathers who acted wrongly**Through favouritism**

GEN 37:3–37:4 See also GEN 25:28

Through lack of discipline

1SA 2:22–2:25 See also 1SA 2:27–2:36, 1SA 3:11–3:18

The intercession of fathers for their children**Abraham**

GEN 17:18–17:22

David

1CH 29:10–29:19 See also 2SA 12:15–12:23

Job

JOB 1:4–1:5

The father of the demoniac

MAT 17:14–17:15 parallels MRK 9:17–9:18, LUK 9:38–9:39

The royal official

JHN 4:46–4:49

5688: firstborn

The firstborn male in a family; as in many cultures, in an Israelite family the eldest son had unique privileges, including the right of inheritance. The title “firstborn” was therefore a title of honour.

The privileges of the firstborn**The place of honour in the family**

GEN 10:15 In this and other lists, the firstborn is specially noted; **GEN 43:33** See also GEN 22:21, GEN 25:13, GEN 35:23, GEN 36:15, GEN 46:8; DEU 33:17

The right of inheritance

DEU 21:15–21:17; ; 2CH 21:3

The right to a blessing

GEN 27:19, GEN 27:30–27:39

The sin of despising these privileges

GEN 25:31–25:34 See also HEB 12:16–12:17

These privileges could be transferred

GEN 48:14 See also GEN 48:18–48:19, GEN 49:3–49:4; 1CH 2:3, 1CH 5:1–5:2, 1CH 26:10

The death of the firstborn a great tragedy

EXO 4:23 See also EXO 11:4–11:6, EXO 12:12, EXO 12:29; NUM 33:4; JOS 6:26; 1KI 16:34; PSA 78:51, PSA 105:36, PSA 135:8, PSA 136:10; HEB 11:28

Repentance likened to grief over the death of a firstborn

ZEC 12:10

God's claim upon the firstborn**In ancient times**

GEN 4:4 See also GEN 22:1–22:2, GEN 22:12

After the exodus

EXO 13:1–13:2 See also EXO 13:11–13:15, EXO 22:29, EXO 34:19–34:20; NUM 18:15, NUM 18:17; DEU 14:23, DEU 15:19; NEH 10:36

The Levites consecrated in place of the firstborn

NUM 3:11–3:13, NUM 3:39–3:51, NUM 8:15–8:18

The offering of a firstborn insufficient to redeem from the consequences of sin

MIC 6:7

Heathen sacrifice of the firstborn

2CH 28:3; ; EZK 20:26

Jesus Christ the ``firstborn''**The firstborn of Mary**

LUK 2:7, LUK 2:22–2:23

The firstborn of God

ROM 8:29 “firstborn” here means that Jesus Christ is above creation, rather than part of it. The title “first-born” has strong Messianic associations; **COL 1:15**; **HEB 1:6**

The ``firstborn from the dead''

COL 1:18 See also REV 1:5

God's people honoured as his ``firstborn''**Israel**

EXO 4:22

David

See also PSA 89:27 prophetic of Jesus Christ

Ephraim

JER 31:9

The church

HEB 12:23

5689: friendlessness

The bitter experience of the absence of friendship, leading to a sense of isolation and despair. It is often blamed on the faithlessness of others or even on God himself.

The experience of friendlessness**The darkness of being alone**

PSA 88:18 See also PSA 88:8, PSA 102:7, PSA 142:4

Contempt and rejection

PSA 31:11–31:12 See also PSA 38:11

Hatred and loathing

JOB 19:13–19:19 See also JOB 30:10

Slander and conspiracy

PSA 31:13 See also JER 20:10

Examples of friendlessness**Elijah**

1KI 19:10

Jesus Christ

MRK 14:50 See also ISA 53:3; MAT 26:56; JHN 16:32

The prodigal son

LUK 15:16

The lame man at the pool of Bethesda

JHN 5:7

Paul

2TI 4:16 See also 2TI 4:10–4:11

The undesirability of friendlessness

GEN 2:18; **ECC 4:9–4:12**

Cultivating true friends is the way to avoid friendlessness

ISA 18:1; **PSA 119:63** See also LUK 16:19

5690: friends

Those to whom one is close. Scripture stresses that friendship is often but not always a positive thing: where good friends can be invaluable in the life of faith, bad friends can be obstacles to the faith of believers, or even lead them astray totally.

5691: friends, good

Those whose commitment from the heart is shown in practical, often sacrificial, care, love and service. They are a source of encouragement, sympathy, comfort and support in time of need. Such relationships are to be cultivated, especially among believers.

Examples of good friends

David and Jonathan

ISA 18:1–18:3 See also ISA 20:17, ISA 20:42; 2SA 1:26

Job's friends

JOB 2:11

Ruth and Naomi

RUT 1:16–1:17

Paul's friends in ministry

ROM 16:3–16:5 See also 2CO 2:12–2:13 Titus; PHP 2:25 Epaphroditus; COL 4:7 Tychicus; COL 4:14 Luke; 2TI 1:2–1:4 Timothy; PHM 1:1 Philemon

Other examples

1SA 22:23 David and Abiathar; ; 2SA 10:2 David and Nahash; ; 2SA 15:19–15:21 David and Ittai; ; 2SA 15:32–15:37 David and Hushai; ; 1KI 5:1 David and Hiram; ; 2KI 2:2 Elijah and Elisha; ; 2KI 10:15 Jehonadab and Jehu; ; MRK 2:3–2:4 the friends who brought the paralysed man to Jesus Christ

The benefits brought by good friends

Comfort and sympathy

JOB 2:11–2:13 See also PRO 17:17

Support and encouragement

ISA 23:16–23:17; PRO 18:24; ECC 4:9–4:10 See also PRO 27:10; ECC 4:11–4:12; AMO 3:3; MAT 27:55–27:56, MAT 28:1; ROM 1:11–1:12

Sacrificial service

JHN 15:13 See also ROM 5:7

Shared joy and sorrow

LUK 15:5; ; ROM 12:15

Loving rebuke

PRO 27:6, PRO 27:9; ; EPH 4:15

Encouragement in good works

ROM 14:13; ; HEB 10:24

Challenge

PRO 27:17

Good friendship among believers

Unity in the love and fear of the LORD

PSA 119:63 See also MAL 3:16; PHP 4:1

Worshipping together

PSA 55:13–55:14, PSA 133:1; ; ACT 2:42–2:43, ACT 2:46–2:47

Sharing possessions

ACT 2:44–2:45, ACT 4:32–4:35, ACT 11:29

Serving together

GAL 2:8–2:9; ; PHP 1:3–1:5

Praying for one another

JOB 42:10; ; 2TH 1:11–1:12; ; JAS 5:16

Living peaceably

ROM 12:18; ; PHP 4:2–4:3

Covering sins

PRO 10:12, PRO 16:28, PRO 17:9 A friend does not stir up trouble by spreading details of wrongs suffered, but rather seeks reconciliation; ; 1CO 13:6; ; 1PE 4:8

Restoring from sin

GAL 6:1–6:2; ; JAS 5:19–5:20

Jesus Christ is the friend of sinners

MAT 11:19 parallel LUK 7:34

5692: friends, bad

Those who are close or who exercise influence, who prove to be unreliable or deceptive or who lead astray. Scripture provides numerous instructive examples of the negative effects of bad friends upon believers.

Friends who lead astray

From worship

DEU 13:6–13:8 See also DEU 23:6; 1KI 11:2

From good character

1CO 15:33 See also PRO 12:26, PRO 22:24–22:25

From friendship with God

JAS 4:4 See also ISA 52:11; JER 9:4–9:5; MIC 7:5; 2CO 6:14–6:18, 2CO 7:1

Friends who are unreliable

In their commitment

JOB 6:14–6:17

In their trustworthiness

PSA 41:9 See also PSA 38:11, PSA 55:20–55:21; OBA 1:7; MAT 26:14–26:15; JHN 13:18 Jesus Christ is speaking about his betrayal by Judas.

In their support

2TI 4:16 See also 2TI 4:10

Examples of bad friends

Those who lead astray

GEN 3:12 See also 1KI 12:8–12:11; EST 5:14

Those who are inconstant

JOB 19:19 Presumably these friends are not merely the ones who attempted to comfort him. See also MAT 26:31, MAT 26:33–26:34; 2TI 4:10, 2TI 4:16

5694: generation

The population as a whole at any one time, or the interval of time separating parents and children.

All the contemporaries of an individual

GEN 7:1 See also EXO 1:6; JDG 2:10; PSA 24:6, PSA 78:8, PSA 112:2; JER 2:31, JER 7:29; MAT 11:16 parallel LUK 7:31; MAT 24:32–24:34 parallels MRK 13:28–13:30, LUK 21:29–21:32; ACT 2:40, ACT 13:36; PHP 2:14–2:16

The everlasting kingdom of God

LAM 5:19 See also PSA 72:5, PSA 145:13; DAN 4:3; EPH 3:20–3:21

The passing of time expressed in terms of generations

EXO 3:15 See also GEN 9:12, GEN 17:12; EXO 12:17, EXO 20:5 parallel DEU 5:9 the enduring consequences of rebellion; EXO 31:16; LEV 6:18, LEV 23:41; NUM 15:38, NUM 35:29; DEU 29:22; JOS 22:27; EST 9:28; PSA 72:5 traditionally taken as referring to the Messiah; PSA 105:8; ISA 34:10; JER 50:39; LUK 1:46–1:50

Past generations

ISA 51:9 See also DEU 32:7; JOB 8:8; ISA 41:4, ISA 61:4; EPH 3:4–3:5; COL 1:25–1:26

The requirement to teach the next generation

DEU 4:9 See also DEU 6:6–6:7, DEU 32:7; PSA 22:30, PSA 71:18, PSA 78:1–78:8, PSA 79:13

Time references by specific numbers of generations

MAT 1:17 See also EXO 34:6–34:7; NUM 14:18; DEU 7:9, DEU 23:2–23:3, DEU 23:7–23:8; 2KI 10:30, 2KI 15:12; 1CH 16:15; JOB 42:16

The generation that died in the wilderness

NUM 32:13 See also DEU 1:34–1:36, DEU 2:14, DEU 32:5, DEU 32:20; HEB 3:7–3:11; PSA 95:7–95:11

Jesus Christ's comments concerning his own wicked generation

MRK 8:38 See also MAT 12:39–12:42 parallel LUK 11:29–11:32; MAT 12:43–12:45, MAT 16:4 parallel MRK 8:12; MAT 17:17 parallels MRK 9:19, LUK 9:41; MAT 23:33–23:36; LUK 11:47–11:51, LUK 17:22–17:25

5695: girls

Scripture provides insights into, and examples of, the way in which girls have a place in the purposes of God. Although the OT tends to portray girls mainly as potential wives or sexual partners, Jesus Christ's

raising of Jairus' daughter can be seen as a symbol of the positive value placed on them.

The portrayal of girls in the OT

As potential wives

JDG 21:21–21:25 See also GEN 24:12–24:51; JDG 11:29–11:40; ISA 18:17–18:27

As sexual partners

JDG 19:24 This way of treating girls as mere sexual objects illustrates the moral corruption of the men of Gibeah. Though not condemned in this passage, such behaviour was totally contrary to OT law. See also GEN 19:1–19:8, GEN 34:1–34:4

Chaste girls were to be protected but promiscuous girls were to be punished

DEU 22:13–22:21

Girls undertaking various kinds of work

As slaves or servants

EXO 21:7–21:9 See also RUT 2:8–2:9; 1KI 1:1–1:4; ACT 12:13–12:14

Drawing water and tending animals

EXO 2:16 See also GEN 24:15–24:20; ISA 9:11

Repairing the walls of Jerusalem

NEH 3:12

In domestic service

ISA 8:13

The place of girls in serving the purposes of God

Girls receive ministry from Jesus Christ and the apostles

MRK 5:35–5:43 parallels MAT 9:23–9:25, LUK 8:49–8:56 See also MAT 15:21–15:28 parallel MRK 7:24–7:30; ACT 16:16–16:18

Girls receive and use spiritual gifts

ACT 2:16–2:17 See also JOL 2:28; ACT 21:8–21:9

Examples of girls serving the purposes of God

2KI 5:2–5:6 The example of this servant girl, instrumental in Naaman's healing, shows that girls have a value and a status before God not generally acknowledged in OT culture; ; EST 2:1–2:18 Having become queen under the providence of God, Esther, chosen while a young virgin, is later able to use her influence to save the Jews from fierce persecution; ; LUK 1:26–1:33 Mary should be regarded as a girl, as she is a virgin betrothed and not a woman married.

5696: grandchildren

Grandchildren mentioned in Scripture

Terah's grandson, Lot
GEN 11:31

Nahor's grandchildren
GEN 29:5 See also GEN 24:47–24:48

Laban's grandchildren
GEN 31:55 See also GEN 31:26–31:28

Zibeon the Hivite's granddaughter, Oholibamah
GEN 36:2 See also GEN 36:14

Esau's grandchildren
GEN 36:12–36:13 See also GEN 36:16–36:17

Jacob's grandchildren
GEN 46:7 See also GEN 45:10

Gideon's grandson
JDG 8:22

Abdon's grandsons
JDG 12:13–12:14

Saul's grandson, Mephibosheth
2SA 19:24 See also 2SA 9:9–9:10, 2SA 16:3

Omri's granddaughter, Athaliah
2KI 8:26 parallel 2CH 22:2

The grandsons of the sons of Ulam
1CH 8:40

Nebuchadnezzar's grandson
JER 27:6–27:7

Grandchildren as representative of descendants
EXO 10:1–10:2 See also DEU 4:25–4:26; 2KI 17:41

Believing grandchildren have a responsibility to care for their grandparents
1TI 5:4

5697: grandparents

Grandparents mentioned in Scripture

Saul, the grandfather of Mephibosheth
2SA 9:7 See also 2SA 16:3, 2SA 19:26–19:28

Maacah, the grandmother of Asa
1KI 15:9–15:10 See also 1KI 15:13 parallel 2CH 15:16

Lois, the grandmother of Timothy
2TI 1:5

Believers have a responsibility to support their grandparents
1TI 5:4

5698: guardian

Human guardianship

Responsibility for people
GAL 4:2 See also RUT 3:9–3:13; 2KI 10:1; 1CO 4:14–4:15

Responsibility for other things
GEN 1:28 See also GEN 9:5, GEN 9:12; LEV 25:23; PSA 8:6–8:8

God's guardianship of people

He loves and cares
JER 31:3 See also PSA 103:13–103:14, PSA 139:14; MAT 6:32; LUK 12:7; EPH 2:4–2:5; 1PE 5:7

He defends and protects
PSA 125:2 See also 2CH 32:8; PSA 41:2, PSA 57:1; ISA 25:4; MAT 23:37; JHN 17:11; 2TH 3:3; 1PE 1:5

He teaches and guides
PSA 25:9 See also DEU 1:33, DEU 8:2; PSA 139:10; PRO 3:5–3:6; ISA 30:21, ISA 42:16; JHN 16:13

He keeps and provides
PSA 23:1 See also GEN 28:15; DEU 8:18; PSA 121:4; MAL 3:10; 1TI 6:17; 2TI 1:12; JUD 1:24

God's guardianship of other things

He is guardian of his word
MAT 24:35 See also DEU 29:29; MAT 5:18; MRK 13:32

He is guardian of the world
PSA 24:1 See also PSA 33:6–33:7, PSA 50:10, PSA 89:9, PSA 93:1

Christians are guardians of God's truth

2TH 2:15 See also DEU 6:6–6:7; GAL 2:11; EPH 4:1, EPH 4:3; PHP 1:27; 1TH 2:12

Angelic guardianship

PSA 91:11–91:12 See also GEN 3:24; EXO 14:19; JDG 2:1; 2KI 6:17; PSA 34:7; ISA 63:9; ACT 8:26, ACT 12:15, ACT 27:23; GAL 3:19

5699: guests

People who receive hospitality, especially at others' homes. Guests are often invited to special celebrations such as weddings or birthdays. God invites all people as guests at his feast but many refuse.

Occasions for inviting guests

Weddings

GEN 29:21–29:22 See also EST 2:17–2:18; JHN 2:1–2:10

Birthday celebrations

GEN 40:20; ; MAT 14:6 parallel MRK 6:21–6:22; ; MAT 14:9 parallel MRK 6:26

Other special occasions

1SA 9:22–9:24; ; 1KI 1:41, 1KI 1:49; ; EST 1:8

Receiving guests

Receiving Jesus Christ as a guest

LUK 19:7 See also MAT 9:10 parallels MRK 2:15, LUK 5:29; MAT 26:6–26:7 parallels MRK 14:3, JHN 12:1–12:3; LUK 7:36, LUK 7:49, LUK 10:38, LUK 14:1, LUK 24:29; JHN 2:2; REV 3:20

God's people give hospitality

ACT 10:32 See also 2KI 4:8–4:10; MAT 10:11 parallels MRK 6:10, LUK 9:4; LUK 10:33–10:37; ACT 16:34, ACT 21:8, ACT 28:7

Customs associated with receiving guests

Anointing them with oil

PSA 23:5 Anointing with oil was a customary treatment for honoured guests. See also PSA 92:10; LUK 7:46; JHN 12:3

Washing their feet

GEN 18:4–18:5 See also GEN 19:2, GEN 24:32, GEN 43:24; 1SA 25:41; LUK 7:44; JHN 13:1–13:17 It was usually the slave's duty to wash away dirt accumulated in travelling.

Guests treated badly

JDG 19:20–19:23; ; 2SA 15:11; ; JER 41:1–41:2; ; LUK 7:44–7:46

Guests rejecting their hosts

1KI 1:49; ; JOB 19:15

Advice given to guests

Do not promote yourself

PRO 25:6–25:7 See also LUK 14:7–14:11

Do not criticise the food

1CO 10:27 See also LUK 10:7

Do not outstay your welcome

PRO 25:17

God invites people to be his guests

REV 19:9 See also ISA 55:1; MAT 11:28; JHN 7:37; REV 22:17

Some refuse God's invitation

LUK 14:24 See also MAT 22:1–22:7; LUK 14:16–14:20

Some accept God's invitation

MAT 22:8–22:10 See also MAT 9:15 parallels MRK 2:19, LUK 5:34; LUK 14:21–14:23

Guest rooms

MRK 14:14 parallels MAT 26:18, LUK 22:11; ; PHM 1:22

5700: headship

The quality of being in a position of leadership or guidance. Headship has to do with God's relation to this created world, and to his ordering of relationships within it. Headship among human beings does not necessarily signify superior status, but rather a role of leadership and care. Scripture sees it as involving servanthood, and views Jesus Christ as the supreme model of this.

God as head over all things

1CH 29:11 See also ISA 45:23; DAN 4:34–4:35; ROM 9:14–9:21; 1CO 15:24–15:28

Headship within the Godhead

The Father's eternal headship

1CO 11:3 See also 1CO 15:24–15:28; PHP 2:6

The Father's headship in the Son's earthly life and ministry

JHN 6:38 See also MAT 26:39 parallels MRK 14:36, LUK 22:42; PHP 2:6–2:8; HEB 5:7–5:8

Jesus Christ as head of all creation

Head of the created order

COL 1:15–1:17 The description of Jesus Christ as the firstborn does not imply he is part of creation, but rather stresses his rights of inheritance over it. See also HEB 1:2–1:4

Head of all earthly and spiritual powers

EPH 1:20–1:22 See also COL 1:15–1:18, COL 2:10; HEB 2:8

Head of the church

EPH 4:15–4:16 See also EPH 5:23; COL 1:18, COL 2:19

Head over all things at the end

EPH 1:9–1:10 See also 1CO 15:25–15:27; REV 19:11–19:16

Delegated headship in God's world

Headship of humanity over creation

GEN 1:28 See also PSA 8:1–8:9; HEB 2:5–2:8

Headship of rulers over their nations

PSA 18:43 See also ISA 15:17; ISA 7:8–7:9; DAN 2:31–2:38; ROM 13:1–13:6; 1PE 2:13–2:14

Headship of chiefs over their tribes and families

JOS 22:13–22:14 See also NUM 1:1–1:16; JDG 10:17–11:11; 1CH 5:15

Headship of the husband over his wife

EPH 5:22–5:24 See also 1CO 11:3–11:16 Women, including wives, were told to cover their heads when praying or prophesying in public as an acknowledgment, apparently, that headship attaches to males; COL 3:18; 1PE 3:1–3:6

Headship of leaders over the people of God

1TH 5:12 See also 1SA 24:1–24:7; ISA 3:1–3:7 The removal of headship and leadership is seen as a mark of God's judgment; HEB 13:17

Humility, love and respect are to be the framework for delegated headship

1PE 5:1–5:3 See also EPH 5:21, EPH 5:25–5:30

5701: heir

Property and power in biblical times normally descended from father to son. Jesus Christ is therefore called God's heir, and believers are said to inherit in him.

The heir in ancient Israel**The heir of property**

GEN 15:3–15:4 See also PRO 13:22, PRO 19:14

The heir of power

1KI 2:12 parallel 1CH 29:28 See also 1KI 11:43, 1KI 14:31, 1KI 15:3

Lack of an heir regarded as a very serious matter

DEU 25:5–25:6; ; JDG 21:17; ; 2SA 14:4–14:7 The woman of Tekoa was interceding indirectly for Absalom, David's heir, who had been banished.

Daughters and other relatives could be heirs if there were no sons

NUM 27:1–27:11

Property could be inherited before death

LUK 15:11–15:12 The prodigal son's request of inheritance before death could perhaps be regarded as an insult, but graciously the father complied out of love.

An heir must not give up his inheritance

HEB 12:16 See also GEN 25:29–25:34; NUM 36:6–36:7; 1KI 21:3; JER 49:1

The firstborn son was heir to a double share

DEU 21:17

Jesus Christ as the heir of God

HEB 1:2 See also MAT 28:18; LUK 19:12; JHN 3:35

Jesus Christ is heir as the Father's firstborn

HEB 1:6

Envy of Jesus Christ as heir

MAT 21:37–21:39 parallels MRK 12:6–12:8, LUK 20:13–20:15

God's people as heirs**God himself as his people's inheritance**

JOS 18:7; ; PSA 73:26, PSA 119:57, PSA 142:5; ; JER 51:19

Israel as heirs to land

EXO 32:13 See also PSA 105:44

Noah, heir of righteousness

HEB 11:7

Abraham, heir of promise

GEN 17:4–17:8; ; LUK 1:54–1:55; ; HEB 11:8–11:9

David, heir of a kingdom

2SA 7:8–7:16

Israel, heirs of the prophets

ACT 3:25; ; ROM 3:2

All believers are heirs by faith

GAL 3:29 See also ROM 4:13–4:17

Heirs under the covenant

HEB 6:17 See also HEB 9:15

Heirs through God's grace

GAL 3:18 See also COL 1:12

Co-heirs with Jesus Christ

ROM 8:17

The privileges of God's heirs**Believers are heirs to the full rights of sons**

See also GAL 4:1–4:7

Believers are heirs as the firstborn

HEB 12:23

Believers are heirs of salvation

HEB 1:14

Believers are heirs of eternal life

TIT 3:7; ; 1PE 1:3–1:4

Believers are heirs of the earth

MAT 5:5; ; PSA 37:11

Believers are heirs of the kingdom

MAT 25:34

Believers are heirs of all things

1CO 3:21–3:22; ; 2CO 6:10; ; REV 21:7

Believers are heirs of life

1PE 3:7

Believers as heirs share Jesus Christ's throne

LUK 22:29–22:30; ; REV 3:21

God's inheritance is his people

DEU 32:9; ; ZEC 2:12

5702: husband

The male partner in a marriage relationship. The origin of this God-ordained institution is traced back in the Bible to the Garden of Eden. Scripture stresses that marriage is a God-ordained institution, within which the husband is pledged to love and care for his wife. Scripture contains many examples, both good and bad, of how husbands behaved. The ultimate examples of a good husband in Scripture are God as the husband of Israel and Jesus Christ as the bridegroom of the church.

God's pattern for marriage**Husband and wife are one flesh**

GEN 1:27 See also GEN 2:23–2:24; MAL 2:15; MAT 19:4–19:6 parallel MRK 10:6–10:9

The husband is head of the wife

EPH 5:23 See also 1CO 11:3

Duties of a husband**To leave his parents and be united to his wife**

MAT 19:5 parallel MRK 10:7–10:8 See also GEN 2:24

To love his wife

EPH 5:25 See also DEU 24:5; PRO 5:18; ECC 9:9; EPH 5:28–5:33; COL 3:19; 1PE 3:7

To fulfil his marital duty

1CO 7:3–7:5 See also EXO 21:10–21:11

To be faithful to his wife

EXO 20:14 parallel DEU 5:18 See also LEV 20:10; DEU 22:22; MAL 2:14; MAT 5:27–5:28; 1CO 7:14–7:16

Adam, the first husband

GEN 2:20–2:24

Behaviour which is commended in husbands

1SA 1:3–1:8 See also GEN 24:67; GEN 29:20; RUT 3:7–4:11; EST 5:1–5:3; HOS 3:1–3:3; MAT 1:18–1:25

Behaviour which is condemned in husbands

2SA 12:7–12:10 See also GEN 29:30–29:31; GEN 38:8–38:10; JDG 19:16–19:29; MAL 2:13–2:16

God as a husband

ISA 54:5 See also JER 3:14; JER 31:32; EZK 16:8

Jesus Christ as a bridegroom

EPH 5:25–5:27 See also MAT 9:14–9:15 parallels MRK 2:18–2:20; LUK 5:33–5:35; 2CO 11:2; REV 21:2

5703: inheritance

A birthright or endowment, often in the form of goods or land, passed down from one generation to another. Scripture treats eternal life and other privileges of faith as an inheritance from God.

5704: inheritance, material

Family property was normally handed down in biblical times through sons, with a special place for the first-born. The land of Israel was regarded as the nation's inheritance.

Inheritance of family property**It was normally handed down through sons**

GEN 15:3–15:4 See also GEN 25:5; JER 49:1; EZK 46:16–46:17; MAT 21:38 parallels MRK 12:7; LUK 20:14; GAL 4:30; GEN 21:10

The absence of a son as a male heir was seen as a serious disadvantage

GEN 25:21; ; DEU 25:5–25:6; ; JDG 21:17; ; 1SA 1:10–1:11; ; 2SA 14:4–14:7

Other relatives could inherit

NUM 27:8–27:11 See also NUM 27:1–27:7; NUM 36:2–36:4; RUT 4:1–4:4; JOB 42:15

Servants could inherit

GEN 15:2–15:3

Inheritance before death

LUK 15:11–15:12 The son's asking for his inheritance is perhaps to be seen as an insult.

The rights of the firstborn

DEU 21:15–21:17 See also GEN 27:19; GEN 27:32; 2CH 21:3

Stewardship of one's own inheritance**It must be preserved**

1KI 21:2–21:3 See also PRO 13:22

It must not be squandered

HEB 12:16 See also GEN 25:29–25:34; LUK 15:13

It must not be fought over

LUK 12:13–12:15

Respect for the inheritance of others

MIC 2:2–2:3 See also EZK 46:18

The land as Israel's inheritance

It was promised to Abraham

GEN 12:6–12:7 See also GEN 13:14–13:15, GEN 15:7, GEN 15:18–15:21, GEN 17:8; ACT 7:3–7:5; HEB 11:8

It was confirmed to Moses and the patriarchs

EXO 6:2–6:4, EXO 6:8

Entry was denied because of sin

NUM 14:22–14:23; ; DEU 4:21

It was entered by faith

HEB 11:8–11:9, HEB 11:30

It was conquered by Joshua

JOS 1:1–1:4, JOS 11:23

It was allotted to the tribes

JOS 14:1–14:5

It was a land for the godly

PSA 37:9, PSA 37:11, PSA 37:22, PSA 37:29, PSA 37:34

It was a good inheritance

EXO 3:8 See also LEV 20:24; NUM 13:21–13:27; DEU 8:7–8:8, DEU 11:10–11:12; PSA 65:9–65:10; JER 2:7

The LORD's inheritance in the land

EXO 15:17; ; JOS 22:19; ; ZEC 2:12

The inheritance was lost through sin

JER 17:4 See also PSA 79:1; LAM 5:2

God's judgment on the nations

JER 12:14–12:17

The land was regained through grace

EZR 1:1–1:2; ; JER 29:10–29:11

God renewed his promises

PSA 69:34–69:36 The Jews did return to the land; some look, however, for a further fulfilment of these promises in the future; others see them as fulfilled in Jesus Christ. See also ISA 57:13, ISA 58:13–58:14, ISA 61:7, ISA 65:9; ZEC 8:12

5705: inheritance, spiritual

Believers are privileged to receive a spiritual inheritance from their heavenly Father as a result of their adoption into the family of God through faith.

Believers have an inheritance in Christ

Jesus Christ as God's heir

HEB 1:2 See also MAT 21:37–21:39 parallels MRK 12:6–12:8, LUK 20:13–20:15; MAT 28:18; LUK 19:12; JHN 3:35; HEB 1:4–1:6; PSA 2:7–2:8

Believers are co-heirs with Christ

ROM 8:17 See also EPH 3:6

Believers are heirs under the covenant

HEB 6:17, HEB 9:15

Believers are heirs by grace

GAL 3:18 See also ACT 20:32; COL 1:12

Believers are heirs through faith

GAL 3:29 See also ROM 4:13–4:17; HEB 11:7–11:10

The nature of the spiritual inheritance of believers

They inherit salvation

HEB 1:14

They inherit eternal life

See also MAT 19:29; LUK 10:25; TIT 3:7; 1PE 3:7

They have the full rights of sons

GAL 4:4–4:7

They have the rights of the firstborn

HEB 12:22–12:23 See also EXO 4:22; 2KI 2:9

They inherit the earth

MAT 5:5 See also PSA 37:11

They inherit the kingdom

MAT 25:34 See also LUK 22:28–22:30; REV 3:21

They inherit all things

LUK 15:31; ; 1CO 3:21–3:22; ; REV 21:7

Their inheritance is the word of God

PSA 119:111

They inherit the Lord himself

PSA 73:26 See also NUM 18:20; DEU 10:9; PSA 142:5; JER 10:16, JER 51:19

It is a good inheritance

PSA 16:6

The permanence of believers' spiritual inheritance

It has been prepared from the creation

MAT 25:34

It is guaranteed for eternity

1PE 1:3–1:5 See also PSA 37:18; DAN 12:13

It is sealed with God's promise

EPH 1:13–1:14 See also REV 7:3, REV 9:4

The conditions of spiritual inheritance

It is conditional upon continuing obedience and faith

1PE 3:9–3:12 See also PSA 34:12–34:16, PSA 25:12–25:13, PSA 37:11, PSA 37:29, PSA 37:34, PSA 61:5; PRO 28:10; MAT 5:5; COL 3:24; HEB 6:12; JAS 2:5

It is denied to the ungodly

EPH 5:5 See also PSA 37:9, PSA 37:22; 1CO 6:9–6:10, 1CO 10:1–10:5; GAL 5:19–5:21; HEB 3:12–3:19; REV 21:27

5707: male and female

God created humanity as male and female. Although gender differences are evident in behaviour and role, Scripture teaches the equality and complementarity of the sexes.

The creation of male and female

GEN 1:27 See also GEN 2:20–2:24, GEN 5:2

The fall disrupted relationships between male and female

GEN 3:14–3:19 See also 2SA 13:1–13:19; PRO 5:3–5:14; MAT 5:28; ROM 1:26–1:27

The equality of male and female**Equality under many old covenant regulations**

NUM 5:5–5:7 See also LEV 20:10–20:12; NUM 5:1–5:4; DEU 15:12–15:15, DEU 23:17–23:18

Equality in religious observance

EXO 35:22 See also NUM 6:1–6:4; DEU 31:12; 2SA 6:19

Equality of accountability

LAM 2:21 See also LEV 20:27; 2CH 36:15–36:17; ACT 5:1–5:11

Equality in Christ

GAL 3:26–3:28 See also ACT 2:17–2:18; JOL 2:28–2:29; 1CO 11:11–11:12

Variations in the treatment of male and female**In OT patriarchal society**

LEV 27:1–27:7 See also GEN 17:9–17:14; EXO 13:1–13:2, EXO 13:14–13:15; NUM 3:14–3:15, NUM 5:11–5:31, NUM 18:8–18:10

In legislation protecting women under the old covenant

NUM 27:1–27:7 See also NUM 36:1–36:12; DEU 22:13–22:19, DEU 22:25–22:29

In roles within the NT church community

1CO 14:33–14:35 See also 1CO 11:3–11:10; EPH 5:22–5:24 The idea of “headship” is complex, but is generally regarded as including the ideas of responsibility and authority within a relationship; 1TI 2:11–2:15; TIT 2:1–2:5

In behaviour within the NT church community

1TI 2:8–2:10 See also 1CO 11:3–11:16; 1TI 5:1–5:2

Male and female roles within marriage

1CO 7:1–7:7 See also PRO 31:10–31:31; EPH 5:22–5:33; COL 3:18–3:19; 1PE 3:1–3:7

Male and female imagery used of God**Female imagery**

MAT 23:37 parallel LUK 13:34 See also PRO 8:1–8:11; ISA 66:12–66:13

Male imagery

PSA 47:2 See also EXO 15:3; PSA 23:1; MAT 6:6; LUK 11:11–11:13 parallel MAT 7:9–7:11

5708: marriage

The union of a man and a woman in a permanent relationship. Though a lifelong monogamous commitment is presented as the ideal, polygamous marriages were occasionally known in OT times and carried the same legal and moral rights and responsibilities. God's relationship with his people is described in terms of the marriage bond.

5709: marriage, purpose of

Marriage is part of God's intention for humanity from creation and forms the basis for the family which is the primary unit of society. Where marriage flourishes it blesses both the couple and the wider community.

Marriage is part of God's plan for the human race**From creation**

MAT 19:4 parallel MRK 10:6 See also GEN 1:27; 1CO 11:11–11:12 Man and woman are not independent of each other.

It is to provide companionship

GEN 2:18 See also GEN 2:20–2:22, GEN 3:12; PRO 31:10–31:12

It is to be a committed, exclusive relationship

GEN 2:23–2:24 See also MAT 19:5 parallel MRK 10:7–10:8; 1CO 7:2; EPH 5:31

It is a lifelong partnership

MAT 19:6 parallel MRK 10:9 See also ROM 7:2; 1CO 7:39

It is the intended context for raising children

MAL 2:15 See also 1CO 7:14

It will not exist in the life to come

MAT 22:30 parallels MRK 12:25, LUK 20:34–20:35; ; 1CO 7:29–7:31

Marriage as a covenant relationship

MAL 2:14 See also PRO 2:17; EZK 16:8

Sex and marriage

Sex belongs within marriage

1CO 7:9 See also GEN 29:21EXO 22:16–22:17; DEU 22:28–22:29 DEU 22:13–22:21 A woman was expected to be a virgin when she married.

The sexual relationship is exclusive

SNG 2:16 See also DEU 22:22–22:24 Marital unfaithfulness is condemned; PRO 5:15–5:19; 1CO 6:16, 1CO 7:3–7:5

Love and submission in marriage

Falling in love prior to marriage

GEN 29:20 See also GEN 34:3–34:4; 1SA 18:20

Husbands are to love their wives

EPH 5:25 See also GEN 24:67; 1SA 1:5; ECC 9:9; HOS 3:1; EPH 5:28–5:29, EPH 5:33; COL 3:19

Wives are to submit to their husbands

GEN 3:16; EPH 5:22–5:24 See also COL 3:18; TIT 2:4–2:5; 1PE 3:1–3:6

Celibacy as a calling from God

1CO 7:7–7:8 See also JER 16:2; MAT 19:10–19:12; 1CO 7:36–7:38 Whilst Paul commends the unmarried state, for those not so called it is no sin to marry; 1TI 5:11–5:14

5710: marriage, customs concerning

Marriage between two individuals united their families and involved the whole community. Parents, particularly fathers, took an active part in selecting partners for their children. There was often a long period of betrothal; wedding celebrations were usually elaborate and might last a week or more.

The choice of a marriage partner

Parents usually chose a suitable partner

GEN 38:6 See also GEN 24:2–24:4, GEN 21:21 Occasionally mothers made the wedding arrangements.

The wishes of the couple

GEN 24:57–24:58 Rebekah is consulted about her proposed marriage to Isaac. See also GEN 34:4, GEN 34:8–34:9; JDG 14:2; 1SA 18:20

The bride-price

Daughters were “given” by their fathers

GEN 29:28; ; EXO 2:21; ; 1SA 18:21

Fathers often received payment

GEN 29:18, GEN 34:12 See also GEN 29:30; EXO 22:16–22:17; DEU 22:28–22:29; 1SA 18:17, 1SA 18:27

Daughters were given as a reward

JDG 1:12–1:13 parallel JOS 15:16–15:17 See also 1SA 18:25

The exchange of wedding gifts

Gifts from the bridegroom’s family

GEN 24:53

Gifts from the bride’s father

Servants given to the bride as a dowry: GEN 24:59, GEN 29:24, GEN 29:29; JDG 1:14–1:15 parallel JOS 15:18–15:19; ; 1KI 9:16

The period of betrothal

Betrothal followed payment of the bride-price

2SA 3:14 See also GEN 29:19–29:20 Jacob worked for Laban during his period of betrothal to Rachel.

A betrothed couple were regarded as husband and wife

GEN 19:14; ; DEU 22:23–22:24 Unfaithfulness during the period of betrothal is treated as adultery; ; MAT 1:18–1:20 Divorce is required to break a betrothal.

Sexual relationships took place only after the wedding

GEN 29:21 JOL 1:8; ; LUK 1:27; MAT 1:25; ; 1CO 7:36–7:38

Soldiers and marriage

DEU 20:7 Engaged soldiers were to marry before going into battle; ; DEU 24:5 Recently married soldiers were exempted from military service for a year.

The wedding celebrations

The bride wore an elaborate dress and jewellery

EZK 16:9–16:13 An allegorical description of God dressing Jerusalem as a bride. See also PSA 45:13; ISA 61:10; JER 2:32; REV 21:2

Attendants on the bride and groom

PSA 45:14; JHN 3:29 See also JDG 14:11, JDG 14:20; MAT 9:15 parallels MRK 2:19, LUK 5:34; MAT 25:1–25:10

The wedding banquet

GEN 29:22; ; JDG 14:10; ; MAT 22:2; ; REV 19:9

Wedding festivities

PSA 78:63; ; ISA 62:5; ; JER 7:34, JER 33:11

The invitation to a wedding

MAT 22:3–22:4 Invited guests were called when the feast was ready.; MAT 22:5–22:7; ; LUK 14:18–14:21; MAT 22:11–22:12 Guests were expected to dress appropriately.

5711: marriage, restrictions concerning

The OT law forbade intermarriage with people who worshipped idols because it threatened the covenant relationship with God and his people. Marriage with close relations was also forbidden. Remarriage is

permissible following the death of a spouse and, in certain circumstances, following divorce.

Intermarriage with foreigners

Examples of marriages to foreigners

GEN 38:2, GEN 41:45; ; EXO 2:21; ; LEV 24:10; ; RUT 1:4; ; 1CH 2:34–2:35; ; EZR 10:18–10:44

Warnings against marrying foreigners

EXO 34:16 See also DEU 7:3–7:4; JOS 23:12–23:13

Intermarriage with foreigners led to idolatry

JDG 3:5–3:6; 1KI 11:1–11:8 Royal marriages to foreigners brought disastrous consequences. See also 1KI 16:31; MAL 2:11EZR 9:1–9:2, EZR 9:14, EZR 10:1–10:2; NEH 13:23–13:27

Parents sought to avoid their children marrying foreigners

NEH 10:30 See also GEN 24:3–24:4 Abraham seeks a bride for Isaac from among his own people. GEN 26:34–26:35, GEN 27:46 GEN 28:1–28:2 Isaac forbids Jacob to marry a Canaanite woman; JDG 14:3 Samson's parents encourage him to marry an Israelite.

Marriage to foreigners may be permissible

RUT 4:13 Boaz' marriage to Ruth the Moabitess was acceptable because Ruth embraced the Israelite faith. Restrictions were on the grounds of religion not of race.

Foreign wives were put aside after the exile

EZR 10:3 See also EZR 10:10–10:17

Marriages between Christians and unbelievers

Christians should not marry unbelievers

1CO 7:39; ; 2CO 6:14

Christians should not leave an unbelieving spouse

1CO 7:12–7:16

Restrictions on marriage to close relatives

Sexual relations with close relatives is forbidden

LEV 18:6–18:18 See also LEV 20:11–20:12, LEV 20:14, LEV 20:19–20:21; DEU 22:30; EZK 22:10–22:11; MAT 14:3–14:4 parallel MRK 6:17–6:18

Examples of marriage to close relatives

GEN 20:12 Abraham was married to his half-sister; ; 2SA 13:13 Tamar suggests marriage with her half-brother, Amnon.

Levirate marriage

The levirate law was instituted to preserve the dead father's name

DEU 25:5–25:10; RUT 4:10 Levirate marriage refers to the legal obligation of a brother-in-law to produce heirs for his dead brother by marrying his widow. When there was no brother-in-law responsibility fell to a near relative, also described as a “kinsman-redeemer”. See also GEN 38:8, GEN 38:11; RUT 1:11–1:13, RUT 3:9, RUT 4:5; MAT 22:24–22:26 parallels MRK 12:19–12:22, LUK 20:28–20:31

Unwillingness to fulfil the levirate law

GEN 38:9, GEN 38:14, GEN 38:26; ; RUT 4:6

Regulations governing seduction and rape

EXO 22:16; ; DEU 22:28–22:29

Remarriage

Widows are free to remarry

ROM 7:2–7:3 See also RUT 1:9; 1CO 7:8–7:9; 1TI 5:14

Remarriage after divorce may be adultery

LUK 16:18 parallels MAT 19:9, MRK 10:11–10:12 See also 1CO 7:10–7:11

Remarriage after divorce permissible in certain circumstances

DEU 24:1–24:4; ; MAT 5:32; ; 1CO 7:15, 1CO 7:27–7:28

5712: marriage, between God and his people

Marriage is used to describe the relationship between God and Israel in the OT and between Jesus Christ and the church in the NT. Contemplating marriage deepens understanding of God's love for his people; examining God's covenant love for his people similarly enriches an understanding of marriage.

God's marriage relationship with Israel

God's marriage covenant with Israel

EZK 16:8–16:14 The covenant at Sinai was seen as a form of marriage. See also JER 31:32; EZK 16:59–16:60

God as Israel's husband

ISA 54:5 See also HOS 2:7; JOL 1:8

Israel's early devotion

JER 2:2 See also EZK 16:43; HOS 2:15

The breakdown of God's marriage to Israel

Israel's adultery

JER 3:20 See also JER 2:32; EZK 16:32–16:34; HOS 1:2, HOS 9:1

Israel's alienation from God is likened to a divorce

HOS 2:2 Israel's unfaithfulness led to a form of divorce between God and his people. This was sometimes identified with the exile. See also ISA 50:1; JER 3:6–3:10

The renewal of God's marriage to Israel

God calls his bride to return

JER 3:12–3:14; HOS 3:1–3:3 See also ISA 54:6–54:8; HOS 2:14

The renewed relationship

ISA 62:4–62:5 See also JER 31:31–31:33; EZK 16:62; HOS 2:16; HOS 2:19–2:20

Jesus Christ's marriage relationship with the church

Jesus Christ's love as a model for marriage
EPH 5:25–5:33

Jesus Christ is described as a bridegroom

JHN 3:29 John the Baptist describes Jesus Christ as the bridegroom and himself as the best man. See also MAT 9:15 parallels MRK 2:19–2:20, LUK 5:34–5:35; MAT 22:2; MAT 25:1–25:13

The church as Christ's bride

2CO 11:2; REV 19:7–19:9 See also REV 21:2; REV 21:9–21:10; REV 22:17

5714: men

God created both men and women in his image and likeness. Scripture portrays men in both their strengths and weaknesses, their successes and failures. While noting that they are incomplete without women, and share equally in the privileges and tasks entrusted to them by God, men have nevertheless been given specific responsibilities by God.

The place of men

Men are equal with women in creation

GEN 1:27 See also GEN 5:2

Men are incomplete without women

GEN 2:18 See also GEN 2:21–2:25; 1CO 11:11–11:12

Absence of men in society seen as a curse

ISA 3:1–3:3 See also LAM 5:14; EZK 17:11–17:14

Men are equal with women in redemption

GAL 3:28 See also ACT 2:17–2:18; JOL 2:28–2:29

The role of men

As leaders in marriage and family life

EPH 5:22–5:24 See also 1CO 11:3; COL 3:18–3:21

As leaders in Israelite society and worship

NUM 1:16 See also EXO 34:23–34:24; NUM 3:10–3:15; DEU 1:9–1:15; 1SA 8:1; EZR 10:16–10:17

As leaders in the early church

1TI 3:2 See also ACT 6:2–6:6; 1TI 2:12 The role of teaching and exercising authority is here restricted to men. Interpretations vary as to whether Paul is reflecting cultural circumstance or establishing theological principle; 1TI 3:8

The character requirements of men

To be prayerful and godly

1TI 2:8 See also DAN 6:10–6:11; 1TI 4:7–4:8, 1TI 6:11–6:12

To be courageous

1CO 16:13 While courage can be exercised by all, it is identified here as a specifically male characteristic. See also ACT 4:13; ACT 27:21–27:25

To be determined and decisive

MAT 11:12 See also 1CH 12:38

To be humble

1PE 5:5 See also NUM 12:3; DAN 10:12; MAT 11:29

To love their wives

COL 3:19 See also PRO 5:15–5:19; EPH 5:25–5:33

To be good fathers to their children

EPH 6:4 See also GEN 37:3–37:4 Jacob's favouritism was the cause of resentment developing in the family; 1SA 3:12–3:13 Eli is rebuked for having failed to father his sons properly; COL 3:21

To exercise proper sexual restraint

1TH 4:3–4:7 That Paul is particularly thinking of men here seems apparent from the NIV footnote at verse 4. See also LEV 18:1–18:22; PRO 6:23–6:29; MAT 5:27–5:28; 1CO 5:1–5:2, 1CO 7:2–7:5

Examples of godly men

GEN 6:9 Noah; ; GEN 22:1–22:12 Abraham; ; EXO 32:30–32:32 Moses; ; 1SA 24:1–24:7 David; ; 2KI 18:1–18:7 Hezekiah; ; JOB 1:1–1:8 Job; ; DAN 6:10 Daniel; ; ACT 4:13–4:20 Peter and John; ; ACT 7:54–7:60 Stephen; ; HEB 11:4–11:28 OT heroes of faith; ; JAS 5:17–5:18 Elijah

Examples of godly men who had moments of failure

GEN 20:1–20:3 Abraham was deceitful; ; NUM 20:2–20:12 Moses and Aaron showed unbelief; ; 2SA 11:1–11:27 David committed adultery with Bathsheba and plotted Uriah's death; ; 1KI 19:1–19:5 Elijah became fearful and wanted to die; ; JON 1:1–1:3 Jonah ran from God's call on his life; ; MAT 26:69–26:75 parallels MRK 14:66–14:72, LUK 22:55–22:62, JHN 18:16–18:18, JHN 18:25–18:27

Peter denied Jesus Christ; ; ACT 16:36–16:40 Paul and Barnabas fell into sharp disagreement.

Examples of ungodly men

GEN 19:4–19:5 The ungodliness of the men of Sodom lay in sexual immorality; ; GEN 38:8–38:10 Onan's ungodliness lay in failing to fulfil his obligations to his brother's wife; ; NUM 16:1–16:35 Korah's ungodliness lay in rebellion against God's leaders; ; 1SA 2:12 Eli's sons' ungodliness lay in their abuse of the sacrifices; ; 1KI 16:29–16:33 Ahab's ungodliness lay in intermarriage and idolatry; ; 2KI 21:1–21:9 parallel 2CH 33:1–33:9 Manasseh's ungodliness lay in idolatry, divination and human sacrifice; ; MAT 2:16 Herod's ungodliness lay in the wholesale slaughter of infants; ; MAT 14:3–14:11 parallel MRK 6:17–6:28 Herod the tetrarch's ungodliness lay in immorality and murder; ; ACT 8:9–8:23 Simon's ungodliness lay in the practice of magic; ; JUD 1:4–1:19 The ungodliness of men in the church lay in their rejection of apostolic doctrine and lifestyle.

Examples of fearful men

GEN 26:7–26:9 Isaac's fear of the Philistines led him to lie; ; NUM 13:26–13:33 The spies' fear led them to give a bad report; ; 1SA 28:5–28:7 Saul's fear of the Philistines led him to enquire of a medium when the LORD did not answer him; ; 2SA 3:7–3:11 Ish-Bosheth's fear of his brother led him to stay silent concerning sin; ; JHN 19:4–19:16 parallels MAT 27:19–27:26, MRK 15:9–15:15, LUK 23:13–23:25 Pilate's fear of the crowd led him to condemn Jesus Christ, even though he knew he was innocent; ; ACT 24:24–24:25 Felix' fear arose from the message of the gospel.

Examples of weak men

LEV 26:36–26:39 Men who are disobedient to God will be weak; ; 1SA 3:12–3:13 Eli's weakness lay in failing to restrain his sons; ; 1KI 21:1–21:16 Ahab's weakness lay in his allowing his wife to rule his life and his kingdom.

5715: menstruation

A woman was considered ceremonially unclean during menstruation

LEV 15:19–15:23 See also LEV 12:1–12:5, LEV 15:25–15:30; ISA 30:22

Sexual intercourse during menstruation forbidden

LEV 18:19 See also LEV 20:18; EZK 18:5–18:6, EZK 22:10

The discomfort of menstruation

GEN 31:35

5716: middle age

The period between youth and old age. Middle age is marked by physical strength and experience and should bring maturity and stability. Many of God's servants began ministry in middle age, often after having been prepared in their youth. Middle age may also bring complacency and the temptation to leave the devotion and commitments of youth.

Middle age defined

Adulthood reckoned from age 20

NUM 1:2–1:3 See also EXO 30:14, EXO 38:26; NUM 26:2–26:41 **CH 23:24** See also 2CH 31:17; EZR 3:8

Full maturity reckoned from age 30

LUK 3:23 See also NUM 4:30, NUM 4:43

Characteristics of middle age

Physical strength

LEV 27:3–27:7 Strength is greatest between 20 and 60. See also NUM 1:45 Men served in the army from age 20; JOS 14:10 Caleb, in his prime at 40, is still strong at 85.

Growth in wisdom and experience

ECC 1:16 See also 1SA 17:33; 2SA 17:8; 2CH 17:131 **CH 22:5** See also 1CH 29:1; PRO 7:7

Maturity and stability

EPH 4:13–4:14 See also 1CO 2:6; HEB 5:11–5:14; JAS 1:4

The responsibilities of middle age

The need to be prepared for these responsibilities

PRO 22:6 See also PRO 4:1–4:4 Solomon passes on wisdom learned from his father. **LUK 1:80** 1SA 2:26; LUK 2:40

The need to train for service

NUM 8:24 The period from 25 to 30 (see Nu 4:3) may have been a period of apprenticeship. See also 1CH 23:27 In later years the apprenticeship may have started at 20; NUM 11:28

The start of service in middle age

NUM 4:3 See also ACT 7:23 Moses showed concern for his fellow Israelites at age 40; JOS 14:7 Caleb was 40 when he explored Canaan; 1SA 7:3–7:4 Samuel became judge over Israel in his thirties; LUK 3:3 John the Baptist began his public ministry at about 30; JHN 8:57 Jesus Christ had not achieved the status of wisdom and authority associated with old age in Israel; 1TI 3:1–3:13 The mention of families in the instructions to elders and deacons suggests that these leaders were of middle age.

Rulers coming to office in middle age

GEN 41:46 Joseph; ; 1SA 13:1 Saul; ; 2SA 5:4 David; ; 2SA 2:10 Ish-Bosheth; ; 2CH 12:13 parallel 1KI 14:21 Rehoboam; ; 2CH 20:31 Jehoshaphat

Temptations of middle age**Complacency**

2SA 11:1; ; ISA 32:9–32:11; ; AMO 6:1

Worldly distractions

2SA 11:4; ; 1KI 11:3–11:4; ; ECC 2:1–2:8; ; LUK 12:18–12:19

Turning from the commitment of youth

PRO 2:16–2:17; ; MAL 2:14

5717: monogamy

The practice of having and remaining faithful to only one marriage partner at one time. It is set out as God's ideal for human relationships; an ideal demonstrated in the use of the marriage bond to portray the relationship between God and his people.

Monogamy as God's original intention for marriage

GEN 2:22–2:24 See also MAL 2:15; MAT 19:4–19:6 parallel MRK 10:6–10:9; EPH 5:31

Monogamy is shown in God's relationship with his people**God's marriage with Israel**

EZK 16:8 See also ISA 54:5–54:8; JER 2:2–2:3; HOS 2:16–2:20; HOS 3:1; EPH 5:32–5:33

God's exclusive commitment to Israel

DEU 14:2; AMO 3:2 See also EXO 19:5–19:6; DEU 26:18; DEU 32:8; PSA 135:4

Monogamy in marriage**The commitment to a lifelong, loving companionship**

GEN 2:18; PRO 5:15–5:19 The satisfaction that may be found in marriage makes marital unfaithfulness and polygamy unnecessary. See also PRO 2:17; ECC 9:9; MAL 2:14

Polygamy undermines full commitment

DEU 21:15 Favouritism within polygamous relationships undermines the close companionship which should characterise marriage. See also GEN 29:30; 1SA 1:1–1:8; 2CH 11:21–11:22

Monogamy is implicit in teaching about divorce

MAT 19:9 parallel MRK 10:11 See also LUK 16:18

Monogamy is commanded

1CO 7:2–7:4 This is an implicit, but clear prohibition of polygamy; **1TI 3:12** Monogamy is obligatory in leaders. See also 1TI 3:2; TIT 1:6

5718: mothers

The female parent of children. The role and influence of mothers are frequently stressed in Scripture, and their care for children is used as a picture of God's care for his people.

5719: mothers, responsibilities of

The fundamental importance of motherhood is recognised throughout Scripture.

Motherhood and childbirth**God plans happiness for women in motherhood**
PSA 113:9**The need for a mother's cleansing after childbirth**

See also LEV 12:1–12:8; LUK 2:22–2:24

A mother's relationship with her children**A mother loves and cares for her children**

1TH 2:7 Paul's statement assumes that a mother's normal attitude towards her child is one of love and care. See also LUK 2:48

A mother's role as teacher

PRO 1:8 See also PRO 6:20; 2TI 1:5

The responsibility to discipline children

PRO 29:15

The joy or sorrow of parents at their children's conduct

PRO 10:1 See also PRO 23:25

The negative influence of some mothers upon their children

2CH 22:3 See also GEN 27:5–27:17; 1KI 22:52; MAT 14:6–14:8; MAT 20:20–20:22

Children's responsibility to honour their parents

EXO 20:12 parallel DEU 5:16 "Honour" implies respect, obedience and care for the parents' needs. See also LEV 19:3; MAT 19:19 parallels MRK 10:19; LUK 18:20; EPH 6:1–6:3

This honour is due especially to mothers in old age

PRO 23:22

Penalties for disobeying parents

EXO 21:15; EXO 21:17; ; DEU 21:18–21:21; ; PRO 20:20; ; MAT 15:4–15:6 parallel MRK 7:10–7:13

Sexual relations with one's mother or mother-in-law are forbidden

LEV 18:7; ; DEU 27:23

Upon marriage the mother-child relationship becomes secondary

GEN 2:24 See also MAT 19:5 parallel MRK 10:7; EPH 5:31

Care for a mother-in-law

RUT 2:11 See also MAT 8:14–8:15 parallels MRK 1:29–1:31, LUK 4:38

The ministry of Jesus Christ may produce conflict within families

LUK 12:53 parallel MAT 10:35–10:36

Following Jesus Christ involves a commitment to him even deeper than love of one's parents

MAT 10:37 See also LUK 14:26

Jesus Christ regards those who do God's will as his own family

MAT 12:49–12:50 parallels MRK 3:31–3:35, LUK 8:19–8:21
See also MAT 19:29 parallels MRK 10:29, LUK 18:29–18:30

5720: mothers, examples of

Examples are given in Scripture of notable mothers, mothers-in-law and grandmothers.

Eve, the mother of all the living

GEN 3:20 See also GEN 3:16

Hagar, the mother of Ishmael

GEN 16:1–16:4, GEN 16:15

Sarah, the mother of Isaac

GEN 21:1–21:3 See also GEN 17:15–17:19, GEN 18:10–18:14

Rebekah, mother of Esau and Jacob

GEN 25:21, GEN 25:24, GEN 27:5–27:17

Rachel, mother of Joseph and Benjamin

GEN 30:22–30:24, GEN 35:16–35:18

Jochebed, mother of Moses

EXO 2:1–2:2, EXO 6:20; ; HEB 11:23

Naomi, Ruth's mother-in-law

RUT 1:15, RUT 4:13–4:17

Hannah, mother of Samuel

1SA 1:2, 1SA 1:11, 1SA 1:20

Jezebel, who taught her sons to worship Baal rather than the LORD

1KI 22:52; ; 2KI 9:22

The Shunammite woman

2KI 4:16–4:22, 2KI 4:32–4:37

Elizabeth, mother of John the Baptist

LUK 1:5–1:7, LUK 1:13, LUK 1:24–1:25, LUK 1:57

Mary, mother of Jesus Christ

LUK 2:6–2:7 See also MAT 1:18; LUK 1:26–1:31, LUK 1:38, LUK 2:19; JHN 2:1–2:5, JHN 19:25–19:27; ACT 1:14

Herodias, a treacherous mother

MAT 14:8 parallel MRK 6:24–6:25

Rufus' mother, a mother to Paul

ROM 16:13

Lois and Eunice, a godly grandmother and a mother

2TI 1:5

5721: mothers, as a symbol

Motherhood is used in Scripture to illustrate the relationship between God and his people, to describe certain aspects of Israel and also to explain the difference between the two covenants.

God's tender care for his children is like a mother's

God's care like that of a mother bird
DEU 32:11; ; MAT 23:37 parallel LUK 13:34

God never forgets his children

ISA 49:15

Becoming a Christian is like birth

JHN 3:5–3:6

The believer trusts God as a weaned child trusts his or her mother

See also PSA 131:1–131:2; ISA 66:13

Israel pictured as a mother

EZK 16:44–16:45 See also ISA 50:1, ISA 54:1, ISA 66:7–66:13; EZK 16:3, EZK 19:2, EZK 19:10; HOS 2:2–2:13

Mothers as symbols of the old and new covenants

GAL 4:21–4:28

5723: nobles

People of high rank who therefore had great power and importance.

Nobles were of high rank

EST 1:14; PRO 25:6–25:7 See also JDG 5:25; 1KI 21:8, 1KI 21:11; 2KI 24:12; 2CH 23:20; NEH 4:14, NEH 4:19, NEH 7:5; EST 5:11; JER 27:20; LUK 19:12; 1CO 1:26

Nobles had great power and importance

DAN 5:1–5:3 See also JDG 5:13; 2SA 10:2–10:3 parallel 1CH 19:2–19:3; EST 1:3, EST 1:11, EST 1:16, EST 1:21, EST 2:18, EST 9:3; PSA 47:9; PRO 8:15–8:16; JER 14:3; JON 3:7

Nobles' abuse of their rank and power

NEH 5:6–5:7, NEH 5:12 See also NEH 3:5, NEH 13:17; EZK 34:2

God's judgment of nobles who abused their power

JOB 34:18–34:19 See also JOB 12:20–12:21; PSA 107:40, PSA 149:6–149:8; ISA 5:13–5:14, ISA 34:12; EZK 17:12; NAM 3:10

5724: offspring

Literally, physical descendants, and figuratively, the recipients of a spiritual inheritance.

Physical offspring**Offspring as physical descendants**

GEN 12:7 See also GEN 13:15–13:16; NUM 18:19; RUT 4:12; ISA 61:9

Offspring as a blessing to parents

PSA 127:3–127:5 See also GEN 21:6–21:7; DEU 7:14; LUK 1:41–1:45

Offspring as a blessing to others

GEN 28:14 See also GEN 22:17–22:18; 2SA 7:12–7:13 parallel 1CH 17:11–17:12; LUK 1:76–1:79

Absence of offspring seen as a sadness or curse

GEN 15:2–15:3 See also LEV 20:20; PSA 109:9; JER 22:30

Steps to be taken to provide offspring under the law

DEU 25:5–25:6 See also RUT 4:10, RUT 4:13; MAT 22:24 parallels MRK 12:19, LUK 20:28

Offspring as a result of God's special intervention

HEB 11:11 See also GEN 21:1–21:2, GEN 25:21; JDG 13:2–13:3; LUK 1:11–1:13; ROM 4:18–4:21

God's claim on the firstborn offspring

EXO 13:1–13:2 See also EXO 13:11–13:16, EXO 34:19–34:20; NUM 3:11–3:13, NUM 8:15–8:18; LUK 2:22–2:24

Offspring can inherit parents' blessing or punishment

EXO 20:5–20:6 parallel DEU 5:9–5:10 See also LEV 26:39; JER 22:28–22:30; HOS 9:15–9:17

The fate of the offspring of the wicked

JOB 27:13–27:14 See also PSA 37:28; ISA 14:20–14:22

Spiritual offspring**Human beings, the offspring of God through creation
ACT 17:26–17:29****The offspring of Abraham**

GAL 3:29 See also JHN 8:31–8:41; ROM 4:13–4:17, ROM 9:6–9:8

Believers, spiritual offspring through new birth

1PE 1:23 See also JHN 3:3–3:8; 1JN 3:9; REV 12:17

5725: old age

Living for a relatively long time was regarded as a blessing from God and the aged in society are to be respected. Advancing years can bring greater wisdom and in both the OT and NT elders are given authority and leadership. Old age brings physical weakness and Scripture recognises this but states God's ability to strengthen and sustain the aged.

5726: old age, attainment of

Attaining old age is regarded as a blessing from God, often as a reward for obedience. The physical weakness brought by old age is recognised; so too is God's ability to strengthen and sustain the aged. Old age is often accompanied by a growth in wisdom and discernment.

Life expectancy in the OT**Before the flood**

GEN 5:5, GEN 5:8, GEN 5:11, GEN 5:27 Methuselah died in the year of the flood; ; GEN 9:29

After the flood

GEN 6:3 See also GEN 11:10–11:25 Following the flood, the span of life gradually reduces; GEN 25:7–25:8 Abraham's death at 175 is considered "a good old age".

In later generations

PSA 90:10 See also 2SA 5:4–5:5, 2SA 19:34–19:35

Attaining old age is a blessing from God**Long life as a reward for obedience**

DEU 5:33 See also EXO 20:12 parallel DEU 5:16; DEU 4:40; PRO 3:1–3:2, PRO 16:31; ECC 8:13

Reaching old age is a mark of God's favour

GEN 15:15 See also GEN 24:1, GEN 35:29 Isaac; JDG 8:32 Gideon; 1CH 29:28 David, like Abraham and Gideon is described as dying at "a good old age"; 2CH 24:15 Jehoiada; JOB 42:17 Job

People reaching old age indicates God's blessing on society

ZEC 8:4 See also ISA 65:20

Seeing grandchildren is a sign of blessing

PRO 17:6 See also GEN 48:11, GEN 50:22–50:23; RUT 4:15; JOB 42:16; PSA 128:5–128:6; ISA 53:10

Failure to reach old age is a result of God's judgment

ISA 2:31–2:33

The disabilities of old age

Its frailties

PSA 71:9 See also GEN 27:1, GEN 48:10; 1KI 1:1, 1KI 15:23; ECC 12:2–12:7 an allegory portraying physical decline

The progressive inability to have children

GEN 18:11–18:13 See also GEN 17:17, GEN 37:3 Children born in old age were rare and therefore special; 2KI 4:14; LUK 1:18

The approach of death

GEN 27:2; ; 1KI 1:15; ; 1CH 23:1

God's provision for the aged

God strengthens and sustains them

ISA 46:4 See also DEU 34:7; JOS 14:10–14:11; JOB 5:26; PSA 92:14

God gives them children

GEN 21:7 Abraham and Sarah; ; 2KI 4:16–4:17 the Shunammite woman; ; LUK 1:36 Elizabeth

Wisdom and self-control should accompany old age

JOB 12:12 See also JOB 15:10; PRO 20:29; JHN 8:9; TIT 2:2

5727: old age, attitudes to

Old age is generally held in honour and the aged in society are to be respected. Because of the wisdom associated with their advancing years elders had an important role of authority and guidance in Israelite society and the NT speaks of the leadership of elders within the church.

Old age is to be held in honour

Respect for the aged

LEV 19:32; 1PE 5:5 See also JOB 29:8; PRO 16:31, PRO 20:29; 1TI 5:1

Respect for parents

LEV 19:3; PRO 23:22 See also EXO 20:12, EXO 21:17; LEV 20:9; DEU 27:16; PRO 30:17; MAT 15:4 parallel MRK 7:10; EPH 6:1–6:3; COL 3:20

Old age is associated with wisdom

Deferring to the wisdom of the aged

JOB 32:6–32:7 See also 1KI 12:6–12:8 parallel 2CH 10:6–10:8 Rehoboam rejected the advice of elders and rebellion ensued; JOB 12:12, JOB 15:10; PHM 1:9 Paul refers to his age to add authority to his words.

Learning from the previous generation

PSA 71:18 See also JOB 8:8; PSA 37:25–37:26

Old age does not necessarily bring superior wisdom

ECC 4:13 See also JOB 32:9; PSA 105:22

Showing disrespect for the elderly is a sign of evil days

ISA 3:5 See also DEU 28:50; JOB 30:1; ISA 47:6; LAM 5:12

The role and status of elders

Elders of non-Israelite nations

GEN 50:7; ; NUM 22:7

Elders in Israel

Israel's elders were probably the heads of families, qualified to lead by virtue of age and experience: EXO 3:16–3:18, EXO 4:29–4:31, EXO 19:7; NUM 11:25 The number of elders is reduced to 70 who are anointed by the Spirit for leadership alongside Moses.; DEU 19:11–19:12, DEU 22:15–22:18, DEU 25:7; 2SA 5:3 Israel's elders accept David as king; ; MAT 26:57 parallel MRK 14:53 Jewish elders were among those who tried Jesus Christ. By NT times they had become involved with religious as well as civil affairs and their title related more to their role than to age.

Elders in the church

1TI 5:17 See also 1TI 3:1–3:7; TIT 1:5–1:9; JAS 5:14; 1PE 5:1–5:2

God as the ``Ancient of Days``

God as one ``advanced in years``

DAN 7:9 This description of God as the "Ancient of Days" implies that he possesses the respectability, authority and wisdom to judge that accompanies age. It also points to his eternity. See also DAN 7:13, DAN 7:22; REV 1:14

The eternity of God

PSA 9:7 See also PSA 29:10, PSA 90:2; ISA 41:4, ISA 44:6

5729: one flesh

A sign and expression of the inseparable union between husband and wife. This is not only physical but emotional, mental and spiritual. It is also used to describe the union between Jesus Christ and the church.

One flesh describes the inseparable union between husband and wife

GEN 2:22–2:24 See also 1CO 6:16; EPH 5:28–5:29, EPH 5:31

One flesh refers to sexual union which Scripture describes in various ways

To lie with

GEN 4:1, GEN 4:17, GEN 4:25, GEN 19:31–19:35, GEN 29:21, GEN 29:23, GEN 29:30; ; 1SA 1:19; ; 2SA 11:11, 2SA 12:24, 2SA 16:21

To come together

MAT 1:18; ; 1CO 7:5

To have union or unite with

1CO 6:15–6:16 See also GEN 2:24; MAT 1:25, MAT 19:5 parallel MRK 10:7; EPH 5:31

Natural relations

ROM 1:26–1:27

One flesh expresses an intimacy encouraged by God

Only within heterosexual marriage

MAT 19:4–19:6 parallel MRK 10:6–10:9 See also GEN 1:27, GEN 2:24; EXO 20:14 parallel DEU 5:18; LEV 20:10; MAT 5:27–5:28; 1CO 5:9–5:11, 1CO 6:9, 1CO 7:4

Intimate relations between members of the same sex are unnatural and wrong

LEV 18:22 See also ROM 1:26–1:27; 1CO 6:9

One flesh describes the union between Jesus Christ and the church

EPH 5:31–5:32 See also GEN 2:24; 1CO 6:16–6:17

5730: orphans

Children whose parents are dead; a vulnerable group of people to whom God shows special kindness. He expects his people to do the same. Those who exploit them incur God's judgment.

Orphans as symbols

Of weakness

PSA 82:3 See also JOB 29:12; ISA 9:17

Of disgrace

LAM 5:1–5:3 See also PSA 109:9, PSA 109:12

God cares for orphans

DEU 10:18 See also PSA 10:14, PSA 10:17–10:18, PSA 68:5, PSA 146:9; JER 49:11; HOS 14:3

God expects his people to care for orphans

They are not to be oppressed

ZEC 7:10 See also DEU 24:17, DEU 26:12–26:13; JER 22:3

Caring for them brings blessing

DEU 24:19 See also DEU 14:28–14:29; ISA 1:17; JER 7:5–7:7; JAS 1:27

Exploitation of orphans is a mark of wickedness

PSA 94:5–94:6 See also JOB 6:27, JOB 22:9, JOB 24:3, JOB 24:9, JOB 31:17, JOB 31:21; ISA 1:23; JER 5:28; EZK 22:7

God punishes those who oppress orphans

DEU 27:19 See also EXO 22:22–22:24; PRO 23:10–23:11; ISA 10:1–10:4; MAL 3:5

Orphans are included among God's people

DEU 16:11, DEU 16:14

Jesus Christ includes those who are spiritually fatherless

JHN 14:18 See also GAL 4:5, GAL 4:7

Examples of orphans

GEN 11:27–11:28 Lot; ; NUM 27:1–27:5 the daughters of Zelophedad; ; EST 2:7 Esther

5731: parents

Scripture stipulates that children should show respect and concern for their parents.

Honouring parents

EXO 20:12 parallel DEU 5:16 See also LEV 19:3; PRO 23:22; MAT 19:16–19:19 parallels MRK 10:17–10:19, LUK 18:18–18:20; EPH 6:1–6:3; COL 3:20; 1TI 5:4

Dishonouring parents

2TI 3:1–3:2 See also EXO 21:15–21:17; DEU 21:18–21:21; EZK 22:7; MAT 15:1–15:9 parallel MRK 7:1–7:13; ROM 1:28–1:32

Love between parents and children can be suppressed

LUK 21:16–21:17 parallels MAT 10:21, MRK 13:12 See also ZEC 13:2–13:3

Love for God must surpass love for parents

LUK 14:26 See also DEU 33:8–33:11; LUK 18:28–18:30 parallels MAT 19:27–19:29, MRK 10:28–10:30

Divine love surpasses parental love

PSA 27:10

The belief that children were punished for their parents' sins

JHN 9:1–9:3 See also EXO 20:5–20:6 parallel DEU 5:9–5:10; JOB 21:19–21:21; EZK 18:1–18:4

Parents caring for their children

2CO 12:14 See also PRO 19:14, PRO 23:24–23:25; HEB 11:23

Children caring for their parents

1SA 22:3–22:4 See also JOS 2:8–2:20, JOS 6:22–6:23; PRO 17:6

Mourning for parents

LEV 21:1–21:2 See also LEV 21:10–21:11; NUM 6:2–6:7; DEU 21:10–21:13; EZK 44:25

Parents and the marriage of their children

A man leaves his parents to marry his wife

GEN 2:21–2:24 See also MAT 19:3–19:6 parallel MRK 10:2–10:9; EPH 5:25–5:33

Parents were responsible for vindicating their daughter's reputation

DEU 22:13–22:19

Sometimes parents jointly arranged their children's marriages

JDG 14:1–14:3

5732: polygamy

The practice of having more than one wife at one time. Although not explicitly forbidden in Scripture as a general practice, it is presented as problematic and monogamy is the clearly preferred option.

Monogamy is God's intention for marriage

GEN 2:24 See also JER 2:2; HOS 2:19–2:20; EPH 5:31

Early examples of polygamy

GEN 4:19 See also GEN 26:34, GEN 28:9, GEN 29:28

Reasons for the practice of polygamy

Sealing foreign treaties

1KI 3:1 See also 1KI 16:31

Producing offspring

GEN 16:1–16:3; 2CH 13:21 A large family, and especially numerous progeny, was regarded as a sign of divine blessing. See also GEN 30:3–30:5, GEN 30:9; JDG 8:30; 2SA 3:1–3:5; 1CH 7:4; 2CH 11:23, 2CH 24:2–24:3

Problems associated with polygamy

Being led away from God

DEU 17:17 It was common for kings to cement foreign alliances by marriage. Israel's king is warned against the practice; **1KI 11:1–11:8** See also NEH 13:25–13:26; MAL 2:11

Conflicts within families

GEN 29:30, GEN 30:1; DEU 21:15–21:17 See also GEN 16:4–16:6 Sarah and Hagar; 1SA 1:4–1:7 Hannah and Peninnah; 2CH 11:21–11:22; 1KI 1:11–1:13 the conflict over the succession to David's throne

Further examples of polygamy

2SA 5:13 parallel 1CH 14:3 See also 1SA 25:40–25:43; 2SA 12:8–12:9; 1KI 20:5 Ahab; 2KI 24:15 Jehoiachin; 1CH 4:5 Ashhur; DAN 5:2 Belshazzar

Restrictions on polygamous relationships

GEN 31:50; ; EXO 21:10; ; LEV 18:18

Polygamy forbidden

1CO 7:2; ; 1TI 3:2 Polygamy is expressly forbidden for church leaders.

5733: pregnancy

Pregnancy regarded as a blessing from God

GEN 4:1 See also GEN 4:17, GEN 16:4, GEN 20:17–20:18, GEN 29:32, GEN 30:1–30:2, GEN 30:4–30:6, GEN 30:17, GEN 30:23

Pregnancy after barrenness

GEN 25:21 See also GEN 30:22–30:23; 1SA 1:1–1:20; 2KI 4:11–4:17; LUK 1:24–1:25

Pregnancy in old age

LUK 1:36–1:37 See also GEN 18:9–18:15, GEN 21:1–21:7

Ritual uncleanness after pregnancy

LEV 12:1–12:7

Pregnancy outside marriage

As a result of incest

GEN 19:30–19:38

As a result of prostitution

GEN 38:24–38:25 See also GEN 38:13–38:19

As a result of adultery

2SA 11:2–11:5

Pregnancy in troubled times sometimes a misfortune

Because of atrocities committed in war
2KI 15:16 See also 2KI 8:12; HOS 13:16; AMO 1:13

Because of additional hardship in harsh circumstances
MAT 24:15–24:21 parallels MRK 13:14–13:19, LUK 21:20–21:24

Premature birth
EXO 21:22–21:25 See also 1SA 4:19

Labour pains
1TH 5:3 See also GEN 3:16; 1SA 4:19; REV 12:2

Miscarriage
EXO 23:25–23:26 See also GEN 31:38; JOB 21:10; HOS 9:14

Figurative use of pregnancy
PSA 7:14 See also HOS 9:11

5734: relationships

God created people to be in relationship with himself and with one another in friendship, marriage, family, society and the church.

Human beings are created to be in relationship

With God
REV 21:3 See also ISA 43:6–43:7; HOS 11:1; 2CO 6:18

With one another
GEN 2:18 See also PSA 127:4; PRO 17:6, PRO 17:17, PRO 18:24, PRO 27:10; ECC 4:9–4:12

Relationship with God

Is entered by faith
JHN 1:12–1:13 See also MAT 12:50 parallels MRK 3:35, LUK 8:21; JHN 17:3; GAL 3:26

Is expressed through covenant
EXO 6:7 This is often known as the covenant formula. See also GEN 17:7; 2SA 7:14–7:15 parallel 1CH 17:13–17:14; LUK 22:20 parallels MAT 26:28, MRK 14:24; 2CO 6:16; LEV 26:12; HEB 10:15–10:18; JER 31:33–31:34

Relationships between believers

Believers are to be in relationship with one another in the church
GAL 3:28 See also EPH 2:14–2:16, EPH 2:19

Believers are to maintain good relationships
EPH 4:3 See also ROM 12:18, ROM 14:19; HEB 12:14

Believers are to restore broken relationships
MAT 18:15 See also MAT 5:23–5:24; EPH 4:26

5735: sexuality

Men and women are intended to complement one another and to take pleasure in one another. God has provided for the full and glad expression of this in marriage.

Sexuality comes from God

It was created by God
GEN 1:27

God intended men and women to complement one another
1CO 11:11 See also GEN 2:18–2:22

Sexual differences

In strength
1PE 3:7

In role
1CO 11:3–11:5, 1CO 14:34–14:35; ; EPH 5:22–5:25; ; COL 3:18–3:19; ; 1TI 2:12–2:14; ; 1PE 3:1

In dress
DEU 22:5 See also 1CO 11:14–11:15

Sexual activity

It was ordained by God
GEN 1:28 This command was made before the fall, and no guilt attaches to it.

Marriage in its proper context
GEN 2:23–2:24 “one flesh” implies both bodily union and an inseparable intimate relationship. See also MAT 19:4–19:6 parallel MRK 10:6–10:9; 1CO 7:2–7:4; EPH 5:31–5:33

Sexual desire
SNG 4:3–4:15 “Song of Songs” celebrates the beauty of sex in a loving context. It contains much delicate and intimate imagery that applies directly to human lovers and can also be applied to Jesus Christ and the church. See also GEN 3:16; SNG 1:2–1:4, SNG 4:16, SNG 7:11–7:13, SNG 8:10

Abstinence is possible
MAT 19:12; ; 1CO 7:1, 1CO 7:5

Perversions of sexuality

Adultery
EXO 20:14 parallel DEU 5:18 See also HEB 13:4

Lust

MAT 5:28 Lust may also lead to other sexual sins. See also EPH 4:19, EPH 5:3; COL 3:5; 1PE 4:3

Promiscuity

DEU 22:13–22:21; ; ROM 1:24

Prostitution

LEV 19:29

Homosexuality

ROM 1:26–1:27 See also GEN 19:4–19:7; LEV 18:22

Bestiality

EXO 22:19

Sexual perversion will be punished

1CO 6:9–6:10; ; REV 21:8, REV 22:15

Sexual perversion can be cleansed

1CO 6:11

Sexuality is transcended in heaven

MAT 22:30

5736: singleness

Not being married; the state prior to betrothal or following separation or the death of a spouse. In Scripture, an unmarried woman generally lives with, and is the responsibility of, her family. Whilst the unmarried are freer of worldly concerns and may devote themselves more fully to God, those already married should not separate, and those without the gift of celibacy should not remain single.

Responsibility for an unmarried woman

An unmarried woman is responsible to her father

DEU 22:16 See also EXO 2:21; NUM 30:3–30:5; JDG 1:12–1:13; 1SA 18:17, 1SA 18:21

An unmarried woman is dependent on her brothers

LEV 21:3 See also GEN 24:51, GEN 34:14–34:15; EZK 44:25

Widowed or divorced women could return to their parents' home

RUT 1:8–1:13 See also GEN 38:11; LEV 22:13; JDG 19:2

Regulations relating to the unmarried

DEU 20:7, DEU 22:20–22:21, DEU 22:28–22:29

The unwelcome prospect of remaining unmarried

JDG 11:37–11:39; ISA 54:6 See also GEN 19:31–19:32; ISA 49:20–49:21, ISA 62:4; HOS 2:2; GAL 4:27; ISA 54:1

Celibacy**Celibacy is a calling from God**

1CO 7:7 See also JER 16:2; MAT 19:10–19:12; 1CO 7:9, 1CO 7:36; 1TI 5:11–5:14

Believers should remain as they are when called

1CO 7:25–7:28 See also 1CO 7:10, 1CO 7:12–7:13, 1CO 7:17, 1CO 7:24

Sexual abstinence within marriage is strictly limited

1CO 7:2–7:6 See also EXO 19:15; 1SA 21:4–21:5

The desirability of being unmarried

1CO 7:8 See also 1CO 7:1, 1CO 7:11, 1CO 7:37–7:38

The unmarried may devote themselves to God

1CO 7:32–7:35 See also LUK 14:20, LUK 14:26; ACT 21:9; 1TI 5:5

Marriage belongs to a passing order

MAT 22:30 parallels MRK 12:25, LUK 20:35 See also 1CO 7:29–7:31

5737: sisters

The daughter of one's parents, or of either mother or father. The relationship with a sister is a close one, especially with an unmarried sister.

The relationship with a sister was a close one

EZK 44:25 See also LEV 21:1–21:3; NUM 6:6–6:7; JOB 1:1–1:4

A brother had some measure of responsibility for his sister

SNG 8:8–8:9 See also GEN 24:28–24:60; 2SA 13:19–13:20

Sexual relationships with sisters

Marrying a sister was permissible in pre-Mosaic times

GEN 20:12

Sexual relationships with a sister were later forbidden in Mosaic law

LEV 18:9 See also LEV 18:11–18:13, LEV 18:18, LEV 20:17; DEU 27:22; EZK 22:11

Rape

GEN 34:1–34:31 Dinah's rape was avenged by her brothers; ; 2SA 13:1–13:19 Tamar was raped by her half-brother; ; 2SA 13:23–13:36 Absalom avenged Tamar's rape.

Sometimes the wives of the patriarchs posed as their sisters

GEN 20:13 See also GEN 12:10–12:20, GEN 20:1–20:7, GEN 26:1–26:10

Examples of the behaviour of sisters

Jealousy

GEN 30:1 See also GEN 30:7-30:8

Criticism

LUK 10:38-10:42 See also NUM 12:1-12:15

Kindness and concern

2CH 22:11 parallel 2KI 11:2 See also EXO 2:1-2:8; JOB 42:11; JHN 11:1-11:3, JHN 11:17-11:32

Sisters-in-law

Marriage to a sister-in-law was allowed in specific circumstances

DEU 25:5-25:10 See also GEN 38:6-38:11

Sexual relationships with sisters-in-law were forbidden under normal circumstances

LEV 18:16 See also LEV 20:21; MRK 6:17-6:20; LUK 3:19-3:20

Sister used as a term of affection

By a husband

SNG 4:9-4:10 See also SNG 4:12, SNG 5:1-5:2

In the church

ROM 16:1 See also 1TI 5:1-5:2; PHM 1:1-1:2; JAS 2:15-2:17; 2JN 1:13

The metaphorical use of sister

Of death

JOB 17:13-17:16

Of wisdom

PRO 7:1-7:5

Of nations

JER 3:6-3:10 See also EZK 16:44-16:63, EZK 23:1-23:49

Sister as a theological term

Describing the relationship of believers to Jesus Christ

MAT 12:46-12:50 parallel MRK 3:31-3:35

Jesus Christ requires his followers to put him before family ties

LUK 14:26 See also MAT 19:29 parallel MRK 10:29-10:30

5738: sons

The male offspring of parents. While sharing in the general privileges and responsibilities of children, sons had special claims to inheritance from their parents. To refer to Christians as “sons of God” is to identify both their relationship to God and also their rights as heirs of God. A significant number of titles

for Jesus Christ make use of the term “Son”, stressing the close relationship between the Father and Son.

Privileges of sonship

Inheritance

PRO 13:22; ; GAL 4:7; ; HEB 1:2

Being disciplined

Discipline is here seen as a loving means of enabling a child to grow to maturity: DEU 8:5; ; PRO 19:18, PRO 29:17; ; HEB 12:5-12:11; ; REV 3:19

Being loved and provided for

LUK 11:11-11:13 parallel MAT 7:9-7:11

Being prayed for

See also GEN 17:18-17:20; 2SA 12:16; JOB 1:5

Examples of good sons

GEN 9:23 Shem and Japheth; ; GEN 22:6-22:12 Isaac; GEN 45:8-45:11, GEN 47:11-47:12; LUK 2:51 The voluntary obedience of the child Jesus towards Mary and Joseph is widely regarded as setting an example for believers.; 2TI 1:5, 2TI 3:14-3:15

Examples of bad sons

GEN 37:1-37:35 Jacob's eleven sons; ; LUK 15:11-15:32

Christians as sons of God

HEB 12:5-12:6 See also ROM 8:14, ROM 9:26; 2CO 6:18; HEB 12:7

Adopted sons

EXO 2:10 See also GEN 48:5

Sons-in-law

GEN 19:12-19:14; ; JDG 19:5; ; 1SA 18:18-18:27

Family relationships must be subservient to one's relationship with God

MAT 10:35 parallel LUK 12:53; ; MAT 10:37

Son as an honorific term

MAT 9:2 parallel MAT 9:5; ; LUK 15:31

Sons in a spiritual role

1TI 1:18 See also JOL 2:28; ACT 2:17; 2TI 1:1

Son in a non-literal sense

MAT 23:15; ; MRK 3:17; ; JHN 12:36; ; ACT 4:36; ; 1TH 5:5

Titles of Jesus Christ as Son

Son

ISA 9:6 See also PSA 2:7, PSA 2:12; MAT 3:17; JHN 3:35

Son of Joseph

Jesus Christ is described in this way by those who have yet to understand the circumstances of his conception and birth: LUK 3:23; ; JHN 1:45, JHN 6:42

Son of Mary

MRK 6:3

Son of David

MAT 15:22 See also MRK 10:47-10:48 parallel LUK 18:38-18:39

Son of God

ACT 9:20 See also MAT 4:3; LUK 1:35; JHN 1:34, JHN 19:7; ROM 1:3-1:4; 1JN 5:5

Son of the living God

MAT 16:16

Son of the Most High

See also LUK 1:32

Son of Man

LUK 19:10 See also MAT 8:20, MAT 17:22; MRK 9:12; LUK 17:22; JHN 5:27; ACT 7:56

5739: twins

Two children born of the same parents at the same time. Figuratively used to describe a matching pair.

Examples of twins

GEN 25:21-25:26 Although Jacob and Esau were twins, their very different characters indicate that God deals with and relates to people individually. See also GEN 38:27-38:30; JHN 20:24 Didymus means “twin”. It is not known who his twin was; JHN 21:2; ACT 28:11 the mythical twin sons of Zeus regarded as special protectors of sailors

Twins used to illustrate God’s election

ROM 9:10-9:16

Twins used figuratively for matching pairs

SNG 4:2, SNG 4:5, SNG 6:6, SNG 7:3

5740: virgin

Generally a young person, especially a female, who has not had sexual intercourse. Virginity is an important quality in a bride, and its surrender or violation prior to marriage is sternly condemned. In the miracle of the incarnation, Mary was still a virgin when Jesus Christ was conceived. Virginity is also used metaphorically to denote purity and innocence.

Virginity is important in a bride

Virgins were sought as brides

GEN 24:14-24:16; SNG 4:12 See also GEN 24:42-24:45 The word translated “maiden” might also refer to a virgin; LEV 21:13-21:14; DEU 22:13-22:19; EST 2:2, EST 2:17; ISA 62:5; EZK 44:22

The church presented as a virgin bride

2CO 11:2 See also EPH 5:25-5:27; REV 19:7-19:8

The loss of virginity before marriage

Of a virgin not pledged in marriage

EXO 22:16-22:17 See also DEU 22:28-22:29; 2SA 13:12-13:16

Of a virgin pledged in marriage

DEU 22:20-22:21 See also DEU 22:23-22:24 Betrothal was as serious a commitment as marriage itself; consorting with another person during this period was tantamount to adultery; DEU 22:25-22:27; MAT 1:18-1:19

Some fathers surrendered their daughters’ virginity

GEN 19:8 See also JDG 19:24

Particular roles involving virgins

Maidens in victory processions

PSA 68:25; JER 31:4 See also EXO 15:20-15:21; JDG 11:34; 1SA 18:6

Virgins as bridesmaids

PSA 45:14 See also MAT 25:1

A virgin looked after King David

1KI 1:1-1:4

Virginity as a sign of purity and innocence

Virgins were spared after military victories

NUM 31:17-31:18 See also JDG 21:11-21:12

Israel’s virgin purity lost

JER 18:13 See also JER 31:21-31:23; EZK 23:3-23:8

Virginity as a metaphor for (apparent) inviolability

2KI 19:21 parallel ISA 37:22; ; ISA 47:1

Lost opportunities of virgin youthfulness

AMO 5:2 See also JDG 11:36-11:40; ISA 23:12; JER 46:11; LAM 1:15-1:16, LAM 2:13; JOL 1:8

Paul’s advice about virgins

A virgin is freer to serve God

1CO 7:32-7:35 The unmarried have fewer responsibilities and worldly cares and so may offer undivided devotion to God. See also 1CO 7:25-7:28

Remaining unmarried is a preferred option

1CO 7:8, 1CO 7:37–7:38

Marriage is the proper outlet for sexual passion

1CO 7:9 Though Paul urges abstinence, sexual passion is not wrong; however, sexual relationships must be confined to marriage; ; 1CO 7:36

Mary's virginity at Jesus Christ's conception**MAT 1:20–1:25** See also ISA 7:14; LUK 1:27, LUK 1:34–1:35**Parable of the ten virgins**

MAT 25:1–25:13

5741: vows

Promises made to God, usually in the context of worship or religious practice. There was no requirement on any Israelite to make vows, but once made, they were binding and had to be kept.

Vows were binding**DEU 23:21–23:23** See also NUM 30:2, NUM 30:9; PRO 20:25; ECC 5:4–5:6; MAL 1:14**Exceptions to keeping vows****NUM 30:3–30:8** In certain cases vows made by daughters or wives could be nullified by fathers or husbands respectively. See also NUM 30:10–30:15**Vows made to God in the context of worship****To offer sacrifices****LEV 22:17–22:19** See also LEV 7:16, LEV 22:21, LEV 27:9; NUM 15:2–15:4, NUM 15:8–15:10; DEU 12:6, DEU 12:11; PSA 50:14, PSA 66:13; PRO 7:14; JON 2:9**To dedicate people, animals or property to God****LEV 27:1–27:25****To give money****2KI 12:4–12:5** See also DEU 23:18**Motives for making vows****To elicit God's help****1SA 1:11** See also GEN 28:20–28:22; NUM 21:2; JDG 11:30–11:40; 2SA 15:7–15:8; PSA 66:13–66:14**To express thanksgiving****PSA 116:12–116:14** See also PSA 50:14, PSA 56:12, PSA 116:17–116:18; JON 1:16, JON 2:9**To praise God****PSA 22:25** See also PSA 61:8, PSA 65:1**Vows of Nazirites**

NUM 6:1–6:21; ; JDG 13:2–13:5 Samson was set apart as a Nazirite from birth; ; 1SA 1:11 Samuel may have been a Nazirite.

Examples of vows made to God**By David****PSA 132:2–132:5****By Paul****ACT 18:18** See also ACT 21:24–21:26**Abuse of vows**

MAT 15:5–15:6 parallel MRK 7:11–7:13

Vows made to idols**JER 44:25–44:28****5742: wedding**

The public acknowledgment and celebration of a couple's marriage. The wedding followed betrothal and was a preliminary to sexual union. The occasion was marked by feasting, singing and rejoicing. The bride wore a wedding dress, jewellery and ornaments and both she and the groom were waited on by attendants.

Wedding garments**The bride's wedding dress****PSA 45:13** See also GEN 24:65; EZK 16:10; REV 19:7–19:8, REV 21:2**The bride's jewellery and ornaments****ISA 49:18** See also ISA 61:10; JER 2:32; EZK 16:11–16:12**Wedding festivities****Weddings were occasions for rejoicing****JER 33:11** GEN 29:27–29:28; ; JDG 14:12; SNG 3:11; ; ISA 62:5; ; JER 7:34**Wedding songs**

PSA 45:0, PSA 78:63

The wedding banquet**JDG 14:10** See also GEN 29:21–29:22 A feast celebrates Jacob's wedding; MAT 22:2 a wedding banquet given by a king for his son; JHN 2:3–2:10 Jesus Christ changes water into wine at a wedding feast; REV 19:9 the marriage supper of the Lamb**Guests and attendants at weddings****Wedding guests****JHN 2:1–2:2** See also MAT 22:3–22:10, MAT 22:11–22:12 Wedding guests were expected to wear appropriate clothes; LUK 14:8–14:10**Attendants on the groom****JHN 3:29** See also JDG 14:11, JDG 14:20; MAT 9:15 parallels MRK 2:19, LUK 5:34

Bridesmaids**PSA 45:14** See also MAT 25:1–25:10**Wedding gifts****1KI 9:16** See also GEN 24:59, GEN 29:24, GEN 29:29; JDG 1:14–1:15**Elements in the wedding ceremony****Covering the bride**

Sometimes the groom would cover the bride with his cloak as a symbol of protection: RUT 3:9; ; EZK 16:8

A covenanted commitment

PRO 2:17; ; MAL 2:14

Blessing the couple

GEN 24:60; ; RUT 4:11

Consummating the marriage**JOL 2:16** See also GEN 29:23; PSA 19:5**5743: widows**

God's tender concern for bereaved wives is declared throughout the whole of Scripture. He defends their rights and expects his people to do the same.

God is the protector of widows**PSA 68:5** See also DEU 10:18; PSA 146:9; PRO 15:25; JER 49:11**Jesus Christ's concern for widows**

MRK 12:41–12:44 parallel LUK 21:1–21:4; ; LUK 7:11–7:15, LUK 18:1–18:5

Widows are to be treated justly**DEU 27:19** See also EXO 22:22–22:24; JOB 24:21–24:22; PSA 94:6; ISA 10:1–10:4; JER 22:3–22:5; EZK 22:25**Widows are not to be exploited****EXO 22:22** See also ISA 10:1–10:2; EZK 22:7; MAL 3:5; MRK 12:38–12:40 parallel LUK 20:45–20:47**The law requires God's people to provide for widows****DEU 24:19** See also DEU 14:28–14:29, DEU 16:11, DEU 24:17, DEU 24:20–24:21, DEU 26:12; ISA 1:17 The prophet encourages God's people to return to the law.**The Christian community are to care for widows****1TI 5:3** See also 1TI 5:4–5:16; 1CO 7:8–7:9; JAS 1:27**Examples of widows and their treatment**

DEU 16:14; ; RUT 1:16–1:17; ; 1KI 17:13–17:14; ; JOB 24:3, JOB 29:13; ; LUK 2:36–2:38 Anna; ; LUK 4:25–4:26, LUK 7:11–7:17 the widow of Nain; ; ACT 6:1, ACT 9:36–9:41 Dorcas

Women widowed because of God's judgment**EXO 22:22–22:24** See also PSA 109:9; ISA 9:17; JER 15:8; LAM 5:3**Laws governing the remarriage of widows****The people generally****DEU 25:5–25:10** The OT emphasises continuity of the family line. See also GEN 38:8; RUT 3:12 Boaz refers to the law which gave the nearest male relative the duty of marrying the widow; RUT 4:10; MRK 12:19 parallel LUK 20:28**The priests****LEV 21:13–21:14** See also EZK 44:22**Widowhood as the personification of a city****LAM 1:1** A lament for desolate Jerusalem. See also ISA 54:4–54:5 a prophecy of the restoration of Jerusalem; REV 18:7 the boasts of Babylon**5744: wife**

The female partner in a marriage relationship. The origin of this God-ordained institution is traced back in the Bible to the Garden of Eden. Scripture stresses that marriage is a God-ordained institution, within which the husband should love and care for his wife, just as the wife should obey, honour and care for her husband. A good wife is portrayed as a great blessing, but a bad wife influences her husband for evil. In the OT, Israel is sometimes portrayed as God's wife; in the NT, the church is described as Christ's bride.

God's pattern for marriage**Husband and wife are one flesh****GEN 1:27** See also GEN 2:23–2:24; MAL 2:15; MAT 19:4–19:6 parallel MRK 10:6–10:9**The wife as helper and companion****GEN 2:18** See also GEN 2:20–2:22**The husband is head of the wife****EPH 5:23** See also 1CO 11:3**The wife is the weaker partner****1PE 3:7** See also GEN 3:16**The Israelites were forbidden to take foreign wives****DEU 7:3–7:4** See also EXO 34:16; JOS 23:12–23:13**Duties of a wife****To submit to and respect her husband****COL 3:18** See also EPH 5:22–5:24, EPH 5:33; 1PE 3:1–3:6**To care for her husband and household****PRO 31:10–31:31** See also TIT 2:4–2:5

To be faithful to her husband

EXO 20:14 parallel DEU 5:18 See also NUM 5:11–5:31; PRO 23:27; MAT 14:3–14:4 parallel MRK 6:17–6:18; MRK 10:12; LUK 3:19

Advice on widows remarrying

1CO 7:39–7:40 See also 1CO 7:8–7:9

Childless wives

GEN 25:21 See also GEN 18:9–18:15; JDG 13:2–13:5; 1SA 1:9–1:20; LUK 1:5–1:25

Good wives

PRO 31:10–31:31 See also 1SA 19:11–19:17, 1SA 25:14–25:35; PRO 12:4, PRO 18:22, PRO 19:14; TIT 2:3–2:5; 1PE 3:1–3:6

Wives giving good counsel

MAT 27:19 See also JDG 13:22–13:23; DAN 5:10–5:12

Bad wives

PRO 12:4 See also PRO 19:13, PRO 21:19, PRO 25:24

Wives influencing their husbands for evil

GEN 3:8–3:12 See also 1KI 11:3–11:4, 1KI 21:20–21:26; EST 5:9–5:14; JOB 2:9

Israel as the wife of God

JER 3:20 Israel's relationship with God was at times comparable to that of an unfaithful wife; **EZK 16:8** See also ISA 62:5; JER 2:2; EZK 16:32; HOS 1:2, HOS 2:2

The church as the bride of Christ

REV 21:2 See also EPH 5:25–5:27; REV 19:7

5745: women

God created both women and men in his image and likeness. Scripture shows women in a variety of roles, playing an important part in God's salvation plan. In Christ, there is no fundamental distinction between believers on account of gender, race or social status. Women played a significant part in the life of Jesus Christ and in the early church. The NT both records their role and faces the questions thereby raised.

The creation of women

GEN 2:20–2:24 See also GEN 1:27, GEN 5:1–5:2; 1TI 2:13

Women and the fall

1TI 2:14 See also GEN 3:1–3:16; 2CO 11:3

Examples of godly women

RUT 1:16–1:17 Ruth; ; 1SA 1:9–1:28 Hannah; ; 1SA 25:2–25:35 Abigail; ; EST 4:15–4:16 Esther; ; LUK 1:41–1:45 Elizabeth; ; ACT 9:36–9:42 Tabitha

Examples of women who are condemned or judged

2SA 6:16–6:23 Michal; ; 1KI 21:1–21:25 Jezebel; ; PRO 5:1–5:6 the adulteress; ISA 3:16–4:1; ; EZK 13:17–13:23

OT laws concerning women

EXO 21:22–21:25; ; LEV 12:1–12:8, LEV 15:19–15:30; ; DEU 22:5

Women in office in the OT**As a judge or leader**

JDG 4:4–4:5

As a prophetess

EXO 15:20–15:21 See also JDG 4:4; 2KI 22:14–22:20; ISA 8:3

As a queen

2KI 11:1–11:3 See also 1KI 10:1–10:13 parallel 2CH 9:1–9:12; EST 1:9–1:21, EST 2:17

Women as wives and mothers in the OT

PRO 12:4 See also GEN 2:24, GEN 21:11–21:12; PRO 18:22, PRO 31:10–31:31

Women in the life of Jesus Christ**In the birth narratives**

LUK 1:26–1:56, LUK 2:16–2:19, LUK 2:36–2:38

In the ministry of Jesus Christ

LUK 8:1–8:3 Jesus Christ respected women and talked to them as individuals with spiritual understanding. This was a considerable deviation from the cultural conventions of the time. See also MAT 9:20–9:22 parallels MRK 5:25–5:34, LUK 8:43–8:48; MAT 15:21–15:28 parallel MRK 7:24–7:30; MRK 12:41–12:44 parallel LUK 21:1–21:4; LUK 10:38–10:42; JHN 4:7–4:30, JHN 11:17–11:44

In the passion narratives

MAT 27:55–27:56 parallels MRK 15:40–15:41, LUK 23:49 See also MAT 26:6–26:13 parallels MRK 14:3–14:9, LUK 7:37–7:38, JHN 12:1–12:8; MAT 27:61 parallels MRK 15:47, LUK 23:55–23:56; MAT 28:1–28:10 parallels MRK 16:1–16:11, LUK 24:1–24:11

Women's ministry in the early church**As prophets**

ACT 21:8–21:9 See also ACT 2:17–2:18; JOL 2:28–2:29; 1CO 11:5

As teachers

TIT 2:3–2:5 See also ACT 18:24–18:26

As deacons

ROM 16:1–16:2 NIV footnote at verse 1. See also 1TI 3:11

As hostesses**COL 4:15** See also ACT 16:15; 1CO 16:19**As workers in the church****ROM 16:12** See also ROM 16:6; PHP 4:2–4:3**As an apostle****ROM 16:7** Interpreters disagree over whether Junias was a man or a woman, and also over whether Paul meant these two were notable in the ranks of the apostles or were well-known to the apostles.**Instructions to women in the early church community****Their role in the church meetings**

See also 1CO 11:5–11:16, 1CO 14:33–14:35; 1TI 2:11–2:12

Their behaviour as Christians

1TI 2:9–2:10, 1TI 5:11–5:16; ; TIT 2:3–2:5; ; 1PE 3:1–3:6

The care of women in the early church community

ACT 6:1; ; 1TI 5:1–5:10

Women as the weaker sex**1PE 3:7** See also 1TI 2:13–2:14**Women and their relationships****Their relationship to God through Jesus Christ****GAL 3:26–3:29****Their relationship to their husbands**

See also ROM 7:2–7:3; 1CO 7:1–7:5, 1CO 7:10–7:16, 1CO 7:39–7:40; EPH 5:22–5:24, EPH 5:33; COL 3:18; TIT 2:4–2:5; 1PE 3:1–3:6

Their relationship to men**1CO 11:3** Some interpret this as referring to a husband, rather than to men generally. See also 1CO 11:7–11:12; 1TI 2:11–2:12**Feminism and the Bible's teaching on women****The equality of the sexes and rejection of female subordination**

1CO 11:11–11:12; ; GAL 3:28

Examples of the abuse of women by men

JDG 11:30–11:40, JDG 19:22–19:30; ; 2SA 13:1–13:20; ; ACT 16:16–16:21

Women who are strong role models

JDG 4:4 Deborah; ; 2KI 22:14–22:20 Huldah; ; PRO 31:10–31:31 the wife of noble character; ; SNG 3:1–3:5 the beloved; ; ACT 16:13–16:15 Lydia

5746: youth

Scripture characterises youth as a time of vigour and strength. It speaks, too, of the pressures and expectations of youth, warns about the temptations facing young people, and instructs the young about what is expected of them.

The vigour of youth**PRO 20:29** See also JOB 33:25; PSA 103:5, PSA 144:12; SNG 2:3; ECC 11:9–11:10 **ISA 40:30** Even youthful strength and vigour may fail. See also JOB 20:11; PSA 78:31; AMO 8:13**The duties of youth****To remember God****ECC 12:1** See also 1KI 18:12; PSA 71:5; LAM 3:25–3:27 **PSA 119:9** See also PSA 71:17; EZK 4:14**To respect the elderly****LEV 19:32** See also JOB 29:8, JOB 32:6; 1TI 5:1; 1PE 5:5**To honour parents****EXO 20:12** parallel DEU 5:16 See also EPH 6:2–6:3; LEV 19:3; 1TI 5:4**To obey parents****PRO 1:8** See also PRO 6:20, PRO 23:22; EPH 6:1; COL 3:20**To remain faithful to one's partner****PRO 5:18** See also PRO 2:17; MAL 2:14–2:15**Examples of godly young people****Godly young men**

1SA 2:18 Samuel; ; 1SA 17:33 David, fighting Goliath; ; 2CH 24:1–24:2 parallel 2KI 12:1–12:2 Joash became king at the age of seven; ; 2CH 34:1–34:2 parallel 2KI 22:1–22:2 Josiah became king at the age of eight; ; LUK 2:42–2:52 Jesus Christ at the age of twelve; ; 2TI 1:5 Timothy

Godly young women

JDG 11:36 Jephthah's daughter; ; RUT 1:16–1:17 Ruth; ; EST 4:15–4:16 Esther; ; LUK 1:38 the virgin Mary; ; ACT 21:9 Philip's daughters

The promise of youth**Israel's youthful devotion****JER 2:2** See also JER 3:4; EZK 16:22, EZK 16:43 **HOS 2:14–2:15** See also ISA 54:4, ISA 62:5; EZK 16:60**Dying young as a sign of judgment****PSA 89:45** See also JOB 36:14; PSA 78:63; ISA 13:12; JER 9:21 The death of children and young people symbolises loss of hope for the future; JER 11:22

Particular pressures of youth

The inexperience of youth

1KI 3:7; ; 1CH 22:5, 1CH 29:1; ; 2CH 13:7; ; JER 1:6; ; 1TI 4:12

Temptations facing the young

2TI 2:22 See also PRO 7:7; LUK 15:13, LUK 15:30; MAT 19:22 parallels MRK 10:22, LUK 18:23; TIT 2:6

Troubles faced from the time of one's youth

2SA 19:7; ; PSA 88:15, PSA 129:1–129:2

The sins of youth

PSA 25:7 See also JOB 13:26

Disrespect for older people

2KI 2:23–2:24; ; JOB 30:1; ; ISA 3:5; ; LAM 5:12

Dishonouring parents

DEU 21:18–21:20; ; PRO 15:20, PRO 30:11; ; 2TI 3:2

Persistent sinfulness

JER 3:24–3:25, JER 22:21, JER 32:30

The sinfulness of Israel's youth

EZK 23:3, EZK 23:8, EZK 23:19–23:21; ; HOS 11:1–11:2

Examples of sinful young men

1SA 2:17 the sons of Eli; ; 1SA 8:2–8:3 the sons of Samuel; ; 2SA 15:6 Absalom; ; 1KI 12:8–12:14 parallel 2CH 10:8–10:11 Rehoboam; ; 2KI 21:1–21:2 parallel 2CH 33:1–33:2 Manasseh

5760: Human attitudes and behaviour

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- 5947: shame
- 5948: shrewdness
- 5949: shyness
- 5950: silence
- 5951: slander
- 5952: sorrow
- 5953: stability
- 5954: strength
- 5959: submission
- 5960: success
- 5961: superiority
- 5962: surprises
- 5963: sympathy
- 5964: temper
- 5965: temperament
- 5966: tenderness
- 5967: thrift
- 5968: timidity
- 5969: treachery
- 5970: unhappiness
- 5971: uniqueness
- 5972: unkindness
- 5973: unreliability
- 5974: value
- 5975: violence
- 5976: visiting
- 5977: waiting
- 5978: warning
- 5979: waste

5761: attitudes

The ways in which people think or feel about something or someone and which affect their behaviour.

5762: attitudes, God's to people

Scripture indicates the ways in which God relates to people, often suggesting that these illustrate the ways in which believers should behave.

God's love

JHN 3:16 See also PSA 36:5–36:7, PSA 107:1, PSA 136:1; JHN 13:1; ROM 5:5, ROM 8:35–8:39; EPH 5:2; 1JN 4:8–4:10, 1JN 4:16

God's compassion

PSA 116:5 See also ISA 54:8; JER 9:24; HOS 11:4; MAT 9:36; ROM 2:4, ROM 11:22; 2CO 1:3; EPH 2:7; TIT 3:4; JAS 5:11

God's grace and mercy

JHN 1:14 See also DEU 4:31; DAN 9:9; ROM 5:15; 2CO 8:9; EPH 2:4, EPH 2:7; 1TI 1:14; 1PE 5:10

God's jealousy

EXO 20:5 parallel DEU 5:9 See also DEU 4:24; JOS 24:19; NAM 1:2

God's patience

2PE 3:9 See also NEH 9:30; ROM 9:22; 1TI 1:16; 1PE 3:20

God's faithfulness

PSA 117:2 See also EXO 34:6; DEU 7:9; PSA 25:10, PSA 36:5, PSA 119:90; LAM 3:22–3:23; 1CO 10:13; 1JN 1:9

5763: attitudes, positive to God

Scripture identifies a range of positive attitudes towards God, which believers are encouraged to adopt.

Trust

PRO 3:5 See also PSA 20:7, PSA 25:1–25:2, PSA 40:4, PSA 56:11; JHN 14:1; ROM 15:13

Faith

MAT 8:10 parallel LUK 7:9 See also MAT 9:2 parallels MRK 2:5, LUK 5:20; HEB 11:1–11:39

Hope

JOB 13:15 See also PSA 25:5; ISA 40:31; MIC 7:7; ROM 4:18

Love

DEU 6:5 See also DEU 30:6; PSA 18:1, PSA 116:1; JHN 21:15–21:17

Holiness

HEB 12:14; 1PE 1:15–1:16 See also DEU 7:6, DEU 14:1–14:2; ROM 12:1–12:2; 1CO 5:7–5:8; COL 3:2

Awesome respect

ECC 12:13 See also DEU 10:12–10:13; PRO 1:7, PRO 9:10; JER 5:22; ACT 9:31; REV 14:7

Repentance

2CO 7:10 See also JOB 42:6; EZK 14:6; ACT 2:38, ACT 17:30

Humility

ISA 66:2 See also EZR 8:21; JAS 4:10; 1PE 5:6

Self-denial

MAT 16:24 parallels MRK 8:34, LUK 9:23

Submission

JAS 4:7 See also JOB 22:21; ROM 8:7, ROM 10:3

Thankfulness

1TH 5:18 See also 1CH 16:34; PSA 35:18, PSA 100:4; MAT 14:19; EPH 5:20; PHP 4:6; COL 2:7

Praise

HEB 13:15 See also EZR 3:11; PSA 148:1–148:5, PSA 150:1–150:6; ISA 42:10, ISA 61:3; ACT 2:46–2:47; JAS 5:13

Prayerfulness

JAS 5:13 See also MAT 14:23, MAT 26:41; ROM 8:26; 1TH 5:17

Reverence

PSA 5:7 See also NEH 5:15; MAL 2:5, MAL 4:2; EPH 5:21; HEB 12:28; 1PE 3:1–3:2

Watchfulness

COL 4:2 See also LUK 12:37–12:38; 1TH 5:6–5:8; 1PE 5:8

5764: attitudes, negative to God

Scripture identifies a range of negative attitudes towards God, which believers are encouraged to avoid.

Rejection

ISA 53:3 See also LEV 26:15–26:16; 1SA 8:7; EZK 5:6, EZK 20:15–20:16; JHN 1:11

Lack of faith

MRK 4:40 parallels MAT 8:26, LUK 8:25 See also MAT 13:58 parallel MRK 6:6

Pride

DEU 8:14 See also LEV 26:19; LUK 1:51; JAS 4:6; 1PE 5:5; PRO 3:34

Stubbornness

JER 5:23 See also PSA 78:8; ISA 48:4; MRK 3:5, MRK 16:14; ROM 2:5

Rebellion

PSA 78:40 See also DEU 1:26; ISA 1:2; JER 2:29; EZK 2:3; HOS 7:13; TIT 1:10; HEB 3:16

Hostility

ROM 8:7 See also LEV 26:21, LEV 26:23–26:24, LEV 26:27–26:28; HOS 9:7

5765: attitudes, to other people

Scripture illustrates a range of attitudes towards other people, some of which are commended, while others are condemned.

Love

JHN 13:34–13:35 See also MAT 22:39 parallels MRK 12:31, LUK 10:27; 1CO 13:1–13:13; EPH 5:2; 1TH 4:9; 1JN 3:11, 1JN 4:7

Forgiveness

COL 3:13 See also MAT 6:14; MRK 11:25; LUK 6:37, LUK 17:3; EPH 4:32

Helpfulness

ACT 9:36 See also EZK 16:49; MAT 25:44; ACT 20:35; 1CO 12:28; 2CO 9:2; 1TI 5:9–5:10; HEB 6:10

Hospitality

ROM 12:13 See also GEN 18:1–18:8; LUK 10:38; HEB 13:2

Generosity

2CO 8:2 See also PSA 37:21, PSA 37:26; MAT 10:8; ACT 10:2; 2CO 9:6–9:7; 1TI 6:18

Kindness

EPH 4:32 See also PRO 14:31; 1CO 13:4; COL 3:12; 2TI 2:24; TIT 2:4–2:5

Humility

1PE 5:5 See also PRO 3:34; MAT 20:26–20:28 parallel MRK 10:43–10:45; PHP 2:3–2:8; TIT 3:1–3:2; JAS 3:13

Patience

1TH 5:14 See also PRO 16:32; 1CO 13:4; GAL 5:22; EPH 4:2; COL 1:11; 2TI 4:2; JAS 5:7–5:11

Submission

EPH 5:21 ROM 13:1, ROM 13:5; ; 1PE 2:13; EPH 5:22–5:24; ; COL 3:18; ; 1TI 2:11; ; 1PE 3:1, 1PE 3:5–3:6; JAS 3:17; ; 1PE 2:18 submission of slaves to masters; ; 1PE 5:5

Gentleness

PHP 4:5 See also GAL 5:23; EPH 4:2; COL 3:12

Unselfishness

PHP 2:4 See also PRO 18:1; GAL 5:19–5:20; PHP 1:17; JAS 3:14, JAS 3:16

Pride

ROM 12:16 See also PRO 8:13; 2CO 12:7; GAL 5:26

Jealousy

PRO 27:4 See also GEN 30:1, GEN 37:11; ACT 5:17, ACT 7:9; 1CO 3:3; 2CO 12:20

Judgment

LUK 6:37 parallel MAT 7:1 See also JHN 8:3–8:7

Anger

EPH 4:31 See also GEN 4:3–4:5; 2KI 5:11; MRK 3:5; EPH 4:26; 1TI 2:8

Hatred

1JN 3:15 See also 1JN 2:9, 1JN 2:11, 1JN 4:20

Partiality

GEN 37:3 See also GEN 25:28; EXO 23:3; LEV 19:15; 1TI 5:21; JAS 2:1–2:4

5766: attitudes, to life

The way in which people think or feel about human life is of major importance to morality. Scripture declares the sanctity of life, and the attitudes towards life which should follow.

The sanctity of life

PSA 49:7–49:8; ; MAT 16:26 parallel MRK 8:37

Fear

1JN 4:18 See also PSA 23:4, PSA 91:5, PSA 112:7–112:8; ISA 35:4, ISA 41:10; 1PE 3:6

Courage

1CO 16:13 See also JOS 1:6–1:7; 1SA 17:32, 1SA 17:37; ACT 4:13

Rejoicing

PSA 118:24 See also ROM 5:3, ROM 12:15; 1PE 4:13

Anxiety

PHP 4:6 See also PSA 94:19; PRO 12:25; ECC 11:10; MAT 6:25–6:34 parallel LUK 12:22–12:31; LUK 10:41; 1PE 5:7

Being forward-looking and positive

PHP 3:12–3:14 See also LUK 9:62; 2TI 1:7, 2TI 2:3–2:6

5767: attitudes, in prayer

Attitudes in prayer include both the postures people adopt while praying and the hopes that they have concerning its outcome. Scripture points to the need for humility and expectation on the part of those who pray.

Positions adopted for prayer**Bowing down and kneeling**

PSA 95:6 See also GEN 24:26; EXO 4:31; ISA 45:23; DAN 6:10; LUK 22:41; ACT 7:60; EPH 3:14; PHP 2:10

Falling on one's face before God

MAT 26:39 See also NUM 20:6; JOS 5:14; 2CH 20:18

Standing

MRK 11:25 See also 1KI 8:22; LUK 18:11

Attitudes in the spiritual life

Standing for warfare

EPH 6:13–6:14 See also 2TH 2:15; JAS 5:8

Walking with God

MIC 6:8 See also ISA 40:31; 1JN 1:7

Running

HEB 12:1 See also ISA 40:31

5769: behaviour

A person's actions or way of life. Good behaviour will not earn salvation, but believers must practise good behaviour in accordance with Scripture as evidence of their conversion. Scripture stresses that bad behaviour is inconsistent with Christian faith and urges believers to mend their ways.

Examples of good behaviour

GEN 6:22; LUK 1:6 See also GEN 5:24; 2KI 18:3; JOB 1:8; JHN 1:47; 3JN 1:3, 3JN 1:5–1:6, 3JN 1:12

Examples of bad behaviour

1KI 16:30 See also GEN 4:8, GEN 6:5; ISA 25:3; 2TI 4:14; 3JN 1:9–1:10

Good behaviour towards God is commanded

EXO 20:2–20:11 parallel DEU 5:6–5:15

Obedience to God's word

PSA 1:2 See also PSA 19:7–19:11, PSA 119:1–119:4

Good behaviour towards other people is commanded

1PE 2:12 See also EXO 20:12–20:17 parallel DEU 5:16–5:21; PSA 15:1–15:5; PRO 12:2 Pr 10:1–31:31 contains much wisdom concerning good and bad behaviour; MAT 5:21–5:24

Good behaviour does not earn salvation

ROM 3:20; TIT 3:5 See also GAL 2:15–2:16; EPH 2:8–2:9; PHP 3:9

Good behaviour confirms a believer's profession of faith

JAS 2:14–2:19; 2PE 1:5–1:11 See also MAT 7:16–7:20 parallel LUK 6:43–6:45

Obedience to Jesus Christ and his teachings

MAT 7:24–7:25 parallel LUK 6:47–6:48 See also JHN 14:15, JHN 14:23, JHN 15:10; COL 3:16

A believer has died to sin and is alive to God

ROM 6:11–6:14 See also ROM 6:2, ROM 6:19; GAL 5:16, GAL 5:24–5:25; EPH 4:22–4:24; COL 3:1, COL 3:5, COL 3:9–3:10; 1TH 5:5–5:8

5770: abandonment

The state and experience of being forsaken, shared by God as well as by human beings.

God is abandoned

God's people deliberately abandon him

JER 2:13 See also DEU 32:15; JDG 2:12; 1KI 9:9 parallel 2CH 7:22; 2CH 13:11; ISA 1:4; JER 17:13

God's people abandon his law

JER 9:12–9:14 See also 1KI 18:18; 2CH 12:1; PSA 89:30, PSA 119:53; PRO 4:2, PRO 4:6; HEB 10:28

God's people abandon his covenant

DEU 29:25 See also JER 22:9, JER 31:32; DAN 11:30

God's people abandon his temple

2CH 24:18, 2CH 29:6

Those who abandon the gospel

1TI 4:1 See also HEB 10:26, HEB 10:29; REV 2:4

God abandons those who forsake him

2CH 24:20 See also NUM 32:15 Moses warns the Transjordan tribes; DEU 31:17 Israel's rebellion predicted; DEU 32:30ISA 18:12, ISA 28:15 1KI 9:7 parallel 2CH 7:20; 1CH 28:9; NEH 9:28; ISA 2:6; JER 12:7; LAM 2:7

God shows mercy to those who have been justly abandoned

ISA 54:7 See also NEH 9:19, NEH 9:28, NEH 9:31; JER 51:5

Those who feel abandoned by God

God's people

LAM 5:20 See also PSA 22:1, PSA 43:2, PSA 71:11, PSA 74:1, PSA 89:38

Their prayers

PSA 38:21–38:22 See also 1KI 8:57; PSA 27:9, PSA 71:9, PSA 71:18, PSA 119:8; JER 14:9

Jesus Christ's feelings of abandonment

MAT 27:46 parallel MRK 15:34 See also PSA 22:1; ACT 2:27; PSA 16:10

God promises never to abandon his people

DEU 31:8 See also LEV 26:44; DEU 4:31, DEU 31:6; 1SA 12:22; PSA 37:25, PSA 37:28, PSA 94:14; ISA 49:14–49:16; MAT 28:20; 2CO 4:9; HEB 13:5

Examples of people who were abandoned

GEN 16:7–16:8 Hagar; ; 1SA 30:13 a slave; ; ISA 49:15 a newborn baby; ; EZK 16:3–16:6 Jerusalem; ; ACT 14:19 Paul

5771: abstinence

The deliberate decision to do without something, especially as a form of spiritual discipline expressing commitment or repentance.

5772: abstinence, from drinking

See 4436: [drinking](#), [abstention from](#)

5773: abstinence, as a discipline

Israel's abstinence from certain sorts of meat

LEV 7:22–7:27, LEV 11:1–11:47; ; DEU 14:1–14:21; ; ACT 10:9–10:14 God used the food laws to teach Peter a spiritual lesson.

Israel's abstinence from other things

EXO 19:14–19:15; LEV 16:29–16:31; NUM 6:1–6:4 See also EXO 31:16–31:17; NUM 29:7; JDG 13:4; ISA 21:4

Abstinence from food

As an expression of repentance

1SA 7:5–7:6; EZR 10:6 See also 2SA 1:11–1:12; NEH 1:3–1:4; JOL 2:12; JON 3:5

Expressing a seeking after God

ACT 13:1–13:2 See also MAT 4:1–4:2 parallel LUK 4:1–4:2; MAT 9:14–9:15 parallels MRK 2:18–2:20, LUK 5:33–5:35; LUK 2:36–2:37; ACT 9:9, ACT 14:23; ROM 14:6

Temporary sexual abstinence as a form of discipline

EXO 19:15; ; 1SA 21:4–21:5; ; 1CO 7:5

Denial of selfish desires

MAT 16:24 parallels MRK 8:34, LUK 9:23 **1PE 2:11** See also ROM 13:13

Voluntary abstinence for the sake of others

1CO 8:13 See also ACT 15:19–15:20, ACT 15:29, ACT 21:25; ROM 14:21; 1CO 9:12, 1CO 9:19–9:27, 1CO 10:15–10:31

Abstinence may be hypocritical

MAT 6:16 See also ISA 58:3–58:7; JER 14:10–14:12; ZEC 7:2–7:6; LUK 18:11–18:12; 1TI 4:2–4:5

5775: abuse

The deliberate misuse of gifts or privileges, and the insulting of individuals. Scripture stresses that neither God's gifts nor his people are to be abused.

The abuse of God and his people

Of God himself

2KI 19:16

Of God's people

NEH 4:1–4:4; 1PE 4:4 See also MAT 5:11; ACT 2:13, ACT 17:32, ACT 18:6; REV 2:9

Of God's servants

ACT 2:13 See also 2CH 36:16; PSA 22:6–22:8, PSA 69:7–69:12, PSA 123:3; JER 20:7

Of Jesus Christ

LUK 16:14 See also LUK 23:11

The abuse of Christian freedom is condemned

Believers are required to resist sin

ROM 6:12 See also ROM 6:14; HEB 12:1–12:2; 1JN 5:16–5:18

Grace does not give believers the freedom to sin

ROM 6:1–6:2 See also ROM 6:15, ROM 3:5–3:8; GAL 2:17–2:21

The dangers of abusing Christian freedom

1CO 8:9–8:12 becoming a stumbling-block to others; ; GAL 5:13 indulging oneself; ; 1PE 2:16 as means of covering up evil

Examples of the abuse of Christian freedom

Sexual excesses

1CO 5:1–5:2 See also 1CO 6:12–6:20; REV 2:20–2:22

Abuse of giving

ACT 5:1–5:2

Abuse of the Lord's Supper

1CO 11:20–11:22

Falling back into sin

See also ROM 6:1–6:2; HEB 12:1; 1JN 1:8–1:10

Disobedience towards God

EPH 5:6; ; 1PE 2:8; ; 1JN 2:3–2:4, 1JN 3:4

Abuse of spiritual gifts

1CO 14:1–14:20

Eating food sacrificed to idols

1CO 8:1–8:13; ; REV 2:14, REV 2:20

5776: achievement

Human beings can achieve many things, though any achievement which disregards God is futile. God always achieves what he intends. Anything of eternal value needs God-given resources.

Kinds of human achievement

Accumulation of wealth

EST 1:4 See also 1KI 10:23 parallel 2CH 9:22; 1KI 10:26–10:27 parallel 2CH 9:27; JOB 42:12; ECC 2:4–2:9

Political power

GEN 41:41–41:43 See also 1KI 4:21 parallel 2CH 9:26; EST 1:1, EST 10:2–10:3; DAN 2:37–2:38, DAN 2:48

Buildings

1KI 7:1–7:12; ; DAN 4:30; ; MRK 13:1

Great learning

1KI 4:32–4:34; ; ECC 1:13–1:16; ; DAN 1:17

Military victory

GEN 14:14–14:16; ; EXO 17:8–17:13; ; JOS 8:24–8:26; ; JDG 4:14–4:16; ; 1SA 18:7; ; 2SA 22:35–22:43 parallel PSA 18:34–18:42

Acts of courage

1SA 14:6–14:14, 1SA 17:50; ; 2SA 23:8–23:21 parallel 1CH 11:11–11:23

Spiritual achievements

ROM 15:19 See also LUK 10:17; JHN 14:12; ACT 14:3, ACT 20:26–20:27; 2CO 3:1–3:3; 1JN 2:13–2:14; REV 2:19

Limitations of human achievements

Human achievements can lead to pride

ISA 10:12–10:15 See also DEU 8:10–8:18; 2CH 26:16; DAN 4:29–4:30

Human achievements can give false security

LUK 12:16–12:20 See also 2KI 19:11–19:13 parallel ISA 37:11–37:13; 2KI 19:21–19:28 parallel ISA 37:21–37:29; JER 48:7; 1TI 6:17; REV 18:7–18:8

Human achievements are ultimately futile

ECC 2:11 See also PSA 39:6; ECC 2:17–2:23; ISA 40:6; HAB 2:13

Human achievements do not lead to justification

ACT 13:39; ; ROM 5:1; ; 1CO 6:11; ; GAL 2:15–2:16, GAL 2:21

God can thwart human achievements

GEN 11:1–11:9 God will overthrow all human achievement that is in opposition to him. See also JOB 5:12; PSA 33:10; ISA 13:19; REV 18:10, REV 18:16–18:19

God's achievements

God's purposes are always accomplished

ISA 46:10 See also JOB 42:2; ISA 14:24, ISA 55:10–55:11; JER 23:20, JER 30:24

Creation as God's achievement

PSA 104:24 See also GEN 1:1, GEN 1:31; PSA 104:2–104:23; ISA 40:25–40:26

Salvation as God's achievement

HEB 7:25 See also JHN 17:4, JHN 19:28, JHN 19:30; ACT 4:12; PHP 1:6; HEB 10:14, HEB 12:2

Spiritual resources for human achievements

Achieving things with God's help

PSA 127:1 See also 2SA 22:30 parallel PSA 18:29; 2CH 26:5; ZEC 4:6–4:9; JHN 15:5; ACT 1:8; ROM 15:18–15:19; 1CO 3:6; PHP 2:13, PHP 4:13

Achieving things by faith

MRK 9:23 See also MAT 17:20, MAT 21:21 parallel MRK 11:22–11:23; LUK 17:6

Achieving things through prayer

JHN 14:13–14:14 See also 1SA 1:27; JAS 5:16–5:18

Achievements out of trials and sorrows

2CO 4:17 See also ROM 5:3–5:4; 2CO 7:10, 2CO 12:7–12:10; JAS 1:2–1:4

Achieving things with the help of fellow believers

GAL 6:2 See also ACT 2:42–2:45, ACT 4:32–4:37, ACT 5:12–5:16; PHP 4:13–4:14, PHP 4:18; HEB 10:24–10:25

5777: admonition

A loving attempt to correct another's attitude or behaviour. Christians are to admonish fellow believers.

The prophets admonished Israel

2KI 17:13; NEH 9:29–9:30 See also JDG 6:7–6:10; MAL 2:1–2:4

Parents are to admonish their children

PRO 22:6; EPH 6:4 See also GEN 18:19; DEU 11:19; PRO 13:24, PRO 19:18, PRO 22:15, PRO 23:13

Leaders are to admonish those in their care

2TI 4:2 See also 1CO 4:14; COL 1:28; 1TH 5:12; TIT 2:15, TIT 3:10

Christians are to admonish fellow believers

COL 3:16 See also PSA 141:5; LUK 17:3; ROM 15:14; 1TH 5:14; 2TI 3:16

It is wise to accept legitimate admonition

PRO 13:18, PRO 25:12 See also PRO 15:5; ECC 7:5; JER 2:30, JER 5:3, JER 7:28; ZEP 3:1–3:2, ZEP 3:7–3:8

5778: adorning

A form of ornamentation, using especially jewels and precious metals, to enhance the beauty of buildings or people.

Buildings were adorned with various materials

2CH 3:6 See also PSA 45:8; ISA 60:13; AMO 3:15

Objects of worship were adorned

HOS 10:1 See also JER 10:3–10:4

Women adorned themselves with jewellery and fine clothes

EZK 16:11–16:12 See also 2SA 1:24; JER 4:30; EZK 16:13

Personal adornment should not be allowed to detract from worship

1TI 2:9 See also 1PE 3:3–3:4

Adorning used in a metaphorical sense

ISA 61:10 See also JOB 40:10; PSA 93:5, PSA 144:12; PRO 1:8–1:9; ISA 60:7; REV 21:2

5779: advice

Counsel is essential for gaining wisdom, though human advice is not always reliable. God's advice is necessary and trustworthy for guidance in life.

Human advice

A wise person seeks advice from others

PRO 12:15 See also PRO 11:14, PRO 13:10, PRO 15:12, PRO 15:22, PRO 19:20, PRO 24:6, PRO 27:9; ECC 4:13

Rejecting good advice can lead to disaster

PRO 1:30–1:31 See also 1KI 12:8 parallel 2CH 10:8; 1KI 12:13–12:15 parallel 2CH 10:13–10:15; PRO 1:25–1:26; JER 18:18; ACT 27:11

Human advice can have unseen dangers

PRO 12:5 See also JOB 21:16; PSA 1:1; ISA 19:11; EZK 11:2

Examples of good human advice

EXO 18:17–18:24 Jethro; ; 2SA 17:5–17:16 Hushai; EST 1:13–1:22, EST 2:1–2:4; DAN 4:27 Daniel; ; ACT 5:38 Gamaliel; ; 2CO 8:10 Paul

Examples of bad human advice

NUM 31:15–31:16 Balaam; 2SA 15:31–15:34, 2SA 16:20–16:23, 2SA 17:1–17:4, 2SA 17:21–17:23; 1KI 12:28 Jeroboam; ; ISA 19:11 Egyptian advisers

Seeking advice from false gods is futile

LEV 19:31 See also DEU 18:14; 2CH 25:15–25:16; ISA 19:3, ISA 41:28–41:29, ISA 47:12–47:13

God needs no-one to advise him

ISA 40:13–40:14 See also JOB 12:13; PRO 8:14; ISA 28:29

God gives advice

To his people

PSA 32:8 See also PSA 16:7, PSA 73:24; REV 3:18

Through Jesus Christ and his Spirit

ISA 11:2 See also ISA 9:6; JHN 14:26, JHN 15:26, JHN 16:13

Through his word

2TI 3:16

God frustrates bad advice

1CO 1:19 See also 2SA 17:14; PSA 33:10

Examples of receiving God's advice

David: 1SA 23:1–23:4; ; 2SA 2:1; 1KI 22:5 parallel 2CH 18:4

Examples of rejecting God's advice

Job: JOB 38:2, JOB 42:2–42:3; PSA 106:13, PSA 107:11

5780: advisers

Those who give advice and counsel. Human advice is desirable, but not always reliable. Only God's counsel is wholly dependable.

Human advisers

It is wise to consult advisers

PRO 15:22 See also PRO 12:15, PRO 13:10, PRO 15:12, PRO 19:20, PRO 20:18, PRO 24:6; ECC 4:13

It is folly to reject wise advisers

PRO 11:14 See also 1KI 12:8 parallel 2CH 10:8; 1KI 12:13–12:15 parallel 2CH 10:13–10:15; PRO 1:25–1:26, PRO 1:30–1:31; JER 18:18; ACT 27:11, ACT 27:21

Unwise advisers are dangerous

PSA 1:1 See also JOB 21:16, JOB 42:7; PRO 12:5; ISA 19:11; EZK 11:2–11:4

Advisers who trust in false gods must be rejected

ISA 8:19–8:20 See also 2CH 25:15–25:16; ISA 19:3, ISA 47:13–47:15

Examples of wise advisers

EXO 18:17–18:24 Jethro; DAN 2:23, DAN 2:48, DAN 4:18, DAN 4:27, DAN 5:11–5:12; ACT 5:38–5:39 Gamaliel; ; 2CO 8:10–8:12 Paul

Examples of bad advisers

NUM 31:16 Balaam; 2SA 15:31, 2SA 17:1, 2SA 17:7; 1KI 12:28–12:30 Jeroboam; ; ISA 19:11 Egyptian advisers; ; JHN 11:49–11:53 Caiaphas

Examples of official advisers

GEN 26:26; ; 2SA 15:12, 2SA 16:23; ; 1KI 4:5; ; 1CH 27:32–27:33

God as adviser

God is an adviser

PSA 16:7 See also 1KI 22:5 parallel 2CH 18:4; PSA 32:8, PSA 73:24; REV 3:18

The promised Messiah is an adviser

ISA 9:6 See also ISA 11:2

The Holy Spirit is an adviser

JHN 14:26 See also JHN 14:16, JHN 15:26, JHN 16:13
The Holy Spirit's counsel defends believers from every accusation and provides all necessary teaching and guidance.

5781: affection

Positive feelings towards another, often expressed in terms of attachment and warmth.

People and things arouse affection

Whole churches

PHP 1:7 See also 2CO 7:13–7:15

Friends

1SA 18:1 See also 1SA 18:3, 1SA 20:41–20:42; JHN 11:36; ROM 16:5, ROM 16:9, ROM 16:12; COL 4:14; 3JN 1:1

Strangers

LUK 7:13

The temple

EZK 24:21

Jerusalem

NEH 1:3–1:4 See also PSA 137:6

Affection is sometimes expressed in familial terms

1SA 3:16; 1CO 4:17 See also 1SA 4:16, 1SA 24:11; 2SA 18:22; 2KI 2:12; JHN 13:33; 2CO 6:13; 2TI 2:1; PHM 1:10; 1PE 5:13; 1JN 2:28

Emotions expressing affection

Tenderness

GEN 34:3 See also LUK 7:38; PHP 2:1

Longing

PHP 1:8 See also 2SA 14:1; MAT 23:37 parallel LUK 13:34; ROM 15:23; 2CO 7:11; GAL 4:20; PHP 2:26, PHP 4:1; 2TI 1:4

Openness

2CO 6:11 See also 2CO 6:12–6:13

Compassion

MAT 9:36 parallel MRK 6:34 See also 1KI 3:26; ISA 49:15; LUK 15:20; EPH 4:32; COL 3:12; 1PE 3:8

Sorrow

2CO 2:4 See also PSA 35:14; LAM 2:11; ROM 9:2–9:3

Joy

PHM 1:7 See also PRO 23:15, PRO 27:11; GAL 4:14–4:15; 2JN 1:12

Concern

1CO 4:14 See also PRO 1:8, PRO 27:6, PRO 31:2–31:3; ECC 12:12; 2CO 7:7, 2CO 8:16, 2CO 12:19; GAL 4:11–4:12, GAL 4:19; PHP 4:10; 1TI 1:18

5782: agony

Intense suffering of body, mind or spirit, brought about by illness, death or the judgment of God.

Examples of agony

Agony of body

PSA 6:2 See also PSA 31:10, PSA 42:10; ISA 21:3; JHN 16:21; REV 9:5, REV 16:10

Agony of heart

JER 4:19 See also DEU 2:25; 1SA 1:16 Hannah prays for a son; JOB 6:2, JOB 7:11; PSA 6:3, PSA 25:17, PSA 31:7, PSA 38:8, PSA 55:4; ISA 65:14; MAT 26:38; MRK 14:33; LUK 22:44 Jesus Christ prays on the Mount of Olives; ROM 9:2; 2CO 2:4

Causes of agony

Illness

JER 15:18 See also JOB 30:16–30:17; PSA 6:2–6:3, PSA 38:7, PSA 69:29

Death

ACT 2:24 See also JOB 26:5; PSA 18:4–18:6, PSA 42:10, PSA 55:4, PSA 116:3

The judgment of God

LUK 16:24–16:25 See also JER 4:19; EZK 30:16; MIC 4:10; ZEC 9:5; MAT 22:13, MAT 24:51, MAT 25:30

5783: agreement

Being of one mind with others, whether for good or evil purposes. Agreement among believers is commended as a means of enhancing unity and peace, and building up the people of God.

Agreements made by deliberate choice

Agreement to do good

JOB 2:11 See also NEH 5:9–5:13

Agreement to do wrong

DAN 6:7 See also JER 7:18; LUK 22:5–22:6 parallel MRK 14:11; ACT 5:1–5:2, ACT 23:20–23:21

Legal agreements

Between witnesses

DEU 17:6 See also NUM 35:30; DEU 19:15; RUT 4:9–4:11; MAT 18:16

Treaties

1KI 15:19–15:20 parallel 2CH 16:3–16:4 See also GEN 21:27, GEN 26:28–26:31; JOS 9:15, JOS 11:19; 1KI 5:12, 1KI 20:34

Ways of making agreements

By accepting terms offered

GEN 23:16 See also GEN 30:31–30:34, GEN 34:24; JOS 2:21; JDG 15:12–15:13, JDG 17:10–17:11; ISA 20:16–20:17

Through mutually acceptable terms

GEN 37:26–37:27 See also GEN 13:8–13:9, GEN 26:19–26:22; ACT 15:28–15:29

Agreement reached by persuasion

DAN 1:12–1:14

Agreement commended to believers

Agreement enhances unity

EPH 4:3 See also 2CH 30:12; PSA 133:1; JHN 17:11, JHN 17:21–17:23; ROM 15:5

Agreement avoids division

1CO 1:10 See also ROM 12:16; PHP 2:1–2:3, PHP 4:2

Agreements made before God

Agreement in prayer

MAT 18:19 See also 1KI 1:36; ACT 1:14, ACT 4:24, ACT 12:12; ROM 15:30–15:31

Agreement in praise

NEH 8:6 See also 1CH 16:36 parallel PSA 106:48; PSA 41:13, PSA 72:19; 1CO 14:16; REV 5:13–5:14

Agreement with God's terms

EXO 24:3 See also NUM 5:22; DEU 27:15–27:26; 2KI 23:3 parallel 2CH 34:32; JER 11:1–11:5

5784: amazement

Astonishment and surprise are frequent responses to the actions and words of God and Jesus Christ.

Amazement at God's actions

His marvellous deeds

PSA 98:1 See also JOS 3:5 The LORD promises to do amazing things when his people cross the Jordan; JDG 13:19; 1CH 16:24; PSA 71:17, PSA 72:18, PSA 86:10, PSA 96:3, PSA 118:23; ISA 25:1; DAN 3:24 Nebuchadnezzar is amazed at seeing four men in the furnace; REV 15:1, REV 15:3

His creation

JOB 37:5

His judgment

ISA 29:9; ; HAB 1:5; ; JHN 5:28

Throughout his life Jesus Christ inspired amazement

MAT 27:14 parallel MRK 15:5; ; LUK 2:33, LUK 2:47, LUK 4:22

Amazement at Jesus Christ's teaching

At his inherent authority

MAT 7:28–7:29 See also MAT 13:54 parallel MRK 6:2; MRK 1:22 parallel LUK 4:32; MRK 1:27 parallel LUK 4:36; JHN 7:15

In debate with the Pharisees

MAT 22:22 parallels MRK 12:17, LUK 20:26

In theological debate with the Sadducees

MAT 22:33

After talking with the rich young man

MAT 19:25 parallel MRK 10:26; ; MRK 10:24

After the cleansing of the temple

MRK 11:18 parallel LUK 19:47 Here the crowds' amazement causes the chief priests and teachers of the law to fear Jesus Christ.

Amazement at Jesus Christ's revelation of himself

See also LUK 24:41; JHN 5:20; 2TH 1:10

Amazement at Jesus Christ's miracles

Miracles of healing

MAT 15:31 See also MAT 9:8 parallels MRK 2:12, LUK 5:26 at the healing of the paralytic; MRK 5:42 parallel LUK 8:56 at the healing of Jairus' daughter; ACT 3:10–3:11 at the healing of the crippled beggar

The casting out of demons

MRK 1:27 MAT 9:33; ; LUK 11:14; MRK 5:20 Legion; ; LUK 9:43 a boy with an evil spirit

Miracles of nature

MAT 8:27 parallel LUK 8:25 See also MAT 21:20 the withered fig-tree; MRK 6:51 Jesus Christ walking on the water; LUK 5:9 the miraculous haul of fish

Amazement at the coming of the Holy Spirit and subsequent events

ACT 2:12 See also ACT 2:7, ACT 8:13 Simon's amazement at the miracles performed by Philip; ACT 9:21 amazement at the change in Saul; ACT 10:45 astonishment at the Holy Spirit being poured out on the Gentiles; ACT 12:16 amazement at Peter's release from prison; ACT 13:12

Jesus Christ himself experienced amazement

MRK 6:6; ; LUK 7:9

5785: ambition

A powerful personal drive towards achieving goals which are regarded as being of importance to the individual. Ambition is viewed negatively when these goals are selfish or evil, and positively when they are directed towards building up the church or furthering the kingdom of God.

5786: ambition, negative aspects of

In its negative sense, ambition is the pursuit of personal status and fortune, which is contrary to the purposes of God as expressed in Scripture.

Selfish ambition: a desire for personal aggrandisement

MRK 10:36–10:37 See also GEN 11:4 the men of Babel; 2SA 15:1–15:4 Absalom; 1KI 1:5 Adonijah; ISA 14:13–14:14 the king of Babylon; EZK 28:2 the ruler of Tyre; DAN 11:36–11:38; MIC 7:3; HAB 2:4–2:5; MAT 20:21; LUK 22:24; PHP 1:17; 2TH 2:4–2:7 the antichrist

Selfish ambition arises from fallen human nature

GAL 5:19–5:21 See also PRO 6:18; EPH 2:3; 1JN 2:16

The results of selfish ambition

Humiliation by God

MAT 23:12

The believer becomes spiritually unproductive

See also MRK 4:18–4:19; JAS 3:14–3:16

Warnings against selfish ambition

PHP 2:3 See also JER 45:5 God's word to Baruch

5787: ambition, positive aspects of

In its positive sense, ambition is a personal desire for spiritual progress or achievement.

A longing for God and for what he can do in the believer

MAT 5:6; PHP 3:13–3:14 See also PHP 3:10; PSA 40:8; LUK 13:24; COL 1:29; 1TH 4:11; 2TI 2:15; HEB 12:1; 1PE 2:2; 2PE 3:14

The desire for spiritual gifts

1CO 14:12 See also 1KI 3:10–3:14 parallel 2CH 1:11–1:12; 1CO 12:31, 1CO 14:1, 1CO 14:39

The desire for a leadership role in the church

1TI 3:1

The longing for communion with God

PSA 27:4 See also PSA 73:25, PSA 84:2

The compelling desire to preach the gospel

ROM 15:20 See also 1CO 9:16; PHP 1:15–1:18 Jesus Christ can be proclaimed, despite selfish personal ambition.

Focus on future rewards

1CO 9:24–9:27 See also 2TI 4:8; HEB 10:35–10:36, HEB 11:26

5789: anger

A state of indignation and outrage, often resulting from distress caused by injustice or insult. Scripture affirms God's righteous anger against sin and urges moderation in regard to human anger.

5790: anger, divine

The anger of God is directed against all human sin, disobedience, rebellion and wickedness, which threaten to thwart his purposes for his creation and people.

Causes of divine anger

Disobedience

ISA 5:24–5:25 See also NUM 22:22; JOS 7:1; 2KI 22:13; PSA 78:21–78:22; MIC 5:15; ZEC 7:12; MRK 3:5; ROM 2:5; EPH 5:5–5:6; HEB 3:7–3:12

Sinfulness

ISA 57:17 See also 1KI 8:46, 1KI 11:9; 2CH 19:2, 2CH 32:25; EPH 2:1–2:3; COL 3:5–3:6

Apostasy and idolatry

NUM 25:3 See also DEU 4:25, DEU 9:8; JOS 22:18, JOS 23:16; JDG 2:19–2:20, JDG 10:6–10:7; 1KI 14:15; 2KI 22:17; EZR 9:14; JER 7:17–7:18

The characteristics of God that provoke his anger

He is a holy God

PSA 7:11 See also JOS 24:19–24:20; JER 10:10

He is a jealous God

DEU 6:15 See also 1KI 14:22; PSA 79:5; EZK 16:38; NAM 1:2

He is the universal judge

PSA 79:6 See also EZR 8:22; ISA 34:2; ZEP 3:8

He is also compassionate and slow to anger

PSA 103:8 See also EXO 34:6; NEH 9:17; PSA 78:38, PSA 86:15; JON 4:2; NAM 1:3

Consequences of divine anger

Death and destruction

DEU 9:8 See also EXO 15:7, EXO 32:10–32:11; NUM 11:1–11:2; JOB 4:9; ISA 13:5; JER 32:29

Present judgment

LAM 2:2 See also NUM 32:13; 2KI 13:3; ISA 51:20; EZK 7:8; HAB 3:12; MAT 21:12–21:13

Future judgment

ISA 13:9 See also DAN 8:19; MAT 3:7; ROM 2:5

God's rejection of his people

JER 7:29 See also DEU 31:17; 2KI 17:18, 2KI 23:25–23:27; PSA 78:59, PSA 89:38; LAM 2:6–2:7

Being saved from the anger of God**God's anger may be temporary**

PSA 30:5 See also PSA 103:9; ISA 54:8, ISA 57:16, ISA 60:10

God's anger cannot be averted by human means

ZEP 1:18 See also PRO 11:4

Humility and repentance are required

ZEP 2:3 See also GEN 18:30–18:32; DEU 9:18–9:19; 2CH 12:7, 2CH 12:12, 2CH 30:8; ISA 64:9; JOL 2:13

God's anger is averted on account of his love for believers

LAM 3:22 See also HOS 11:9

God's anger is averted on account of the work of Jesus Christ

ROM 5:9 See also JHN 3:36; 1TH 1:10, 1TH 5:9

5791: anger, human

Human anger arises for a number of reasons, some of which are acceptable and others which are not. Scripture stresses the potentially destructive aspects of human anger and urges moderation.

Reasons for human anger**Jealousy**

GEN 4:4–4:5 See also 1SA 17:28, 1SA 18:8; 1KI 21:4; LUK 15:28

Pride

JON 4:1 See also 2SA 3:8, 2SA 6:8; 2KI 5:11; 2CH 26:19

The truth

2CH 16:10 Hanani had prophesied against the king. See also NUM 24:10; JER 37:15

Human anger is sometimes justified

EXO 32:19 See also EXO 11:8, EXO 16:20; NUM 16:15; LEV 10:16; 1SA 11:6, 1SA 20:34; 2SA 12:5; NEH 5:6; MRK 3:5; LUK 14:21

Results of human anger**Strife**

GEN 4:8 See also 1SA 20:30; PSA 124:2–124:3; PRO 29:22, PRO 30:33

God's judgment

MAT 5:22 See also GEN 49:5–49:7

Sin

JAS 1:20 See also PSA 4:4; PRO 14:17; 2CO 12:20; EPH 4:26

Dealing with anger**Becoming slow to anger**

1CO 13:5 See also ECC 7:9; TIT 1:7; JAS 1:19

Not taking revenge

ROM 12:19

Renouncing anger

EPH 4:31 See also PSA 37:8; COL 3:8; 1TI 2:8

5792: appetite

A hunger or desire for something. Although the primary reference of the term is to a hunger for food, it can also refer to other human desires. Scripture distinguishes between healthy and unhealthy appetites, indicating what it is appropriate to seek after.

Appetite as physical hunger

NUM 11:6; PRO 6:30 See also PSA 107:5–107:9; PRO 16:26; ECC 6:7; ISA 29:8; JER 31:25, JER 50:19; LAM 2:12

Appetite as a spiritual hunger

PSA 143:6; PRO 25:25; MAT 5:6 See also PSA 119:20, PSA 119:131

The gospel satisfies human hunger and thirst

JHN 4:13–4:14, JHN 6:35 See also PSA 42:2; ISA 55:1; JHN 6:27, JHN 6:50–6:51, JHN 7:37; REV 21:6, REV 22:17

Lust as sexual appetite

PRO 6:25; ; EZK 23:11; ; COL 3:5; ; 1TH 4:3–4:5

5793: arrogance

Proud and unpleasant behaviour towards other people, based on a belief in one's own superiority or greater importance.

Arrogance characterises the wicked person**As an attitude of the heart**

MRK 7:21–7:22 See also JOB 35:12; PSA 10:2–10:11, PSA 73:3–73:12, PSA 86:14, PSA 94:3–94:7; MAL 3:15; ROM 1:28–1:31

Arising from self-confidence

ISA 9:9–9:10; DAN 4:29–4:30; REV 18:7 See also EXO 15:9; 1KI 20:11; 2KI 14:10 parallel 2CH 25:19; ISA 28:15; EZK 16:49; HOS 12:8; HAB 2:4–2:5; LUK 18:9; ACT 8:9–8:10; 2PE 2:10–2:12

Issuing in words

PSA 17:10; PSA 119:51; JAS 3:5 See also 1SA 2:3; PSA 31:18; PSA 119:69; PSA 123:4; PRO 17:7; PRO 21:24; JER 43:1–43:2

Arrogance is essentially rebellion against God

DEU 1:43; 1SA 15:23 See also NEH 9:16–9:17; NEH 9:29; JOB 36:8–36:9; PSA 5:5; PSA 119:85; HOS 5:4–5:5; HOS 7:10; ZEP 3:1–3:4

Arrogance may even be found in the church

2CO 12:20 See also 1CO 4:18; 1TI 6:17

The godly should reject arrogance

PRO 8:13; JER 9:23–9:24 See also JER 13:15; ROM 11:20; 1CO 1:28–1:31; 1CO 4:7; 1CO 13:4; EPH 2:8–2:9

God punishes the arrogant

ISA 2:17–2:18 See also EXO 18:11; 1SA 15:23 The LORD rejects Saul as king; 2CH 36:15–36:16; NEH 9:10 the arrogance of Egypt punished; PSA 75:2–75:4; PSA 119:21; PSA 119:78; ISA 2:11; ISA 5:15; ISA 13:11; JER 48:29–48:30; JER 50:31–50:32; EZK 7:8–7:10; DAN 5:20 Nebuchadnezzar deposed; ZEC 10:11

5794: asceticism

Rigorous self-denial of bodily pleasures and needs. This can be motivated either by a praiseworthy desire to dedicate oneself completely to God, or by an erroneous belief that the physical body is evil.

Types of ascetic practice**The ascetic practice of fasting**

EST 4:15–4:16 See also JDG 20:26; 2SA 1:11–1:12; JER 36:5–36:6; LUK 2:37

The ascetic practice of wearing sackcloth and ashes
DAN 9:3 See also 1KI 21:27; NEH 9:1; EST 4:3

The ascetic practice of celibacy

1CO 7:1 See also EXO 19:15; 1SA 21:4; 1CO 7:8; 1CO 7:36–7:38; REV 14:4

People who practised asceticism**The Nazirites and asceticism**

NUM 6:1–6:8; ; JDG 13:4–13:5; JDG 16:17

John the Baptist and asceticism

MAT 3:4 parallel MRK 1:6; ; MAT 11:18 parallel LUK 7:33

John's disciples, the Pharisees and asceticism

MAT 9:14 parallels MRK 2:18; LUK 5:33; ; LUK 18:12

The Jews and the ascetic practice of regular fasting

LEV 23:26–23:32; ; ZEC 7:1–7:5

Jesus Christ refuses to enforce ascetic practices

MRK 2:18–2:19 parallels MAT 9:14–9:17; LUK 5:34–5:35

Ascetic practice symbolises separation from the world and dedication to God**Asceticism as a sign of repentance**

JON 3:6–3:9 See also 1SA 7:6; EZR 10:6; JOL 1:13–1:14

Asceticism accompanying prayer

EZR 8:23 See also 2SA 12:16; NEH 1:4; ACT 14:23; 1CO 7:5

Ascetic dedication to God's service

1CO 9:27 See also DAN 1:8; MAT 19:12; 1CO 7:32–7:35

False asceticism opposed**Rejection of fasting without true repentance**

ISA 58:3–58:7; ; JOL 2:12–2:14

Condemnation of ostentatious asceticism

MAT 6:16–6:18

Asceticism not necessary for right worship and conduct

COL 2:20–2:23; ; 1TI 4:1–4:5 Asceticism that is based on a negative view of the material world is rejected.

5795: bereavement

The experience or status of suffering the loss through death of a close relative or friend.

5796: bereavement, experience of

Scripture gives many examples of how people respond to the death of those they love.

The experience of bereavement**Abraham**

GEN 23:1–23:2

Jacob

GEN 37:35 See also GEN 42:38; GEN 48:7

Joseph

GEN 50:10

David

2SA 18:33 See also 2SA 1:11–1:12; 2SA 3:32; 2SA 12:15–12:21

Job

JOB 1:20 At the news of the deaths of his sons and daughters. See also JOB 17:7

Jesus Christ

JHN 11:35 Because of the death of his friend, Lazarus.

The early Christians

ACT 8:2 See also ACT 9:39

The expression of grief

GEN 37:34; PSA 31:9 See also DEU 34:8; 1SA 2:33; 2SA 1:17, 2SA 3:31–3:34, 2SA 14:2; 2CH 35:25; PSA 35:14; ISA 16:7; LAM 3:48; EZK 24:17; ZEC 12:10 prediction of mourning for the Messiah; PHP 2:27

Grief passes with time

GEN 24:67, GEN 38:12; ; 2SA 12:24

5797: bereavement, God's comfort in

God cares for the bereaved, and can turn their mourning into joy and hope.

God comforts the bereaved and the sorrowful

LAM 3:32–3:33; 2CO 1:3–1:4 See also PSA 116:8; MAT 5:4; REV 7:17

Mourning turned into joy

PSA 30:11 See also ISA 61:1–61:3; JER 31:13; JHN 16:20

Despair turned into hope

1TH 4:13–4:14 “Falling asleep” was a euphemistic way of talking about dying.

Fear turned into assurance

PSA 23:4; ISA 25:8–25:9 In the OT, death was generally feared because it meant the loss of meaningful existence. However, like several references, this one looks beyond the grave and anticipates NT hope for all who trust in God; **ROM 8:38–8:39** Paul's conclusion after working through the implications of the gospel. See also JHN 11:25–11:26; 1CO 15:55–15:57; 2CO 5:6–5:8; PHP 1:21–1:24; REV 21:4

God's care for widows and orphans

DEU 10:18; PSA 10:14 See also PSA 68:5, PSA 146:9; JER 49:11; HOS 14:3

Jesus Christ cared for the bereaved

LUK 7:11–7:13; JHN 11:33 At the grave of his friend, Lazarus. See also LUK 8:49–8:56

Caring for the bereaved

DEU 24:19 Special provisions in the law for the bereaved; **ROM 12:15** See also DEU 26:12; JER 22:3; ACT 6:1–6:3 The early church provided for widows in the fellowship with a special fund; 1TI 5:3; JAS 1:27

5798: betrayal

The treacherous exposing or deceiving of people by those they formerly trusted. It is usually associated with an enemy masquerading as a friend, or with a broken or abused relationship. Betrayal was suffered by Jesus Christ and can be expected by his followers.

Betrayal is part of human experience**Examples of those experiencing betrayal**

PSA 41:9 See also JDG 16:18; 1SA 18:17; 2SA 19:26–19:27; PSA 55:12–55:14 Betrayal carries acute feelings for its victims; JER 12:6; LAM 1:2, LAM 1:19

Examples of those murdered through betrayal

The power struggles of Israel's early kingship period gave rise to many bloody betrayals: 2SA 3:27, 2SA 4:6, 2SA 11:15, 2SA 13:28–13:29, 2SA 20:10; ; 1KI 21:8–21:10

Betrayal is seen as a particularly wicked act

ISA 33:1 See also 1CH 12:17; PRO 25:9–25:10; ISA 24:16–24:17; MAT 26:24 parallels MRK 14:21, LUK 22:22

The betrayal of Jesus Christ**Judas determines to betray Jesus Christ**

MAT 26:14–26:16 parallels MRK 14:10–14:11, LUK 22:3–22:6

Jesus Christ's knowledge of events

MAT 26:21–26:23 parallel MRK 14:18–14:20 See also MAT 20:17–20:19 parallel MRK 10:33–10:34; LUK 22:21; JHN 13:11, JHN 13:18; PSA 41:9; JHN 13:21–13:27

Jesus Christ is betrayed by a kiss

MAT 26:47–26:49 parallels MRK 14:43–14:45, LUK 22:47–22:48 The kiss featured in several betrayals as part of feigned friendship (see e.g., 2Sa 20:9–10 and Pr 27:6).

The betrayer's remorse

MAT 27:3–27:5

Betrayal may be part of Christian experience

MAT 10:21 parallels MRK 13:12, LUK 21:16 See also DAN 7:25; MAT 10:35–10:36; MIC 7:6

Betrayal as a sign of the end times

MAT 24:10

God never betrays those who trust in him

PSA 89:33 See also PSA 118:8, PSA 125:1; PRO 29:25; ISA 26:3–26:4; 2TI 1:12

5799: bitterness

A feeling of anger and resentment, caused particularly by perceived unfairness in suffering or by adverse circumstances.

The causes of bitterness

Adverse personal circumstances

JOB 10:1 See also GEN 27:34; RUT 1:20 “Mara” means “bitter”; ISA 30:6; 2SA 13:36; 2KI 4:27; PSA 55:4–55:14; PRO 17:25; JER 6:26

External circumstances

EZK 3:14 Because of the exiles’ hardness of heart. See also JOB 21:25; JOB 27:2; LAM 3:1–3:20; EZK 21:6

Human failure

MAT 26:75 parallel LUK 22:61–22:62 See also EZR 10:1; JER 2:19; JER 4:18; LAM 1:4

Bitterness is evidence of a sinful heart

ACT 8:23 See also ROM 3:10–3:18

Bitterness is to be avoided

HEB 12:15 See also EPH 4:31; JAS 3:14

The remedy for bitterness

Forgiveness

GEN 33:1–33:11; ; LUK 15:25–15:32; ; EPH 4:31–4:32

The causes of bitterness will pass away

PSA 37:1–37:2

Examples of bitterness in people’s lives

See also RUT 1:19–1:21; 2SA 13:22; EST 5:9; LUK 15:30

5800: blasphemy

The profaning, desecration and taking in vain of the name of God, or the reviling of any of his works or deeds. It is strongly forbidden by God as dishonouring to his name.

Blasphemy strongly forbidden

EXO 20:7 parallel DEU 5:11 See also EXO 22:28; LEV 18:21; LEV 19:12; LEV 22:32; NUM 15:30–15:31

Blasphemy against God punished

LEV 24:10–24:16; LEV 24:23; ; 2KI 19:20–19:37 parallel ISA 37:21–37:38

Blasphemy against the Holy Spirit is unpardonable

MRK 3:28–3:30 parallels MAT 12:31–12:32, LUK 12:10 See also HEB 10:29

God blasphemed indirectly

Rejecting his word and his servants blasphemes God
NEH 9:26 See also 2CH 36:16; PSA 107:11; ISA 5:24

Defiling sacred things blasphemes God

LEV 22:1–22:2 See also EZK 20:27–20:28, EZK 22:26; MAL 1:6–1:13

Despising the poor blasphemes God

PRO 14:31 See also AMO 2:7; JAS 2:5–2:7

Speaking against his people blasphemes God

ZEP 2:8–2:11; ; ACT 9:4–9:5 To persecute the church is to persecute Jesus Christ; ; ACT 26:9; ; 1TI 1:13; ; REV 2:9

Slandering celestial beings blasphemes God

2PE 2:10–2:12; ; JUD 1:8–1:10

The sins of God’s people may cause others to blaspheme

1TI 6:1 See also 2SA 12:13–12:14 The phrase “you have made the enemies of the LORD show utter contempt” reflects a scribal tradition which avoided any reference to blasphemy. The underlying idea of blasphemy would have been obvious to the original readers; EZK 36:20–36:23; ROM 2:24; ISA 52:5

God’s enemies blaspheme him

PSA 139:20 See also PSA 74:10–74:11, PSA 74:18; DAN 7:25, DAN 11:36; 1CO 12:3; 2TH 2:4; REV 13:5, REV 16:9, REV 16:11, REV 16:21, REV 17:3

False accusations of blasphemy

Jesus Christ falsely accused of blasphemy

MRK 2:6–2:7 parallels MAT 9:3, LUK 5:21 See also MAT 26:65–26:66 parallel MRK 14:63–14:64; JHN 10:33–10:36

God’s servants falsely accused of blasphemy

1KI 21:9–21:13; ; ACT 6:11–6:14

5801: brokenness

God breaks the spirit of the proud and arrogant so that in their humility and brokenness they may come to repentance and restoration. A crushed heart or spirit may be caused by tragic circumstances or by God’s judgment.

Brokenness before God

PSA 51:17 See also PSA 34:18, PSA 51:8; ISA 57:15, ISA 66:2; ZEC 12:10

Brokenness of heart

PSA 147:3 See also PSA 34:18, PSA 69:20, PSA 109:16; ISA 61:1; JER 23:9; EZK 21:6–21:7

Brokenness of spirit

JOB 17:1 See also JOB 30:24, JOB 31:38–31:40

Brokenness as a result of God’s judgment

On individuals

ISA 1:28 See also JOB 24:20; ISA 8:12–8:15, ISA 65:14–65:15; JER 22:24–22:30

On nations

EZK 32:28 See also JER 48:4–48:5, JER 48:16–48:17, JER 48:38–48:39, JER 50:23–50:24, JER 51:6–51:10

Brokenness as contrition

ISA 66:1–66:2 See also PSA 34:18, PSA 51:16–51:17; ISA 57:14–57:21

5802: care

A practical outworking of loving vigilance, efforts and tenderness. Care is perfectly shown by God. People should imitate God's care, but human care is often limited, faulty or misplaced in self-centred ways.

Caring as part of God's character**God's care for his children**

PSA 121:3 See also PSA 8:4, PSA 23:1, PSA 65:9, PSA 115:12; MAT 6:32 parallel LUK 12:30; MAT 10:30–10:31 parallel LUK 12:7; LUK 15:20 God is the father in this parable.

Human care should reflect God's nature

JHN 15:12 See also GEN 37:14; ISA 10:2; 2SA 18:29; EST 2:11; LUK 10:34–10:35; ACT 20:31; PHP 4:10, PHP 4:14; 1TH 3:10

God's care contrasted with human care

ISA 49:15 See also PSA 118:9; EZK 34:2–34:3, EZK 34:11–34:12; ZEC 10:2–10:3; JHN 10:13–10:14; 1TI 3:5

Care involves responsibility

GEN 2:15 See also GEN 39:4; NUM 1:50; PRO 29:7; MAT 21:33–21:34, MAT 21:41 parallels MRK 12:1–12:2, MRK 12:9, LUK 20:9–20:10, LUK 20:16; 1TI 6:20

God's care reflected in human relationships

EPH 5:25 See also PSA 103:13–103:14; ECC 11:5; ISA 49:15; EPH 6:1, EPH 6:4; 1TI 5:8

To be careless or uncaring is wrong

JER 48:10 See also DEU 8:14; 2CH 24:5; ISA 47:8; ZEC 7:9–7:10; MAT 12:36

Care for worldly things is wrong

PHP 4:6 See also ECC 5:12; MAT 6:31–6:32 parallel LUK 12:29–12:30; MAT 13:22 parallels MRK 4:18–4:19, LUK 8:14; LUK 10:40–10:42, LUK 21:34; 1CO 7:32–7:34

God relieves his people of cares

1PE 5:7 There is a vital distinction between “care” in the sense of “loving care” which Christians are to practise, and “worldly care” in the sense of “anxiety” which Christians should transfer to God, since they and their needs are his responsibility. See also PSA

37:25, PSA 55:22; PRO 3:5–3:6; ISA 53:4; MAT 11:28–11:29; LUK 12:11–12:12; JHN 14:1

5803: carelessness

A lack of attention to one's thoughts and deeds, or a failure to give adequate thought to the consequences of one's actions, often leading to distressing results.

Carelessness in speech

LEV 5:4 See also PRO 20:25; ECC 5:2, ECC 5:6; MAT 12:36

Warnings against carelessness in actions

EXO 21:33–21:34 See also EXO 21:22–21:25, EXO 21:28–21:29, EXO 21:35–21:36, EXO 22:5; LEV 5:2–5:3; NUM 35:22–35:24

Unintentional sins resulting from carelessness**By the nation**

LEV 4:13 See also NUM 15:22–15:26

By an individual

LEV 4:27 See also LEV 4:2–4:3, LEV 4:22–4:23; NUM 15:27–15:28, NUM 35:22–35:24

Examples of carelessness**Careless speech**

JDG 11:30–11:35 See also GEN 25:29–25:34; MAT 14:6–14:11 parallel MRK 6:21–6:28

Careless actions and omissions

MAT 7:26–7:27 parallel LUK 6:49 See also MAT 25:1–25:13

5804: charm

The gracious effect of attracting and captivating others or the subtle ability to deceive and mislead them.

Charm to attract and captivate others**King Xerxes by Esther**

EST 2:17

A husband by his wife

PRO 5:18–5:19

The lovers in the Song of Solomon

SNG 1:15–1:16 See also SNG 2:14, SNG 4:9–4:10, SNG 5:16, SNG 6:4–6:5, SNG 7:6

Charm to deceive people

PRO 26:24–26:25 See also PRO 6:25–6:26, PRO 31:30

The devil subtly seeks to deceive people

2CO 11:3, 2CO 11:14 See also GEN 3:1–3:5, GEN 3:13; MAT 4:1–4:11 parallels MRK 1:12–1:13, LUK 4:1–4:13

Absalom deceived others

2SA 15:1–15:6

False teachers use charm to deceive others**For their own gain****ROM 16:18** See also JUD 1:16**To draw people away from Jesus Christ****2PE 2:18** See also 2CO 11:13–11:15**Christians must not be deceived by such charm**

EPH 4:14, EPH 5:6; ; COL 2:4

5805: comfort

The consolation and reassurance of those who are in distress, anxiety or need. Such comfort is an essential aspect of human relationships. Scripture declares that God comforts his people in times of distress.

The comfort of friends and relations

JOB 2:11; JHN 11:19 See also GEN 5:29, GEN 24:67, GEN 37:35; RUT 2:13; 2SA 12:24; 1CH 7:22; JOB 16:5, JOB 29:25, JOB 42:11; JHN 11:31; ACT 20:12

Parental comfort

ISA 66:13; 1TH 2:11–2:12 See also ISA 66:11; JER 31:15; MAT 2:18

God's comfort

ISA 49:13; 2CO 1:3–1:4 See also PSA 23:4, PSA 71:20–71:21, PSA 119:50, PSA 119:76; ISA 12:1, ISA 40:1, ISA 51:3, ISA 51:12, ISA 52:9, ISA 57:18, ISA 61:2; JER 8:18, JER 31:13; ZEC 1:3, ZEC 1:17; MAT 5:4; LUK 16:25; PHP 2:1

Comfort as a specific work of the Holy Spirit

JHN 14:16–14:17 The title “Counsellor” may be translated “Comforter”. See also ISA 11:2–11:3; JHN 15:26, JHN 16:7

Comfort within the fellowship of believers

2CO 1:5–1:7 See also 1CO 14:3; 2CO 2:7, 2CO 7:6–7:7; COL 4:11; HEB 12:12

Promises of comfort**When worried**

ISA 43:1–43:13; ; MAT 6:25–6:34; ; PHP 4:4–4:7; ; 1PE 5:7

When lonely

PSA 73:23–73:24; ; ISA 41:10, ISA 49:14–49:16; ; JHN 14:15–14:21

When tired or weary

ISA 40:28–40:31; ; MAT 11:28–11:30; ; 2CO 4:16–4:18; ; PHP 4:12–4:13

When discouraged

PSA 34:18, PSA 42:5; ; LAM 3:20–3:23; ; ROM 8:28–8:39

False comfort**LUK 6:24** See also JOB 16:2; ZEC 10:2**Lack of comfort**

JER 16:7 See also PSA 69:20; ECC 4:1; ISA 51:19, ISA 54:11; LAM 1:2, LAM 1:16–1:17, LAM 1:21

5806: compassion

A quality of care and sympathy, characteristic of God and Jesus Christ, usually shown in acts of kindness and consideration towards those in any kind of difficulty or crisis.

5807: compassion, of GodSee [1030: God, compassion of](#)**5808: compassion, of Jesus Christ**See [2015: Jesus Christ, compassion of](#)**5809: compassion, human**

An attitude of care and concern, grounded in pity and sympathy towards others. Christian compassion towards others should reflect the compassion of God for his people.

Compassion is a vital requirement in Christian character**EPH 4:32; COL 3:12** See also 2CO 1:3–1:5; 1PE 3:8**Compassion needs to be shown in actions**

1JN 3:17 See also ISA 58:6–58:7; MAT 10:42 parallel MRK 9:41; MAT 25:35–25:36; ACT 20:35

Examples of compassionate behaviour**To the oppressed and needy**

JOB 29:12–29:17, JOB 30:25; ; PRO 14:31; ; LUK 10:33–10:35; ; ACT 28:2

To the bereaved

GEN 37:35; ; RUT 2:1–2:20; ; 2SA 10:1–10:2; ; 1CH 7:22; ; JHN 11:19

To children

EXO 2:6; ; 1KI 3:26; ; ISA 49:15

To prisoners

2CH 28:15, 2CH 30:9; ; ACT 16:33–16:34; ; HEB 13:3

To forgiven sinners

2CO 2:7–2:8; ; GAL 6:1

To the sick

JOB 2:11–2:13; ; PSA 35:13

To the solitary

ECC 4:10–4:11

To widows and orphans

ZEC 7:9–7:10; ; JAS 1:27

To Jerusalem

PSA 102:14

God inspires human compassion**DAN 1:9** See also EXO 3:21; PSA 106:46; JER 42:12**God rewards compassion****PRO 14:21** See also PSA 112:4–112:5; PRO 19:17**Lack of compassion**

2SA 12:6; ; PSA 69:20, PSA 109:16; ; EZK 16:5; ; AMO 1:11

Limits of human compassion

DEU 28:53–28:57; ; ISA 13:18; ; JER 21:7; ; LAM 4:10

5810: complacency

A self-satisfied state of negligence or carelessness, especially in relation to one's personal situation.

Spiritual complacency**ZEP 1:12; LUK 12:19** See also DEU 8:14; 2CH 20:33; PSA 10:4; ISA 43:22, ISA 64:7; JER 10:21; EZK 33:31; DAN 9:13; HOS 7:7; ZEP 1:6; HEB 6:12, HEB 12:25**Examples of complacency****JER 6:14; OBA 1:3; 1CO 5:1–5:2** See also PRO 30:20; ISA 16:6; EZK 28:2; HAG 1:2; MAL 1:6–1:14; MAT 7:26, MAT 22:5, MAT 26:33; LUK 12:47–12:48, LUK 14:18; 1CO 4:8; REV 3:15–3:17**Warnings against complacency****AMO 6:1; 2CO 13:5** See also PRO 1:32, PRO 10:4, PRO 12:27; ECC 10:18; ISA 32:9, ISA 32:11, ISA 47:8–47:9; EZK 30:9; 1CO 10:12; HEB 2:3**5811: compromise**

Usually a combination of contrasting values, practices or persons incurring God's disapproval, but it can also be a positive way to achieve a greater good.

God forbids compromising associations**Israel was not to associate with paganism****EXO 20:3** parallel DEU 5:7 See also EXO 23:32–23:33, EXO 34:12–34:16; DEU 7:2–7:4; 1KI 18:21**Christians must not compromise their allegiance****JAS 4:4** See also MAT 6:24 parallel LUK 16:13; ROM 13:14; 2CO 6:14–6:16; GAL 1:6–1:9; JAS 4:8**Israel's compromises with paganism****In worship****1KI 12:28–12:30** The LORD's action in bringing Israel up out of Egypt is here attributed to the golden calves representing Baal. See also EXO 32:2–32:6; JDG 2:11–2:12, JDG 8:27; 2KI 1:2–1:3, 2KI 16:10–16:16, 2KI 17:32–17:33, 2KI 17:41; 2CH 28:22; REV 2:20–2:23**In foreign alliances****ISA 30:1–30:2** See also 2CH 19:2, 2CH 20:35–20:37, 2CH 28:16–28:21; ISA 31:1; HOS 5:13, HOS 7:8–7:9, HOS 7:11**In marriage****1KI 11:1–11:11** See also 1KI 16:31; 2CH 18:1; EZR 9:2; NEH 13:23, NEH 13:25–13:26**Motives for compromise****Fear****GEN 26:7–26:9** See also GEN 12:11–12:13, GEN 12:18–12:19, GEN 19:18–19:20, GEN 20:2, GEN 20:11; GAL 2:12–2:13**Lack of faith****GEN 16:1–16:2** See also GEN 15:2–15:3; 1KI 12:26–12:33**Desire for material things****JOS 7:21** See also HAG 1:2–1:4; MAT 13:22 parallels MRK 4:18–4:19, LUK 8:14; ACT 5:1–5:4; 2TI 4:10**Examples of those who refused to compromise****EST 3:4** See also GEN 39:7–39:12; 1KI 22:13–22:14; DAN 3:18, DAN 6:7–6:10; 2CO 4:2**Compromise as a mutually acceptable solution****For the sake of the gospel****1CO 9:19–9:23** See also ACT 15:19–15:20, ACT 15:28–15:29, ACT 21:20–21:26; ROM 14:19–14:22, ROM 15:1–15:2**As an act of wisdom**

1KI 3:24–3:25, 1KI 12:6–12:7 parallel 2CH 10:6–10:7; ; JER 40:9–40:10

As a means to peace

GEN 13:8–13:9, GEN 26:19–26:22, GEN 37:26–37:27; ; PRO 25:8; ; MAT 5:25 parallel LUK 12:58

5812: concealment

The deliberate hiding from view of a person, object or action. Those who sin against God often attempt to hide from him. The Bible teaches the need to confess sin and receive God's forgiveness. Nothing is concealed from him and all secrets will ultimately be revealed.

Attempted concealment of sin from God

GEN 3:1–3:10 See also NUM 32:23; JOS 7:21; 2KI 17:9; JOB 24:13–24:17; EZK 8:12

Such attempts are foolish

PRO 28:13 See also ISA 29:15

No sin can be concealed from God

HEB 4:13 See also JOB 13:9, JOB 10:14; PSA 44:20–44:21, PSA 69:5; JER 16:17; EZK 11:5–11:6

Concealed sins will be exposed

ECC 12:14 See also JOB 20:27; MAT 10:26 parallel LUK 12:2; ROM 2:16; 1CO 4:5

Sins should be confessed to God and not concealed

1JN 1:8–1:9 See also PSA 32:5–32:6

Believers should not conceal their light

MAT 5:14–5:16

God may conceal matters

COL 2:2–2:3, COL 3:3 Christ is the mystery of God, which has now been made known. Through faith, believers share in this mystery. See also PRO 25:2; DEU 29:29; MAT 13:11, MAT 13:35; MRK 13:32; ACT 1:7; ROM 16:25; COL 1:26

The concealment of people**Of Moses**

HEB 11:23 See also EXO 2:2

Of Israelite spies

JOS 6:25 See also JOS 2:4–2:6, JOS 6:17

5813: conceit

A state of pride arising out of an overestimation of one's own ability, possessions or importance.

The definition of conceit

GAL 6:3

Examples of conceit**In military strength**

2KI 18:33–18:35 See also EXO 15:9; 1SA 17:42–17:44

In the power of idols

DAN 3:15 See also ACT 8:9–8:10

In personal abilities

MAT 26:33 parallel MRK 14:29 See also GEN 16:4; 1KI 20:11; EST 5:10–5:12

In false teaching

1TI 6:3–6:4

In possessions

HOS 12:8

In intellectual ability

PSA 73:7–73:9

In national status

ISA 47:6–47:8 See also ISA 16:6; JER 48:29

God's response to conceit

2SA 22:28; 1CO 1:27–1:29 See also ISA 2:12, ISA 23:9, ISA 47:8–47:11; OBA 1:3–1:4

Warnings against conceit

PHP 2:3 See also PRO 3:7; ISA 5:21; JER 9:23–9:24; ROM 12:3, ROM 12:16; 1CO 3:18–3:21, 1CO 4:7, 1CO 8:2; GAL 5:26; 2TI 3:4

The folly of conceit

PRO 26:12 See also PRO 28:26; ISA 16:6; HOS 10:13–10:14; JAS 3:5, JAS 4:16

The danger of conceit for Christians

1CO 10:12 See also ROM 11:25; 2CO 12:7; 1TI 3:6; 1JN 2:16

Remedies for conceit**Being aware of one's sin**

LUK 18:9–18:14

Being prepared to mix with the lowly

ROM 12:16

Considering others as being superior

PHP 2:3

5814: confrontation**Confrontation in battle****Between armies**

JDG 20:20; 2CH 14:11 See also JDG 20:25; 1SA 4:1, 1SA 17:2, 1SA 31:1; 2SA 10:17; 2CH 13:3

Between individuals

1SA 17:45 See also 2SA 23:21; 1KI 11:14; 2KI 14:11

Personal confrontation**Between individuals**

GAL 2:11 See also EXO 8:20; 2SA 22:19 parallel PSA 18:18; 1KI 22:24; 2CH 26:18; JER 28:10; JHN 18:26; ACT 13:8, ACT 23:2

Between individuals and groups

NUM 16:3; ACT 18:6 See also 1SA 12:7; EZK 16:2; ACT 5:28–5:29, ACT 6:9

Between believers and a sinner

LUK 17:3 See also LEV 19:17; MAT 18:15; GAL 6:1; JAS 5:19–5:20

Confrontation between Jesus Christ and the Pharisees

LUK 11:53–11:54 See also MAT 16:1, MAT 22:15; MRK 2:16, MRK 7:5; LUK 6:2, LUK 19:39; JHN 8:13

Confrontation with God

JOB 9:32; ACT 9:4–9:5 See also GEN 32:24; EXO 15:7; NUM 22:22; 2CH 35:21; JOB 23:13, JOB 31:14, JOB 33:5; PSA 17:13; ISA 30:11; JER 50:24; ACT 11:17

5815: confusion

A state of perplexity, bewilderment or disorder. Confusion may be brought about by God to cause the schemes of the wicked to fail and opposition to his people to prove ineffective. Confusion over spiritual truth is the natural state of humanity; believers, too, may be perplexed by God's purposes or thrown into confusion by false teaching.

Examples of people in confusion

2SA 18:29; ; EST 3:15; ; LUK 21:25–21:26; ; ACT 17:8, ACT 19:32

God sends confusion as judgment

The righteous ask God to confuse their enemies

PSA 35:26 See also PSA 40:14, PSA 55:9, PSA 70:2

God sends confusion on Israel's enemies

EXO 23:27 See also DEU 7:23; PSA 71:24

Israel, too, may experience confusion

DEU 28:20 See also DEU 28:28; 2CH 15:5–15:6; JER 51:34

Examples of God sending confusion

GEN 11:7–11:9 at the tower of Babel; ; JOS 10:10 on the Amorites; ; 1SA 14:20 on the Philistines; ; 2CH 20:22–20:23 on Jehoshaphat's enemies

Spiritual confusion is humanity's natural state

ISA 57:20–57:21 See also ISA 41:29; 1CO 1:18, 1CO 2:14; 2CO 4:3–4:4

Confusion relating to Jesus Christ

Confusion among the Jews

JHN 6:52; ACT 2:6–2:7 See also MAT 12:23–12:24 parallels MRK 3:22, LUK 11:15; LUK 9:7–9:9 parallels MAT 14:1–14:2, MRK 6:14–6:16; JHN 3:4; ACT 2:12; 2CO 3:14

Confusion among Jesus Christ's disciples

MAT 8:27 parallels MRK 4:41, LUK 8:25 See also MRK 9:5–9:6 parallels MAT 17:4, LUK 9:33–9:34; MRK 16:8; LUK 24:22–24:25; JHN 6:60, JHN 16:17–16:19

Further examples of believers in confusion

Confusion over God's purposes

2CO 4:8 See also PSA 73:12–73:14; ECC 7:15; ISA 21:3–21:4; DAN 4:19; HAB 1:2–1:4; 2CO 7:5; GAL 4:19–4:20

Confusion over doctrine

GAL 1:6–1:7 See also GAL 4:9, GAL 4:17, GAL 5:10

Remedies for confusion

Confusion dispelled by asking God for understanding

JER 33:3 See also JAS 1:5

Confusion dispelled by the enlightenment of the Holy Spirit

JHN 14:26 See also JHN 16:13; 1CO 2:9–2:10, 1CO 2:13

Confusion combated by the teaching of wise leaders

ACT 20:28–20:30; ; 2TI 2:24–2:25, 2TI 4:2–4:3; ; HEB 13:17

Confusion dispelled by the instruction of Scripture

PSA 119:103–119:105; ; 2TI 3:16

Confusion goes as believers grow to spiritual maturity

EPH 4:13–4:14 See also PHP 1:9–1:10; HEB 5:14

5816: consciousness

The state of being aware, especially of one's actions and motivations, or of the existence and concerns of others. All people have a general awareness or consciousness of God and of sin, but it is often suppressed or destroyed.

Consciousness of sin

Through the law

ROM 3:19–3:20 See also ROM 7:7–7:13; JAS 2:9–2:10

Through the convicting power of the Holy Spirit

JHN 16:8 See also 1CO 14:24–14:25; JUD 1:14–1:15

Through comparison with God's righteousness

PSA 143:2 See also JOB 25:2–25:6; PSA 130:3–130:4

Consciousness of God

Through an innate knowledge of the creator

ROM 1:19–1:23 See also ACT 17:22–17:31; ROM 1:28; EPH 4:17–4:19

Through the revelation of God in nature

ACT 14:17 See also PSA 19:1–19:6, PSA 50:6

Through observation of divine judgment

EZK 6:13 See also PSA 83:16–83:18; EZK 29:6–29:9, EZK 39:6

Through observation of divine blessing

JOS 4:23–4:24 See also EXO 7:5; DEU 4:35; ISA 52:9–52:10

Lack of consciousness

JOB 14:10–14:12 See also PSA 6:5, PSA 30:9, PSA 31:17, PSA 88:10–88:12, PSA 115:17–115:18; ECC 9:5–9:6, ECC 9:10; ISA 38:18–38:19

5817: conspiracies

Malicious plots or plans to harm or to kill, which may be directed against other people, or even against God. Conspiracies are sometimes motivated by political aspirations, but may be simply an outlet for wrongdoing.

Conspiracies to sin

MIC 7:3 See also PSA 52:2, PSA 64:6; PRO 16:27, PRO 16:30; JER 11:9–11:10; EZK 22:25

Conspiracies to murder

JER 18:23 See also GEN 37:17–37:23; 2SA 11:2–11:17; 2CH 24:20–24:21

Conspiracies to commit genocide

EST 9:24–9:25 See also 2SA 21:1–21:6; EST 3:5–3:9

Conspiracies to hinder the work of God

NEH 4:7–4:8 See also NEH 4:11, NEH 4:15

Conspiracies against kings**Conspiracies to overthrow the king**

2KI 15:10 See also 1KI 15:25–15:28, 1KI 16:8–16:10, 1KI 16:15–16:18; 2KI 9:14–9:24, 2KI 10:9–10:11, 2KI 12:19–12:21 parallel 2CH 24:25–24:26 the assassination of Joash; 2KI 14:17–14:19 parallel 2CH 25:27 the assassination of Amaziah; 2KI 15:15, 2KI 15:23–15:25, 2KI 15:30, 2KI 21:23–21:24 parallel 2CH 33:24–33:25 the assassination of Amon; EST 2:21–2:22, EST 6:2

Conspiracies against King David

2SA 15:10–15:12 See also 1SA 23:7–23:13, 1SA 23:15, 1SA 23:19–23:23; 2SA 15:31; 1KI 1:5–1:10, 1KI 2:28

False accusations of conspiracy against kings

AMO 7:10–7:11 See also 1SA 22:6–22:8, 1SA 22:13–22:16; NEH 6:5–6:9; DAN 2:9

Conspiracies against cities and nations

JER 48:2 See also ISA 7:5–7:6; JER 49:30–49:33; EZK 11:2–11:3; DAN 11:24–11:25; HAB 2:10

Conspiracies against God

PSA 2:1–2:3 See also PSA 21:11, PSA 83:5–83:8; HOS 7:11–7:16; NAM 1:9–1:11

Conspiracies against God's servants

2CH 24:20–24:21 See also PSA 31:13, PSA 35:4, PSA 36:4, PSA 37:12, PSA 38:12, PSA 52:2, PSA 56:5, PSA 59:3, PSA 64:2, PSA 71:10, PSA 83:3, PSA 105:24–105:25; JER 11:18–11:19 a plot against Jeremiah; JER 18:23; LAM 3:60–3:61

Conspiracies against Jesus Christ

MAT 12:14 parallels MRK 3:6, LUK 6:11 See also MAT 26:3–26:4 parallels MRK 14:1, LUK 22:1–22:2; JHN 11:53; ACT 4:27

Conspiracies against Paul

ACT 23:12–23:16 See also ACT 9:20–9:25, ACT 14:1–14:7, ACT 18:12, ACT 20:3, ACT 20:19, ACT 23:30

Conspirators condemned

ISA 33:15–33:16 See also 2SA 12:1–12:12; PRO 3:29, PRO 6:12–6:15, PRO 12:20, PRO 14:22, PRO 24:1–24:2, PRO 24:8; ISA 8:12; MIC 2:1; ZEC 8:16–8:17

5818: contempt

An attitude of scorn and derision. Examples are given of the way in which a rebellious and fallen world treats its creator with contempt.

Contempt of some people for others**Eliab for David**

1SA 17:28

Nabal for David

1SA 25:10–25:11, 1SA 25:14

King Hanun for David's men

2SA 10:4–10:5

Sanballat, Geshem and Tobiah for Nehemiah's men

NEH 2:19, NEH 4:3

Contempt for parents

PRO 15:5, PRO 15:20, PRO 23:22

Contempt from the godless

JOB 16:10; PSA 31:18 See also JOB 19:18, JOB 30:1; PSA 35:21, PSA 42:10, PSA 69:19–69:20, PSA 119:22; ISA 28:9–28:10, ISA 28:14; JER 20:7

God's contempt for the godless

PSA 2:4 See also JOB 12:21; PRO 1:26; NAM 3:6

God will bring contempt on his people

JER 18:16 See also JER 25:9, JER 25:18; EZK 22:4; DAN 9:16; MIC 6:16

Human contempt for God

For God himself

NUM 14:11 See also NUM 14:23, NUM 16:30; PSA 14:1, PSA 73:11

For his law

PSA 78:10 See also LEV 22:9; ISA 30:9; HOS 4:6; MRK 7:9 parallel MAT 15:3; HEB 10:28

For his prophets

2CH 36:16 See also AMO 7:12–7:13; MAT 5:12

For his works

ZEC 4:10 See also HAB 1:5; ACT 13:41

For his day

NEH 13:15–13:21; ; AMO 8:5

For his worship and service

MAL 1:6–1:8, MAL 1:12–1:13, MAL 2:11, MAL 3:8–3:9, MAL 3:14

For his gospel

MAT 7:6

For his kindness

ROM 2:4

For his authority

2PE 2:10

For his patience

2PE 3:3–3:4, 2PE 3:9

Jesus Christ as the object of contempt

Anticipated in prophecy

PSA 22:6–22:8 See also MAT 27:43 **PSA 69:19–69:21** See also ISA 53:3

During his earthly ministry

MAT 13:54–13:57 parallel MRK 6:1–6:4 See also MAT 9:24; LUK 16:14; JHN 9:34

While on the cross

MAT 27:39 parallel MRK 15:29 See also MRK 15:32; LUK 23:39

Contempt will be punished

PRO 1:26 See also PRO 3:34, PRO 19:29, PRO 22:10; EZK 25:3–25:7, EZK 36:2–36:5

Final punishment is contempt

DAN 12:2

5819: cowardice

An unwillingness to act in a situation of danger or opposition, because of fear. Avoiding the source of one's anxiety or fear, rather than dealing with it directly.

Cowardice prevents people from acknowledging Jesus Christ publicly

JHN 12:42–12:43 See also JHN 7:13, JHN 9:22–9:23 parents of the man born blind; JHN 19:38, JHN 20:19

Cowardice inhibits bad as well as good behaviour

MAT 14:5, MAT 21:26, MAT 21:46

Cowardice leads to avoidance of the difficulty

MAT 26:56 See also 1SA 13:6–13:7 the Philistine threat; 1SA 17:24 Goliath; 1KI 19:2–19:3; JON 1:10; MAT 26:69–26:74 parallels MRK 14:66–14:71, LUK 22:57–22:60, JHN 18:15–18:18, JHN 18:25–18:27; LUK 8:37 after the destruction of the pigs; GAL 2:12 Peter

Cowardice can spread within a group

DEU 20:8 NUM 13:30–13:33; ; JOS 14:8; JDG 7:2–7:3; ; JER 38:4

God can work through cowardice

In humbling disobedient people

LEV 26:36–26:39; ; ISA 30:15–30:17

In routing the enemy

Rahab and the Israelite spies: JOS 2:8–2:11, JOS 2:24; 1SA 14:15–14:16 the Philistines

God gives hope to the cowardly or fearful

PRO 29:25 See also DEU 1:27–1:31; JDG 7:10–7:11; PSA 56:3–56:4; ISA 51:12–51:15; LUK 21:12–21:19 **ACT 4:5–4:10**, **ACT 4:13**, **ACT 4:29–4:31**

Judgment on cowards

REV 21:8 Where cowardice meant rejecting the gospel and denying Jesus Christ.

5820: criticism

The judgment or evaluation of others. The word often has negative associations, implying a harsh or disapproving estimate of people or their actions.

5821: criticism, amongst believers

Harsh criticism is out of place among believers, who are urged to see each other in the best possible light. Criticism of God arises from a failure to understand his actions and purposes.

Criticism forbidden among believers

JAS 5:9 See also MAT 7:1–7:5 parallel LUK 6:37–6:42; ROM 14:1–14:4, ROM 14:10–14:13; 1CO 10:10; GAL 5:15; PHP 2:14–2:16; JAS 4:11–4:12

Reacting to criticism

Some criticism can be disregarded

ECC 7:21–7:22 See also 1CO 4:2–4:5; COL 2:16–2:18

Criticism can be dealt with by settling the dispute**MAT 18:15** See also PRO 15:1**Integrity is a defence against criticism****DAN 6:4** See also 2CO 8:20–8:21; TIT 2:7–2:8**Criticism can be constructive****PSA 141:5** See also PRO 10:17, PRO 15:5, PRO 27:6, PRO 27:9, PRO 28:23**Criticism and complaint directed against God****Criticism of God for his apparent injustice****DEU 1:26–1:27** See also JER 20:7–20:9; JON 4:1–4:4; HAB 1:1–1:4, HAB 1:12–1:17; MAL 3:13–3:15; ROM 9:19–9:21; ISA 29:16, ISA 45:9**Criticism of God for his apparent disregard of his people's plight****ISA 40:27** See also PSA 10:1, PSA 13:1–13:2, PSA 22:1–22:2, PSA 42:9–42:10, PSA 44:23–44:24, PSA 74:10–74:11, PSA 80:4–80:6, PSA 108:11–108:12**5822: criticism, against believers**

Many notable servants of God were subject to criticism, which was sometimes vicious and severe. This was particularly true of Jesus Christ, who was constantly subject to complaint and criticism.

Examples of criticism directed against believers**The patriarchs criticised****GEN 31:25–31:30** See also GEN 12:17–12:20, GEN 16:5, GEN 20:9–20:10, GEN 30:1–30:2**Moses criticised****EXO 17:3** See also EXO 2:11–2:14, EXO 5:19–5:21, EXO 14:11–14:12, EXO 15:24, EXO 16:2; NUM 12:1–12:2, NUM 16:1–16:3, NUM 16:12–16:14, NUM 16:41**David criticised****1SA 17:28** See also 2SA 6:16–6:23, 2SA 15:1–15:4**Job criticised****JOB 8:1–8:2** See also JOB 11:1–11:6, JOB 15:1–15:6**The prophets criticised****JER 20:8** See also 1KI 18:17, 1KI 22:24–22:27; AMO 7:10–7:12**Criticism directed against Jesus Christ****Jesus Christ criticised by his family****MRK 3:20–3:21** See also LUK 2:48; JHN 7:2–7:5**Jesus Christ criticised by his disciples****MRK 4:38** See also MAT 16:21–16:23 parallel MRK 8:31–8:33; LUK 10:40; JHN 6:60–6:61, JHN 13:6–13:9**Jesus Christ criticised by the Pharisees****MAT 9:10–9:11** parallels MRK 2:15–2:16, LUK 5:29–5:30
See also MAT 12:1–12:2 parallels MRK 2:23–2:24, LUK 6:1–6:2; LUK 15:1–15:2**Jesus Christ criticised for his teaching****JHN 6:41–6:42** See also MAT 9:3 parallels MRK 2:6–2:7, LUK 5:21; JHN 8:52–8:53**Paul criticised****ACT 21:27–21:28** See also ACT 18:12–18:13; 2CO 10:10**5823: cruelty**

Behaviour in which pain or suffering is deliberately inflicted on others, especially the weak and defenceless.

5824: cruelty, examples of

Scripture condemns cruelty, and gives examples of situations in which it was practised.

Cruelty is an expression of wickedness**PSA 71:4; ROM 1:28–1:31** See also PSA 35:16, PSA 86:14; PRO 17:5; ECC 4:1; AMO 5:12**Forms of cruelty****The cruel nature of war****2KI 8:12** See also 2KI 15:16; ISA 13:15, ISA 13:18; HOS 10:14, HOS 13:16; NAM 3:10**The cruel nature of rape****GEN 34:2** See also JDG 19:25; 2SA 13:14; ZEC 14:2**The cruel nature of words****JOB 17:1–17:2; PSA 42:10; MRK 15:31** See also 1SA 1:6–1:7; JOB 11:3; PSA 22:7, PSA 35:11, PSA 89:50–89:51, PSA 102:8; JER 20:7; LAM 3:14**Particular examples of cruelty**

GEN 37:23–37:24 Joseph's brothers; ; GEN 49:5–49:7 Simeon and Levi; ; EXO 1:22 Pharaoh; ; JDG 1:6 Judah's cruelty to a local king; ; JDG 4:2–4:3 Sisera; ; JDG 10:6–10:8 the Philistines and Ammonites; ; 2CH 16:10 Asa; ; PRO 5:8–5:9 the adulteress; JER 21:7; ; DAN 3:13–3:20; JER 37:15, JER 38:6–38:7; EZK 22:29 Israel; ; NAM 3:18–3:19 the king of Assyria; ; MAT 2:16 King Herod; MAT 27:26–27:31 parallels MRK 15:15–15:20, JHN 19:15; LUK 23:33–23:39 parallels MAT 27:35–27:44, MRK 15:24–15:32, JHN 19:18

5825: cruelty, God's attitude to

God condemns cruelty. As part of the work of redemption, God suffers cruelty from the world in order to redeem believers.

God reproves cruelty**DEU 23:15–23:16; PRO 14:31; ISA 10:1–10:2; EZK 45:9**

See also EXO 22:21, EXO 23:9; LEV 25:42–25:43, LEV 25:46, LEV 25:53; PRO 12:10; ISA 13:11; JER 22:3; ZEC 7:10

God allows cruelty as part of his judgment**ISA 13:9; JER 30:14; LAM 2:17** See also DEU 28:15–28:42 The LORD promises cruel judgment on those who disobey his laws; ISA 19:4; JER 6:22–6:23, JER 13:14, JER 20:16; LAM 2:2, LAM 2:21; HAB 1:5–2:1**God delivers from cruelty****EXO 3:7–3:9; NEH 9:27; PSA 12:5** See also JDG 2:18, JDG 6:9; 1SA 10:18; 2SA 7:10; PSA 72:4, PSA 72:14; ISA 9:4, ISA 25:4–25:5, ISA 29:20**5827: curse**

An expression of contempt or malediction for someone. To be cursed is to suffer various kinds of misfortune, sometimes to the extent of being cut off from one's family or community, or of suffering death itself.

Divine curses**Divine curses came into effect after the fall****GEN 3:14–3:19** See also GEN 5:29, GEN 8:21 This curse refers to the flood; the curse of Ge 3:17 is not revoked here.**Divine curses come from disobeying the law****DEU 28:15–28:19** See also LEV 26:14–26:39; DEU 11:26–11:28, DEU 27:9–27:26, DEU 28:20–28:68, DEU 29:18–29:21; JER 11:2–11:4, JER 11:8; DAN 9:11–9:14; GAL 3:10**Human curses****Human curses upon other human beings****2KI 2:23–2:24** See also GEN 9:24–9:25; JOS 9:22–9:23; 1SA 14:24–14:28; NEH 13:25**Human curses upon God****JOB 2:9; REV 16:9** See also ISA 52:5; EZK 20:27**Human beings are forbidden to curse God and others****LEV 24:15–24:16** EXO 22:28; ; 1KI 21:13; EXO 21:17; ; MAT 15:4 parallel MRK 7:10; ; LEV 20:9; LEV 19:14 cursing the deaf**People can curse the day they were born****JER 20:14** See also JOB 3:1–3:10**Paul wishes himself cursed for the sake of Israel**

ROM 9:3–9:4

Jesus Christ took the curse of the law upon himself**GAL 3:13–3:14** See also DEU 21:22–21:23**Christians are exhorted to bless those who curse them****LUK 6:27–6:28** See also MAT 5:39–5:42 parallel LUK 6:29–6:30; ROM 12:14; 1CO 4:12–4:13**5828: danger**

A condition of threat, physical or spiritual, in which evil, malice, accident or destruction looms.

Physical danger**In nature****LUK 8:23** parallels MAT 8:24, MRK 4:37 See also 1KI 19:11–19:12; PSA 83:14–83:15, PSA 107:23–107:28; ACT 16:26–16:30; 2CO 11:26; REV 11:13**From human violence****PSA 140:1** See also GEN 27:41–27:43; EXO 2:15; 1SA 19:1–19:2; 2SA 22:3; 1KI 19:1–19:3; NEH 4:7–4:9; PSA 7:9, PSA 64:1, PSA 74:20; ECC 12:5; LUK 4:28–4:29; ACT 21:35**Through foolishness****PRO 22:3** See also PRO 27:12; ECC 2:13–2:14**Spiritual danger****From the devil****1PE 5:8** See also GEN 3:1–3:5; JOB 1:6–1:12, JOB 2:1–2:6; MAT 4:1–4:11 parallel LUK 4:2–4:13; JHN 13:2; HEB 2:14; 1JN 3:8; REV 2:10, REV 20:10**Danger of hell through disobedience****MAT 5:22** See also LUK 12:4–12:5; 1CO 5:4–5:5; HEB 6:4–6:6; 2PE 2:4–2:10**Danger of loss through unfaithfulness****1CO 3:13–3:15** See also ROM 6:21, ROM 6:21; 1CO 9:26–9:27; 1TI 6:9–6:10**Danger does not overcome the faithful****ROM 8:35** See also 2TI 3:10–3:11**Examples of those endangered****Israel by her enemies**

EXO 13:17–13:22; ; EST 3:1–3:6

Joseph, through betrayal

GEN 37:18–37:28

Prophets, because of persecution

JER 38:1–38:11

Jonah, through disobedience

JON 1:4–1:17

Jesus Christ, through betrayal

MAT 26:3–26:4, MAT 26:14–26:16

Paul, through shipwreck

ACT 27:13–27:20, ACT 27:42–27:44

5829: defiance

Open refusal to obey any authority. Defiance is seen in the Bible as evil when authority is legitimate but good when authority is ungodly.

Defiance of God is condemned

JER 50:29 See also 1KI 13:21–13:22, 1KI 13:26; PSA 139:19–139:22; ISA 3:8, ISA 65:7; JER 48:26, JER 48:42

To defy God's people is to defy God

1SA 17:10, 1SA 17:23, 1SA 17:25–17:26, 1SA 17:36, 1SA 17:45

Defiance of legitimate authority

ROM 13:2 See also NUM 15:30; 1PE 2:13

Defiance of ungodly authority

DAN 3:28 See also DAN 6:13; ACT 4:19, ACT 5:29, ACT 17:7; REV 20:4

5830: delight

A sense of joy and pleasure, experienced especially through achievements or relationships.

God as the source of delight

Delight in the person of God

ISA 61:10 See also NEH 1:11; JOB 22:26; PSA 22:8, PSA 37:4, PSA 43:3–43:4; ISA 58:13–58:14

Delight in the word of God

PSA 119:16; ROM 7:22 See also PSA 1:2, PSA 19:7–19:14, PSA 119:24, PSA 119:47; JER 15:16

Delight in the works of God

1SA 2:1; ; PSA 35:4–35:10; ; ACT 11:23

God expresses delight

Over his world

PSA 104:31 See also GEN 1:31; PRO 8:30–8:31

Over his people

DEU 30:9–30:10 See also 2SA 22:20; PSA 147:10–147:11, PSA 149:4; ISA 62:4, ISA 65:18–65:19; JER 31:20, JER 32:41; MIC 7:18

Over justice

PRO 11:1 See also PRO 11:20, PRO 12:22; JER 9:24

Over his Messiah

MAT 3:17 parallels MRK 1:11, LUK 3:22 See also ISA 42:1; MAT 12:18–12:21, MAT 17:5 parallels MRK 9:7, LUK 9:35; 2PE 1:17

God's delight is absent when something is viewed unfavourably

ISA 15:22 See also LEV 26:31; PSA 51:16, PSA 147:10

Natural delight in parenthood

PRO 3:12 See also PRO 23:24, PRO 29:17; MIC 1:16

Sexual delight

SNG 1:4 See also GEN 34:19; PRO 5:18; SNG 2:3, SNG 4:1, SNG 7:10

Delight in the created order

In God's gifts

DEU 26:11 See also ISA 55:2; JER 31:12; JOL 2:23

In one's work

ECC 2:10 See also DEU 12:7; ECC 3:22, ECC 5:19, ECC 8:15

In the achievements of others

COL 2:5 See also EXO 18:9; EST 6:9; PRO 14:35; 1TH 2:13–2:14

The delight of believers in their relationship with God

PSA 9:2 See also 1SA 2:1; NEH 1:11; JOB 22:26; PSA 9:14, PSA 13:5, PSA 31:7, PSA 35:9, PSA 37:4, PSA 89:16, PSA 149:2; LUK 1:46–1:47

Delight in wrongdoing

PSA 62:4; 1CO 13:6 See also PSA 68:30; PRO 2:12–2:15, PRO 18:2; ISA 66:3; COL 2:18; 2TH 2:12

5831: depression

A deep sense of despondency, discouragement and sadness, often linked with a sense of personal powerlessness and a loss of meaning in and enthusiasm for life. Many biblical characters show evidence of such behaviour which originates in a number of different ways.

Some causes of depression

External circumstances

2CO 1:8 See also 1KI 19:3–19:4; JOB 9:23; PSA 42:1–42:11, PSA 88:1–88:18; JOL 1:11

Physical illness or exhaustion

1KI 19:5–19:8 See also GEN 21:15–21:16; PSA 6:1–6:7, PSA 22:14–22:17, PSA 31:9–31:12; ISA 38:1–38:2; JON 1:5

Fear of others

1KI 19:1–19:3

Fear of failure

1KI 19:4 See also EXO 4:1; NUM 11:11–11:15

Serious sin

MAT 27:3–27:4 See also PSA 25:16–25:18; JER 14:2–14:3, JER 14:7, JER 16:9–16:10; EZK 4:16–4:17, EZK 7:26–7:27, EZK 12:19; REV 16:10–16:11

A sense of the futility of life**ECC 2:17–2:20****Loss of sense of God's presence****PSA 22:1–22:2** See also MAT 27:46; MRK 15:34**Symptoms of depression****A loathing of life and a desire to end it****NUM 11:15** See also 1KI 19:4; JOB 10:1; ECC 2:17; JER 20:15–20:18; JON 4:8**Deep sorrow****GEN 21:16** See also JDG 21:2; ISA 1:10, 1SA 1:16; PSA 42:3; NEH 1:4, NEH 2:2; EST 4:1–4:3; JOB 16:16; LAM 2:11**Loneliness****1KI 19:10** See also NUM 11:14; 1KI 19:14**Perplexity****PSA 42:5** See also HAB 1:2; LUK 24:17; JHN 16:6**Despair****JOB 17:1** See also PSA 88:3–88:9; 2CO 1:8–1:9**Escapism****PSA 55:6–55:8** See also 1KI 19:1–19:3; JER 8:22**Feeling forsaken by God****PSA 22:1** See also PSA 27:9, PSA 38:21; ISA 49:14; JER 15:18; LAM 3:1–3:20**Examples of spiritual depression**

JDG 6:13; ; 1KI 19:9–19:18; ; PSA 22:1–22:2, PSA 22:6–22:8, PSA 42:1–42:7, PSA 42:9–42:11, PSA 43:1–43:5

Remedies for depression**Renewed vision of God and being centred upon him****1KI 19:11; ISA 26:3** See also JER 17:7–17:8; ROM 8:6**Hope and trust in God****PSA 42:11** See also PSA 22:9–22:11, PSA 22:22–22:31; HAB 3:16–3:18**Praise****PSA 30:1** See also PSA 42:5, PSA 107:1–107:43; ISA 61:1–61:3; 2CO 4:8–4:12**Reviewing what God has done****PSA 77:11–77:12** See also PSA 42:6, PSA 143:5; LAM 3:19–3:26; 2CO 7:6**Prayer****PHP 4:6–4:7** See also PSA 139:23**5832: desire**

A sense of longing for or wanting something. It may be a positive or negative force in the human character, but sinful desire is characteristic of human nature and

must be overcome by the believer. God also expresses desires in Scripture.

Righteous desire**Desire for God****PSA 73:25** See also PSA 42:1–42:2, PSA 63:1–63:8, PSA 143:6; ISA 26:8–26:9**Desire for right living****PSA 40:8** See also PSA 119:174; PRO 22:1; HEB 13:18**Desire for wisdom****2CH 1:7–1:12** parallel 1KI 3:5–3:14 See also JAS 1:5**Desire for spiritual gifts****1CO 14:1–14:5** See also 1CO 12:27–12:31**Desire for church office****1TI 3:1****Sinful desire****DEU 5:21** parallel EXO 20:17 See also PRO 11:6; ROM 1:24, ROM 7:8; 1TI 6:9–6:10; JAS 1:13–1:15; 2PE 3:3; JUD 1:16–1:18**Sinful desire is inherent in human nature****EPH 2:3** See also 2PE 2:10, 2PE 2:18**Following Jesus Christ means putting to death sinful desires****GAL 5:24** See also ROM 8:5–8:14, ROM 13:11–13:14; EPH 4:22–4:24; COL 3:5; 2TI 2:22; 1PE 1:14–1:15, 1PE 2:11, 1PE 4:1–4:5**The tension in believers between the desires of the old and new natures****GAL 5:16–5:17** See also ROM 7:18; JAS 4:1**Sexual desire****GEN 3:16** See also SNG 7:10; 1TI 5:11**Sinful lust condemned****MAT 5:28** See also ROM 1:26; 1TH 4:3–4:4; 1PE 4:3; 2PE 2:18**God's desires****God desires true worship****MAT 12:7** See also HOS 6:6; MAT 9:13; AMO 5:21–5:24; JHN 4:21–4:24; HEB 10:5–10:14; PSA 40:6–40:8**God desires right living****PSA 51:6** See also JAS 1:19–1:20**God's desires for his people****2CH 9:8** See also PSA 132:13

5833: diligence

Conscientious hard work and perseverance, particularly with regard to a relationship with God. In Scripture diligence is highly commended. It may, however, be misguided.

Diligence and its results are commended

PRO 21:5 See also 1KI 11:28; 2CH 24:13; EZR 5:8, EZR 6:12, EZR 7:23; PRO 12:14, PRO 14:23, PRO 31:17 characteristic of the wife of noble character; ECC 3:13; JER 31:16; 2CO 8:11 regarding the collection for the poor Christians in Jerusalem; 1TI 5:17; 1PE 5:2

Diligence contrasted with laziness

PRO 10:4 See also PRO 12:24, PRO 12:27, PRO 13:4; 2TH 3:10

Diligence is important in the outworking of one's relationship with God

1CO 15:58; 1TI 4:15–4:16

Examples of diligence

See also 2CH 15:15, 2CH 29:34 the Levites; ISA 62:6–62:7; ZEC 6:15; LUK 8:15; ACT 17:11 the Bereans ROM 1:15; 1CO 4:12, 1CO 9:24–9:26; 2CO 6:5, 2CO 11:27; 1TH 2:9; 2TH 3:8; 2TI 4:7 ROM 12:8, ROM 16:12; 1CO 12:31, 1CO 14:1; 2CO 8:5 the Macedonian churches; PHP 2:12–2:13; 1TH 5:12; HEB 6:11–6:12; 2PE 1:10; REV 2:2–2:3, REV 2:19

Diligence was a characteristic of Jesus Christ's mission

LUK 9:51 See also HEB 12:1–12:2

Misguided diligence

JHN 5:39–5:40 See also PSA 127:2; PRO 28:20; ECC 1:3, ECC 2:11, ECC 2:19, ECC 4:8; MAT 21:15, MAT 21:23–21:24; 1TI 6:10

5834: disagreement

A failure to be of one mind, which should be avoided whenever possible within the church, the family and other areas of everyday life. Christians are urged to maintain the unity of the church and avoid damaging division.

Disagreement within the church

Between individuals

PHP 4:2 See also MRK 9:33–9:34 parallel LUK 9:46; ACT 15:36–15:40 these differences later reconciled; see 1CO 9:6; 2TI 4:11; 1CO 1:11–1:12, 1CO 3:3–3:4; 2CO 12:20

About doctrine

ACT 15:1–15:2 See also ACT 15:11–15:14, ACT 15:19–15:20; GAL 2:11–2:14

Disagreement in the family

May cause estrangement

MIC 7:6 See also GEN 27:41–27:45, GEN 37:4

Is unpleasant to live with

PRO 19:13, PRO 21:9, PRO 21:19, PRO 25:24, PRO 27:15

Disagreement among witnesses

MRK 14:56 The background to this statement is Dt 19:15, which demands that conviction can only take place on the testimony of two or three agreed witnesses.

The wisdom of avoiding disagreement

2TI 2:14 See also PRO 17:14, PRO 20:3, PRO 26:17, PRO 26:21; ROM 16:17; 2TI 2:23

To prevent division

MAT 12:25 parallels MRK 3:24–3:25, LUK 11:17 See also 1KI 12:16–12:17 parallel 2CH 10:16–10:17

Sin provokes disagreement

GAL 5:19–5:20 See also PRO 6:12–6:14, PRO 17:19; TIT 3:9–3:11; JAS 3:16

Examples where disagreement is inevitable

1SA 11:1–11:2 Nahash's suggestion to the men of Jabesh Gilead; ; 1KI 20:8 Ben-Hadad's demands on Ahab

Examples of resolved disagreement

GEN 13:5–13:9 Abraham and Lot resolve their disagreement over land and livestock; ; GEN 26:19–26:22 Isaac settles a disagreement about the water supply; ; 1KI 3:16–3:27 Solomon resolves a disagreement between two prostitutes.

Ways to resolve disagreement

Settlement out of court

MAT 5:25 parallel LUK 12:58 See also 1CO 6:1

Accepting weaknesses

ROM 14:1

Striving for harmony

1CO 1:10 See also ROM 14:19, ROM 15:5; 2CO 13:11; EPH 4:3; PHP 2:2–2:3; COL 3:13–3:15; 1TH 5:13; 2TI 2:23–2:24; 1PE 3:8

Appointing wise leaders

DEU 1:12–1:13 Moses realised that he was unable to deal with all the people's disputes alone. See also MAT 18:15–18:17; 1CO 6:5–6:6

Being of sound doctrine

1TI 1:3–1:4 See also TIT 3:9–3:10

Those who seek to resolve disagreement are blessed

MAT 5:9 See also JAS 3:18

5835: disappointment

The sadness experienced when people or circumstances do not fulfil expectations.

Disappointment caused by people or circumstances

JOB 6:19–6:21; JER 8:15 See also PSA 10:1; PRO 10:1, PRO 13:12, PRO 17:21, PRO 29:21; ECC 6:2; ISA 49:4; JER 2:36, JER 14:19; LAM 4:17; EZK 37:11

Disappointment as a result of not understanding God's purposes

LUK 24:21 See also JOB 30:26; PSA 73:13; JER 15:18

Disappointment as the result of sin

PRO 11:7; HAG 1:9 See also JOB 11:20; PRO 10:28; LAM 3:18; HOS 13:15; JOL 1:10; ZEC 9:5

Examples of disappointment

RUT 1:20 Naomi at her losses; ; ISA 1:10 Hannah with her childlessness; ; ISA 15:11 Samuel with Saul; ; ISA 30:3–30:6 David and his men at Ziklag; ; 1KI 19:4 Elijah with his own performance; ; MAT 19:22 parallels MRK 10:22, LUK 18:23 the rich young man; ; 2CO 12:21 Paul's possible disappointment with the Corinthians; ; GAL 1:6 Paul with the Galatians

God's disappointment with people

GEN 6:6; 1SA 15:35 See also PSA 78:40; ISA 63:10; EZK 6:9

God does not disappoint his faithful people

JOS 21:45; ROM 5:5 See also JOS 23:14; 1KI 8:56; PSA 22:5, PSA 25:3, PSA 119:116

5836: disgrace

Shame and dishonour that can arise from sin and idolatry. The exile of Israel brought disgrace upon God's name. God's people may suffer disgrace for the sake of Jesus Christ.

Examples of disgrace

Brought on Israel

As the result of Achan stealing what was dedicated to God: JOS 7:1–7:5, JOS 7:11–7:15; 1SA 17:23–17:26 as the result of Goliath's boasting; ; PSA 44:9–44:19 when God no longer acted on Israel's behalf

Brought on Israel's enemies

PSA 6:10, PSA 35:4, PSA 35:26, PSA 40:14, PSA 44:15, PSA 70:2, PSA 71:13, PSA 83:17–83:18

Sin brings disgrace

GEN 3:8–3:10 See also PSA 52:1; PRO 13:5, PRO 14:35, PRO 18:3; JER 3:25; DAN 9:7–9:8; HOS 4:7; ROM 2:23–2:24

False prophets disgraced

JER 23:38–23:40

Idolaters disgraced

ISA 45:16 See also EXO 32:25; ISA 1:29; JER 2:26–2:28; HOS 10:6

The sexually immoral disgraced

PRO 6:32–6:33 See also GEN 34:1–34:7; LEV 20:17; DEU 22:21; JDG 19:22–19:24, JDG 20:4–20:7; 2SA 11:2–11:5, 2SA 12:14, 2SA 13:12–13:14, 2SA 13:22

Barrenness could bring disgrace

GEN 30:22–30:23; ; 1SA 1:6; ; LUK 1:25

The exile brought disgrace upon God's name

EZK 36:20–36:21 See also NEH 1:3, NEH 2:17; JER 22:22, JER 51:51; LAM 5:1–5:2

God's people may suffer disgrace for the sake of Jesus Christ

HEB 11:26 See also MAT 5:11–5:12 parallel LUK 6:22–6:23; ACT 5:41; HEB 13:13; 1PE 2:21, 1PE 4:1, 1PE 4:13, 1PE 5:10

5837: disguise

The hiding of one's personal identity for a variety of reasons

2CH 35:20–35:24 See also GEN 38:13–38:26; 1SA 28:4–28:12; 1KI 14:1–14:6, 1KI 20:35–20:43, 1KI 22:29–22:37 parallel 2CH 18:28–18:34

5838: disrespect

The attitude of heart that leads people to treat God and others in ways that demonstrate a lack of esteem.

Causes of disrespect for God and Jesus Christ

Disrespect caused by a wrong view of God and Jesus Christ

ROM 1:21–1:23 See also LUK 23:8–23:11

Disrespect caused by disobedience to God

NEH 9:26 See also 2CH 24:17–24:20; 2TI 3:1–3:5

Disrespect caused by Satan

ACT 5:3 See also MAT 8:28–8:29 parallels MRK 5:1–5:7, LUK 8:26–8:28

Causes of disrespect for others

Disrespect for others caused by a wrong view of people

MAT 19:13–19:14 parallels MRK 10:13–10:14, LUK 18:15–18:16 The lack of respect for the children arose from the erroneous belief that they were not important enough for Jesus Christ to bother with. See also LUK 10:25–10:37 Those who passed by failed to heed God's command to love their neighbours as themselves; JAS 2:1–2:4

Disrespect for others caused by seeking power and wealth

ECC 4:1 See also JAS 5:1–5:6

Disrespect for others caused by envy

MIC 2:1–2:2 See also GEN 37:3–37:4

Disrespect for others caused by pride and contempt

PSA 31:18 See also MAT 27:27–27:31 parallel MRK 15:16–15:20

Disrespect shown in speech

JAS 3:9 See also MAT 27:39–27:44 parallels MRK 15:29–15:32, LUK 23:35–23:39; 1TI 6:3–6:5

The development of disrespect

Disrespect can grow insidiously

1KI 11:4 See also JER 2:1–2:11 MRK 11:15–11:17 parallels MAT 21:12–21:13, LUK 19:45–19:46, JHN 2:13–2:17

Disrespect can spread infectiously

DEU 1:27–1:28 See also EST 1:16–1:18; MRK 15:9–15:15 parallels MAT 27:17–27:26, LUK 23:13–23:25; ROM 2:24

Disrespect can end fatally

LEV 10:1–10:2 See also EXO 32:25–32:28; DEU 21:18–21:21; JER 25:4–25:11

5839: dissatisfaction

The human feeling of emptiness and unfulfilment, at either a physical or spiritual level.

Hunger and thirst are never permanently satisfied

ECC 6:7 See also PSA 59:15; ISA 55:2; JHN 4:13–4:14

Dissatisfaction as a result of divine judgment

LEV 26:26 See also ISA 9:19–9:21; EZK 7:19; MIC 6:14

Death is never satisfied

PRO 27:20 See also PRO 30:15–30:16; HAB 2:5

Dissatisfaction is characteristic of the unrighteous

PRO 13:4 See also EST 5:9–5:13; ECC 5:10; EZK 16:28–16:29; 3JN 1:9–1:10

5840: eagerness

A willingness, zeal or longing to accomplish a task or fulfil an ambition.

Eagerness to perform a task

1CH 12:8; NEH 3:20 See also EZR 5:8; PRO 31:13; ACT 20:16; 1TH 2:17

Eagerness to fulfil personal ambitions

ZEP 3:7; 1TI 6:10 See also PSA 56:6; PRO 1:11–1:12, PRO 28:20; MRK 6:25; GAL 4:17–4:18; PHP 3:6

Eagerness for personal godliness

2CH 15:15; 2PE 1:10 See also 1CH 28:9; PSA 27:4, PSA 42:1–42:2, PSA 63:1; PRO 23:17; ACT 26:7; 1CO 14:1; 2CO 7:11; HEB 4:11, HEB 6:11; 1PE 2:2; 2PE 1:5

Spiritual eagerness may be superficial and unreal

ISA 58:2 See also PSA 78:34–78:37; ISA 48:1

Believers should be eager to follow and serve their Lord

Eager to do good works

TIT 2:14 See also 2CO 8:7, 2CO 8:22; TIT 3:1, TIT 3:8, TIT 3:14; 1PE 3:13

Eager to serve

ROM 12:11; 1PE 5:2 See also PSA 110:3; ROM 12:8; 1CO 14:12; EPH 4:3; TIT 3:8

Eager to share the truth

ROM 1:15; 2PE 1:15 See also ACT 18:25, ACT 21:13; ROM 15:20; PHP 1:20; JUD 1:3

Eager to receive or understand the truth

MRK 12:37; ACT 10:33 See also MRK 10:17 parallels MAT 19:16, LUK 18:18; LUK 2:15, LUK 21:38; JHN 4:40; ACT 13:42, ACT 17:11; 1TI 4:15

Eager to give

2CO 8:7 See also EXO 35:21–35:22; 1CH 29:9; 2CO 8:11, 2CO 8:19; GAL 2:10; 1TI 6:18

Eager to pray

COL 4:2 See also ROM 15:30; PHP 1:3–1:4; COL 4:12

Eager for God's honour

NUM 25:11 See also 1KI 19:14; 2KI 10:16; JHN 2:17

Eager to see Jesus Christ's return and the end of the world

1CO 1:7 See also MAT 24:44 parallel LUK 12:40; ROM 8:19 Creation shares the same eager expectation; ROM 8:23; GAL 5:5; PHP 3:20

5841: ecstasy

An exalted condition of spiritual joy or rapture; usually reflecting the experience of the Holy Spirit.

Ecstasy in response to prophetic and visionary experiences

NUM 24:4; 2CO 12:3–12:4; REV 1:10 See also NUM 24:16; ISA 10:10–10:11; ISA 6:1 Isaiah's vision of the Lord; EZK 11:24–11:25; DAN 2:19–2:21, DAN 10:7–10:8, DAN 10:16; ACT 9:10 Ananias' vision; ACT 10:3 Cornelius' vision of the angel of God; ACT 10:10–10:16, ACT 11:5; REV 4:2, REV 17:3, REV 21:10

Ecstasy in response to the Holy Spirit

ACT 2:4 See also ACT 10:44–10:46, ACT 13:52, ACT 19:6

Ecstasy in response to Jesus Christ

LUK 10:21; 1PE 1:8 See also PSA 4:7, PSA 28:7; MAT 28:8

Ecstasy as a corporate experience

EZR 3:12 See also 1KI 8:11 parallel 2CH 7:2; EZR 6:16

Transfiguration of appearance through ecstasy

EXO 34:29 See also MAT 17:2; LUK 1:22

Future ecstasy in response to God's coming kingdom

ISA 55:12; 1CO 2:9–2:10 See also ISA 35:10, ISA 51:11

5842: eloquence

The ability to speak with fluency and persuasive power, using words appropriate to the circumstances.

Examples of lack of eloquence

EXO 4:10 See also EXO 6:12, EXO 6:30; 2CO 10:10, 2CO 11:6

Preaching the gospel does not rely on human eloquence

1CO 1:17 See also 1CO 1:19–1:21, 1CO 2:1, 1CO 13:1

Eloquence that comes from God

ACT 6:9–6:10 See also EXO 4:11, EXO 4:15–4:16; ISA 32:4; MRK 13:11; LUK 21:15; ACT 18:4, ACT 19:8–19:10

Examples of eloquence in speeches

ACT 5:35–5:40, ACT 17:22–17:23, ACT 18:24–18:28

Eloquent words may lead to sin

PRO 7:21 See also PSA 12:3–12:4, PSA 55:21; PRO 2:16, PRO 5:3, PRO 6:24, PRO 29:5

Sayings concerning eloquence

PSA 45:1 See also PRO 10:31–10:32, PRO 12:18, PRO 22:11; ECC 10:12

5843: embarrassment

A state of discomfort and shame, caused by a sense of guilt over something that has been said or done.

Embarrassment may be a sign of misunderstanding or mistrust

JHN 13:6–13:8 See also MRK 2:16–2:17 Jesus Christ's enemies approached the disciples knowing they would be embarrassed by the company he was keeping; MRK 3:21 The family of Jesus Christ were embarrassed by what they were hearing about him.

Love includes not causing unnecessary embarrassment

DEU 24:10–24:11

Embarrassment caused by another person

See also 2KI 8:11 Elisha's fixed gaze embarrassed Hazael who, as the following verses suggest, may already have had a guilty conscience.

Embarrassment may motivate actions

JDG 3:23–3:26; 2KI 2:17

Doing right may be embarrassing

ACT 10:28–10:29

Embarrassment may motivate wrong behaviour

MRK 6:26–6:27

5844: emotions

Scripture portrays both human beings and God as having emotions. Human emotions and sentiments are of importance to the life of faith. Human feelings can be positive or negative and are subject to change and misinterpretation.

Emotions shown by God

Love

DEU 7:7–7:8 See also ISA 43:4; JER 31:3; HOS 11:1; MRK 10:21; JHN 13:1, JHN 17:23; 1JN 4:8, 1JN 4:10, 1JN 4:19

Compassion

PSA 103:13 See also EXO 33:19; DEU 13:17; JDG 2:18; PSA 116:5; MAT 9:36, MAT 14:14, MAT 15:32 parallel MRK 8:2; MAT 20:34

Joy and delight**JER 32:41** See also DEU 30:9; ISA 62:4; LUK 15:32**Anger****EXO 22:24** See also DEU 6:14–6:15; JOS 7:1; JER 7:20; EZK 5:13; MAT 21:12–21:13 parallels MRK 11:15–11:17, LUK 19:45–19:46, JHN 2:14–2:17**Human emotions experienced by God's people****Joy****ISA 51:11** See also ISA 2:1; PSA 4:7, PSA 28:7, PSA 30:11–30:12; LUK 1:47; ACT 16:25**Love for God and one another****PSA 116:1** See also PSA 18:1; JHN 21:17; 1JN 4:11–4:12**Sorrow and pain****PSA 6:6–6:7** See also ISA 1:7–1:8, ISA 1:10; 2SA 18:33; 1KI 19:3–19:4; PSA 88:15, PSA 119:28, PSA 137:1; JER 15:18; MIC 7:1; JHN 11:19, JHN 11:31, JHN 11:33; ROM 9:2–9:3**Fear****EXO 3:6** See also GEN 18:15; JOS 9:24; ISA 35:4, ISA 41:10; MAT 8:26 parallels MRK 4:40–4:41, LUK 8:25; MAT 28:8 parallel MRK 16:8**God's people are to feel for one another****PHP 1:7–1:8** See also EXO 22:21, EXO 23:9; 1CO 12:25–12:26; 2CO 6:11–6:13, 2CO 7:2–7:3, 2CO 11:29**Believers are to control their emotions****GAL 5:22–5:23** See also PRO 25:28; EPH 4:26, EPH 5:18; COL 3:8; 1TI 2:8; JAS 1:19–1:20**Emotions are changeable****PRO 14:13****The wicked may feel an unwarranted sense of security****AMO 6:1** See also DAN 8:25, DAN 11:21, DAN 11:24; ZEC 1:15**5845: emptiness**

Scripture stresses the emptiness of human life without God, and notes that Jesus Christ chose to empty himself in order to redeem humanity.

Emptiness and creation**The world created to be filled****ISA 45:18; HAB 2:14** See also GEN 1:2**Emptiness as a symbol of judgment****JER 4:23****Human life can be empty****RUT 1:21** See also ECC 1:2, ECC 3:19, ECC 12:8**Human words can be empty****JOB 35:13** See also JOB 35:16; ISA 16:6, ISA 36:5 parallel 2KI 18:20; ISA 59:4; EPH 5:6; 2PE 2:18**Human attempts at fulfilment are empty****Work does not satisfy****ISA 55:2** See also PSA 127:1–127:2; ECC 2:17, ECC 6:7; HAG 1:5–1:6**Pleasure does not last****JOB 20:5** See also PRO 21:17; ECC 2:1–2:3, ECC 2:25**Wealth does not satisfy****ECC 5:10** See also ECC 4:7–4:8; LUK 12:15; 1TI 6:9–6:10**Material possessions are unreliable****LUK 12:18–12:20** See also JOB 8:13–8:15, JOB 15:31; PSA 49:10, PSA 49:12, PSA 49:16–49:17; PRO 11:4; ECC 5:15; 1TI 6:7**False religion cannot save****ISA 57:13** See also JDG 10:14; ISA 44:17–44:18, ISA 45:20, ISA 46:7; JER 11:12; ACT 14:15**Emptiness as the result of sin****MIC 6:13–6:14** See also LEV 26:14–26:16; PSA 78:32–78:33; HOS 4:10; HAG 1:7–1:9**God wants to remove the emptiness of people's lives****1PE 1:18** See also PSA 81:10; JHN 1:16, JHN 10:10; EPH 4:13; COL 2:10**Jesus Christ accepts emptiness in order to redeem humanity****PHP 2:7** See also 2CO 8:9**5846: enjoyment**

The ability to find pleasure and joy in life. Scripture sees the capacity for enjoyment as a gift from God, whose people are to find pleasure and happiness in him and the many blessings he has given to them.

Human capacity and opportunity for enjoyment is bestowed by God**ECC 5:18–5:20; 1TI 6:17** See also NEH 9:35; ECC 2:24–2:26**People find enjoyment in a great diversity of things****Enjoyment of the land and its produce****NUM 14:31** See also GEN 45:17–45:18; DEU 20:6, DEU 28:30; ISA 65:22; JER 31:5

Enjoyment of long life and health

ECC 11:8 See also DEU 6:1–6:2; 1CH 29:28; PRO 28:16; 3JN 1:2

Enjoyment of peace and security

PSA 37:11 See also JDG 8:28; PSA 37:3; JER 33:6–33:9; ACT 9:31, ACT 24:2

Enjoyment of prosperity

PSA 106:4–106:5 See also PSA 37:18–37:19

Enjoyment of food and drink

ECC 8:15 See also NEH 8:9–8:12; HAB 1:16

Enjoyment of friendship and fellowship

ROM 15:24 See also JDG 19:6, JDG 19:9, JDG 19:22; PSA 55:12–55:14

Enjoyment of love

PRO 7:18 See also ECC 9:9

Enjoyment of the fruits of righteous living

ISA 3:10 See also PRO 13:2

Enjoyment of good favour

ACT 2:46–2:47 See also ACT 7:45–7:46

Enjoyment of work

ECC 3:22 See also ECC 3:13

Enjoyment of light of the world

JHN 5:35 See also JOB 33:28

Enjoyment of hospitality

ROM 16:23

Enjoyment of rest

JOB 3:18

Enjoyment of fragrance

EXO 30:38

People also find unwholesome enjoyment in sin

HEB 11:24–11:25 See also JOB 20:12–20:14

The land enjoying rest

2CH 36:21 See also LEV 26:34, LEV 26:43

Lack of enjoyment

ECC 4:8 See also DEU 28:30; JOB 20:17–20:19, JOB 21:23–21:25; ECC 2:26, ECC 6:1–6:6

5847: enthusiasm

A state of eagerness, leading to the positive and committed performance of actions.

Enthusiasm for doing good

1PE 3:10–3:13 See also TIT 2:11–2:14

Enthusiasm for doing evil

JER 8:6 See also MIC 2:1–2:2; ZEP 3:7

Enthusiasm for work

PRO 31:10–31:19 See also PRO 6:6–6:11, PRO 31:24, PRO 31:27

Enthusiasm for giving

2CO 9:2 See also 2CO 8:10–8:12; GAL 2:10

Enthusiasm for spiritual gifts

1CO 14:12 See also 1CO 14:39

Enthusiasm for serving God

2CO 8:16–8:17 See also 1PE 5:2

5848: exaggeration

An overstatement of something, usually relating to its importance or value. People exaggerate because of fear, envy, pride or self-pity. Exaggeration can also be used positively to good effect, for example, in the teaching of Jesus Christ.

Exaggeration of difficulties through fear

NUM 13:32–13:33 See also DEU 1:28, DEU 9:1

Exaggeration of the lifestyle of others through envy

JOB 21:7–21:10 Job's complaint that the wicked often appear to prosper is stated with exaggeration in order to make his point clear. See also PSA 73:3–73:12

Exaggerating one's status or abilities through pride

EZK 27:3 See also EZK 28:2; HOS 12:8; MAT 8:19 parallel LUK 9:57; LUK 22:33; ACT 12:21–12:23; 1CO 4:8; REV 3:17

Exaggeration of the achievements of others

1SA 21:11 The reference to David as king by the Philistines may be an exaggeration reflecting the great success and popularity of David among the Israelite people. See also 1SA 18:7, 1SA 29:5

Exaggeration of troubles through self-pity

1KI 18:22 See also 1KI 19:10, 1KI 19:14, 1KI 19:18; PSA 12:1–12:2

Exaggeration of the appearance of others through admiration

These verses represent exaggeration typical in poetic descriptive passages: SNG 5:10–5:16, SNG 7:1–7:9

Exaggeration used by Jesus Christ as a teaching tool

MAT 7:3–7:5 parallel LUK 6:41–6:42 See also MAT 5:29–5:30, MAT 7:9–7:10 parallel LUK 11:11–11:12; MAT 13:33 parallel LUK 13:20; MAT 19:24 parallels MRK 10:25, LUK 18:25

5849: exaltation

The lifting up or raising on high of a person, in words or actions. The exaltation of Jesus Christ, first on the cross and then in his resurrection, provides a model of how God exalts the humble and obedient. God also humbles those who exalt themselves. Believers are called upon to exalt God in their praise of him.

True exaltation comes from God

PSA 75:6–75:7 See also GEN 39:1–39:6; ISA 2:1–2:10; 2SA 7:18–7:29

God exalts those who are humble

JAS 4:10 See also MAT 5:3–5:5; LUK 1:46–1:55; 1PE 5:5–5:6; PRO 3:34

Examples of God's exaltation of his people

God's exaltation of Joshua
JOS 3:7

God's exaltation of David

2SA 5:9–5:12 See also 2SA 22:47–22:51 parallel PSA 18:46–18:50; PSA 89:19–89:29

God's exaltation of Solomon

1CH 29:25 See also 1KI 3:5–3:15 parallel 2CH 1:7–1:12; 1KI 10:1–10:10 parallel 2CH 9:1–9:9

God's exaltation of Jesus Christ

Prophecies of Jesus Christ's exaltation

ISA 52:13 See also PSA 110:1–110:7

The exaltation of Jesus Christ upon the cross

JHN 3:14–3:15, JHN 12:32 See also JHN 8:28

God's exaltation of Jesus Christ in the resurrection

ACT 2:32–2:36 See also ACT 5:30–5:31; PHP 2:9–2:11; HEB 7:26

Self-exaltation is wrong

Warnings against self-exaltation

PRO 25:6–25:7 See also DAN 4:19–4:27; MAT 23:5–23:12 parallels MRK 12:38–12:39, LUK 20:45–20:47; LUK 14:7–14:11

Examples of self-exaltation

ISA 14:13–14:14 See also GEN 11:3–11:4; EZK 28:1–28:2; DAN 3:1–3:7; 2TH 2:3–2:4

Consequences of self-exaltation

MAT 23:12 parallel LUK 14:11 See also GEN 11:5–11:9; ISA 2:11–2:17, ISA 14:12–14:20 taunt against the king of Babylon; DAN 4:28–4:33; LUK 18:9–18:14

The exaltation of God in his people's praise

EXO 15:1–15:2 Rejoicing after the exodus from Egypt. See also PSA 34:1–34:3, PSA 57:9–57:11, PSA 99:5, PSA 145:1–145:13; ISA 25:1; DAN 4:36–4:37

5850: excess

A surplus of material or wealth, especially food or drink. Scripture criticises excessive consumption and extravagance, which are seen as exploiting the less fortunate and leading to a lack of concern for God.

Examples of excessive eating and drinking

The Israelites in idolatry

EXO 32:2–32:6

The Israelites' greed, after God's miraculous provision

NUM 11:32

The Israelites in luxury

AMO 6:4–6:6

Other examples of excess

See also 1SA 25:36 Nabal; 1SA 30:16 the Amalekites in victory; ISA 56:12 Israel's wicked watchmen; DAN 5:1–5:4 King Belshazzar in pride; PHP 3:19 the enemies of the cross of Christ; REV 18:3 the godless nations

Mentions of excess in Jesus Christ's parables

As a warning to the rich

LUK 12:18–12:21

As a warning against ingratitude and spiritual indifference

See also LUK 15:13, LUK 16:19–16:31

Excessive eating and drinking is never encouraged

Church leaders are not to overindulge

1TI 3:2–3:3, 1TI 3:8 See also TIT 1:7

It causes sickness

PRO 25:16 See also PRO 25:27

It brings poverty

PRO 23:20–23:21 See also PRO 21:17

It brings disgrace

PRO 28:7

It is associated with laziness

TIT 1:12

It shows a disregard for God

ISA 5:11–5:12 See also HOS 4:10–4:11; PHP 3:19

It leads the unwise man astray

PRO 20:1

Commands for believers to abstain from such excesses

GAL 5:19–5:21; EPH 5:18 See also 1CO 6:10–6:13; 1PE 4:3; 2PE 2:13

The charging of excessive interest on loans is forbidden

EZK 18:8, EZK 18:13, EZK 18:17, EZK 22:12

5851: excuse

The attempt to deny responsibility for an action or for a lack of action. There is no excuse for sin.

Examples of excuses given for wrong actions

GEN 3:12–3:13 by Adam and Eve for eating the forbidden fruit; ; EXO 32:22–32:24 by Aaron for making the golden calf; ; 1SA 13:11–13:12 by Saul for acting as priest; 1SA 15:20–15:21, 1SA 15:24–15:25

Examples of excuses given for inaction

By Moses: EXO 3:11, EXO 4:10; JDG 6:15 by Gideon; PRO 22:13, PRO 26:13; JER 1:6 by Jeremiah; MAT 25:14–25:30; ; LUK 19:12–19:27; MAT 25:41–25:45 by the ignorant

Excuses given by those unwilling to follow Jesus Christ

LUK 14:16–14:24 See also MAT 22:2–22:3; LUK 9:59–9:62

There is no excuse for sin

ROM 1:20 See also JHN 9:41, JHN 15:22; ROM 2:1, ROM 3:19–3:23, ROM 5:12; 1JN 1:8, 1JN 1:10

5852: experience

The direct personal knowledge of people and situations which comes from a firsthand encounter with life. To experience God is to encounter and know him directly, rather than merely to know facts about him.

5853: experience, of life

Experience of life comes with increasing age and through observation, reflection and the application of lessons learned. Experience in a craft or profession comes through training and practice.

Experience associated with advancing years

JOB 12:12 See also JOB 32:6–32:7; 1KI 12:6–12:7 parallel 2CH 10:6–10:7; PSA 37:25; PRO 4:1–4:4

Dissatisfaction with life's experiences

ECC 2:11 See also ECC 3:11 People are made for eternity and cannot be fully satisfied with the things of this world; ECC 1:13–1:17 application to study; ECC 2:1–2:3 devotion to pleasure; ECC 2:4–2:6 pursuit of great projects; ECC 2:7–2:8 a life of materialism **ECC 2:24–2:26**

Human experiences find fulfilment only in relation to God. **ECC 3:12–3:14, ECC 12:13–12:14**

Learning from life's experiences

PRO 24:32 See also JOB 4:8–4:9, JOB 5:3; PSA 107:43

Sympathy resulting from personal experience

EXO 23:9 See also EXO 22:21; DEU 15:12–15:15; 2CO 1:3–1:4; HEB 10:32–10:34

Growing through experiences

ROM 5:3–5:4 See also HEB 5:8; JAS 1:2–1:4

Learning from everyday experiences

MAT 24:32 parallel MRK 13:28 See also MAT 16:2–16:3; LUK 12:54–12:55; MAT 6:28–6:31 parallel LUK 12:27–12:29

Jesus Christ shared human experience

HEB 4:15 See also HEB 2:17–2:18; PHP 2:8; HEB 2:9

Experience in a craft or profession

Skilled craftsmen

2CH 2:7 See also 2CH 2:13–2:14; 1KI 7:13–7:14; EXO 36:1–36:2; 1CH 22:15–22:16

Experienced soldiers

2CH 17:12–17:13 See also 1SA 17:33; 2SA 17:8; 1CH 12:33; SNG 3:7–3:8

Other competent people

1SA 12:2 Samuel's experience in leadership; ; EST 1:13 Xerxes consults experts in law and justice; ; MAT 2:4 Herod consults teachers of the law; ; ACT 18:2–18:3 Paul and Aquila were experienced tent makers.

5854: experience, of God

Scripture stresses the importance and also the possibility of a true experience of the living God. This is contrasted with the more academic knowledge about him. Experiential knowledge of God comes through personal encounter, through the witness of the Holy Spirit, through reflection on his past goodness and through the shared experiences of others.

Personal experience of God

Contrasted with academic knowledge

JOB 42:5 See also JER 31:34; JHN 4:42, JHN 5:39–5:40; JAS 2:19

Experience of God's blessing

PSA 34:8 See also 1PE 2:3; HEB 6:4–6:5

Experiencing God through Scripture

MAT 22:29; ; JHN 5:39–5:40; ; ACT 17:11–17:12; ; 2TI 3:15–3:17

Knowing God through the Spirit

ROM 8:15–8:16 See also JHN 14:16–14:17, JHN 14:26, JHN 16:14–16:15; 1CO 2:9–2:10; ISA 64:4

Examples of personal encounter with God

DEU 11:2–11:7 See also DEU 5:3–5:4; GEN 32:30 Jacob; EXO 3:3–3:4 Moses; ISA 6:1 Isaiah; ACT 9:3–9:6 Saul of Tarsus; 2CO 12:2–12:4 Paul; REV 1:17 John

Sharing experience of God**Experience of God through his people**

ZEC 8:23 See also ISA 45:14; 1CO 14:24–14:25

Leaders with experience of God

JOS 24:31 See also NUM 12:8; JDG 6:22; ACT 1:21–1:22; 1CO 15:3–15:7; 2PE 1:16–1:18

Speaking to future generations

DEU 4:9–4:10 See also EXO 10:2; DEU 6:20–6:21; JOB 8:8–8:9; PSA 71:18

Speaking from personal experience: OT

DEU 7:18–7:19 See also 1SA 17:34–17:37 David's experience teaches him to trust God. ISA 43:14–43:17, ISA 51:9–51:11 JER 16:14–16:15

Speaking from personal experience: NT

JHN 3:11 See also JHN 20:18; ACT 4:13; 1JN 1:1–1:3 **JHN 9:25** See also MRK 5:19–5:20 parallel LUK 8:39; JHN 4:28–4:29

Confidence based on past experience

MAT 16:9–16:10 parallel MRK 8:18–8:20 The disciples' experience of Jesus Christ's provision should have taught them not to worry about food; ; 2TI 4:17–4:18

5856: extravagance

Exaggerated, excessive or immoderate behaviour often linked with wastefulness which may result in personal harm. God's people are called to be wise stewards of what has been entrusted to them. However, Scripture also points to a right kind of openhandedness and generosity of spirit which reflects love and worship towards God and concern for others.

Examples of sinful extravagance**Wastefulness**

LUK 15:13 See also PRO 21:20, PRO 29:3

Drunkenness and gluttony

PRO 23:20 See also DEU 21:20; EPH 5:18; PHP 3:19

The results of sinful extravagance**Wastefulness leads to poverty**

LUK 15:14–15:17 See also PRO 13:18, PRO 22:16, PRO 23:21

Extravagant living leads to spiritual complacency

LUK 12:19–12:20 See also ISA 5:11–5:12, ISA 22:12–22:13, ISA 56:11–56:12; AMO 6:1–6:6; ZEP 1:12–1:13

The alternative to sinful extravagance**Thankful enjoyment of God's gifts**

1TI 4:3–4:4 See also ACT 10:13–10:15; 1CO 10:30–10:31

Stewardship of God's blessings

EZK 34:18–34:19 See also GEN 2:15; EXO 23:10–23:12; DEU 15:14–15:15; PRO 22:9

Discipline and self-control

1CO 9:25–9:27 See also GEN 2:16–2:17; MAT 6:16–6:18 fasting; ROM 14:6 abstinence from certain foods; 1CO 7:5 temporary abstinence from sexual relationships

Examples of commendable extravagance in worship

MRK 14:3–14:5 parallels MAT 26:6–26:9, JHN 12:3–12:5 See also EXO 36:3–36:7 gifts for the tabernacle; 2SA 6:14–6:15 David dancing before the ark 1CH 29:3–29:4; 2CH 24:10 PSA 119:171; 2CO 4:15; COL 2:7 MRK 12:41–12:44 parallel LUK 21:1–21:4

Examples of extravagance not commended in worship

MIC 6:7–6:8 Extravagant offerings are no substitute for doing what God requires. See also 1SA 15:20–15:22

Other examples of commendable extravagance**Extravagance in caring for others**

2CO 8:2–8:4 See also MAT 5:39–5:42 parallel LUK 6:29–6:30; 2CO 9:12–9:13; 1TH 3:12

Extravagance in forgiveness

MAT 18:21–18:22 See also LUK 17:3–17:4; MAT 18:26 the king's generosity in forgiving his servant's debt; LUK 15:22–15:23 celebrations at the return of the prodigal son

Warnings against failing to be extravagant towards God and others

Stinginess cheats God: ISA 43:24; ; MAL 3:8–3:9; ; ACT 5:1–5:2; DEU 15:7–15:8; ; PRO 23:6–23:8; PRO 11:24, PRO 28:22, PRO 28:27; ; MAT 18:32–18:34

The extravagance of God's grace**The gift of his Son**

JHN 3:16; ; 2CO 9:15

The blessings of God's salvation

ROM 8:32 See also ROM 5:5, ROM 5:15; EPH 1:8; TIT 3:5–3:6; 1JN 3:1

The abundance of God's provision

PSA 23:5, PSA 65:11; ; ISA 66:11; ; JOL 2:24; ; ZEC 1:17

God's blessings promised to the generous

MAL 3:10 See also PRO 19:17, PRO 22:9; LUK 6:38; 2CO 9:6–9:11

5857: fame

The reputation gained by individuals or groups of people as a result of their achievements. Scripture shows how God's fame among the nations rested upon his saving actions and, in the NT, how the miracles of Jesus Christ brought him widespread fame. God's people are to rejoice in his fame, without lapsing into arrogance.

God's acts of salvation have brought him renown

JOS 9:9–9:10 See also EXO 8:9–8:11; NUM 14:13–14:16; PSA 72:1–72:19, PSA 135:13–135:14; ISA 55:13, ISA 63:11–63:14; JER 32:20; HAB 3:2

Jesus Christ's teaching and miracles brought him fame

MAT 4:24 See also MAT 8:32–8:34 parallels MRK 5:14–5:17, LUK 8:34–8:37; MAT 9:27–9:31; MRK 1:27–1:28 parallel LUK 4:36–4:37

Jesus Christ taught servanthood rather than the pursuit of status and fame

MRK 9:33–9:35 parallels MAT 18:1–18:4, LUK 9:46–9:48 **MRK 10:42–10:45** parallel MAT 20:25–20:28

Israel's fame dependent on her obedience to God

DEU 26:18–26:19 See also DEU 2:24–2:25

Israel made famous in order to glorify God

JER 13:11 See also JER 33:9

Israel's abuse of her fame led to judgment

EZK 16:14–16:15 See also EZK 16:35–16:42

Glorious restoration promised by God

HOS 14:7 See also ISA 61:1–61:4

Local, national or international fame**Local**

1CH 12:30

National

JOS 6:27 See also EST 9:4

International

1CH 14:17 See also 1KI 4:31, 1KI 10:1 parallel 2CH 9:1; 2CH 26:8; ISA 45:1–45:7

God's judgment on the arrogance that may come with fame

ISA 23:8–23:9 See also JER 48:16–48:18, JER 48:29–48:30; EZK 26:15–26:18

Famous for doing wrong

NUM 16:40; ; 1KI 15:34; ; JUD 1:11

5858: fat

Used to describe a successful person, fruitful land or healthy animals. It is often associated with the idea of prosperity and contentment. It also designates the part of an animal used in OT sacrifices.

Fat as a symbol of success

ISA 10:27; JER 5:27–5:28 See also DEU 32:15; JOB 15:27–15:28; EZK 34:16

Fat representing fruitful land

GEN 45:18

Fat animals

GEN 41:2 See also GEN 41:17–41:21; 1SA 15:9; PSA 66:15; EZK 34:20

Fat people

JDG 3:17 See also JDG 3:18–3:22

Fat used in the context of judgment

ISA 17:4

The fat of animals**Not to be eaten**

LEV 3:17 See also LEV 7:22–7:25

To be offered to God in sacrifice

LEV 3:16 See also GEN 4:4; LEV 3:3–3:5; NUM 18:17; DEU 32:37–32:38; 1SA 2:15–2:16, 1SA 15:22; 1KI 8:64; ISA 34:6–34:7, ISA 43:24; EZK 39:19

5859: favour

Looking kindly upon someone or treating someone with special regard. Scripture stresses the kindness and graciousness of God and Jesus Christ, which is not the result of human merit or achievement.

5860: favour, divine

See [1055: God, grace and mercy of](#), [2027: Jesus Christ, grace and mercy of](#)

5861: favour, human

Looking kindly upon someone or treating someone with special regard. Favour can be gained by means of good character, gifts, service or through the in-

tervention of God. Scripture warns against undue favouritism.

Examples of those who were regarded with favour by others

OT characters

1SA 2:26 Samuel; 1SA 16:18, 1SA 16:21–16:22, 1SA 18:6–18:7, 1SA 20:3; EST 2:15, EST 2:17; DAN 1:9 Daniel

Jesus Christ

LUK 2:52

The first Christians

See also ACT 2:47; ROM 14:18

Finding favour can lead to being treated with special regard

RUT 2:13–2:16 See also PRO 16:15, PRO 19:12

Being held in favour can create an opportunity for a request to be made

NEH 2:5 See also GEN 30:27, GEN 47:29–47:30, GEN 50:4–50:6; NUM 32:5; RUT 2:2; 1SA 20:28–20:29, 1SA 27:5; EST 7:3, EST 8:5

Finding favour with others

Through good character

PRO 3:3–3:4 See also PRO 13:15, PRO 28:23; ECC 9:11; PHM 1:14

Through the giving of gifts

GEN 32:5, GEN 33:8–33:11, GEN 33:15, GEN 34:11–34:12; ; PSA 45:12; ; PRO 19:6; ; EZK 16:33–16:34

Through service rendered

GEN 39:3–39:4 See also 2SA 14:19–14:22; EPH 6:6 parallel COL 3:22

Through the intervention of God

GEN 39:21; ; EXO 3:21, EXO 11:3, EXO 12:36; ; NEH 1:11

Warnings against favouritism

LEV 19:15; 1TI 5:21 See also EXO 23:3; DEU 1:17; JOB 13:10; PRO 24:23–24:25; MAL 2:9; JAS 2:1–2:4, JAS 2:9

5863: flattery

Insincere and undeserved praise or words of encouragement, used with the intention of gaining favour with others.

Flattery is deceitful

PSA 12:2–12:3 See also PSA 5:9, PSA 55:20–55:21, PSA 62:4; PRO 27:6; JER 9:8

The results of flattery are ruinous

PRO 26:28 See also PRO 29:5

Flattery is rejected by godly people

JOB 32:21–32:22 See also GAL 1:10; 1TH 2:5–2:6

Honesty is preferable to flattery

PRO 28:23 See also PRO 16:13, PRO 27:9

False teachers use flattery

ROM 16:17–16:18 See also 2TI 4:3–4:4; JUD 1:16–1:19

Examples of flattery

2SA 14:17–14:20 The woman from Tekoa flatters David; ; 2SA 15:2–15:6 Absalom to Israelites; ; DAN 6:21 Daniel flatters the king; ; MAT 22:16 parallels MRK 12:14, LUK 20:21 the Pharisees and Herodians to Jesus Christ; ; LUK 20:21 The spies from the teachers of the law flatter Jesus Christ; ; ACT 12:22 The crowds flatter Herod.

5864: futility

All human life and human systems are ultimately useless without God, because death comes to all. God wants to deliver people from their futile ways.

Human life is futile

The brevity of life

PSA 89:47 See also JOB 7:6–7:7, JOB 14:1–14:2; PSA 39:4–39:5; ECC 6:12; ISA 40:6–40:7; JAS 4:14

Death is the destiny of all

JOB 9:22; ; ECC 3:19–3:20, ECC 9:2

The dead are forgotten

PSA 103:15–103:16; ; ECC 1:11, ECC 2:16, ECC 9:5

Human endeavour is futile

ECC 1:14 The writer speaks of human life without reference to God. See also PSA 39:6, PSA 127:2; ECC 2:10–2:23; HAB 2:13; JAS 1:11

Human thoughts are futile

PSA 94:11 See also 1CO 3:19–3:20; ROM 1:21; EPH 4:17–4:18

Human attitudes are futile

Self-confidence is futile

ISA 16:6 See also JER 48:29–48:30; LUK 1:51–1:52

Relying solely on human help is futile

JER 17:5 See also PSA 60:11 parallel PSA 108:12; PSA 146:3–146:4; ISA 2:22, ISA 30:1–30:5, ISA 31:1–31:3; LAM 4:17

False religion is futile

Idolatry is futile

2KI 17:15 See also 1SA 12:21; PSA 31:6; JER 2:5, JER 10:8, JER 10:14–10:15, JER 16:19; JON 2:8

Divination is futile

ISA 8:19–8:22; ; EZK 13:6–13:9; ; ZEC 10:2

Human religious systems are futile

1KI 18:29 See also ISA 16:12; JER 10:5; ACT 5:36–5:38; COL 2:20–2:23

Nominal religion is futile**Religious observance without true faith is futile**

ISA 1:13 See also MAL 3:14; MAT 15:8–15:9 parallel MRK 7:6–7:7; 1CO 3:1–3:3; JAS 1:26

Mere religious language is futile

TIT 3:9 See also JER 7:8; LAM 2:14; EPH 5:6; COL 2:18; 1TI 1:6; 2TI 2:14; 2PE 2:18

Christian endeavour using only human strength is futile

JHN 15:5; ; 1CO 3:12–3:15

Hearing God's word without responding to it is futile

HEB 4:2 See also MAT 7:26–7:27, MAT 13:19–13:22; JAS 1:22–1:24, JAS 2:20

Sin is futile because it achieves nothing

JER 13:10 See also PSA 2:1, PSA 112:10, PSA 119:118; PRO 10:28, PRO 11:7; JER 51:58; EPH 5:11

Faithfulness to God may seem to be futile

PSA 73:13 See also JOB 34:9; ECC 7:15, ECC 8:14; ISA 49:4

God wants to deliver people from futile ways

1PE 1:18 See also 2TI 2:21

5865: gestures

Significant acts, bodily movements or signals which carry meaning, evoke responses or convey positive or negative feelings. They may or may not be accompanied by words or other communications.

Gestures are part of human communication**They give weight to a contract**

RUT 4:7 See also 2SA 24:22–24:24 parallel 1CH 21:23–21:24; JER 32:10–32:12

They add force to words

1SA 11:7 See also JOS 7:25–7:26; 1SA 15:27–15:28; 2SA 12:16; MAT 21:12–21:13 parallels MRK 11:15–11:17, LUK 19:45–19:46, JHN 2:15–2:16 Use of gestures illustrates the demonstrative nature of much communication in the cultures of biblical times.

Gestures often convey more than words**Gestures of joy**

2SA 6:14 GEN 21:6; ; LEV 9:24; ; ACT 3:8

Gestures of love

1SA 1:5 See also GEN 37:3; 1SA 2:19; LUK 7:46–7:47, LUK 10:34, LUK 15:20; JHN 15:13; ROM 5:8

Gestures of mercy

ISA 6:6–6:7 See also 1SA 24:10–24:11; 2SA 9:1, 2SA 9:7; MAT 18:27 Mercy itself is a gesture of love.

Gestures of worship and reverence

EXO 3:5 See also EXO 3:6; JOS 5:14; NEH 8:6; PSA 63:4, PSA 134:2; MAT 2:11; LUK 5:8; JHN 11:32; REV 1:17

Gestures of repentance

JOB 42:6 See also 1KI 21:27; EZR 10:1; ISA 22:12; JOL 2:12; JON 3:6–3:8; MAT 11:21 parallel LUK 10:13; MAT 27:3–27:5

Gestures of sorrow and mourning

2SA 3:31 Gestures of sorrow and mourning are very similar to those of repentance and remorse. See also 2SA 19:4; EST 4:1; PSA 137:1; JOL 1:13; AMO 5:16

Gestures of dedication

ACT 22:16 See also GEN 17:10; EXO 21:6; 1SA 20:41–20:42; NEH 10:35–10:37

Gestures of anger

LUK 15:28 See also EXO 32:19; NUM 22:27; 1SA 20:33–20:34; MAT 26:65 parallel MRK 14:63; ACT 7:54, ACT 7:57; REV 3:16

Gestures of treachery

LUK 22:47–22:48 parallels MAT 26:47–26:49, MRK 14:43–14:45 See also 2SA 3:27, 2SA 20:9–20:10

Gestures of contempt

Shaking of the head: PSA 22:7, PSA 64:8; ; MAT 27:39 parallel MRK 15:29; MAT 26:67 parallel MRK 14:65; ; REV 3:16

Other examples of gestures**The gesture of washing hands**

MAT 27:24 See also DEU 21:6–21:7; PSA 26:6, PSA 73:13

The gesture of shaking dust from the feet

MAT 10:14 parallels MRK 6:11, LUK 9:5 See also LUK 10:11; ACT 13:51

Jesus Christ's gesture of washing the disciples' feet

JHN 13:4–13:5, JHN 13:12–13:15 This was a gesture of service and a lesson in both serving and being willing to accept service.

5866: gluttony

Scripture condemns an excessive greed for food. Its unrestrained self-indulgence often leads to deeper iniquity and represents a rejection of godly moderation.

Gluttony is a form of idolatry and therefore condemned as offensive to God

EPH 5:5; PHP 3:19 See also PSA 10:3; ISA 22:12–22:14 Gluttony as escapism, trying to avoid God's requirements; ZEC 7:4–7:6 Even their religious feasts were nothing but self-indulgence; MRK 7:21–7:23; 1CO 6:9–6:10, 1CO 10:7; COL 3:5; JAS 5:5

Gluttony is closely linked with drunkenness

EXO 32:6; ; JDG 9:27; ; 1SA 25:36

The destructive consequences of gluttony

PRO 23:20–23:21, PRO 28:7 See also PRO 15:27, PRO 28:25; ECC 6:7

Warnings against gluttony

PRO 23:1–23:2; LUK 12:15; EPH 5:3; COL 3:5 See also LUK 12:19–12:20, LUK 21:34; 1CO 5:9–5:11; GAL 5:19–5:21; TIT 1:12–1:13; 1PE 4:3–4:4

Examples of gluttony

GEN 25:29–25:34 Esau putting food before his birthright; ; NUM 11:32 the children of Israel gorging on quail; ; 1SA 30:16 an Amalekite raiding party; ; 1KI 1:24–1:25 Adonijah feasting with his supporters; ; DAN 5:1 King Belshazzar; ; MAT 11:19 parallel LUK 7:34 Jesus Christ falsely accused of gluttony; ; MAT 23:25 parallel LUK 11:39 the Pharisees; ; MAT 24:49 parallel LUK 12:45 the irresponsible servant; ; LUK 15:13 the prodigal son; ; 2PE 2:13–2:14 false teachers

5867: golden rule

The command of Jesus Christ to love others as ourselves

MAT 7:12 parallel LUK 6:31 See also MAT 22:39–22:40 parallel MRK 12:31; ROM 13:8–13:9; GAL 5:14

5868: gossip

Idle talk which foolishly or maliciously spreads rumours or facts. The effects of gossiping are divisive and destructive.

Examples of gossiping

NEH 6:5–6:8 False rumours were used to intimidate Nehemiah; ; PSA 41:5–41:8; ; JHN 7:12–7:13; ; 3JN 1:9–1:10

Dangers of talking too much

PRO 10:19 See also PRO 18:6–18:7, PRO 21:23, PRO 29:11; ECC 5:2–5:3; MAT 12:36–12:37

Gossip can result from idleness

1TI 5:13

Gossip has disastrous effects

PRO 16:28 See also PRO 11:13, PRO 17:9, PRO 25:9–25:10, PRO 26:20

Gossiping condemned and forbidden

LEV 19:16 See also EXO 23:1; PSA 101:5; PRO 10:18; ROM 1:29–1:30; 2CO 12:20

Advice on avoiding gossip

PSA 141:3 See also PRO 20:19

5869: greed

An excessive appetite for further goods or food, often linked with selfishness and gluttony.

5870: greed, condemnation of

Greed is condemned by Scripture as contrary to the purposes of God.

Greed is a feature of the fallen world

PSA 10:3; ROM 1:29 See also 1CO 5:10

Greed is an expression of sinful human nature

MRK 7:21–7:22 parallel MAT 15:19–15:20 See also EZK 33:31; ROM 7:8

Examples of greed

Of individuals

JOS 7:21; ; EZK 22:12; ; DAN 5:23

Of false teachers

MAT 23:25 See also JER 6:13, JER 8:10; LUK 11:39; 2PE 2:3, 2PE 2:14

Greed invites God's judgment both now and later

EPH 5:5 See also PRO 15:27, PRO 28:8, PRO 28:25, PRO 29:4; EZK 18:10–18:13, EZK 28:5–28:7; AMO 8:4–8:7; MIC 2:1–2:3; HAB 2:5–2:6; 1CO 6:9–6:10

5871: greed, believers' response to

Greed should have no place in the lives of God's people.

The righteous are not to be greedy

PRO 28:6 See also EXO 20:17 parallel DEU 5:21; PRO 11:28, PRO 22:1, PRO 23:4; EZK 18:8, EZK 18:17; ROM 13:9

The Christian leader is not to be greedy

1TI 3:2–3:3 See also TIT 1:7; 1PE 5:2

The example of Paul

ACT 20:33 See also 1TH 2:5

The antidotes to greed

Greed must be repented of

LUK 3:14 John the Baptist counselling soldiers on how they must express their repentance.

The need to be on guard against greed

PSA 62:10; LUK 12:15 See also LUK 12:16–12:21

The need to be separate from greed and from the greedy

1CO 5:11; COL 3:5 See also JOB 36:18; EPH 5:3

The need to be content

HEB 13:5 See also PHP 4:11–4:13; 1TI 6:3–6:10

The need to seek God, not gain

1TI 6:17–6:18 See also 1KI 3:11–3:14; PSA 119:14; JER 9:23–9:24

5873: habits

Set patterns of behaviour. These patterns can be helpful when they lead to spiritual discipline and a regular pattern of prayer and worship; others can be detrimental to faith.

Examples of good habits

Reading and obeying God's word

PSA 119:56; HEB 5:14 See also PSA 119:44, PSA 119:97

Private prayer

LUK 5:16 See also PSA 5:3; MAT 6:5–6:6, MAT 14:23 parallel MRK 6:46; MRK 1:35 parallel LUK 4:42; LUK 6:12, LUK 9:18, LUK 11:1

Attendance at public worship

LUK 4:16; ; ACT 2:46, ACT 14:1, ACT 17:2

Examples of bad habits

JER 22:21 See also EXO 21:29, EXO 21:36; JDG 2:19; EZK 33:31

Warnings to avoid certain habits

HEB 10:25 See also 1TI 5:13

The difficulty of breaking bad habits

JER 13:23

5874: happiness

A state of pleasure or joy experienced both by people and by God, but subject to change according to circumstances. True happiness derives from a secure and settled knowledge of God and a rejoicing in his works and covenant faithfulness. God rejoices over his faithful people.

Happiness found in human relationships

DEU 24:5 See also GEN 30:13, GEN 34:19; 1KI 10:8; PSA 113:9; PRO 23:24; ECC 9:9; SNG 4:10; ROM 15:24; 2CO 7:13

Happiness found in people and things

1KI 4:20; LUK 1:14; 1TI 6:17 See also DEU 20:61SA 18:3, 1SA 20:17 PSA 127:3–127:5; ECC 3:12, ECC 5:19, ECC 8:15, ECC 11:9; ISA 65:22; JON 4:6; LUK 12:19; JHN 16:21; PHP 2:25–2:30

Happiness found in God

In God's presence

PSA 16:11 See also PSA 21:6, PSA 43:4; 1TH 3:9

In God's word

PSA 119:35 See also ISA 55:2; JER 15:16; MRK 12:37; ROM 7:22

In God's actions

GEN 21:6; ACT 11:23 See also EXO 18:9; 1SA 2:1, 1SA 19:5; 1KI 8:66; EST 8:16; PSA 16:6, PSA 92:4, PSA 111:2; ISA 61:10; ACT 13:48

God's happiness

In obedient people

DEU 30:9–30:10 See also 1SA 15:22; PSA 147:11; ISA 9:17; MAT 25:21

In the righteous

PRO 11:20 See also PSA 147:11; PRO 11:1; ECC 2:26; JER 9:24

Jesus Christ's recipe for happiness

MAT 5:3–5:10 parallel LUK 6:20–6:22

Happiness may not be permanent

ECC 7:14 See also EST 5:9; JOB 7:7; PSA 10:6; PRO 15:13; ECC 11:9; JER 16:9; LAM 5:15; JOL 1:12

Happiness for those who trust in God

PSA 84:12 See also PSA 2:12, PSA 34:8, PSA 40:4, PSA 146:5; PRO 16:20; JER 17:7; LUK 1:45; JHN 20:29; GAL 3:9

Happiness for those who obey God

PSA 89:15 See also JOB 5:17; PSA 1:1–1:2, PSA 94:12, PSA 112:1, PSA 128:1; PRO 28:14, PRO 29:18; ISA 56:1–56:2; LUK 11:27–11:28; REV 1:3, REV 22:7

Happiness for those who are forgiven

PSA 32:1–32:2 See also ROM 4:7–4:8; REV 22:14

Happiness for those who suffer persecution

1PE 3:14 See also MAT 5:11–5:12; 1PE 4:14

Happiness for those who persevere

MAT 11:6 See also JAS 1:12, JAS 5:11; REV 16:15

5875: hatred

Hatred for others or God is associated with human sin. Scripture also emphasises God's hatred of sin and evil. Believers are commanded to love those who hate them.

Hatred as evidence of corrupt human nature

2SA 13:15; TIT 3:3 See also GEN 37:4; DEU 7:15, DEU 19:11–19:12; JDG 11:7; 2SA 13:22; PSA 25:19, PSA 38:19; PRO 10:12; MAT 24:10; GAL 5:19–5:20; 1JN 2:9–2:11, 1JN 3:15, 1JN 4:20

Hatred of God himself

PSA 81:15; ROM 1:29–1:31 See also EXO 20:5; DEU 7:10, DEU 32:41; 2CH 19:2; PSA 50:17; PRO 1:29; JHN 3:20, JHN 15:23–15:25; JAS 4:4

Hatred of Jesus Christ

JHN 7:7 See also ISA 53:3; MAT 12:14, MAT 21:46, MAT 26:3–26:4, MAT 27:22; LUK 19:14; JHN 17:14

Hatred of the godly and upright

1KI 22:8; MAT 10:22 See also EST 9:1; PSA 35:19, PSA 69:4, PSA 109:3–109:5; PRO 29:10; ISA 66:5; AMO 5:10; MAT 24:9–24:10 parallels MRK 13:13, LUK 21:16–21:19; LUK 1:69–1:71, LUK 6:22; JHN 15:18; ACT 9:29, ACT 23:12–23:15; 1JN 3:13

Believers are to love those who hate them

LUK 6:27–6:28 See also MAT 5:43–5:44

God's hatred of evil

PSA 5:4–5:5; PRO 6:16–6:19; ISA 61:8 See also DEU 12:31, DEU 16:21–16:22; PSA 11:5; ISA 1:14; JER 12:8; HOS 9:15; AMO 5:21; ZEC 8:16–8:17; MAL 2:16

The godly should also hate evil

PRO 8:13; ROM 12:9 See also EXO 18:21; PSA 31:6, PSA 97:10, PSA 101:3, PSA 119:104, PSA 119:113, PSA 119:128, PSA 119:163, PSA 139:21; PRO 13:5, PRO 15:17; AMO 5:15; HEB 1:9; PSA 45:7; REV 2:6

5876: helpfulness

God's help

God promises his help

ISA 41:10 See also PSA 121:3–121:4; MAT 28:20; JHN 14:16

People value God's help

PSA 118:6–118:7 See also DEU 33:29; 2CH 25:8; PSA 28:7, PSA 54:4; ISA 50:9; ACT 26:22

People need God's help

PSA 94:17 See also JOS 14:12; PSA 22:11, PSA 22:19, PSA 40:17, PSA 116:6; ISA 59:16, ISA 63:5; MAT 9:36; HEB 13:6; PSA 118:6–118:7

God's help can be withheld

2SA 22:42 See also JOB 19:7; PSA 107:11–107:13; HOS 13:9; ZEC 7:13

God's help is not imposed

JER 29:12 See also 2KI 5:11–5:12; 2CH 16:12; 1PE 5:6–5:7

People should imitate God's help by being helpful

2SA 9:1; ; LUK 10:36–10:37; ; GAL 6:2; ; EPH 5:1; ; JAS 2:14–2:17

Examples of human helpfulness

Shown to those in need

LUK 10:34 See also 2CH 28:15; JOB 29:15–29:16; ACT 2:44–2:45, ACT 4:34–4:35

Shown by young people

1SA 2:18, 1SA 17:15, 1SA 17:17, 1SA 20:36; ; 2KI 5:2–5:3; ; JHN 6:9

Shown within marriage

GEN 2:18, GEN 2:22; ; PRO 18:22, PRO 31:12, PRO 31:20; ; 1PE 3:7

Shown to God's servants

ROM 16:2 See also JOS 2:4, JOS 2:15; 1KI 17:10–17:11; LUK 10:7; 1CO 16:15–16:16; 2CO 1:11; PHP 4:3; PHM 1:11

Helpfulness is remembered and rewarded

MAT 25:34–25:36 See also JOS 6:17; 1KI 17:14; ROM 16:2

5877: hesitation

A delay in reaching a decision, or a reluctance to reach a decision, on account of uncertainty, caution or rebellion. Scripture provides examples of individuals who hesitate in the face of divine commands or promises, and indicates its dangers.

Examples of people who hesitated

Lot

GEN 19:16

Lot's wife

GEN 19:26 See also GEN 19:17; LUK 17:32

Moses

EXO 3:11, EXO 3:13, EXO 4:1, EXO 4:10, EXO 4:13, EXO 6:12

Peter in obeying the Lord

ACT 11:12 See also ACT 10:14–10:20

Other examples

Israel on approaching the promised land: NUM 13:31–13:33, NUM 14:1–14:4; JDG 6:36–6:40 Gideon; ; 1KI 18:21 Israel in the time of Elijah; ; JER 1:6 Jeremiah

Examples of people who did not hesitate

Caleb

NUM 13:30

Simon and Andrew

MAT 4:18–4:20 parallels MRK 1:16–1:18, LUK 5:10–5:11, JHN 1:40–1:42

Paul

ACT 20:27 See also ACT 20:20

Believers should not hesitate to act when they know what is right

They should not hesitate to speak

ISA 58:1

Jesus Christ commands immediate obedience

LUK 9:62 See also LUK 9:57–9:60 parallel MAT 8:19–8:22

God does not hesitate

To bring judgment

EZK 24:14 See also EZK 12:25; DAN 9:14

The delay in Jesus Christ's return is not due to hesitation

2PE 3:9

5878: honour

Great respect; the creation is called upon to respect and revere God as its Creator. Since human beings are made in the image of God, they should respect one another.

The creation honours its Creator

All creatures honour God

ISA 43:20 See also REV 5:13

The people of God honour God

EXO 12:40–12:42; PSA 22:23 See also PSA 50:14–50:15; ISA 25:1–25:3; JER 3:17, JER 33:7–33:9; 2TH 3:1

How God wishes to be honoured

Honouring God by worshipping him

REV 5:11–5:12 See also PSA 50:23; REV 4:9–4:11

Honouring God by obeying him

EZK 33:31 These people honoured God with their words only, but this was not true honour for they failed to obey his commands. See also NUM 25:10–25:13; ISA 29:13

Honouring God with one's body

1CO 6:19–6:20 See also ROM 12:1; 2CO 4:10–4:11

Honouring God with one's possessions

PRO 3:9 See also ISA 60:9; 2CO 8:19

Honouring God by caring for others

PRO 14:31 See also MAT 25:31–25:40; JAS 1:27

The consequences of not honouring God

MAL 2:2 See also NUM 20:12; DAN 5:22–5:31

Jesus Christ and honour

Honour given to Jesus Christ

HEB 2:9 See also ACT 19:17; 2PE 1:17; MAT 17:5; MRK 9:7; LUK 9:35

The relationship of honour between the Father and the Son

JHN 5:23 See also JHN 8:49–8:50

God brings honour to people

1SA 2:30 See also PSA 62:7; ZEP 3:19–3:20; JHN 12:26; ROM 2:9–2:11

Honouring others as a duty to God

Honouring one's parents

EXO 20:12; EPH 6:2–6:3 See also MAL 1:6; MAT 15:1–15:6; LUK 18:20

Honouring fellow believers

ROM 12:10 See also PHP 2:29; 1TI 5:17

5879: humiliation

The act of being put to shame, often in a public manner. Jesus Christ was humiliated through his suffering, degradation and execution. Believers may expect to suffer humiliation on account of their faith.

Examples of humiliation

David's men at the hands of Hanun

2SA 10:4–10:5 parallel 1CH 19:4–19:5

Michal, by David's dancing

2SA 6:14, 2SA 6:20–6:22

Joab and his men, by David's seemingly inappropriate mourning

2SA 19:5–19:6

Haman, by his death on the gallows prepared for Mordecai

EST 6:11–6:12, EST 7:10

Job

JOB 19:5

Peter, by his denial of Jesus Christ

MAT 26:69–26:75 parallels MRK 14:66–14:72, LUK 22:55–22:62, JHN 18:16–18:18, JHN 18:25–18:27

Warnings against presumption

PRO 25:7; ; LUK 14:7–14:11; ; 1CO 10:12

People are often humiliated as a punishment for sin

OBA 1:8–1:10 See also 2KI 19:28; EZR 9:7; PSA 35:26; ISA 13:11, ISA 22:19, ISA 25:11, ISA 26:5; JER 15:9, JER 23:40, JER 31:19, JER 49:16; EZK 28:8; MAL 2:9

Jesus Christ suffered humiliation**Jesus Christ's humiliation prophesied in the OT**

ISA 53:9, ISA 53:12 See also ISA 50:6, ISA 52:14, ISA 53:2–53:4; ACT 8:32–8:33; ISA 53:7–53:8

Jesus Christ's humiliation in his incarnation

PHP 2:6–2:8 See also 2CO 8:9

Jesus Christ's humiliation in his humble birth

LUK 2:7

Jesus Christ's humiliation through the words of others

MAT 9:34, MAT 11:19 parallel LUK 7:34; ; MRK 3:21; ; JHN 7:20, JHN 9:16

Jesus Christ's humiliation through the actions of others

LUK 4:28–4:29, LUK 7:44–7:46

Jesus Christ's humiliation at his trials

MRK 14:55–14:65; MAT 27:27–27:31 See also MAT 26:59–26:68 parallel JHN 18:19–18:24; MAT 27:26 parallels MRK 15:15, LUK 23:25, JHN 19:16, MRK 15:16–15:20, JHN 19:1–19:3; LUK 23:9–23:11

Jesus Christ's humiliation at his crucifixion

LUK 23:33–23:43 See also GAL 3:13; DEU 21:23; LUK 22:37; ISA 53:12; MAT 27:33–27:44 parallels MRK 15:22–15:32, JHN 19:17–19:24

Believers should be prepared to suffer humiliation from unbelievers

2TI 3:12 See also MAT 5:11, MAT 10:17–10:18; JHN 15:20, JHN 16:2; PHP 1:28–1:30; 1TH 1:6; HEB 10:33–10:34; 1PE 2:19–2:21; REV 2:10

Believers are not to humiliate others

JAS 2:2–2:4 See also MAT 5:22, MAT 7:4–7:5; 1CO 11:20–11:22

5880: humour**A time and place for humour**

ECC 3:1–3:4

Touches of humour in Scripture**Things people found funny**

GEN 18:12 See also GEN 17:17

Humour at others' expense

JOB 12:4

OT writers found wordplay humorous

MIC 1:10–1:11

Some passages seem to have a humorous intent

See also 1KI 18:27; MAT 19:24; LUK 6:42; ACT 12:13–12:16

5881: immaturity

The result of insufficient growth, or a failure to develop to one's full potential.

Marks of physical immaturity**Pride**

2SA 15:1–15:4

Rejection of wise counsel

DEU 21:18; ; 1KI 12:8

Tactlessness

1KI 12:13–12:14

Lack of respect

2KI 2:23; ; JOB 19:18

Weakness of character

2CH 13:7

Foolishness

PRO 22:15

Lack of understanding

DEU 1:39; ; PRO 1:4; ; JON 4:11; ; 1CO 13:11

Lack of self-control

TIT 2:6

Disgrace

PRO 29:15

Waste

LUK 15:13

Spiritual immaturity is to be avoided

1CO 14:20; HEB 6:1 See also 2CO 13:9, 2CO 13:11 The word “perfection” may be understood in terms of maturity; EPH 4:13, EPH 4:15; COL 1:28, COL 4:12; JAS 1:4; 2PE 3:18

Marks of spiritual immaturity**Backsliding**

MAT 13:20–13:21 parallels MRK 4:16–4:17, LUK 8:13 Jesus Christ to his disciples. See also GAL 4:8–4:9

An over-sensitive conscience**ROM 14:2****Lack of spiritual understanding****1CO 3:1–3:2** See also MAT 11:16–11:19 parallel LUK 7:31–7:35; HEB 5:11–5:14**Divisiveness****1CO 3:3****Instability****EPH 4:14** See also JAS 1:6–1:7**Pride****1TI 3:6** The church overseer must be a spiritually mature person. See also 1PE 5:5**Remedies for immaturity****Confession of sin****PRO 28:13** See also JER 3:13–3:22; JAS 5:16; 1JN 1:9**Discipline****PRO 3:11–3:12** See also PSA 119:67–119:71; 1PE 4:1–4:2; REV 3:19**Prayer and meditation****PSA 119:97–119:99** See also PSA 119:27; JHN 17:17–17:19; ROM 8:26; HEB 4:16; JAS 1:25**5882: impartiality**

The ability to be unbiased towards any one race, class or person. This attitude is demonstrated by God and is to be emulated by the human race.

God is impartial**DEU 10:17** See also 2CH 19:7**God treats people impartially****MAT 5:45** See also JOB 25:3; JOB 34:19; PRO 22:2; ROM 2:11; EPH 6:9**God judges impartially****COL 3:25** See also JOB 34:11–34:12; PSA 62:12; JER 17:10; ROM 2:9–2:11; 2CO 5:10; 1PE 1:17; REV 22:12**God does not distinguish between people on the basis of external appearance****1SA 16:7** See also PSA 147:10–147:11; JER 9:25; LUK 16:15; GAL 2:6; REV 2:23**God does not discriminate against different races or classes****ACT 10:34–10:35; GAL 3:28** See also DEU 10:18; JOB 34:19; ACT 10:28; ACT 15:7–15:9**The impartiality of Jesus Christ****Jesus Christ's teaching was impartial****LUK 20:21** parallels MAT 22:16; MRK 12:14 See also MAT 20:1–20:16 a parable of Jesus Christ about divine impartiality**Jesus Christ showed impartiality in his dealings with people****JHN 4:9** Jesus Christ contravened accepted boundaries of partiality in this encounter. See also MAT 9:10–9:12 parallels MRK 2:15–2:17, LUK 5:29–5:31; MAT 15:22–15:28 parallel MRK 7:26–7:29; MAT 20:20–20:23 parallel MRK 10:35–10:40**Impartiality commended****JAS 2:1** See also PRO 28:21; 1CO 3:3–3:4, 1CO 4:6–4:7; 1TI 5:21; JAS 2:9**Humanity should judge impartially****PRO 24:23–24:25** See also EXO 18:16; DEU 1:17, DEU 16:19, DEU 24:17; PRO 17:15, PRO 18:5; MAL 2:9**Showing impartiality to all people is commanded****Impartiality to foreigners****EXO 22:21** See also EXO 23:9; LEV 19:33–19:34; NUM 15:15–15:16; ROM 10:12**Impartiality to children**

DEU 21:15–21:17

Impartiality to the poor**EXO 23:6** See also EXO 23:3; LEV 19:15; PRO 29:7; JAS 2:2–2:7**Ways to avoid partiality****By not accepting bribes****EXO 23:8** See also JOB 36:18; PRO 15:27; ISA 1:23**By not following the crowd**

EXO 23:2; ; MRK 15:15

Christians should be partial towards spiritual principles**MAT 6:24** parallel LUK 16:13 See also MAT 12:30 parallel LUK 11:23; MAT 7:13–7:14; MRK 9:39–9:40 parallel LUK 9:49–9:50**Examples where impartiality is absent**

GEN 25:27–25:28 Isaac and Rebekah to Jacob and Esau; ; GEN 29:30–29:32 Jacob to Leah and Rachel; ; GEN 37:3–37:4 Jacob to Joseph and his brothers; ; 1SA 1:4–1:6 Elkanah to Hannah and Peninnah

5883: impatience

A refusal to wait for people or developments, frequently displaying a lack of faith.

Examples of impatience

GEN 16:1–16:2 Abraham and Sarah who did not wait for God to give them the son he had promised; ; GEN 25:30 Esau's impatience cost him his birthright; ; NUM 20:9–20:11 Moses; NUM 21:4; ; PSA 106:13; ; ISA 59:7; 1SA 13:6–13:12 Saul made the offering without waiting for Samuel; ; 2SA 13:2 Amnon with his half-sister, Tamar; ; 2SA 14:29 Absalom with Joab; ; 2SA 18:14 Joab with Absalom; ; 2KI 5:11–5:12 Naaman; ; 2KI 6:33 King Joram; JOB 6:11, JOB 21:4; JOB 32:16 Elihu; ; MAT 18:29–18:30 the unforgiving debtor; ; LUK 15:2 The younger son could not wait for his inheritance; ; JHN 21:3 Peter; ; ACT 20:16 Paul; ; 1CO 11:20–11:21 the Corinthian Christians at their communal meal; ; REV 6:10–6:11 the martyrs waiting for the Lord to avenge their deaths

Warnings against impatience

PSA 37:7; PRO 19:2; GAL 6:9; JAS 1:19–1:20 See also PRO 6:18, PRO 12:16, PRO 14:29, PRO 15:18, PRO 16:32, PRO 20:3PRO 21:5, PRO 28:22 PRO 25:8 the need to exercise caution in disputesPRO 29:20; ECC 5:2 ECC 7:9, ECC 8:3; HAB 2:3

5884: indecision

Uncertainty, hesitation and doubt reflect a failure of the basic human ability to choose. They reveal an internal debate and lack of conviction.

Indecision arising from doubt and hesitation

JAS 1:6–1:8 See also 1KI 18:21; MAT 14:31, MAT 21:21; MRK 11:23; ROM 14:23

Examples of indecisive behaviour

EXO 3:11 See also EXO 4:13, EXO 14:10–14:15; JOS 7:10; EST 5:8; MAT 27:21–27:26 parallels MRK 15:9–15:15, LUK 23:13–23:25, JHN 18:38–18:40; MRK 16:11–16:14; JHN 20:25; ACT 24:25

Indecision may be indicative of divided loyalty

MAT 6:24 parallel LUK 16:13 See also MAT 19:22 parallels MRK 10:22, LUK 18:23

Indecision or uncertainty may be prompted by Satan

GEN 3:1 See also GEN 3:4; JHN 8:44; 2CO 11:3; REV 12:9

5885: indifference

A neutral attitude to God that is as dangerous as hostility. It is condemned as a rejection of God's love and of the needs of others.

Indifference towards God

No desire to seek God

ROM 3:11 See also ISA 42:20; JER 5:21; ZEP 1:6; MAT 13:15, MAT 24:12; ACT 28:27; REV 3:15–3:22

Refusal to heed God's word

JER 37:2 See also PSA 81:11; JER 6:10, JER 7:13, JER 25:3–25:7, JER 35:15; EZK 3:7; ZEC 1:4, ZEC 7:11–7:13

Refusal to respond to God's discipline

JER 5:3 See also JER 2:30, JER 7:27–7:28, JER 17:23, JER 32:33

Ignoring God is rebellion against him

EZK 12:2 See also JER 2:19, JER 7:26, JER 36:24; EZK 20:8

People ignore God and his warnings at their peril

JER 12:11 See also EXO 9:21, EXO 9:25; 2CH 33:10–33:11; NEH 9:30; PRO 1:24–1:27, PRO 13:18; JER 11:8, JER 36:31, JER 44:5–44:6; MAT 22:5–22:7

For those who ignore God's salvation, there is no hope

HEB 2:3 See also JER 7:24; MAT 12:30 parallel LUK 11:23

Indifference to God's declared intentions

EZK 22:30 See also NUM 32:6–32:7; JDG 5:15–5:17, JDG 5:23; 2CH 24:5; PSA 22:11; ISA 64:7; JER 48:10

Indifference of religious leaders condemned

EZK 34:2–34:4; ; ZEC 11:16–11:17; ; JHN 10:12–10:13

Indifference towards the needs of others

Indifference arises from sin

PRO 29:7 See also JOB 21:21; ISA 32:6; JAS 2:15–2:16, JAS 5:1–5:6

Examples of indifference towards others

GEN 40:23 towards Joseph; ; ISA 25:10–25:11 towards David; MAT 26:40 parallels MRK 14:37, LUK 22:45; 2TI 4:10, 2TI 4:16

Jesus Christ condemns indifference

MAT 25:41–25:45 See also LUK 10:30–10:32, LUK 16:19–16:21

Jesus Christ's apparent indifference

MRK 4:38 parallels MAT 8:24–8:25, LUK 8:23–8:24 Jesus Christ sometimes delayed responding to cries for help in order to draw out faith. See also MAT 15:26 parallel MRK 7:27; LUK 10:40; JHN 11:6

5886: individualism

The recognition of individuality, of the differences between particular people, and of their special gifts, needs and character. In a negative sense, the term can mean placing the needs of individuals above those of

the church as a whole, which is contrary to the biblical emphasis on all believers sharing in the common ministry of the body of Christ.

Individualism stresses the differences between people

Recognising people's special gifts

1CO 12:4–12:6 See also ROM 12:6–12:8; 1CO 12:8–12:11, 1CO 12:28–12:30; EPH 4:11; HEB 2:4; 1PE 4:10

Recognising people's abilities and opportunities

MAT 25:14–25:15 See also LUK 19:12–19:13; 1CO 4:7

Individualism and the church

Recognising the parts people play in the church, the body of Christ

1CO 12:12 See also ROM 12:4–12:5; 1CO 12:14, 1CO 12:17–12:20, 1CO 12:27

Individualism must not emphasise the individual at the expense of the church as a whole

1CO 12:21–12:26 See also ROM 12:3, ROM 12:10, ROM 12:16; PHP 2:3

Contrary to self-seeking individualism, believers should share in the common ministry of the body of Christ

ACT 2:42 See also ACT 2:44, ACT 4:34–4:35; 2CO 8:13–8:14, 2CO 9:13; HEB 13:16

5887: inexperience

Lack of experience of life or a particular aspect of life. Inexperience is often associated with the young who are thus vulnerable and who should be taught by those older and wiser. God sometimes calls the inexperienced to leadership but usually also provides encouragement and support from more experienced leaders.

The inexperience of youth

ISA 3:4–3:7; JER 1:6 See also DEU 1:39; 1KI 3:7; 1CH 29:1; 2CH 10:8–10:11 parallel 1KI 12:8–12:11; 2CH 13:7; ISA 7:15–7:16

The inexperienced may be led astray

2KI 17:41 Children often follow in the ways of their parents; **MAT 18:6** See also 1KI 22:53; 2KI 24:9; MRK 9:42; LUK 17:2

God's call to the inexperienced

JER 1:7–1:8 See also 1SA 16:11–16:13 David, Jesse's youngest son, is chosen by God; 1SA 17:33 David's inexperience in the face of Goliath; 1TI 4:12 Timothy was called to pastor a church despite his youth. In

general, however, church leaders should be people of experience (see 1TI 3:6).

Support for the inexperienced

Teaching the inexperienced

DEU 4:9–4:10; JOB 8:8–8:9 Each generation learns from the wisdom and experience of those going before. See also DEU 11:2–11:7, DEU 31:13; JOB 32:6–32:7; PSA 71:18, PSA 78:3–78:5; PRO 5:1–5:2; EPH 6:4

Examples of help given to the inexperienced

1CH 22:5 See also DEU 1:38 Moses is to encourage his young successor, Joshua; JDG 3:1–3:2 teaching warfare to those who have no experience of it; 1SA 3:8–3:10 Eli instructs the inexperienced Samuel; 1KI 19:19–19:21 Elisha becomes Elijah's attendant; 1CH 28:20 David encourages Solomon to build the temple; PRO 4:3–4:4 Solomon recalls the instruction given by his father; ACT 15:39 Barnabas takes John Mark with him; 2TI 3:14–3:15 Paul reminds Timothy of the example he has been given.

5888: inferiority

A discouraging sense of being of less importance or value in comparison with others.

Inferiority as a depressing lack of self-worth

JDG 6:15; PSA 22:6; 1CO 2:3 See also 1SA 18:23; NEH 4:4, NEH 6:9; PSA 31:9–31:10, PSA 70:5, PSA 74:21, PSA 86:1, PSA 109:22, PSA 119:25, PSA 119:141; ECC 9:16; ISA 33:8; JER 22:28; LAM 1:11; MAL 2:9

Inferiority as a healthy sense of unworthiness

ISA 6:5; MAT 5:3; LUK 5:8 See also 2SA 12:13; JOB 42:6; PSA 38:1–38:22, PSA 51:3–51:5; REV 1:17, REV 3:17

God's judgment will bring inferiority on on proud nations

OBA 1:2 See also ISA 16:14; JER 49:15; EZK 29:15

Refusing to be intimidated by a sense of inferiority

JOB 12:3; 1TI 4:12 See also JOB 13:2; 2CO 11:5, 2CO 12:11; TIT 2:15

God values those regarded as inferior and uses them

DEU 7:7–7:8; 1CO 1:27–1:28 See also 1SA 2:8; PSA 12:5, PSA 34:6, PSA 35:10, PSA 36:7, PSA 40:17, PSA 72:13, PSA 136:23, PSA 140:12; ISA 11:4, ISA 25:4, ISA 29:19, ISA 41:14, ISA 49:7, ISA 61:1–61:3; HOS 11:1–11:4

Jesus Christ valued those traditionally regarded as inferior

MAT 8:2–8:4 the diseased and ritually unclean; ; MAT 9:10–9:13 the morally unacceptable; ; MAT 15:21–15:29 non-Jews; ; MAT 19:13–19:14 children; ; LUK 18:13 those who are ashamed of their sins; ; JHN 4:9 women

Believers are to help and encourage those who feel inferior

LUK 14:13; ROM 12:16 See also PSA 82:3–82:4; 1TH 5:14; HEB 12:12–12:13

5889: ingratitude

The absence of due thankfulness. Scripture gives examples of human ingratitude to God for all the blessings and gifts which he provides for them. It is especially important for Christians to give thanks to God.

The ingratitude of human beings to one another

Examples of ingratitude

GEN 40:23 the chief butler towards Joseph; ; NUM 16:13–16:14 Dathan and Abiram to Moses; JDG 8:35, JDG 9:18; 1SA 25:21 Nabal to David; ; 2CH 24:22 King Joash to Jehoiada; ; ECC 9:15 the citizens to the wise man who delivered a city

Returning evil for good

PSA 35:12 See also GEN 44:4; PSA 109:5; PRO 17:13; JER 18:20

Ingratitude to God

It was in evidence at the fall

GEN 3:2–3:3 Eve showed ingratitude for God's provision by not believing him.

It is part of fallen human nature

ROM 1:21

It is a sign of the last days

See also 2TI 3:2

Israel's repeated ingratitude to the LORD

For deliverance from Egypt: EXO 16:3, EXO 16:8, EXO 17:7; ; HEB 3:7–3:9, HEB 3:15; ; PSA 95:7–95:9; DEU 32:6 They were rebuked by Moses for the way they repaid God; ; 1SA 8:7–8:8 They rejected the LORD when they rejected Samuel; ; NEH 9:26 They rejected God's law and killed his prophets.

Ingratitude compared with other sins

Becoming like animals

ISA 1:3

Becoming like prostitutes

EZK 16:17–16:19

Becoming like an adulterous wife

HOS 2:8, HOS 4:12, HOS 5:4, HOS 9:1

Jesus Christ exposed ingratitude

LUK 17:15–17:18

God is kind even to the ungrateful

LUK 6:35

It is important for believers to show gratitude to God

PSA 100:4 See also PSA 107:22; COL 1:12, COL 3:15; 1TH 5:18

5890: insecurity

Lack of security, often in relation to one's future or to one's present position. All human life is insecure, but the future of sinners is particularly dangerous and real security is found only in God.

The insecurity of human life

ISA 40:6–40:8 See also JOB 1:13–1:21; PSA 90:10, PSA 146:3–146:6; ECC 9:1, ECC 9:12, ECC 10:8–10:9; JER 51:58; 1TH 5:1–5:3

The insecurity of the sinner's life

PSA 37:1–37:2 See also PSA 37:9–37:11; PRO 6:12–6:15, PRO 11:5, PRO 24:19–24:22, PRO 29:1; ISA 30:12–30:14, ISA 47:8–47:11; JER 6:13–6:15, JER 15:5–15:9, JER 49:16–49:18; AMO 8:14

The insecurity of the rich

1TI 6:17 See also PRO 27:24; LUK 12:15–12:21; 1TI 6:7–6:10

Examples of behaviour motivated by insecurity

Saul's vendetta against David

1SA 18:6–18:12 See also 1SA 18:17–18:29, 1SA 19:1, 1SA 19:9–19:17, 1SA 20:30–20:31

Assassination of political rivals

2KI 11:1 parallel 2CH 22:10 See also JDG 9:1–9:6

True security is to be found in God alone

PRO 14:26 See also DEU 33:12; 1KI 2:45; PSA 16:5, PSA 48:8; PRO 3:5–3:6

5891: instability

The danger of instability in the Christian life

EPH 4:14; JAS 1:6–1:8 See also MAT 7:26–7:27; 2PE 2:14, 2PE 3:16

Firmness of faith as an antidote to instability**1CO 15:58** See also MAT 7:24–7:25; COL 1:23; 1PE 5:10**Political instability****PRO 29:4****5892: instinct**

An innate urge, rooted in natural conditioning rather than reason. Scripture likens sinners to creatures of instinct.

Animals are creatures of instinct**2PE 2:12** See also JUD 1:10**Sinners are likened to creatures of instinct****JUD 1:10****People without the Holy Spirit are likened to creatures of instinct****JUD 1:19****Believers ought instinctively to obey God**

ISA 1:3 Just as the animals instinctively know their masters, so Israel should know and obey God. See also JER 8:7

5893: insults

Expressions of an individual's hostility or contempt for God and his servants or fellow human beings. Believers are to follow Jesus Christ's example in not returning insults.

Insults to God**Insults to God coming from open unbelief**

2KI 19:14–19:16, 2KI 19:20–19:23 parallels 2CH 32:16–32:19, ISA 37:14–37:17, ISA 37:21–37:24; ; HEB 10:29

Insults to God coming through the suffering of believers

PSA 69:7–69:9 See also JER 20:7–20:8; ROM 15:3; HEB 13:12–13:13

Insults to God lamented by the psalmist**PSA 74:18, PSA 74:22–74:23** See also PSA 10:3**Jesus Christ insulted**

LUK 18:31–18:33 parallels MAT 20:17–20:19, MRK 10:32–10:34 See also MAT 26:67–26:68 parallels MRK 14:65, LUK 22:63–22:65; MAT 27:39–27:44 parallels MRK 15:29–15:32, LUK 23:35–23:39; JHN 8:48–8:49, JHN 18:22–18:23; 1PE 2:23

Israel insulted

JER 51:51 See also ISA 17:26; 2SA 21:20–21:21 parallel 1CH 20:6–20:7; EZK 21:28–21:32; ZEP 2:8–2:10

Kings, prophets and others insulted

1SA 10:27, 1SA 25:9–25:11, 1SA 25:14; ; 2SA 10:1–10:5 parallel 1CH 19:1–19:5; ; 2KI 2:23–2:24; ; NEH 4:1–4:5; ; ECC 10:20

The poor insulted

1CO 11:20–11:22; ; JAS 2:1–2:7

Christians insulted

ACT 18:6; 1PE 4:14 See also ACT 2:13, ACT 17:32, ACT 19:8–19:9; 1PE 4:4

The pain of insult

PSA 55:12–55:14 See also PSA 22:6–22:8; JOB 19:1–19:3, JOB 20:2–20:3; PSA 44:16, PSA 55:3, PSA 89:50–89:51, PSA 109:21–109:25; LAM 3:55–3:63; 1TH 2:2; REV 2:9

Dealing with insults**Avoiding insults**

PRO 9:7, PRO 22:10

Not repaying insults

PRO 12:16 See also MAT 5:39 parallel LUK 6:27–6:29; 1PE 3:9

Rejoicing in reproach for Jesus Christ's sake

MAT 5:11–5:12 parallel LUK 6:22–6:23 See also ACT 5:41; 2CO 12:10; HEB 10:32–10:34; 1PE 4:13–4:14

Insult supposed but not intended

LUK 11:45; ; ACT 23:1–23:5

5894: intelligence

The natural ability to acquire knowledge and to learn skills. It is not emphasised in Scripture because wisdom is viewed primarily in spiritual and moral terms. Human cleverness proves ultimately futile; nevertheless, believers are called to develop and use their minds to the full in God's service and to dedicate gifts and abilities to him.

Wisdom is primarily spiritual and moral**PRO 9:10** See also JOB 28:28; PSA 111:10; JAS 3:13**The spiritual and moral inadequacy of unaided human intelligence****Unaided human intelligence proves futile**

PSA 94:11 See also ECC 9:11, ECC 12:12; DAN 12:4; ACT 17:21; 1CO 3:20

Human intelligence does not bring knowledge of God

1CO 1:20–1:21 See also JHN 5:39–5:40; ROM 1:22–1:23; COL 2:8

Human intelligence cannot promote godliness**COL 2:23** See also 1CO 8:1–8:2; JAS 3:14–3:16**Reliance on human intelligence brings judgment****ISA 29:14** See also JOB 5:13; ISA 44:25; 1CO 1:19**Many of the first Christians were not intelligent****1CO 1:26–1:31** See also ACT 4:13**Believers are to use their minds****The mind to be used in serving God****MRK 12:30** parallels MAT 22:37, LUK 10:27 See also 1CO 7:37 The mind is to be used in seeking to discern God's will; 1CO 14:15–14:18 The mind is to be used in worship.**God wants to renew the mind****ROM 12:2** See also EPH 4:23; HEB 10:16; JER 31:33**The mind must be correctly focused**

ROM 8:5–8:6; ; PHP 4:6–4:7; ; COL 3:2

Examples of intelligent people

1SA 25:3 Abigail; ; 2CH 2:12 Solomon; ; DAN 1:4 young men from Israel exiled in Babylon; ; DAN 1:17 Daniel, Shadrach, Meshach and Abednego; ; ACT 5:34 Gamaliel; ; ACT 7:22 Moses; ; ACT 13:6–13:7 Sergius Paulus; ; ACT 26:24 Paul

Examples of believers using their minds**ECC 8:9** See also EZR 7:10 Ezra; ECC 7:25 the Teacher; DAN 10:12 Daniel; ACT 17:11 the Bereans; 2TI 2:15 Paul's expectation for Timothy**God uses intelligence dedicated to him**

GEN 41:46–41:49 God uses Joseph's administrative skill; ; EXO 31:2–31:6 parallel EXO 35:30–35:35 Craftsmen use artistic expertise; ; 1KI 7:13–7:14 parallel 2CH 2:13–2:14 Hiram does work in bronze for Solomon's temple; ; 2CH 26:15 Skilful men design machines for the defence of Jerusalem; ; DAN 5:13–5:14 Daniel's intelligence aids his witness in the Babylonian court; ; LUK 1:3–1:4 Luke's thorough research owes something to his medical training.

5895: intimacy

Close relationships are part of God's will for human life. Scripture speaks of intimate relationships between Jesus Christ and the Father, between God and his people, and between various individuals.

Jesus Christ's intimate relationship with his Father**MAT 11:27** See also MAT 3:17 parallels MRK 1:11, LUK 3:22; JHN 5:20, JHN 10:30, JHN 10:38, JHN 14:10–14:11, JHN 17:21**God's intimate relationship with his people****JHN 17:3** "know" speaks of close personal relationship rather than theoretical or academic knowledge. See also 2CH 7:15–7:16; PSA 148:14; HOS 6:6; JHN 14:21, JHN 15:4, JHN 15:15**Images of God's desire for intimacy with his people****God as a father****JER 31:9** See also PSA 103:13; JER 31:20; HOS 11:1–11:4; ROM 8:15; 1JN 3:1**God as a husband****ISA 62:5** See also ISA 54:4–54:8; JER 3:14; HOS 2:19; EPH 5:25–5:27; REV 19:7, REV 21:2**Intimate relationships between men and women****As God's good purpose****GEN 2:18** See also GEN 1:27–1:28, GEN 2:24; MAT 19:5 parallel MRK 10:7; 1CO 6:16; EPH 5:28, EPH 5:31; 1TI 4:3–4:4**Examples of such close relationships**

Jacob and Rachel: GEN 29:20, GEN 29:30; RUT 4:13 Boaz and Ruth; 1SA 1:5, 1SA 1:8; EST 2:17 Xerxes and Esther; ; SNG 1:15–1:16 Solomon and his beloved

Intimacy in other relationships**Close friendships commended****PRO 18:24** See also PRO 17:17, PRO 27:10; ECC 4:9–4:12; JHN 15:13**Examples of close friendships**

David and Jonathan: 1SA 18:1, 1SA 18:3; 2KI 2:2, 2KI 2:4; 2TI 1:16 Paul and Onesiphorus

Examples of intimate family relationships

GEN 37:3 Jacob and his son Joseph; ; RUT 1:16 Ruth and her mother-in-law Naomi; ; 2SA 18:33 David and his son Absalom

5896: irreverence

A complete absence of the proper sense of awe, respect and wonder that is inspired and demanded by the character and activity of the living God. Irreverence involves disrespect for the character, deeds, words, law and ministers of God. As such, it brings judgment upon those who behave in this way.

Irreverence as the root of sin**ROM 3:10, ROM 3:18** See also PSA 36:1, PSA 10:4–10:5, PSA 55:19; ROM 1:21**Rebellion leads to irreverence****JER 5:23–5:24** See also ISA 29:13; MAT 15:3–15:9

Causes of irreverence

Arrogance

PSA 10:4–10:5 See also DEU 17:19–17:20

Self-deception

PSA 36:1–36:2

Prosperity

PRO 30:9 See also PSA 10:4–10:5

Kinds of irreverence

Insulting God

PSA 69:9 See also PSA 74:22–74:23; HEB 10:29

Misusing God's name

EXO 20:7 See also LEV 19:12, LEV 24:10–24:16

Insulting God's representatives

1KI 21:10–21:13 See also DEU 17:12; ACT 6:11

Ignoring God's law

NUM 15:30 See also ISA 63:17; JER 44:10; AMO 2:7; 1TH 5:20

Worshipping idols

EZK 20:39 See also LEV 18:21, LEV 20:1–20:3

Sacrificial worship

LEV 22:2 See also LEV 21:6; 1SA 2:17; MAL 1:6–1:8

Towards holy objects and places

2SA 6:6–6:7 See also PSA 74:7–74:8, PSA 79:1; JER 7:30

Attacking God's people

PSA 22:7–22:8 See also 2KI 19:9–19:12, 2KI 19:16; PSA 31:18, PSA 35:15–35:16, PSA 74:10, PSA 74:18, PSA 89:50–89:51; EZK 35:12; DAN 7:8, DAN 7:21–7:22; ZEP 2:10–2:11; EZK 36:20–36:23; ROM 2:24

Blasphemy against the Holy Spirit

MAT 12:31–12:32 parallels MRK 3:29, LUK 12:10 Jesus Christ's opponents were beyond hope, so long as they continued to say that the work of the Holy Spirit was the work of Satan (Mt 12:24) See also 1CO 12:3; JHN 10:33; MAT 26:63–26:65 parallel MRK 14:63–14:64

Social consequences of irreverence

In family relationships

MAT 15:4 See also EXO 21:17 parallel LEV 20:9; PRO 20:20, PRO 30:11

Oppression and cruelty

PSA 10:9–10:11 See also PSA 73:2–73:11, PSA 94:4–94:7; PRO 8:13

Social irresponsibility

PRO 17:5 See also PRO 14:31; JER 34:16; EZK 22:11–22:12; LUK 18:2; ROM 1:28–1:32; 1CO 11:20–11:22

Irreverence brings condemnation and judgment

DEU 17:12–17:13; PSA 55:19 See also NUM 14:23; 2CH 26:5, 2CH 26:16, 2CH 36:15–36:16; PRO 1:29–1:31, PRO 3:34, PRO 28:14; HOS 10:3, HOS 12:14; HEB 10:29; JUD 1:15

Particular warnings about the consequences of irreverence

1SA 12:14–12:15 See also DEU 28:58–28:59; MAL 2:1–2:2

5897: judging others

God's people are to exercise fairness and impartiality when called upon to exercise judgment in legal or church matters. However, the temptation to pass judgment upon the life or testimony of other individuals is clearly warned against.

Judging others in a legal situation

Fairness and impartiality are required by God

DEU 16:18–16:20 See also EXO 23:6–23:7; LEV 19:15; DEU 1:16–1:17; PRO 24:23; EZK 18:5–18:8

Judges are appointed by God

1KI 3:28 See also EXO 18:13–18:16; 1SA 7:15, 1SA 12:1–12:4

Jesus Christ refuses to judge others

JHN 8:3–8:11 See also LUK 12:13–12:14; JHN 7:24, JHN 8:15–8:16

Judging others in the church

Judgmental attitudes condemned

MAT 7:1–7:5 parallel LUK 6:37–6:42 See also ROM 2:1–2:3, ROM 14:1–14:13; COL 2:16; JAS 2:1–2:4, JAS 4:11–4:12

A discerning attitude commended

1CO 5:12–5:13 See also 1CO 5:1–5:5, 1CO 6:1–6:6

Evaluation of ministries commended

MAT 7:15–7:20 See also 2CO 11:10–11:15; PHP 3:2

5898: kissing

Kissing within the family

GEN 29:13 See also GEN 27:26–27:27, GEN 33:4, GEN 48:10

Kissing as an expression of love

SNG 1:2 See also GEN 29:11; SNG 8:1; 1PE 5:14

Kissing as a sign of reconciliation

LUK 15:20 See also GEN 45:15; 2SA 14:33

Kissing as a sign of homage

1SA 10:1 See also 1KI 19:18; JOB 31:27; PSA 2:12; HOS 13:2; LUK 7:38, LUK 7:45

Greeting with a kiss

EXO 18:7 See also EXO 4:27; ROM 16:16; 1CO 16:20; 2CO 13:12; 1TH 5:26; 1PE 5:14

Kissing good-bye

RUT 1:14 See also GEN 31:28, GEN 31:55, GEN 50:1; RUT 1:9; 1SA 20:41; 1KI 19:20; ACT 20:37

Blessing with a kiss

2SA 19:39

Kissing linked with treachery

2SA 20:9–20:10 See also PRO 7:13, PRO 7:21, PRO 27:6; MAT 26:48–26:49 parallels MRK 14:44–14:45, LUK 22:47–22:48

5899: lament

A song of mourning or sorrow. Laments may be occasioned by bereavement, personal trouble, national disaster or the judgment of God.

Lamentation occasioned by bereavement

2SA 3:33–3:34 See also GEN 50:10; JER 31:15; MAT 2:16–2:18, MAT 9:23 parallels MRK 5:38, LUK 8:52; LUK 23:27; JHN 11:31–11:33

Lamentation occasioned by personal trouble

PSA 56:2, PSA 56:8, PSA 102:1–102:2

Lamentation occasioned by national disaster

2CH 35:25 See also 2SA 1:17–1:27; EST 4:1, EST 9:31; JER 8:21–9:1

Lamentation occasioned by the judgment of God on Israel

AMO 5:1–5:2 The call to lament is sometimes meant as a warning of impending judgment; **LAM 1:1** The book of Lamentations is a series of laments after the fall of Jerusalem. See also ISA 3:24–3:26, ISA 29:1–29:2; JER 4:7–4:8, JER 7:29, JER 9:10, JER 9:17–9:21; LAM 2:5; EZK 2:9–2:10, EZK 19:1–19:14

Lamentation occasioned by the judgment of God on other nations

ISA 16:9–16:11 See also ISA 15:5, ISA 15:8, ISA 16:7, ISA 19:8; JER 48:36; EZK 26:17–26:18, EZK 27:2–27:36, EZK 28:12–28:19, EZK 30:2–30:4, EZK 32:2–32:16

Lamentation as a sign of repentance

LAM 1:5, LAM 1:8, LAM 3:39–3:40; ; EZK 9:3–9:6

5900: laughter

The act or sound of laughing, often associated with joy and delight, yet occasionally linked with ridicule and scorn.

People laughing**Out of pleasure**

GEN 21:6 See also PRO 31:25; ECC 3:4, ECC 10:19

In scorn and derision

MAT 9:24 parallels MRK 5:40, LUK 8:53 See also JOB 39:18, JOB 41:29; PSA 52:6; LAM 1:7; HAB 1:10

God laughing

PSA 2:4 See also PSA 37:13, PSA 59:8; PRO 1:26

God helping people to laugh

PSA 126:2; LUK 6:21 See also JOB 5:22, JOB 8:21; JER 51:39 as a prelude to judgment

Laughter qualified

PRO 14:13 See also ECC 2:2, ECC 7:3

Laughter rebuked

LUK 6:25 See also ECC 7:6; JAS 4:9

5901: loneliness

God intends human beings to live together in harmony and to value one another, but Scripture recognises many reasons for individuals to feel unwanted and isolated.

Loneliness is not part of God's plan for human beings

GEN 2:18 See also PSA 68:5–68:6; ISA 49:15

God is with his people at all times and in all circumstances

ISA 41:10 See also DEU 31:8; JOS 1:9; PSA 27:10; ISA 43:2; MAT 28:20; JHN 14:18; HEB 13:5–13:6

Reasons why people may experience loneliness**Sin**

ISA 59:2 See also GEN 4:10–4:12; 1SA 28:5–28:6; PSA 81:11–81:12; ISA 64:7; HOS 5:6; EPH 4:18

Remorse

MAT 27:4–27:5 See also 1CH 21:17; MAT 26:75

Lack of friends

PSA 142:4 See also JHN 5:7, JHN 14:18

Social ostracism

JHN 4:9 A moral outcast (see Jn 4:18), she was collecting water at the hottest part of the day, when she could do so alone. See also LUK 19:7 A Jew who worked

for the Roman occupying power was considered a traitor.

Public shame

JHN 8:3 See also MRK 15:29–15:32

Desertion

2TI 4:16 See also PSA 38:11, PSA 88:18

Loss of family

LUK 7:12 See also RUT 1:3–1:5; 2SA 18:33; 2KI 4:1; JOB 1:20–1:21; PSA 27:10; MAT 2:17–2:18; JER 31:15; 1TI 5:5

Loss of identity

LUK 8:27 parallel MRK 5:2–5:3 See also LUK 8:30 parallel MRK 5:9

Discontent

ECC 4:8 See also ECC 2:10–2:11, ECC 2:18; HEB 13:5–13:6

Disability

ACT 3:2 See also LEV 21:17–21:18; MAT 9:32, MAT 12:22

Disease

LUK 17:12 Lepers were forbidden to mix with those not affected. See also LEV 13:4; NUM 5:1–5:3; 2KI 7:3; 2CH 26:21

Insomnia

PSA 102:7 See also JOB 7:4; DAN 6:18

Depression

1KI 19:4 See also DEU 33:27; JOB 7:16; PSA 43:5, PSA 73:16–73:17; JER 15:10; MIC 7:1

Poverty

PRO 19:7 See also 1KI 17:12; PRO 19:4; LUK 15:14–15:16

Old age

PSA 71:9 See also 2SA 19:34–19:35

Dying and the approach of death

PSA 23:4 See also PSA 18:4–18:6; ROM 8:38–8:39

Loneliness experienced as a consequence of God's calling

God's setting apart for service

1KI 19:10 See also JDG 6:14–6:15; JER 1:5, JER 4:18–4:19, JER 15:16–15:17

Leadership

MRK 10:32 See also EXO 24:1–24:2; JOS 1:6–1:7; MAT 20:17–20:19

Responsibility

NUM 11:14 See also EXO 18:17–18:18; 2CO 11:28

Jesus Christ experienced loneliness

MAT 27:46 parallel MRK 15:33–15:34 See also PSA 22:1–22:2; MAT 4:1–4:2 parallel LUK 4:1–4:2; MAT 14:23; LUK 4:28–4:30; JHN 6:67, JHN 16:32

Positive aspects of loneliness

Solitude provides an opportunity for communion with God

MAT 6:6 See also EXO 3:1–3:2, EXO 33:9; 2KI 4:32–4:33; MAT 26:39; MRK 1:35, MRK 6:45–6:46; REV 1:9

Engaging in spiritual warfare

GEN 32:24

The opportunity for spiritual experiences away from the crowd

MRK 9:2 See also DAN 10:8; 2CO 12:2–12:4

Solitude as rest from the turmoil of everyday life

MRK 6:31–6:32 See also MAT 11:28

5902: maturity

The full development at the end of a process of growth, by means of which a human being reaches adulthood.

5903: maturity, physical

In the OT, reaching adulthood brought with it certain privileges and responsibilities.

Growth to physical and psychological maturity

LUK 2:52 Jesus Christ's normal childhood is evidence of his full humanity. See also 1SA 2:26; LUK 1:80, LUK 2:40; 1CO 13:11

The responsibilities of maturity in the Israelite community

The payment of atonement money

EXO 30:11–30:16, EXO 38:25–38:26

Eligibility for military service

NUM 1:2–1:3, NUM 1:45, NUM 26:2; ; 2CH 25:5

Accountability for actions

NUM 14:29, NUM 32:11

Inheritance of the land

NUM 26:52–26:54

Serving Levites

NUM 8:24–8:25; ; 1CH 23:24, 1CH 23:27; ; EZR 3:8

Maturity should produce wisdom

JOB 12:12 See also JOB 15:10, JOB 32:6–32:9; PRO 7:7; ECC 4:13

Respect should be shown to the mature

LEV 19:32 See also JOB 32:4; PRO 23:22; 1TI 5:1–5:2; 1PE 5:5

Maturity of years seen as God's blessing

GEN 24:1; ; RUT 4:15; ; 1CH 29:28

The maturity of crops for harvest used as a metaphor

JOL 3:13; JHN 4:35–4:36 See also AMO 8:1–8:2; MAT 9:37–9:38 parallel LUK 10:1–10:2; MRK 4:26–4:29; REV 14:15

5904: maturity, spiritual

The development of Christlike character and behaviour in the Christian through a renewed mind and tested faith.

Christlikeness as the goal and model for spiritual maturity

EPH 4:13–4:15 See also COL 2:6–2:7; HEB 12:2

Marks of spiritual maturity

Spiritual understanding

COL 2:2 See also ROM 15:14; 1CO 2:6, 1CO 14:20; EPH 1:17–1:18; HEB 5:12–6:1

Discernment of God's will and changed behaviour

COL 1:9–1:10 See also ROM 12:2; 1CO 3:1–3:3; GAL 5:22–5:23; EPH 4:22–4:23; PHP 1:9–1:11; 2TH 1:3

Stability

COL 4:12 See also EPH 4:14; 2PE 3:17–3:18

Care for the weaker brother

ROM 15:1 See also GAL 6:1–6:2

Maturity is to be the aim of the Christian

PHP 3:13–3:15 See also LUK 8:14 a reason for spiritual immaturity; 2CO 7:1, 2CO 13:11; 1TI 6:11

The process of maturity

God causes spiritual growth

PHP 1:6 See also GAL 3:3; HEB 10:14

Possessing gifts of ministry

EPH 4:11–4:13 See also ROM 1:11

Being equipped by the word of God

2TI 3:16–3:17 See also ROM 15:4; 1PE 2:2; 1JN 2:5

Persevering through trials

ROM 5:3–5:5 See also HEB 2:10; JAS 1:3–1:4; 1PE 5:10

The concern of the pastor is to help others to maturity

COL 1:28–1:29 See also 2CO 13:9–13:10; GAL 4:19

5907: miserliness

A reluctance to part with money, often associated with the hoarding of money or possessions. While Scripture censures the squandering of resources, it also regards

the hoarding of money or possessions as potentially idolatrous.

Miserliness as a form of idolatry

PRO 18:11; MAT 6:24 See also DEU 15:9; PRO 11:26; HOS 12:8; MAT 6:19–6:21; EPH 5:3–5:5; COL 3:5; 1TI 6:17

The foolishness of miserliness

ECC 2:26; 1TI 6:7 See also PSA 39:6, PSA 39:11, PSA 49:10; PRO 22:16, PRO 23:6, PRO 28:8, PRO 28:22; ECC 4:7–4:8, ECC 5:10–5:11, ECC 5:15; LUK 12:15–12:21

Miserliness leads to misery

PRO 11:24; 1TI 6:9–6:10 See also PRO 11:16; ECC 5:12–5:14; JAS 5:1–5:6

Some examples of miserliness

1SA 25:3; ; AMO 3:10; ; LUK 16:19–16:31; ; ACT 5:1–5:2

5908: motives

The underlying reasons for a course of action. Scripture stresses the importance of doing things with the intention of honouring and glorifying God and building up his people.

5909: motives, importance of

God acts from the highest, purest motives and expects his people to do the same.

God's supreme motive is the honour of his name

PSA 106:8 See also EXO 9:16; PSA 23:3; ISA 43:7; EZK 36:20–36:23; EPH 1:11–1:14

God's glory is to be the highest motive of his people

1CO 10:31 See also NUM 25:7–25:13; ISA 26:8; COL 3:17; 1PE 4:11

Purity of motive is essential for acceptable worship

MAT 6:1–6:18 See also PSA 51:6, PSA 51:10, PSA 86:11; MAT 5:8

Wrong motives hinder effective prayer

JAS 4:3 See also PSA 66:18; 1JN 3:21–3:22

Motives for good moral behaviour

Wanting to please God

COL 3:22–3:25 See also EPH 6:5–6:8

Compassion for others

DEU 24:17–24:22 The experience of slavery and the exodus were to promote compassion for the poor and the alien. See also EXO 22:21–22:27; LEV 25:35–25:42, LEV 25:54–25:55

Fear of punishment for sin**HEB 13:4** See also COL 3:5–3:6; 1TH 4:3–4:6**God judges the motives of the heart****PRO 16:2** See also 1CH 28:9; PRO 20:27**5910: motives, examples of**

Scripture reflects the wide range of motives which influence human behaviour.

Right actions can result from wrong motives**PHP 1:15–1:18** See also 1SA 18:20–18:23**Right motives do not always produce right actions****1KI 8:17–8:19** parallel 2CH 6:7–6:9 See also MAT 1:18–1:20**Examples of wrong motives****Malice and envy****GEN 37:11** See also GEN 37:18–37:28; EST 3:1–3:9; EZK 25:15–25:16, EZK 36:5; MAT 2:7–2:13**Greed****JHN 12:4–12:6** See also 2KI 5:19–5:27; TIT 1:10–1:11**Motives are sometimes misjudged****JOS 22:9–22:34** See also NUM 32:1–32:33; 2SA 10:1–10:4 parallel 1CH 19:1–19:4; 2KI 5:5–5:7**Jesus Christ's actions motivated by a desire to do God's will****JHN 8:29** See also JHN 4:34, JHN 6:38; HEB 10:5–10:7; PSA 40:6–40:8**Paul's motives****Paul rejected all base motives in ministry****1TH 2:3–2:6** See also 2CO 2:17**Paul was motivated by his knowledge of God****2CO 5:9–5:12****Paul was concerned for the spiritual growth of others****PHP 4:14–4:18** Paul's motive in rejoicing in the gift from the Philippians was the spiritual benefit which they would gain as a result of it. See also PHP 1:22–1:26; PHM 1:8–1:14**5913: negotiation****Negotiation between peoples****GEN 21:23; LUK 14:31–14:32** See also JOS 9:6, JOS 10:4; 1SA 11:2; 2SA 3:12–3:13; 1KI 15:19; 2KI 18:23 parallel ISA 36:8**Negotiation in the buying of land****GEN 23:8–23:9** See also RUT 4:4; 2SA 24:24; JER 32:8**Negotiation in the setting of wages****GEN 29:15** See also GEN 29:27, GEN 30:32; JDG 17:10–17:11; 1KI 5:6; MAT 20:2, MAT 26:14–26:15 parallels MRK 14:10, LUK 22:4**Negotiation for personal safety****JOS 2:12–2:13** See also JDG 15:12–15:13; 1SA 20:8, 1SA 30:15**5914: optimism**

The ability to face the future with confidence. For believers this is possible because of their knowledge of God.

Optimism resulting from faith**Confidence in God****PSA 52:8, PSA 125:1** See also PSA 25:4–25:5, PSA 56:4, PSA 71:5, PSA 91:2; NAM 1:7**Confidence in what God can do****2CO 1:10–1:11** See also PSA 27:1–27:3; JER 17:7; MIC 7:7; HEB 13:6; 1JN 5:14**Confidence in what God will do in the future****2CO 5:5–5:8** See also ACT 24:14–24:15; GAL 5:5; PHP 1:3–1:6**Confidence founded on God's grace****ISA 12:1–12:2** See also EZR 10:2; 2CO 3:4–3:5; EPH 3:12; 2TH 2:16–2:17; 1JN 3:21–3:22**Encouragements to be optimistic****JHN 14:1; ROM 15:13** See also PSA 9:10, PSA 37:3–37:5, PSA 42:5, PSA 115:9–115:11; JHN 14:27, JHN 16:33; ROM 12:12; 1TI 6:17; HEB 4:15, HEB 10:19–10:23; 1PE 1:13; 1JN 2:28**Examples of optimism****In the OT**

2CH 32:8; ; PRO 12:25, PRO 31:11

The apostle Peter

1PE 5:10

The apostle Paul**2CO 7:4** See also 1CO 1:8–1:9, 1CO 4:17; 2CO 1:7, 2CO 2:3, 2CO 8:22; PHP 2:22; COL 4:9, COL 4:12–4:13; 2TI 1:12; PHM 1:21**The apostle John**

3JN 1:3–1:5

Misplaced optimism

Trusting in anyone or anything other than God

PSA 146:3 See also JDG 9:26; 1SA 15:32; JOB 6:20, JOB 8:12–8:13; PRO 11:7; JER 7:4, JER 9:4, JER 12:6, JER 49:4, JER 49:31; EZK 29:16; MIC 7:5; 2CO 9:4

Presumption

EZK 13:6 See also ISA 58:4; JER 7:9–7:10; LUK 18:9

5915: ornaments

The use of jewellery and other adornments is not forbidden in Scripture, but excessive use can indicate worldliness. Inner spiritual adornment is of greater value.

Possession and use of various ornaments show wealth

Ornaments used to beautify

SNG 1:10–1:11 See also GEN 37:3, GEN 37:23, GEN 37:32; 2SA 1:24; JER 2:32

Rings, ear-rings and nose rings

GEN 35:4; ; EXO 32:2–32:3; ; JDG 8:24; ; EST 8:8; ; PRO 25:12; ; ISA 3:19, ISA 3:21; ; EZK 16:12; ; LUK 15:22; ; JAS 2:2

Bracelets and gold chains

GEN 24:22, GEN 41:42; ; PRO 1:9; ; EZK 16:11; ; DAN 5:29

Bells

EXO 28:33–28:35

Ornaments plundered from Egypt

EXO 3:22

The misuse of ornaments for pride and seduction

ISA 3:16 See also EZK 23:40, EZK 23:42; HOS 2:13

Ornaments as gifts

GEN 24:53 See also GEN 24:22; JOB 42:11

Adornment as a picture of God's love

EZK 16:11–16:13 See also ISA 61:10; LUK 15:22

Ornaments as symbols of authority

GEN 41:42 See also 2SA 1:10; EST 3:10; DAN 5:29

Ornaments discarded

In mourning

EXO 33:4–33:6 See also EZK 26:16

To make idols

EXO 32:2–32:4 See also JDG 8:24–8:27

As offerings to God

EXO 35:22 See also NUM 31:50

Inner, not outer, adornment encouraged

1PE 3:3–3:4

5916: pessimism

A negative and hopeless attitude, resulting either from viewing the world as being without God or from loss of faith in God.

The world may appear to be meaningless

ECC 1:14 See also ECC 1:1–1:11

Wisdom may be pointless

ECC 1:17–1:18 See also ECC 2:12–2:16

Pleasures may be empty

ECC 2:1

Work may be in vain

ECC 2:17 See also ECC 2:18–2:23, ECC 4:4

The world may seem corrupt and oppressive

ECC 4:1 See also ECC 4:2–4:3, ECC 5:8–5:9

Loneliness can be depressing

ECC 4:8

Wealth is no answer

ECC 5:10 See also ECC 5:11–5:15, ECC 6:1–6:6; LUK 12:18–12:20

Life is short and often miserable

ECC 6:12 In the OT, before the resurrection hope was fully developed, this life seemed to be all that there was. See also 1CH 29:15; JOB 7:6, JOB 14:7–14:12, JOB 14:18–14:22, JOB 17:13–17:16

Suffering may lead to pessimism

JOB 6:11 See also JOB 30:26; LAM 3:16–3:18; EZK 37:11

Suffering may cause a sense of God's rejection

JOB 14:18–14:19 See also JOB 19:5–19:13

The godless have no grounds for optimism

EPH 2:12 See also JOB 8:13–8:15; PRO 10:24, PRO 11:7, PRO 24:19–24:20; ISA 19:3; JER 4:9; MAT 7:26–7:27; 1TH 4:13

Examples of pessimism

The Israelites on hearing about the strength of the Canaanites

NUM 13:31–13:33; ; DEU 1:28

Israel's enemies

DEU 2:25; ; JOS 2:9

Naomi on her return to Israel

RUT 1:21

The Israelites threatened by the Philistines

ISA 17:11, ISA 13:6–13:7

Elijah at Mount Horeb

1KI 19:9–19:10

The men with leprosy at the gate of Samaria

2KI 7:4

Judah facing the threat from Aram and Israel

ISA 7:2

The Philistine cities on seeing Tyre's destruction

ZEC 9:5

Thomas after the resurrection

JHN 20:24–20:25

Paul's shipboard companions during the storm

ACT 27:20

The antidote to pessimism is faith in God**PSA 42:5; 2CO 4:13–4:16** See also ISA 41:10; LAM 3:21–3:24; 2CO 4:7–4:9**5917: plans**

Designs or schemes, prepared in advance of doing something. Scripture indicates the sovereign plans of God and the varied plans of men and women.

God's plans**For judgment****JER 18:11** See also NUM 33:55–33:56; 2KI 19:25–19:26; JOB 23:14–23:16; ISA 25:1–25:2, ISA 37:26–37:27; JER 26:3; LAM 2:17; MIC 2:3ISA 14:24–14:27, ISA 19:12, ISA 19:17, ISA 23:8–23:9; JER 49:20, JER 50:45; MIC 4:11–4:13**For salvation****EPH 1:11** See also PSA 40:5; HEB 11:40**For the tabernacle and the temple****EXO 26:30–26:37** See also 1CH 28:11–28:12, 1CH 28:18–28:19; EZK 43:10–43:11**God's plans are revealed to his people****AMO 3:7** See also EXO 26:30; JER 49:20–49:21**God's plans are always fulfilled****JOB 42:2** See also PSA 33:11; ISA 5:18–5:19, ISA 14:24–14:27, ISA 46:11**God may sometimes reverse his plans****JER 36:3** See also JER 18:5–18:10, JER 26:3; JON 3:10**Plans of the wicked****PSA 64:5–64:6** See also 2SA 17:1–17:4; 2KI 16:10–16:11; PSA 140:2; PRO 14:22, PRO 30:32; ISA 30:1; JER 18:12; MIC 2:1; MAT 28:12–28:13**Plans of the righteous****PRO 12:5** See also 1CH 28:2; PSA 14:6; PRO 14:22, PRO 21:5; ISA 32:8; ROM 1:13, ROM 15:24; 2CO 1:15–1:17**Plans and the role of counsellors****PRO 15:22** See also EZR 4:4–4:5; PRO 20:18**Malicious plans****Against other people****ISA 18:25** See also ISA 23:10; EST 8:3; PSA 140:4; JER 49:30**Against God's servants****JER 18:18** See also MAT 22:15; JHN 12:10–12:11; ACT 9:23–9:24, ACT 27:42–27:43**Human plans are subject to God's will****JAS 4:13–4:15; PSA 33:10** See also PSA 20:4, PSA 140:8, PSA 146:4; PRO 16:1–16:3, PRO 16:9, PRO 19:21, PRO 21:30; ECC 9:10; ISA 8:10, ISA 19:3; JER 19:7**5918: pleasure**

A gratifying emotion, used in Scripture to refer to both human and divine emotions. Believers are invited to take pleasure in every aspect of God's creation, while not allowing pleasure in the creation to overshadow pleasure in the Creator himself.

Divine pleasure**That which gives God pleasure****PSA 147:11; JER 9:24** See also PSA 37:23, PSA 149:4; PRO 11:20, PRO 12:22; MAT 11:25–11:26 parallel LUK 10:21; MAT 12:18; ISA 42:1; EPH 1:5, EPH 1:9**That which does not give God pleasure****PSA 5:4; EZK 18:23** See also PSA 51:16, PSA 147:10; ISA 1:11; EZK 18:32, EZK 33:11**Human pleasure****God provides everything for the enjoyment of life****ECC 8:15; 1TI 6:17****Pleasure in human physical relationships****SNG 4:10** See also SNG 1:2, SNG 2:3, SNG 7:6**Such pleasures are not satisfying in themselves****ECC 2:10–2:11** See also ECC 2:1–2:2, ECC 2:24–2:25

True pleasure is found in the things of God

PSA 16:11, PSA 37:4; ROM 7:22 See also PSA 1:2, PSA 35:9, PSA 43:4, PSA 111:2, PSA 112:1, PSA 119:16; PRO 10:23, PRO 16:13, PRO 18:2; ISA 55:2; JER 6:10, JER 15:16

Pleasures may also be misleading or positively sinful

LUK 8:14; TIT 3:3 See also PRO 1:22, PRO 2:14; ECC 7:4; ISA 66:3; 2TH 2:12; 1TI 5:6; 2TI 3:4; HEB 11:25; JAS 4:3; 2PE 2:13–2:14

5919: popularity

The state of being liked and admired. Scripture notes how the faithful preaching of the gospel will lead to hostility and unpopularity, not least on account of its demands on people and its proclamation of judgment.

The popularity of Jesus Christ during his early ministry

Crowds gathered round him

MRK 2:2 See also MRK 3:10, MRK 5:24; LUK 5:1, LUK 8:19, LUK 8:45

Many people followed him

MAT 4:25, MAT 13:2, MAT 15:30; ; MRK 1:33, MRK 2:13; ; LUK 12:1

The popularity of David

1SA 18:7, 1SA 21:11, 1SA 29:5; ; 2SA 3:36

Popularity can result from seeking approval from human beings, rather than from God

JHN 12:43 See also LUK 6:26; COL 3:22

Actions carried out to gain popularity

2SA 15:1–15:6 Absalom's attempt to curry favour; ; ACT 12:1–12:3 Herod's arrest of Christians; ; ACT 24:27 Felix' imprisonment of Paul; ; ACT 25:9 Festus' prosecution of Paul

Causes of unpopularity for the gospel

Its appeal to those whom the world regards as weak and foolish

1CO 1:26–1:29, 1CO 2:6–2:7

Its insistence that people are sinful

ROM 7:7; ; 1TI 5:20; ; 1JN 1:8

Its challenge to vested interests

JHN 11:45–11:48 the Pharisees' privileged position; ; ACT 19:23–19:40 the silversmith's trade; ; ACT 5:17–5:41, ACT 21:27–21:36

The high demands that the gospel makes of people

MRK 10:17–10:23

The difficulty of some of Jesus Christ's sayings

JHN 6:60–6:66

5920: pretence

The deception of others by individuals, usually for the sake of their own interest, safety or pride. Scripture condemns such pretence and demands honesty from believers at every point.

Pretence practised by people for their own interests

The wearing of a disguise

1KI 14:1–14:6 See also GEN 27:5–27:19, GEN 27:35–27:36, GEN 29:16–29:25, GEN 38:13–38:16; 2SA 14:1–14:3

Other pretences

GEN 42:7 See also GEN 34:13–34:15, GEN 34:25; 2SA 13:1–13:11; 2KI 10:18–10:19; PRO 13:7; JER 9:6–9:9; MAT 22:15–22:22 parallels MRK 12:13–12:17, LUK 20:20–20:26

Pretence practised by people for their own safety

The wearing of a disguise

JOS 9:3–9:22 See also 1SA 28:7–28:12; 1KI 22:29–22:32 parallel 2CH 18:28–18:32

Other pretences

1SA 21:10–21:13 See also 1SA 19:11–19:17; PSA 34:0; ACT 27:29–27:30

Examples of pretence

That practised by people because of their pride

PRO 12:9 See also 2CH 35:20–35:22; PRO 13:7; MAT 6:2, MAT 6:5, MAT 6:16, MAT 23:27–23:28, MAT 24:4–24:5 parallels MRK 13:5–13:6, LUK 21:8

That practised by people in their approach to God

JER 3:10 See also MAT 15:7–15:8 parallel MRK 7:6; ISA 29:13

That commanded by the LORD for his own purpose

1KI 20:37–20:43

God's people must rid themselves of pretence

1PE 2:1 See also PSA 119:29; LUK 12:1; 1PE 2:21–2:22; ISA 53:9

The gospel demolishes pretence

2CO 10:5

5921: privacy

Privacy to conduct conversations

JER 37:17 See also 1SA 18:22; 2SA 3:27; JER 40:15

Privacy to express emotions**GEN 43:30** See also MAT 14:9–14:13**Privacy to teach and to learn****MAT 17:19** parallel MRK 9:28 See also MAT 24:3 parallel MRK 13:3; LUK 10:23; GAL 2:2**Privacy to pray****LUK 9:18** See also MAT 6:5–6:6, MAT 14:22–14:23 parallel MRK 6:45–6:46; MAT 26:36 parallels MRK 14:32, LUK 22:39–22:42; LUK 6:12**5922: prudence**

Careful, wise discernment; the avoidance of rash behaviour or speech; the good management of talents and resources and the showing of tact and wisdom in relationships with other people.

The link between prudence and wisdom**PRO 8:12** See also PRO 1:1–1:6**Characteristics of prudence****Discernment****PRO 14:15** See also PRO 12:16, PRO 14:8; LUK 14:28–14:32**Foresight and caution****PRO 22:3** See also PRO 23:1–23:3; AMO 5:13**Wise use of knowledge****PRO 12:23** See also PRO 14:18; MAT 7:6**Wise speech****PRO 21:23** See also PSA 39:1; JAS 3:5–3:8**A teachable spirit****PRO 15:5****Prudence involves good management of talents and resources****Good management commended****PRO 6:6–6:11** See also GEN 41:33–41:40; PRO 24:27; MAT 25:14–25:30**Warnings against unwise financial dealings****PRO 22:26–22:27** See also PRO 6:1–6:5; MAT 5:25–5:26**Examples of prudent behaviour****In averting disaster****ISA 25:14–25:35** See also GEN 32:3–32:21**In avoiding persecution****ACT 14:5–14:7** See also MAT 12:14–12:16 parallel MRK 3:6–3:7 Jesus Christ ACT 9:23–9:25, ACT 9:29–9:30 ACT 12:17 Peter**Prudence in dealing with other people**

GEN 26:26–26:31 Abimelech makes a treaty with Isaac; ; GEN 32:3–32:21 Jacob prepares to meet Esau; ; NEH 2:1–2:6 Nehemiah petitions Artaxerxes; ; DAN 1:8–1:14 Daniel's diplomacy in avoiding Nebuchanezzar's food; ; DAN 2:10–2:16 Daniel's wisdom and tact in the face of death; ; MAT 22:15–22:22 Jesus Christ's wisdom on the question of paying taxes to Caesar; ; ACT 5:33–5:40 Gamaliel's speech to the Sanhedrin

5923: public opinion

The concepts and views held by the majority of the population. Scripture urges personal, independent thinking, based on God's word, rather than adherence to popular beliefs.

God's people should not be concerned about public opinion**EXO 23:2** See also JOB 31:33–31:34; ECC 7:21–7:22**Examples of the impact of public opinion**

1SA 14:45 Public opinion saved Jonathan's life; ; 1SA 15:24 Public opinion led to Saul losing his kingdom; ; MAT 27:15–27:26 Public opinion led to Jesus Christ being crucified; ; ACT 12:3 Public opinion led to Peter being imprisoned.

Public opinion is often contrary to divine standards**HAG 1:2–1:11** See also NUM 13:21–14:10; DEU 1:19–1:40; 1SA 8:4–8:9; 1KI 18:21; JER 2:31–2:35, JER 26:7–26:16**Public opinion is sometimes in accord with divine standards****DEU 5:28–5:29** See also JOS 24:19–24:24**Public opinion of Jesus Christ was divided****Concerning his identity****MAT 16:13–16:17** parallels MRK 8:27–8:29, LUK 9:18–9:20 See also JHN 7:40–7:43**Concerning his teaching and ministry**

LUK 12:51; ; JHN 7:12, JHN 7:43, JHN 9:16, JHN 10:19

5924: quarrelsomeness**The evil of quarrelling****JAS 4:1–4:2** See also EXO 21:18–21:19; PRO 10:12, PRO 13:10, PRO 15:18, PRO 20:3, PRO 21:9, PRO 22:10, PRO 26:20–26:21, PRO 27:15–27:16, PRO 30:33; 2TI 2:23**Quarrelsomeness is unfitting for God's people****1CO 3:3; 1TI 3:2–3:3** See also PRO 17:19; ISA 58:4; ROM 13:12–13:14; 2CO 12:20; 1TI 6:3–6:5; 2TI 2:14, 2TI 2:23–2:24

Examples of quarrelsomeness

1CO 1:10–1:12 See also GEN 13:7–13:8, GEN 26:20–26:22; EXO 17:1–17:7 NIV footnote at verse 7; NUM 20:1–20:13 NIV footnote at verse 13; DEU 33:8; PSA 95:8, PSA 106:32; MRK 9:33–9:34 parallel LUK 9:46; LUK 22:24; PHP 4:2–4:3

5925: rashness

Acting without careful consideration of the possible consequences or risks.

Examples of rashness

GEN 34:25–34:31 Jacob's sons; EXO 2:11–2:12; ; ACT 7:24–7:25; ; NUM 20:8–20:12; ; PSA 106:32; JOS 8:14–8:17 the king of Ai; ; JDG 11:30–11:31 Jephthah; ; 1SA 14:24 King Saul; ; 2SA 6:6 Uzzah; ; 2SA 12:18 fear for King David; ; 1KI 1:5 King Adonijah; ; 2KI 5:20–5:21 Gehazi; ; 2KI 10:16 Jehu; ; 2CH 26:16–26:20 King Uzziah; ; 2CH 35:21–35:22 King Josiah; ; HAB 1:6 the Babylonians; ; MAT 8:19–8:20 a would-be disciple; ; MAT 14:6–14:10 parallel MRK 6:26 King Herod; MAT 26:33–26:34; ; JHN 18:10; ACT 19:36 the Ephesian crowd; ; GAL 1:6 the Galatian Christians; ; 2TI 3:2–3:4 a characteristic of the last days

Warnings against rashness

PRO 14:16; ECC 5:2 See also PRO 6:16–6:18, PRO 12:18, PRO 13:3, PRO 19:2, PRO 20:3, PRO 20:25, PRO 21:5, PRO 25:8, PRO 29:20; ECC 7:9, ECC 8:3; ISA 52:12; ZEP 3:7; ACT 19:35–19:36; 1TI 5:22; 2TI 3:1–3:5

Antidotes to rashness

Trust in the guiding presence of the Lord
ISA 52:12

Appreciating the importance of considered actions
JAS 1:19 See also LUK 14:28–14:33

5926: rebuke

A verbal expression of blame. Scripture gives examples of both divine and human rebuke. Sometimes God issues rebukes directly but more commonly he did so through the OT prophets. In the NT Jesus Christ and the apostles issue rebukes and teach the church how to address those who sin.

God has an absolute right to rebuke those who depart from his ways

He sometimes exercises this right directly

LEV 26:23–26:24 See also DEU 28:20; NEH 9:30; JOB 5:17; PSA 39:11, PSA 50:21, PSA 94:12, PSA 105:14, PSA 119:21; JER 2:19, JER 2:30; HEB 8:8

His rebuke is powerful

JOB 26:11; ; PSA 80:16, PSA 104:7; ; ISA 50:2

In the OT much rebuke came indirectly

Balaam's ass rebukes Balaam: NUM 22:28; ; 2PE 2:16; 1SA 2:25 Eli rebukes his sons; ; 1SA 15:12–15:26 Samuel rebukes Saul; ; 1SA 24:5–24:7 David rebukes his men; ; 2SA 12:1–12:12 Nathan rebukes David; ; 1KI 18:18 Elijah rebukes Ahab; ; EZR 10:9–10:11 Ezra rebukes the men of Judah and Benjamin; ; ISA 1:10–1:17 Isaiah rebukes Judah and Jerusalem; ; HOS 4:1–4:3 Hosea rebukes the Israelites.

Examples of Jesus Christ issuing rebukes

To evil spirits

MAT 17:18 parallels MRK 9:25, LUK 9:42 See also LUK 4:41

To his disciples

MRK 8:33 parallel MAT 16:23; ; MRK 16:14

Other examples of rebuke being administered in the NT

Inappropriate rebukes by Jesus Christ's disciples: MAT 16:22 parallel MRK 8:32; ; MAT 19:13 parallels MRK 10:13, LUK 18:15; LUK 3:19 John the Baptist rebukes Herod; ; LUK 23:40–23:41 The repentant thief on the cross rebukes the other crucified criminal.

Proverbs on the subject of rebuke

The importance of responding correctly to a rebuke

PRO 1:23–1:26 See also PRO 6:23, PRO 10:17, PRO 12:1, PRO 15:10, PRO 15:31–15:32, PRO 17:10, PRO 19:25; ECC 7:5

Different responses to a rebuke

PRO 9:7–9:8

Instructions to believers on giving and receiving rebuke

On giving a rebuke

LEV 19:17 See also MAT 18:15; LUK 17:3; GAL 6:1; COL 1:28, COL 3:16; 1TI 5:1 advice on rebuking those who are older; 1TI 5:20 disciplining elders; 2TI 3:16 the usefulness of Scripture for rebuking; 2TI 4:2; TIT 1:9, TIT 1:13, TIT 2:15; JAS 5:19–5:20

On receiving a rebuke

HEB 12:5 See also 1CO 16:14

Believers thus follow the example of the Lord himself

HEB 12:6 See also PRO 3:12; REV 3:19

5927: resentment

A feeling of bitterness towards someone, usually as a result of their actions or words. Resentment is possible against God or against other people.

5928: resentment, against God

Resentment against God or Jesus Christ is usually the consequence of a lack of faith or unbelief or as a response to adverse circumstances.

Israel's resentment against God expressed in constant grumbling**Resentment at hardships and lack of provisions**

EXO 15:24, EXO 16:2–16:3, EXO 17:3; ; NUM 20:2–20:5, NUM 21:4–21:5

Resentment due to faithless fear

EXO 14:10–14:11; ; NUM 14:2–14:3, NUM 14:36; ; DEU 1:27; ; PSA 106:25

God's response to Israel's resentment**Punishment**

NUM 11:1, NUM 14:27–14:30, NUM 14:37; ; PSA 106:26–106:27; ; 1CO 10:10

Merciful provision

EXO 16:4, EXO 16:8–16:9, EXO 16:11–16:12; ; NUM 17:5, NUM 17:10

Expressions of resentment**At suffering**

JOB 10:1 See also JOB 3:20–3:26, JOB 7:11; 1SA 1:10; PSA 77:1–77:3, PSA 142:2; JER 15:18

At apparently unjust treatment by God

RUT 1:20–1:21 See also JOB 23:2; ISA 40:27

At God's word

MRK 6:18–6:19 See also 1KI 20:42–20:43, 1KI 21:4; 2CH 30:10, 2CH 36:16

The folly of resentment

JOB 5:2 See also PSA 73:21–73:22; PRO 15:12, PRO 19:3; LAM 3:39

The evil of resentment

JOB 36:13 See also JAS 3:14–3:16; JUD 1:16

Resentment towards Jesus Christ**At his miracles**

MAT 13:54–13:58 parallel MRK 6:1–6:6; ; MAT 21:15

At his teaching

MAT 15:12; ; JHN 6:60–6:61

At his claims

JHN 6:41–6:43

5929: resentment, against people

A sinful, emotional response to others or to circumstances, frequently caused by envy or a sense of injustice.

Causes of resentment**Unwelcome instruction**

PRO 3:11–3:12 See also PRO 1:7, PRO 5:12

Feelings of rejection

GEN 4:2–4:5 See also JDG 8:1; MAT 20:24

Feelings of injustice

ACT 6:1 See also GEN 27:34, GEN 50:15; MAT 20:10–20:11; COL 3:21

Hard circumstances

1SA 30:6 See also 1SA 22:2

Disappointment with leaders

JOS 9:18

Resentment has no place in godly living

EPH 4:31; PHP 2:14 See also LEV 19:18; DEU 15:10; 2CO 9:5; 2TI 2:24; HEB 12:15; JAS 3:14–3:15, JAS 5:9; 1PE 4:9

Dealing with resentment**Not an easy task**

PRO 18:19

Through forgiveness

PRO 17:9 See also PRO 19:11

Through God-given contentment

PHP 4:11 See also 1TI 6:6–6:10; HEB 13:5

Through conciliation

JDG 8:1–8:3

5931: resistance

Opposition to the demands of the state or other legitimate authorities. Individuals must not resist such demands unless they are contrary to God's requirements. God will himself judge unjust rulers. Christians should not resist the evil person but, following Jesus Christ's teaching and example, entrust themselves to God.

God should not be resisted

2CH 35:21; ; ACT 7:51, ACT 11:17; ; ROM 9:19

Individuals should not resist legitimate authorities**Civil authorities**

ROM 13:1–13:2 See also DEU 17:12–17:13; 1SA 24:6; TIT 3:1–3:2; 1PE 2:13–2:14, 1PE 2:17

Religious authorities**HEB 13:17** See also ACT 23:5**Parental authority**

EPH 6:1; ; COL 3:20; ; 2TI 3:2

Resistance of unjust authorities**Resistance to human authorities is justified when they oppose God's requirements****EXO 1:15–1:17** See also EXO 1:22–2:3; DAN 3:13–3:18, DAN 6:6–6:10; ACT 4:18–4:20, ACT 5:27–5:29; HEB 11:23**God will enable Christians, unjustly brought before human authorities, to defend themselves****MRK 13:11** parallels MAT 10:19–10:20, LUK 12:11–12:12 See also LUK 21:14–21:15**God will vindicate those of his people who cannot resist unjust authorities****DAN 3:28–3:29** See also GEN 39:20–39:21; ECC 8:12; DAN 6:19–6:28**God will himself judge unjust rulers****HOS 5:10** See also 1KI 21:15–21:19; ISA 1:23–1:26, ISA 3:11–3:15, ISA 10:1–10:3, ISA 59:14–59:20; EZK 22:27–22:31; MIC 7:2–7:4**Resisting evil****Christians should not resist the evil person****MAT 5:38–5:41** See also MAT 5:43–5:48, MAT 26:52; LUK 6:27–6:30; ROM 12:19–12:21**Christians should follow the teaching and example of Jesus Christ and entrust themselves to God****1PE 2:20–2:23** See also ISA 53:7–53:9; 2TI 4:14**5932: response**

People are to respond to God in obedience, worship and repentance and in love for others. Lack of response from others can be a sign of death, disobedience and defiance.

The response of people to God**Obedience and love for others****EXO 24:3; 1JN 4:11** See also EXO 19:8, EXO 24:7; 1CH 29:6–29:9; ROM 15:7; GAL 2:2; PHP 2:1–2:4; 1JN 2:3–2:6, 1JN 3:16–3:17**Worship****NEH 8:6; ROM 12:1** See also NEH 12:24; DAN 4:34–4:37**Repentance**

2KI 22:18–22:20 parallel 2CH 34:26–34:28; ; ACT 2:37–2:38

Response to the preaching of the gospel**ACT 16:14** See also ACT 16:31–16:34; 1CO 15:1–15:2; EPH 1:13; COL 1:6; 1TH 2:13**Inappropriate responses****2CH 32:24–32:25** See also DAN 4:24–4:32; ROM 1:21–1:23**The response of God to people****God responds to those who seek him in prayer****PSA 102:17** See also PSA 3:4, PSA 40:1–40:3; ISA 19:22; DAN 10:12; MAT 7:7–7:11 parallel LUK 11:9–11:13; LUK 11:5–11:8; JHN 14:13–14:14, JHN 15:7, JHN 16:24**Sometimes God appears not to respond to prayer**

JOB 19:7; ; PSA 10:1, PSA 13:1–13:2, PSA 22:1–22:2, PSA 42:9–42:10; ; ISA 1:15, ISA 59:1–59:2

False gods do not respond to people**1KI 18:26–18:29** See also DEU 4:28; ISA 44:18; JER 10:5**The response of people to others****Believers should respond to others in kindness and forgiveness****EPH 4:32** See also GEN 50:15, GEN 50:21; MAT 5:38–5:42 parallel LUK 6:29–6:30**Harsh or aggressive responses**

2SA 19:43; ; ROM 12:19–12:21

Lack of response**As an indication of death**

1SA 4:20; ; 2KI 4:31

As a sign of disobedience**JER 7:27–7:29** See also PRO 29:19; JER 2:30, JER 17:23, JER 32:33**As a sign of defiance**

2KI 18:36 parallel ISA 36:21

From not knowing what to say

JOB 32:15–32:16, JOB 40:3–40:5; ; MAT 22:46; ; LUK 20:26

Jesus Christ made no response at his trial

MAT 27:14 parallel MRK 15:5; ; MRK 14:61; ; 1PE 2:22–2:23; ; ISA 53:9

5933: restlessness

A lack of peace, experienced physically, spiritually or mentally.

Causes of restlessness**Worry****ECC 5:12; JER 49:23** See also GEN 41:8; EST 6:1; PRO 15:16; DAN 2:1, DAN 6:18–6:19**Illness****JOB 7:4–7:5** See also PSA 6:2–6:6, PSA 32:3–32:4, PSA 38:3–38:10; ISA 38:13–38:14

Lack of purpose**ECC 2:22–2:23** See also PSA 107:4–107:5**Uncompleted business**

RUT 3:18

Rebelliousness

GEN 27:40

Demon-possession

MRK 5:3–5:5 parallel LUK 8:29; ; MAT 12:43 parallel LUK 11:24

Sinfulness**ISA 57:20–57:21; JUD 1:13** See also JOB 3:17; PSA 59:15; ISA 48:22; JER 14:10, JER 50:6; 1TI 6:20–6:21; JAS 3:8; REV 14:11**Restlessness as part of God's judgment against sin****DEU 28:65–28:67** See also GEN 4:11–4:14; PSA 107:40, PSA 109:10; LAM 4:15; AMO 8:12; ZEC 10:2**Antidotes to restlessness****Trusting in God****PSA 62:1; ISA 26:3; ISA 30:15; PHP 4:6** See also EXO 33:14; PSA 46:10; ISA 32:17; JER 6:16; MAT 6:31–6:32**Trusting in Jesus Christ****MAT 11:28–11:30****5934: restraint**

The holding back of actions, emotions or forces, whether one's own or another's. God holds back the power and extent of evil in the world and restrains his anger. Believers are to show similar self-control in life, especially in speech.

Restraint as the holding back of actions**The example of Jesus Christ****MAT 26:52–26:53****Other examples**

See also EXO 36:6 God restrains the Israelites; 1SA 3:13 Eli's failure to restrain his sons 1SA 24:1–24:22, 1SA 26:1–26:25 1KI 1:6 David's failure to restrain Adonijah; EST 5:10 Haman's self-restraint; JER 14:10 Judah's lack of restraint; 2PE 2:16 Balaam's donkey

Restraint as the holding back of emotions**Jesus Christ's silence under suffering****1PE 2:21–2:23** See also MAT 26:62–26:63 parallel MRK 14:60–14:61; MAT 27:12–27:14 parallel MRK 15:4–15:5**Restraint as the holding back of forces****God and the Red Sea****EXO 14:21** See also EXO 15:8; PSA 78:13**Jesus Christ and the wind and the waves**

MAT 8:23–8:27 parallels MRK 4:36–4:41, LUK 8:22–8:25

God restrains the power of evil**In the world****MRK 13:20** parallel MAT 24:22 See also 2KI 19:28; PSA 76:10; 2TH 2:6–2:7; REV 20:2**From the righteous****JHN 17:15** See also 1SA 25:39; 1CH 4:10; PSA 19:13, PSA 34:7, PSA 141:3; MAT 6:13 parallel LUK 11:4; REV 7:3**God restrains his anger****PSA 78:38** See also EXO 34:6; NUM 14:18; NEH 9:17; PSA 74:11, PSA 86:15, PSA 103:8, PSA 145:8; ISA 48:9; JOL 2:13; JON 4:2; 2PE 3:9**Believers are to show restraint****In their speech****PSA 141:3; JAS 1:26** See also PSA 39:1; PRO 13:3, PRO 21:23; JAS 3:2–3:12; 1PE 3:10; PSA 34:13**In their actions****PSA 32:9** See also ROM 6:12**5935: riddles**

Enigmatic or allegorical statements whose meaning must be searched for or revealed by God. They may be compared with other forms of obscure communication and contrasted with clear messages. Riddles are associated with proverbs and parables as means of teaching wisdom.

Samson's riddle**The riddle posed****JDG 14:5–14:14** In the ancient world, riddles were popular at feasts and special occasions.**The riddle solved****JDG 14:15–14:20****Further examples of riddles****Riddles and dreams**

See also GEN 37:5–37:9 Joseph's dreams; GEN 40:5–40:8 dreams of Pharaoh's cupbearer and baker; GEN 41:1–41:8 Pharaoh's dreams; DAN 2:1–2:3 Nebuchadnezzar's dream

Four mysteries

PRO 30:18–30:19

The eagles and the vine

EZK 17:2–17:8, EZK 17:11–17:15

The writing on the wall

DAN 5:5–5:9, DAN 5:25–5:28

Riddles in the ministry of Jesus Christ

JHN 16:25 See also JHN 2:19 the destruction of the temple; JHN 16:16–16:19 Jesus Christ predicts his death and resurrection in enigmatic form.

The riddle of the number of the beast

REV 13:18, REV 17:7–17:9

Riddles and prophetic communication**Riddles contrasted with clear messages**

NUM 12:6–12:8 See also DEU 34:10; 1CO 13:12; 1PE 1:10–1:11

Messianic prophecies cast as riddles

GEN 49:8–49:11; ; ISA 11:1, ISA 53:2

Riddles as means of teaching wisdom**Riddles explained by the wise**

PSA 49:3–49:4 See also 1KI 10:3 parallel 2CH 9:2; DAN 5:12

Riddles and proverbs

PRO 1:1–1:6 See also PRO 6:6–6:8, PRO 26:1–26:2, PRO 26:7–26:10

Riddles and parables

PSA 78:2 See also JDG 9:7–9:15; 2SA 12:1–12:4; ISA 5:1–5:2; JER 13:1–13:7; MAT 13:34–13:35

5936: riots

The hostile reactions of crowds who take the law into their own hands, frequently in opposition to a messenger of God.

Riotous responses to unpopular actions or teaching

GEN 19:4–19:11 the hostility of the men of Sodom against Lot; ; JDG 6:30–6:31 The men of Ophrah call for the death of Gideon; ; JER 26:8–26:11 The people react to Jeremiah's message; ; LUK 4:28–4:30 The people of Nazareth expel Jesus Christ; ; ACT 19:23–19:34 the anger of the Ephesians over Paul; ; 2CO 6:5

Riots stirred up intentionally

MAT 27:20–27:24 parallel MRK 15:6–15:15; ; ACT 6:8–6:14, ACT 17:5–17:9, ACT 21:27–21:35

Riotous behaviour avoided or quelled

MAT 26:3–26:5 parallel MRK 14:1–14:2; ; ACT 19:35–19:41, ACT 24:5–24:12

5937: rivalry

Viewing other people as a threat to oneself in the accomplishment of some aim, or being in active competition with others for recognition or achievement.

Examples of rivalry at a national level**Between Israel and Judah**

1KI 15:25–15:31 This is typical of the conflict that existed for 80 years after the division of the kingdom.

Within Israel**1KI 16:21–16:22****Between Assyria and Judah**

See also 2CH 32:13–32:22; ISA 37:10–37:13 Assyria claimed that behind the rivalry of the nations lay the rivalry of their gods. The LORD vindicated himself in answer to Hezekiah's prayer (see Isa 37:14–38).

Examples of rivalry at an individual level**Between Esau and Jacob**

GEN 25:29–25:34, GEN 27:41

Between Peninnah and Hannah**1SA 1:6–1:7****Between Saul and David**

1SA 18:7–18:9 See also 1SA 20:31

Between Absalom and David

2SA 15:1–15:13

Between Rehoboam and Jeroboam

1KI 12:26–12:27

Condemnation of rivalry at an individual level**By the Mosaic law**

LEV 18:18

By Jesus Christ

LUK 9:46–9:48 parallels MAT 18:1–18:4, MRK 9:34–9:37 See also MAT 20:20–20:24 parallel MRK 10:35–10:41; MAT 23:8–23:11

By Paul

1CO 3:3–3:4 See also 1CO 1:12–1:13

Rivalry between individuals is overcome in Christ

GAL 3:26–3:28 See also MRK 10:42–10:45 parallel MAT 20:25–20:28; PHP 1:15–1:18

5938: sadness

Heaviness of heart brought about through disappointment, disillusionment, failure or sin. It can lead to depression of spirit, but this can be relieved.

Sadness caused by disappointment or disillusionment

NEH 2:1–2:3 See also GEN 40:6–40:7; 1KI 21:4; ECC 6:1–6:2; ISA 19:1–19:10; MAT 19:21–19:22 parallels MRK 10:21–10:22; LUK 18:22–18:23; MAT 26:21–26:22; LUK 24:17

Sadness leading to depression of spirit

NUM 11:14–11:15 See also JOS 7:7; 1KI 19:3–19:4; PSA 42:3–42:4; JER 15:10

The relief of sadness

PSA 42:5–42:6 See also PRO 12:25; PRO 15:30; PRO 17:22; PRO 31:6–31:7; PHP 2:19

5939: satisfaction

A state of contentment or fulfilment. Only God brings true satisfaction and Scripture advocates that believers should cultivate satisfaction in every situation. Jesus Christ's atoning death was the unique means of satisfying the demands of the law.

Satisfaction of hunger and thirst

Literal

PRO 6:30 See also LEV 26:26; DEU 14:29; DEU 26:12; JOB 38:39–38:41; PSA 22:26; PSA 59:15; PSA 105:40; PSA 132:15; PSA 147:14; ECC 6:7; JER 31:25; HOS 13:6; JOL 2:19; MIC 6:14

Metaphorical

PSA 104:13 See also JOB 38:25–38:27; ISA 66:11; JER 46:10; JER 50:19

Satisfaction in one's work

ECC 3:13 See also ECC 2:24; ECC 5:18

Satisfaction with one's situation

HEB 13:5 See also LUK 3:14; PHP 4:10–4:13; 1TI 6:6–6:8

Spiritual satisfaction

Found in God

PSA 17:15 See also PSA 63:1–63:5; PSA 81:13–81:16; PSA 90:14; PRO 19:23; ISA 55:1–55:2; LUK 6:21; JHN 4:7–4:15

As a result of God's good provision

PSA 145:16 See also DEU 8:10; DEU 11:15; PSA 91:16; PSA 107:8–107:9; ISA 58:9–58:11

Jesus Christ satisfies the hungry

MAT 14:15–14:20 parallels MRK 6:35–6:44; LUK 9:12–9:17
See also MAT 15:32–15:37 parallel MRK 8:2–8:8

Dissatisfaction

Riches do not bring satisfaction

ECC 5:10 See also EST 5:10–5:13; ECC 4:8; EZK 7:19; LUK 12:13–12:21; 1TI 6:7–6:10; HEB 13:5

Death is never satisfied

PRO 27:20 See also PRO 30:15–30:16; HAB 2:5

Jesus Christ's satisfaction of the demands of the law

2CO 5:21; ; HEB 7:26–7:28; HEB 9:11–9:14; HEB 9:25–10:10; HEB 10:12–10:14; ; 1PE 3:18

5940: searching

Scripture points to several aspects of searching: the human search for satisfaction in the things of this world, the human search for God and God's search for lost humanity.

The human search for security in the world

The search for material well-being

LUK 12:16–12:19 See also GEN 42:1–42:3; RUT 3:1; JOB 28:1–28:11; LAM 1:11

The search for comfort

PSA 119:82 See also EXO 14:10–14:12; NUM 11:4–11:6; 1KI 1:1–1:4

The search for success

ECC 2:1–2:11 See also 2CH 18:9–18:12; JER 45:5

The search for security

JOS 9:22–9:24 The Gibeonites resorted to deception in their eagerness to be secure. See also EXO 16:2–16:3; JDG 18:7; 2KI 20:19 parallel ISA 39:8

The search for love

PRO 7:18 See also JDG 14:1–14:3; 2SA 13:1–13:14; 1KI 11:1–11:3

The search for wisdom and understanding

ECC 8:16–8:17 See also ECC 7:24–7:29

Instructions to search for God

ISA 55:6–55:7 See also 1CH 28:9; 2CH 7:14; JER 29:13; MAT 7:7–7:8

God's search for lost humanity

EZK 34:11 See also LUK 15:1–15:10; LUK 19:9–19:10

God searches a person's innermost being

PRO 20:27 See also 1CH 28:9; PSA 139:1–139:4; JER 17:10; ROM 8:27; REV 2:23

5941: secrecy

Behaving in a way designed to keep intentions or feelings hidden from others. In Scripture acting or speaking in secret is often linked with wrongdoing, although not in all cases. But nothing can be kept secret from God.

Secrecy as a cover for wrongdoing

EPH 5:11–5:12 See also DEU 13:6, DEU 27:15, DEU 27:24; 2SA 15:10 Absalom's camp; 2KI 17:9 high places, centres of pagan Canaanite worship; JOB 31:24–31:28; PSA 10:8; PRO 9:17, PRO 17:23; ISA 65:4; ACT 6:11; 2CO 4:2; 2TH 2:7; 2PE 2:1; JUD 1:4

Secrecy associated with Satan and the black arts

REV 2:24 See also EXO 7:11, EXO 7:22, EXO 8:7, EXO 8:18; 2TH 2:7

Secrecy sometimes ensures safety

JOS 2:1 See also JDG 3:15–3:26; 2SA 21:12 **EST 2:20** See also JER 13:17, JER 38:16; MRK 7:24; JHN 7:2–7:10, JHN 19:38

Nothing can be kept secret from God

JER 23:24 See also 2SA 12:7–12:12; JOB 13:10; PSA 44:20–44:21, PSA 90:8, PSA 101:5, PSA 139:1–139:15

God's truths are not made known in secret

ISA 45:19 See also ISA 48:16; JHN 18:20; ACT 26:26

Secrecy in worship

MAT 6:16–6:18 See also MAT 6:1–6:6

Secrets

Divine secrets

DEU 29:29 See also JOB 11:5–11:6; EZK 28:3; MAT 13:10–13:11 parallel MRK 4:10–4:11; LUK 8:10; ISA 6:9; 1CO 2:7, 1CO 4:1

Human secrets

PRO 11:13 See also JDG 16:5–16:17; ROM 2:16; 1CO 14:24–14:25; PHP 4:12

5942: security

Guaranteed safety, whether natural or spiritual, from danger or loss. Scripture stresses that ultimate security is to be found only in God himself.

The security of Israel

Their security was found in God himself

DEU 33:27 See also DEU 33:26, DEU 33:28–33:29; EZR 8:21–8:23; JER 31:10–31:11

They were secure from danger and loss

ISA 54:17 See also EZK 34:27–34:28

Their security was conditional upon obedience

EXO 19:5 See also DEU 28:1–28:6, DEU 28:15–28:19

The security of believers is guaranteed

By the everlasting covenant

2SA 23:5 See also ROM 8:29–8:30

In spiritual security in Jesus Christ

JHN 10:28–10:29 See also JHN 17:12, JHN 17:15; ROM 8:35–8:39; PHP 1:6; HEB 7:25

In the provision of needs

MAT 6:33 See also PSA 23:1, PSA 23:4; PHP 4:19; HEB 13:5–13:6; PSA 118:6–118:7

In safety from danger

PSA 46:1 See also PSA 91:1–91:15, PSA 121:3–121:5; JUD 1:24–1:25

In a sure hope

2TI 1:12 See also JOB 19:25–19:27; HEB 6:19; 1PE 1:3–1:5

In prophecies of security

ISA 2:4, ISA 11:6–11:9, ISA 65:21–65:25; ; MIC 4:3–4:4; ; REV 21:4

Provision for the security of human beings

Protection for the weak

RUT 2:8–2:9; ; ISA 11:1–11:6, 1SA 22:22–22:23; ; EZR 6:6–6:7; ; PRO 3:29; ; ACT 23:10, ACT 23:23–23:24; ; ROM 13:3

Financial pledges

PRO 6:1–6:5, PRO 11:15, PRO 17:18, PRO 22:26–22:27; ; LUK 10:35; ; PHM 1:17–1:19

Pastoral protection

JHN 21:16; ; ACT 20:28; ; PHP 2:19–2:20; ; 1PE 5:1–5:2

False security

In Israel

JER 22:21 See also ISA 28:17–28:18, ISA 29:13–29:15; DAN 11:21–11:24; AMO 6:1; LUK 3:8; JHN 8:33

In the church

REV 3:17 See also REV 2:4, REV 2:14, REV 2:20, REV 3:1–3:2

In professing Christians

1CO 10:12 See also MAT 7:21–7:23, MAT 22:11–22:12, MAT 25:41–25:46; LUK 18:9; HEB 10:26–10:27; 2PE 2:21–2:22; 1JN 1:8–1:10; JUD 1:4

In the world

1TH 5:3 See also JDG 8:11, JDG 18:7; 1SA 24:3–24:4; JOB 12:6, JOB 18:14, JOB 31:24; PRO 27:24; ZEC 1:15; LUK 17:26–17:28; 1TI 6:17

5943: self-deception

The state of individuals or nations who do not face up to their sin, their spiritual state or their future with any realism. It also describes those who presume upon their relationship with God or their own ability, or who have a misplaced trust in idols.

Those who are deceived over their sin

1JN 1:8 See also PSA 36:1–36:4; JER 2:34–2:35, JER 17:9–17:10; 1CO 6:9–6:10; 1JN 1:10

Those who are deceived over their spiritual state

REV 3:17 See also MAT 23:13–23:15, MAT 23:23–23:33 parallel LUK 11:42–11:52; JHN 8:33–8:34, JHN 8:39–8:47; JAS 1:22–1:26

Those who are deceived concerning the future

JAS 4:13–4:16 See also JER 5:31, JER 6:13–6:14 parallel JER 8:10–8:11; JER 14:14–14:16, JER 23:16–23:18; EZK 13:7–13:9; MIC 3:5; LUK 12:16–12:20

Those who presume on their relationship with God

JER 7:9–7:11 See also DEU 29:14–29:21; JER 37:9–37:10; MAT 3:8–3:9 parallel LUK 3:8; MAT 7:21–7:23 parallel LUK 13:25–13:27; MAT 25:41–25:46; JHN 8:39–8:47

The value of circumcision

ROM 2:17–2:29; ; 1CO 7:19; ; PHP 3:2–3:7

Those who presume on their own ability

1CO 3:18–3:20 See also PRO 12:15; JER 49:16 parallel OBA 1:3–1:4; MAT 26:33–26:35 parallels MRK 14:27–14:31, LUK 22:33–22:34, JHN 13:37–13:38; 2CO 10:12; GAL 6:3

Those who deceive themselves about the acceptability of their worship

ISA 1:11–1:17 See also ISA 58:2–58:7; JER 7:2–7:8, JER 7:21–7:29; AMO 5:21–5:24; MAL 1:6–1:14; MAT 6:5, MAT 6:7

Those who have a misplaced trust in their own righteousness

LUK 16:15 See also PRO 30:12; ISA 65:2–65:5; LUK 18:9–18:14

Those who have a misplaced trust in idols

ROM 1:20–1:23 See also ISA 44:17–44:20

5944: self-defence

The people of God in the OT defended themselves, but their ultimate defence was to be God himself. Paul, using the channels open to him, answered false charges against him in the church and before civil authorities. Christians are not to take personal revenge but, following Jesus Christ's example, are to entrust themselves to God.

Defence of one's property

EXO 22:2–22:3

Defence of one's person**The use of a stronghold**

See also JDG 6:2; ISA 23:14; 2SA 5:17

The strength of numbers

ECC 4:12

Trust in the Lord

DAN 3:16–3:18

The example of Jesus Christ in self-defence

1PE 2:20–2:23 See also ISA 53:7; MAT 5:39 parallel LUK 6:29; MAT 26:52; JHN 18:11; ROM 12:19; 2TI 4:14

Defence against spiritual enemies

ACT 20:28; EPH 6:10–6:12 See also EPH 6:13–6:18

Self-defence in the face of false accusations**Paul to the Corinthian church**

1CO 9:1–9:3; ; 2CO 12:17–12:19

Paul before the civil authorities

ACT 21:39–22:1, ACT 22:3–22:21, ACT 22:30–23:5, ACT 24:10, ACT 25:6–25:8, ACT 25:13–25:16, ACT 26:1–26:2; ; 2TI 4:16

The promise of the help of the Holy Spirit

LUK 12:11–12:12 parallels MAT 10:19–10:20, MRK 13:11 See also LUK 21:14–21:15

5945: self-pity

Sorrow or despondency aroused by one's own suffering or misfortune. It can result from personal loss or suffering, hardship in God's service or the judgment of God. Its cure is to remember the goodness of God.

Examples of self-pity as a result of personal loss or suffering**The Israelites in the wilderness**

EXO 16:3 See also EXO 14:10–14:12, EXO 17:3; NUM 11:4–11:6, NUM 14:1–14:4; DEU 1:26–1:28; 1CO 10:10–10:11

Job

JOB 6:1–6:13, JOB 10:1 See also JOB 3:1–3:26, JOB 12:1–12:6, JOB 16:6–17:2, JOB 30:9–30:31

Other examples

GEN 27:34, GEN 27:38; ; 2SA 15:30; ; 2KI 20:2–20:3 parallel ISA 38:2–38:3; ; PSA 10:1, PSA 73:2–73:3, PSA 73:13–73:14, PSA 74:1

Examples of self-pity as a result of hardship in the service of God**Moses**

NUM 11:11–11:15 See also EXO 5:22–5:23, EXO 17:4

Elijah**1KI 19:4** See also 1KI 19:10, 1KI 19:14**Jeremiah****JER 15:10** See also JER 15:18, JER 20:7–20:10, JER 20:14–20:18**Other examples****JER 45:3** See also JON 4:1–4:5**Examples of self-pity as a result of God's judgment**

PSA 137:1–137:9; ; LAM 3:1–3:18; ; REV 18:9–18:19 The kings, merchants and sailors will be full of self-pity when they see the destruction of Babylon, because their opportunities for making wealth will be gone.

People calling upon others to pity them**JOB 19:21** See also MRK 9:22; LUK 17:13**Turning to God puts self-pity in its true perspective****PSA 43:5, PSA 73:16–73:17** See also PSA 3:1–3:4, PSA 13:1–13:6, PSA 37:1–37:7, PSA 73:23–73:28, PSA 106:7; LAM 3:19–3:26, LAM 3:31–3:33; 2CO 1:5, 2CO 6:3–6:10; JAS 1:2–1:3; 1PE 4:13**5946: sensitivity**

Deep feelings for others and sympathy for their needs, leading to appropriate action on their behalf. Spiritual sensitivity is the ability to perceive and respond to the call of God or the spiritual demands of the moment. Oversensitivity and lack of sensitivity are extremes to be avoided.

God's sensitivity to his people**EXO 3:7** See also JDG 2:18; ISA 40:2; LAM 3:22; HOS 2:14; LUK 1:78**Sensitivity shown by Jesus Christ****MAT 12:20** See also ISA 42:3 **MAT 23:37** parallel LUK 13:34 See also LUK 7:12–7:13, LUK 19:41; JHN 9:34–9:35, JHN 11:33–11:35**Jesus Christ's own experience of temptation****HEB 4:14–4:15** See also HEB 2:18**Sensitivity to others****Arises from an experience of God's compassion****2CO 1:3–1:4** See also PHP 2:1**Believers urged to show sensitivity****ROM 12:15** See also ISA 40:2; EPH 4:32; COL 3:12–3:13; 1PE 3:8; HEB 13:3**Sensitivity to foreigners in Israel****EXO 23:9** parallel EXO 22:21 See also LEV 19:33–19:34**Sensitivity to those in distress****JOB 2:11–2:13** See also MAT 26:38–26:40 parallel MRK 14:34–14:37; 2CO 7:5–7:7; HEB 10:33–10:34; JAS 1:27**Sensitivity to those weak in faith****ROM 15:1** See also ROM 14:1–14:3, ROM 14:15; 1CO 8:9–8:12; 1TH 2:7**Sensitivity in speech**

PRO 15:23, PRO 16:24, PRO 25:11, PRO 25:15; ; 1PE 3:15

Insensitivity to others**Examples of insensitivity to others**

DEU 28:53–28:57 As a result of God's judgment, the most sensitive person will become insensitive even to the needs of family; ; 1SA 1:13–1:14 Eli's insensitivity to Hannah; ; JOB 16:2 the insensitivity of Job's "comforters"; ; JON 4:9–4:11 Jonah's insensitivity to the people of Nineveh; ; MAT 19:13 parallels MRK 10:13, LUK 18:15 the disciples' insensitivity towards children brought to Jesus Christ; ; 1CO 11:20–11:21 insensitivity to the needs of others; ; JAS 2:2–2:4 insensitivity towards poorer visitors to church

The results of insensitivity

PSA 69:20; ; PRO 25:17, PRO 25:20

Oversensitivity**Oversensitivity in the face of rejection**

1SA 25:11–25:13 David's hasty reaction towards Nabal; ; LUK 9:53–9:54 James' and John's hasty reaction

Oversensitivity of conscience

ROM 14:2; ; 1CO 8:6–8:8

Spiritual sensitivity**Spiritual awareness****1SA 3:8** See also MAT 24:32–24:34 parallels MRK 13:28–13:29, LUK 21:29–21:30; ACT 16:9–16:10**Lack of spiritual sensitivity****EPH 4:18–4:19** See also PRO 23:31–23:35; ROM 1:28–1:29; 1TI 4:1–4:4 ISA 42:25; JER 5:3 EZK 12:2; ZEC 7:11–7:14**God hardens human hearts**

EXO 7:3; ; ROM 1:24–1:25

5947: shame

An uncomfortable feeling of guilt and humiliation, usually arising from sin or failure.

Shame is to be avoided**PSA 25:2** See also PSA 25:20, PSA 31:1, PSA 31:17, PSA 44:15, PSA 119:31, PSA 119:80

Causes of shame

Military defeat

2KI 19:26

Natural afflictions

LUK 1:25 See also GEN 30:23; ISA 4:1, ISA 54:4 not only childlessness but widowhood

Humiliation by an enemy

PSA 69:19 See also PSA 69:6–69:7; ISA 11:2; 2SA 10:4–10:5; ISA 3:17; MRK 12:4

Nakedness

REV 3:18 See also GEN 2:25, GEN 3:10, GEN 9:22–9:23; ISA 47:3; EZK 16:37; REV 16:15

The sin of relations or associates

PRO 14:34

Heathen gods as a source of shame

2SA 2:10 “Bosheth” means “shame”. According to 1Ch 8:33 he was originally Ish-Baal, but the name “Baal”, subsequently associated with a heathen god, was changed by later writers to “Bosheth”. See also JER 3:24, JER 11:13; HOS 9:10

Shame as a divine judgment

JER 23:40 See also PSA 44:9; JER 46:24

Shame brought upon God's enemies

PSA 6:10, PSA 31:17, PSA 35:26, PSA 70:2, PSA 71:13, PSA 109:29, PSA 129:5

Shame as guilt for sin

EZR 9:6 See also PRO 6:32; DAN 9:5–9:7; ROM 6:20–6:21

Shame may lead to repentance

1CO 6:5; ; 2CO 7:9–7:11; ; 2TH 3:14

Some people are without shame

JER 3:3, JER 6:15; ; ZEP 3:5

Jesus Christ bore shame

HEB 12:2 See also DEU 21:23; MAT 27:39–27:44; HEB 6:6

The temptation of being ashamed of Jesus Christ and the cross

MRK 8:38 parallel LUK 9:26 See also ROM 1:16; GAL 6:14

Those who trust in God will not be put to shame

PSA 25:3 See also PSA 119:5–119:6; ISA 28:16; ROM 9:33, ROM 10:11; 1PE 2:6, 1PE 4:16

5948: shrewdness

Astuteness or craftiness in dealings with others, especially in using one's understanding and judgment to one's own advantage. Scripture commends it when it is seen in wise words and actions directed towards a

worthy goal, but condemns it when it takes the form of cunning and deceitful scheming for sinful and selfish ends.

Shrewdness as astuteness

It is encouraged in believers

MAT 10:16; LUK 16:8–16:9 Jesus Christ explains the parable of the dishonest manager (Lk 16:1–7) and urges his disciples to be shrewd in their use of worldly wealth.

Practical demonstrations of astuteness

MAT 7:24–7:25 parallel LUK 6:47–6:48 See also PRO 12:23, PRO 14:15, PRO 15:5, PRO 18:15; MAT 24:45–24:47 parallel LUK 12:42–12:44

Jesus Christ's wisdom in answering his enemies

MAT 22:18–22:22 parallels MRK 12:15–12:17, LUK 20:23–20:26 on the matter of paying taxes to Caesar; ; MAT 22:31–22:32 parallels MRK 12:26–12:27, LUK 20:37–20:38 on the question of the resurrection; ; JHN 8:7 regarding the woman caught in adultery

Further examples of astuteness

1SA 23:22–23:23 David's shrewdness in fleeing from Saul; ; 2SA 14:1–14:3 Joab's ruse to persuade David to call Absalom back from exile; ; 1KI 3:28 Solomon's wise judgment; ; 2CH 11:23 Rehoboam acts wisely to secure his kingdom; ; DAN 1:11–1:13 Daniel avoids eating royal food and wine; ; MAT 2:16 Herod is outwitted by the Magi; ; MRK 7:27–7:29 parallel MAT 15:26–15:28 the Syro-Phoenician woman's wise response

Shrewdness as crafty and deceitful scheming

It demonstrates human sinfulness

PSA 64:6 See also JOB 15:5; PSA 83:3, PSA 140:1–140:3; PRO 7:10; ACT 13:10; EPH 4:14

It is condemned by God

2SA 22:26–22:27 parallel PSA 18:25–18:26 God is shrewd in dealing with those who cleverly deceive others; **JOB 5:12–5:13** See also PSA 94:11; PRO 6:12–6:15, PRO 12:2; ISA 5:21, ISA 44:24–44:25; 1CO 1:19; ISA 29:14; 1CO 3:19–3:20

Others dislike it

PRO 14:17, PRO 25:23

It is a characteristic of Satan

2CO 11:3 See also GEN 3:1; 2CO 2:11, 2CO 11:13–11:15

The craftiness of Jesus Christ's enemies

MAT 22:15–22:17 parallels MRK 12:13–12:15, LUK 20:20–20:22 The Pharisees try to trap Jesus Christ over paying taxes; ; MAT 26:3–26:4 parallels MRK 14:1–14:2, LUK 22:1–22:2 The religious leaders plot Jesus Christ's death.

Further examples of crafty scheming

GEN 25:31–25:33 Jacob buys Esau's birthright; ; GEN 27:15–27:16 Isaac is tricked into blessing Jacob; ; EXO 1:10 Pharaoh plans to reduce the number of Israelites; ; JOS 9:3–9:6 The Gibeonites deceive Joshua; ; 2SA 13:3 Jonadab plots for Amnon against Tamar; ; NEH 6:2–6:13 schemes against Nehemiah; ; 2CO 12:16 Paul sarcastically echoes the slander against him that he tricked people into giving him money.

5949: shyness

Moses was shy of public speaking

EXO 4:10–4:15, EXO 6:12, EXO 6:30

Shyness caused by youth and inexperience

Jeremiah

JER 1:6

Timothy

1CO 16:10–16:11; ; 1TI 4:12; ; 2TI 1:7

The woman subject to bleeding was shy of making herself known

MRK 5:25–5:28, MRK 5:33

Jesus Christ taught his disciples not to be shy of bearing witness to him

MAT 5:14–5:16

5950: silence

A stillness or absence of noise, often associated with the absence of life or people, but also associated with a sense of expectancy or reverence, especially in the presence of God. Scripture stresses that God is not silent, but has spoken his word to his creation. The silence of Jesus Christ before his accusers is seen as the fulfilment of OT prophecy.

The silence of God

His apparent silence in the face of sin

PSA 50:21 See also JOB 34:29; ISA 42:14, ISA 57:11

God will not remain silent in the face of sin

PSA 50:3 See also ISA 62:1, ISA 65:6–65:7

Prayers that God will not be silent

PSA 28:1 See also PSA 35:22, PSA 39:12, PSA 83:1, PSA 109:1; ISA 64:12; HAB 1:13

God silences those who oppose him

ISA 2:9 See also PSA 8:2, PSA 63:11, PSA 107:42; ISA 25:5, ISA 47:5; JER 47:5, JER 48:2, JER 51:55; MAT 22:34; MRK 3:4; LUK 20:26; ACT 4:14; ROM 3:19

The silence of Jesus Christ

It was foretold in the OT

ISA 53:7 See also ACT 8:32

Its fulfilment in the NT

MAT 26:63 parallel MRK 14:61 before the Sanhedrin; ; MAT 27:14 parallels MRK 15:4–15:5, JHN 19:9 before Pilate; ; LUK 23:9 before Herod

Jesus Christ commands silence as a sign of his authority

MRK 1:25–1:26 parallel LUK 4:35 Jesus Christ silenced evil spirits; ; MRK 4:39 Jesus Christ silenced the storm.

There are times when it is appropriate for God's people to be silent

The silence of expecting God to act

JOS 6:10 See also GEN 24:21; EXO 14:14–14:15; 2KI 2:3, 2KI 2:5; REV 8:1

The silence anticipating the wisdom of another person

JOB 29:7–29:10, JOB 29:21

The silence of prudence

PRO 10:19; ECC 3:7 See also ISA 10:27; JOB 13:5, JOB 33:31–33:33; PRO 11:12, PRO 17:28

The silence of suffering

LAM 3:28 See also PSA 39:9

The silence of shame

EZK 16:63

The silence of anger

PSA 4:4 The psalmist is warning against hasty action when angry.

The silence of amazement at God's actions

See also LUK 9:36; ACT 15:12

A tongues-speaker should be silent if no interpreter is present

1CO 14:28 silence in the church; ; 1CO 14:30 A prophet should be silent if another receives a revelation.

Christian women are sometimes exhorted to be silent

1TI 2:11–2:12 See also 1CO 14:34–14:35; 1PE 3:1–3:4

There are times when it is inappropriate for God's people to be silent

When there is good news to tell

2KI 7:9; ; PSA 40:9

When much depends upon a person's words

EST 4:14 See also JER 4:19, JER 20:9; ACT 18:9–18:10

When God should be praised

PSA 30:11–30:12 See also LUK 19:37–19:40

When sin is unconfessed**PSA 32:3****When God's people feel they have a genuine complaint****PSA 39:1–39:2** See also JOB 7:11, JOB 23:16–23:17**When prayer is urgently required**

ISA 62:6–62:7

God's people are sometimes brought to silence

JOB 31:34 Job fearing the crowd; ; EZK 3:26 Ezekiel as a judgment on Israel; ; MRK 9:34 the disciples when their pride was exposed; ; LUK 1:20 Zechariah because of his unbelief

Silencing the wicked**Believers pray that the wicked will be silenced****PSA 31:17–31:18; 1PE 2:23** See also PSA 143:12**Believers so live that the wicked may be silenced**

TIT 2:8; ; 1PE 2:15

False teachers must be silenced**TIT 1:10–1:11** “the circumcision group” believed that in order to be saved it was necessary to be circumcised and keep the Jewish ceremonial law.**Death is compared to silence**

See also PSA 94:17, PSA 115:17

5951: slander

False and malicious talk about others. It not only harms those against whom it is directed, but also brings ruin to those who propagate it.

Slander condemned**Slander is sinful****MRK 7:21–7:23** parallel MAT 15:19–15:20 See also JER 9:4–9:6; EZK 22:9; ROM 1:29–1:31; 2CO 12:20; 2TI 3:2–3:4**Slander is forbidden****LEV 19:16** See also EXO 23:1; PRO 3:30, PRO 10:18, PRO 12:22; EPH 4:31; COL 3:8; TIT 2:3, TIT 3:1–3:2; JAS 4:11; 1PE 2:1**Slander is destructive****PRO 16:27** See also PRO 11:9, PRO 26:28, PRO 30:10**Dealing with slander****Committing one's cause to God****PSA 120:1–120:2** See also PSA 12:1–12:7, PSA 31:14–31:20, PSA 64:1–64:4, PSA 69:6–69:21, PSA 109:1–109:5**Maintaining one's integrity****1PE 2:12** See also PSA 119:23; 1PE 2:15, 1PE 3:9, 1PE 3:15–3:17**Rejoicing in the Lord****MAT 5:11–5:12** See also ACT 5:41**Not listening to slander****1SA 24:9** See also PRO 17:4**Judgment upon slanderers****PRO 21:28** See also DEU 22:13–22:19; PRO 19:5, PRO 19:9, PRO 21:28; ISA 29:20–29:21, ISA 51:7–51:8; 1CO 6:9–6:10**Examples of slander****JER 18:18** See also GEN 39:7–39:20; 1KI 21:1–21:14 Naboth's vineyard; NEH 6:5–6:7; PSA 31:13, PSA 35:15–35:16, PSA 38:19–38:20, PSA 41:5–41:9; LUK 23:2; ACT 6:13–6:14, ACT 24:5–24:9; ROM 3:8; 3JN 1:9–1:10**5952: sorrow**

The human response to painful and distressing life situations, especially those involving loss.

Sorrow caused by the trials of life**PSA 90:10** See also PSA 13:1–13:2, PSA 31:9; ECC 1:18, ECC 2:23; JER 20:18**Sorrow caused by fulfilling God's will****1PE 1:6** See also MAT 26:38; PHP 2:27**Sorrow caused by illness****ISA 38:2–38:3** See also PSA 6:1–6:7**Sorrow caused by childlessness****1SA 1:16****Sorrow caused by parting****ACT 20:37** See also MAT 17:23 the disciples' reaction to Jesus Christ predicting his death; LUK 22:45; JHN 16:6**Sorrow caused by bereavement****GEN 23:2; JHN 20:11** See also GEN 50:1; DEU 34:8; 2SA 19:2; LUK 7:12–7:14, LUK 8:52; JHN 11:33–11:35; ACT 8:2**Sorrow caused by national calamities****PSA 137:1** See also ISA 15:3, ISA 22:4; JER 22:10, JER 48:17; EZK 21:6, EZK 27:30**God and sorrow****God is close to those who grieve****PSA 34:18** See also PSA 10:14; ISA 53:4; JHN 11:35**God comforts the sorrowing****JER 31:13** See also ISA 35:10; LAM 3:32–3:33; JHN 16:20; 1TH 4:13–4:14; REV 21:4

Sorrow in response to human sin

The result of sinning

PSA 16:4 See also 1SA 2:33

Grief over the failure of others

2CO 2:4–2:5 See also GEN 34:7; 1SA 20:34; EZR 10:6; EZK 9:4; ROM 9:2; 1CO 5:2

Grief over one's own shortcomings

MAT 5:4 See also MAT 26:75; 2CO 7:9–7:11; JAS 4:9

Sorrow in response to God's judgment on human sin

LAM 1:5 See also NEH 1:4; JER 8:21, JER 10:19, JER 13:17, JER 14:2; EZK 21:6, EZK 21:12; AMO 5:16–5:17, AMO 8:10; MIC 1:8; ZEP 1:15; ZEC 12:10; MAT 8:12, MAT 24:30; REV 1:7

Jesus Christ's sorrow in response to human sin

LUK 19:41–19:42

The promise of final deliverance from sorrow

See also ISA 35:10; REV 21:4

5953: stability

The state of being in a firm or unwavering situation, whether emotional, political or personal. Stability is an important element of a settled life before God.

Stability in the life of faith

Stability for the believer is based on God's unchanging nature

DEU 32:4; PSA 103:19 See also 1SA 2:2; 2SA 22:32; JOB 25:2; PSA 62:2, PSA 89:2, PSA 93:2; ISA 26:4; MAT 7:24–7:27

Stability gives resistance to spiritual assault

1CO 16:13; COL 1:22–1:23 See also PSA 20:7–20:8, PSA 40:2; PRO 10:25; MAT 10:22; ROM 16:25; 1CO 15:58; 2CO 1:24; GAL 5:1; PHP 1:27, PHP 1:27; COL 4:12; 1TH 3:8; 2TH 2:15; HEB 6:19, HEB 10:23; JAS 1:23–1:25, JAS 5:8; 2PE 1:12

Stability depends upon firmness of faith

COL 2:5–2:7 See also PSA 57:7, PSA 119:5; ISA 26:3; EPH 3:17; HEB 3:14; 1PE 5:9–5:10

Stability is an important aim of Christian ministry

EPH 4:14 See also COL 1:28

Political stability

2SA 7:16; PRO 29:4 See also 1SA 13:13; 2SA 5:12; 1KI 2:12; PRO 16:12; ISA 16:5

5954: strength

The quality of power and might which characterises God and his relationship to his creation. Human strength can lead to rebellion against God on account of a belief in human self-sufficiency.

5955: strength, divine

The strength of God is made known in creation and redemption and in his empowering of believers to live faithfully.

The revelation of the strength of God

In creation

ROM 1:20 See also JOB 38:4, JOB 38:8, JOB 38:12, JOB 38:31–38:33; PSA 68:34, PSA 104:1–104:3, PSA 104:32; ISA 40:12, ISA 40:25–40:26; JER 32:17; HEB 1:2–1:3

In providence

PSA 135:6 See also PSA 46:8–46:10, PSA 115:3; ISA 14:24, ISA 40:23; JER 27:5; DAN 4:35; ACT 17:26; EPH 1:11

In redemption

EXO 6:6; EPH 1:19–1:20 EXO 3:19–3:20; ; DEU 4:34, DEU 4:37; ; PSA 77:13–77:15; ; ISA 51:10; ; JER 32:21; DEU 3:24; ; 2SA 22:2–22:3 parallel PSA 18:1–18:2 David's song of praise for deliverance; ; PSA 98:1; ; ISA 59:1, ISA 59:16

In human weakness

2CO 12:9–12:10, 2CO 13:4 See also JDG 7:4–7:7; 1CO 1:25–1:27; HEB 11:34

In judgment

REV 6:15–6:17 See also PSA 89:10; ISA 63:5–63:6; EZK 20:33–20:35; HAB 3:12; 2TH 1:8–1:9; 2PE 3:7; REV 6:12–6:14, REV 18:8

God's strength brings comfort to believers

PSA 27:1 See also PSA 27:3; JHN 10:28–10:29; ROM 8:28, ROM 8:31

5956: strength, human

All human strength derives from God. Among non-believers, strength may become a source of arrogant self-confidence, the oppression of others or rebellion against God.

The strength of the ungodly

Physical prowess

1SA 17:4–17:10 See also NUM 13:31–13:33

Intelligence

1CO 1:22 The Gentile world relies on fallen reason rather than revelation. See also ACT 17:19–17:21, ACT 17:32; COL 2:8

Political and military might

PSA 20:7 See also GEN 10:8–10:12; PSA 33:16; ISA 31:1, ISA 36:18–36:20

Prosperity

PSA 49:6 See also JER 49:4; LUK 12:18–12:19; 1TI 6:17

The ultimate futility of human strength

1CO 1:25 See also 2CH 32:7–32:8; PSA 49:17, PSA 146:3; ECC 5:15; ISA 30:1–30:3; LUK 12:20; 1CO 1:19–1:20, 1CO 2:6; 1TI 6:7; JAS 1:11

Negative consequences of human strength

Arrogant self-confidence

GEN 11:4 See also ISA 17:41–17:44; PSA 52:1 Boasting betrays the source of people's confidence; ISA 36:8–36:9; DAN 4:30; LUK 18:9–18:12; GAL 6:13; PHP 3:3

Violence and oppression

PSA 52:7 See also GEN 4:23–4:24; EXO 1:11–1:14, EXO 5:10–5:14; JDG 6:2, JDG 6:6; PSA 37:14, PSA 73:3–73:8; ISA 5:8; JAS 5:4–5:6

The physical strength of some godly men

2SA 23:20 parallel 1CH 11:22 Benaiah; ; 1CH 11:20–11:21 Abishai; ; HEB 11:32–11:34

5957: strength, spiritual

In contrast to human strength, God is the source and supplier of all spiritual strength through which believers can do all that God asks.

God is the source of spiritual strength

God gives strength

EPH 6:10 See also JDG 16:3, JDG 16:6, JDG 16:18–16:20; PSA 68:35; ISA 40:29–40:31; LUK 24:49; ACT 1:8; EPH 3:16, EPH 3:20; 2TH 2:16–2:17; 1TI 1:12; 2TI 1:7

Strength comes from the promise of his presence

JOS 1:9 See also DEU 31:7–31:8; PSA 119:28; ISA 41:10; JER 1:8; HAG 2:4; 2TI 4:17

Strength comes from the realisation of his grace

2TI 2:1 See also ACT 20:32; 1CO 15:10; HEB 13:9

Strength comes through the Holy Spirit

ZEC 4:6–4:7 See also JDG 14:6; LUK 4:14; EPH 3:7, EPH 3:16

Overcoming strength is often veiled in weakness

2CO 12:7–12:10 See also PSA 8:2; ACT 14:19–14:20; 2CO 4:8–4:12; COL 2:15; HEB 11:32–11:38

Aspects of spiritual strength

Profound dependence upon God

ISA 17:45 See also PSA 27:1, PSA 44:4–44:8, PSA 118:6; ISA 40:29–40:31; DAN 3:16–3:18; MAT 26:42; 1CO 1:31; GAL 6:14; HEB 13:6

Humility and gentleness

MAT 11:29 See also NUM 12:3; 1TH 2:6–2:8, 1TH 2:11–2:12

5959: submission

A humble attitude where obedience is rendered within a relationship; whether it be to God, authorities or other people at work, in the church, in marriage or in the family.

God requires submission

From all people

PSA 2:9–2:11 See also JOB 22:21; 1PE 5:6

From Christians especially

MAT 6:9–6:10 See also HEB 12:9; JAS 4:7

The submission of Jesus Christ to his Father

LUK 22:42 parallels MAT 26:39, MRK 14:36 See also JHN 5:19, JHN 12:49–12:50; 1CO 15:27–15:28; HEB 5:7–5:8, HEB 10:5–10:7

The submissive spirit required in the church

In believers' relationships with one another

EPH 5:21 See also PHP 2:5–2:7

To Jesus Christ

EPH 5:24 See also EPH 1:22–1:23; COL 1:18 As the body is subject to the head, so the church is subject to Christ.

To the Scriptures

JOS 1:7–1:8 See also PSA 119:133; COL 3:15; JAS 1:22–1:25; REV 22:18–22:19

To church leaders

HEB 13:17 See also ROM 13:1; 1CO 16:15–16:16; 1TH 5:12–5:13

In prophecy

1CO 14:32 The implication is that individual prophecies must be submitted to the overall judgment of the church.

The submission of all to civil government

ROM 13:1 See also MAT 22:21 parallels MRK 12:17, LUK 20:25; ROM 13:2–13:7; TIT 3:1; 1PE 2:13–2:14

Submission within other relationships

Of wives to husbands

EPH 5:22–5:24 See also COL 3:18; TIT 2:4–2:5; 1PE 3:1, 1PE 3:5–3:6

Of children to parents

EPH 6:1–6:3 See also EXO 20:12; GAL 4:2; COL 3:20

Of slaves to masters

EPH 6:5–6:8 See also COL 3:22–3:24; TIT 2:9–2:10; 1PE 2:18

Of young to old

1PE 5:5 See also LEV 19:32

Reciprocal attitudes are commended to safeguard against abuse

EPH 5:25–5:33, EPH 6:4, EPH 6:9; ; 1TI 2:1–2:2; ; 1PE 5:1–5:4 Those in authority have a responsibility to set an example.

5960: success

The achieving of objectives or personal fulfilment. For believers, success depends on faithfulness to God. Success can lead to dependence on one's own strength, instead of upon God.

Causes of success

The favour of God

GEN 39:23; ; JOS 1:7; ; 2CH 20:20, 2CH 26:5

Human skill

ECC 10:10

Many advisers

PRO 15:22

Nothing can succeed that is against God

PRO 21:30 See also ACT 5:34–5:39

Examples of prayers for success

GEN 24:12–24:15 success in personal relationships; 1CH 4:10; ; 2CH 14:11; NEH 1:11 success in personal achievement; ; ACT 4:18–4:31 success in ministry

The dangers of success

Pride

2CH 25:19 See also 1SA 2:3; PRO 11:2, PRO 16:5; MIC 2:3

Boasting

EPH 2:8 See also JAS 4:13–4:17; PSA 10:3–10:4; ISA 10:15–10:16

Forgetting God

DEU 32:18 See also DEU 8:11–8:17; JDG 3:7, JDG 8:33–8:34

Lack of thankfulness

ROM 1:21; ; 2TI 3:2

5961: superiority

A sense of being of greater importance or value in comparison with others, which can lead to arrogance and boasting.

Superiority is a characteristic of the wicked person

It is the product of human pride

PRO 21:24; 3JN 1:9 See also 2CH 26:16; PSA 73:3–73:9; ISA 3:16, ISA 9:9–9:10; ROM 1:30; 2TI 3:4; 2PE 2:10

It involves looking down on others

1SA 17:42; LUK 18:9–18:14 See also GEN 16:4–16:5; 1SA 10:27; 2SA 6:16 parallel 1CH 15:29; PSA 31:18, PSA 101:5, PSA 123:3–123:4; PRO 15:20, PRO 23:22; AMO 5:10

It gives rise to boasting

EST 5:11; ACT 8:9 See also 1KI 20:11; ISA 16:6; EZK 28:2; DAN 7:8; HOS 12:8; MAT 26:33–26:35; JAS 3:5; JUD 1:16

God hates superior behaviour and will judge it

ISA 2:11–2:12; 1PE 5:5 See also 1SA 2:3; 2SA 22:28; JOB 20:6–20:7; PRO 3:11, PRO 16:5, PRO 16:18, PRO 21:4; ISA 2:17, ISA 10:12, ISA 13:11, ISA 13:19, ISA 23:9; JER 9:23–9:24; OBA 1:12–1:13; MAT 18:10; ROM 11:17–11:18, ROM 14:3, ROM 14:10; 1CO 1:20–1:25; 1TI 3:6, 1TI 6:17; REV 18:7–18:8

The attitude of the godly is not superior

They demonstrate a proper humility

PSA 131:1; PHP 2:3 See also ROM 12:16; 1CO 4:6–4:7; PHP 2:4–2:8

Jesus Christ's advice to those who aspire to greatness

MAT 20:20–20:28 parallel MRK 10:35–10:45 See also JHN 13:12–13:17

5962: surprises

People are often taken unawares by God's power, love and wisdom. The actions of God and Jesus Christ are often described as surprising those who witnessed them.

God's actions surprise people

Surprise at the sudden appearance of angels

LUK 1:11–1:12 See also DAN 8:16–8:17; LUK 1:28–1:29, LUK 2:9; ACT 10:3–10:4

Surprise deliverance

DAN 3:26–3:27; ; ACT 5:19–5:24, ACT 12:14–12:18, ACT 28:6

Surprise at special births

LUK 1:29–1:34 See also GEN 17:17; LUK 1:18

Surprise at the circumstances of Jesus Christ's death

MAT 27:54

Surprise at the coming of the Holy Spirit

ACT 2:6–2:7 See also ACT 10:45

Surprise at the change in people's lives

ACT 9:21 See also MRK 5:15 parallel LUK 8:35

Surprise at the second coming

MAT 24:44 parallel LUK 12:40 See also MAL 3:1; MAT 24:50 parallel LUK 12:46; MAT 25:6, MAT 25:13; MRK 13:36; LUK 21:34; 1TH 5:4

Surprise at discernment

MAT 25:37–25:39, MAT 25:44; ; LUK 5:22; ; JHN 4:19; ; ACT 5:5, ACT 5:11

Jesus Christ surprised people**Surprise at Jesus Christ's moral requirements**

MAT 5:20 See also MAT 5:48, MAT 18:21–18:22

Surprise at Jesus Christ's humility

JHN 13:6

Surprise at Jesus Christ's control of natural elements

MAT 8:27 parallels MRK 4:41, LUK 8:25 See also MAT 14:25–14:26 parallel MRK 6:49–6:50; MAT 21:20; LUK 5:9; JHN 2:8–2:10, JHN 6:14

Surprise at the company Jesus Christ kept

MRK 2:16 parallels MAT 9:11, LUK 5:30 See also LUK 7:39

Surprise at Jesus Christ's healings

MRK 7:37 See also MAT 9:6–9:8, MAT 9:33, MAT 15:31; MRK 5:42 parallel LUK 8:56

Surprise at the requirements for entry into the kingdom of heaven

MAT 19:13–19:15 parallels MRK 10:13–10:16, LUK 18:15–18:17; ; MAT 19:24–19:25 parallels MRK 10:23–10:26, LUK 18:25–18:26

Surprise at Jesus Christ's teaching authority

MRK 1:22 parallel LUK 4:32 See also MAT 7:28–7:29, MAT 22:33; MRK 6:2–6:4 parallel MAT 13:53–13:54; MRK 11:18; JHN 7:15

Surprise at the wisdom of Jesus Christ

MAT 22:22 parallels MRK 12:17, LUK 20:26

Surprise at the expectations of Jesus Christ

MAT 14:16–14:17 parallels MRK 6:37, LUK 9:13, JHN 6:7–6:9 See also MAT 15:33–15:36 parallel MRK 8:4–8:6

Surprise at Jesus Christ's authority in the spiritual realm

MRK 1:27 parallel LUK 4:36 See also MRK 5:15–5:17 parallels MAT 8:33–8:34, LUK 8:35–8:37

Surprise at Jesus Christ's disregard for Jewish customs

LUK 11:38 See also MRK 7:5 parallel MAT 15:2; JHN 4:27

Surprise at Jesus Christ's rejection of religious words and actions

MAT 7:21–7:23; ; LUK 13:26–13:27

Surprise at Jesus Christ bringing back the dead

LUK 7:14–7:16 See also MRK 5:42 parallel LUK 8:56

Surprise at the post-resurrection appearance of Jesus Christ

LUK 24:36–24:37

Jesus Christ is surprised by people's reactions**By the great faith of an unlikely person**

MAT 8:10 parallel LUK 7:9

By lack of faith among God's people

MRK 6:4–6:6 parallel MAT 13:57–13:58

By the dullness of his followers

MAT 15:16 parallel MRK 7:18 See also MAT 16:9–16:11 parallel MRK 8:17–8:18

By lack of spiritual insight

JHN 14:9 See also JHN 3:10

Surprises for believers**Surprise at suffering**

1PE 4:12 See also 1JN 3:13

Surprise at divine revelation

LUK 24:32 See also ACT 10:17, ACT 11:15

Surprises caused by believers**Surprising courage**

ACT 4:13 See also DAN 3:13

Surprise at miracles

ACT 3:11–3:12, ACT 8:13, ACT 14:11

Surprise at the teaching about Jesus Christ

ACT 13:12

5963: sympathy

The ability to appreciate another's condition, especially through shared experience of pain or suffering. God sympathises with his people in their sufferings, as does Jesus Christ as the sympathetic high priest.

God sympathises with his people

PSA 10:14; 2CO 1:3–1:4 See also EXO 22:26–22:27; DEU 10:18; JDG 2:18; PSA 9:9, PSA 91:15; ISA 40:1–40:2, ISA 66:13; JER 8:18; 2CO 7:6

God's apparent lack of sympathy may be evidence of judgment

JER 16:5–16:6 See also ISA 27:11, ISA 63:15

Jesus Christ sympathises with those in distress

JHN 11:35; HEB 4:15 See also MAT 9:36; MRK 1:41; LUK 7:34; HEB 2:14–2:18

Sympathy as a characteristic of friendship

ISA 20:34; JOB 2:11 See also JDG 11:37; 1SA 20:41; 2SA 10:2–10:3 parallel 1CH 19:2–19:3; JOB 16:4–16:5, JOB 19:21, JOB 29:16, JOB 30:25; ECC 4:10; DAN 1:9; JHN 11:18–11:19

Sympathy expected from God's people

EXO 23:9; ROM 12:15; 1PE 3:8 See also EXO 22:21; LEV 19:33–19:34; DEU 10:19; ISA 58:6–58:7; 2CO 1:4–1:7, 2CO 2:7, 2CO 11:29; PHP 1:7, PHP 2:1, PHP 4:14; COL 3:12; 1TH 2:11–2:12; 1TI 5:9–5:10; HEB 10:34, HEB 13:3

The absence of sympathy

PSA 69:20 See also DEU 15:7; JOB 6:14–6:18; PSA 31:11–31:12, PSA 38:11, PSA 41:9; JER 20:10; LAM 1:16; OBA 1:12; MAT 18:33

5964: temper

A person's usual character or temporary frame of mind. The term often refers to a temporary state of anger, which Scripture insists must be brief and controlled.

General references to good temper

PRO 16:32 See also PRO 15:1; MAT 5:39; EPH 4:2; 1TI 3:2–3:3; 2TI 2:24; JAS 3:17

People who kept their temper under provocation

Joseph

GEN 50:15–50:21

David

2SA 16:5–16:13

Jesus Christ

LUK 23:33–23:34

Stephen

ACT 7:59–7:60

General references to bad temper

PRO 14:17; MAT 5:22 See also PSA 37:8; PRO 19:11; ECC 7:8–7:9; GAL 5:19–5:20

People who lost their temper

Cain

GEN 4:5

King Saul

ISA 20:30 See also 1SA 18:8, 1SA 19:9–19:10

Nabal

ISA 25:14–25:17

Naaman

2KI 5:11–5:12

The people in the synagogue at Nazareth

LUK 4:28–4:29

The Pharisees

LUK 6:11

The people of Ephesus

See also ACT 19:28–19:29

Others

1KI 21:4; ; 2CH 16:10; ; EST 3:5, EST 3:6; ; DAN 3:19; ; AMO 1:11; ; ACT 7:57–7:58, ACT 22:22–22:23

Christians must do all they can to control their temper

PRO 22:24–22:25; EPH 4:26–4:27 See also PHP 4:8; JAS 1:19–1:20; 1PE 1:13; 2PE 1:5–1:7

God enables Christians to control their temper

GAL 5:16–5:18, GAL 5:22–5:23 See also PHP 2:12–2:13; 2TI 1:7

5965: temperament

A person's disposition, especially as shown in mental or emotional responses. God's people should be of an even temperament.

God's people should be of even temperament

PRO 16:32 See also TIT 2:1–2:14

Even temperament is a requirement for church leadership

1TI 3:2–3:3 See also 1TI 3:8–3:9, 1TI 3:11; TIT 1:7–1:9

Examples of people who had an unpleasant temperament

Saul

ISA 16:23 Violent mood swings and bad temper were signs of mental instability in Saul. See also 1SA 16:14–16:16, 1SA 18:6–18:15, 1SA 20:4–20:7, 1SA 20:24–20:33

Nabal the Carmelite

ISA 25:17 See also 1SA 25:2–25:11, 1SA 25:36–25:38

5966: tenderness

Physically, the state of being soft or easily damaged. Tenderness in relationships is an expression of love and affection which, in the case of God, is often linked with compassion for his people.

Physical tenderness

Of new plant growth

EZK 17:22 See also DEU 32:2; 2KI 19:26; ISA 37:27, ISA 53:2; MAT 24:32 parallel MRK 13:28

Of meat

GEN 18:7

Of the young and immature**PRO 4:3** See also GEN 33:13; ISA 47:1**Tenderness in relationships****Human love and affection****GEN 34:3** See also 2SA 1:26; SNG 7:10; LUK 15:20**God's tenderness****ISA 40:1–40:2; LUK 1:78** See also DEU 32:10–32:14; ISA 30:18, ISA 54:10, ISA 63:15; JER 31:3, JER 31:20; HOS 2:14, HOS 11:1–11:4; ZEP 3:17**The tenderness of Jesus Christ****MRK 10:16** See also MAT 9:36, MAT 14:14, MAT 23:37; MRK 1:41; JHN 11:33–11:36, JHN 19:26–19:27**A mark of Christian behaviour****PHP 2:1–2:2** See also 1CO 4:21; PHP 1:8; COL 3:12; 1PE 3:8**5967: thrift**

Saving by the careful use of resources. In general this is encouraged in Scripture, though the dangers of meanness, materialism and anxiety are recognised.

Encouragements to thrift**To provide for the future****PRO 21:20** See also PRO 6:6–6:8, PRO 10:5, PRO 12:27, PRO 27:23–27:27, PRO 30:25**To provide for children**

PSA 17:14; ; PRO 13:22; ; 2CO 12:14

To provide for others

DEU 14:28–14:29; ; 1CO 16:2; ; EPH 4:28

Examples of thrift**Noah****GEN 6:21****Joseph****GEN 41:48** See also GEN 41:28–41:36, GEN 41:53**Solomon**

1KI 9:17–9:19 parallel 2CH 8:4–8:6

Jehoshaphat

2CH 17:12

Hezekiah

2CH 32:27–32:29

The good wife

PRO 31:13–31:16

Jesus Christ**JHN 6:12–6:13****The dangers of thrift****Meanness****JHN 12:4–12:6** parallels MAT 26:8–26:9, MRK 14:4–14:5
See also PRO 3:27–3:28, PRO 11:24, PRO 11:26, PRO 23:6–23:8, PRO 28:22; ECC 5:13; 2CO 9:6**Materialism****LUK 12:15** See also ECC 4:8; MIC 6:14; LUK 12:16–12:21**Anxiety****LUK 12:22–12:31** parallel MAT 6:25–6:34**Lack of thrift****LUK 15:13** See also PRO 21:17, PRO 21:20, PRO 23:20–23:21, PRO 29:3; LUK 16:1**Spiritual thrift****MAT 6:19–6:21; EPH 5:15–5:16** See also PRO 10:14; 1TI 6:19**The wicked store up judgment****ROM 2:5–2:6** See also ROM 2:7–2:10; REV 18:6–18:7**5968: timidity****People who were timid in accepting God's call****Moses**

EXO 3:11–3:14, EXO 4:1–4:3, EXO 4:10–4:15, EXO 6:12, EXO 6:30

Gideon

JDG 6:14–6:15, JDG 6:36–6:40

Saul

1SA 9:21, 1SA 15:17

David

1SA 18:18

Jeremiah

JER 1:6

Timothy's timidity**2TI 1:7** See also 1CO 16:10–16:11**Paul's gentleness misunderstood as timidity**

2CO 10:1

Christians are to encourage the timid**1TH 5:14** See also ROM 8:15; 2TI 1:7**5969: treachery**

A betrayal of trust by a close companion, often involving a preconceived plan. Those found guilty of treachery are severely punished by God.

Treachery against God

ZEP 3:4 See also LEV 26:40; ISA 48:8, ISA 59:13

Treachery against other people

2SA 20:9–20:10 See also JDG 16:19 Delilah against Samson; 1SA 18:17 Saul against David; 2SA 3:27 Joab against Abner; 2SA 4:6 Recab and Baanah against Ish-Bosheth; 2SA 11:15 David against Uriah; 2SA 13:28–13:29 Absalom against Amnon; 1KI 21:7–21:13 Jezebel against Naboth; NEH 6:2 Sanballat and Geshem against Nehemiah; EST 3:8 Haman against Mordecai; MAT 26:49 parallels MRK 14:45, LUK 22:47–22:48 Judas against Jesus Christ; ACT 7:18–7:19 Pharaoh against the Israelites

Punishment of the treacherous

ACT 1:18 See also 2SA 18:14–18:15 Absalom; 1KI 2:31–2:34 Joab; 2KI 9:30–9:37 Jezebel; EST 7:10 Haman; PSA 25:3, PSA 59:5; ISA 33:1

Treachery in the purposes of God

ACT 4:27–4:28 See also GEN 50:20; JDG 9:22–9:24; 2KI 9:23, 2KI 11:14 parallel 2CH 23:13

5970: unhappiness

A sense of despondency or sadness, often linked with disappointment or loss. Scripture documents human unhappiness in response to a number of situations, while recalling God's unhappiness over the folly and rebelliousness of sinful humanity.

Unhappiness as the result of adverse circumstances

PSA 90:10; MAT 26:21–26:22 parallel MRK 14:19 See also GEN 26:34–26:35, GEN 40:6–40:7, GEN 42:24; 1SA 1:8, 1SA 1:15; NEH 1:4, NEH 2:1–2:3 Artaxerxes queries Nehemiah's sadness; JOB 17:7, JOB 30:25; PSA 10:1, PSA 13:2, PSA 31:9; PRO 17:21, PRO 17:25; ISA 19:8–19:10; JER 45:3

Unhappiness caused by loss

2SA 19:1; JHN 16:5–16:6 Jesus Christ had just foretold his departure. See also GEN 38:12, GEN 42:38, GEN 48:7; 2SA 1:26, 2SA 14:2; JOL 1:8; MAT 17:23; LUK 22:45, LUK 24:17; JHN 20:11 Mary weeps at Jesus Christ's tomb; ACT 20:38; PHP 2:27; 1TH 4:13

Unhappiness over failure and sin

EZK 9:4; 1CO 5:1–5:2 See also NUM 14:39; JDG 20:26, JDG 21:6; 1SA 2:33; NEH 8:9–8:11; PSA 88:1–88:9, PSA 107:39; LAM 1:4–1:5; EZK 21:6–21:7; ZEC 12:10; MAT 27:3 Judas seized with remorse at his betrayal of Jesus Christ; LUK 22:62; ROM 9:2; 2CO 2:2–2:5, 2CO 7:8–7:11

Unhappiness caused by a person's own selfishness

1TI 6:10 See also 1KI 21:4; EST 6:12; PRO 23:29–23:30; MAT 19:22 parallels MRK 10:22, LUK 18:23

Jesus Christ knew unhappiness

JHN 11:35 See also MAT 26:38 parallel MRK 14:34; JHN 11:33, JHN 12:27, JHN 13:21

God also grieves

GEN 6:6–6:7 Prior to the flood; **EPH 4:30** See also GEN 18:20; 1SA 15:11, 1SA 15:35; 2SA 24:16; PSA 78:40; ISA 63:10; JER 42:10

God's remedy for unhappiness

LAM 3:32–3:33; 1PE 1:6 See also PSA 6:7–6:8, PSA 10:14, PSA 31:9, PSA 116:1–116:6; ISA 35:10, ISA 51:11, ISA 60:20, ISA 61:1–61:3; JER 8:18, JER 31:12–31:13; JHN 16:20–16:22

5971: uniqueness

The quality of being without an equal. Scripture stresses the uniqueness of God and of the salvation that is available only from him. Jesus Christ is the unique mediator between God and humanity.

The uniqueness of God

ISA 40:25 See also EXO 8:10; 1SA 2:2; ISA 40:18; 1TI 1:17, 1TI 6:15–6:16; JUD 1:25

As a forgiver of sins

MRK 2:7

The uniqueness of the Trinity

The three persons are distinct

All use the first person singular pronoun: JHN 12:28, JHN 17:4; ; ACT 13:2; 1CO 12:4–12:6; ; EPH 4:4–4:5

God is one

DEU 6:4 See also ISA 44:6, ISA 45:5–45:6; EPH 4:6; JAS 2:9

There is plurality in the Godhead

GEN 1:26–1:27, GEN 3:22, GEN 11:5–11:7; ; ISA 6:8; ; MAT 28:20; ; 2CO 13:14

The uniqueness of Jesus Christ

As God's Son

JHN 3:16 NIV footnote "only begotten" indicates that Jesus Christ is the unique Son of God, in origin, eternity and nature. See also JHN 1:18; COL 1:15; HEB 1:1–1:3, HEB 1:8, HEB 1:9

As the mediator between God and humanity

1TI 2:5 See also JHN 1:14; HEB 8:6

As the sacrifice for sin

HEB 7:27 See also ROM 6:10; HEB 9:12, HEB 10:10, HEB 10:14, HEB 10:18

As the Saviour

ACT 4:12; JHN 14:6 See also 1JN 5:12

As the foundation

1CO 3:11

The uniqueness of Scripture

JUD 1:3 See also 2TI 3:15–3:16; HEB 1:1–1:2; REV 22:18–22:19

Each human being is unique

PSA 139:13–139:16 See also JER 1:5; GAL 1:15

Each believer is unique

REV 2:17 See also ISA 43:1; JHN 10:3; 1CO 8:3, 1CO 12:21; GAL 4:9; 2TI 2:19

5972: unkindness

Unsympathetic or cruel behaviour. It is contrary to God's character and is condemned in Scripture.

Unkindness condemned**In general terms**

PRO 11:17 See also PRO 17:5, PRO 25:20; EPH 4:31–4:32

Treatment of enemies

MAT 5:43–5:44 See also EXO 23:4–23:5; PRO 25:21; LUK 6:27–6:28, LUK 6:35; ROM 12:14

Treatment of the poor

PRO 14:31; 1JN 3:17 See also DEU 15:7, DEU 24:14; PRO 21:13; ISA 3:15, ISA 10:1–10:2; EZK 22:29; ZEC 7:10

Treatment of animals

PRO 12:10 See also LEV 22:28; DEU 22:6, DEU 25:4; LUK 13:15, LUK 14:5

Inhospitality condemned

1PE 4:9 See also DEU 23:4; MAT 25:41–25:43; LUK 9:52–9:53; HEB 13:2; 3JN 1:10

Some examples of unkindness

1SA 11:2; ; 2SA 12:4; ; 2KI 25:7; ; NEH 5:5–5:6; ; JOB 24:2–24:12; ; PSA 35:15, PSA 69:20–69:21, PSA 109:16; ; EZK 34:4; ; AMO 1:11, AMO 5:11; ; JAS 2:15–2:16

God's kindness as a model for believers

RUT 2:20; ; EZR 9:9; ; ISA 63:7; ; ACT 14:17; ; ROM 2:4, ROM 11:22; ; EPH 2:7

5973: unreliability

The quality of a person or thing that cannot be trusted or relied upon. Scripture notes the unreliability of

human nature, while stressing the total reliability of God.

Human nature is unreliable

PSA 78:57 See also ISA 49:15; HOS 6:4; 2CO 1:9

Examples of unreliable people

GEN 40:23 the chief cupbearer; ; ISA 13:13–13:14 King Saul; ; HOS 5:13 Israel; MAT 26:40 parallels MRK 14:37, LUK 22:45; ; MAT 26:56 parallel MRK 14:50

Unreliable people are not to be trusted

PRO 25:19 See also PSA 146:3–146:4; ISA 2:22

False gods are unreliable

ISA 45:20 See also DEU 4:28; PSA 115:4–115:8; ISA 40:20; JER 10:5, JER 10:10, JER 10:14–10:15, JER 51:17–51:18; DAN 5:23; HAB 2:18; MAT 24:5 parallels MRK 13:6, LUK 21:8

Human wisdom is unreliable

1CO 3:19–3:20 See also JDG 20:36; JOB 5:13; ISA 30:12–30:13, ISA 59:4; EZK 28:6–28:7; ROM 1:22; 1CO 1:19–1:21, 1CO 1:25; COL 2:23

Military strength is unreliable

PSA 44:6 See also 1SA 17:45; PSA 33:16–33:17; ISA 31:1, ISA 36:4–36:6; EZK 33:26; HOS 1:7; HAG 2:22; MAT 26:52

Material wealth is unreliable

PRO 11:28 See also PSA 62:10; JER 49:4; HAG 1:9, HAG 2:16–2:17; ZEC 9:3–9:4; MAT 6:19, MAT 13:22 parallels MRK 4:19, LUK 8:14; 1TI 6:9–6:10

The consequences of unreliability**Unreliable actions let God down**

HOS 11:2–11:3 See also ISA 5:7; JER 2:21; MAT 26:34 parallels MRK 14:30, LUK 22:34; LUK 16:10–16:12

Unreliability leads to disappointment

JAS 1:7–1:8 See also MAT 21:30, MAT 21:43; LUK 16:10–16:12; ACT 15:37–15:38

Trust in unreliable things**Leads to self-delusion**

ISA 44:20 See also ISA 47:10; LUK 12:20; REV 3:17

Leads to judgment

JER 17:5 See also PSA 49:13–49:14, PSA 52:5–52:7; ISA 20:5; JER 46:25; AMO 6:1, AMO 6:7

Unreliable people are judged

EZK 13:9 See also ISA 20:6; MAL 2:7–2:9; MAT 23:38, MAT 25:26–25:27 parallel LUK 19:22–19:23

God is never unreliable

NUM 23:19 See also 1KI 8:56; PSA 71:6; JHN 8:26; 2CO 1:20; TIT 1:2; HEB 6:18; 1JN 4:13–4:16

5974: value

God places inestimable value on the human soul. He paid the redemption price of the blood of his son Jesus Christ to purchase his own people who are precious to him. Everything that achieves or maintains this relationship is to be valued.

Redemptive values of people, animals and property

LEV 27:1–27:25 These are the values for recovering or buying back what has been dedicated to God. They were designed to teach the Israelites the great cost of redemption.

The value of Jesus Christ

The betrayal price

MAT 26:14–26:15 parallels MRK 14:10–14:11, LUK 22:3–22:6 See also JER 32:6–32:9; ZEC 11:12–11:13; MAT 27:9

His true value

PHP 3:8 See also MAT 13:44–13:46; 1PE 2:4–2:7

The value of people

They are made in the image of God

GEN 1:26–1:27 Being made in God's image gives humanity intrinsic worth and dignity. See also PSA 8:3–8:8; COL 3:10; HEB 2:6–2:8

The inestimable value of a human soul

PSA 49:7–49:8 See also MAT 16:26 parallel MRK 8:37

The redemptive price of a soul

1PE 1:18–1:19 See also MAT 20:28 parallel MRK 10:45; ACT 20:28; 1CO 6:20, 1CO 7:23; REV 5:9

The value of God's people to him

1PE 2:4 See also PSA 116:15; ISA 43:3–43:4; MAT 6:26 parallel LUK 12:24; MAT 10:31 parallel LUK 12:7; MAT 12:12

The value of Christian life and service

Godly character

1TI 4:8 See also 1TI 6:6; 1PE 3:4

Spiritual wisdom

JOB 28:12–28:19; ; PRO 3:13–3:15, PRO 8:11, PRO 8:19, PRO 16:16; ; JAS 3:13–3:17

Steadfast faith

1PE 1:7 See also JOB 23:10

Faithful service

DEU 15:18; ; MAT 10:10 parallel LUK 10:7

Good leadership

2SA 18:3; ; 1TI 5:17–5:18

Friendship

2SA 1:26 See also 1TH 2:8; PHM 1:12, PHM 1:16

A good marriage

PRO 31:10 See also PRO 12:4, PRO 18:22

5975: violence

Unrestrained physical or verbal force designed to hurt others, or to gain mastery over them.

The world is full of violence

GEN 6:11–6:13; ; JOB 24:2–24:4; ; PSA 55:9, PSA 74:20; ; PRO 13:2; ; ISA 59:1–59:8; ; EZK 7:23; ; MIC 2:1–2:2

God hates violence

PSA 11:5, PSA 139:19; ; JER 22:3; ; EZK 45:9; ; MAL 2:16

Jesus Christ was not violent

ISA 42:1–42:3, ISA 53:9; ; 1PE 2:23

Christians should not be violent

GAL 5:19–5:21; ; EPH 4:2, EPH 4:31; ; PHP 4:5

Christian leaders should not be violent

1CH 22:8–22:9; ; 1TI 3:3; ; 2TI 2:24; ; TIT 1:7

God helps the victims of violence

2SA 22:3, 2SA 22:49; ; PSA 18:48, PSA 72:14, PSA 140:1–140:4; ; MAT 2:13; ; LUK 22:50–22:51

Christians should help the victims of violence

GEN 14:14; ; 2CH 28:9–28:15; ; JER 38:9–38:12; ; LUK 10:30, LUK 10:33; ; ACT 23:15–23:16

5976: visiting

Calling to see a person or place. Examples include pilgrims to Jerusalem and those visiting family and friends. Visiting those in need, especially the sick and bereaved, is particularly important. Individuals and churches are encouraged and strengthened by visits from other believers.

Visiting particular people or places

Pilgrims visit Jerusalem

LUK 24:18 See also LUK 2:41; JHN 5:1, JHN 12:12; ACT 2:9–2:11, ACT 8:27–8:28

Visiting family, friends, etc

LUK 11:6 EXO 2:11; ; ACT 7:23; JDG 15:1; MAT 21:17; ; MRK 11:11; ; LUK 10:38–10:42; ; JHN 11:20; JHN 4:43–4:46 Jesus Christ visits his home region of Galilee.

Visits from foreign dignitaries

2CH 9:1 parallel 1KI 10:1–10:2 See also 2CH 18:2 parallel 1KI 22:2; 2KI 20:12–20:13 parallel ISA 39:1–39:2; JER 27:3

Further examples

GEN 34:1, GEN 42:2; ; ACT 7:12–7:15; ; NUM 22:7–22:8; ; 1SA 28:8

Visiting those in need

JOB 2:11; MAT 25:36 See also JOB 42:11; MAT 25:39–25:40

The sick

2KI 8:29 parallel 2CH 22:6; ; 2KI 13:14; ; JAS 5:14

The bereaved

GEN 37:34–37:35; ; 1CH 7:22; ; JHN 11:19, JHN 11:45

Visiting fellow believers**Official visits**

ACT 15:2 See also ACT 11:30, ACT 15:22; GAL 2:1–2:2

Visiting churches

ACT 9:32 See also ACT 11:27; 1CO 16:10; 2CO 8:22–8:24; GAL 2:11; PHP 2:19; 2JN 1:12

Paul visits the churches

ACT 15:36–15:41 See also ACT 19:21; ROM 15:23–15:29; 1CO 16:5–16:6; 2CO 1:15–1:16, 2CO 2:1, 2CO 12:14; 1TH 2:1

Visiting individuals

TIT 3:12 See also ACT 28:15; PHP 2:25; 3JN 1:13–1:14

Visiting prisoners

2TI 1:16–1:17 See also 2TI 4:9–4:13; PHM 1:12–1:13; HEB 13:3

Divine visitors**Angels**

HEB 13:2 See also GEN 18:1–18:2, GEN 19:1; JDG 6:11–6:12, JDG 13:3–13:22; LUK 1:11, LUK 1:26–1:28

The day of God's visitation

1PE 2:12 See also ISA 10:3; JER 46:21; MIC 7:4; LUK 19:44

5977: waiting

Being in readiness for service or for some future appointment or event. Wild animals and the wicked lie in wait to ambush the unsuspecting; servants wait on their masters; believers and the whole creation wait for their renewal by God. God, too, waits for sinners to repent.

Waiting for future events**Waiting to see what happens**

RUT 3:18; ; JON 4:5; ; ACT 28:6

Waiting for a period of time

GEN 8:10–8:12; ; LEV 12:4–12:5; ; EZK 44:26

Waiting for people**Waiting to meet others**

EXO 5:20, EXO 7:15; ; 2SA 16:1; ; 1KI 20:38

Waiting to be joined by others

1CO 11:33 See also EXO 24:14; ACT 17:16, ACT 20:5–20:6; 1CO 11:21

Waiting for word from others

JOB 29:21–29:23 See also 1SA 10:8, 1SA 20:19; 2SA 15:28; LUK 3:15

Waiting for God**For God's instruction**

NUM 9:8; ; PSA 106:13; ; HAB 2:1

For God's promise

HEB 6:15 See also HAB 2:3; LUK 24:49; ACT 1:4–1:5; HEB 11:13

For God's kingdom

LUK 2:25; ; MRK 15:43 parallel LUK 23:51

For vindication from God

HAB 3:16 See also PSA 119:84; ISA 51:5; ZEP 3:8; REV 6:11

For Jesus Christ's return

JAS 5:7–5:8 See also LUK 12:36; 1CO 1:7; 1TH 1:10; HEB 9:28

Believers and creation wait for renewal

ROM 8:19–8:21, ROM 8:23 See also ISA 65:17; ROM 8:11; 1CO 15:42–15:43; 2PE 3:13; 1JN 3:2; REV 21:1

Lying in wait to attack**Preparing for military assault**

JOS 8:9; ; JDG 9:32–9:33

Criminals wait for victims

PRO 1:11–1:13 See also DEU 19:11; PSA 10:8; PRO 23:27–23:28, PRO 24:15; JER 5:26

The wicked lie in wait for God's servants

PSA 37:32 See also JDG 16:2 The Philistines lay in wait for Samson; PSA 59:3, PSA 71:10–71:11, PSA 119:95; JER 20:10 Jeremiah's enemies were looking for an opportunity against him; ACT 23:21 Some Jews were waiting to kill Paul.

Jesus Christ's enemies waited to trap him

LUK 11:53–11:54; JHN 7:1 See also MAT 12:10 parallel MRK 3:2; MRK 11:18 parallel LUK 19:47; MRK 12:13; LUK 20:20

Animals lie in wait for prey

JOB 38:40; ; PSA 10:9; ; JER 5:6; ; LAM 3:10

Waiting as delaying

JOS 18:3 See also JDG 18:9; 2KI 7:9, 2KI 9:3; ECC 5:4; JER 4:6; ACT 22:16

Waiting as a servant

MAT 8:15 parallels MRK 1:31, LUK 4:39 See also 1KI 1:4; LUK 12:37, LUK 17:8; ACT 6:2

God waits for sinners to repent

2PE 3:9 See also LUK 15:20; ROM 2:4; 1TI 1:16; 1PE 3:20

5978: warning

Telling someone of coming disaster or danger or of the consequences of their action or attitude. Scripture gives strong warnings against idolatry, sin and false teaching.

Warnings of coming disaster or danger

GEN 41:28–41:32 See also GEN 19:12–19:13; EST 4:12–4:17; MAT 24:6–24:7 parallels MRK 13:7–13:8, LUK 21:9–21:11; MAT 24:15–24:22 parallels MRK 13:14–13:20, LUK 21:20–21:24; ACT 21:10–21:11, ACT 23:16–23:21

Warnings against idolatry

DEU 6:14–6:15, DEU 8:19 See also DEU 7:25, DEU 11:16, DEU 29:18–29:21; JER 7:9–7:15, JER 25:4–25:11; 1CO 10:7–10:11; 1JN 5:21

Warnings against sin

2CH 19:10; MAT 5:29–5:30 See also GEN 2:16–2:17; ISA 13:11; JER 21:14; EZK 3:17–3:19, EZK 33:7–33:9; JHN 5:14; ACT 2:40; ROM 2:8–2:9, ROM 6:23; 1CO 6:9–6:10; 2TH 1:8–1:9

Warnings against false teaching

GAL 1:7–1:8; 2PE 3:17 See also MAT 10:32–10:33 parallel LUK 12:8–12:10; MAT 16:6; LUK 12:1; PHP 3:2; COL 2:8; TIT 1:10–1:11; 2JN 1:7–1:11; JUD 1:4

5979: waste

The misuse and squandering of resources. God condemns the waste of resources which he provides, especially spiritual provisions such as grace and opportunity. Sometimes extravagance in God's service is mistaken for waste.

Waste of material resources

Squandering is folly

LUK 15:13–15:16 See also PRO 21:20, PRO 29:3; LUK 16:1; JAS 5:1–5:6; 1PE 4:3–4:5

As a consequence of yielding to temptation

PRO 29:3 See also PRO 5:7–5:14

Jesus Christ avoids waste

JHN 6:12–6:13

Spiritual resources should not be wasted

God's grace

JON 2:8 See also JHN 12:35–12:36; 2CO 6:1; GAL 4:9–4:11; HEB 10:26–10:29, HEB 10:35; 2PE 2:21

God-given abilities

MAT 25:14–25:30; ; LUK 19:12–19:27

Opportunities for service

EPH 5:16 See also JHN 9:4; GAL 6:10; COL 4:5

Spiritual teaching

MAT 7:6 Spiritual teaching is wasted if inappropriate to the spiritual capacity of the hearers. See also PRO 9:7, PRO 23:9; 1CO 2:14

Examples of wasted lives

Esau

Esau lived for the pleasures of the moment and threw away his spiritual inheritance: GEN 25:29–25:34; ; HEB 12:16

Samson

JDG 16:18–16:21 Though Samson did retrieve something at the end of his life, his spiritual gift of supernatural strength was largely wasted through his indulgence in sexual immorality.

King Saul

1SA 16:21; ; 2SA 1:17–1:27 Through natural strength and spiritual gifts Saul had the prospect of establishing a successful royal dynasty. The future was lost through disobedience and the end of his reign was wasted through jealousy.

Judas Iscariot

MAT 27:3–27:5 Judas had the best of opportunities—three years with Jesus Christ. This was thrown away in a moment of personal ambition.

Devotion to God is not waste

MAT 26:6–26:13 parallel MRK 14:3–14:9 See also JHN 12:1–12:8

Waste as the destruction of life and land

The frailty of human beings

JOB 13:28 See also JOB 33:21; PSA 32:3; LAM 4:9; 2CO 4:16

Waste as a result of the judgment of God

JER 34:22 See also LEV 26:31–26:33, LEV 26:39; NUM 5:21; DEU 28:22, DEU 29:23, DEU 32:24; PSA 106:43; ISA 24:1, ISA 24:3; EZK 4:17; HOS 5:9